THE GHISSU MODEL ANSWER SERIES



With a foreword by BHARGAVA V

IRMS, UPSC CSE 2024 · FORMER ASST. COMMISSIONER, APPSC GROUP-I 2023

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS

Paper IV

Economy and Development of India and Andhra Pradesh

MODEL ANSWERS TO PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

2008 *to* 2025

232 questions · in handwriting style

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

FOUNDER · GHISSU.COM

FOREWORD

When I sat for APPSC Group-I Mains, I noticed that most aspirants in the hall knew the content. What separated the final list was how each answer met the exact demand of the question within the time and the pages available. That is why understanding the syllabus, analysing previous year questions (PYQs) and following the trends in the pattern matter so much.

During my own preparation, I worked extensively with the APPSC Mains PYQs. I answered each question myself, working on how I presented the answer and on the value additions I could bring to it. This improved the presentation of my content, and with it, my confidence. Technology gave me an extra edge as well: I used AI to refine my answers.

This book brings together previous year questions with model answers written to the demand of the exam. It analyses the examination from every angle, which makes the aspirant's journey simpler and more focused. Attempt each question yourself before you read the model answer, and then compare. You can also get your written answer evaluated on ghissu.com. Practicing these questions year by year will sharpen your sense of the demand, the structure and the depth that score marks.

I hope this book helps aspirants prepare with clarity and confidence, and succeed in realising their goals.

All the best,

BHARGAVA V
Indian Railway Management Service (IRMS)
UPSC Civil Services Examination 2024
Former Assistant Commissioner of State Tax, Andhra Pradesh
(APPSC Group-I, 2023)

A FREE RESOURCE FROM GHISSU

Preface

APPSC Group-I Mains is a writing exam. The syllabus tells you what to study. The previous papers show you what the commission actually asks, how it words each question and how much it expects for ten marks. This book gives you every question from eight sittings, 2008 to 2025, each with an answer written the way an aspirant can write it in the exam hall.

How this book is arranged

Each paper is a separate book. Inside it, the questions run year by year, newest first, with the same order and numbering as the official question papers. The arrangement follows the latest APPSC syllabus. Questions from the older sittings, when the papers were organised differently, are placed in the paper they belong to today, and their label shows where they were first printed. Every answer fits in three pages, the space the 44-page answer booklet allows per question. The answers are drafted with Ghissu's Model Answer engine, then checked and edited, and set in a handwriting style so you can see exactly what three pages in the exam hall look like.

Why this book

After graduating in Mathematics and Computing Engineering from DTU, New Delhi, I spent years as an aspirant myself. I wrote two UPSC Civil Services Mains, two APPSC Group-I Mains and one APPSC Group-II Mains. I am still a learner, walking the same path as you.

Then, for nearly two years, I worked on the other side as Mentor-cum-Head Reviewer at Vajiram & Ravi, New Delhi, where I headed the evaluation of its Mains Test Series. I reviewed more than 10,000 answer copies, trained over 600 evaluators and mentored more than 100 aspirants. One lesson stayed with me: marks are rarely lost because of too little reading. They are lost when the demand is only half answered, the structure wanders or the conclusion says nothing. These are habits, and habits change only through writing and honest feedback.

This book is half of the method

A model answer shows you where to reach. It cannot show you how far your own answer is from it. That is what ghissu.com is for. There you will find the same questions arranged subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise. Alongside them are UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 that match the APPSC syllabus, and more practice questions that cover each topic fully. You can write an answer, get it evaluated within minutes, and compare it with the exam-hall thinking, toppers' answers and value additions for that question.

> **To use the topic-wise PYQs and resources:** sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist. Requests are usually approved within one or two days. The next pages explain how to use this book and the website together.

An apology, in advance

Every question and every answer has been checked with care. Even so, some errors may remain. If you find anything that could be clearer or more accurate, please write to **hello@ghissu.com**. Every correction makes the book better for the next reader.

With best wishes,

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

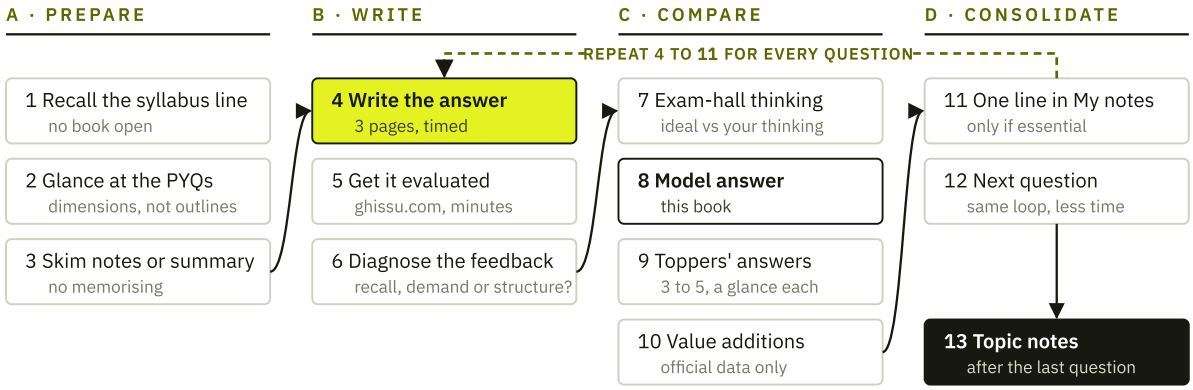
Founder, ghissu.com

READ THIS BEFORE THE FIRST QUESTION

How to use this book with ghissu.com

Keeping a book of model answers open in front of you feels like preparation, but it is passive reading, and passive reading fades. The method below keeps you active at every stage: you recall before you read, you write before you compare, and you compare in order to find the half mark you left behind in each part of the answer, from the introduction to the conclusion.

It assumes you have covered the syllabus once from a standard book or a coaching programme. Work topic by topic, using the topic-wise view of these questions on ghissu.com, and keep a time limit for every step.



Where the website comes in. Every answer page in this book carries a QR code at the bottom right, and every question in the index has a Practice link. Both open that exact question on ghissu.com, where you can upload a handwritten answer, type it against a running timer, or dictate it by voice.

SUGGESTED TIME FOR THE FIRST QUESTIONS OF A TOPIC	MINUTES
Recall, glance at the PYQs and skim your notes (steps 1 to 3, once per topic)	10 to 15
Write the answer at exam pace (step 4)	12
Read the feedback and the exam-hall thinking (steps 5 to 7)	8 to 10
Model answer, toppers' answers and value additions (steps 8 to 10)	8 to 10

A beginner may need 30 to 45 minutes for each of the first one to three questions of a sub-topic. That is expected. The time falls with every question, and what you gain is the confidence to attempt any question from the topic, at any time.

PHASE A Prepare, without opening the answers

1 **Recall the syllabus line.** Read the line from the syllabus and brainstorm everything you remember about it, on paper.

2 **Glance at the previous questions.** See which questions were asked and along which dimensions. Do not outline or think deeply yet. This shows the gaps in what you recalled and where the marks in this topic usually lie.

3 **Skim your notes.** If you have notes, skim them without trying to memorise. If not, read the summary, strategy, value addition and toppers' answers for the topic on ghissu.com, just enough to attempt the first question with confidence.

PHASE B Write and get feedback

4 **Write the first question.** Do not wait for the perfect moment; there is none. Answer writing is the skill the examiner tests most, more than reading or revision. If the topic has few APPSC questions, ghissu.com adds the related UPSC questions and practice questions.

5 **Get it evaluated.** Submit a full answer, or only a quick outline, on ghissu.com. Feedback returns in two to three minutes. Upload a handwritten page, type with the timer running, or dictate, whichever suits your day.

6 **Diagnose before you read further.** Find the one major issue. If it is only recall, move on; it disappears as you finish the topic. If it is a missed demand or a weak structure, slow down and understand it with the exam-hall thinking for that question. Ask Ghissu and the Ghissu bull can explain further, in your own language.

PHASE C Compare with the ideal

7 **Exam-hall thinking.** See how the question is broken down: its demand and structure, how to open the introduction, how to generate points, which frameworks and value additions to use and how to conclude. Measure the distance between your thinking and the ideal. By the end of a topic, your own thinking will often go further.

8 **The model answer in this book.** Note new terms, data and value additions, and see how a complete answer fits three pages. Do not memorise it.

9 **Toppers' answers.** Glance through three to five toppers' answers on ghissu.com, drawn from more than 1.5 lakh answers, mostly by UPSC toppers. The APPSC syllabus overlaps heavily with UPSC, so they apply directly. Spend little time on each. Your mind will start to notice how they earn the extra half mark in each part, and their keywords will come back to you in the hall.

10 **Value additions.** For the latest figures and data, use the value additions on the question or the topic. They are taken from official government sources, ready to quote in an answer.

PHASE D Consolidate

11 **Hold back the notes.** Do not write short notes after a single question; you will end up copying everything. If something is essential, add it to My notes on that question. Your notes collect topic by topic on their own, so nothing is written twice.

12 **Next question, same loop.** Repeat steps 4 to 11 for every question in the topic, keeping to the time limits so that no step runs away with your day.

13 **Write your topic notes last.** When every question is done, write one to three ways to open and close an answer on this topic, a few multi-dimensional points each for positives, negatives and the way forward, and the keywords and frameworks you will break a question into. Fifteen to twenty points and a diagram are enough to reproduce in the exam. The strategy section of each topic on ghissu.com helps, but your own versions matter more.

APPSC Group-I Mains · Paper IV

Model answers in handwriting style, 2008 to 2025, numbered as in the official papers · latest-syllabus arrangement

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).
Click a question to open its model answer. "Practice" opens the same question on ghissu.com.

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2025	30 answers		
1(a)	Analyse the factors contributing to India's Current Account Deficit (CAD) and unfavourable Balance of Payments (BoP) and discuss their implications for the Indian...	21	Practice →
1(b)	Discuss how infrastructure bottlenecks hinder the growth of the Indian Manufacturing sector. What steps can be taken to address them?	24	Practice →
2(a)	Discuss the key instruments of Monetary Policy (RBI) and Fiscal Policy in India and evaluate their role in resource mobilisation and inflation management.	27	Practice →
2(b)	Differentiate between internal and external public debt. Explain their relative advantages and risks for a developing country like India.	30	Practice →
3(a)	Critically evaluate the role of education and healthcare in achieving inclusive and sustainable development in India. Highlight the current challenges and government...	33	Practice →
3(b)	Explain the major sources of budgetary resources for Andhra Pradesh. What are the key challenges the state faces in mobilising adequate financial resources?	36	Practice →
4(a)	What do you understand by Government Budget? Briefly explain the types of public expenditure and how these expenditures are classified in the government budget.	39	Practice →
4(b)	Define the term 'deficit' in government finance. Explain the various types of deficits and their economic implications.	42	Practice →
5(a)	Discuss the role of the State Finance Commission in Andhra Pradesh and analyse its significance in strengthening local finances and promoting fiscal decentralisation withi...	45	Practice →
5(b)	Discuss the key recommendations of the Fifteenth Finance Commission of India. How do these recommendations influence government budgeting at the centre and state...	48	Practice →
6(a)	What are the challenges faced by women in India? Throw some light on the recent programmes initiated by the government for women empowerment.	51	Practice →
6(b)	Elaborate on the meaning of Inclusive Growth in the context of the Indian economy. Discuss the key strategies and instruments that can be employed to foster greater...	54	Practice →
7(a)	Critically Examine the major poverty alleviation and employment generation programmes in India. How effective have they been in addressing rural and urban...	57	Practice →
7(b)	Discuss the significance of Social Welfare Schemes in promoting inclusive growth in India. Analyse the key objectives and features of some major social welfare schemes...	60	Practice →
8(a)	Examine the concept of 'Financial Inclusion' and its critical role in fostering inclusive growth in India. Discuss the key initiatives undertaken to promote financial inclusion an...	63	Practice →
8(b)	Explain the concept of sustainable agriculture. What are its key objectives and common practices in India?	66	Practice →
9(a)	Explain the role of the Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC) Act in Agricultural Price Policy in regulating the agricultural market in India. What are the...	69	Practice →
9(b)	Examine the significance of agriculture finance, production, and marketing in the context of India's agricultural development. Discuss the challenges and opportunities...	72	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
10(a)	What are the key drivers for the growth of the fisheries sector? What are the schemes undertaken by the fisheries department for the growth of this sector?	75	Practice →
10(b)	Discuss the role of agriculture in the economic development of Andhra Pradesh. How has agriculture contributed to the State Gross Domestic Product (SGDP) in recent...	78	Practice →
11(a)	Examine the role of the industrial sector in India's economic development. How does industrialisation contribute to income generation, employment, and modernisation of...	81	Practice →
11(b)	Examine the role of the Startup India programme in promoting entrepreneurial development in India. What are the major features of the programme, and how has it...	84	Practice →
12(a)	Critically Examine the industrial policy of the Andhra Pradesh government. What are the major initiatives, support measures and bottlenecks to industrial development in the...	87	Practice →
12(b)	Discuss the role of the industrial sector in the economic development of India. Discuss the role of the Department of Industrial Policy & Promotion (DIPP).	90	Practice →
13(a)	Discuss the current state of transport infrastructure in India and its contribution to economic development. Highlight key challenges and suggest policy measures for...	93	Practice →
13(b)	Discuss the significance of solar energy in India's renewable energy strategy. Highlight the major initiatives, achievements and challenges in the promotion of solar power.	96	Practice →
14(a)	Critically evaluate the role of the Smart Cities Mission in transforming urban infrastructure in India. Mention its objectives, implementation progress, key...	99	Practice →
14(b)	Critically explain the development of Transport, Energy and ICT infrastructure in Andhra Pradesh. How do these sectors contribute to the state's economic growth an...	102	Practice →
15(a)	Discuss the significance of the recommendations of the latest Finance Commission for the fiscal relations between the Union Government and the States in India, with specifi...	105	Practice →
15(b)	What are the flaws in the existing Public Private Partnership (PPP) model of infrastructure development? What are the key points to focus on while restructuring th...	108	Practice →
2023	30 answers		
1(a)	Discuss the impact of 'New Age' reforms on the Indian Economy in the last eight years. Examine the scope of growth potential for India in this decade (2023 – 30).	112	Practice →
1(b)	Is the exchange rate of the Indian Rupee fully determined by the market ? Explain the effects of Rupee Depreciation on the Indian Economy. Discuss the role of the RBI in...	115	Practice →
2(a)	What is meant by Monetary Policy Transmission? Explain the issues experienced during the process of Monetary Policy and suggest steps to overcome these issues.	118	Practice →
2(b)	What are the different fiscal policy tools used in India ? Can Customs and Excise Duties be used as flexible fiscal policy tools in order to increase revenue and control inflation...	121	Practice →
3(a)	What are externally aided projects ? Discuss the principles, funding and objectives of Andhra Pradesh Irrigation and Agriculture Transformation Project (APIIATP). Provide a...	124	Practice →
3(b)	Briefly discuss the impact of bifurcation on the economy of Andhra Pradesh with respect to sectoral changes and resource gap. Provide a brief note on the steps take...	127	Practice →
4(a)	What is meant by the 'Goods and Services Tax' (GST) ? Explain the steps taken by the Indian Government to facilitate trade and 'ease of doing business' under the GST...	130	Practice →
4(b)	Mention the recommendations of the 15th Finance Commission with respect to Fiscal Consolidation. Discuss the progress and present situation of 'Fiscal Consolidation' in...	133	Practice →
5(a)	Explain the importance of budgetary policy in reallocation of resources. Briefly discuss the allocation of budgetary resources in the social services sector with respect to the...	136	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
5(b)	What is meant by 'Gender Budgeting' and 'Child Budgeting' ? Does Andhra Pradesh follow gender budgeting and child budgeting ? Evaluate.	139	Practice →
6(a)	Describe the scope of 'Differentiated Banking Policy' with respect to financial inclusion in India. Analyse the potential of Digital Banking in improving financial inclusion in India.	142	Practice →
6(b)	Explain the challenges faced by women entrepreneurs in India. Discuss the schemes and initiatives taken by the Indian Government with respect to facilitating women...	145	Practice →
7(a)	Discuss the types and sources of agricultural credit in India. Explain the initiatives taken by the Indian Government in order to improve access to agricultural credit.	148	Practice →
7(b)	What is meant by sustainable agriculture? Discuss the sustainable agriculture practices and systems in India. Provide suggestions to improve agricultural incomes from...	151	Practice →
8(a)	Explain the scope and benefits of farm mechanization. Discuss the implementation of farm mechanization schemes in Andhra Pradesh with special reference to Community...	154	Practice →
8(b)	Explain the extent of marine fishery resources in Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the steps taken by the Andhra Pradesh Government in order to promote the welfare and...	157	Practice →
9(a)	What is meant by 'Strategic Disinvestment' ? Explain the different methods of Disinvestment adopted since the re-christening of Department of Disinvestment (DO...	160	Practice →
9(b)	What is meant by 'Industrial Revolution 4·0' ? Assess the likely impact of the fourth industrial revolution on India's manufacturing sector. Provide a brief note on the...	163	Practice →
10(a)	With respect to the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Andhra Pradesh, discuss the following : (i) Importance of MSMEs in Andhra Pradesh economy (ii) Scop...	166	Practice →
10(b)	Explain the development programme of Visakhapatnam Chennai Industrial Corridor Development Program (VCICDP). Write a short note on the socio-economic impact of...	169	Practice →
11(a)	Explain the impact of Digital Public Infrastructure on the socio-economic development in India. Discuss the steps taken by the Indian Government to accelerate digital...	172	Practice →
11(b)	What are the features of a 'Smart City'? Explain the role of smart cities in economic development. Discuss the challenges faced in financing the smart cities under the...	175	Practice →
12(a)	Explain the 'PUSH' strategy of the Government of Andhra Pradesh with respect to Export Promotion Policy (2022 – 27). Discuss the challenges of export sector and the...	178	Practice →
12(b)	Explain the policy framework for development of Civil Aviation in Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the development of Greenfield Airport projects in Andhra Pradesh.	181	Practice →
13(a)	Explain the effects of prevailing low global growth and high global inflation on present Indian domestic growth and inflation. Discuss the methods to control inflation with a...	184	Practice →
13(b)	What are the factors that spur foreign investment in India ? Explain the major features of India's Consolidated Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy. Briefly discuss the presen...	187	Practice →
14(a)	Explain the reasons leading to higher Public Debt in India. Discuss the scope of public debt sustainability in India.	190	Practice →
14(b)	"The focus of the government has shifted from women development to women led development' — Examine this statement in the context of Education, Skilling and...	193	Practice →
15(a)	Explain the impact of rainbow revolution in India. Discuss the scope for Industrial transformation in Indian agriculture.	196	Practice →
15(b)	Explain the regulation of agricultural markets in India. Discuss the scope of farmer-market linkages with a special mention of the e-National Agriculture Market in...	199	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2020	30 answers		
1(a)	State some of the notable initiatives taken by the government recently to boost the growth of manufacturing sector in India.	203	Practice →
1(b)	Highlight some of the major factors leading to low agricultural productivity in India.	206	Practice →
2(a)	What are the factors responsible for the narrow tax base in India? Explain in brief.	209	Practice →
2(b)	Define public debt and give its components with reference to Indian government? Explain trends in public debt since 2010 onwards.	212	Practice →
3(a)	Briefly give an account of revenue and fiscal deficits and the debt positions of Andhra Pradesh for the last five years (since 2014-15).	215	Practice →
3(b)	Give an account of the mineral and forest resources of Andhra Pradesh?	218	Practice →
4(a)	What are the recommendations of the Fourteenth Finance Commission with respect to the grant to local governments, fiscal deficit and FRBM Act?	221	Practice →
4(b)	Differentiate between revenue deficit, fiscal deficit and primary deficit? How does deficit financing impact the economy.	224	Practice →
5(a)	Highlight the areas of central assistance to Andhra Pradesh under the provision of Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act and Fourteenth Finance Commission?	227	Practice →
5(b)	Examine some of the major features of Andhra Pradesh budget for the FY 2020-21 with special reference to fiscal deficit situation of the state.	230	Practice →
6(a)	Analyse trends in rural-urban poverty in Andhra Pradesh. What are the factors responsible for its existence?	233	Practice →
6(b)	Examine major issues concerning public Distribution System in Andhra Pradesh.	236	Practice →
7(a)	What is e-NAM? State the challenges in its implementation.	239	Practice →
7(b)	What do you mean by rainbow revolution? What are its objectives? Discuss.	242	Practice →
8(a)	How has the growth in Andhra Pradesh's agriculture and allied sectors impacted the income levels of the farmers?	245	Practice →
8(b)	Give an account of the different schemes implemented by the Andhra Pradesh government to promote agriculture in the state?	248	Practice →
9(a)	Contrast the Industrial Policy of 1980 with that of 1991 with respect to small enterprises in India.	251	Practice →
9(b)	Critically Examine the performance of public sector in Indian economy.	254	Practice →
10(a)	What are the critical issues that must be addressed before implementing disinvestment policy?	257	Practice →
10(b)	What are the challenges faced by the industrial sector of Andhra Pradesh? Throw light on the strategies created to face these challenges.	260	Practice →
11(a)	Describe some of the key initiatives taken and incentives provided by the government of Andhra Pradesh to promote agro and food processing industry.	263	Practice →
11(b)	Explain the Marginal Cost Pricing Rule for Public Utilities. What are the problems associated with this rule?	266	Practice →
12(a)	In the light of the problems faced by public-private partnerships in India, give recommendations on the future plan of action.	269	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
12(b)	Describe the long term agenda of the Andhra Pradesh government with respect to development of infrastructure in the state.	272	Practice →
13(a)	Discuss the initiatives taken by the Government of India to build smart cities, and highlight the challenges in doing so.	275	Practice →
13(b)	Discuss the Industrial Policy statement 2015-20 of Andhra Pradesh.	278	Practice →
14(a)	What are the challenges faced by energy sector in Andhra Pradesh? Briefly give the vision targets for energy sector set by the AP Government.	281	Practice →
14(b)	Discuss about some of the major initiatives highlighted in Vision 2020 for the development of agriculture sector in India.	284	Practice →
15(a)	Give an account of the objectives of Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) and the benefits received under this scheme.	287	Practice →
15(b)	Explain briefly the four pillars for developing a strong IT in Andhra Pradesh?	290	Practice →
2017	30 answers		
P-III 1(a) old P-III	Discuss the nature of sectoral contribution of income to national income of India since independence. Also Examine whether the changes in sectoral contribution to national...	294	Practice →
P-III 1(b) old P-III	What is human development ? Discuss the importance and measurement of Gross National Happiness Index.	297	Practice →
P-III 2(a) old P-III	"The aim of economic reforms in India is to improve the competitiveness and efficiency of domestic industry and pave the way for achieving high rate of economic growth."...	300	Practice →
P-III 2(b) old P-III	Describe the salient features of National Manufacturing Policy and also the critical role of manufacturing sector in employment generation.	303	Practice →
P-III 3(a) old P-III	According to the Economic Survey 2016 – 17, Universal Basic Income (UBI) aims at achieving Mahatma Gandhi's objective of "wiping every tear from every eye". In this...	306	Practice →
P-III 3(b) old P-III	What is relative poverty ? What are the reasons for its presence in India ? Explain the Gini-coefficient and Lorenz curve methods of measuring relative poverty.	309	Practice →
P-III 4(a) old P-III	What are the objectives of the demonetization policy announced by the Central Government on 8th November, 2016 ? Discuss its impact on various sectors and...	312	Practice →
P-III 4(b) old P-III	Critically analyse the causes and consequences of India's public debt relating to the period from 1991 till date.	315	Practice →
P-III 5(a) old P-III	"Selfish attitude of human beings is the sole cause of environmental degradation." Discuss.	318	Practice →
P-III 5(b) old P-III	Discuss the nature and importance of Public-Private Partnership (PPP) in health care and basic education in India.	321	Practice →
P-III 6(a) old P-III	Explain the reasons for constituting a land committee under the chairmanship of Sri Koneru Ranga Rao in the year 2004 and bring out its recommendations related to lan...	324	Practice →
P-III 6(b) old P-III	Discuss the evolution of tenancy reforms in Andhra Pradesh and also explain the main features of the Andhra Pradesh (Andhra Area) Tenancy Act, 1956 including the...	327	Practice →
P-III 7(a) old P-III	Discuss the structural composition of Andhra Pradesh's economy in terms of Gross Value Added (GVA) at current and constant basic prices (2011 – 12 base) from 2014 – 1...	330	Practice →
P-III 7(b) old P-III	"SERP has been playing an important role in reducing rural poverty in Andhra Pradesh." Discuss.	333	Practice →
P-III 8(a) old P-III	Evaluate the programmes/schemes initiated by the Andhra Pradesh Government to achieve women empowerment.	336	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-III 8(b) old P-III	Critically evaluate the nature of occupational structure in Andhra Pradesh.	339	Practice →
P-III 9(a) old P-III	In the context of the financial situation of Andhra Pradesh after reorganization, discuss the nature and extent of Central assistance provided to Andhra Pradesh.	342	Practice →
P-III 9(b) old P-III	Discuss the sources and trends in revenue of the Andhra Pradesh Government before and after reorganization for the period 2011 – 12 to 2016 – 17.	345	Practice →
10(a) old P-III	List out the monitorable targets of the 11th Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh State. Also explain the pattern of resource allocation in the 10th and 11th Five Year Plans of Andhr...	348	Practice →
10(b) old P-III	Explain the important features of the proposed strategy of Andhra Pradesh to achieve sustainable development goals by 2030.	351	Practice →
11(a) old P-III	Discuss the growth and structure of small and tiny sector establishments in Andhra Pradesh on the basis of data of the 6th Economic Census.	354	Practice →
11(b) old P-III	Discuss the nature of functioning of Aadhar enabled e-public distribution system (AePDS) in Andhra Pradesh in terms of purchase, transportation, storage, allotment an...	357	Practice →
12(a) old P-III	Evaluate the trends in output and productivity of food and non-food crops in Andhra Pradesh (in the present 13 districts) since the year 2000 – 01. Also bring out the...	360	Practice →
12(b) old P-III	State and discuss the important features of the Handri-Neeva Sujala Sravanthi project and explain its role in meeting the water needs of the Rayalaseema Region.	363	Practice →
13(a) old P-III	Examine the present state of microfinance in Andhra Pradesh in the backdrop of its earlier crisis.	366	Practice →
13(b) old P-III	"An efficient power sector is essential for growth and poverty reduction." In light of the above statement, discuss the impact of reorganization of the State on its power secto...	369	Practice →
14(a) old P-III	Discuss the objectives, complementary components and the importance of node-centric development of Phase-I of the East Coast Economic Corridor.	372	Practice →
14(b) old P-III	"The main aim of Andhra Pradesh State Mineral Policy is to serve as a guiding force to translate the State's mineral potential into reality with eco-friendly and sustainable...	375	Practice →
15(a) old P-III	State the important features of the Infrastructure Mission of Andhra Pradesh and discuss its role in Vision 2029.	378	Practice →
15(b) old P-III	Explain the details of the "Arogya Raksha" scheme started by the Government of Andhra Pradesh. Also compare the scheme with other health insurance schemes of...	381	Practice →
2016	30 answers		
P-III 1(a) old P-III	Discuss the difficulties faced in measuring the developmental level of economy and justify whether the current method of measurement in India overcomes the difficulties.	385	Practice →
P-III 1(b) old P-III	Discuss briefly the major changes involved in the recent revision in the base year and method of national income accounting.	388	Practice →
P-III 2(a) old P-III	Eleventh five year plan identified the weaknesses on the employment front during the period of reforms. Describe them.	391	Practice →
P-III 2(b) old P-III	Discuss briefly the guiding principles in setting up the NITI Aayog.	394	Practice →
P-III 3(a) old P-III	Explain the possible limitations in the strategy for poverty alleviation adopted by the Government of India.	397	Practice →
P-III 3(b) old P-III	Discuss the possible consequences of rural unemployment on the society and suggest two effective remedial measures.	400	Practice →
P-III 4(a) old P-III	Discuss briefly the recommendations of the expert committee constituted "To revise and strengthen the monetary policy framework".	403	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-III 4(b) old P-III	Explain the need for emergence of Regional rural banks, and discuss the problems faced by them and the corresponding revisions made.	406	Practice →
P-III 5(a)	Describe the highlights of Fiscal Reforms and Budget Management Act 2003.	409	Practice →
P-III 5(b) old P-III	Discuss the concept of revenue deficit and effective revenue deficit and justify the reasons for introducing effective revenue deficit. Give the details of the expected...	412	Practice →
P-III 6(a) old P-III	Analyse the possible reasons for placing ceilings on agricultural holdings. Give two possible disadvantages to the economy due to such ceilings.	415	Practice →
P-III 6(b) old P-III	Explain the need to enact the Andhra Pradesh Land Licensed Cultivators Act, 2011 and discuss the problems faced in meeting the objective of enacting the Act.	418	Practice →
P-III 7(a) old P-III	Describe the strategies being adopted by Andhra Pradesh to achieve the mission on agriculture extension program.	421	Practice →
P-III 7(b) old P-III	Detail the key four pillars, the project components, beneficiaries and key result indicators of Andhra Pradesh rural inclusive growth project.	424	Practice →
P-III 8(a)	Discuss the trends in the literacy rates in Andhra Pradesh.	427	Practice →
P-III 8(b) old P-III	"Employment opportunities through Jawahar Knowledge Centres"- Explain how the Andhra Pradesh Government expects to meet its objective through this program.	430	Practice →
P-III 9(a) old P-III	Explain the distinct aspect of Annual Budget for 2016-17 of Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the reasons for revenue deficit and fiscal deficit in residuary AP.	433	Practice →
P-III 9(b) old P-III	The proportion of revenue receipts and total budgetary receipts as percentage of GSDP increased during the period 2002-2007 and declined during 2008-14. Explain...	436	Practice →
10(a) old P-III	Discuss the performance of agriculture sector during the 11th plan period and reasons for such performance.	439	Practice →
10(b) old P-III	List all the flagship programmes of Central Government implemented by the State during the 11th plan period and state the objective of the programs in one sentence.	442	Practice →
11(a) old P-III	Discuss salient features of Andhra Pradesh Industrial Investment Promotion Policy - 2015-20.	445	Practice →
11(b) old P-III	Explain the need for the Andhra Pradesh Capital Region Development Authority Bill 2014 and describe its salient features.	448	Practice →
12(a) old P-III	Discuss the recent initiatives taken to help farmers to increase productivity levels in agriculture.	451	Practice →
12(b) old P-III	"Fair Price Shop Automation and portability within a District" – discuss the possible advantages of these changes in public distribution system.	454	Practice →
13(a)	Describe the salient features of Polavaram irrigation project and explain its benefits.	457	Practice →
13(b) old P-III	Explain the salient features and benefits of the PPP model of health services provided under Dr NTR Vaidya Seva programme.	460	Practice →
14(a) old P-III	Discuss the highlights of farmers' debt redemption scheme implemented in Andhra Pradesh and its benefits.	463	Practice →
14(b) old P-III	"An Indian peasant is born in debt, lives in debt and dies in debt". In this context, explain the problems faced by the rural population in getting the loans from institutional and...	466	Practice →
15(a)	Explain the e-pragati initiative of Andhra Pradesh and its benefits.	469	Practice →
15(b) old P-III	"Smart village - Smart ward towards Smart Andhra Pradesh" - Explain.	472	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2012	26 answers		
P-III 1(a) old P-III	Declining share of agriculture in national income facilitated a rise in the rate of economic growth in India. - Justify your answer	476	Practice →
P-III 2(a) old P-III	Briefly discuss the main objectives and strategies outlined in the XII Five Year Plan of India.	479	Practice →
P-III 3(a) old P-III	Comment on the recent controversies relating to the estimates of rural-urban poverty in India.	482	Practice →
P-III 3(b) old P-III	Assess the impact of MGNREGS in reducing the intensity of unemployment in rural areas of our country	485	Practice →
P-III 4(a) old P-III	Analyse the strategy adopted by Reserve Bank of India to control the rising prices in the last two years.	488	Practice →
P-III 4(b) old P-III	State the measures initiated by Reserve Bank of India to regulate credit disbursed by Non-Banking Financial Institutions.	491	Practice →
P-III 5(a) old P-III	Examine the relative shares of direct and indirect tax revenues of Indian Government in the post-reforms period.	494	Practice →
P-III 5(b) old P-III	Justify the view that public debt is essential for the development of Indian economy endowed with natural resources.	497	Practice →
P-III 6(a) old P-III	Describe the changing structure of land holdings in Andhra Pradesh in the past two decades	500	Practice →
P-III 6(b) old P-III	Discuss the problems associated with the issue of land distribution in Andhra Pradesh State.	503	Practice →
P-III 7(a) old P-III	Explain the existing inter-regional differences in the levels of poverty in Andhra Pradesh economy.	506	Practice →
P-III 7(b) old P-III	How far does the present use of agricultural inputs and technical knowledge facilitate the achievement of evergreen revolution in Andhra Pradesh?	509	Practice →
P-III 8(a) old P-III	Suggest suitable steps to utilise demographic dividend for the rapid economic development of Andhra Pradesh.	512	Practice →
P-III 8(b) old P-III	Critically Examine the socio-economic issues retarding the pace of women empowerment in Andhra Pradesh.	515	Practice →
P-III 9(a) old P-III	Describe the analysis of tax devolution from Central Government to Andhra Pradesh Government in the last decade.	518	Practice →
10(a) old P-III	Discuss the sectoral performance of Eleventh Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh.	521	Practice →
10(b) old P-III	Explain the important features of XII Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh.	524	Practice →
11(a) old P-III	State the policy measures recently implemented by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to promote the growth of Industries.	527	Practice →
11(b) old P-III	Suggest appropriate measures to overcome the institutional problems of small scale industries in Andhra Pradesh.	530	Practice →
12(a) old P-III	Examine the view that Public Distribution System in India shall be made the responsibility of State Governments.	533	Practice →
12(b) old P-III	Analyse the recent changes in the composition and structure of agricultural output in Andhra Pradesh.	536	Practice →
13(a) old P-III	Write a brief note on the regional disparities in irrigation facilities in Andhra Pradesh.	539	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
13(b) old P-III	Evaluate the trends in the expenditure of Andhra Pradesh Government on health and education in the last decade.	542	Practice →
14(a) old P-III	Comment on the inadequacy of institutional credit in rural areas of Andhra Pradesh State.	545	Practice →
14(b) old P-III	Elucidate the problems of cooperatives in providing adequate agricultural credit to farmers in Andhra Pradesh.	548	Practice →
15(a) old P-III	Describe the changes in the composition and growth of service sector of Andhra Pradesh in the post-reforms period.	551	Practice →
2011	26 answers		
P-III 1(b) old P-III	Explain the important sectoral changes in post-independence Indian economy with respect to income and work-force.	555	Practice →
P-III 2(a) old P-III	Critically Examine the performance of X Five Year Plan.	558	Practice →
P-III 2(b) old P-III	What is the scope for public-private partnership in post-economic reform period in India? Elaborate.	561	Practice →
P-III 3(a) old P-III	What are the important concepts of employment / unemployment used by National Sample Survey Organization (NSSO)?	564	Practice →
P-III 3(b) old P-III	Discuss the important anti-poverty programmes implemented by the Government of India	567	Practice →
P-III 4(a) old P-III	Explain the structure of Indian Banking System	570	Practice →
P-III 4(b) old P-III	Critically Examine the role of RBI in credit control.	573	Practice →
P-III 5(a) old P-III	Explain the role of Finance Commission in a federal country like India.	576	Practice →
P-III 5(b) old P-III	What are the important tax reforms in India since 1991?	579	Practice →
P-III 6(b) old P-III	Do you consider that land reforms in Andhra Pradesh have provided sufficient protection to tenants?	582	Practice →
P-III 7(a) old P-III	Highlight the important trends in incidence of poverty in Andhra Pradesh.	585	Practice →
P-III 7(b) old P-III	Do you consider that Andhra Pradesh economy is still dominated by agricultural sector? Justify your answer.	588	Practice →
P-III 8(b) old P-III	What are the measures taken by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to empower women? Elaborate.	591	Practice →
P-III 9(a) old P-III	Critically Examine the role of World Bank Loans in the Development of Andhra Pradesh Economy.	594	Practice →
10(a) old P-III	Do you consider that Public Sector is getting adequate financial support from the Government of Andhra Pradesh in XI Five Year Plan?	597	Practice →
10(b) old P-III	Critically Examine the allocation pattern of resources in X and XI Five Year Plans of Andhra Pradesh.	600	Practice →
11(a) old P-III	Evaluate the performance of Industrial Sector in Andhra Pradesh.	603	Practice →
11(b) old P-III	Discuss the measures taken by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to promote small scale Industries have they yielded expected results?	606	Practice →
12(a) old P-III	Critically Examine the procurement price policy of the Government of India and Andhra Pradesh.	609	Practice →
12(b) old P-III	Highlights the important features of Public Distribution System in Andhra Pradesh.	612	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
13(a) old P-III	What are the causes for inter-regional and inter-district disparities in Andhra Pradesh?	615	Practice →
13(b) old P-III	Discuss the measures taken by the Government to improve education and health status in Andhra Pradesh.	618	Practice →
14(a) old P-III	Discuss the composition of institutional and non-institutional credit in rural Andhra Pradesh.	621	Practice →
14(b) old P-III	Explain the significance of micro-finance institutions in meeting rural credit needs in Andhra Pradesh.	624	Practice →
15(a) old P-III	Bring out the importance of transport and communication in the development of Andhra Pradesh.	627	Practice →
15(b) old P-III	Write about the growth of IT industry in Andhra Pradesh.	630	Practice →
2008	30 answers		
P-III 1(a) old P-III	Explain various approaches to measure national income.	634	Practice →
P-III 1(b) old P-III	Explain the problems in measuring national income.	637	Practice →
P-III 2(a) old P-III	Explain the important objectives of the 10th Five Year Plan.	640	Practice →
P-III 2(b) old P-III	Explain the role of private sector after economic reforms.	643	Practice →
P-III 3(a) old P-III	Explain the methods of measuring poverty in India.	646	Practice →
P-III 3(b) old P-III	Explain the methods of measuring unemployment in India.	649	Practice →
P-III 4(a) old P-III	Explain the objectives of monetary policy.	652	Practice →
P-III 4(b) old P-III	Explain the impact of economic reforms in the Banking sector.	655	Practice →
P-III 5(a) old P-III	Explain the pattern of revenue collection after economic reforms in India.	658	Practice →
P-III 5(b) old P-III	Explain the principles of public expenditure.	661	Practice →
P-III 6(a) old P-III	Why are Land Reforms implemented? What are the main laws pertaining to Land Reforms in Andhra Pradesh?	664	Practice →
P-III 6(b) old P-III	Explain the scope of Land Reforms in Andhra Pradesh and assess success in computerisation of Land Records.	667	Practice →
P-III 7(a) old P-III	How is Andhra Pradesh economy popularly classified? What are the relative shares of the three regions in the GSDP of Andhra Pradesh in the recent years?	670	Practice →
P-III 7(b) old P-III	What is Green Revolution? What is its impact on the agricultural economy of Andhra Pradesh?	673	Practice →
P-III 8(a) old P-III	Examine the structure of occupations pursued by Andhra Pradesh people and the proportion of SC-ST population in the total population of Andhra Pradesh.	676	Practice →
P-III 8(b) old P-III	Write notes on : (i) Measures taken by the Andhra Pradesh government to empower women. (ii) Infant Mortality and Death rates in Andhra Pradesh in the recent decade.	679	Practice →
P-III 9(a) old P-III	What are the direct and indirect taxes levied by the government of Andhra Pradesh?	682	Practice →
P-III 9(b) old P-III	Write notes on : (i) Debt composition of Andhra Pradesh government (ii) Tax revenue and other resource inflows into Andhra Pradesh government from the Central...	685	Practice →
10(a) old P-III	Explain the pattern of resource mobilisation for the public sector in the 5-Year Plans of Andhra Pradesh in the recent decade.	688	Practice →
10(b) old P-III	What are the total outlays of Andhra Pradesh's X and XI 5-Year Plans? What proportion of the outlay is allocated to agriculture including irrigation?	691	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
11(a)	Examine the growth and structure of industries in Andhra Pradesh.	694	Practice →
11(b) old P-III	Explain the significance of SSI in the development of Andhra Pradesh and mention the incentives extended by the government to this sector.	697	Practice →
12(a) old P-III	Briefly explain the need for administering agricultural commodity prices and mention the administering machinery.	700	Practice →
12(b) old P-III	Explain the basic features of Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS) and its performance in the state.	703	Practice →
13(a) old P-III	Examine the causes for regional disparities in Andhra Pradesh and measures initiated by the government to reduce the same.	706	Practice →
13(b) old P-III	Explain the causes for backwardness of certain regions and suggest measures for development.	709	Practice →
14(a) old P-III	Examine the role of SHGs in Andhra Pradesh in meeting the credit requirements of rural people.	712	Practice →
14(b) old P-III	Examine the importance and development of transport and communication in the state of Andhra Pradesh.	715	Practice →
15(a)	State the importance of service sector in the development of Andhra Pradesh.	718	Practice →
15(b) old P-III	Write short notes on : (i) Kisan Credit Card Scheme (ii) Providing Urban Facilities in Rural Areas (PURA)	721	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

PAPER IV AT A GLANCE

Trend analysis

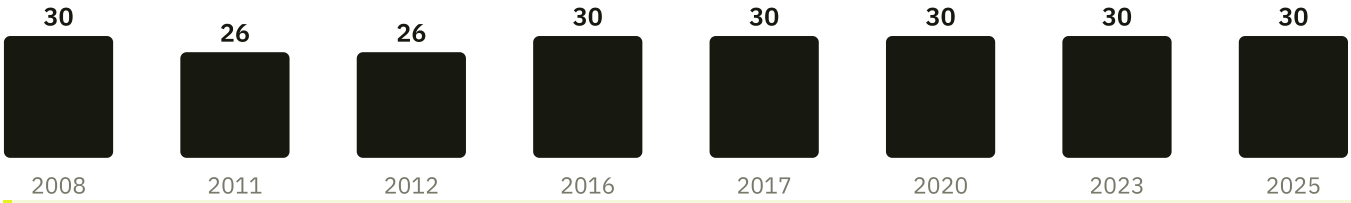
232
APPSC QUESTIONS

8
SITTINGS, 2008 TO 2025

12
CHAPTERS

66
SUB-TOPICS ASKED

QUESTIONS BY SITTING



Darker cells mark the sub-topics the commission returns to most. Older sittings (2008 to 2017) are counted under today's syllabus.
To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
1. Major Challenges of Indian Economy	**5**	**3**	**3**	**4**	**4**	**1**	**3**	**2**	**25**
1.1 Inconsistent growth rate	3	1	1	2	·	·	1	·	**8**
1.2 Low growth rates of agriculture and manufacturing sectors	2	2	2	1	1	1	·	1	**10**
1.3 inflation and oil prices	·	·	·	1	·	·	1	·	**2**
1.4 current account deficit and unfavorable balance of payments	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**1**
1.5 falling rupee value	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
1.7 money laundering and black money	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	**1**
1.9 Lack of Inclusive growth and Sustainable development	·	·	·	·	2	·	·	·	**2**
2. Resource Mobilization in Indian Economy	**3**	**3**	**4**	**·**	**1**	**2**	**4**	**2**	**19**
2.2 budgetary resources – tax revenue and non-tax revenue	1	1	1	·	·	1	·	·	**4**
2.3 public debt : market borrowings, loans and grants etc.	·	·	1	·	1	1	1	1	**5**
2.5 foreign institutional investment and foreign direct investment	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
2.7 Monetary and fiscal policies	1	1	1	·	·	·	2	1	**6**
2.8 financial markets and institutions of developmental finance	1	1	1	·	·	·	·	·	**3**
3. Resource mobilization in Andhra Pradesh	**4**	**3**	**3**	**1**	**4**	**2**	**2**	**1**	**20**
3.1 Budgetary resources and constraints	3	2	2	1	2	·	1	1	**12**
3.3 central assistance and issues of conflict	·	·	1	·	1	1	·	·	**3**
3.4 public debt and projects of external assistance	1	1	·	·	·	·	1	·	**3**
3.5 Physical resources - Mineral and forest resources	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	·	**2**

PAPER IV TREND ANALYSIS, CONTINUED

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
4. Government Budgeting (Union)	**1**	**1**	**·**	**4**	**·**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**15**
4.1 Structure of Government budget and its components	1	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**2**
4.2 Budgeting process and recent changes	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
4.4 types of deficits, their impact and management	·	·	·	2	·	1	1	1	**5**
4.6 GST and related issues	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
4.7 Central assistance to states	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	**1**
4.8 Issues of federal finance in India	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	1	**2**
4.9 Recommendations of the latest finance commission	·	1	·	·	·	1	·	1	**3**
5. Government budgeting in Andhra Pradesh	**·**	**·**	**1**	**1**	**·**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**6**
5.1 Budget constraints	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	**1**
5.3 management of deficits	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
5.4 Highlights and Analysis of the current year budget	·	·	·	1	·	1	1	·	**3**
5.5 State finance commission and local finance in Andhra Pradesh	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**1**
6. Inclusive Growth: India and AP schemes	**6**	**7**	**5**	**9**	**9**	**3**	**4**	**7**	**50**
6.1 Meaning of inclusion	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1	**2**
6.3 Strategies for and instruments of inclusion : Poverty alleviation and employm...	1	3	3	3	2	2	2	4	**20**
6.4 Food Security and Public Distribution System	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	**1**
6.5 sustainable agriculture	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	**2**
6.7 regional diversification	2	1	1	·	·	·	·	·	**4**
6.8 Public and partnership for inclusive growth	·	·	·	1	1	·	·	·	**2**
6.9 Financial inclusion	1	1	·	1	1	·	1	1	**6**
6.10 All Andhra Pradesh government's current schemes for inclusive growth and ...	2	2	·	4	4	1	·	·	**13**
7. Agricultural Development (India)	**3**	**1**	**1**	**3**	**·**	**3**	**3**	**2**	**16**
7.2 Contribution of to GDP	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	**1**
7.3 Issues of finance, production, marketing	1	·	·	1	·	1	2	2	**7**
7.4 green revolution and changing focus to dryland farming, organic farming and s...	1	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	**1**
7.5 minimum support prices	1	1	·	·	·	·	·	·	**2**
7.6 agriculture policy	·	·	·	2	·	1	·	·	**3**
7.8 Rainbow revolution	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	**2**

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

PAPER IV TREND ANALYSIS, CONTINUED

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
8. Agriculture Development in Andhra Pradesh	**4**	**3**	**7**	**5**	**6**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**31**
8.1 Contribution to SGDP	2	1	·	1	2	1	·	1	**8**
8.2 Regional disparities in irrigation and agricultural development	·	·	1	1	2	·	·	·	**4**
8.3 changing cropping pattern	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	**1**
8.4 focus on horticulture and fisheries and dairying	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	**2**
8.5 Government schemes to promote agriculture in Andhra Pradesh	2	2	**5**	3	2	1	1	·	**16**
9. Industrial Development and Policy (India)	**1**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**2**	**4**	**2**	**3**	**12**
9.1 Role of industrial sector in economic development	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	2	**2**
9.2 Evolution of industrial policy since independence	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
9.4 Contribution of Public Sector to industrial development in India	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
9.5 impact of liberalization and privatization and globalization on industrial develo…	1	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	**2**
9.6 Disinvestment and privatization	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	**2**
9.10 Manufacturing policy	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	·	**2**
9.11 Make-in India	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
9.12 Start up programme	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**1**
10. Industrial Policy of the AP Government	**2**	**2**	**2**	**1**	**3**	**4**	**3**	**1**	**18**
10.1 Incentives to industries	2	2	2	1	1	2	2	1	**13**
10.2 Industrial corridors in and SEZs in Andhra Pradesh	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	·	**2**
10.3 Bottlenecks for industrial development	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
10.4 Power projects	·	·	·	·	1	1	·	·	**2**
11. Infrastructure in India	**·**	**1**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**3**	**2**	**4**	**10**
11.1 Transport infrastructure : Ports, Roads, Airports, Railways	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**1**
11.4 Information Technology –e-governance - Digital India	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
11.5 Energy and Power	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**1**
11.6 Urban infrastructure – smart cities – urban environment - solid waste manag…	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	1	**3**
11.9 Public-private partnership and related issues	·	1	·	·	·	1	·	1	**3**
11.10 Pricing of public utilities and government policy	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
12. Infrastructure Development in Andhra Pradesh	**1**	**2**	**·**	**2**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**1**	**10**
12.1 Transport , Energy and ICT infrastructure	1	2	·	1	·	1	1	1	**7**
12.3 Government policy	·	·	·	1	1	1	·	·	**3**
Paper IV total	**30**	**26**	**26**	**30**	**30**	**30**	**30**	**30**	**232**

1 question 2 3 or more · not asked that year

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2025

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) Analyse the factors contributing to India's Current Account Deficit (CAD) and unfavourable Balance of Payments (BoP) and discuss their implications for the Indian economy.

10

Introduction

India's Current Account Deficit (CAD) narrowed to 0.7% of GDP in FY24 from 2% a year earlier. Yet a persistent trade deficit and external vulnerabilities, amid geopolitical tension and fluctuating crude prices, keep the Balance of Payments (BoP) under pressure.

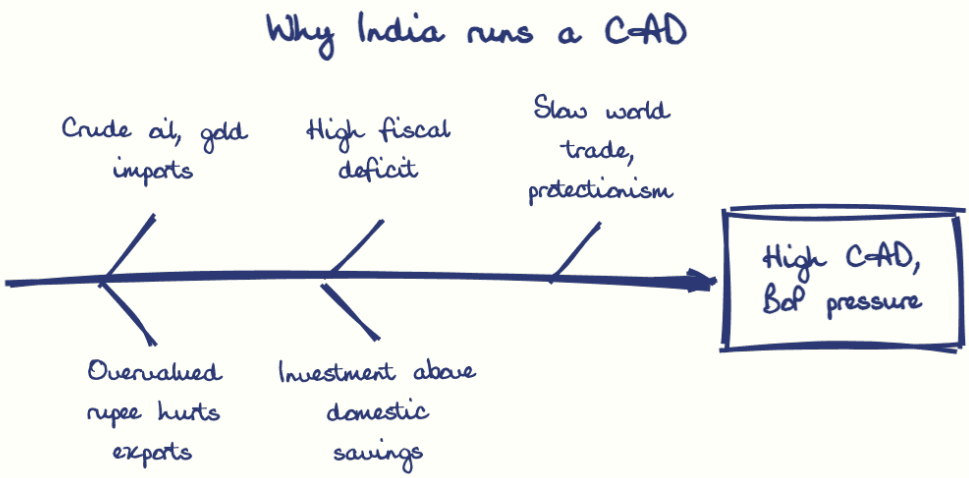
Factors Contributing to CAD and BoP Imbalance

1. **Trade deficit dominance:** Imports of crude oil, gold and electronic goods outpace exports. The trade deficit fell from USD 121.6 billion in FY23 to USD 78.1 billion in FY24, but still pressures the BoP.
2. **Exchange rate dynamics:** An overvalued rupee cheapens imports and hurts exports, while depreciation, as in 2013–14 to 2018–19, raises import costs.
3. **Savings–investment gap:** A high fiscal deficit raises demand and imports. Investment above domestic savings must be financed by foreign capital.

Practice 1(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Global environment: Slower world trade and rising protectionism constrain exports, while integration into global value chains remains limited.



Implications for the Economy

1. Weak export competitiveness: India holds only (1.8%) of global merchandise exports, and logistics and port gaps, including at Visakhapatnam, limit growth.
2. Volatile capital flows: FDI is robust but FPI volatility strains forex reserves during shocks.
3. Inflation: Rupee depreciation raises the cost of crude, as when CAD widened in 2018–19.
4. Fiscal strain: Low capital expenditure in Andhra Pradesh (1.1% of GSDP in 2026–27) and a high revenue deficit limit export

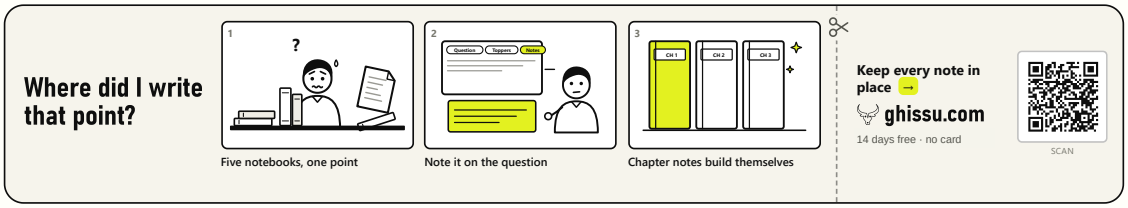
capacity.

Way Forward

1. Export infrastructure: Modernise ports using Andhra Pradesh's coastal advantage.
2. Diversified exports: Strengthen PLI and Districts as Exports Hub.
3. Fiscal consdidation: Central and state discipline, including Andhra Pradesh's targeted deficit reduction plans, lowers demand-driven import pressure.

Conclusion

Managing CAD needs export competitiveness, fiscal discipline and prudent management of capital flows to keep India's external sector resilient.



1(b) Discuss how infrastructure bottlenecks hinder the growth of the Indian Manufacturing sector. What steps can be taken to address them?

10

Introduction

India's manufacturing sector contributes around 16–17% of GDP and employs over 27 million workers, making it pivotal for growth and jobs. Yet persistent infrastructure bottlenecks limit its expansion and global competitiveness, even as public capital expenditure has risen to 12.2 lakh crore in FY2026–27.

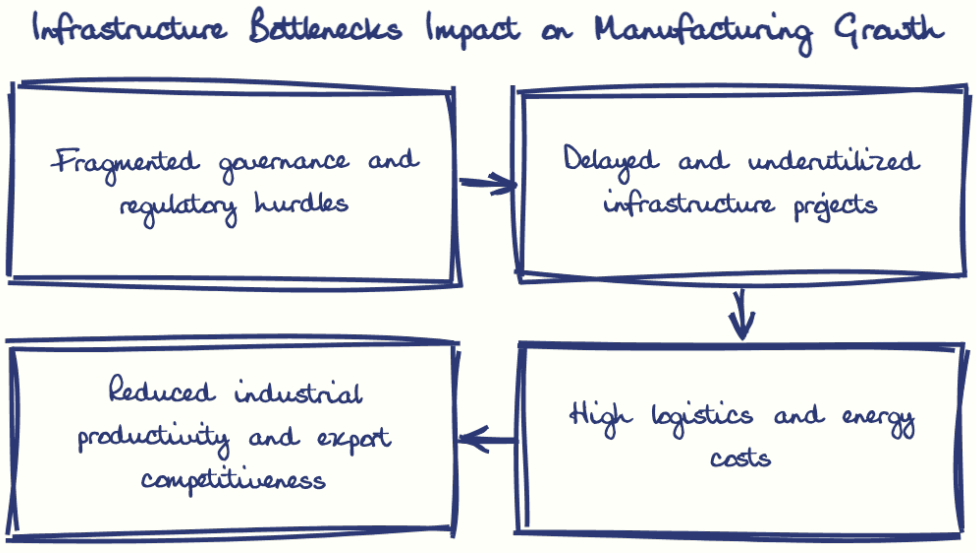
Institutional Bottlenecks

1. Fragmented governance: Central and state departments work in silos, causing delays, as seen in the slow progress of the Polavaram Irrigation Project in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Land and regulatory hurdles: Stringent land acquisition laws and cumbersome local permits for water and power in Andhra Pradesh raise costs and discourage investment.
3. Poor last-mile connectivity: Completed projects stay underutilised when not linked to demand centres, as in several industrial corridors.
4. Weak urban utilities: Only (4) of (123) ULBs in Andhra Pradesh have operational sanitary

landfill sites, hurting industrial environments.

Physical Bottlenecks

1. **Logistics inefficiency:** Over-reliance on road freight keeps logistics costs at 13–14% of GDP, while underdeveloped rail raises transit time and cost.
2. **Energy deficits:** Unreliable and costly power, and per capita energy use far below China's, limit productivity.
3. **Weak industrial clusters:** Despite the National Manufacturing Mission, MSMEs lack plug-and-play infrastructure, clean water and renewable energy.



Steps to Address Them

1. **Unified planning authority:** A state-level body to synchronise timelines and ensure last-mile connectivity.
2. **Simpler land and permits:** Reform acquisition laws and local permitting to speed up industrial land and utility access.
3. **Multimodal transport and energy:** Expand rail freight capacity and renewable energy for reliable, affordable power.
4. **Plug-and-play parks:** Scale up PM MITRA parks and Biopharma SHAKTI in Andhra Pradesh to integrate MSMEs into global value chains.

Conclusion

Infrastructure gaps raise costs and delay projects. Coordinated reforms in transport, energy and industrial parks will unlock job-rich growth aligned with SDG (8.)

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 1(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

2(a) Discuss the key instruments of Monetary Policy (RBI) and Fiscal Policy in India and evaluate their role in resource mobilisation and inflation management.

10

Introduction

Inflation management has grown complex due to supply shocks and global uncertainty. RBI has followed a flexible inflation targeting framework since 2016, aiming at 4% inflation within a 2–6% band, while fiscal policy drives resource mobilisation and stability, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh.

Monetary Policy Instruments

1. **Policy rates:** The repo rate is the primary lever; it stands at 5.25%, lowered in 2025–26 to stimulate growth within the target band.
2. **CRR and SLR:** CRR was cut by 100 basis points to 3% in 2025, easing liquidity and lending, though overuse risks inflation.
3. **Open market operations:** Buying or selling government securities absorbs or injects liquidity and supports government borrowing, crucial for Andhra Pradesh, which relies on market borrowing.
4. **MPC framework:** The Monetary Policy

Committee sets the rate on inflation and growth forecasts, adding transparency.

Fiscal Policy Instruments

1. Taxation: Andhra Pradesh's own tax revenue is projected at Rs 94,967 crore for 2024–25, reflecting a wider tax base.
2. Expenditure: Its 2026–27 budget targets a fiscal deficit of 3.8% of GSDP.
3. Borrowing and transfers: Liabilities stand at 36% of GSDP, while central transfers of Rs 89,157 crore in 2024–25 bridge resource gaps.

Monetary vs fiscal instruments

Monetary (RBI)	Fiscal
Repo, CRR, SLR, OMO	Taxation, expenditure, borrowing
MPC sets the rate	Budgets set deficit targets
Steers credit and liquidity	Mobilises revenue
Inflation 6.8% to 4.9%	High deficits crowd out

Evaluation of Their Role

1. Monetary and mobilisation: Rates and

liquidity steer credit, but high fiscal deficits crowd out private investment and weaken transmission.

2. Monetary and inflation: Average inflation fell from 6.8% (2012–16) to 4.9% post–2016, yet food and energy shocks in Andhra Pradesh's agrarian economy need more than monetary action.

3. Fiscal role: Tax reforms and better compliance have enhanced revenue mobilisation in Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

Monetary policy anchors prices while fiscal policy mobilises resources. Their coordination, with disciplined deficits and debt, is key to growth with price stability.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

ghissu

ghissu exam-hall thinking decodes every directive — Discuss, Examine, Elucidate — before you write a line.

Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 2(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

Scan to practice

2(b) Differentiate between internal and external public debt. Explain their relative advantages and risks for a developing country like India.

10

Introduction

India's public debt-to-GDP ratio is nearing 70% amid ambitious growth goals. The composition of this debt, internal versus external, shapes fiscal sustainability, macroeconomic stability and growth. For a developing country, getting this balance right is key to funding infrastructure and welfare without debt distress.

Differences Between Internal and External Debt

1. Internal debt: Borrowing within the country through market loans, treasury bills and rupee bonds from banks, institutions and the public, such as the Floating Rate Savings Bond, 2020.
2. External debt: Borrowing from the IMF, World Bank, foreign governments and international markets in foreign currencies like the US dollar or SDRs.
3. Composition: Internal debt forms about 90% of public debt and external about 10%, unlike many developing economies.

Internal vs external public debt

Internal debt	External debt
About 90% of public debt	About 10%
Rupee, no forex constraint	Foreign currency
Mobilises domestic savings	Concessional, technical assistance
Risk: crowding out, inflation	Risk: currency, global volatility

Internal Debt: Advantages and Risks

1. Monetary sovereignty: Rupee debt can be serviced without forex constraints.
2. Development finance: It mobilises domestic savings for schemes like UD-AY in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Market depth: Government securities and RBI Retail Direct deepen bond markets and give households investment avenues.
4. Risks: Heavy borrowing can crowd out private investment and add to inflation.

External Debt: Advantages and Risks

1. Cheaper capital: Concessional rates and longer maturities lower costs.
2. Reserve support: Reserves cover 68.9% of external

debt, aiding stability.

3. Knowledge transfer: Multilateral loans bring technical assistance.

4. Diversification: It complements domestic resources without crowding out private investment.

5. Risks: Currency risk and global volatility can raise servicing costs.

Conclusion

India's internal-heavy mix limits external vulnerability. Balancing both can finance development while keeping debt sustainable.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

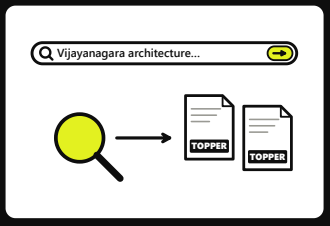
Read a topper copy like an examiner

Don't read a topper's answer for its facts. Read it for its moves — they transfer to any question.

1. **First two lines** — How does the intro frame the demand?
2. **Headings** — How is the body split — by dimension, by actor, by time?
3. **Proof** — Which fact, report or case holds up each paragraph?
4. **Last two lines** — What way forward, and how specific is it?

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

1.5 lakh+ topper answers are matched to each question — with their intro, structure and conclusion laid bare.



Search any question →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

3(a) Critically evaluate the role of education and healthcare in achieving inclusive and sustainable development in India. Highlight the current challenges and government interventions.

10

Introduction

Inclusive and sustainable development rests on education and healthcare, which shape human capital and social equity. With about 27% of the population of school-going age in 2024 and a rising elderly share, their quality decides whether India harnesses its demographic dividend.

Role of Education

1. Human capital: Education builds skills for productive work. NEP 2020 targets 100% GER by 2030.
2. Bridging inequalities: Gender parity has improved, though SC/ST gaps remain; SSA and PM-SHRI widened access in rural and tribal Andhra Pradesh.
3. Skills for sustainability: DIKSHA and Atal Tinkering Labs link learning to livelihoods.

Role of Healthcare

1. Health and productivity: MMR fell from 130 to 97 per lakh live births in 2014-20 under NHM

and Ayushman Bharat.

2. Financial protection: Insurance and free services cut out-of-pocket costs and poverty traps, though AP's public health spending remains low.

3. Preventive care: NHP (2017) stresses prevention and private partnerships as NCDs rise.

Education vs Healthcare

Education	Healthcare
Builds human capital	Raises productivity
NEP 2020, PM-SHRI	NHM, Ayushman Bharat
Retention only 63.8%	175 CHCs against 412
About 3.5% of GDP	Under 2% of GDP

Challenges

1. Underfunding: Education about (3.5%) and health under (2%) of GDP.

2. Quality and retention: Elementary retention is only (63.8%), and secondary access in AP government schools is limited.

3. Infrastructure: AP has (175) CHCs against (412)

needed and 22% specialist vacancies.

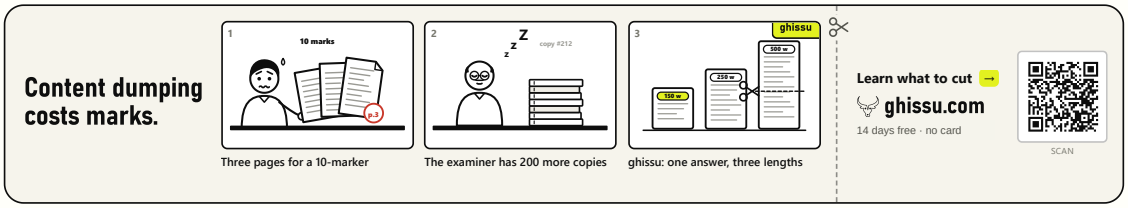
4. Unequal access: Tribal and marginalised groups face barriers worsened by the digital divide.
5. Quality deficits: Skill mismatches in education and absenteeism in health reduce trust in public services.

Government Interventions

1. Education: NEP 2020, Sarv Shiksha Abhiyan, PM-SHRI, DIKSHA and Atal Tinkering Labs expand access and skills.
2. Healthcare: NHM, Ayushman Bharat and the National Health Policy 2017 improve outcomes and financial protection.

Conclusion

Government interventions have widened access, but higher funding and equitable access are needed for truly inclusive development.



3(b) Explain the major sources of budgetary resources for Andhra Pradesh. What are the key challenges the state faces in mobilising adequate financial resources?

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh aims to sustain GSDP growth of 12–14% while managing a significant revenue deficit and rising liabilities. Its budgetary resources finance development projects like Polavaram and welfare schemes such as the NTR Bharosa pension, so their sources and limits shape fiscal sustainability.

Major Sources of Budgetary Resources

1. Own tax revenue: The largest share, at about 6.4% of GSDP, with moderate growth in collection capacity. Better compliance could lift it further. It showed a 28% rise in 2026–27 over the previous year.
2. Central transfers: Revenue deficit grants and finance commission allocations bridge gaps but face policy uncertainty, as the demand for Special Category Status shows.
3. Non-tax and mineral revenue: Fees and charges contribute modestly, mineral revenue is underused, with only about 84% of targets realised.

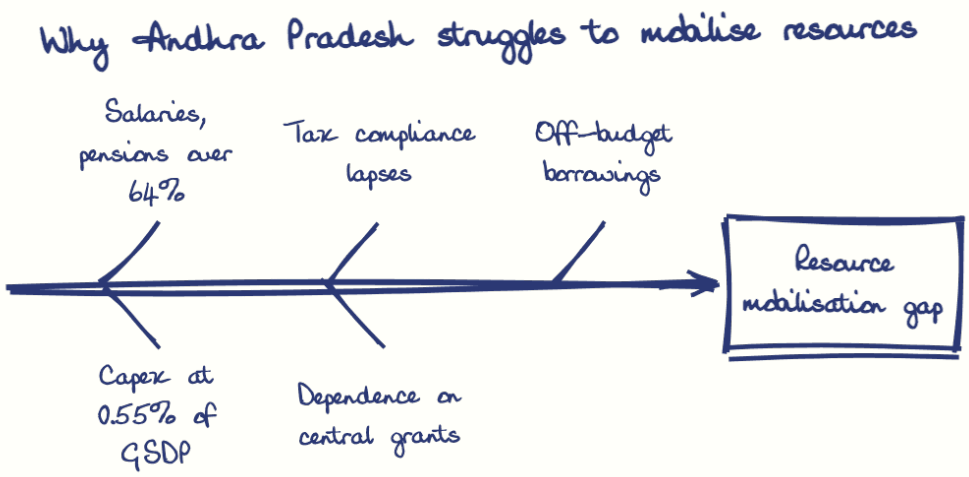
4. Borrowings: The state borrows, including off-budget borrowings through PSUs and para-statals, raising transparency concerns. Such borrowing also threatens debt sustainability.

Challenges in Mobilising Resources

1. Committed expenditure: Salaries and pensions take over 64% of revenue receipts, squeezing fiscal space. Little is left for capital investment.
2. Declining capital expenditure: It fell to a five-year low of 0.55% of GSDP in 2022-23, constraining infrastructure. Economic services critical for long-term growth suffer most.
3. Tax inefficiency: A CAG audit found a revenue impact of over Rs 1,800 crore from compliance lapses and pending objections.
4. Dependence on central grants: Unresolved demands for special packages after the 2014 bifurcation hurt budget predictability. Policy changes and political conflict add fiscal risk.

Strategies

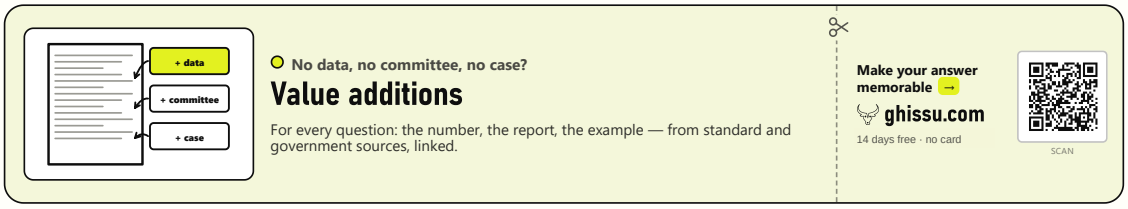
1. Tax administration: Use robust audits, technology and data analytics to plug leakages.



2. Efficient capital spending: Complete Polavaram on time to maximise economic returns.
3. New revenue: User fees, PPPs and asset monetisation to cut reliance on taxes and grants.
4. Debt transparency: Bring off-budget borrowings under strict oversight and transparent fiscal rules to retain investor confidence.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's resources rest on own taxes, central transfers and borrowings, but deficits and weak capital spending strain them. Fiscal discipline can support growth towards Viksit Bharat 2047.



4(a) What do you understand by Government Budget? Briefly explain the types of public expenditure and how these expenditures are classified in the government budget.

10

Introduction

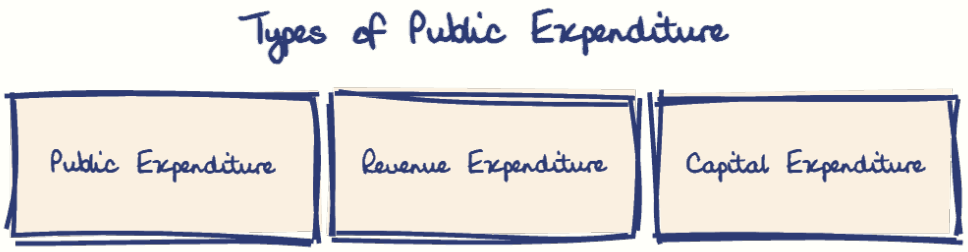
The government budget is a vital economic tool that sets out estimated receipts and expenditures for a financial year, guiding fiscal policy and resource allocation. For India and Andhra Pradesh, where development needs and fiscal stress coexist, its structure is central to accountability and planning.

Defining Government Budget

1. Annual Financial Statement: It is presented before Parliament under Article 112, covering April 1 to March 31.
2. Legal Authority: Under Articles 265 and 266, no tax can be levied nor expenditure incurred without legislative approval.
3. Types by Timeframe: A Full Budget covers the year, an Interim Budget is used in election years, and a Vote-on-Account meets expenses if the budget is delayed.
4. Policy Tool: It states priorities, as in the Union Budget 2026-27's emphasis on capital

expenditure.

Types of Public Expenditure



1. Revenue Expenditure: Day-to-day spending such as salaries, subsidies and interest that creates no assets. Andhra Pradesh's rising revenue deficit in 2022–23 reflects this pressure.
2. Capital Expenditure: Spending that creates assets or reduces liabilities, such as roads, dams and public buildings.
3. Developmental and Plan Classes: Developmental us non-developmental gave way to plan and non-plan, phased out in 2017–18.

Classification in the Budget

1. Revenue and Capital Budget: The Revenue Budget covers revenue receipts and expenditure, while the Capital Budget covers capital receipts such as loans and recoveries and capital expenditure.

2. By Nature: Revenue expenditure is current consumption, capital expenditure builds assets for long-term growth.

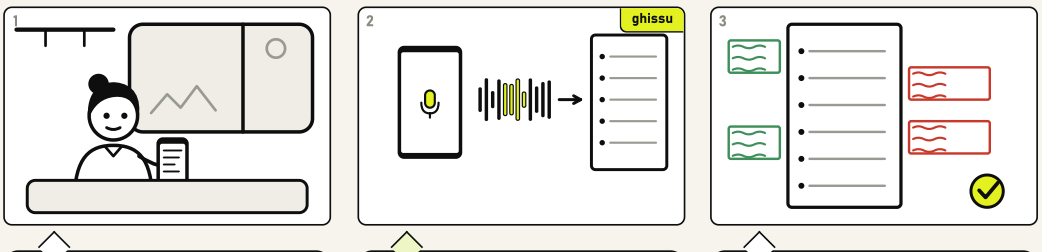
3. Outcome and Gender Budgeting: Outcome Budgeting links spending to results, and Gender Budgeting addresses gender disparities.

Conclusion

The budget balances revenue and capital flows. Better quality capital spending, curbs on revenue deficits and performance-based budgeting will turn allocations into real development outcomes.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW · QUICK OUTLINE — TYPE, SPEAK OR SCAN

Practice on the bus



No desk, no time. No practice today, again.

Just speak the outline into ghissu.

Feedback before my stop.

— An outline a day beats a full answer a week.

Try a quick outline →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 4(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

4(b) Define the term 'deficit' in government finance. Explain the various types of deficits and their economic implications.

10

Introduction

Deficit in government finance is a critical indicator of fiscal health, reflecting the gap between expenditure and revenue. For India and Andhra Pradesh, managing deficits is vital to sustain development with macroeconomic stability; the Union Budget 2026–27 targets a fiscal deficit of 4.3% of GDP.

Meaning of Deficit

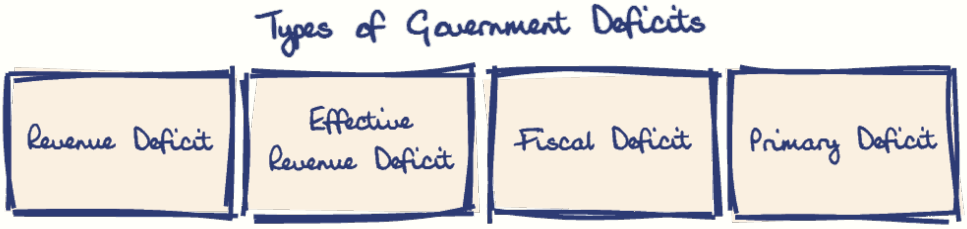
1. Defintion: A deficit occurs when total expenditure exceeds total revenue in a fiscal year, so the gap must be bridged by borrowing or other means.
2. Deficit Financing: Covering the gap through borrowing or money creation, a practice India adopted since 1969.
3. Indicator: The size and composition of deficits signal fiscal discipline and shape credit ratings.

Types of Deficits

1. Revenue Deficit: Revenue expenditure minus

Practice 4(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice



revenue receipts, showing that current costs like salaries, pensions and subsidies exceed current income.

2. Fiscal Deficit: Total expenditure minus total receipts excluding borrowings, the total borrowing requirement; Andhra Pradesh aims for 3.8% of GSDP.

3. Primary Deficit: Fiscal deficit minus interest payments; India's target for 2026–27 is 0.7% of GDP.

4. Effective Revenue Deficit: Revenue deficit minus grants for capital expenditure, 0.9% of GDP in the Union Budget 2024–25.

Economic Implications

1. Borrowing to Consume: A high revenue deficit reduces future growth; Andhra Pradesh's quadrupled revenue deficit in 2022–23 caused a sharp fall in capital expenditure.

2. Debt and Crowding Out: Persistent fiscal

deficits raise debt and interest rates and crowd out private investment, though moderate deficits can fund productive assets.

3. Debt Sustainability: A primary deficit means new borrowing beyond interest, a primary surplus signals prudence.
4. Inflation and Confidence: Monetised deficits fuel inflation, while large deficits raise borrowing costs.
5. State Stress: High liabilities and off-budget borrowings complicate Andhra Pradesh's fiscal management.

Conclusion

Deficits are a tool, not a goal. Borrowing for productive investment while consolidating revenue deficits balances growth with stability.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

5(a) Discuss the role of the State Finance Commission in Andhra Pradesh and analyse its significance in strengthening local finances and promoting fiscal decentralisation within the state.

10

Introduction

Fiscal decentralisation is critical for empowering local governments to deliver public services and foster inclusive development. In Andhra Pradesh, the State Finance Commission (SFC) addresses fiscal imbalances between the state and its local bodies, made sharper by the 2014 bifurcation.

Role of the SFC in Andhra Pradesh

1. **Constitutional Mandate:** Constituted under Article 243-I, it reviews the finances of Panchayati Raj Institutions and urban local bodies.
2. **Composition:** Experts and officials assess revenue capacity and needs, though serving civil servants may limit autonomy.
3. **Devolution Framework:** It recommends tax devolution and grants to bridge the gap between functions and funds, as local revenues cover only a fraction of costs.
4. **Link to State Finances:** A rising state revenue deficit and falling capital spending shape what can be devolved.

How the SFC Works



Implementation Challenges

1. **Delayed Adoption:** The state has historically delayed acting on SFC reports.
2. **Data Gaps:** Weak local data and inefficiencies, such as 968 crore excess payments in the CFMS audit.
3. **Fiscal Stress:** A revenue deficit of 68,743 crore in 2024-25 limits transfers.
4. **Weak Local Governance:** Dependence on state grants limits the ability of Panchayats and municipalities to plan projects independently.

Significance for Local Finances

1. **Fiscal Autonomy:** Higher devolution reduces dependence on state grants.
2. **Accountability:** Performance-linked grants improve tax collection and service delivery.
3. **Regional Equity:** Targeted transfers support

lagging areas like Rayalaseema.

Way Forward

1. Timely Implementation: Institutionalise prompt acceptance of SFC reports for predictable transfers.
2. Data Systems: Use IT systems like CFMS for better local fiscal planning and audit.
3. Capacity Building: Train local officials in financial management.

Conclusion

The SFC is the key to fiscal decentralisation in Andhra Pradesh. Acting on its reports promptly will make local bodies financially strong units of self-government.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

5(b) Discuss the key recommendations of the Fifteenth Finance Commission of India. How do these recommendations influence government budgeting at the centre and state levels?

10

Introduction

The Fifteenth Finance Commission (FFC), constituted under Article 280, submitted its final report for 2021–26 amid evolving fiscal challenges. Its recommendations shape the fiscal architecture between the Centre and states, influencing budget priorities, discipline and resource allocation, especially for stressed states like Andhra Pradesh.

Key Recommendations

1. **Tax Devolution at 41%:** Slightly below the earlier 42%, adjusted for new Union Territories, based on income distance (45%), 2011 population (15%), area (15%), forest and ecology (10%), demographic performance (12.5%) and tax effort (2.5%).
2. **Revenue Deficit Grants:** Extended to 17 states, up from 11, to maintain services without excessive borrowing. Andhra Pradesh is a major recipient.
3. **Performance-Based Incentives:** Conditional grants linked to health and education, with education grants tied to a Performance Grading Index.
4. **Local Bodies Grants:** Substantial grants to urban

and rural local bodies.

Influence on Central Budgeting

1. **Reduced Discretion:** A fixed 41% share shrinks the Centre's discretionary space, forcing it to optimise spending.
2. **Committed Expenditure:** Over Rs 10.3 lakh crore in grants-in-aid for 2021–26 requires careful consolidation.
3. **Conditionality:** Monitoring state compliance with health and education targets increases oversight but promotes outcome-oriented budgeting.
4. **Cess Exclusion:** Cesses and surcharges outside the pool keep revenue with the Centre, creating tension.

Influence on State Budgeting

1. **Predictability:** Assured devolution aids medium-term planning. Andhra Pradesh's 2026–27 budget projects a 28% rise in own tax revenue.
2. **Fiscal Discipline:** Grants carry prudence conditions, yet Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit quadrupled in 2022–23.
3. **Social Sector Focus:** Performance grants shift budgets towards health and education.
4. **Local Governance:** Local grants need state capacity

to be used well.

Impact on Budgeting

Centre	States
Less discretionary space	Predictable 41% devolution
Rs 10.3 lakh crore committed	Revenue deficit grants, 17 states
Monitors grant conditions	Shift to health, education

Overall Effect

1. Shared Discipline: Fixed devolution and conditional grants push both levels to optimise spending and borrowing.
2. From Outlays to Results: Performance-linked grants shift budgets towards measurable outcomes.
3. Federal Friction: Cess exclusion remains a source of tension that complicates revenue forecasting at both levels.

Conclusion

The FFC brought predictability and outcome-oriented budgeting to both levels, strengthening cooperative federalism while demanding fiscal discipline.

Write your own answer to 5(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

6(a) What are the challenges faced by women in India? Throw some light on the recent programmes initiated by the government for women empowerment.

10

Introduction

Women's empowerment is a critical agenda as India seeks to harness its demographic dividend. Despite progress in education and health, women face barriers rooted in social norms, economic disparities and institutional gaps. Recent programmes aim to remove these barriers and promote gender equality.

Challenges Faced by Women

1. Social and cultural constraints: Patriarchal norms restrict mobility, decision-making and access to education and jobs; gender-based violence and workplace harassment deter participation.
2. Economic participation gaps: Female LFPR rose to 41.7% in 2023-24, but many women remain in informal, low-paid jobs without social security, childcare or safe transport.
3. Skill and health deficits: Training is poorly aligned with markets; AP has 22% specialist vacancies and 175 CHCs against 412 needed.
4. Digital divide: Only 28% of rural women

have internet access, limiting use of Jan Dhan and DBT.

Recent Government Programmes

1. Legal measures: The POSH Act (2013) prevents workplace harassment, and the Maternity Benefit Act (2017) extends paid leave to (26) weeks.
2. Support centres: One Stop Centres give medical, legal and psychological help to victims of vidence, Working Women Hostels offer safe housing.
3. Financial inclusion: Stand-Up India and Mudra give collateral-free loans; (81%) of Stand-Up India loans went to women as of (2025).
4. State efforts: Mahila Shakti Kendras in Andhra Pradesh build rural women's skills and digital literacy.

Challenges and Responses

Challenge	Programme
Vidence, workplace harassment	POSH Act, One Stop Centres
Informal, low-paid work	Stand-Up India, Mudra
Rural skill gaps	Mahila Shakti Kendras

Way Forward

1. Institutions: Expand One Stop Centres and hostels in regions like Rayalaseema.
2. Skills and work: Tailor training to emerging sectors and promote flexible work backed by childcare.
3. Digital access: Invest in affordable internet and digital literacy for rural women to use online finance and education.
4. Health: Fill health vacancies and add CHCs in Andhra Pradesh to improve maternal and reproductive health.

Conclusion

Sustained institutional support and effective implementation will raise women's participation, advancing SDG (5) and a Viksit Bharat by (2047).

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

ghissu

On ghissu every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into chapter notes by themselves.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 6(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

Scan to practice

6(b) Elaborate on the meaning of Inclusive Growth in the context of the Indian economy. Discuss the key strategies and instruments that can be employed to foster greater inclusion and ensure that the benefits of economic growth reach all sections of society.

10

Introduction

India has become one of the fastest-growing major economies, yet growth has not been equitably shared. Inclusive growth, which ensures that rural people, women, marginalised communities and backward regions benefit, is now a central policy goal. Andhra Pradesh's growth of 9.24% in 2024-25, above the national 6.4%, shows the potential when growth is paired with inclusion.

Meaning of Inclusive Growth

1. Broad-Based Participation: Growth that creates opportunities for the poor, women and disadvantaged groups, in line with the Eleventh Plan's stress on equality of opportunity.
2. Vulnerable Sectors and Regions: Growth in agriculture, MSMEs and backward regions, such as aquaculture and horticulture in Rayalaseema.
3. Productive Employment: Long-term poverty reduction through jobs rather than short-term transfers, crucial given informal work and skill

mismatches.

4. Reducing Inequalities: Narrowing entrenched gaps of caste, gender and geography.

Key Strategies

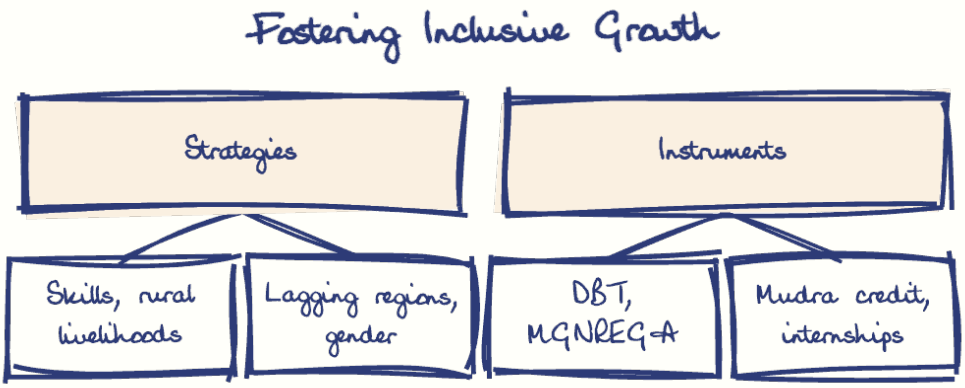
1. Human Capital: Education and vocational training through the Skill India Digital Platform and Skill India International Centers.
2. Rural Livelihoods: DAY-NRLM encourages non-farm jobs and rural entrepreneurship.
3. Lagging Regions: Transport, digital and irrigation infrastructure like the Polavaram project.
4. Gender and Social Protection: Mission Shakti and safety nets remove barriers for women.

Instruments

1. Direct Benefit Transfer: DBT cuts leakages and ensures timely support.
2. Employment Guarantee: MGNREGA gives income security to the rural poor.
3. Financial Inclusion: Mudra Yojana gives credit to small entrepreneurs.
4. Skills and Internships: The PM Internship Scheme and ELI Scheme support youth jobs.

Practice 6(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

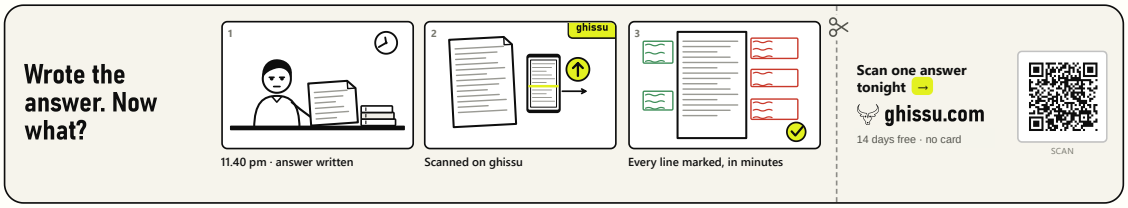


Way Forward

1. Public–Private Partnerships: Use Andhra Pradesh's port-led industrial corridors for job creation.
2. Digital Infrastructure: Extend connectivity to rural and remote areas for access to markets, education and finance.
3. Monitoring: Robust data systems to track inclusion outcomes and adjust policies.

Conclusion

Inclusive growth turns high growth into shared prosperity when skills, jobs, credit and safety nets reach every section of society. Inclusion is not a cost to growth but its foundation.



7(a) Critically Examine the major poverty alleviation and employment generation programmes in India. How effective have they been in addressing rural and urban poverty?

10

Introduction

India's multidimensional poverty declined from 29.17% in 2013–14 to 11.28% in 2022–23. Yet rural distress, urban poverty and uneven regional development persist, so the effectiveness of these programmes matters, especially in Andhra Pradesh.

Poverty Alleviation Programmes

1. **MGNREGA:** Guarantees 100 days of unskilled work, demand rose 30% in 2020–21 during COVID-19.
2. **PM-AY-G:** Over 2.69 crore houses built by early 2025; the urban scheme targets slums.
3. **NRLM:** Organises poor families into SHGs for self-employment and financial inclusion.
4. **NFSA 2013:** Subsidised grain for 75% of rural and 50% of urban people, with PDS and Midday Meals.

Employment Generation Programmes

1. **Skill and credit:** Skill India Digital Platform, Mudra Yojana and Stand-Up India support

micro and small enterprises.

2. ELI Scheme: Incentivises employers to create formal jobs.

3. NULM: Enables self-employment and skilled wage work for vulnerable urban populations.

4. Internships and apprenticeships: The PM Internship Scheme and Skill India International Centres build youth skills and exposure to industry.

Effectiveness

1. Rural poverty: MGNREGA gives income security, but delayed and below-market wages persist. CAG found welfare fund diversion in Andhra Pradesh.

2. Urban poverty: Housing gaps, informal work and weak services keep it entrenched. NULM has had limited success, and AP's urban bodies lag in basic services.

3. Governance gaps: Poor targeting, corruption and weak political will hurt delivery. slow rehabilitation of families displaced by the Polavaram Project shows how projects can deepen poverty.

4. Human development: Women and SCs are now better targeted, but health vacancies and

budget shortfalls in Andhra Pradesh limit outcomes.

Rural vs Urban Poverty Response

Rural	Urban
MGNREGA, NRLM, PM-AY-G	PM-AY-U, NULM
Stronger safety net	Fragmented, overlapping schemes
Wage delays, fund diversion	Informal work, weak services

Critical Assessment

1. Rural bias: The rural safety net is stronger, while urban schemes remain fragmented and overlapping.
2. Delivery over design: Most failures arise from implementation, targeting and fund diversion rather than scheme design.

Conclusion

These programmes have cut poverty, especially rural, but stronger governance, transparency and an urban focus are needed for truly inclusive growth.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 7(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

7(b) Discuss the significance of Social Welfare Schemes in promoting inclusive growth in India. Analyse the key objectives and features of some major social welfare schemes and evaluate their effectiveness in reaching vulnerable populations and reducing inequalities.

10

Introduction

With GVA growth estimated at 6.4% for 2024–25, ensuring that progress benefits all is imperative. Social welfare schemes bridge disparities by targeting women, SCs, STs and minorities, turning growth into a broad-based process of social justice.

Significance for Inclusive Growth

1. Poverty reduction: MGNREGA has employed over 110 million rural households, stabilising incomes.
2. Human capital: The Mid-Day Meal scheme raises attendance and nutrition.
3. Economic empowerment: PMJDY's over 55 crore accounts, especially among women and the rural poor, enable financial inclusion and DBT.
4. Safety nets: PMGKAY ensured food security during COVID-19.

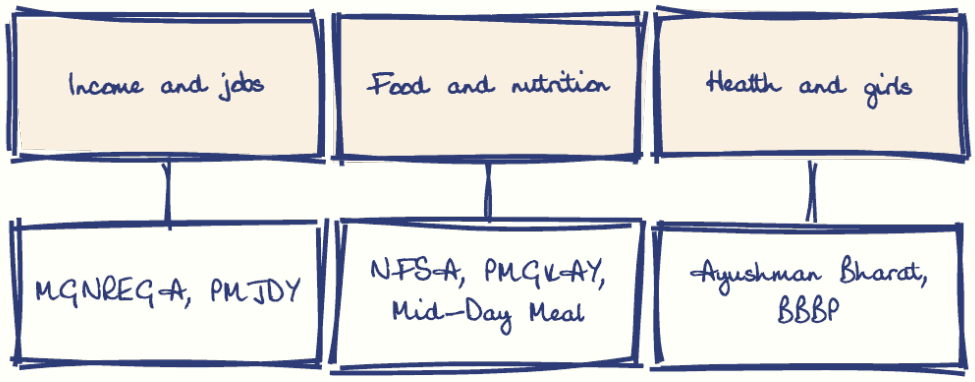
Objectives and Features

1. Targeted equity: Schemes focus on marginalised groups; Beti Bachao Beti Padhao improves girls'

education and health.

2. Legal entitlements: NFSA entitles over 80 crore people to subsidised grain.
3. Integrated design: Ayushman Bharat links insurance with primary care for over 500 million people.
4. Technology and DBT: Direct Benefit Transfers cut leakages; AP's DBT template is a model.

Major Welfare Schemes



Effectiveness

1. Poverty alleviation: Nearly 25 crore people left multidimensional poverty in a decade.
2. Social indicators: The Swachh Bharat Mission brought rural sanitation to near universal levels, improving health in vulnerable communities.
3. Leakages: AP audits show fund diversion,

excess administrative costs and pending claims reaching (100%) in some welfare boards.

4. Coverage gaps: Socio-cultural barriers, infrastructure deficits and bureaucratic inefficiency exclude the most marginalised, limiting the fall in inequality.

Way Forward

1. Accountability: Robust audits and real-time grievance redressal to curb fund diversion, especially in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Targeting: Use data analytics to identify and include the most vulnerable.
3. Social infrastructure: Invest in health, education and sanitation to complement cash transfers.

Conclusion

Welfare schemes have widened reach and cut poverty sharply, but tighter accountability and better targeting will make them a true engine of inclusive growth and lower inequality.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

8(a) Examine the concept of 'Financial Inclusion' and its critical role in fostering inclusive growth in India. Discuss the key initiatives undertaken to promote financial inclusion and evaluate their impact on bringing the unbanked and underbanked populations into the formal financial system.

10

Introduction

Financial inclusion is the process of ensuring affordable access to savings, credit, insurance and payments for vulnerable and low-income groups, delivered responsibly. With over 78% of Indian adults holding bank accounts in 2024, India has made major strides, and inclusion is a key enabler of several UN Sustainable Development Goals.

Understanding Financial Inclusion

1. Scope: RBI's National Strategy for Financial Inclusion 2019–24 stresses timely and adequate credit for weaker sections at reasonable cost.
2. Multi-dimensional: It covers credit, insurance and pension use, backed by financial literacy and consumer protection, not just accounts.
3. Barriers: Poverty, irregular income and illiteracy on the demand side; thin branch network, high costs and cumbersome KYC on the supply side.

Practice 8(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

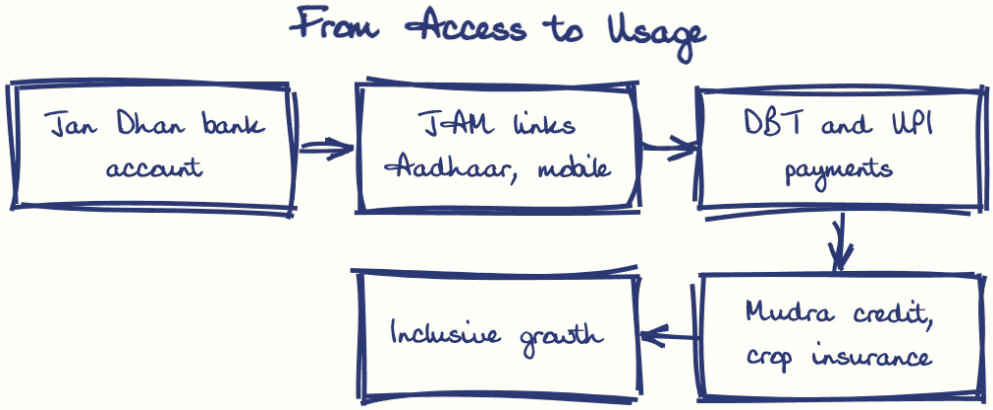
Role in Inclusive Growth

1. **Economic empowerment:** Credit and savings support income, assets and entrepreneurship, aiding growth like Andhra Pradesh's 9.24% in 2024–25.
2. **Gender inclusion:** Accounts give women control over household resources, though a gender gap persists nationally and in Andhra Pradesh.
3. **Social security:** Atal Pension Yojana and PMSBY reduce vulnerability to health emergencies and crop failures.
4. **Reducing inequality:** Formal access curbs dependence on exploitative informal lenders.

Key Initiatives and Impact

1. **PMJDY (2014):** Over 55 crore accounts, 67% in rural and semi-urban areas and 56% owned by women; it widened banking outreach in Andhra Pradesh.
2. **Digital ecosystem:** The JAM trinity and UPI lowered costs and enabled payments in remote areas.
3. **Credit and insurance:** Mudra Yojana and Fasal Bima Yojana improved credit and risk cover for micro enterprises and farmers.

4. Last-mile delivery: Business Correspondents and literacy campaigns overcome physical barriers.



5. Evaluation: The Financial Inclusion Index rose from 43.4 in 2017 to 67.0 in 2025, though credit and insurance usage still lag.

Conclusion

India has largely solved access; the next step is meaningful usage through credit deepening, literacy and closing the gender gap, making inclusion the base of inclusive growth.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

8(b) Explain the concept of sustainable agriculture. What are its key objectives and common practices in India?

10

Introduction

Sustainable agriculture means farming that maintains productivity while conserving soil, water and biodiversity, ensuring long-term food and nutrition security. With agriculture employing over half of India's workforce and facing climate change and resource depletion, it is essential for India's future.

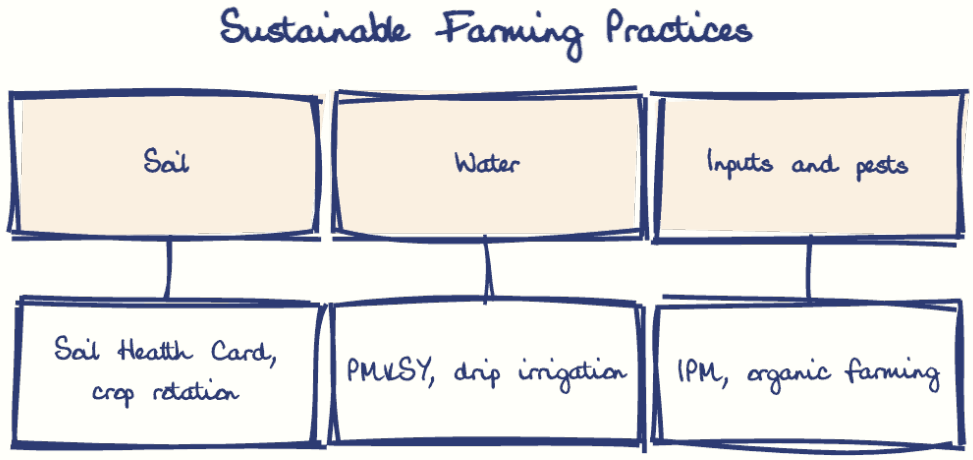
Key Objectives

1. Productive rainfed farming: NMSA, launched in 2014, raises rainfed productivity through integrated farming and climate resilience.
2. Soil health: The Soil Health Card scheme guides precise fertiliser use to prevent degradation.
3. Water efficiency: PMKSY promotes micro-irrigation and rainwater harvesting, crucial in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
4. Livelihoods: RKVY funds modern practices and skills, creating over 2 million jobs.

Common Practices in India

1. Crop rotation and intercropping: Improve fertility and cut pests; rotation covers about 30 million hectares.

2. Micro-irrigation and rainwater harvesting: Drip and on-farm water management suit water-scarce regions.
3. Integrated Pest Management: IPM reduces chemical pesticides through biological control.
4. Organic and natural farming: Avoid synthetic inputs and raise soil organic matter.
5. Agroforestry and mulching: Conserve moisture, prevent erosion and store carbon.



Challenges

1. Low adoption: Organic farming covers only 2% of net sown area and IPM about 5 million hectares.
2. Knowledge gaps: Extension services are uneven, so many smallholders lack training in sustainable methods.

3. High costs: High initial costs of drip irrigation and organic inputs deter small and marginal farmers without credit.

4. Climate pressure: Soil degradation from chemical overuse and droughts cause frequent crop failures in Andhra Pradesh's drought-prone districts.

Way Forward

1. Farmer education: Strengthen extension services and farmer producer organisations in Andhra Pradesh.

2. Finance: Enhance credit and subsidies under the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund.

3. Policy: Clear guidelines and incentives integrated with state agricultural policies.

4. Technology: Digital tools for real-time advisory and market links.

Conclusion

Sustainable agriculture is vital for long-term food security, environmental conservation and farmers' livelihoods. Combining these practices with institutional support and tools like Agri-Stack can deliver resilient growth for Atmanirbhar Krishi.

Correct, but average?
A number, a committee, a case — for every question.
ghissu.com →

9(a) Explain the role of the Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC) Act in Agricultural Price Policy in regulating the agricultural market in India. What are the issues that have been observed by policy makers regarding the functioning of the APMC Act?

10

Introduction

Agricultural marketing is a key determinant of farm incomes and food security, with over 42% of India's population depending on the sector. The APMC Acts, enacted by states, regulate markets and shape price policy. With fragmented markets and rising farmer distress, policymakers have increasingly scrutinised their effectiveness.

Role in Agricultural Price Policy

1. **Price discovery:** Regulated mandis host the first sale of notified commodities, protecting farmers from exploitative middlemen and providing a platform for MSP procurement, as for paddy and chillies in Andhra Pradesh.
2. **Market fees:** Fees fund market infrastructure but act as a quasi-tax that can raise marketing costs.
3. **Price control:** Mandatory sales through licensed agents in notified areas can stabilise prices and prevent distress sales, though without

competition it limits farmers' bargaining power.

4. Model APMC Act (2003): It allowed contract farming and special markets for perishables, vital for AP's horticulture.

How the Act Regulates Markets

1. Market committees and yards: Sales must occur in designated yards, ensuring orderly trade but fragmenting markets.
2. Licensing: Agents and traders need APMC licences, meant for market discipline but often leading to limited competition and cartelisation.
3. Fees: Fees and commissions vary widely and lack transparency, adding to farmers' costs.
4. Restrictions: Farmers are restricted from selling outside notified mandis.

Issues Observed by Policymakers

1. No national market: Thousands of mandis under different state laws impede a unified national market and inter-state trade.
2. Monopoly and politics: Committees and licensed agents form cartels that inflate commissions and cut farmers' net prices, and political patronage in appointments worsens this.

3. High costs: Multiple, non-transparent fees reduce the farmer's share of the consumer rupee.

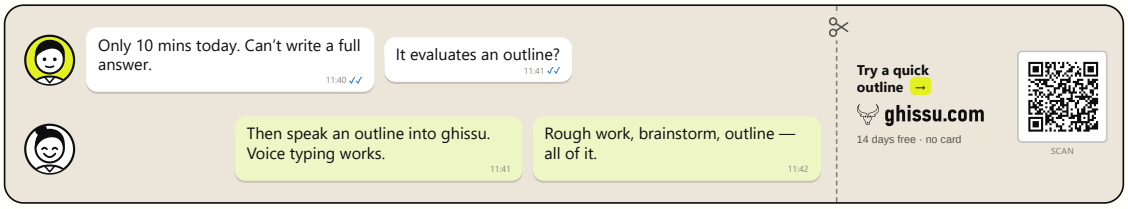
4. Slow reform: Many states, including AP, have been slow to adopt direct sales, special markets and single market fees.

APMC: Intent vs Practice

Intended Role	Observed Issue
Shield from middlemen	Cartels of licensed agents
Fees fund infrastructure	High, non-transparent fees
Orderly regulated yards	No unified national market
Model Act 2003 reforms	Slow adoption, including AP

Conclusion

The APMC framework protects farmers from distress sales but restricts competition. Faster adoption of Model Act reforms can ensure fair price discovery and wider market access.

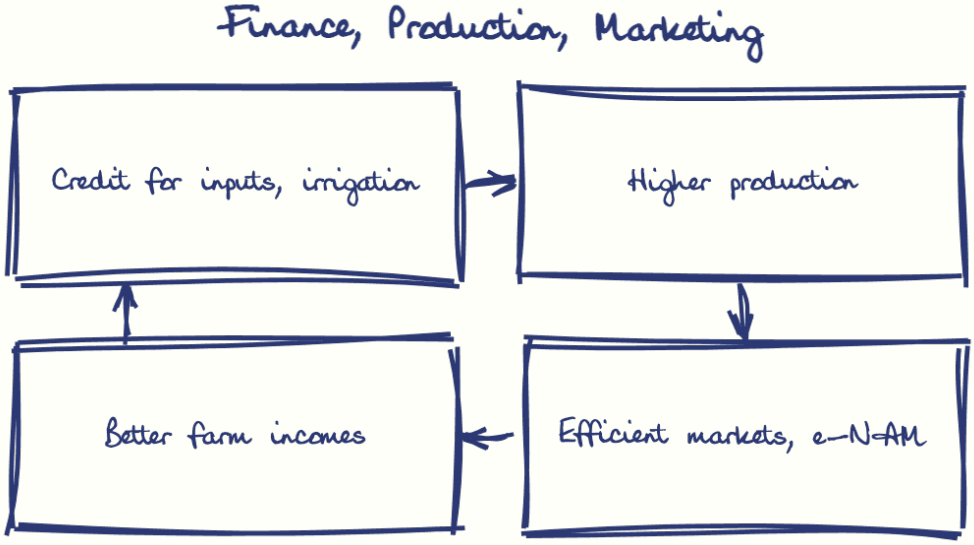


9(b) Examine the significance of agriculture finance, production, and marketing in the context of India's agricultural development. Discuss the challenges and opportunities associated with financing agricultural activities, improving production, and developing efficient marketing systems to support sustainable growth in the agricultural sector.

10

Introduction

Agriculture supports (42.3%) of India's population and contributes (18.2%) of GDP (2024), yet faces low productivity, fragmented holdings and climate vulnerability. Finance, production and marketing together decide farm incomes and food security, as schemes like the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund and e-NAM show.



Agricultural Finance

1. Significance: Timely credit funds seeds, fertilisers, irrigation and machinery; institutional farm credit

grew at a (14.8%) CAGR in FY2019–FY2023.

2. Smallholder focus: With (86%) of holdings small and marginal, KCC and NABARD's Micro Irrigation Fund reduce dependence on moneylenders.

3. Challenges: Lack of collateral, fragmented holdings and risk aversion among lenders restrict long-term investment in sustainable practices.

4. Opportunity: AP's use of the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund has boosted post-harvest investment.

Agricultural Production

1. Significance: Record foodgrain output of (357.73 million) tonnes is projected for 2024–25, underpinning food security and rural jobs.

2. Challenges: Small holdings and low mechanisation limit economies of scale, while soil degradation and water scarcity threaten output.

3. Opportunities: Sustainable intensification under the National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture, and horticulture and aquaculture in coastal AP.

Agricultural Marketing

1. Significance: e-NAM integrates mandis, cutting intermediaries and price volatility.

2. Infrastructure: Agricultural Marketing Infrastructure

funds warehouses, cold storage and grading, reducing post-harvest losses.

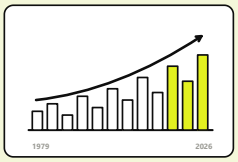
3. Challenges: Smallholders face regulatory constraints and lack of information, weakening their bargaining power.
4. AP initiatives: Public-private partnerships and ATMA have strengthened market linkages and farmer training.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive credit: Collateral-free loans for smallholders through digital finance and FPO linkages.
2. Sustainable technology: Climate-resilient seeds, precision farming and water-efficient irrigation backed by extension.
3. Modern marketing: Scale up cold chains and warehouses and link e-NAM with FPOs and warehouse receipts.

Conclusion

Inclusive credit, climate-resilient production and modern markets reinforce each other; together they can raise farmer incomes and deliver sustainable agricultural growth.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

10(a) What are the key drivers for the growth of the fisheries sector? What are the schemes undertaken by the fisheries department for the growth of this sector?

10

Introduction

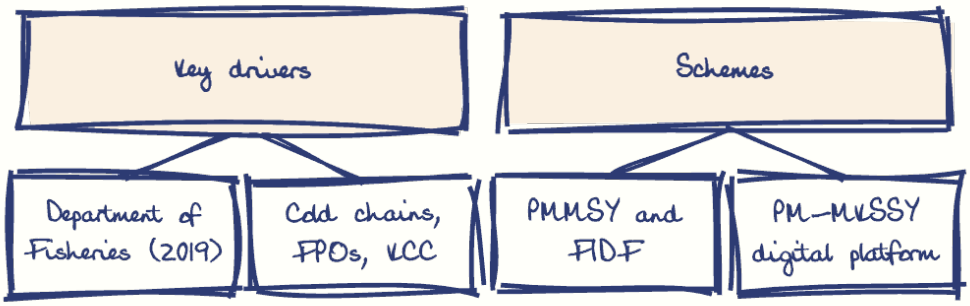
The fisheries sector is a vital engine of growth, employment and nutritional security, with India's fish production reaching 197.75 lakh tonnes in 2024–25. It sustains coastal and inland livelihoods and adds to agricultural GDP and exports. Doubling fishers' incomes and sustainable aquaculture are priorities nationally and in Andhra Pradesh.

Key Drivers of Growth

1. **Institutional focus:** A separate Department of Fisheries, created in 2019, streamlined governance and integrated schemes under the Blue Revolution.
2. **Infrastructure and cold chains:** Over 730 cold storages and 26,348 fish transport facilities created under PMMSY improved the supply chain and cut losses.
3. **Collective action:** 2,195 Fisheries FPOs with investments of Rs 544 crore strengthened bargaining, market access and value addition.
4. **Credit and insurance:** Kisan Credit Cards for 4.39 lakh fishers and insurance for 3.3 million beneficiaries improved resilience.

5. Coastal potential: Andhra Pradesh's extensive coastline and aquaculture potential, tapped through projects aligned with PMMSY, drive growth in coastal districts.

Growth of fisheries



Schemes for the Sector

1. PMMSY (2020): The flagship Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana targets a 70-lakh tonne rise in production and doubling fishers' incomes by 2024-25.
2. FIDF: The Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund, with a corpus over Rs 7,500 crore, gives concessional loans through NABARD for harbours, cold chains and processing.
3. PM-Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana: It formalises the sector through a National Fisheries Digital Platform, aquaculture insurance and quality upgrades.

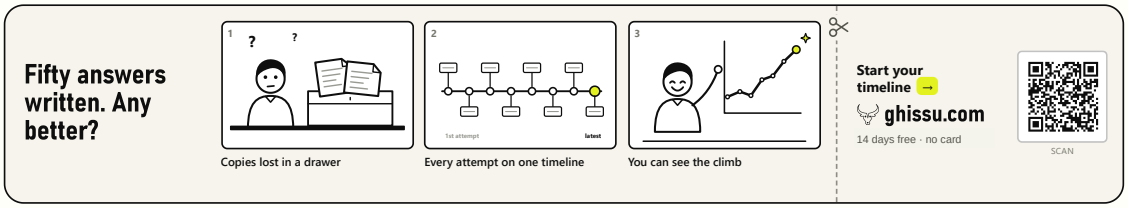
4. Blue Revolution measures: Seasonal fishing bans and eco-friendly technologies protect breeding cycles.

Challenges

1. Technology gap: Many small-scale fishers still lack GPS and fish finders, limiting productivity.
2. Weak value chains: Much inland catch is sold in unhygienic traditional markets, and value-added products are a small share of exports.
3. Gender gap: Women dominate low-paid, unrecognised post-harvest roles.
4. Uneven enforcement: Seasonal bans are unevenly enforced in marine fisheries.

Conclusion

Institutional reform and schemes have driven production and exports. Technology access, post-harvest infrastructure and women's empowerment will make the growth inclusive.



10(b) Discuss the role of agriculture in the economic development of Andhra Pradesh. How has agriculture contributed to the State Gross Domestic Product (SGDP) in recent years? Identify the key drivers influencing its performance.

10

Introduction

Agriculture is a cornerstone of Andhra Pradesh's economy, sustaining livelihoods and food security amid rapid urbanisation and industrial growth. With the state's GSDP growth outpacing the national average, agriculture's diversification into high-value crops and allied activities has become critical for inclusive development.

Role in Economic Development

1. Rural livelihoods: Agriculture is the main source of income and employment for much of the rural population, sustaining stability and reducing poverty.
2. Industrial linkages: It supports food processing, textiles and fisheries, creating backward and forward linkages and rural non-farm jobs.
3. High-value diversification: Horticulture, aquaculture and dairy have raised incomes, in line with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.
4. Resource stress: Small holdings, groundwater depletion and climate variability call for practices like APCNF.

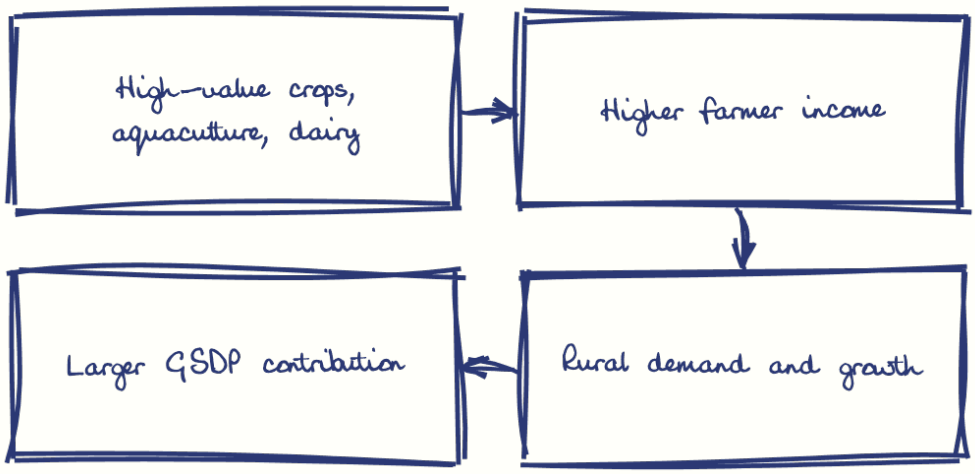
Practice 10(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

Contribution to SGDP in Recent Years

1. **Share and growth:** Agriculture and allied sectors contributed about Rs 2.32 lakh crore to GSDP in 2024–25, growing at 10.70%.
2. **Above national pace:** State GSDP grew 9.24% in 2024–25 against 6.4% nationally, with agriculture a key driver.
3. **Declining but vital share:** Its share has fallen with industrialisation, but it remains vital for food security and rural income.
4. **Monsoon volatility:** Output remains vulnerable to monsoon variability and market swings, which call for risk mitigation.

How agriculture lifts GSDP



Key Drivers of Performance

1. **Irrigation:** Projects like Polavaram expand water

availability, improving yields and enabling multiple cropping in drought-prone regions.

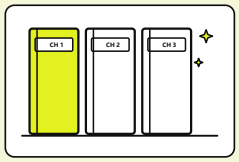
2. Technology: High-yield varieties, precision agriculture and extension through Krishi Vigyan Kendras raise productivity and resilience against climate risks.

3. Markets: e-NAM, MSP and farmer producer organisations improve market linkages and price realisation.

4. Welfare schemes: The Crop Cultivators Right Act and Annadatha Sukhibhava give security and encourage investment.

Conclusion

Agriculture remains a vital engine of Andhra Pradesh's development and GSDP. Sustainable resource management, technological innovation and stronger markets will drive its climate-resilient growth and the goal of doubling farmers' income.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

11(a) Examine the role of the industrial sector in India's economic development. How does industrialisation contribute to income generation, employment, and modernisation of the economy? Support your answer with relevant examples and policy references.

10

Introduction

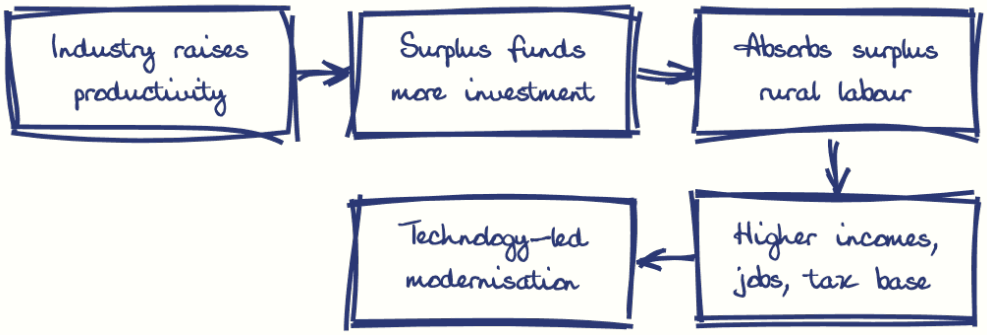
Industrialisation is the key driver that transforms India's largely agrarian economy into a modern, diversified one by generating income, employment and technological progress. Andhra Pradesh's GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, ahead of the national 6.4%, shows how industry can accelerate development.

Role of Industry in Economic Development

1. Prime mover of growth: Industry raises productivity and links agriculture and services; port-led industrialisation along the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor has boosted trade and investment.
2. Economic surplus: Economies of scale and inter-industry links create surplus that funds further investment.
3. Structural transformation: Industry absorbs surplus rural labour, but premature deindustrialisation and a falling manufacturing job share are concerns.

4. Policy support: PSUs led early industrialisation; the 1991 reforms eased licensing and promoted FDI.

How industry transforms the economy



Contribution to Income Generation

1. Higher value addition: Industry yields higher incomes than farming; AP's per capita income of Rs 2,68,653 in 2024–25 exceeds the national average.
2. Rural multiplier: Demand for raw materials lifts rural incomes; textiles contribute 2.3% of GDP and employ over 45 million.
3. Tax base: Formal growth widens revenue; AP's own tax revenue is projected at Rs 94,967 crore in 2024–25.

Contribution to Employment

1. Job creation: The PLI scheme has created over 12.6 lakh jobs directly and through ancillaries.

2. Skills: Visakhapatnam's clusters and textile hubs build skills.

3. Jobless growth risk: Capital-intensive industry limits labour absorption.

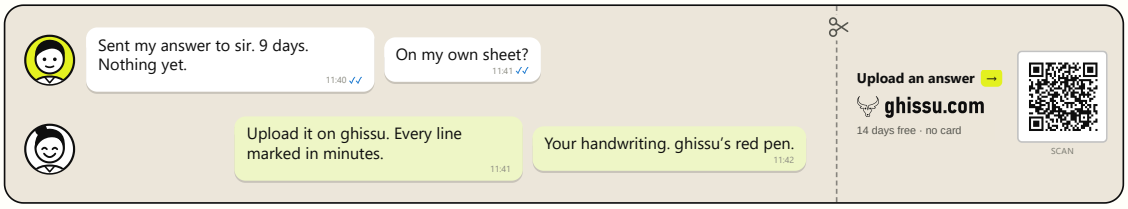
Contribution to Modernisation

1. Technology: Medium and high-technology manufacturing is 46.3% of manufacturing value added.

2. Open economy: Post-1991 FDI and reduced licensing brought in capital, technology and global practices.

Conclusion

Industry drives income, jobs and modernisation, but labour-intensive and inclusive policy is needed so its gains reach all regions and groups.



11(b) Examine the role of the Startup India programme in promoting entrepreneurial development in India. What are the major features of the programme, and how has it contributed to the industrial and economic growth of the country?

10

Introduction

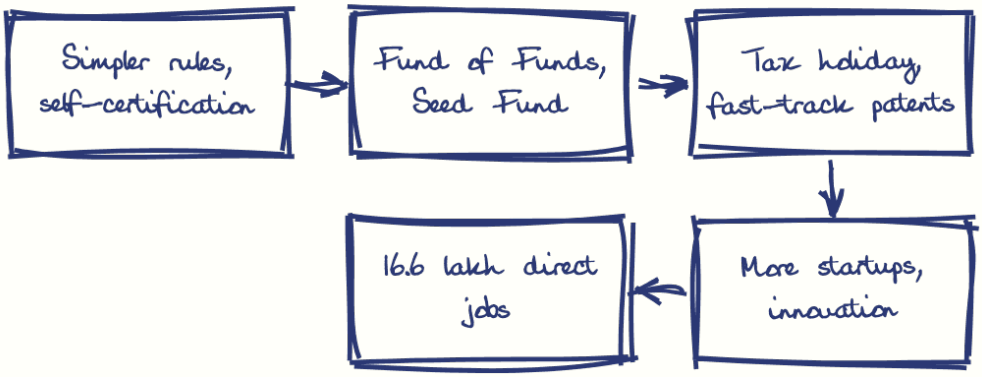
With India's startup ecosystem now the third largest globally, Startup India, launched in 2016, has become a pivotal tool for entrepreneurship and innovation. It matters because job creation and diversification are urgent priorities for harnessing the demographic dividend.

Major Features

1. Simplified regulation: Easier registration and self-certification under labour and environmental laws speed up startup formation.
2. Financial support: The Rs 10,000 crore Fund of Funds managed by SIDBI, the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme and the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Startups.
3. Tax and IPR benefits: A three-year tax holiday, capital gains exemptions and fast-track patent examination with fee rebates.
4. Incubation and mentorship: Incubators, accelerators and the Startup India Hub offer mentoring and networking.

5. Inclusivity: Stand-Up India supports women and SC/ST entrepreneurs, and startups in agriculture, health and education are encouraged.

How Startup India works



Contribution to Industrial Growth

1. Innovation-driven industries: Fintech, healthtech, agritech and AI deepen industry beyond assembly lines.
2. MSME competitiveness: Access to credit and technology strengthens MSMEs, including along Visakhapatnam's port-led corridor.
3. Regional development: Startups in Tier-II and Tier-III cities, including Andhra Pradesh, decentralise growth.
4. Scale-up limits: Scarce skilled manpower and complex regulation constrain scaling.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Contribution to Economic Growth

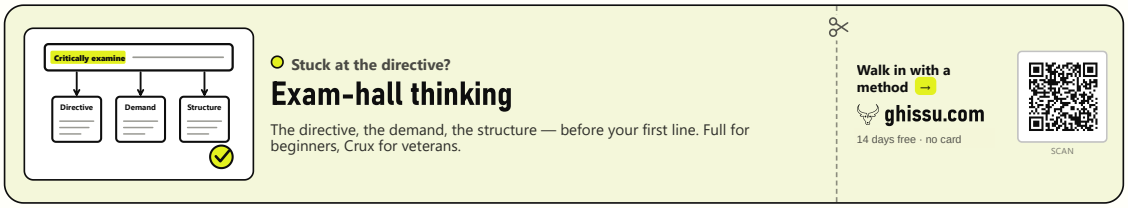
1. Jobs: Recognised startups generated over 16.6 lakh direct jobs by late 2024.
2. Investment: The ecosystem has drawn significant foreign capital.
3. Equity gaps: Only 17% of startups are founded by women and under 1% by persons with disabilities.

Way Forward

1. Funding access: Simplify disbursement under the Fund of Funds and Seed Fund for timely early-stage capital.
2. Skills: Link startup training with state initiatives to ease manpower shortages.

Conclusion

Startup India has turned entrepreneurship into an engine of innovation and jobs. Easier funding, skills and wider inclusion can extend its gains.



How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 11(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

12(a) Critically Examine the industrial policy of the Andhra Pradesh government. What are the major initiatives, support measures and bottlenecks to industrial development in the state?

10

Introduction

The industrial policy of Andhra Pradesh shapes the state's economic path by leveraging its 974 km coastline and port-led corridors. With GSDP growing at 9.24% in 2024-25, above the national average, industry is pivotal for jobs, but the policy must balance rapid industrialisation with infrastructure and environmental limits.

Major Initiatives

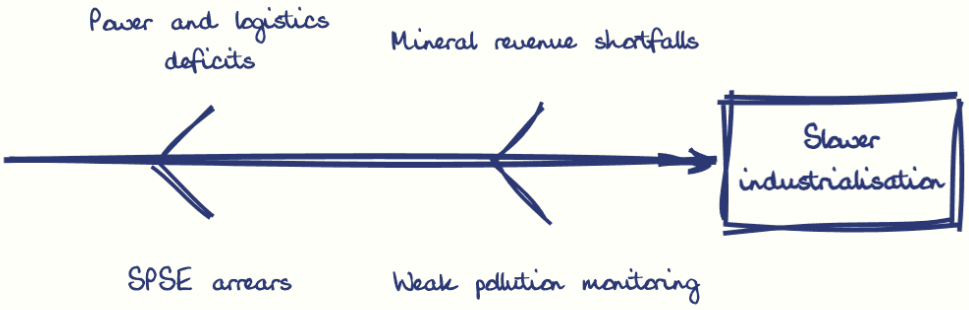
1. Zoning and green parks: The 2020-2023 policy creates green category parks with common effluent treatment plants, attracting environmentally conscious investors.
2. Port-led corridors: The Visakhapatnam-Chennai Industrial Corridor boosts export-oriented manufacturing and links the state to global supply chains.
3. MSMEs and clusters: Cluster infrastructure and skills support broad-based jobs in semi-urban and rural areas.
4. National schemes: Integration of PLI and FAME

builds high-tech and green sectors.

Support Measures

1. Fiscal incentives: Capital and interest subsidies and tax exemptions encourage large and mega projects.
2. Infrastructure: APIIC develops parks with power, roads and water.
3. Ease of doing business: Single-window clearances reduce bureaucratic delays.

Bottlenecks to industrial development



Bottlenecks

1. Infrastructure deficits: Power shortages and weak logistics raise costs.
2. SPSE governance: C&AG reports flag arrears in SPSEs, which form 6.69% of GSDP.
3. Mineral revenue shortfalls: Policy delays in the

barytes and limestone sector limit reinvestment funds.

4. Environmental risks: Weak pollution monitoring may deter green investors.

Way Forward

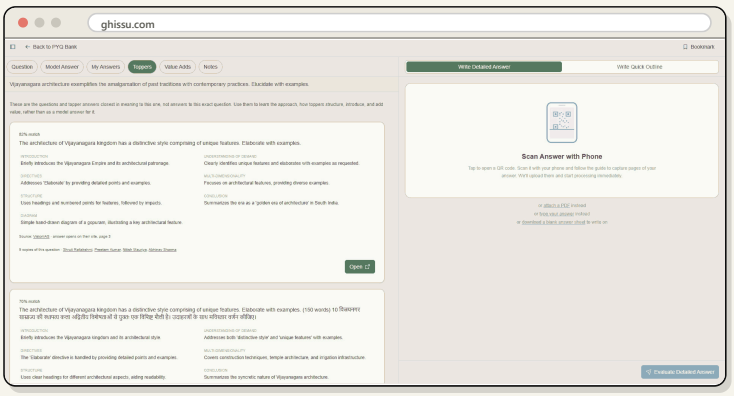
Upgrade power and logistics through PPPs, reform SPSEs, align skilling with green and tech sectors, and enforce pollution norms.

Conclusion

The policy has strong initiatives and support, but closing these bottlenecks is essential for sustainable and inclusive industrialisation.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

Forty PDFs, and still no topper copy for this question?



See how toppers wrote it →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 Topper answers matched by meaning to this exact question.

2 Each broken down: introduction, directives, structure.

3 Searched from 1.5 lakh+ topper answers.

Write your own answer to 12(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

12(b) Discuss the role of the industrial sector in the economic development of India. Discuss the role of the Department of Industrial Policy & Promotion (DIPP).

10

Introduction

The industrial sector is a cornerstone of India's development, driving growth, employment and technological progress. Industrial GVA grew 7.0% in the first half of FY2025–26 and manufacturing formed 14.3% of GVA in FY23, making industry vital for a $10-trillion economy. The DIPP, now the DPIIT, shapes industrial policy and investment through Make in India and the PLI scheme.

Role of the Industrial Sector

1. Growth and employment: The PLI scheme has raised electronics production by 146% and created over 12 lakh jobs.
2. Structural limits: Manufacturing stays around 14–15% of GDP; scaling MSMEs and formalising jobs remain hard, and assembly-led growth limits deeper industrialisation.
3. Regional development: Corridors such as Visakhapatnam–Chennai take industry to states like Andhra Pradesh, where state enterprises contribute 6.69% of GSDP.

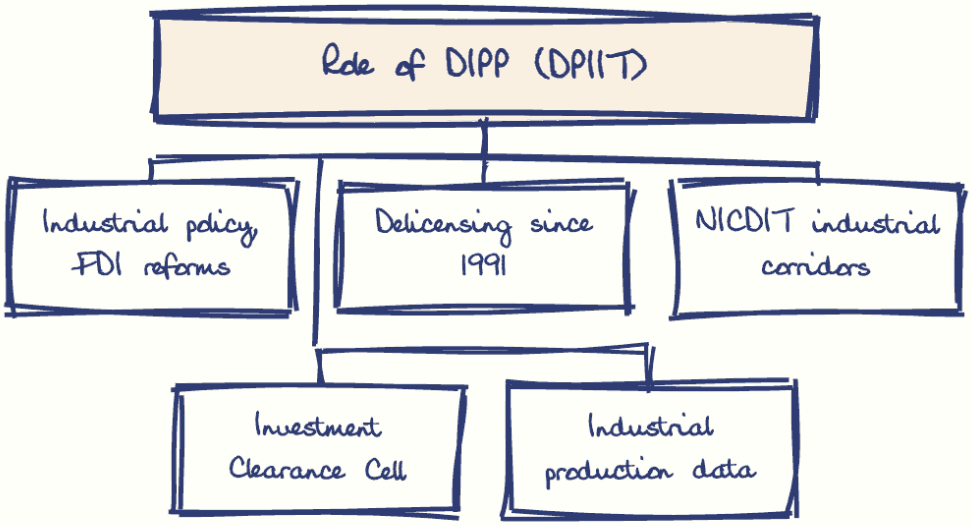
4. Technology: FDI brings capital, though much is brownfield private equity with limited technology transfer.

Role of DIPP (DPIIT)

1. Nodal policy agency: It frames industrial policy, FDI reforms and investment promotion, ensuring a unified national approach.
2. Liberalisation since 1991: It abolished industrial licensing for most sectors, reduced public sector dominance and promoted FDI.
3. Industrial corridors: The NICDIT, under its control, coordinates corridor infrastructure with states that provide land equity.
4. Investment facilitation: The National Investment Clearance Cell and Project Development Cells streamline approvals.
5. Industrial data: The Price and Production Statistics scheme supports performance data, though real-time gaps remain.

Way Forward

1. Centre–state synergy: Joint SPVs to clear land and infrastructure bottlenecks.
2. MSMEs: Expand CGTMSE and Udyam



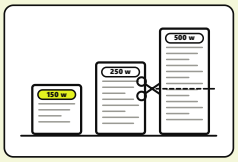
Registration support.

3. Greenfield FDI and R&D: Use PLI and the National Capital Goods Policy for high-technology sectors.

4. Better data: Upgrade industrial statistics for timely, granular monitoring of industrial clusters.

Conclusion

Industry remains India's engine of jobs, innovation and exports. A proactive DPIIT can make this growth inclusive, advancing Viksit Bharat 2047 and SDG 8.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

13(a) Discuss the current state of transport infrastructure in India and its contribution to economic development. Highlight key challenges and suggest policy measures for improving its efficiency and reach.

10

Introduction

India's transport infrastructure has seen major expansion and modernisation, driving growth and social integration. With capital outlay nearly doubling to over 11 lakh crore for FY26 and PM GatiShakti driving multimodal connectivity, transport is central to productivity and competitiveness, though modal imbalance, capacity limits and poor maintenance persist.

Current State and Contribution to Development

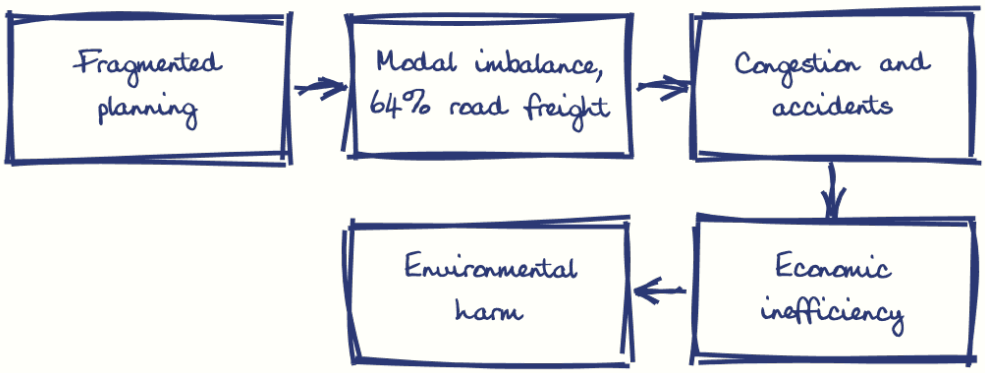
1. Coordinated planning: The GatiShakti National Master Plan takes a whole-of-government approach to integrate railways, roads, ports, waterways, airports and logistics, ending fragmented planning.
2. State-level corridors: Andhra Pradesh's port-led Visakhapatnam-Chennai corridor uses transport for regional growth.
3. Investment mobilisation: PPPs, hybrid annuity models and NIIF attract private capital and ease fiscal limits.
4. Regulatory reforms: Standard documents, dispute resolution and GST integration enable seamless

interstate freight and passenger movement.

Key Challenges

1. Modal imbalance: Roads carry over 64% of freight, causing congestion, while railways and inland waterways remain underused.
2. Maintenance and safety: Poor upkeep of railways and highways lowers standards, and road accidents cause large human and economic losses.
3. Energy and environment: Transport accounts for 18% of commercial energy use and 55% of petroleum consumption, threatening energy security as demand rises.
4. Root cause: Fragmented planning feeds modal imbalance, which leads to congestion, safety problems, economic inefficiency and environmental harm.

Root cause of transport inefficiency



Policy Measures

1. Multimodal integration: Link ports, railways and roads through SMILE and the National Logistics Policy to cut logistics costs.
2. Maintenance and safety: Pre-emptive maintenance and advanced safety standards using technology and data analytics to reduce accidents.
3. Sustainable modes: Rail electrification, inland waterways and coastal shipping to cut carbon and oil dependence.
4. Institutional capacity: PPP expertise, simpler clearances and transparent regulation for timely completion.

Conclusion

Transport infrastructure is a cornerstone of India's development, facilitating trade, employment and social integration. Integrated planning, sustainable practices and robust institutions will unlock its full potential, contributing to inclusive growth, Viksit Bharat (2047) and SDG (8.)

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

13(b) Discuss the significance of solar energy in India's renewable energy strategy. Highlight the major initiatives, achievements and challenges in the promotion of solar power.

10

Introduction

India's renewable strategy prioritises solar energy for its vast potential to meet growing demand sustainably and cut emissions. With over 300 sunny days a year and ambitious National Solar Mission targets, solar is central to reaching 500 GW of renewable capacity by 2030, supporting energy security and climate goals.

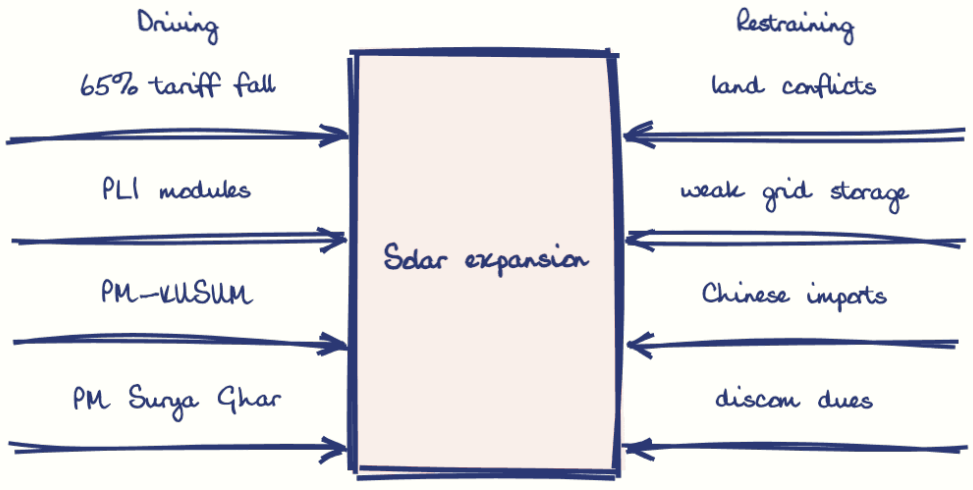
Significance and Major Initiatives

1. **Institutions:** MNRE and the Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency have driven policy and financing since the 1990s.
2. **National Solar Mission:** The initial 20 GW target for 2022 was raised to 100 GW, and India now aims for 280 GW by 2030.
3. **State action:** Andhra Pradesh uses the Solar Park Scheme and PM Surya Ghar for solar parks and rooftops.
4. **International Solar Alliance:** India's leadership aids global cooperation, technology sharing and investment flows.

Achievements

1. Cost competitiveness: Solar tariffs fell nearly 65% in a decade, making solar competitive with conventional power and driving corporate and household adoption.
2. Rural livelihoods: PM-KUSUM solar pumps in Andhra Pradesh raised farm productivity and cut diesel use.
3. Manufacturing and jobs: PLI helped module capacity rise from 38 GW to 74 GW in a year.
4. Climate goals: Solar supports the NDC target of cutting emission intensity by 45% from 2005 levels by 2030.

Solar power in India

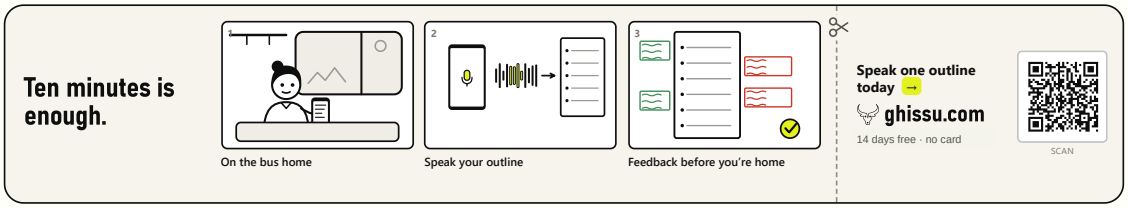


Challenges

1. **Land and environment:** Solar farms need extensive land and conflict with agriculture and ecology, causing delays and resistance in regions like Rayalaseema.
2. **Grid and storage:** Intermittent supply needs smart grids and large-scale storage, which remain underdeveloped relative to capacity.
3. **Import dependence:** A significant share of components still comes from China, hurting the trade balance and supply security.
4. **Finance and discoms:** High upfront costs and delayed discom payments deter investors and limit small-scale adoption despite PM Surya Ghar subsidies.

Conclusion

Solar energy drives growth, energy security and climate action together, and schemes like PM Surya Ghar and PM-KUSUM have accelerated adoption. Grid modernisation, domestic manufacturing and sustainable land use will be key to a low-carbon future and SDG 7.



14(a) Critically evaluate the role of the Smart Cities Mission in transforming urban infrastructure in India. Mention its objectives, implementation progress, key achievements and the major challenges faced.

10

Introduction

Rapid urbanisation makes transforming urban infrastructure vital. The Smart Cities Mission (SCM), launched in 2015, uses technology and citizen participation to create efficient, inclusive and resilient urban spaces, and a critical evaluation shows both real gains and clear limits.

Objectives

1. Inclusive development: Better water, sanitation, energy and mobility, with inclusion across income, gender and age.
2. Citizen-centric governance: Active participation and governance reform.
3. Technology: ICCCs in all 100 cities using AI and IoT.
4. Sustainability: Smart, incremental development with fewer resources.

Implementation Progress

1. Projects and funds: By early 2025, 94% of 8,067 projects were complete with 1.64 lakh crore

invested, and 99.44% of the outlay was released.

2. Area-based development: Retrofitting, redevelopment and greenfield projects, but only in selected pockets.
3. SPVs: Autonomous, but raising accountability concerns.

Smart Cities Mission: gains and limits

Achievements	Challenges
94% of 8,067 projects done	Only small pockets covered
1,740 km smart roads	SPVs bypass elected bodies
ICCCs in all 100 cities	Weak waste management
Women, start-ups gain	Fund and tendering delays

Key Achievements

1. Infrastructure: 1,740 km of smart roads and 713 km of cycle tracks, with Coimbatore's lake rejuvenation.
2. Technology: Operational ICCCs integrate departments for real-time governance.
3. Social gains: Opportunities for women in sanitation, support for start-ups and safer public

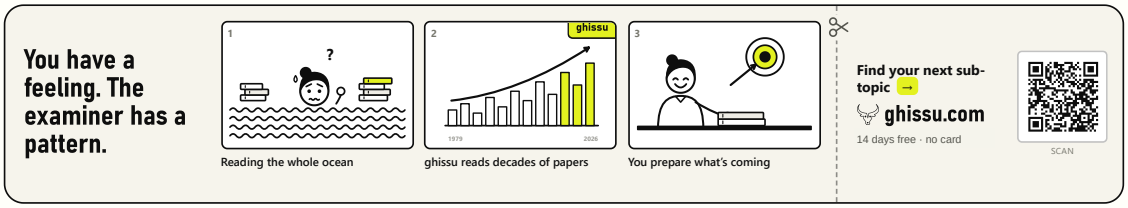
spaces.

Major Challenges

1. **Limited spatial coverage:** In Delhi only (2.2) sq. km of NDMC was covered.
2. **Governance:** The SPV model bypasses elected municipal bodies.
3. **Waste management:** Only (4) of (123) ULBs in Andhra Pradesh had operational sanitary landfills in (2022).
4. **Capacity constraints:** Delays in funds, tendering and execution, worsened by COVID-19.

Conclusion

SCM has upgraded roads, technology and public spaces, but limited coverage, weak accountability and capacity gaps restrict its transformative role.



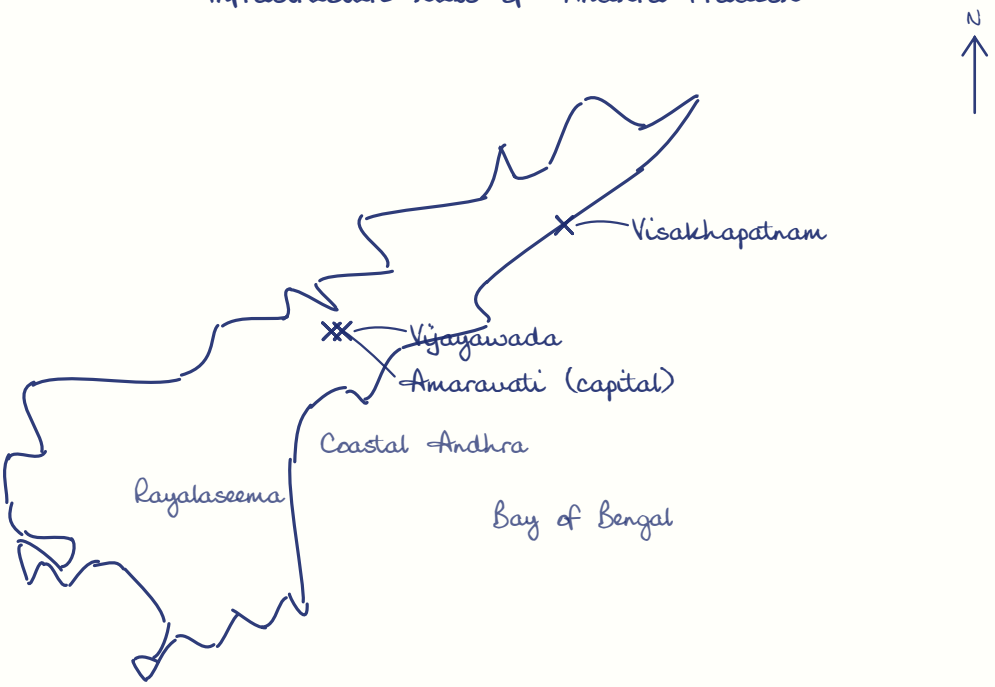
14(b) Critically explain the development of Transport, Energy and ICT infrastructure in Andhra Pradesh. How do these sectors contribute to the state's economic growth and connectivity?

10

Introduction

Infrastructure is a critical driver of growth in Andhra Pradesh, whose projected GSDP growth of 9.24% for 2024–25 significantly outpaces the national average. Transport, energy and ICT enhance connectivity and productivity, attract investment and improve quality of life.

Infrastructure hubs of Andhra Pradesh



Ports, corridor and IT hubs on the coast

Transport Infrastructure

1. Road networks: Integration with Bharatmala and PM GatiShakti has accelerated highways and expressways, cutting logistics costs.
2. Ports: The 974 km coastline and Visakhapatnam port support the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor and pharma and electronics clusters.
3. Multimodal links: Dry ports and inland waterways cut transit times and costs.
4. Rural linkages: Better roads in Krishna and Rayalaseema have diversified livelihoods into non-farm work.

Energy Infrastructure

1. Renewables: Solar and wind investments strengthen a sustainable energy mix.
2. Electric mobility: The Electric Mobility Policy (2018–23) promotes EVs in Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada and targets electrified public transport by 2029 with charging and battery swapping.
3. Power SPSEs: They contribute over 80% of SPSE turnover, ensuring reliable supply.

ICT Infrastructure

1. Digital services: e-Seva provides government

Practice 14(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV
2 / 3
Scan to practice

services online, improving governance efficiency.

2. Knowledge economy: Strong innovation scores and R&D attract IT firms to hubs like Amaravati.
3. Critical gap: Rural digital penetration and ICT quality remain weak.

Contribution to Growth and Connectivity

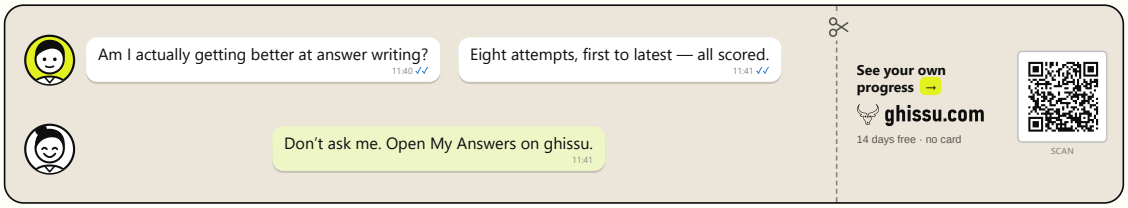
1. Lower costs: Roads and ports raise export competitiveness.
2. Investment: Reliable power and digital governance attract industry.

Way Forward

Coordinate the three sectors under PM GatiShakti through integrated planning.

Conclusion

Integrated transport, energy and ICT development can keep Andhra Pradesh's growth inclusive and connected.



15(a) Discuss the significance of the recommendations of the latest Finance Commission for the fiscal relations between the Union Government and the States in India, with specific reference to resource allocation and revenue sharing.

10

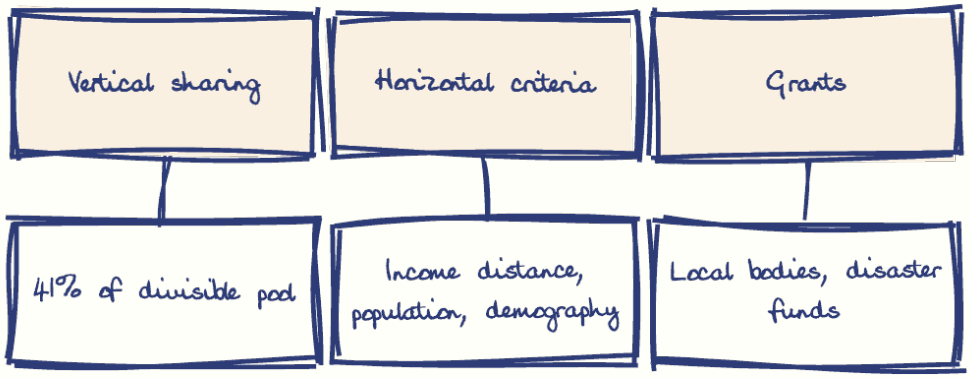
Introduction

The latest Finance Commission's recommendations shape fiscal relations between the Union and the States as India pursues post-pandemic recovery and balanced regional development. The 16th Finance Commission's report for 2026-31, building on the 15th Commission's framework, matters because states bear most social sector and infrastructure spending.

Key Recommendations

1. **41% Devolution Retained:** States' share in the divisible pool of central taxes stays at 41%, giving predictability to state budgets.
2. **Local Body Grants:** 7.91 lakh crore for rural and urban local bodies over five years, split 60:40 and with an 80:20 basic-performance ratio.
3. **Disaster Corpus:** 2.04 lakh crore for State Disaster Relief and Management Funds, relevant for disaster-prone Andhra Pradesh.
4. **Equity and Performance Criteria:** Income distance, 2011 population, area, forest cover and demographic performance guide horizontal distribution.

16th Finance Commission Transfers



Significance for Resource Allocation

1. **Fiscal Autonomy:** A stable (41%) share lets states plan with autonomy. Andhra Pradesh's own tax revenue, projected at 1,25,846 crore for 2026–27, complements these transfers.
2. **Local Governance:** Local grants address intra-state disparities, like drought-prone Rayalaseema and coastal aquaculture zones.
3. **Disaster Preparedness:** Assured funds reduce dependence on ad hoc central help during cyclones and floods.

Significance for Revenue Sharing

1. **Vertical and Horizontal Balance:** A large vertical share and equitable criteria uphold fiscal federalism.
2. **Performance Incentives:** Performance-based grants

push states to raise tax effort, fostering competitive federalism.

3. Continuity: Consistency with the 15th Commission reduces uncertainty in Centre–State relations.

4. Limitations: Excluding cesses and surcharges from the pool shrinks states' share, and uniform criteria miss post-bifurcation pressures.

Significance for Andhra Pradesh

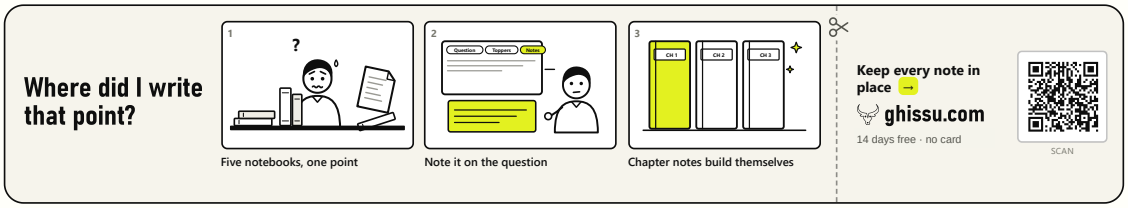
1. Region-Wise Allocation: The call for State Finance Commissions to allocate resources region-wise helps match funds to diverse needs within the state.

2. Competitive Federalism: Performance components push the state to address audit objections in its tax departments and spend more efficiently.

3. Post-Bifurcation Gaps: Uniform criteria may not fully reflect its special fiscal pressures.

Conclusion

The recommendations bring stability and strengthen cooperative federalism, but fairer pool sharing and attention to state-specific needs remain essential.



Write your own answer to 15(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2025 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

15(b) What are the flaws in the existing Public Private Partnership (PPP) model of infrastructure development? What are the key points to focus on while restructuring the PPP model?

10

Introduction

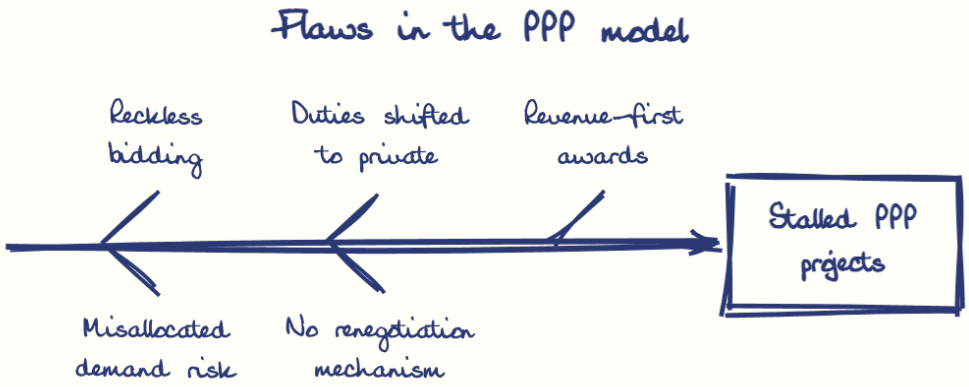
With India's infrastructure investment set to nearly double by FY26, driven by PM GatiShakti and the National Logistics Policy, PPPs are critical for bridging the financing and efficiency gap. Yet serious flaws hinder timely, cost-effective and quality delivery, so the model needs restructuring.

Flaws in the Existing PPP Model

1. **Reckless bidding:** Private partners quote unsustainable revenue shares to win contracts, a "buy now, pay later" approach seen in the Tata Uttra Mega Power Project in Gujarat, encouraged by expected bailouts.
2. **Misallocation of risks:** Traffic and demand risks in highways and ports are transferred to private firms that cannot control them.
3. **Shifting government duties:** Land acquisition and environmental clearances are delegated to private partners, causing delays and abandonment.
4. **No renegotiation mechanism:** Officials avoid renegotiating for fear of investigations, prolonging

delays and legal battles.

5. Fiscal gains over service: Ports and airports are awarded on highest revenue share, hurting operational standards.



Key Points for Restructuring

1. Balanced risk allocation: Allocate risk to the party best able to manage it, sharing demand risk through guarantees or viability gap funding.
2. Flexible contract design: Measurable performance indicators and timely renegotiation provisions.
3. Transparent bidding: Stricter norms, penalties for non-performance and no bailouts.
4. Institutional strength: Dedicated PPP cells at central and state levels, including Andhra Pradesh.
5. Service quality: Shift to value-for-money, user feedback and performance-based payments.

Way Forward

1. Risk instruments: Government-backed guarantees and VGF schemes tailored to state-specific projects, such as those in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Independent regulator: A PPP regulatory authority to oversee contract standards, monitor progress and resolve disputes.
3. Capacity building: Train officials and PPP cells in contract management, financial analysis and stakeholder coordination.
4. Sustainability: Align PPP projects with environmental and social safeguards.

Conclusion

The flaws of the PPP model lie in reckless bidding, misplaced risk, rigid contracts and a fiscal-first mindset. Restructuring it around fair risk, flexible contracts, strong institutions and service quality can deliver timely infrastructure and inclusive development.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2023

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) Discuss the impact of 'New Age' reforms on the Indian Economy in the last eight years. Examine the scope of growth potential for India in this decade (2023 – 30).

10

Introduction

Over the last eight years, India's New Age reforms have aimed at efficiency, formalisation and inclusive growth. Despite shocks like the pandemic and commodity price spikes, they laid a strong foundation. In 2023–30, the task is to turn this into faster, more inclusive expansion.

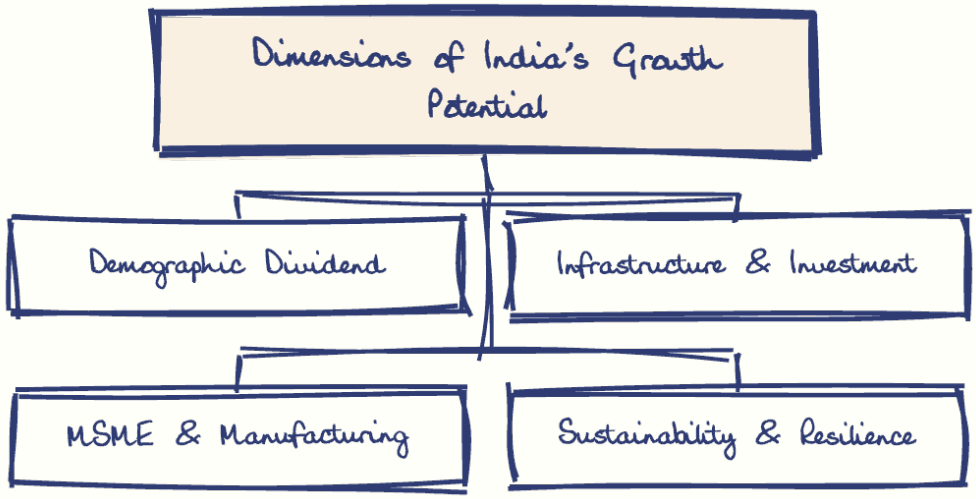
Impact of New Age Reforms

1. Formalisation: GST and the IBC streamlined taxation and improved credit discipline, raising compliance, GST collections and ease of business.
2. Digital Infrastructure: UPI, DBT and ONDC transformed payments and delivery, widening financial inclusion and helping Mudra and PM-KISAN reach beneficiaries.
3. Agriculture: PMFBY reduced farmer vulnerability, though integration into formal markets remains incomplete in regions like Rayalaseema in Andhra Pradesh.
4. Banking Health: Clean-up of stressed assets and recapitalisation revived double-digit credit growth.

Practice 1(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
Scan to practice

Growth Potential in 2023–30

1. **Demographic Dividend:** Over 50% of Indians are under 25; nearly 78.51 lakh non-farm jobs are needed every year.
2. **Infrastructure:** NIP and NMP aim to lift capital formation above 30% of GDP; Andhra Pradesh's port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai show the regional potential
3. **MSME and Manufacturing:** PLI schemes, RAMP and the Self-Reliant India Fund can lift manufacturing's stagnant share.
4. **Sustainability:** Energy transition and critical minerals open green growth opportunities.



Way Forward

1. **Skilling:** Scale up industry-aligned training through Skill India.
2. **Infrastructure:** Timely completion of NIP and NMP projects with active participation of states such as Andhra Pradesh.
3. **MSME Credit:** Expand credit guarantees and Udyam Assist to ease compliance and financing.
4. **Green Growth:** Incentivise clean technology and secure critical minerals.

Conclusion

The reforms have strengthened India's fundamentals. With skills, investment and green growth, the decade can deliver faster and more inclusive expansion, provided growth creates enough quality jobs for the young workforce.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

1(b) Is the exchange rate of the Indian Rupee fully determined by the market ? Explain the effects of Rupee Depreciation on the Indian Economy. Discuss the role of the RBI in defending the falling rupee.

10

Introduction

The Indian rupee has recently breached historic lows against the US dollar. Given the persistent current account deficit and global financial uncertainty, it is important to see whether its value is market-determined and how the RBI manages depreciation.

Is the Rupee Fully Market-Determined?

1. **Market-based regime:** Since 1999, the rupee's value is set mainly by demand and supply in the forex market, reflecting trade balances, capital flows and investor sentiment.
2. **Managed float:** It is not fully free. RBI intervenes occasionally to curb excessive volatility and keep markets orderly, without targeting a fixed rate or band. Hence it is a managed float.

Effects of Rupee Depreciation

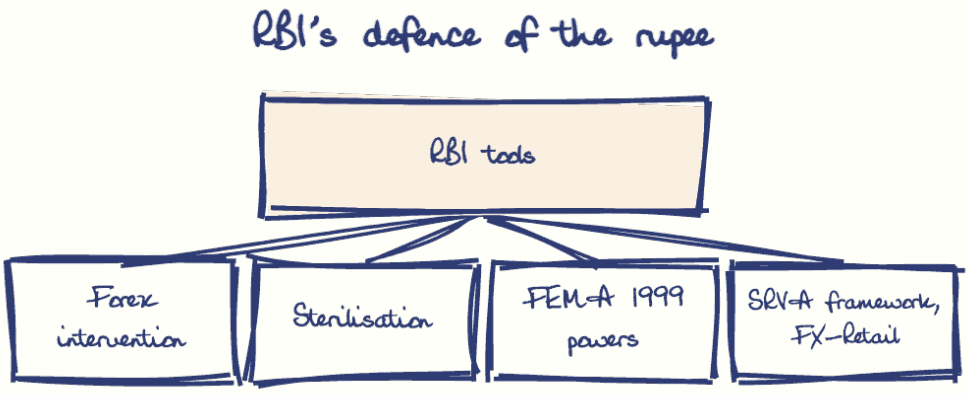
1. **Imported inflation:** Costlier crude oil, fertilisers and machinery raise input costs and create

cost-push inflation that hurts low-income households most.

2. Export competitiveness: Cheaper Indian goods can boost textiles, pharmaceuticals and Andhra Pradesh's aquaculture and horticulture.
3. Capital outflows: Sharp falls trigger portfolio outflows and stock market volatility, dampening investment.
4. Wider CAD: Higher import bills widen the deficit and pressure forex reserves.

RBI's Role in Defending the Rupee

1. Forex intervention: RBI uses its reserves to smooth volatility and maintain orderly conditions.
2. Sterilisation: It neutralises the effect of interventions on money supply to keep macro stability.
3. Regulatory framework: FEMA (1999) enables RBI to monitor and intervene in currency markets.
4. Market infrastructure: The SRVA framework, Forex Correspondent Scheme and FX-Retail deepen liquidity.

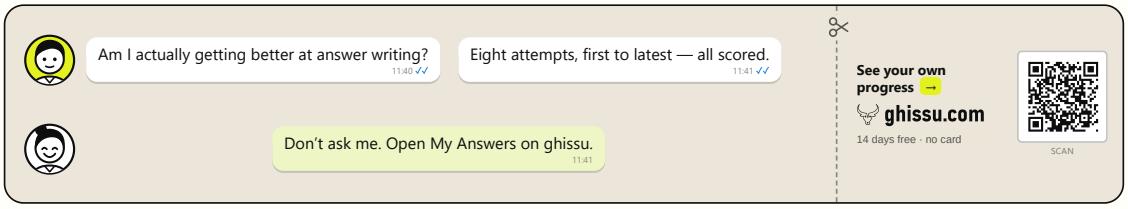


Limits to RBI's Defence

1. Volatile flows: FPI and NRI deposits reverse quickly with US Federal Reserve tightening.
2. Offshore speculation: NDF contracts in Singapore and Dubai lie beyond RBI's reach.
3. Inflation–growth trade-off: RBI must contain imported inflation while still supporting growth in fragile regions like Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

The rupee is market-determined but managed. Attracting stable FDI into sectors like Andhra Pradesh's port infrastructure and agro-processing, and deepening forex markets, will reduce reliance on reserve-based defence.



2(a) What is meant by Monetary Policy Transmission? Explain the issues experienced during the process of Monetary Policy and suggest steps to overcome these issues.

10

Introduction

Monetary policy transmission is the process by which changes in the RBI's policy repo rate pass through financial markets and banks to lending rates, credit, aggregate demand, inflation and output. Its effectiveness decides whether policy achieves price stability and growth, including in Andhra Pradesh.

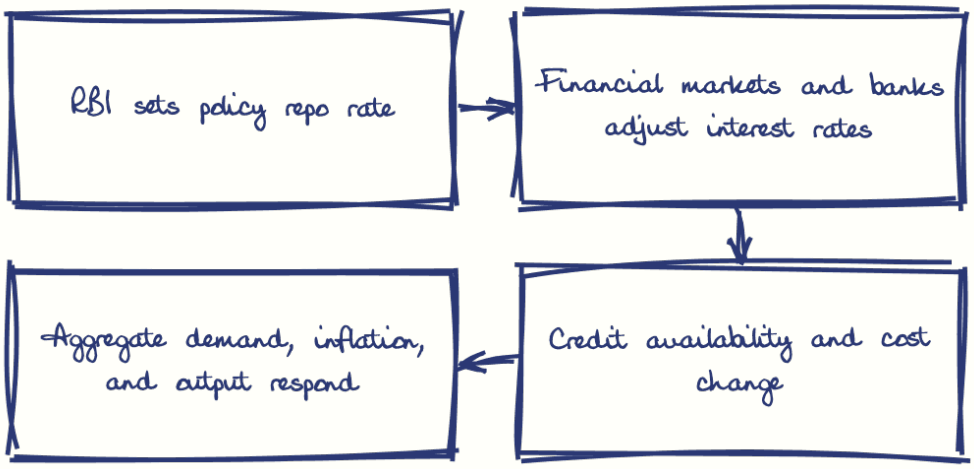
The Transmission Framework

1. RBI and MPC: The MPC sets the repo rate under the inflation targeting framework adopted in 2016.
2. Financial markets: Liberalisation since the 1990s developed markets, but mandated bank holdings of government securities and high fiscal deficits limit market-determined rates.
3. Payment systems: Platforms like UPI support liquidity and timely credit flow.

Issues in Transmission

1. Partial pass-through: Between 2015 and 2018, a 200 basis point policy cut lowered lending rates

Monetary Policy Transmission Framework



by only 154 basis points, with outstanding loans lagging fresh ones.

2. Weak banking structure: Public sector banks with legacy NPAs and loans priced at base rate or BPLR blunt the pass-through.
3. Segmented credit markets: NBFCs, SHGs and MFIs, about one-third of lending, do not align with policy changes, as in rural and semi-urban Andhra Pradesh.
4. Fiscal crowding out: High deficits at Centre and states keep rates elevated.
5. Time lags: Effects on output take 2–3 quarters and on inflation 3–4 quarters.

Steps to Overcome These Issues

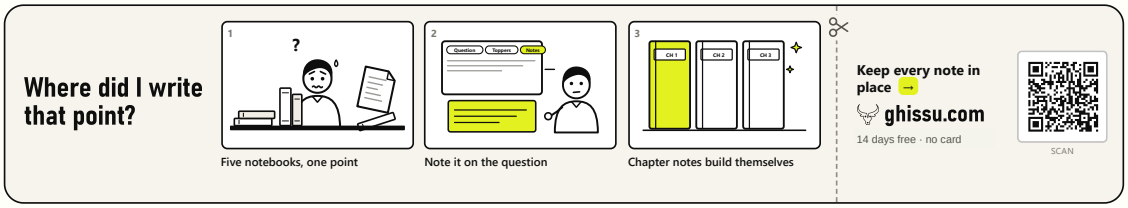
1. Banking reforms: Recapitalisation and resolution

of stressed assets, including in Andhra Pradesh's banking system.

2. Align NBFC and MFI rates: Encourage linking their rates to RBI policy.
3. Fiscal consolidation: Andhra Pradesh should cut its revenue deficit, lowering government borrowing and freeing credit for private investment.
4. Deeper markets: Improve government securities market liquidity.

Conclusion

Stronger transmission is vital for price stability and sustainable growth, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh where credit and investment shape development. Overcoming partial pass-through, segmented credit markets and fiscal crowding out through banking, market and fiscal reforms will make policy signals reach borrowers quickly.



2(b) What are the different fiscal policy tools used in India ? Can Customs and Excise Duties be used as flexible fiscal policy tools in order to increase revenue and control inflation ? Discuss.

10

Introduction

India's fiscal policy plays a crucial role in managing economic growth, inflation and government revenue. After the COVID-19 pandemic and fluctuating global commodity prices, the government's ability to use fiscal tools flexibly has gained prominence. Customs and Excise Duties, as major indirect taxes, have been leveraged to balance revenue needs and inflation control.

Fiscal Policy Tools in India

1. **Direct taxes:** Income Tax and Corporate Tax contribute over half of gross tax revenue. They are progressive and have shown buoyancy with better tax administration.

2. **Indirect taxes and GST:** GST, introduced in 2017, unified multiple indirect taxes and improved compliance. Customs and Excise remain important for petroleum, alcohol and imports.

3. **Customs and Excise Duties:** Customs duties

on imports and exports have protected domestic industry; excise is levied on goods made within the country.

4. Challenges: These taxes carry cascading effects, a regressive impact on the poor and administrative complexity.

Customs and Excise as Flexible Tools

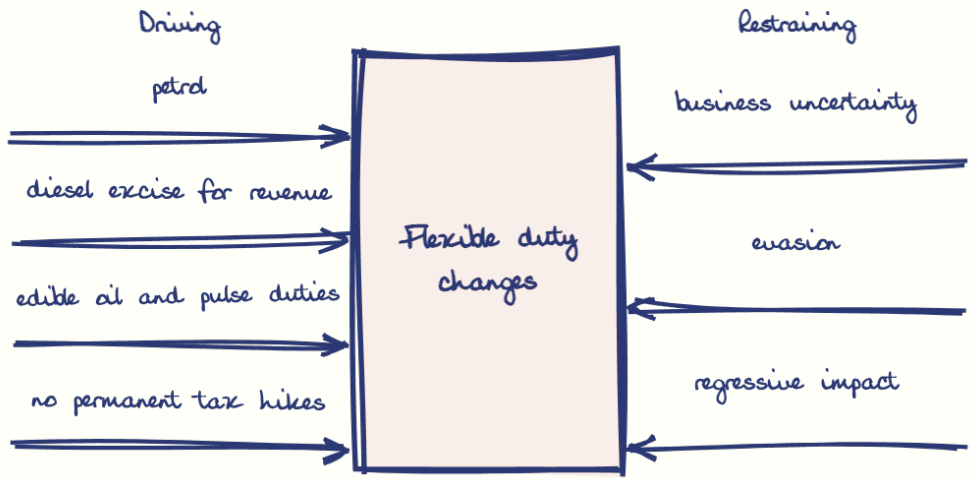
1. Revenue adjustment: During the pandemic the government raised excise on petrol and diesel when other collections fell, and later cut it to ease inflation.

2. Inflation control: Adjusting customs duty on edible oils, pulses and steel managed price pressures; lowering customs duty on edible oils in FY23 helped contain food inflation for low-income households in Andhra Pradesh and across India.

3. Balancing revenue and growth: Modulating duties meets revenue needs without permanent tax hikes that could stifle growth.

4. Concerns: Frequent changes create uncertainty for business and trade partners and encourage evasion and litigation, as Andhra Pradesh's commercial tax audits on underassessment show.

Customs and excise as flexible tools



Way Forward

1. Efficient administration: Stronger enforcement in states like Andhra Pradesh can reduce revenue leakages.
2. Simpler duty structures: Rationalised rates will cut cascading effects and litigation.
3. Broader reform: Link duty changes to a wider tax base and higher capital expenditure.

Conclusion

India uses a mix of direct and indirect taxes as fiscal tools. Customs and Excise Duties can work as flexible levers for revenue and inflation control, provided they are used predictably and with sound administration.

Wrote the answer. Now what?
Upload it — every line marked, in minutes.
ghissu.com

Write your own answer to 2(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
Scan to practice

3(a) What are externally aided projects ? Discuss the principles, funding and objectives of Andhra Pradesh Irrigation and Agriculture Transformation Project (APIIATP). Provide a brief note on the scope of beneficiaries with respect to the APIIATP.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's GSDP is projected to grow 9.24% in 2024-25, and stronger irrigation and farm productivity are critical to sustain it. Its agrarian economy, with diverse agro-climatic zones and water challenges, needs interventions like the Andhra Pradesh Irrigation and Agriculture Transformation Project (APIIATP).

Externally Aided Projects

1. **Meaning:** Projects funded wholly or partly by multilateral development banks or bilateral donors to supplement government resources.
2. **Purpose:** They target large infrastructure, capacity building and technology transfer beyond domestic funding.
3. **Examples and limits:** The AP Rural Roads Project is funded by AIIB, but EAPs face compliance burdens and land acquisition delays.

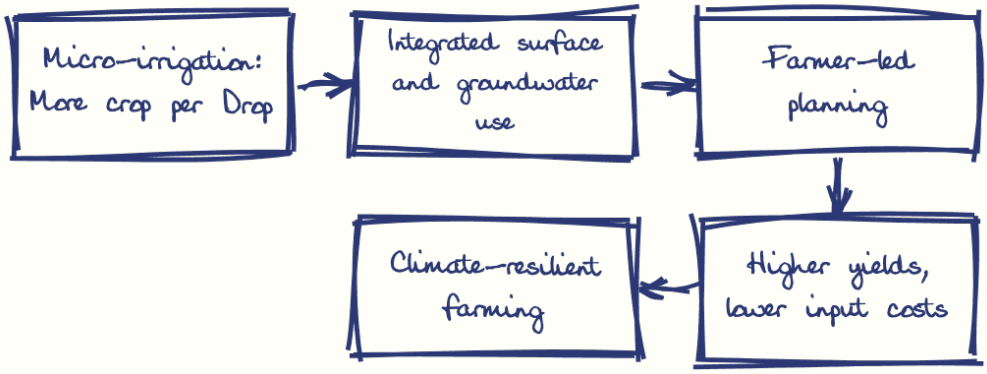
Principles of APIIATP

1. **Water use efficiency:** Micro-irrigation to achieve

"More crop per Drop" in drought-prone and rain-shadow regions. This conserves scarce water.

2. Farmer-centric approach: Farmers take part in planning and implementation. Irrigation gains thus become higher productivity and livelihoods.
3. Integrated water management: Surface and groundwater, command area development and on-farm management.
4. Institutions and technology: Capacity building and digital platforms for applications and subsidies.

How APII-ATP works



Funding of APII-ATP

1. Multisource financing: Central grants, state budget allocations, farmer contributions and external assistance.
2. Loans and grants: Concessional terms reduce the state's burden.

3. Performance-linked: Releases are tied to milestones like construction and enrolment. This encourages timely execution.

Objectives

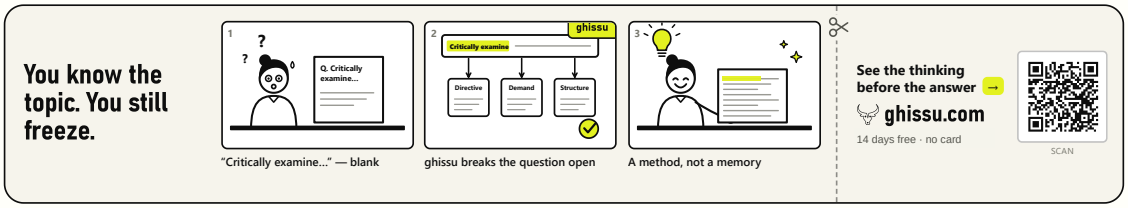
1. Irrigation potential: Create and efficiently use it to expand cropped area and enable multiple cropping.
2. Productivity: Raise yields and cut input costs.
3. Sustainability: Reduce groundwater depletion and promote climate-resilient farming.

Scope of Beneficiaries

1. Small and marginal farmers: Smallholders who depend heavily on irrigation for diversification and stable income.
2. Vulnerable regions: Socio-economically vulnerable farmers in drought-prone and rain-shadow districts, for equitable growth.

Conclusion

~~AP11-ATP~~ shows how external aid can drive efficient irrigation and inclusive farm growth.



3(b) Briefly discuss the impact of bifurcation on the economy of Andhra Pradesh with respect to sectoral changes and resource gap. Provide a brief note on the steps taken by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to mobilize resources.

10

Introduction

The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014, which created Telangana, was a major economic turning point. Losing Hyderabad, the main economic and administrative hub, opened a resource gap and forced a reorientation of the residual state's economy.

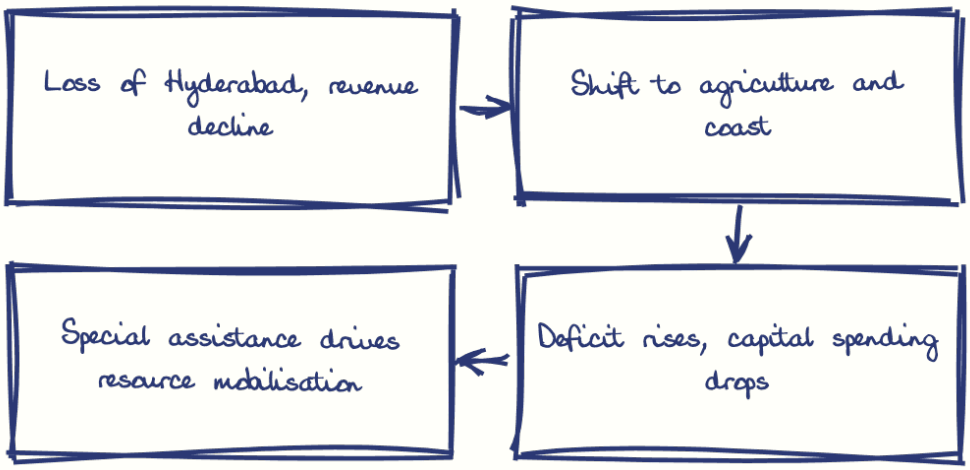
Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation



Impact on Sectors

1. Loss of capital and industry: Hyderabad held a large share of revenue and industry. The delayed new capital, Amaravati, hurt administrative efficiency and investor confidence.
2. Shift to agriculture: With Hyderabad's IT and services gone, aquaculture, horticulture and chilli in Rayalaseema and Coastal Andhra became growth drivers.
3. Coastal economy: A 974 km coastline supports fisheries and export industries, partly offsetting industrial contraction.

Impact of bifurcation on Andhra Pradesh



Resource Gap

1. Revenue deficit: The revenue deficit quadrupled to 3.30% of GSDP.

2. Capital squeeze: Capital expenditure fell to 0.55% of GSDP and was just 3.45% of total expenditure in 2022-23.

Steps to Mobilise Resources

1. External funding: Rs 15,000 crore was arranged through multilateral agencies, with World Bank and ADB loans.

2. Industrial corridors: Infrastructure in nodes like Kopparthy and Orvakal on the Visakhapatnam-Chennai Industrial Corridor attracts private investment.

3. Tax and fiscal discipline: Own tax revenue is estimated at Rs 1,09,789 crore in 2024-25, up 28%, while the state tries to trim committed spending, which takes over 64% of revenue receipts.

4. Central grants: Assistance under the Reorganisation Act supports the Polavaram Irrigation Project.

Conclusion

Bifurcation shifted Andhra Pradesh towards agriculture and left a deep resource gap. Better tax effort, external finance and higher capital spending are key to growth.

Write your own answer to 3(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

4(a) What is meant by the 'Goods and Services Tax' (GST) ? Explain the steps taken by the Indian Government to facilitate trade and 'ease of doing business' under the GST regime.

10

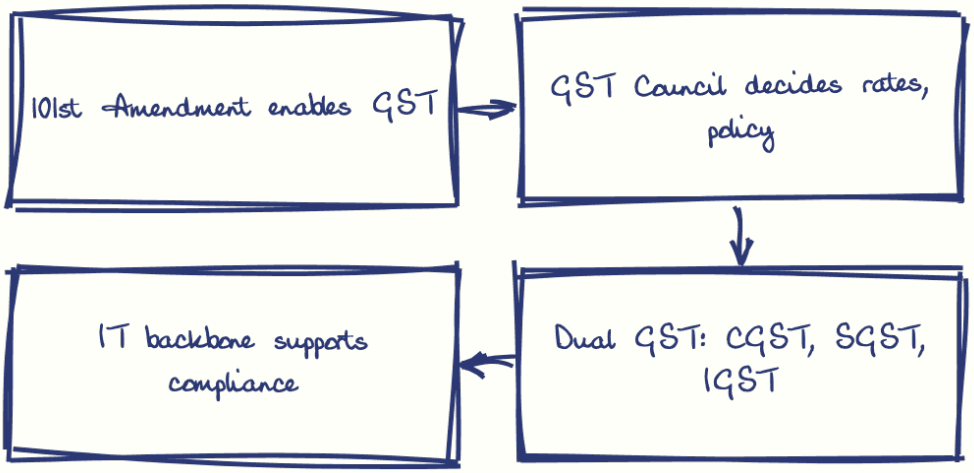
Introduction

The Goods and Services Tax (GST), introduced on (1) July (2017), is a landmark reform that unified multiple central and state taxes into a single, destination-based consumption tax. It created a unified national market, reduced tax cascading and increased transparency, supporting growth and export competitiveness.

Meaning and Institutional Framework

1. GST Council: Chaired by the Union Finance Minister with state finance ministers, it decides rates, exemptions and rules, with states holding two-thirds of votes, a model of cooperative federalism.
2. Dual GST: CGST and SGST apply on intra-state supplies and IGST on inter-state transactions, keeping input tax credit seamless.
3. Compensation: States were guaranteed (14%) annual revenue growth for five years.

GST Institutional Mechanism



Steps to Facilitate Trade and Ease of Business

1. **Simpler Compliance:** The **Composition Scheme** for small taxpayers, quarterly returns under QRMP and simplified registration reduce the burden on MSMEs.
2. **Faster Refunds:** Risk-based provisional refunds give exporters (90%) of claims within seven days, easing liquidity.
3. **Rate Rationalisation:** Many rates were cut, with higher rates only on luxury and sin goods.
4. **Market Integration:** Abolishing check posts and octroi and introducing the **E-Way Bill** cut logistics costs and transit times.
5. **Digital Platform:** The **GST Network** offers one interface for registration, returns and payment, while e-invoicing and automated credit

matching curb evasion.

6. Taxpayer Support: Outreach programmes and the GST Grievance Redressal Committee resolve disputes, while linking GST with bank details curbs fraudulent claims.

Way Forward

1. Smarter IT: AI-driven analytics for real-time fraud detection.
2. Wider Composition Scheme: Include more small businesses, especially in Andhra Pradesh, to formalise the informal sector.

Conclusion

GST has made taxation simpler and the national market more unified. AI-driven IT upgrades, a wider Composition Scheme and stronger state capacity in Andhra Pradesh can further ease doing business.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

4(b) Mention the recommendations of the 15th Finance Commission with respect to Fiscal Consolidation. Discuss the progress and present situation of 'Fiscal Consolidation' in India.

10

Introduction

Fiscal consolidation remains a priority as India balances growth with macroeconomic stability. The 15th Finance Commission (2021–26) gave key recommendations to strengthen fiscal discipline amid deficits and debt worsened by the COVID-19 pandemic. With states central to public spending, progress depends on both Union and state finances.

Recommendations on Fiscal Consolidation

1. **Deficit and Debt Targets:** Adhere to FRBM targets of the Centre and states with a credible medium-term debt consolidation roadmap.
2. **Tax Devolution:** Keep a (41%) share of central taxes for states, adding demographic performance as a criterion and using (2011) census data.
3. **Grants-in-Aid:** Over 10 lakh crore for 2021–26, including revenue deficit grants to (17) states and funds for local bodies.
4. **Off-Budget Borrowings:** Full disclosure and phased elimination to reveal the true deficit.
5. **Public Financial Management:** An expert group to

draft a statutory framework for budgeting, accounting and audit standards.

Recommendation vs Reality

15th FC Recommendation	Present Situation
Medium-term debt roadmap	Deficit 9.5% of GDP 2020-21
Disclose off-budget borrowings	Still obscure true deficits
Better revenue mobilisation	AP audit lapses persist

Progress and Present Situation

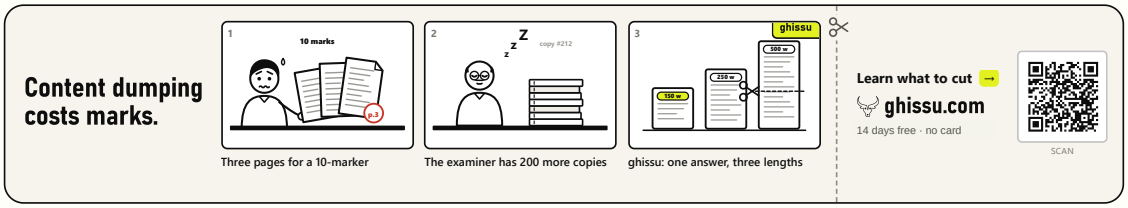
1. Pandemic Shock: The combined fiscal deficit rose to about 9.5% of GDP in 2020-21, with government debt nearing 90% of GDP.
2. State Lapses: CAG audits in Andhra Pradesh found 968 crore excess payments, 1,806 crore revenue impact from irregularities and 2,772 crore outstanding observations.
3. GST Volatility: Revenue shortfalls and dependence on compensation from the Centre complicate state consolidation.
4. Disclosure Gaps: Off-budget borrowings still obscure true deficits, so the real fiscal position is weaker than budgets show.

Way Forward

1. FRBM Compliance: Rigorous targets with flexibility for shocks, monitored by a high-powered inter-governmental group.
2. Transparent Borrowing: Enforce full disclosure and phased elimination of off-budget borrowings to build investor confidence.
3. Broader Tax Base: Better tax administration to raise revenue without raising rates.
4. Empower Local Bodies: Stronger transfers and capacity to ease pressure on states.

Conclusion

The 15th Finance Commission offers a framework balancing discipline with equitable sharing. Sustained consolidation will support stability and Viksit Bharat 2047. Full disclosure of off-budget borrowings, a statutory public financial management framework and stronger state revenues will decide whether consolidation moves from targets to lasting outcomes.



5(a) Explain the importance of budgetary policy in reallocation of resources. Briefly discuss the allocation of budgetary resources in the social services sector with respect to the AP Budget (2023 – 24).

10

Introduction

Budgetary policy shapes the economic and social landscape by directing financial resources to priority areas. For Andhra Pradesh, it is essential for reallocating resources towards inclusive growth. The AP Budget 2023-24, framed amid fiscal constraints, shows the balancing act between fiscal prudence and social sector commitments.

Importance of Budgetary Policy in Reallocation

1. Economic Prioritisation: It shifts resources from less productive to more productive sectors, as funds for infrastructure or social services raise employment and human capital.
2. Reducing Inequities: Targeted allocations reach lagging regions and vulnerable groups, vital given the gap between coastal Andhra and drought-prone Rayalaseema.
3. Fiscal Discipline: Expenditure ceilings and priorities keep finances sustainable, yet the quadrupled revenue deficit in 2022-23 shows weak reallocation.

4. Responsiveness: The shift to direct benefit transfers shows how budgets adapt to new needs.

Social Services in the AP Budget 2023-24

1. Development Priority: Health, education and social protection are central to human development.
2. Health Allocation: Health received only 3.11% of the budget against an 8% target.
3. Outcome Gaps: The CAG found 22% vacancies in specialist posts and too few community health centres.
4. Welfare and Infrastructure: Key social schemes and rural infrastructure were maintained to address regional disparities.
5. Fiscal Pressure: A high revenue deficit and outstanding liabilities limited expansion.
6. Fund Diversion: CAG audits reported diversion of welfare funds, reducing impact.

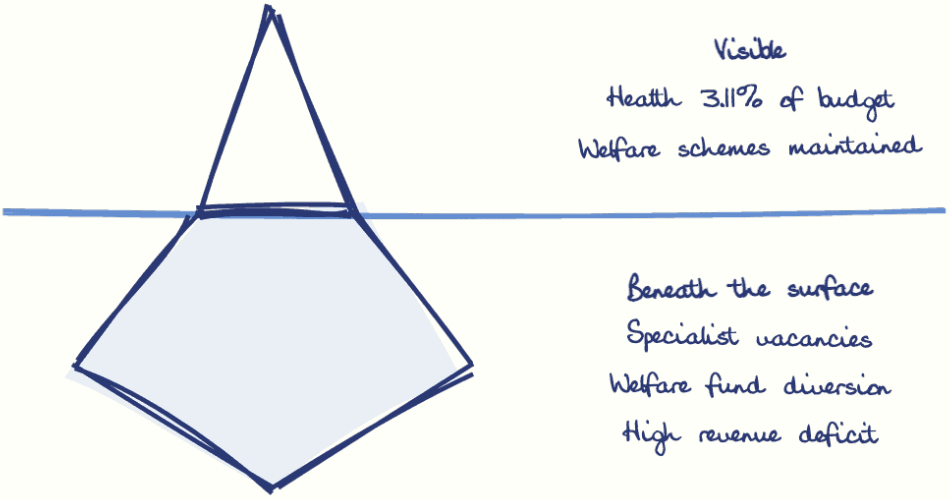
Way Forward

1. Raise Social Spending: Move health and education towards IPHS norms and fill staff gaps.
2. Financial Controls: Robust controls to stop

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Social Services in AP Budget 2023-24



diversion of welfare funds and keep administrative spending in check.

3. Outcome Budgeting: Align medium-term frameworks with development goals and link allocations to measurable results.

Conclusion

Budgetary policy is a powerful reallocation tool, but AP's social sector needs both higher allocations and better delivery. The tension between fiscal prudence and social spending can be eased only by spending better, not just spending more.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

5(b) What is meant by 'Gender Budgeting' and 'Child Budgeting' ? Does Andhra Pradesh follow gender budgeting and child budgeting ? Evaluate.

10

Introduction

Gender Budgeting and Child Budgeting are fiscal tools that promote inclusive development by addressing the specific needs of women and children through government budgets. Given Andhra Pradesh's growth ambitions and welfare commitments, assessing their adoption is essential for equitable resource allocation.

Meaning of Gender Budgeting

1. Definition: It integrates a gender perspective into the entire budget process so that allocations address the different needs of women and men.
2. Mechanisms: Gender-sensitive formulation, allocation, monitoring and impact assessment are supported by Gender Budget Cells and Gender Budget Statements.
3. Scope: It shapes revenue and tax policy too; India introduced it in the Union Budget of 2005-06.

Meaning of Child Budgeting

1. Concept: It analyses spending on child education, health, nutrition and protection, enabling targeted interventions.

2. Age-Specific Allocation: It tracks support by child age group so resources match developmental needs and SDG commitments.

Gender vs Child Budgeting

Gender Budgeting	Child Budgeting
Gender perspective in budget	Child health, education, nutrition
Gender Budget Cells	Allocation by age group
AP: Thalliki Vandanam	AP among eight states

Andhra Pradesh: Evaluation

1. Gender Budgeting Followed: Schemes like Thalliki Vandanam and Stree Shakti institutionalise it, and budget allocations for women and girls have increased significantly.
2. Child Budgeting Followed: Andhra Pradesh is among eight states preparing child budgets, backed by Saksham Anganwadi, POSHAN (2.0), Samagra Shiksha and Bala Sanjeevani.
3. Execution Gaps: Audits show diversion of welfare funds, administrative inefficiency and underutilised women-centric budgets.
4. Outcome Gaps: The CAG reports health

infrastructure deficits and staff shortages.

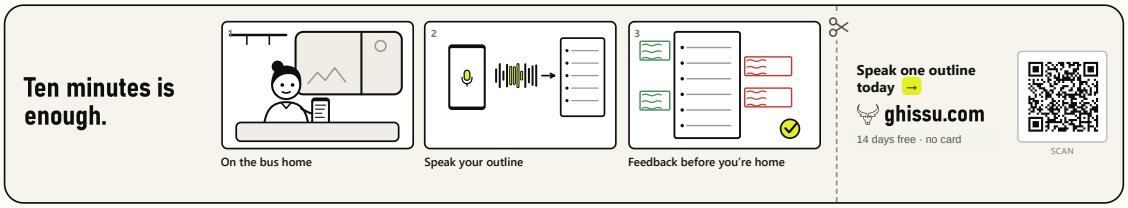
5. Fiscal Constraints: Deficits limit expansive social spending, so prioritisation is needed.

Way Forward

1. Stronger Cells: Gender and child budget cells with capacity for real-time tracking and impact evaluation, so funds reach intended beneficiaries.
2. Fill Vacancies: Upgrade health and education facilities to complement budget allocations.
3. Transparency: Stricter audits and public disclosure to prevent diversion of funds.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh follows both gender and child budgeting with rising allocations, but better monitoring and implementation are needed to turn commitments into outcomes.



6(a) Describe the scope of 'Differentiated Banking Policy' with respect to financial inclusion in India. Analyse the potential of Digital Banking in improving financial inclusion in India.

10

Introduction

India's financial inclusion journey has accelerated through policy innovation and digital transformation, with RBI's Financial Inclusion Index rising to 67.0 in March 2025. Differentiated banking and digital banking are now the keys to deeper inclusion, especially in large, diverse states like Andhra Pradesh with regional disparities.

Scope of Differentiated Banking Policy

1. Targeted banking models: Banks are segmented into small finance banks, payments banks and regional rural banks, each serving specific low-income, rural or marginalised groups; small finance banks focus on microfinance and MSMEs.

2. Differentiated PSL targets: Category-wise priority sector targets ensure credit for agriculture, micro-enterprises and weaker sections, as in the Rayalaseema drought bett.

3. Business Correspondent model: BCs provide doorstep banking, extending services to tribal and

rural people in AP.

4. Regulatory flexibility: Simplified KYC, lower capital needs and technology enabled rapid scaling of no-frills accounts under PMJDY.

Potential of Digital Banking

1. Low-cost access: UPI, with over 5 billion transactions by March 2022, has transformed payments even in rural AP.
2. Scheme integration: Digital rails support Direct Benefit Transfers, PMSBY and APY, cutting leakages.
3. Digital lending: Alternative data and AI extend credit to those with weak credit histories, such as farmers and small entrepreneurs.
4. Digital divide: Linguistic barriers, digital illiteracy and uneven internet penetration still hold back rural and tribal pockets of AP, so the divide must be bridged for equitable inclusion.

Two Routes to Inclusion

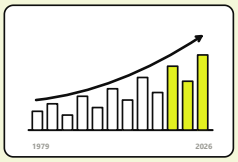


Way Forward

1. Digital literacy: Targeted digital literacy campaigns in rural and tribal areas of AP to drive adoption.
2. Infrastructure: Offline and low-cost payment systems so remote regions get seamless access.
3. Customised products: Region-specific products for AP's linguistic and socio-economic diversity.
4. Regulatory support: Keep refining differentiated banking rules to encourage innovation while protecting vulnerable consumers.

Conclusion

Together, differentiated banking and digital banking form a robust framework for inclusion. Implemented well, they can ensure no citizen is left behind, in line with Viksit Bharat @2047.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 6(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

Scan to practice

6(b) Explain the challenges faced by women entrepreneurs in India. Discuss the schemes and initiatives taken by the Indian Government with respect to facilitating women entrepreneurship in India.

10

Introduction

Women entrepreneurs are vital to India's growth, jobs and innovation. Yet women-owned enterprises form only about 14% of all businesses, reflecting persistent gender gaps. Schemes like the Women Entrepreneurship Platform and Mudra show the urgency of empowering them as female workforce participation rises.

Challenges Faced by Women Entrepreneurs

1. Socio-cultural barriers: Gender roles assign women most unpaid domestic work, limiting time and energy for business, especially in patriarchal rural areas.

2. Access to finance: Lack of collateral and gender bias in financial institutions make loans hard to secure.

3. Information and skill gaps: Limited networks and formal training create information asymmetry and low confidence, keeping women in sectors like textiles and food.

4. Market linkages and role models: Few visible

successful women reduce motivation and networking; remote districts in Andhra Pradesh still lag in scheme awareness.

Government Schemes and Initiatives

1. **Women Entrepreneurship Platform:** NITI Aayog's WEP offers training, mentorship, finance and market links, with over 26,500 beneficiaries since 2018.
2. **PM Mudra Yojana:** Loans worth INR 2.22 lakh crore went to 4.24 crore women entrepreneurs in FY 2023–24.
3. **Stand-Up India:** Mandates at least one woman borrower per bank branch; 81% of beneficiaries are women.
4. **Mahila e-Haat:** Enables online marketing of women's products.
5. **SHGs in Andhra Pradesh:** Mobilise rural women into collective enterprise with better financial literacy and market access.

Way Forward

1. **Affordable training:** Low-cost skill programmes through digital platforms and local institutions.
2. **Simpler credit:** Less paperwork and more collateral-free products.

Barriers and Schemes

Barrier	Scheme
Lack of collateral	Mudra, Stand-Up India
Skill, information gaps	WEP training, mentorship
Weak market links	Mahila e-Haat
Rural isolation	SHGs in Andhra Pradesh

3. Mentorship and awareness: Spread scheme awareness through community networks and mentoring by successful women.
4. Work-life balance: Develop childcare facilities and flexible work environments for women with domestic duties.

Conclusion

Addressing these challenges through strong institutions and targeted schemes can unlock women's entrepreneurial potential. Strengthening WEP and grassroots SHGs will advance inclusive growth under SDG 8.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

7(a) Discuss the types and sources of agricultural credit in India. Explain the initiatives taken by the Indian Government in order to improve access to agricultural credit.

10

Introduction

Agricultural credit is vital for productivity and resilience in India, where agriculture employs over (45%) of workers but contributes less than (18%) of GDP. Small and marginal farmers dominate, so timely, affordable credit decides their ability to invest in inputs and technology, while weather risks and informal lending persist.

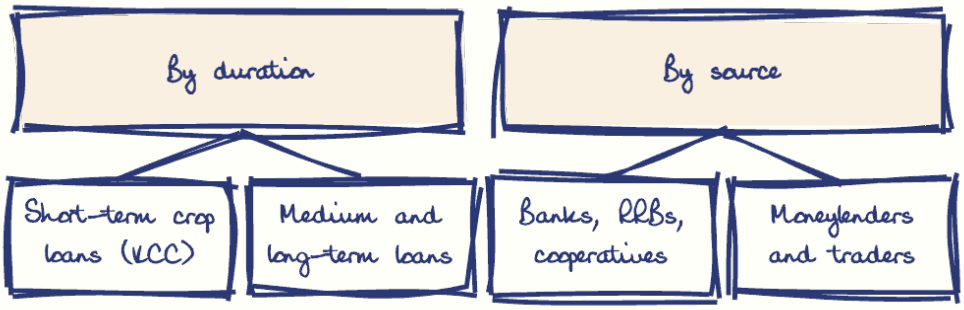
Types of Agricultural Credit

1. Short-term crop loans: Finance seeds, fertilisers and labour for a crop cycle, Kisan Credit Card limits are now Rs (5 lakh).
2. Medium and long-term loans: Fund machinery, irrigation and land development, as under NABARD's RIDF.
3. Group-based credit: Joint Liability Groups, growing at over (40%) CAGR, reach tenant and marginal farmers.
4. Allied credit: KCC now covers fisheries, animal husbandry and horticulture.

Sources of Credit

1. **Institutional:** Commercial banks, RRBs and cooperatives lent over Rs 22.8 lakh crore in 2023–24, aided by NABARD refinance.
2. **Non-institutional:** Moneylenders and traders still serve about 23%, at high rates.
3. **Cooperatives:** Cooperative credit societies remain crucial in rural areas, though efficiency varies and AP's cooperative reforms are ongoing.
4. **New channels:** Business correspondents, SHGs and Jan Dhan accounts reach remote areas.

Agricultural Credit: Types and Sources



Government Initiatives

1. **KCC:** Over 7.75 crore accounts with Rs 9.8 lakh crore outstanding in 2024.
2. **Priority Sector Lending:** RBI requires banks to direct a significant share of lending to agriculture.

3. Interest subvention: Subsidised crop loans cut dependence on moneylenders.

4. Agriculture Infrastructure Fund: A Rs 1 lakh crore fund for storage and processing, with strong uptake in AP.

Way Forward

1. Tenant farmers: Recognise tenants through laws like Andhra Pradesh's crop cultivator rights framework and extend KCC and JLG loans to them.

2. Cooperatives and RRBs: Computerise primary agricultural credit societies and improve their governance.

Conclusion

Formal credit is steadily replacing moneylenders; extending it to tenants and smallholders is key to farmer welfare.

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

ghissu

On ghissu every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into chapter notes by themselves.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

7(b) What is meant by sustainable agriculture? Discuss the sustainable agriculture practices and systems in India. Provide suggestions to improve agricultural incomes from sustainable agriculture.

10

Introduction

Sustainable agriculture is farming that maintains productivity while conserving natural resources, protecting ecological balance and supporting farmers' livelihoods. With agriculture employing over half of India's population and contributing about 16% of GDP, climate change makes eco-friendly systems essential.

Sustainable Practices and Systems in India

1. **NMSA:** Launched in 2014–15, it promotes climate-resilient rainfed farming with water efficiency, soil health and integrated farming systems, including in Andhra Pradesh's rainfed zones.
2. **RKVY:** Funds modern practices and skills, creating over 2 million jobs, including in AP's horticulture and aquaculture.
3. **Soil Health Cards:** Encourage balanced fertiliser use in intensive cropping areas.
4. **Agriculture Infrastructure Fund:** Credit for post-harvest infrastructure and sustainable supply chains improves market access and reduces

wastage.

5. Agroecological practices: Crop rotation, IPM and agroforestry conserve soil and cut chemical use, while natural farming avoids synthetic inputs altogether.

Challenges

1. Low adoption: Organic farming covers only (2%) of net sown area, and natural farming is practised by fewer than one million farmers.
2. Credit gaps: Small and marginal farmers in Andhra Pradesh struggle to fund drip irrigation, rainwater harvesting or agroforestry.
3. Climate risk: Droughts in Rayalaseema and floods in coastal districts undermine resilience.
4. Budget gaps: NMSA gets less than (1%) of the agriculture ministry's budget, weakening extension.

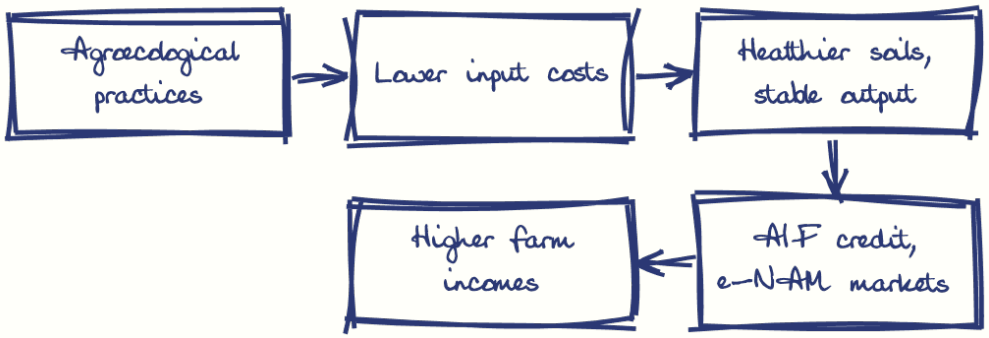
Suggestions to Improve Incomes

1. Agroecology: Crop rotation, IPM and agroforestry improve soil and yields while cutting input costs.
2. Capacity building: Scale up RKVY and NMSA training on techniques and market links.
3. Finance and markets: Agriculture Infrastructure Fund credit and e-NAM raise profitability.

4. Climate resilience: Region-specific water budgeting and efficient irrigation under PMKSY in drought-prone areas reduce vulnerability and stabilise incomes.

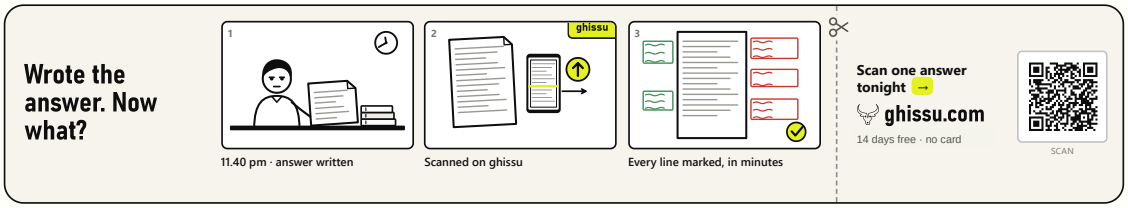
5. Budget priority: A larger NMSA share would fund extension and technology spread.

From Sustainable Practice to Income



Conclusion

Sustainable agriculture is vital for food security, environmental conservation and better livelihoods. Focusing on income-raising practices can help double farmers' income, in line with SDG (8) and a Viksit Bharat @2047.



8(a) Explain the scope and benefits of farm mechanization. Discuss the implementation of farm mechanization schemes in Andhra Pradesh with special reference to Community Hiring Centres (CHCs).

10

Introduction

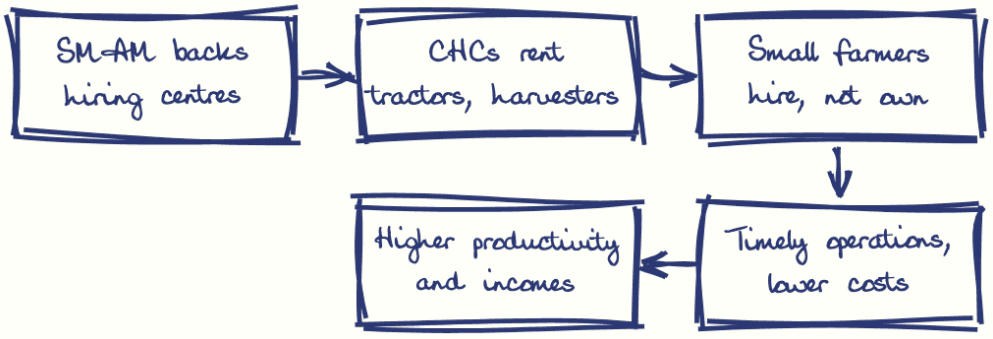
Agriculture employs over 45% of India's workforce but contributes less than 18% of GDP. With rising labour shortages and the need for timely operations, farm mechanization can raise cropping intensity, cut costs and lift profits. In Andhra Pradesh, with small holdings and diverse agro-climatic zones, Community Hiring Centres (CHCs) bring machinery within reach of small farmers.

Scope and Benefits of Mechanization

1. Higher productivity: Mechanization raises cropping intensity by 15–20% and productivity by 10–15%.
2. Timeliness: Time savings of 20–30% enable timely sowing and harvesting across crops, horticulture and aquaculture.
3. Lower costs: Mechanization eases rising labour shortages and reduces cultivation costs, raising profitability.
4. Inclusion and jobs: CHCs create jobs for rural youth, and the Natural Farming Model in Rayalaseema shows mechanization with skilling

empowering women farmers.

How CHCs mechanise small farms



Implementation in Andhra Pradesh

1. **SM-AM:** The state aligns with the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization, which promotes hiring centres so small farmers avoid costly ownership.
2. **CHCs and machinery banks:** Tractors, seed drills and harvesters are rented out, so resource-poor farmers mechanize without heavy capital.
3. **ATMA training:** ATMA trained over 1.27 crore farmers between 2021 and 2025, building awareness of mechanized practices.
4. **Skilling:** STRY and PMKVY train rural youth to operate and maintain machines.
5. **Scheme linkages:** Mechanization works alongside MGNREGS and e-NAM for market access.

Challenges

1. Fragmented holdings: Small, scattered plots limit scale economies and complicate machine deployment.
2. Repair gaps: Few repair services in remote areas raise downtime and costs, hurting CHC sustainability.
3. ~~Affordability~~: Without hiring centres, the high cost of owning machines would keep mechanization limited to large farmers.

Way Forward

1. Expand CHCs: Widen the network across all agro-climatic zones.
2. Repair hubs: Build local repair and maintenance hubs to cut downtime in remote areas.
3. Training: Scale up ~~ATMA~~ and STRY programmes to build technical skills among farmers and youth.

Conclusion

Mechanization through CHCs makes modern machinery affordable for smallholders in ~~Andhra~~ Pradesh, raising productivity and rural incomes.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

ghissu

ghissu exam-hall thinking decodes every directive — Discuss, Examine, Elucidate — before you write a line.

Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 8(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

Scan to practice

8(b) Explain the extent of marine fishery resources in Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the steps taken by the Andhra Pradesh Government in order to promote the welfare and development of fishermen in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Marine fisheries are a vital part of Andhra Pradesh's economy, given its extensive 974 km coastline along the Bay of Bengal. The state is the largest fish producer in India, contributing significantly to national production and exports. Rising seafood demand makes fishermen's welfare critical for economic and nutritional security.

Extent of Marine Fishery Resources

1. **Long coastline:** The 974 km coast supports small, medium and deep-sea fishing, making the state a leader in fish output.
2. **Fishing harbours:** Specialised harbours at major and minor ports serve vessels of all sizes, while the 2004 Marine Fishing Policy protects traditional fishing zones.
3. **Large fisher population:** Over 5.97 lakh fisher families depend on the sector.

Steps for Fishermen's Welfare and Development

1. **Welfare schemes:** The state provides replacement

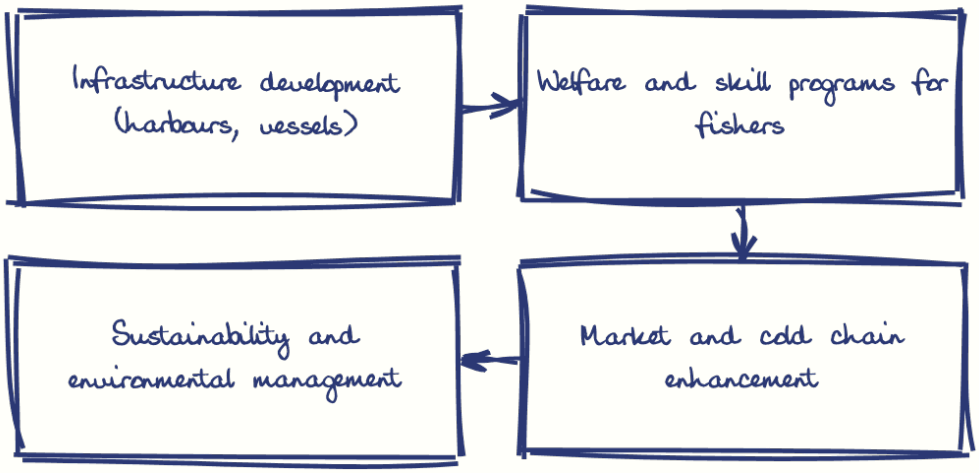
Practice 8(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

boats, nets and livelihood support, with health and skill programmes under PMMSY.

2. Centre–state coordination: Though fisheries are on the State List, the state works with PMMSY, which has sanctioned infrastructure and welfare projects for coastal fishers.
3. Market and cold chain: Cold storage and transport have improved, with over 26,000 fish transport units sanctioned.
4. Service delivery: The e-Seva portal makes fisheries schemes more accessible and transparent.
5. Regulation: Exclusive zones for traditional and mechanised fishing are being demarcated to curb overfishing.

Fisheries Development in Andhra Pradesh



Remaining Gaps

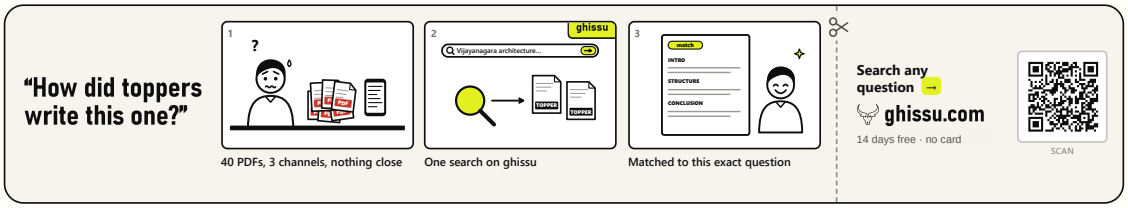
1. Low value addition: Many fishers still sell in traditional markets.
2. Women excluded: Women fish vendors are largely outside welfare schemes.
3. Climate risk: Rising sea temperatures and pollution threaten marine ecosystems.

Way Forward

1. Sustainable fishing: Enforce spatial regulations and eco-friendly gear.
2. Value addition: Invest in processing and branding so fishers earn more.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's rich marine resources and welfare measures give a strong base. Sustainability, value addition and women's inclusion will secure fishermen's long-term welfare.



9(a) What is meant by 'Strategic Disinvestment' ? Explain the different methods of Disinvestment adopted since the re-christening of Department of Disinvestment (DOD) as Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM). Briefly discuss the achievements and outcomes of these disinvestments.

10

Introduction

With gross fixed capital formation yet to regain its pre-2007-08 peak, optimising public sector assets is crucial for growth and fiscal health. Disinvestment has been a key reform since the early 1990s, and renaming the Department of Disinvestment as DIPAM in 2016 marked a shift towards comprehensive asset management.

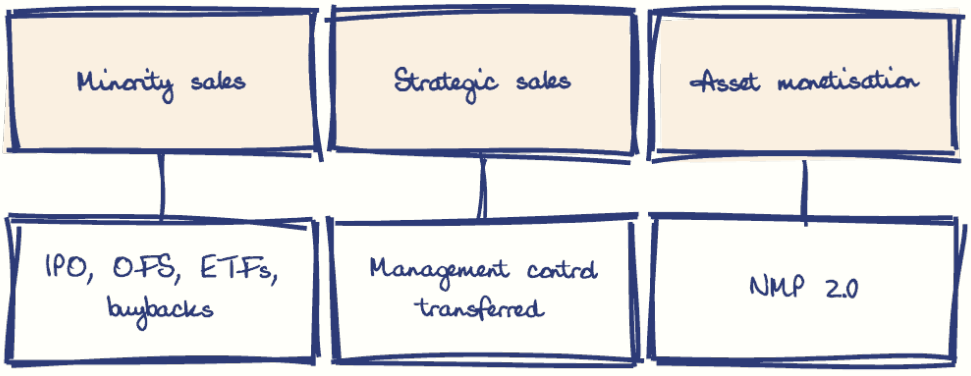
Meaning of Strategic Disinvestment

1. **Definition:** The sale of a substantial share of government equity, often over 50%, with transfer of management control to a private entity.
2. **Contrast with token sales:** Earlier minority sales of 5-10% raised funds but did not improve PSU efficiency or governance; strategic sale brings private efficiency.
3. **DIPAM's mandate:** Since 2016 it manages both CPSE equity sales and wider public assets to optimise returns.

Methods Adopted Since DIP-AM

1. IPOs and Offer for Sale: Minority stakes are divested while retaining contrd, as in the LIC IPO, which mobilised significant capital.
2. Buybacks and ETFs: PSU share buybacks and the CPSE-ETF and Bharat-22 ETF manage holdings and raise funds efficiently.
3. Strategic sales: Contrd is transferred to private or consortium buyers, as with Dredging Corporation of India's acquisition by a ports consortium.
4. Asset monetisation: NMP 2.0 targets Rs 16.72 lakh crore during FY26-FY30, complementing equity sales and financing infrastructure.

Disinvestment methods since DIP-AM



Achievements and Outcomes

1. Resources: Significant capital has been mobilised

for fiscal consdidation and infrastructure.

2. Efficiency: Strategic sales improved operational efficiency and reduced government liabilities.
3. Delays: Political resistance, valuation disputes and strategic sensitivities have prolonged sales of National Fertilisers Limited and RCF.

Way Forward

1. Transparent valuation: Independent valuation and open bidding.
2. Time-bound targets: Stricter timelines and parliamentary monitoring to reduce delays.
3. Atmanirbhar alignment: Align sales with defence production under the Defence Acquisition Procedure 2020.

Conclusion

Strategic disinvestment under DIP-AM has become a tool for fiscal consdidation, efficiency and infrastructure finance, freeing resources for social priorities.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

9(b) What is meant by 'Industrial Revolution 4·0' ? Assess the likely impact of the fourth industrial revolution on India's manufacturing sector. Provide a brief note on the 'Production-Linked Incentive' (PLI) schemes in India.

10

Introduction

The Fourth Industrial Revolution integrates digital, physical and biological technologies and is reshaping global manufacturing. As India aims to be a manufacturing hub, adopting Industry 4.0 alongside the PLI scheme is critical for competitiveness and jobs, including in fast-growing Andhra Pradesh.

Meaning of Industry 4.0

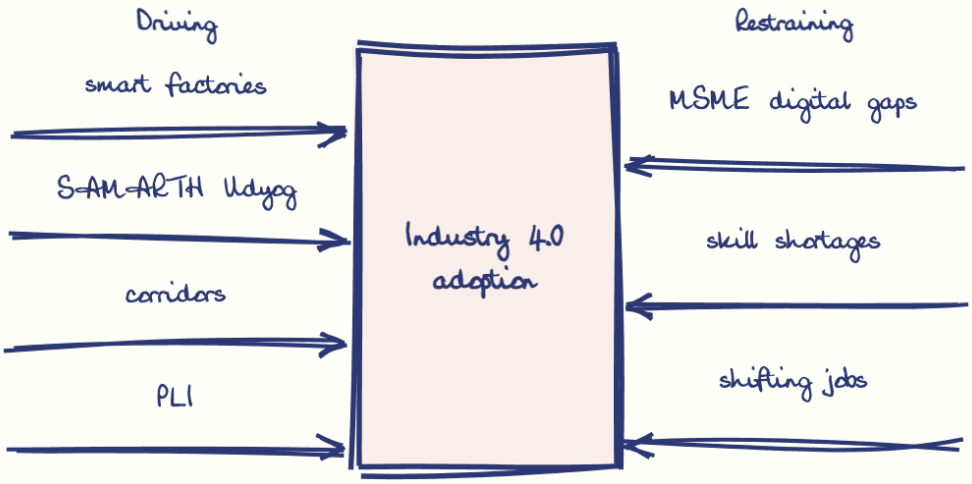
1. **Definition:** The digitisation and automation of manufacturing through IoT, AI, cloud computing and cyber-physical systems.
2. **Smart factories:** Connected machines optimise production and decisions in real time.

Likely Impact on Indian Manufacturing

1. **Productivity and competitiveness:** Smart factories raise efficiency; SAMARTH Udyog Bharat 4.0 promotes advanced technologies.
2. **MSME barriers:** Many MSMEs are in early automation, lacking digital infrastructure and skilled workers, limiting gains.

3. Changing jobs: Job profiles will shift, needing reskilling and digital literacy.
4. Regional ecosystems: Corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai give Andhra Pradesh a base for adoption, helped by its role in the National Manufacturing Mission.

Industry 4.0 in Indian manufacturing



Note on PLI Schemes

1. Design: The PLI scheme rewards incremental production in (14) sectors, including electronics and pharmaceuticals, with an outlay of Rs (1.97 lakh) crore.
2. Investment: Committed investment crossed Rs (1.61) (lakh) crore by late (2024).
3. Outcomes: It created over (12.6 lakh) jobs and lifted electronics production by (146%) from FY

2020-21 to FY 2024-25.

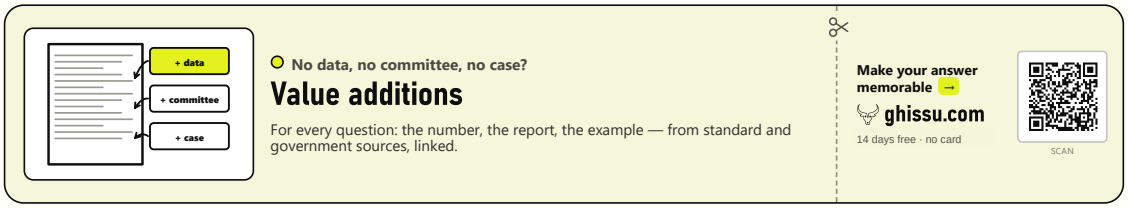
4. Concerns: Benefits are uneven; AP's 9.24% GSDP growth against 6.4% nationally shows uptake, but inclusion across districts lags.

Way Forward

1. MSME digitalisation: Targeted finance for Industry 4.0 adoption.
2. Skills: Reskilling for digital literacy and advanced manufacturing.
3. Infrastructure: Speed up corridors, high-speed internet and smart logistics in port-led zones.

Conclusion

Industry 4.0 and PLI can modernise Indian manufacturing, provided technology, skill and infrastructure gaps are closed.



10(a) With respect to the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Andhra Pradesh, discuss the following : (i) Importance of MSMEs in Andhra Pradesh economy (ii) Scope and implementation of Dr. YSR Navodayam and ReSTART programmes in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) are pivotal to Andhra Pradesh's economy, contributing to employment, industrial output and inclusive growth. In the post-bifurcation need for diversification, the Dr. YSR Navodayam and ReSTART programmes aim to address credit access, revival and market linkages.

(i) Importance of MSMEs

1. Economic contribution: MSMEs add substantially to output and jobs, supporting GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024-25, above the national 6.4%.
2. Livelihoods: They sustain livelihoods in agro-based and industrial clusters of Rayalaseema and coastal Andhra, absorbing workers displaced by agricultural distress and reducing migration.
3. Traditional and emerging links: They support handlooms and agro-processing and integrate with aquaculture and horticulture, adding resilience.
4. Constraints: Limited formal credit, technological backwardness and competition from large firms

restrict scale and global competitiveness, which is why targeted programmes are needed.

(ii) Scope and Implementation of the Programmes

1. Dr. YSR Navodayam: Targets micro and small enterprises, easing credit access through simplified procedures and supporting entrepreneurship in backward regions, in line with the inclusive growth agenda.
2. ReSTART: Revives stressed MSMEs hit by economic disruptions through financial restructuring, capacity building and market linkages, helping them regain viability.
3. Implementation mechanism: Digital platforms handle registration and loan processing, banks ensure timely disbursal and monitoring, and incubation centres add skills and innovation support.
4. Execution challenges: Low awareness among rural entrepreneurs, infrastructure gaps in remote areas and coordination problems among stakeholders slow delivery and call for better outreach.

Way Forward

1. Digital outreach: Expand digital literacy and access in rural areas so MSMEs can use online platforms.
2. Skills: Integrate training and technology adoption

Navodayam and ReSTART

Dr. YSR Navodayam	ReSTART
Micro and small enterprises	Stressed MSMEs
Easier credit access	Financial restructuring
Backward-region entrepreneurship	Capacity building, market links

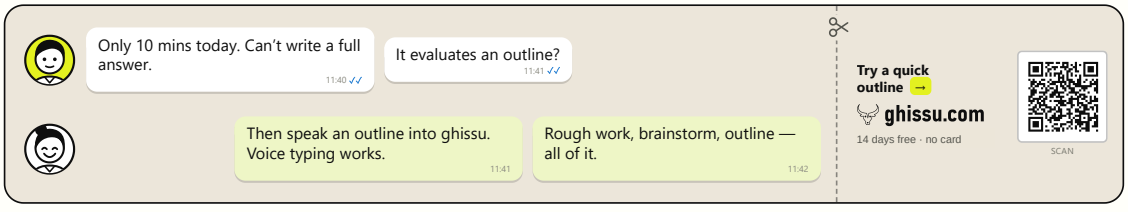
with both programmes to raise productivity.

3. Credit linkages: Expand credit guarantee schemes to ease collateral constraints and reduce NPAs.

4. Clusters: Support agro-processing and textile clusters for economies of scale and market access.

Conclusion

MSMEs drive employment and diversification in Andhra Pradesh. By enhancing credit access and enterprise revival, effective implementation of Navodayam and ReSTART can strengthen the sector's resilience and inclusive development.



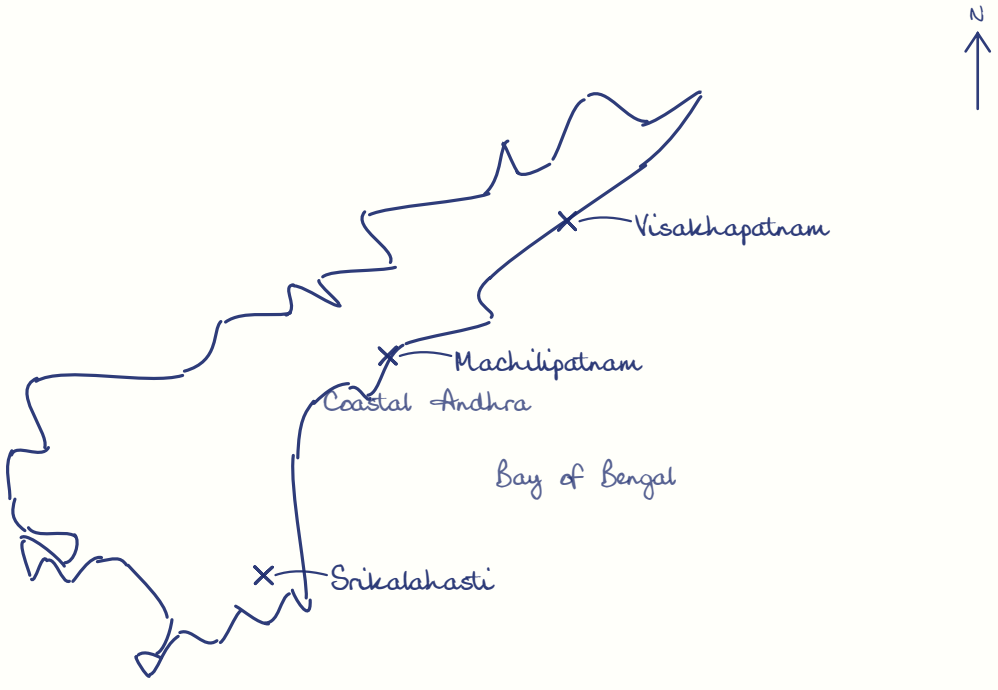
10(b) Explain the development programme of Visakhapatnam Chennai Industrial Corridor Development Program (VCICDP). Write a short note on the socio-economic impact of the VCICDP.

10

Introduction

The Visakhapatnam–Chennai Industrial Corridor Development Program (VCICDP) is a strategic initiative to boost industrial growth and regional development on India's east coast. Linking two major port cities, it uses port-led infrastructure to expand manufacturing under Make in India and to improve connectivity with Southeast and East Asian markets.

VCIC industrial nodes in Andhra Pradesh



Nodes: Visakhapatnam, Machilipatnam, Donakonda, Yerpedu–Srikalahasti

Development Programme

1. **Node-centric model:** Four industrial nodes, Visakhapatnam, Machilipatnam, Donakonda and Yerpedu-Srikalahasti, serve as manufacturing hubs with focused infrastructure.
2. **ADB and PPP support:** The Asian Development Bank funds the corridor, with the Centre and Andhra Pradesh combining public investment and private participation.
3. **National corridor network:** NICDIT coordinates it with other corridors and coastal economic zones for balanced industrialisation.
4. **Policy facilitation:** Incentives for downstream industries and streamlined land acquisition, though feedstock availability and export incentives remain weak.

Socio-Economic Impact

1. **Connectivity gains:** Better port connectivity at Visakhapatnam, well placed for Southeast Asian trade, reduces logistics costs and turnaround times.
2. **Employment and industry:** Clusters attract investment in petrochemicals and electronics, as with Amara Raja Batteries at Yerpedu-Srikalahasti, creating direct and indirect jobs.
3. **Planned urbanisation:** Smart cities and industrial

townships house the growing workforce and curb unplanned urban sprawl, lifting the region socio-economically.

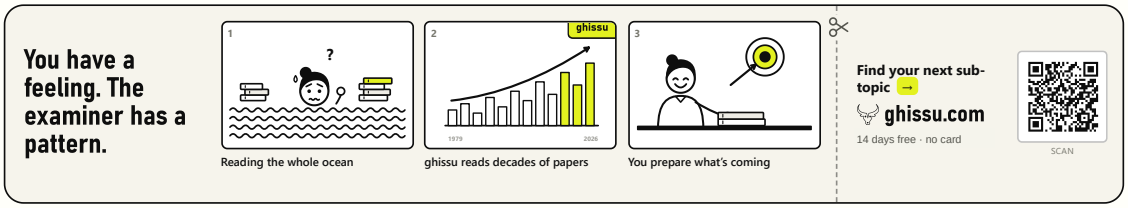
4. Social and environmental concerns: Land acquisition disputes, displacement and environmental risks must be managed for inclusive development.

Way Forward

1. Policy incentives: Stronger export incentives, lower interest rates for downstream units and assured feedstock.
2. Land and rehabilitation: Transparent acquisition with timely resettlement to reduce delays.
3. Skills: Vocational centres aligned with corridor industries to raise local employability.

Conclusion

The VCICDP is a transformative opportunity for industrialisation and jobs in Andhra Pradesh. By fostering manufacturing, connectivity and employment, and if managed inclusively, it advances Viksit Bharat 2047 and SDG 8.



Write your own answer to 10(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

11(a) Explain the impact of Digital Public Infrastructure on the socio-economic development in India. Discuss the steps taken by the Indian Government to accelerate digital infrastructure and to reduce digital divide in India.

10

Introduction

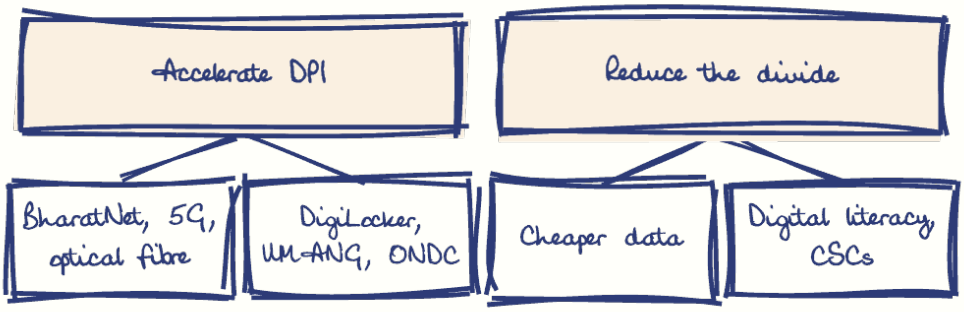
India's digital transformation is a cornerstone of its socio-economic development, with the digital economy contributing 11.74% of national income in 2022-23. Digital public infrastructure (DPI) connects remote areas, fosters innovation and improves governance, and bridging the digital divide remains a key priority.

Impact of DPI on Socio-Economic Development

1. **Financial inclusion and delivery:** Aadhaar, UPI and DigiLocker brought over a billion people into the formal economy. UPI recorded 1,867.7 crore transactions worth 24.77 lakh crore in April 2025.
2. **Growth and employment:** Digital industries grow faster than traditional ones, creating jobs and enterprises and helping youth use the demographic dividend.
3. **Governance and transparency:** E-governance raises accountability. UMANG offers over 2,300 services in 23 languages.

4. Persistent divide: Urban–rural and social gaps remain, as rural connectivity and literacy gaps in Andhra Pradesh show.

Government steps on digital infrastructure



Steps to Accelerate Digital Infrastructure

1. Digital India and BharatNet: Broadband reached over 2.15 lakh Gram Panchayats.
2. 5G and fibre: 5.18 lakh base stations cover 99.9% of districts; optical fibre grew from 19.35 lakh route km in 2019 to 42.36 lakh in 2025.
3. Platforms: DigiLocker, UM-ANG and ONDC give interoperable services.
4. Innovation: Startup India and Make in India support tech entrepreneurship.

Steps to Reduce the Digital Divide

1. Affordability: Data fell from 269 per GB in 2014 to 8–10 in 2025–26; tele-density hit

84.49% by October 2024.

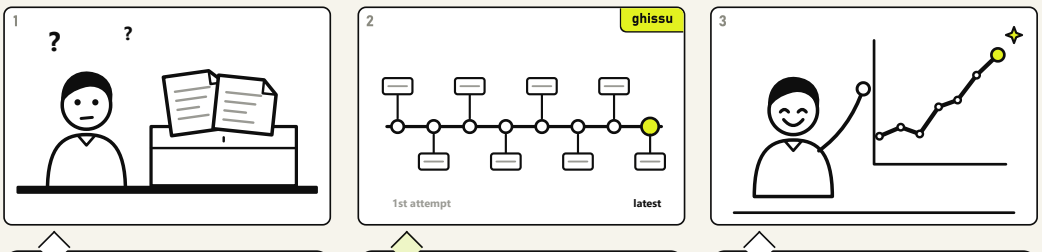
2. Digital literacy: Skills training for rural and marginalised groups.
3. Inclusive delivery: Common Service Centres and multilingual UM-ANG.
4. Last-mile links: Community wireless networks in remote and drought-prone regions of Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

DPI has widened access, growth and transparency. Closing the remaining divide will make India's digital gains truly inclusive.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

The drawer of old answers



Fifty answers in here. Am I improving? No idea.

Every attempt, scored, on one line.

The line is going up. I AM getting better.

— You can't fix what you can't see.

See your own progress →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

11(b) What are the features of a 'Smart City'? Explain the role of smart cities in economic development. Discuss the challenges faced in financing the smart cities under the Smart City Mission, and the solutions to overcome these challenges.

10

Introduction

Rapid urbanisation makes sustainable urban development critical. The Smart Cities Mission, launched in 2015, aims to turn 100 cities into hubs of economic growth and better quality of life through technology and innovative planning, tackling congestion, pollution and infrastructure deficits.

Features of a Smart City

1. Integrated infrastructure: Assured water and electricity, efficient mobility, sanitation and affordable housing for all, including the poor.
2. Technology-driven governance: E-governance and Integrated Command and Control Centres using AI and IoT raise transparency and participation.
3. Sustainable planning: Mixed land use, walkable localities, open spaces and public and non-motorised transport.
4. Economic identity and inclusion: An identity built on local industries, as Visakhapatnam's focus on port-led corridors and affordable housing shows.

Role in Economic Development

1. **Productivity and innovation:** ICT infrastructure fosters entrepreneurship and innovation, creating jobs in knowledge-based sectors.
2. **Investment and talent:** Better infrastructure and governance attract domestic and foreign investors and retain skilled professionals.
3. **Inclusive growth:** Affordable housing, sanitation and public services reduce urban poverty and spread prosperity.
4. **Competitiveness:** Amaravati has used smart city projects to improve connectivity and services, and Tirupati has built smart roads.

Financing Challenges

1. **High capital needs:** Investment demands exceed municipal and state capacity.
2. **Matching funds:** Matching central grants strains revenue-deficit states like Andhra Pradesh.
3. **Limited municipal autonomy:** Weak revenue bases and financial capacity for PPPs.
4. **Coordination gaps:** Overlapping roles and weak Metropolitan Planning Committees under Article 243ZE.

Solutions

1. Municipal revenue: Reform property tax, user charges and non-tax revenue.
2. PPPs: Clear risk-sharing frameworks.
3. Institutions: Empower MPCs for pooled planning.
4. Innovative instruments: Municipal bonds, land value capture and blended finance.

Smart city financing

Challenge	Solution
High capital needs	Municipal bonds, blended finance
Weak municipal revenue	Property tax, user charges
Limited PPP capacity	Clear risk-sharing
Coordination gaps	Empowered MPCs

Conclusion

Smart cities can drive inclusive and sustainable growth by combining technology, infrastructure and governance, provided their financing is diversified and institutions strengthened.

Where did you write that point?
Notes that live with the question.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 11(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

12(a) Explain the 'PUSH' strategy of the Government of Andhra Pradesh with respect to Export Promotion Policy (2022 – 27). Discuss the challenges of export sector and the support extended by the AP Government towards export promotion in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh recorded exports of over US$ 19 billion in FY22 and ranked eighth in the Export Preparedness Index 2022. Its Export Promotion Policy (2022–27) adopts a PUSH strategy to proactively build export capability through infrastructure, institutional support and market access, using the state's coastal advantage.

The PUSH Strategy

1. **Comprehensive policy design:** District-level export plans and sector strategies focus on thrust sectors such as engineering goods, seafood and agro-products, coordinated by District Export Promotion Councils and Export Commissioners.
2. **Institutional facilitation:** A State–Centre coordination cell, grievance redressal, single-window clearances and capacity-building workshops raise exporter readiness.
3. **Infrastructure and quality:** The state has the highest area under Export Promotion Zones and Agri-export zones, with testing labs;

Visakhapatnam and East Godavari are export hubs.

4. Market development: Trade fairs, buyer–seller meets and international outreach diversify markets.

Challenges of the Export Sector

1. Power deficits: Inadequate power and high tariffs raise production costs.
2. Small exporter base: Few businesses hold Importer Exporter Codes, so many manufacturers remain non-exporters.
3. Logistics gaps: Inland container depots and warehouses are underdeveloped, and the LE-ADS score shows room to cut export lead times.
4. Narrow export basket: Exports grew 41.2% over three years but need diversification.

Government Support for Export Promotion

1. Power: Investment to improve power availability and cut costs for export units.
2. Exporter base: Programmes to raise IEC registrations and bring MSMEs into global value chains.
3. Logistics: More inland container depots, cold storage and warehouses.

4. Diversification: Support for innovation and value addition in agro-products and engineering goods, and new markets through trade fairs and digital platforms.

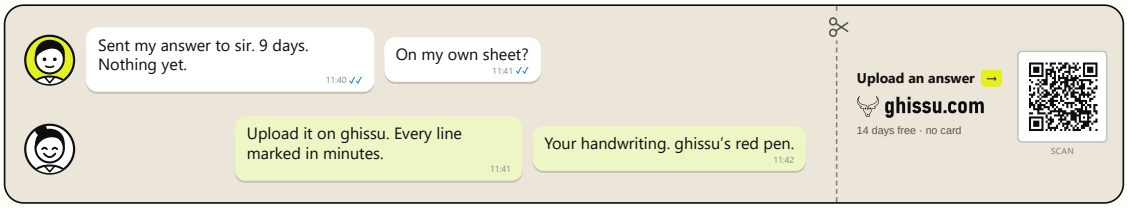
5. Institutions: Export promotion forums and district export plans keep exporters supported at the local level.

Export challenges and state support

Challenge	Support
Power deficits	Better power availability
Few IEC holders	IEC drives, MSMEs into GVCs
Weak ICDs, warehouses	More ICDs, cold storage
Narrow export basket	Value addition, new markets

Conclusion

The PLUSH strategy builds a proactive, coordinated export ecosystem. Addressing power, logistics and exporter capacity can deliver inclusive export-led growth under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.



12(b) Explain the policy framework for development of Civil Aviation in Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the development of Greenfield Airport projects in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

India's civil aviation sector is expanding rapidly through private participation, regional connectivity and infrastructure modernisation. Andhra Pradesh, with its strategic eastern coastal location and growing economy, is using civil aviation and Greenfield airports as part of its vision of infrastructure-led growth.

Policy Framework for Civil Aviation

1. National alignment: The National Civil Aviation Policy (2016) guides the state, stressing regional connectivity, revival of unserved airports and Public-Private Partnerships, which the state has embraced.

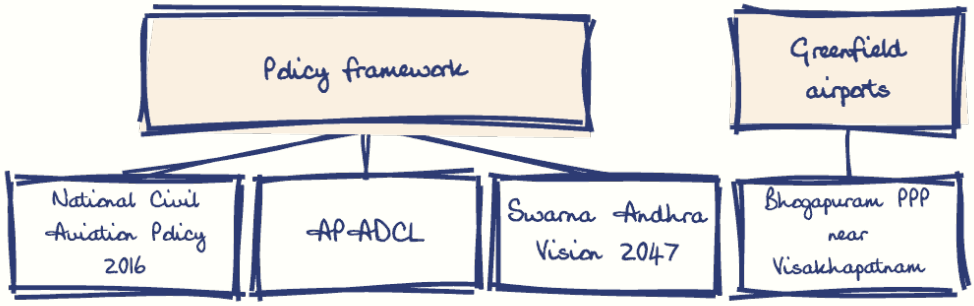
2. Institutional support: The Andhra Pradesh Airports Development Corporation Limited (AP-ADCL) facilitates design, financing and operation of airport projects.

3. Link to growth: Aviation is integrated with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, which treats infrastructure as a growth multiplier for

aquacutture, horticutture and tourism.

4. Fiscal challenge: Only a small fraction of Indian airports are profitable, and the state must balance airport investment against Pdavaram and welfare schemes.

Civil aviation in Andhra Pradesh



Greenfield Airport Prjects

1. Bhogapuram airport: The flagship prject follows a PPP model with a 40-year concession, which GMR won by offering a competitive per-passenger fee.
2. Strategic location: Near Visakhapatnam, it uses the 974 km coastline and port-led corridors, boosting cargo, passenger traffic and tourism.
3. Progress: The concession agreement is underway but delays persist, so land acquisition and clearances are crucial.
4. Wider prospects: The state's push matches the

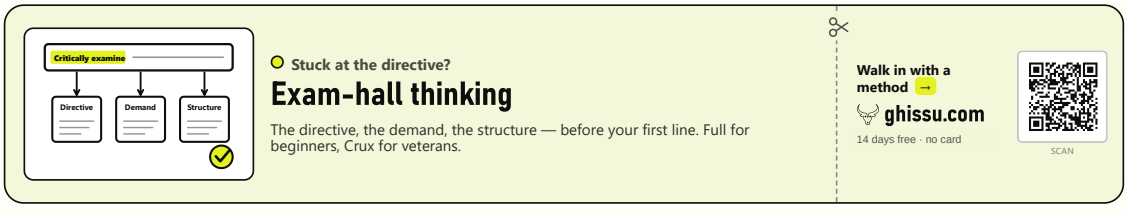
national plan for (18) new airports, but demand forecasting and environmental clearances need care.

Way Forward

1. Better PPPs: Offer clear regulatory support and risk-sharing.
2. Multimodal links: Connect airports with ports and road corridors.
3. Viability: Use airport economic regulation and performance monitoring to move airports towards profitability.
4. Technology: Advanced IT systems for airport management and passenger services can attract more airlines.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's aviation policy and Greenfield airports are a strategic effort to use aviation as a catalyst for growth. By aligning with national policy and private partners, they can enhance connectivity and create jobs, advancing SDG (8) on inclusive growth and decent work.



13(a) Explain the effects of prevailing low global growth and high global inflation on present Indian domestic growth and inflation. Discuss the methods to control inflation with a special mention of inflation targeting.

10

Introduction

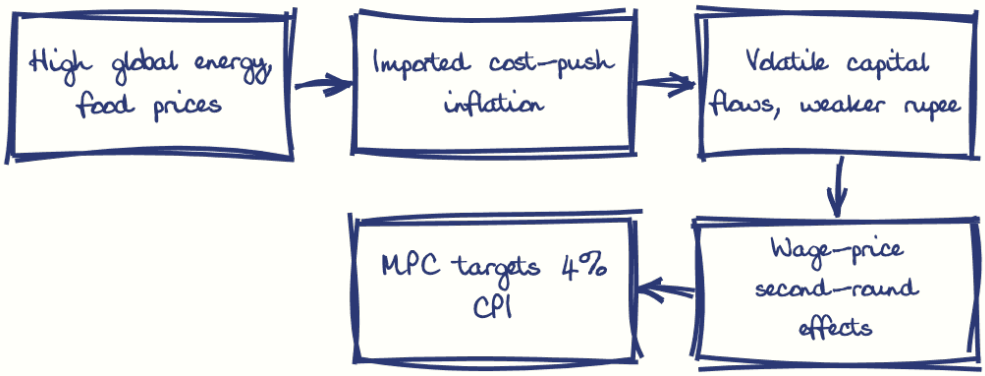
The global economy faces low growth combined with high inflation, a scenario described as stagflation. This creates external headwinds for India's trade, capital flows and price stability, making policy tools like inflation targeting crucial.

Effects on Domestic Growth and Inflation

1. Weaker export demand: Low global growth reduces external demand, hitting exports and domestic demand and slowing GDP growth. Yet Andhra Pradesh's GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national 6.4%, shows regional resilience.
2. Imported inflation: High global prices of energy and food raise input costs, causing cost-push inflation and squeezing margins.
3. Capital flows and rupee: Elevated global rates make capital flows volatile and push the rupee down, adding to imported inflation.
4. Second-round effects: Persistent inflation can cause wage-price spirals and unanchored

expectations.

From global shocks to Indian inflation



Methods to Contrd Inflation

1. Inflation targeting: Since 2016, India follows flexible inflation targeting with a 4% CPI target and a ±2% band, renewed till 2031. It anchors expectations and guides policy.
2. Monetary Policy Committee: A six-member MPC sets policy rates based on the inflation outlook and growth, balancing both goals.
3. Fiscal coordination: Deficit management and expenditure prioritisation curb demand-side inflation, as in Andhra Pradesh's targeted deficit reduction in its 2026-27 budget.
4. Supply-side measures: Dynamic stock management and trade policy ease food inflation, about 40% of the CPI basket.

Challenges

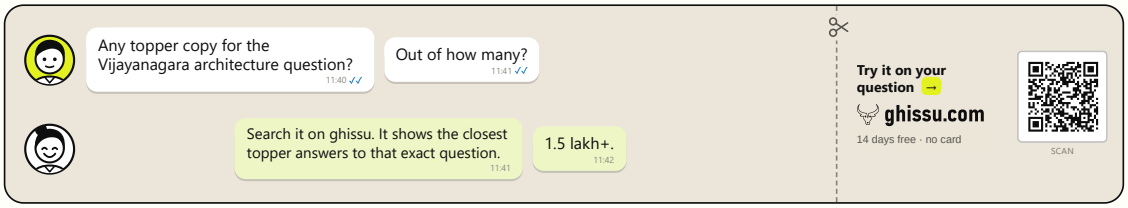
1. Supply shocks: Food price shocks cannot be fully controlled by monetary policy.
2. Regional variation: Urban inflation has exceeded rural since 2018.
3. Growth–inflation trade-off: RBI stays cautious on rate cuts amid global uncertainty.
4. Credibility: Transparent MPC communication is vital to anchor expectations.

Way Forward

1. Supply chain resilience: Better logistics and infrastructure in Andhra Pradesh can ease food supply bottlenecks and moderate food inflation.
2. Early monitoring: Data analytics and market intelligence can detect price pressures early.

Conclusion

A credible inflation targeting regime, supported by fiscal discipline and supply chain resilience, can shield India's growth from global stagflation.



13(b) What are the factors that spur foreign investment in India ? Explain the major features of India's Consolidated Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy. Briefly discuss the present situation of the FDI equity inflows in India.

10

Introduction

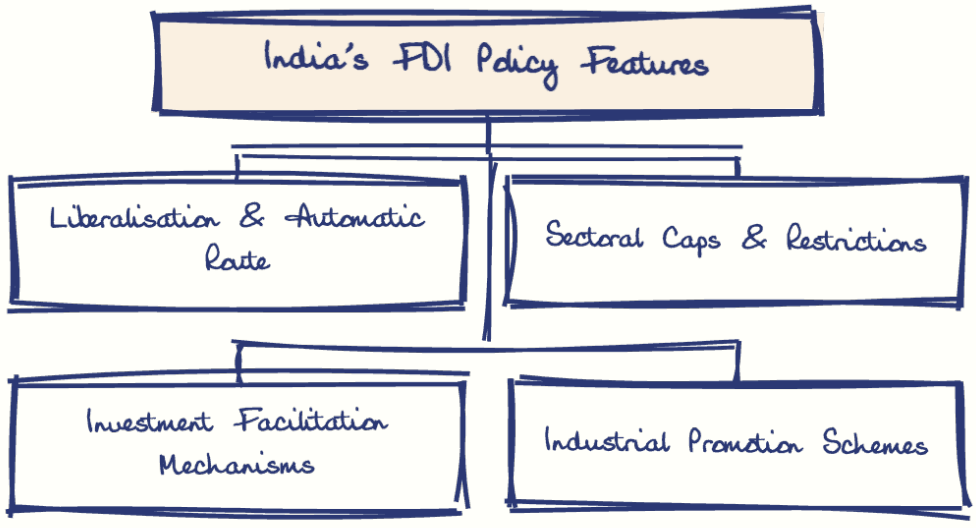
India has become a preferred destination for foreign investment, driven by GDP growth averaging around 8.2% from 2021–22 to 2024–25, policy reforms and a large domestic market. Its evolving FDI framework aims at deeper integration with global value chains.

Factors Spurring Foreign Investment

1. Market size and growth: A large, youthful market with rising demand gives scale for expansion and exports.
2. Policy stability: Consistent liberalisation, stable macro policy, eased caps and simpler approvals build confidence.
3. Innovation ecosystem: FDI brings technology, as in AWS's planned $8.2 billion AI and cloud project in Maharashtra.
4. Global integration: The China+1 strategy draws firms like Foxconn, which is expanding by $1.5 billion for iPhone production.

Features of the Consdidated FDI Pdicy

1. Liberalisation: 100% foreign equity is allowed in most sectors under the automatic route, including petroleum, pharmaceuticals and road building.
2. Sectoral caps: Strategic sectors like banking and telecom have caps, often up to 49%, while atomic energy, gambling and multi-brand retail remain closed or restricted.
3. Facilitation: The FIIA, the National Single Window System and India Industrial Land Bank ease approvals and site selection.
4. Supportive schemes: Make in India, PLI, Start-up India and PM GatiShakti complement the pdicy.



Candidates must not write on this margin

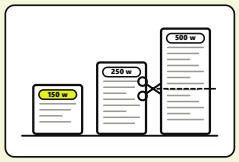
Candidates must not write on this margin

Present Situation of FDI Equity Inflows

1. **Rising inflows:** About US$ 50 billion in the first nine months of FY 2024–25, up 13% year on year.
2. **Higher repatriation:** Nearly US$ 40 billion repatriated up to November 2024 through exits lowers net FDI.
3. **Concentration:** Services, software, telecom and automobiles in advanced states attract most FDI, while Andhra Pradesh's port-led corridors and IT hubs seek a share.

Conclusion

India's liberal FDI regime is drawing rising inflows. Easing infrastructure and tax bottlenecks will spread them more widely.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 13(b) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

14(a) Explain the reasons leading to higher Public Debt in India. Discuss the scope of public debt sustainability in India.

10

Introduction

The Union Budget 2026–27 targets a fiscal deficit of (4.3%) of GDP, while the Centre's gross market borrowings rose to 14.61 lakh crore in 2025–26. Understanding why public debt is rising and whether it is sustainable is vital for macroeconomic stability and development.

Reasons for Higher Public Debt

1. Revenue deficits: Persistent deficits mean borrowing finances consumption rather than capital formation.
2. Expenditure pressures: Post-pandemic spending on welfare, infrastructure and subsidies raised borrowing needs.
3. External borrowing: Lower global rates than domestic ones encouraged external commercial borrowing, adding to servicing costs and vulnerability.
4. State-level burden: Andhra Pradesh's liabilities stand at (36%) of GSDP in 2026–27, and governance and arrears issues in its (124) SPSEs add contingent liabilities.

5. RBI's dual role: Managing debt and monetary policy together creates conflicts, as rate setting influences bond yields and complicates market functioning.

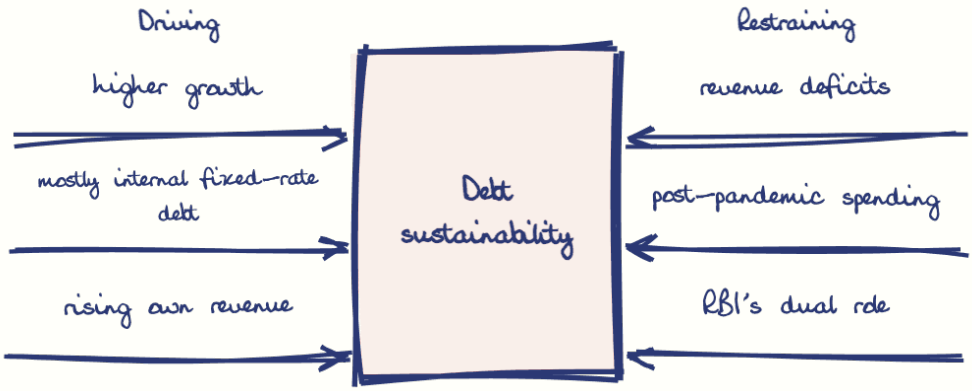
Scope for Debt Sustainability

1. Growth-driven dynamics: Higher growth lowers debt-to-GDP by raising revenue and cutting primary deficits. The ratio has been stable since 2011, with falling interest costs.
2. Improved debt profile: Debt is mostly internal and fixed-rate, while longer maturities and a lower average coupon reduce rollover and interest risk.
3. Revenue mobilisation: Andhra Pradesh's own tax revenue is projected to rise 28% in 2026-27, improving fiscal space.
4. Institutional reform: An independent debt management office, as recommended by NITI Aayog, can improve transparency.
5. Risk mitigation: More floating rate debt and longer maturities can manage interest rate risk.

Way Forward

1. Independent debt agency: A dedicated agency outside RBI can coordinate borrowing and build

Is India's public debt sustainable?



market confidence.

2. Fiscal discipline in states: Stricter fiscal rules and SPSE governance reform in Andhra Pradesh will cut contingent liabilities.

3. Productive spending: Control non-productive expenditure so that borrowing funds capital formation rather than consumption.

Conclusion

India's debt is high but sustainable if growth stays strong, primary deficits stay low and fiscal discipline holds at both levels.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

14(b) "The focus of the government has shifted from women development to women led development' — Examine this statement in the context of Education, Skilling and Microfinance.

10

Introduction

The move from women development to women-led development marks a transformative change in India's gender strategy: women are no longer passive beneficiaries but active leaders and decision-makers. This is vital to harness the demographic dividend amid gaps in education, jobs and financial inclusion.

Nature of the Shift

1. Agency over welfare: Women now participate in planning and decisions, making interventions more sustainable.
2. Inclusive growth: Bridging the gender gap in employment could raise GDP by up to 30%, as women reinvest earnings in families and communities.

Education

1. Leadership for girls: The NEP gender inclusion fund and Beti Bachao Beti Padhao promote leadership, and Vigyan Jyoti encourages STEM.

The Shift in Focus

Women Development	Women-Led Development
Passive beneficiaries	Active leaders, decision-makers
Top-down welfare	Grassroots leadership, enterprise
Access to schooling	Leadership, STEM for girls

2. Andhra Pradesh: Dedicated girls' hostels and scholarships improve safety, reduce dropouts and enable higher education.

Skilling

1. Gender-sensitive design: Skill India Mission offers safe transport, flexible schedules and childcare, aligned with industry demand.
2. Women-centric centres: AP's hostels and skilling centres help women enter formal jobs.
3. Barriers: Social norms and family pressure still cause post-training dropouts, needing awareness and post-placement support.

Microfinance

1. SHGs: Over 10 crore rural women are in DAY-NRLM SHGs, gaining credit, markets

and enterprise; in Andhra Pradesh, SHGs let women collectively manage resources.

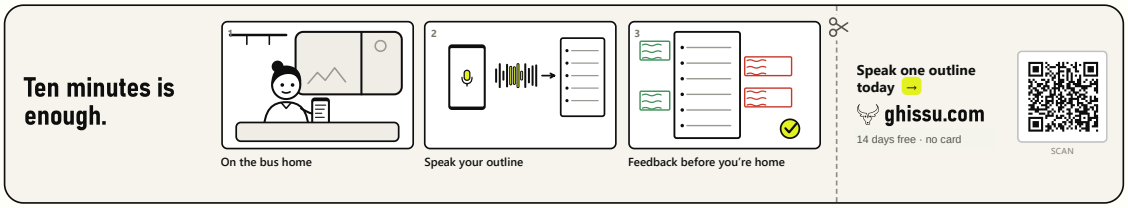
2. Collateral-free credit: Mudra and Stand-Up India serve mostly women-led enterprises.
3. Digital finance: Jan Dhan accounts and digital payments widen access to formal finance.

Critical Examination

1. Shift in design: Schemes now build leadership, skills and enterprise rather than only welfare, supporting the statement.
2. Uneven reach: Gains are strongest where SHGs and hostels exist, so rural and remote women benefit less.

Conclusion

Across education, skilling and microfinance, policy now treats women as agents of change rather than recipients. Sustained social awareness and post-placement support will make women-led development a lasting reality.



15(a) Explain the impact of rainbow revolution in India. Discuss the scope for Industrial transformation in Indian agriculture.

10

Introduction

The Rainbow Revolution expanded Indian agriculture beyond the Green Revolution's focus on wheat to fruits, vegetables, spices and floriculture. This shift helps meet rising demand, raise farmer incomes and secure food and nutrition amid climate challenges. In Andhra Pradesh, horticulture and aquaculture exemplify this diversification and its export potential.

Impact of the Rainbow Revolution

1. Commercialisation: The Agriculture Export Policy and the framework moved farmers from subsistence to market-oriented farming, evident in Andhra Pradesh's chilli and horticulture exports.
2. Extension and irrigation: Revitalised Krishi Vigyan Kendras spread climate-resilient, high-yield varieties, while projects like Polavaram raise water availability, enabling multiple cropping.
3. Export integration: Mechanisms addressing trade barriers and sanitary standards link farmers to global value chains, aided by port infrastructure at Visakhapatnam.
4. Employment: It increased on-farm and off-farm jobs,

with aquaculture diversifying livelihoods in the coastal belt.

5. Persisting limits: Lack of cold storage causes distress sales and wastage, small farmers in regions like Rayalaseema lack institutional credit despite PM-KISAN, and intensive cropping has degraded soil and stressed groundwater, prompting organic farming in select districts.

From diversification to agro-industry



Scope for Industrial Transformation

1. Agro-processing and value addition: Developing food processing clusters and cold chains would cut post-harvest losses and raise farmers' share in consumer prices; Andhra Pradesh's food parks are steps in this direction.

2. Technology and mechanisation: Precision agriculture, biotechnology and mechanisation boost productivity, with industrial partners supplying affordable, locally

suited machinery.

3. Supply chain modernisation: Strengthening e-NAM and contract farming creates efficient chains that link farmers directly to markets and processors, fostering industrial growth alongside agriculture.
4. Allied industries: Expanding livestock, dairy and fisheries complements crop agriculture, giving year-round income and opportunities in processing and export, as in Andhra Pradesh's fast-growing aquaculture sector.

Conclusion

The Rainbow Revolution broadened India's agricultural base, raising productivity, diversification and incomes. Industrial transformation through agro-processing, technology integration and supply chain modernisation is essential to sustain this momentum and ensure equitable growth. Andhra Pradesh's experience with horticulture, aquaculture and infrastructure shows the potential of this approach, which serves SDG (2) of zero hunger.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 15(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2023 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

15(b) Explain the regulation of agricultural markets in India. Discuss the scope of farmer-market linkages with a special mention of the e-National Agriculture Market in India.

10

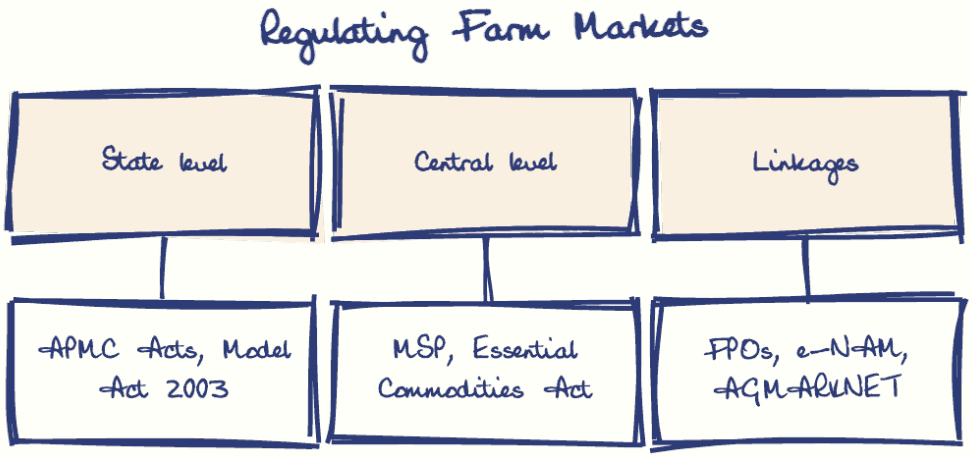
Introduction

Agricultural markets are critical for remunerative prices and national food security. Though agriculture employs over 40% of the population, fragmented and inefficient markets have constrained farm incomes. The e-National Agriculture Market (e-NAM), launched in 2016, marked a major step towards integrating mandis and improving transparency.

Regulation of Agricultural Markets

1. State APMC Acts: Farmers must sell in designated mandis under oversight, which prevents exploitation but fragments markets and breeds dependence on intermediaries.
2. Central interventions: The Essential Commodities Act and MSP stabilise prices, though they can skew cropping patterns and procurement.
3. Model APMC Act (2003): It allowed private players, contract farming and direct sales, but adoption has been uneven; AP has sought mandi reforms after bifurcation.

4. Commodity futures: Regulated by SEBI since 2015, they aid price discovery but remain out of reach for small farmers.



Scope of Farmer–Market Linkages

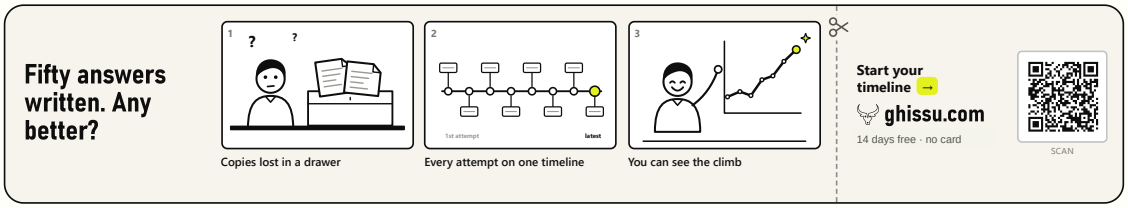
1. Fragmented access: Farmers often sell in a single local mandi, which limits competition and leaves them to middlemen who also supply credit, raising transaction costs.
2. FPOs: Farmer Producer Organisations aggregate smallholders; in AP, RKVY support helped them reach markets and credit.
3. Gaps: Poor mandi infrastructure, weak assaying and low digital literacy hurt price realisation.
4. Information tools: AGMARKNET and e-Seva in AP provide market data and access to government schemes.

Role of e-NAM

1. Unified platform: By March 2026, 1,656 mandis across 23 states and 4 UTs were integrated, with over 1.80 crore farmers.
2. Better prices: Transparent bidding raises prices and lowers transaction costs; Telangana and Gujarat report high satisfaction.
3. Challenges: Limited assaying, reluctance of traders and farmers to trust electronic quality checks, and varying state APMC laws. AP is integrating e-NAM with mandi reforms and FPOs.
4. Complementary reforms: A single trading licence, single-point fee and integration with e-NWRs.

Conclusion

Liberalised regulation, strong FPOs and e-NAM together can build a unified national market and raise farmers' income.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2020

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) State some of the notable initiatives taken by the government recently to boost the growth of manufacturing sector in India.

10

Introduction

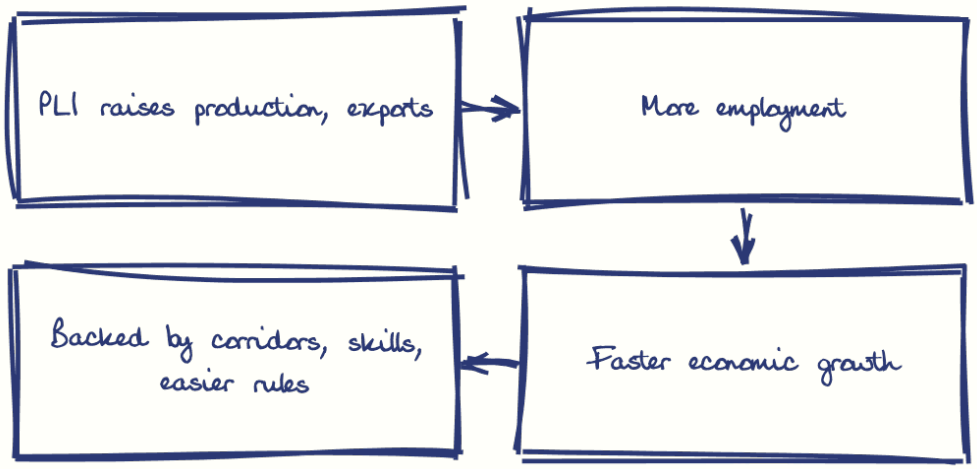
Manufacturing is pivotal for growth, jobs and global competitiveness, yet its share in GDP has stagnated around 16–17%, held back by infrastructure deficits and ease of doing business hurdles. Recent government initiatives aim to make India a global manufacturing hub by using its large market and workforce.

Notable Initiatives

1. PLI scheme: With an outlay of Rs 1.97 lakh crore for 14 sectors, it rewards domestic production and exports; 764 applications are approved, aiming at over USD 500 billion of production in five years.
2. Make in India 2.0: It covers 27 sectors, including aerospace, pharmaceuticals, electronics and textiles, to attract investment and build world-class infrastructure; Andhra Pradesh promotes corridors and smart cities under it.
3. PM GatiShakti and corridors: Integrated logistics and industrial corridors cut costs, as the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor shows.

4. Skills and technology: Skill India and the National Manufacturing Mission upgrade skills and R&D, while Project Development Cells and fast-track IPR registration aid startups.
5. Ease of doing business: Redundant laws are removed and licensing streamlined, Andhra Pradesh runs single-window clearance.

How the initiatives work together



Contribution to Manufacturing

1. Output and exports: Manufacturing GVA grew 7.0% year-on-year in H1 FY2025-26, with gains in specialty steel and electronics.
2. Investment and jobs: Make in India drew FDI and domestic capital, AP's industrial parks and smart cities helped it grow 9.24% in 2024-25.
3. Logistics: GatiShakti and corridors cut

bottlenecks, costs and delivery times, helping MSMEs and large firms join global supply chains.

4. Innovation: R&D support helps move India from assembly to design-led manufacturing.
5. Business climate: Lower compliance burdens and digital governance make investment easier.

Way Forward

1. Wider PLI: Include emerging sectors like green technologies and electric vehicles to keep manufacturing future-ready.
2. State implementation: Strengthen single-window systems and infrastructure.
3. MSME integration: Improve finance, technology and market access in manufacturing clusters.
4. Sustainable manufacturing: Build environmental goals into incentives so growth stays green.

Conclusion

Together these initiatives are building scale, infrastructure and skills, positioning India as a competitive manufacturing hub.

Are you actually improving?
Every attempt scored. Watch the curve.
ghissu.com →

1(b) Highlight some of the major factors leading to low agricultural productivity in India.

10

Introduction

Agriculture remains the backbone of India's economy, employing nearly half the workforce. Yet yields of major crops like rice and wheat are far below those of the USA and China. This productivity gap threatens food security, farm incomes and rural development, especially in agrarian states like Andhra Pradesh.

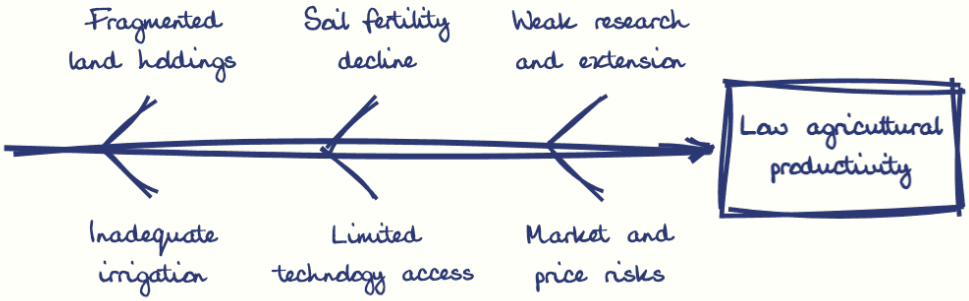
Major Factors behind Low Productivity

1. Fragmented Land Holdings: Shrinking holdings create uneconomical farms that hinder mechanisation and scale, as in Andhra Pradesh, where small and marginal farmers dominate.
2. Inadequate Irrigation: Despite PMKSY, regions like Rayalaseema in Andhra Pradesh stay rainfed and vulnerable to the monsoon, lowering yields and cropping intensity.
3. Soil Fertility Decline: Continuous cropping causes exhaustion and erosion; imbalanced fertiliser use persists despite the Soil Health Card Scheme.
4. Limited Technology Access: High-yielding

varieties, quality seeds and machinery reach mainly richer, irrigated farms, while smallholders in Andhra Pradesh lack credit.

5. Weak Research and Extension: Research outputs rarely reach small farmers.
6. Market and Price Risks: Limited MSP reach and inefficient marketing deny remunerative prices.

Why farm productivity stays low



How They Depress Productivity

1. No Economies of Scale: Small plots discourage investment.
2. Climate Vulnerability: Monsoon dependence causes crop failures.
3. Low Adoption: Information gaps keep traditional methods alive.
4. Risk Aversion: Low, uncertain prices trap farmers in low output.

Way Forward

1. Land Leasing Reform: Enable consolidation and mechanisation, especially in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Micro-Irrigation: Scale up drip and sprinkler irrigation in dry zones like Rayalaseema.
3. Soil and Extension: Intensify Soil Health Cards and digital outreach.

Conclusion

Low productivity stems from structural, ecological and market factors together; tackling them jointly can raise farm incomes and food security.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON NOTES THAT LIVE WITH THE QUESTION

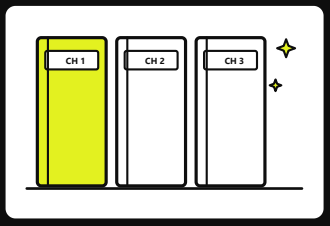
Notes that come back when you need them

Most notes are written once and never found again. Four habits fix that.

1. **Where** — On the question that taught you the point.
2. **How long** — One line. If it needs a paragraph, it's two notes.
3. **Tag** — With its syllabus sub-topic.
4. **Revise** — By chapter, not by the date you wrote it.

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into topic and chapter notes by themselves.



Build notes that find you →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

2(a) What are the factors responsible for the narrow tax base in India? Explain in brief.

10

Introduction

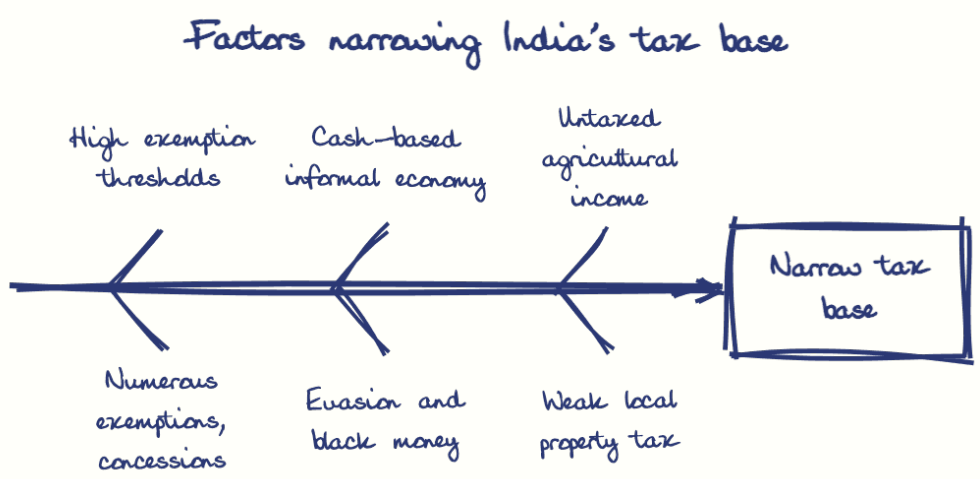
India's tax-to-GDP ratio remains low despite sustained growth, reflecting a narrow tax base that constrains fiscal capacity and public investment. Widening it is essential to finance development and welfare, including in Andhra Pradesh.

Institutional Factors

1. **High exemption threshdds:** The individual exemption limit raised to 12 lakh keeps a large population outside direct taxes.
2. **Weak administration:** A CAG audit of Andhra Pradesh (2021–22) found underassessment and losses of over 1,800 crore.
3. **High tax expenditure:** Numerous exemptions and concessions create loophdes and lower effective rates.
4. **Limited local powers:** Local governments collect only a fraction of potential property tax.

Implementation and Structural Factors

1. **Informal economy:** Cash-based activity enables evasion, Andhra Pradesh's revenue fell up to



(16%) short of estimates.

2. Low taxpayer penetration: Only about (4%) of the voting-age population pays tax, against an expected (23%).

3. Evasion and black money: High rates and complex compliance encourage tax evasion, as demonetisation exposed.

4. Legal delays: Slow contract enforcement deters formal business.

5. Political economy: Reluctance to tax agricultural income and luxury consumption exempts large groups.

6. Reliance on indirect taxes: Less visible taxes weaken voluntary compliance.

Way Forward

1. Lower exemptions: Phase out unnecessary concessions

and tax expenditure without raising rates.

2. Digital integration: Use data analytics to capture informal sector incomes and curb evasion.

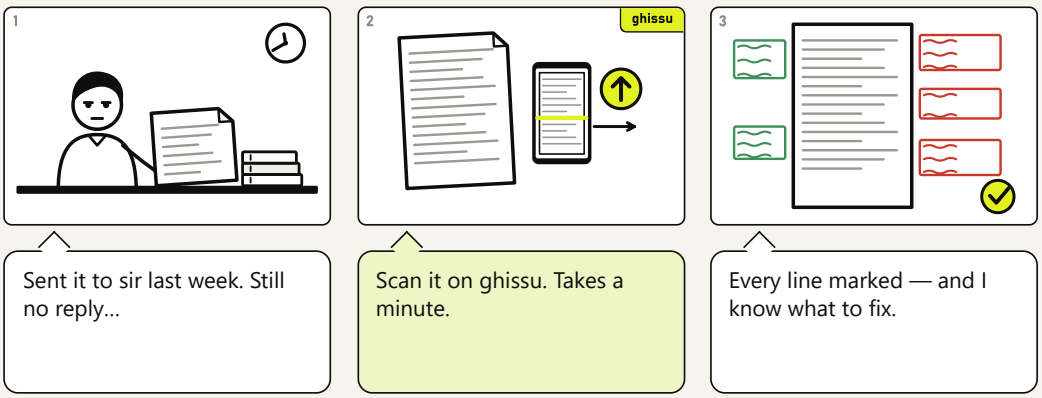
3. Empower local bodies: Improve property tax collection, of which local governments now realise only a fraction.

Conclusion

A narrow base reflects institutional, economic and political factors. Rationalised exemptions, better administration and stronger local taxation can widen it fairly and fund inclusive growth, including in Andhra Pradesh.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW ANSWER EVALUATION

The answer nobody read



— Feedback you get tonight beats feedback you wait a week for.

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

2(b) Define public debt and give its components with reference to Indian government? Explain trends in public debt since 2010 onwards.

10

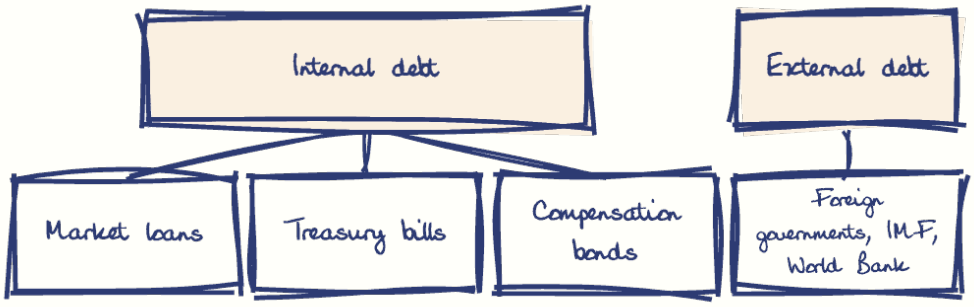
Introduction

Public debt is the total borrowing by the government to meet expenditure beyond its revenue. Managing it well is vital for fiscal health and development as India grows after the pandemic. Since 2010, debt trends reflect a balance between financing growth and keeping debt sustainable.

Components of India's Public Debt

1. **Internal debt:** Market loans, treasury bills, compensation bonds and other domestic securities. Dated securities finance over 90% of the Centre's fiscal deficit, while treasury bills give short-term funding.
2. **External debt:** Loans in foreign currency from foreign governments, the IMF, World Bank and bilateral lenders. Since 2005-06, states like Andhra Pradesh borrow externally with central guarantees.
3. **Debt management:** The RBI manages issuance and servicing, though an independent debt office is debated.

Components of India's public debt



Trends Since 2010

1. **Rising debt:** Public debt has grown significantly, with internal debt the major share.
2. **Longer maturity:** Weighted average maturity rose from 9.7 years in 2010 to 11.7 years in 2022, reducing rollover risk.
3. **Borrowing and deficit:** Gross market borrowing rose to 14.61 lakh crore in 2025–26, but net borrowing fell slightly; the 2026–27 fiscal deficit is projected at 4.3% of GDP.
4. **State pressures:** Andhra Pradesh's liabilities reached 43.99% of GSDP in 2023, with off-budget borrowings adding risk; its 2026–27 fiscal deficit target is 3.8% of GSDP.
5. **Investor base:** Commercial banks hold most securities, and the foreign investor share

stays low.

Challenges

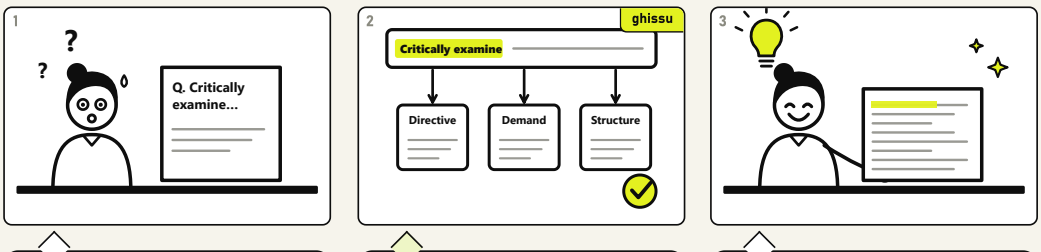
1. RBI's dual role: Conflict between monetary policy and debt management raises costs.
2. State deficits: Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit quadrupled in 2022–23, limiting capital spending.

Conclusion

India has lengthened maturities and consolidated deficits, but an independent debt management office and state discipline are needed for sustainability.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW EXAM-HALL THINKING

Three minutes staring at one word



"Critically examine"... what do they even want?

Directive, demand, structure — laid out first.

Oh. Counter-view, then my judgement. Easy.

— Walk into the hall with a method, not a memory.

Walk in with a method →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

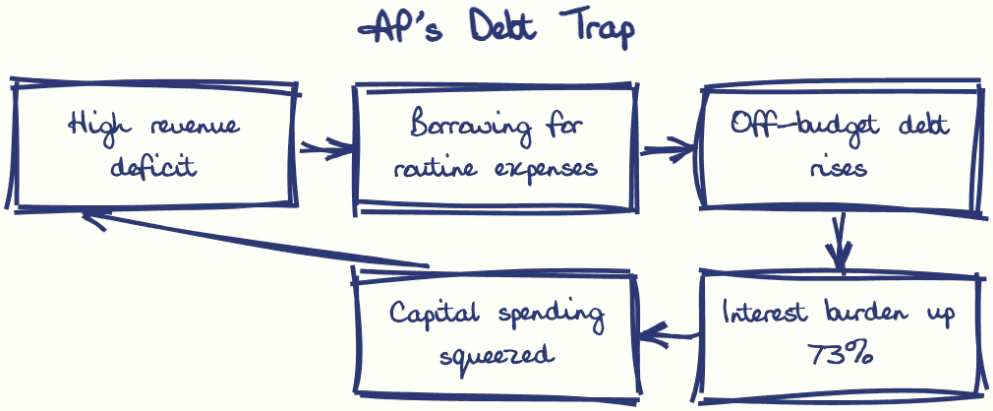
SCAN

3(a) Briefly give an account of revenue and fiscal deficits and the debt positions of Andhra Pradesh for the last five years (since 2014-15).

10

Introduction

Since bifurcation in 2014, Andhra Pradesh's finances have been under close scrutiny because of the loss of Hyderabad and the need to build a new capital and economic base. Its revenue and fiscal deficits and debt show the effort to balance development with fiscal prudence.



Revenue Deficit Since 2014–15

1. **Persistent Deficits:** Revenue expenditure has exceeded revenue receipts every year since 2014–15, forcing borrowing for routine expenses rather than investment.
2. **Sharp Rise in 2022–23:** The revenue deficit jumped by 405% over the previous year, signalling growing fiscal stress.

3. Committed Expenditure: Salaries, pensions and interest took about 64.6% of revenue receipts in 2022–23.

4. Slow Revenue Growth: Own tax revenue grew at only about 6% CAGR from 2018–19 to 2022–23.

Fiscal Deficit Since 2014–15

1. Within FRBM Targets: The fiscal deficit was 2.48% of GSDP in 2022–23, below the 4.5% ceiling.

2. Future Path: The 2026–27 budget targets 3.8% of GSDP, down from 4.6% in 2025–26.

3. Capital Squeeze: Capital spending was only 0.55% of GSDP and 3.45% of total expenditure, against a states' average of 13.48%.

Debt Position

1. Rising Debt Stock: Liabilities including off-budget borrowings reached 5,79,621 crore (43.99% of GSDP) by March 2023.

2. Off-Budget Borrowings: 1,28,048 crore, or 9.72% of GSDP, in 2022–23, a non-transparent risk.

3. Interest Burden: Interest payments rose by 73%, crowding out developmental spending.
4. Some Stabilisation: The debt ratio rose until 2020–21 and then eased slightly, helped by a fall in average interest rate from 8.2% to 7.6%.

Way Forward

1. Revenue Mobilisation: Widen the tax base and improve compliance to reduce the revenue deficit.
2. Transparent Borrowing: Bring off-budget borrowings onto the budget.
3. Capital Priority: Raise the capital share of spending for infrastructure-led growth.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has kept its fiscal deficit within limits, but a large revenue deficit and off-budget debt weaken sustainability. Better revenue mobilisation and more capital spending are vital.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

3(b) Give an account of the mineral and forest resources of Andhra Pradesh?

10

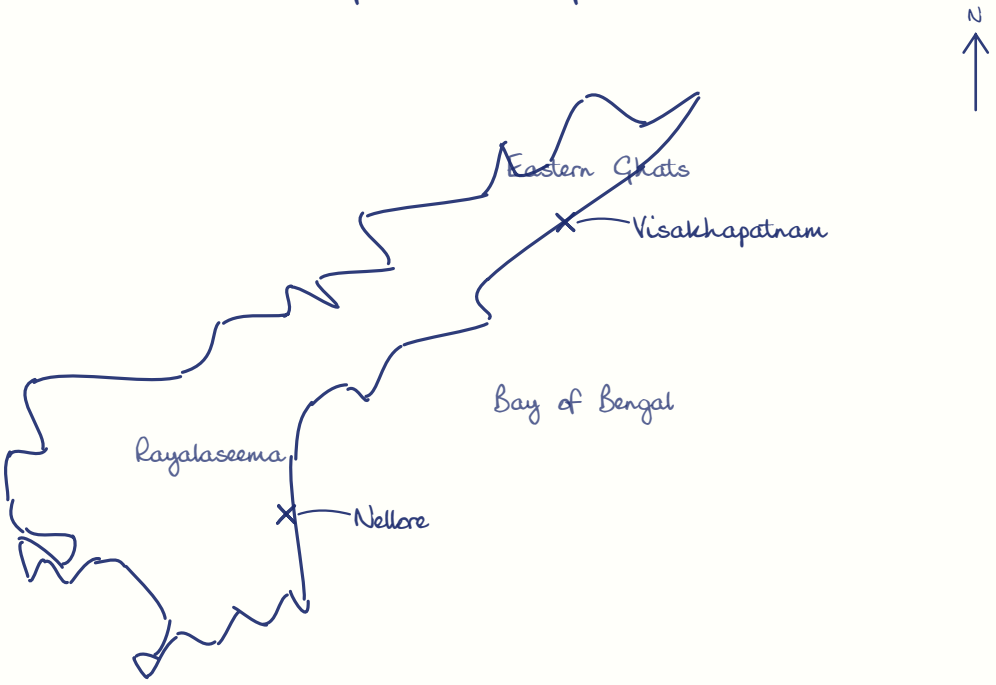
Introduction

The mineral and forest resources of Andhra Pradesh are crucial for economic growth and environmental sustainability. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, using them well is vital. Rich mineral deposits and significant forest cover support jobs, industry and ecological balance.

Mineral Resources

1. Diverse mineral wealth: Barytes, limestone, coal, mica, copper, manganese and asbestos; barytes reserves are 86.11% of India's total.
2. Distribution: Major deposits lie in Nellore, Krishna, Visakhapatnam and West Godavari, where mica and other minerals are mined.
3. Revenue gaps: The CAG found realisation shortfalls of 2% to 52% against estimates in 2017–22. This shows weak governance and enforcement.
4. Institutional framework: The District Mineral Foundation, NMET and MERIT support exploration and community development. They also aim to improve revenue collection.

Mineral and forest wealth of Andhra Pradesh



Minerals in Nellore, Visakhapatnam; forests in the Eastern Ghats

Forest Resources

1. Forest cover: Forests cover about 23% of the area, with teak, eucalyptus, casuarina, bamboo and softwoods for timber, fuelwood and minor produce.
2. Distribution: Mainly in the Eastern Ghats and parts of Rayalaseema, aiding biodiversity and carbon storage. They anchor the state's ecological landscape.
3. Tribal linkages: The National Forest Policy, 1988 stresses the bond between tribals and forests. Forest-dependent people rely on them for food and work.

4. Conservation: Mining and development drive deforestation, while afforestation aims to restore cover.

Significance

1. Economy: Limestone and barytes support revenue, industry and jobs. Both sectors employ many in rural and tribal areas.
2. Ecology: Forests regulate climate, soil and water for an economy where 62% depend on agriculture.
3. Balance: Extraction must be balanced with conservation.

Way Forward

1. Revenue: Use technology and CAG advice to plug shortfalls.
2. Sustainable mining: Community-inclusive mining under DMF.
3. Afforestation: Community forest management.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh is rich in minerals and forests. Better revenue realisation, sustainable mining and afforestation can turn them into inclusive, lasting growth.

Write your own answer to 3(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2020 · Paper IV

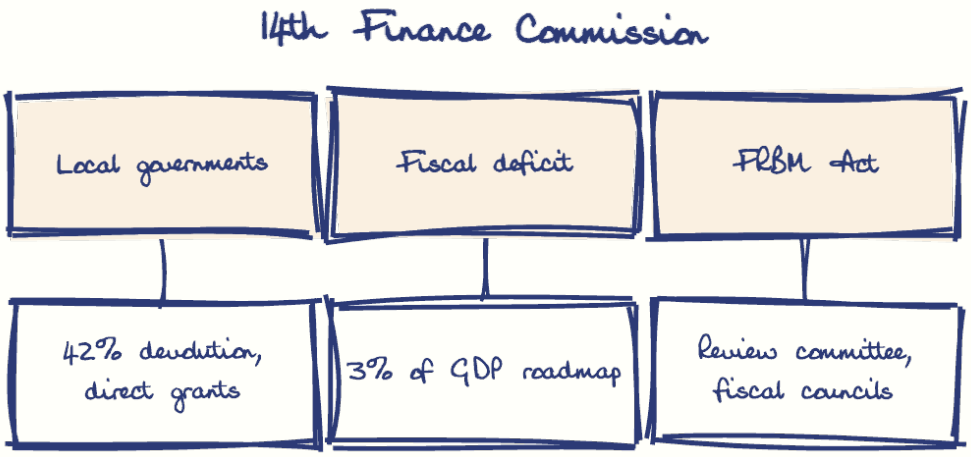
Scan to practice

4(a) What are the recommendations of the Fourteenth Finance Commission with respect to the grant to local governments, fiscal deficit and FRBM Act?

10

Introduction

The Fourteenth Finance Commission (FFC), constituted in 2013 under Dr. Y. V. Reddy, marked a pivotal moment in India's fiscal federalism. Its recommendations sought to deepen fiscal decentralisation, improve local governance and ensure fiscal discipline, balancing grassroots empowerment with macroeconomic stability.



Grants to Local Governments

1. Enhanced Devolution: States' share in the central divisible pool rose from 32% to 42%, indirectly boosting resources for local bodies mandated by the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

2. Direct Grants: Grants were recommended for Panchayats and urban local bodies to strengthen service delivery.
3. Performance Incentives: Performance-linked components, especially for urban bodies, rewarded better governance.
4. Andhra Pradesh Context: After bifurcation and the loss of Hyderabad, local finances depend heavily on such grants.

Fiscal Deficit

1. Consolidation Roadmap: The Centre's deficit was targeted at 3% of GDP by 2017-18 and states' at 3% of GSDP, leaving space for development.
2. Revenue Deficit Grants: Deficit states, including Andhra Pradesh, received grants to meet shortfalls without unsustainable borrowing.
3. Limits Exposed: Rising revenue deficits and off-budget borrowings in Andhra Pradesh show how hard consolidation is amid regional disparities.

FRBM Act

1. Review and Strengthening: A high-powered committee to review the FRBM Act, 2003, making rules realistic and allowing counter-cyclical policy.

2. Independent Fiscal Councils: To monitor compliance and give objective assessments, improving accountability.

3. Linking Rules to Development: Deficit targets balanced with capital spending on infrastructure and social sectors.

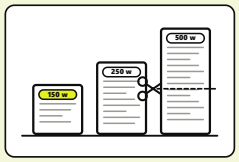
4. State Responsibility Laws: States were encouraged to enact or strengthen their own fiscal responsibility legislation.

Significance

1. Stability with Flexibility: A clear deficit roadmap, combined with a call for flexible, counter-cyclical rules, balanced growth and prudence.

Conclusion

The FFC combined deeper decentralisation with fiscal discipline. Yet Andhra Pradesh's quadrupled revenue deficit in 2022-23 shows that grants and rules must be matched by stronger state finances.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

4(b) Differentiate between revenue deficit, fiscal deficit and primary deficit? How does deficit financing impact the economy.

10

Introduction

With India targeting a fiscal deficit of 4.4% of GDP in 2025–26, the distinctions between revenue, fiscal and primary deficits reveal the government's spending patterns and borrowing needs, which shape macroeconomic stability. This matters for states like Andhra Pradesh, where rising revenue deficits constrain capital spending.

Differentiating the Deficits

1. **Revenue Deficit:** Revenue expenditure minus revenue receipts, showing that current income cannot meet day-to-day expenses.
2. **Fiscal Deficit:** Total expenditure minus total receipts excluding borrowings. It is the overall borrowing requirement for both revenue and capital spending.
3. **Primary Deficit:** Fiscal deficit minus interest on past borrowings, the imbalance excluding debt servicing. India's target for 2025–26 is 0.8% of GDP.

Types of Deficits

Revenue Deficit	Fiscal Deficit
Only revenue account gap	Total expenditure gap
Consumption borrowing	Total borrowing need
Excludes capital expenditure	Includes capital and revenue
Operational imbalance	Overall fiscal health

Impact of Deficit Financing

1. Growth Stimulus: It injects funds for public investment and welfare, higher capital spending aims to crowd in private investment and raise output and jobs.
2. Inflation: Deficits monetised by the RBI raise money supply and prices, eroding purchasing power of the vulnerable.
3. Debt Stress: Persistent deficits raise interest costs, Andhra Pradesh's liabilities, including off-budget borrowings, reached 5,79,621 crore (43.99% of GSDP) in 2022-23.
4. Ratings and Investment: High deficits raise borrowing costs, the FRBM Review Committee (2017) urged consolidation.

Way Forward

1. **Revenue Mobilisation:** Strengthen tax administration and broaden the tax base in Andhra Pradesh to reduce revenue deficits.
2. **Capital Expenditure:** Prioritise infrastructure like the Visakhapatnam port-led industrial corridor for long-term growth.
3. **Fiscal Responsibility:** Adhere to FRBM targets and disclose off-budget borrowings.
4. **Efficient Subsidies:** Rationalise subsidies through Direct Benefit Transfer.

Conclusion

Prudent deficit financing catalyses growth, but unchecked deficits risk inflation and debt distress. Revenue mobilisation and FRBM compliance are key.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

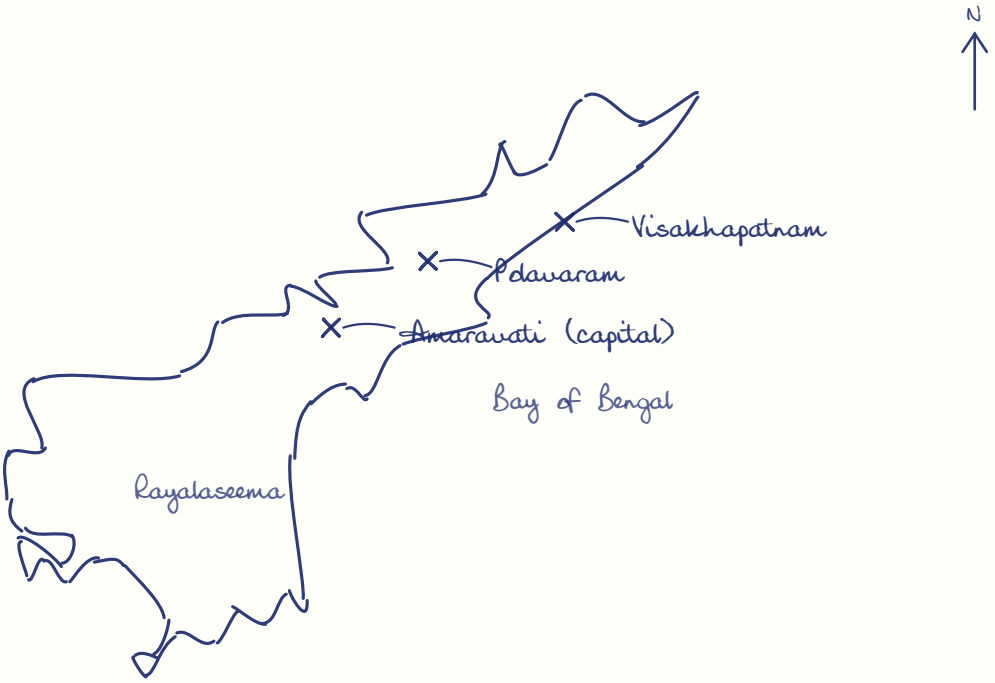
5(a) Highlight the areas of central assistance to Andhra Pradesh under the provision of Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act and Fourteenth Finance Commission?

10

Introduction

The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014 under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act required substantial central assistance for the new state's viability. The Act and the Fourteenth Finance Commission (FFC) laid down financial and infrastructure support to offset the loss of Hyderabad.

Central assistance in Andhra Pradesh



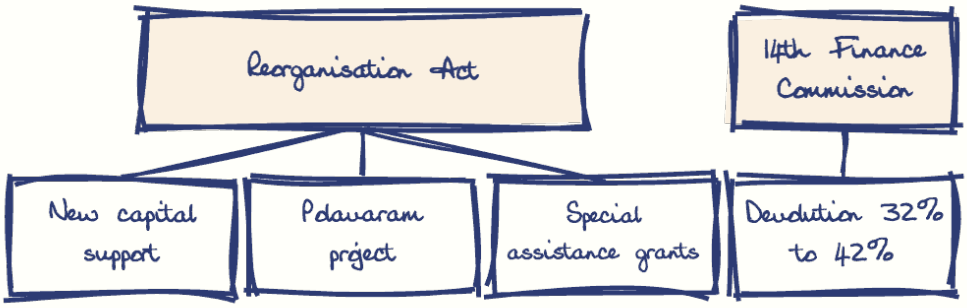
Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Assistance under the Reorganisation Act

1. **Capital formation:** The Act mandated special support for a new capital; Rs 15,000 crore has been arranged this year through multilateral agencies.
2. **Polavaram project:** The Polavaram project has full central backing for financing and early completion, aiding farmers and national food security. It is a lifeline for the agrarian economy.
3. **Industrial infrastructure:** Funds for water, power, rail and roads at Kopparthy on the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor and Orvakal on the Hyderabad–Bengaluru corridor.
4. **Special assistance grants:** Over Rs 35,000 crore released since June 2015 for revenue deficits and capital investment. This ensured fiscal stability during the transition.

Central assistance to Andhra Pradesh



Assistance under the FFC and Outcomes

1. **Enhanced devolution:** The FFC raised the states' share in the divisible pool from 32% to 42%, augmenting resources after bifurcation.
2. **Special Category Status:** Not granted; higher devolution partly compensates, but the state seeks more support for its developmental gaps.
3. **Capital investment:** Nearly Rs 4,000 crore was approved and released under SASCI till December 2024.

Way Forward

1. **Amaravati:** Continue multilateral and bilateral funding to complete the new capital with robust urban infrastructure.
2. **Monitoring:** Real-time tracking of Polavaram and corridors to cut delays and improve fund use.
3. **Special packages:** Tailored support for backward, drought-prone Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

Central assistance under the Act and the FFC has been pivotal in stabilising Andhra Pradesh, focused on capital formation, irrigation and industrial infrastructure.

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2020 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

5(b) Examine some of the major features of Andhra Pradesh budget for the FY 2020-21 with special reference to fiscal deficit situation of the state.

10

Introduction

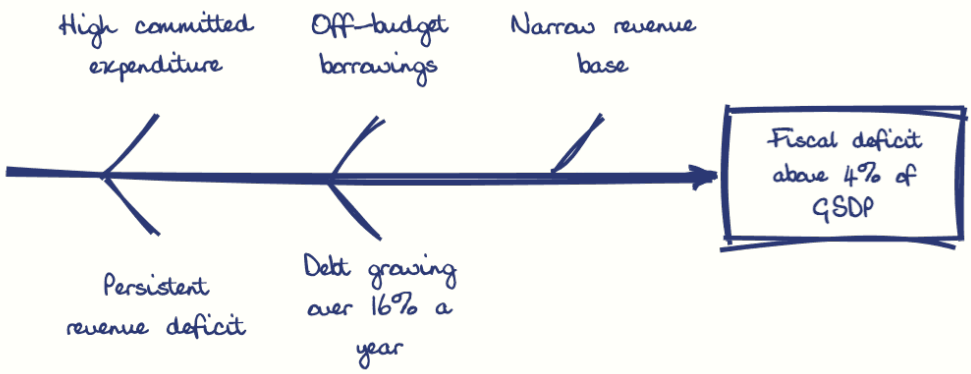
The Andhra Pradesh budget for FY 2020–21 was framed amid significant fiscal challenges, including rising deficits and constrained capital expenditure. These were worsened by the 2014 bifurcation and the continuing demand for Special Category Status, making the fiscal deficit central to its sustainability.

Major Features of the 2020–21 Budget

1. Revenue Receipts: Heavy reliance on own tax revenue, supported by aquaculture and horticulture in Coastal Andhra, though growth had slowed and sources were poorly diversified.
2. Expenditure Pattern: Priority to social welfare and infrastructure like the Polavaram project, but capital spending was a small fraction of the total.
3. High Committed Expenditure: Salaries, pensions and interest absorbed much of revenue spending, fuelling the revenue deficit.
4. Borrowing: Substantial market borrowings financed the deficit, with off-budget borrowings adding to

liabilities.

Fiscal Stress in AP Budget 2020–21



Fiscal Deficit Situation

1. **Above FRBM Targets:** The deficit exceeded (4%) of GSDP, showing fiscal stress.
2. **Persistent Revenue Deficit:** Current revenues did not cover revenue spending, so the state borrowed even for routine expenses.
3. **Declining Capital Outlay:** A falling trend, reaching about (0.55%) of GSDP by 2022–23, weakened infrastructure investment.
4. **Debt and Interest:** Public debt grew at over (16%) a year, and rising interest crowded out productive spending.

Implications

1. **Limited Fiscal Space:** Less money for capital

works such as the Visakhapatnam–Chennai industrial corridor.

2. Debt Sustainability: Rising debt risked higher borrowing costs and lower creditworthiness.
3. Investment Climate: Imbalances could deter private investment in manufacturing and MSMEs.

Way Forward

1. Diversify Revenue: Leverage the coastal economy, aquaculture and IT in Visakhapatnam.
2. Rationalise Committed Spending: Control salary and pension liabilities.
3. Capital Efficiency: Timely execution of Polavaram and port-led corridors.
4. Fiscal Transparency: Monitor off-budget borrowings closely.

Conclusion

The 2020–21 budget reflected welfare ambitions under severe fiscal stress. Strict FRBM discipline and transparency on borrowings are vital. Without these steps, deficits will keep crowding out capital spending.

Only ten minutes today?
Speak an outline. It gets evaluated too.
ghissu.com →

6(a) Analyse trends in rural-urban poverty in Andhra Pradesh. What are the factors responsible for its existence?

10

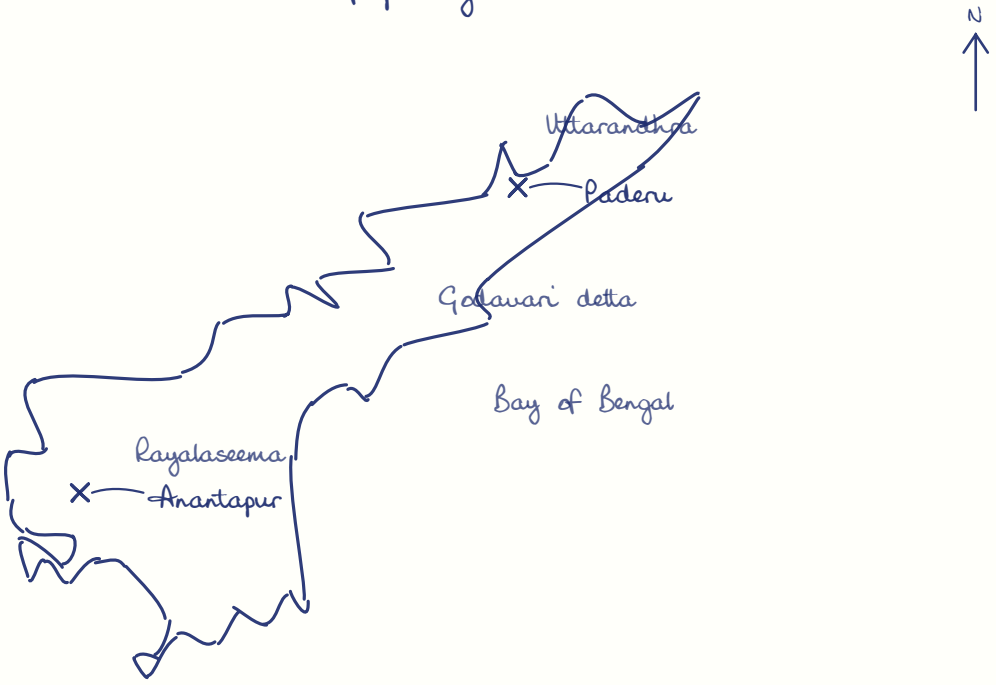
Introduction

Poverty in Andhra Pradesh has fallen steadily, but it remains more rural than urban and is concentrated in drought-prone and tribal regions. Both income poverty and multidimensional poverty show the same pattern.

Trends in Rural and Urban Poverty

1. **Steep decline:** By the Tendulkar method, poverty in undivided Andhra Pradesh fell from 29.9% in 2004-05 to 9.2% in 2011-12.
2. **Rural-urban gap:** Rural poverty fell from 32.3% to 11.0% and urban poverty from 23.4% to 5.8%. By 2011-12, rural poverty was nearly double the urban rate.
3. **Multidimensional poverty:** NITI Aayog's National MPI shows the state's headcount falling from 11.77% (2015-16) to 6.06% (2019-21), with rural deprivation (7.71%) far above urban (2.20%).
4. **Regional pockets:** Poverty clusters in Rayalaseema's dry districts, the north coastal districts and the tribal Agency areas.

Pockets of poverty in Andhra Pradesh



delta districts are better off

Factors Responsible

1. Rain-fed farming: Low and erratic rainfall in Rayalaseema keeps farm incomes low and uncertain.
2. Small holdings and tenancy: Most farmers are marginal, and many tenant cultivators lack access to institutional credit.
3. Indebtedness: The NSS Situation Assessment Survey (2019) found 93.2% of agricultural households in Andhra Pradesh in debt, the highest in India.
4. Tribal exclusion: Poor connectivity, health and schooling deepen deprivation in the Agency

areas.

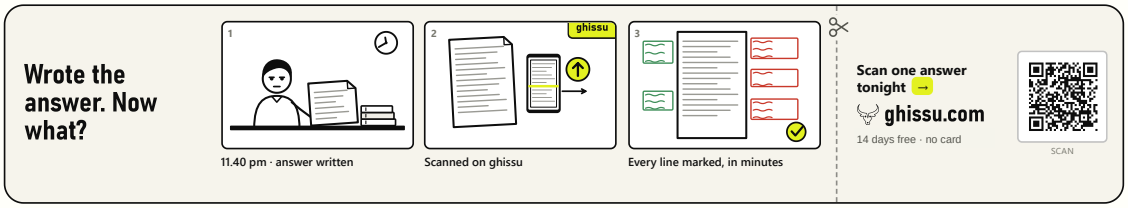
5. Urban informality: Migrants from dry districts crowd into informal, low-wage work and slums in Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada, with little social security.

Way Forward

1. Drought-proofing: Micro-irrigation, watershed works and crop diversification for Rayalaseema.
2. Credit for tenants: Use cultivator rights cards to bring tenant farmers into institutional credit.
3. Targeted support: The state's Zero Poverty P4 initiative links well-off families with the poorest households.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has cut poverty sharply, but rural and regional pockets persist. Region-specific strategies for dry, tribal and urban-informal households are the next step.



6(b) Examine major issues concerning public Distribution System in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The Public Distribution System (PDS) is Andhra Pradesh's main food safety net under the National Food Security Act, 2013. Rice is supplied through fair price shops on QR-coded smart ration cards (issued from August 2025), and free foodgrains continue under PMGKAY. Yet leakages, delivery gaps and nutrition concerns remain.

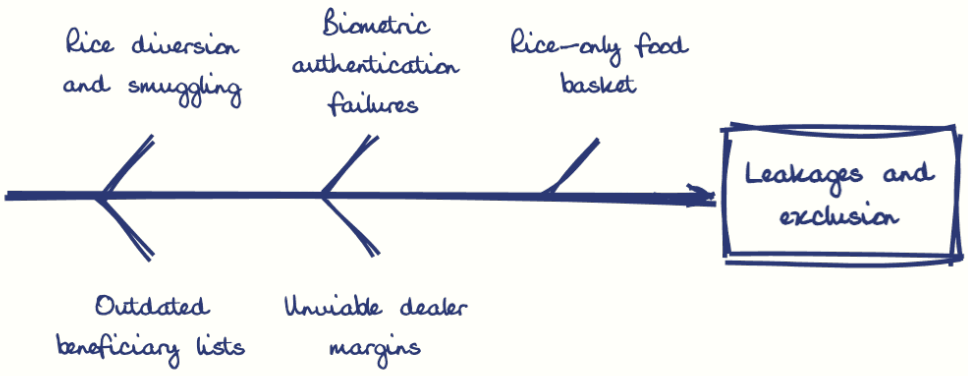
Major Issues

1. **Diversion and smuggling:** PDS rice is resold and exported illegally. In 2024 the state seized PDS rice meant for export at Kakinada port, exposing an organised racket.
2. **Targeting errors:** Eligible households are left out while ineligible ones hold cards, owing to outdated beneficiary data.
3. **Biometric failures:** ePoS authentication often fails for the elderly and manual workers, denying rations at the counter.
4. **Delivery model churn:** Doorstep delivery by Mobile Dispensing Units began in 2021 but the

vans were scrapped in June 2025, as many beneficiaries went unserved and rice was diverted. Ration dealers now deliver at home only to those above 65 and persons with disabilities.

5. Rice-centric basket: The basket is dominated by rice, with little pulse, millet or oil, so it does little for nutritional security.
6. Dealer viability: Low commissions and delayed payments weaken fair price shop dealers, which encourages malpractice.
7. Weak oversight: Vigilance committees and social audits mandated under the NFSA are often irregular, so complaints of short weighing and poor quality go unresolved.

Why PDS in Andhra Pradesh leaks

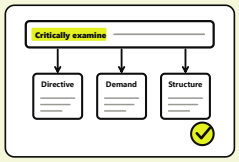


Way Forward

1. End-to-end tracking: GPS-tracked trucks and supply-chain digitisation to stop diversion.
2. Clean the database: Regular e-KYC and grievance redress for excluded families.
3. Diversify the basket: Add millets and pulses, and expand fortified rice.
4. Portability: Wider use of One Nation One Ration Card for migrant workers.
5. Community oversight: Regular social audits and active vigilance committees at every shop.

Conclusion

PDS remains indispensable for food security in Andhra Pradesh. Plugging leakages, accurate targeting and a nutrition-focused basket can turn it from a rice channel into a true safety net.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

7(a) What is e-NAM? State the challenges in its implementation.

10

Introduction

Agriculture employs nearly half of India's workforce but contributes under one-fifth of GVA, so better market access is vital for farm incomes. The National Agriculture Market (e-NAM), launched in 2016, unifies fragmented markets into a single digital platform for better price discovery. By March 2026, over 1.80 crore farmers and 2.73 lakh traders had registered.

What is e-NAM

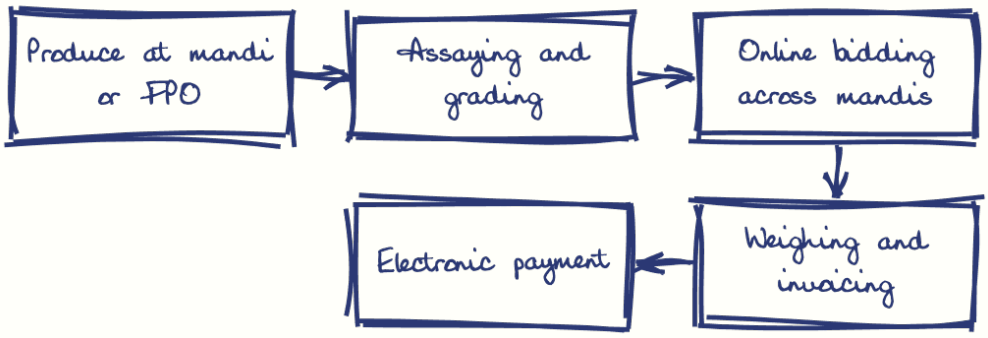
1. **Unified market:** It integrates 1,656 mandis across 23 states and 4 UTs into a pan-India virtual market, letting farmers sell beyond local mandis and raising competition and price realisation.

2. **Legal reforms:** States must amend APMC laws for unified licensing, a single-point market fee and e-auctions, as Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra and Gujarat have done.

3. **Central support:** The Centre gives free software and up to Rs 75 lakh per mandi for IT infrastructure, including assaying and grading, essential for quality-based trading.

4. FPOs: Over 4,700 FPOs are registered, enabling collective bargaining and direct trade from collection centres, which cuts transaction costs.

How e-NAM Works



Challenges in Implementation

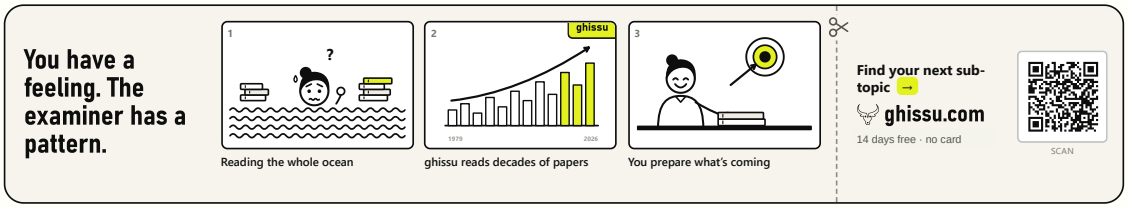
1. Infrastructure gaps: Many mandis lack assaying, grading and cold storage, hurting trade in perishables and farmers' confidence in quality-based pricing.
2. Digital literacy: Many smallholders lack awareness, trust and familiarity with technology, which restricts e-NAM's reach.
3. Regulatory hurdles: West Bengal and Jammu and Kashmir have not amended APMC laws, blocking inter-state trade.
4. Post-auction inefficiencies: Weighing, invoicing, fee collection and payment lack real-time online support, delaying payments.

Way Forward

1. Infrastructure: More assaying labs, cold storage and logistics, especially in AP's horticulture and aquaculture hubs.
2. Farmer outreach: Digital literacy and awareness campaigns to build participation and trust.
3. Uniform rules: All states should adopt the State/UT Agricultural Produce and Livestock Marketing Act, 2017 provisions for inter-state trade.
4. Post-trade systems: Automate post-auction processes with prompt electronic payments.

Conclusion

e-NAM can create a unified, transparent national market with better price discovery. With strong infrastructure and regulatory support it can raise farmer income and support Atmanirbhar Bharat.



7(b) What do you mean by rainbow revolution? What are its objectives? Discuss.

10

Introduction

Indian agriculture must evolve to meet the needs of a growing population and a changing climate. The Rainbow Revolution is a comprehensive strategy to transform agriculture beyond the Green Revolution's focus on food grains, aiming at diversification, commercialisation and sustainability. It suits Andhra Pradesh, whose diverse agro-climatic zones grow chillies, aquaculture and horticulture.

Meaning and Objectives

1. Commercial transformation: It seeks to turn subsistence farming into a commercial enterprise, raising productivity and profit across horticulture, dairy, fisheries and oilseeds, beyond cereals.

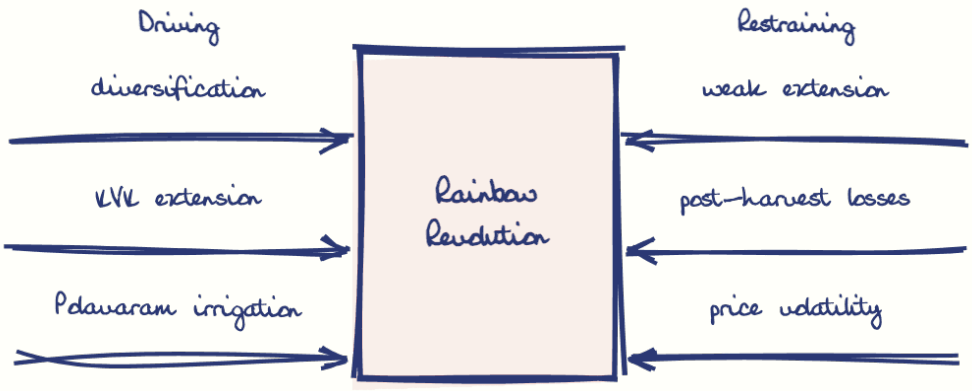
2. Diversification and value addition: It promotes crop diversification, processing and branding, vital for Andhra Pradesh's chilli and aquaculture sectors to reach global markets and earn exports.

3. Research and extension: It intensifies research and dissemination through Krishi Vigyan Kendras, since less than (1%) of farmers use extension services.

4. Irrigation and infrastructure: Completing projects like Polavaram widens irrigated land, enabling multiple

cropping and reducing monsoon dependence.

Rainbow Revolution



Challenges in Implementation

1. **Weak extension:** The collapse of extension services limits technology transfer in rural Andhra Pradesh, hindering modern practices.
2. **Post-harvest gaps:** Lack of cold storage and processing causes losses in perishables like tomatoes and chillies, undermining value addition.
3. **Market volatility:** Fragmented supply chains and price swings hurt horticulture farmers, which the revolution seeks to fix through market integration and export promotion.
4. **Sustainability:** Intensification must avoid groundwater depletion and soil degradation in drought-prone Rayalaseema.

Way Forward

1. Revitalise extension: Strengthen block-level extension with digital technology and training to bridge research and farmers.
2. Cold chains and processing: Invest in cold storage and food processing in key zones to cut losses and add value.
3. Diversification with linkages: Back diversified cropping with assured procurement and export facilitation to stabilise incomes.
4. Sustainable resources: Promote water-saving irrigation and organic farming in Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

The Rainbow Revolution is a holistic transformation aimed at higher farm incomes through diversification, commercialisation and sustainability. Implemented well, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh, it secures food and nutrition security, fosters rural prosperity and supports doubling farmers' income.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

8(a) How has the growth in Andhra Pradesh's agriculture and allied sectors impacted the income levels of the farmers?

10

Introduction

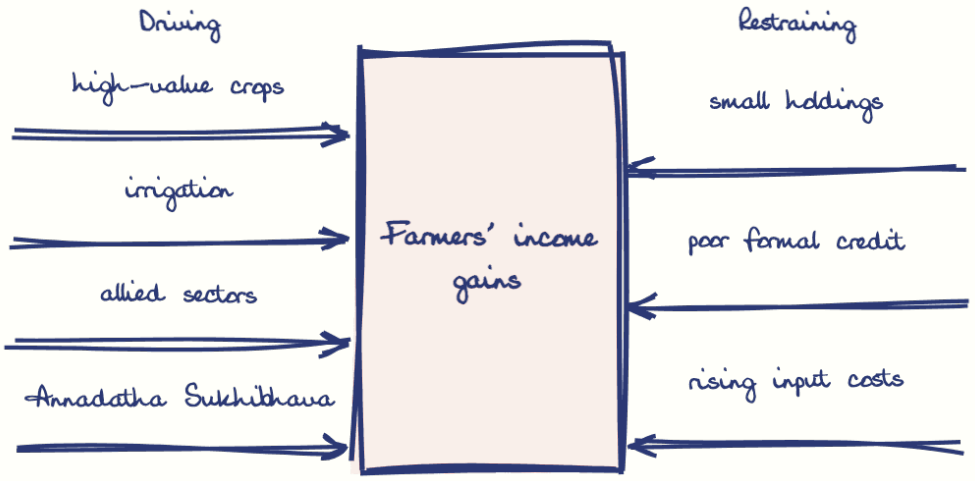
Agriculture and allied sectors are the backbone of Andhra Pradesh's economy, supporting much of its rural population. Their GVA grew at 10.70% in 2024–25, outpacing the national average. Whether this growth lifts farmers' incomes depends on costs, markets and support under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Growth in Agriculture and Allied Sectors

1. **Robust growth:** Sector GVA reached Rs 2.32 lakh crore in 2024–25, significantly above the national average, reflecting higher production and diversification into chillies, horticulture and aquaculture.
2. **Irrigation:** Projects like Polavaram have improved water availability and cropping intensity, especially in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
3. **Technology:** APCNF and soil health cards improved sustainable practices and input efficiency, though extension must reach marginal farmers.
4. **Allied sectors:** Livestock, dairy and fisheries

grew steadily, and the long coastline sustains a thriving aquaculture industry. Food processing, cold chains and RKVY investment add value.

Growth and farmers' income



High-value crops, irrigation and allied activities push incomes up, while small holdings, weak formal credit and rising input costs hold the gains back.

Impact on Farmers' Income

1. Income growth: Per capita income of Rs 2,68,653 in 2024-25, above the national average, reflects the gains, especially where irrigation and allied activities are strong.
2. Diversified, stable income: Allied sectors reduce reliance on crops and cushion crop failures.
3. Persistent disparities: Small holdings, poor formal

credit and rising input costs keep many marginal farmers struggling, like groundnut farmers in Anantapur.

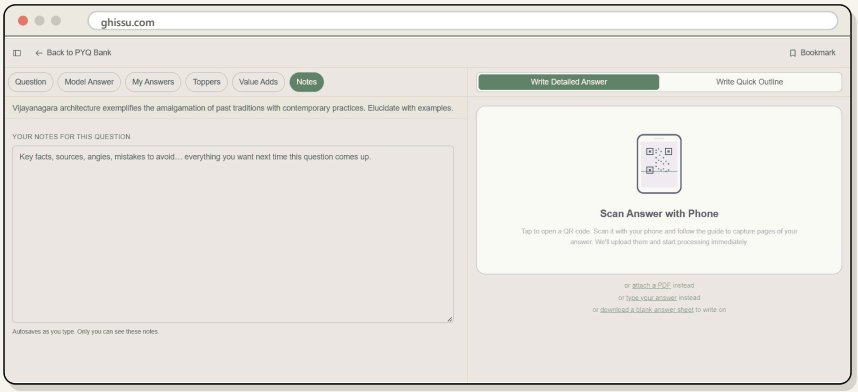
4. Welfare support: Annadatha Sukhibhava and the Crop Cultivators Right Act provide income support and reduce distress.

Conclusion

Sectoral growth has raised farm incomes, but unevenly. Better market access, stronger extension services and climate-resilient practices are needed to protect farmers from environmental and economic shocks, so that growth turns into inclusive income gains.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP NOTES THAT LIVE WITH THE QUESTION

Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?



1 A notes tab beside every question.

2 Note from model answers, toppers and exam-hall thinking.

3 Autosaves — and rolls up into chapter notes.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

8(b) Give an account of the different schemes implemented by the Andhra Pradesh government to promote agriculture in the state?

10

Introduction

Agriculture is a cornerstone of Andhra Pradesh's economy, contributing significantly to GVA and employing a large share of people. With agriculture and allied GVA growing at 10.7% in 2024–25 and a focus on doubling farmer incomes, the government runs several schemes to raise productivity, sustainability and welfare amid water scarcity, climate variability and weak market access.

Major Schemes

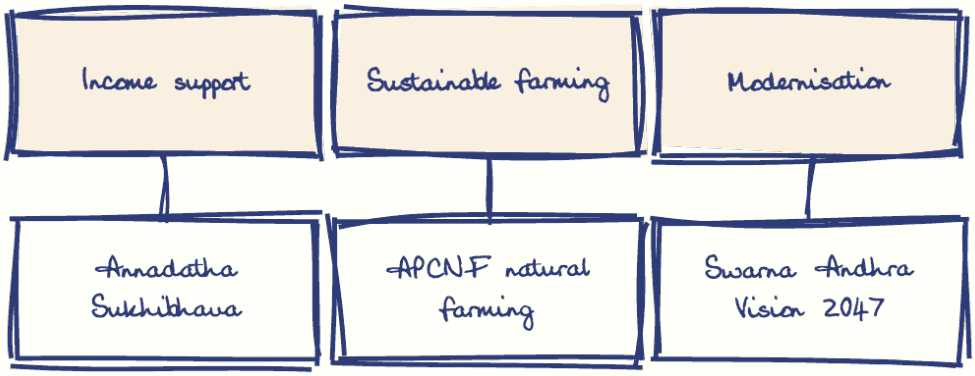
1. **Annadatha Sukhibhava Scheme:** This flagship welfare scheme gives direct income support to land-owning farmers to raise income and reduce indebtedness.

2. **AP Community Managed Natural Farming:** APCNF promotes zero-budget natural farming techniques, reducing input costs and improving soil health.

3. **Swarna Andhra Vision 2047:** This long-term strategy integrates agricultural modernisation with technology, infrastructure and market reforms, aiming to double farmer incomes by 2047 through

productivity, diversification and value addition.

AP schemes for agriculture



How They Promote Agriculture

1. Income security: Direct support reduces vulnerability to market and climatic shocks and helps farmers invest in quality inputs and technology.
2. Sustainable farming: APCNF lowers chemical dependence and production costs while restoring soil fertility, which is crucial for drought-prone areas.
3. Modernisation and markets: Precision agriculture and digital platforms improve access to seeds, credit and markets, helping farmers move from subsistence to commercial farming.

Way Forward

1. Include tenants: Extend income support to tenant

farmers and sharecroppers excluded for lack of land records.

2. Water management: Invest in micro-irrigation, rainwater harvesting and watershed development in Rayalaseema.
3. Digital markets: Promote e-NAM for better price discovery and fewer intermediaries.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's schemes combine income support, natural farming and modernisation to make agriculture sustainable and profitable. This integrated approach is paving the way for doubling farmer incomes and food security, in line with SDG (2) of ending hunger and promoting sustainable agriculture.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON ANSWER EVALUATION

Mark your own answer in four checks

Before you ask anyone for feedback, run these four checks. Most lost marks hide in one of them.

1. **Demand** — Does your first line answer what the directive asks — not just the topic?
2. **Dimensions** — At least three: social, economic, political, ethical, environmental...
3. **Evidence** — One fact, report, case or number in every paragraph.
4. **Verdict** — Does the conclusion add a way forward, or only repeat the body?

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Or upload the answer: ghissu marks all four, line by line, on your own sheet.



Scan one answer tonight →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

9(a) Contrast the Industrial Policy of 1980 with that of 1991 with respect to small enterprises in India.

10

Introduction

The industrial policies of (1980) and (1991) mark two distinct phases for small enterprises. The (1980) policy continued the mixed economy model with protection for small-scale industries as sources of jobs and rural development. The (1991) policy, born of a balance of payments crisis, shifted the focus to competitiveness and liberalisation.

Industrial Policy 1980 vs 1991 on Small Enterprises

Industrial Policy 1980	Industrial Policy 1991
Protective regulation	Market liberalization
Investment limits raised modestly	Investment limits expanded significantly
Reservation and subsidies	Fewer reserved items, subsidies
Decentralisation, public sector support	Competitiveness, technology upgradation

Contrast in Policy Orientation

1. Regulation: (1980) kept a protective framework with reservation of products and concessional credit, (1991) reduced reservations and subsidies,

integrating units into competitive markets.

2. Investment ceilings: 1980 raised limits modestly; 1991 expanded them to allow growth and scale.
3. Institutional support: 1980 relied on District Industry Centres and public sector support; 1991 improved access to technology, finance and marketing.
4. Public sector role: 1991 cut direct government intervention, promoting private-led growth.

Contrast in Outcomes

1. Efficiency: Protection helped units survive but left many technologically backward.
2. Competition: Post-1991 exposure forced upgrading, though weak infrastructure and credit hurt many, including in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Finance: Concessional lending gave way to market-based finance, hard for units lacking collateral.
4. Exports: 1991 pushed quality and export markets, unlike 1980's inward focus on domestic self-sufficiency.
5. Reservation: 1980 reserved many items for small industry; 1991 progressively de-reserved them to raise competitiveness.

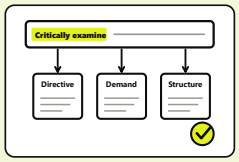
6. Regional development: 1991's market orientation needs regional infrastructure still lacking in Rayalaseema.

Way Forward

1. Credit guarantees: In Andhra Pradesh, bridge the gap left by withdrawn concessional lending.
2. Technology: Support technology transfer and digital infrastructure.
3. Revitalise DICs: Modernise District Industry Centres.

Conclusion

India moved from sheltering small enterprises to making them competitive. Credit, technology and institutional support must now help them succeed in open markets.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 9(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

Scan to practice

9(b) Critically Examine the performance of public sector in Indian economy.

10

Introduction

With GVA growth around 6.4% in FY24 and budgets stressing capital expenditure, the role of the public sector remains a critical debate. Despite liberalisation, public enterprises stay pivotal in strategic industries and infrastructure, including in Andhra Pradesh. A critical assessment shows strong strategic gains alongside persistent inefficiency.

Achievements

1. Strategic industrial base: PSUs built steel, coal and defence capacity for self-reliance. Defence production reached Rs 1.27 lakh crore in FY 2023-24, and exports Rs 23,622 crore in FY 2024-25.
2. Infrastructure and regional balance: PSUs develop backward regions; the Polavaram irrigation project shows their role in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Fiscal and forex gains: Coal PSUs raised output to 1047.57 MT in FY 2024-25, cutting imports.
4. Social equity: As countervailing powers to private monopolies, PSUs stabilise prices and supply essentials.

Public sector: record

Achievements	Shortcomings
Steel, coal, defence base	Low capacity use, overstaffing
Coal output cuts imports	Losses need budget support
Check on private monopolies	SPSE accounts in arrears
Backward-region development	Bureaucratic control

Shortcomings

1. Inefficiency and losses: Low capacity use, overstaffing and social obligations cause losses that need budget support.
2. State-level governance: In Andhra Pradesh, (90) of (103) working SPSEs had arrears in accounts, and power PSUs reported accumulated losses of Rs (2,247 crore) in FY 2024-25, though SPSEs formed (6.69%) of GSDP in 2022-23 with a turnover of Rs (88,176.83 crore).
3. Bureaucratic control: Lack of clear delegation hampers efficiency, though (47) of (125) Central PSEs were rated excellent in 2008-09.

Way Forward

1. Autonomy with accountability: Clear benchmarks

and stronger oversight, learning from CAG audits.

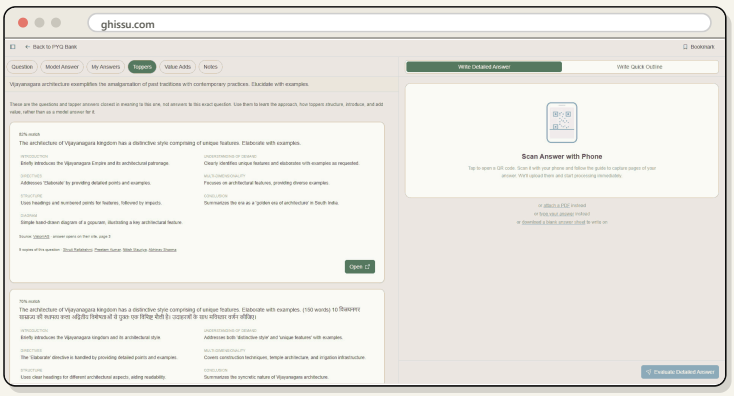
2. Professional management: Recruit professionals and curb bureaucratic interference.
3. Targeted disinvestment: Sell non-strategic PSUs and use PPP models.

Conclusion

The public sector has served strategic and social goals, but losses and weak governance limit it. Autonomy and professional management can raise its efficiency.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

Forty PDFs, and still no topper copy for this question?



See how toppers wrote it →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 Topper answers matched by meaning to this exact question.

2 Each broken down: introduction, directives, structure.

3 Searched from 1.5 lakh+ topper answers.

10(a) What are the critical issues that must be addressed before implementing disinvestment policy?

10

Introduction

Disinvestment has been part of India's reforms since 1991, aimed at improving public sector efficiency and mobilising resources. With the Union Budget 2025–26 stressing asset monetisation under the National Monetisation Pipeline 2.0, critical issues must be settled first. In Andhra Pradesh, where public enterprises and the Visakhapatnam port matter, fiscal needs must be balanced with stability.

Governance and Institutional Issues

1. Clear roles: DIPAM, NITI Aayog and the Core Group of Secretaries need defined roles and coordination with ministries and states.
2. Regulatory framework: Compliance with the Depositories Act (1996) and board reforms of the Kotak Committee (2017) sustain investor confidence.
3. Parliamentary oversight: Committees must enforce time-bound sales, as fertiliser PSU delays exceed seven years, hurting Andhra Pradesh's farm economy.
4. Fair valuation: Transparent, market-driven pricing prevents undervaluation and loss of public assets.

Socio-Economic Issues

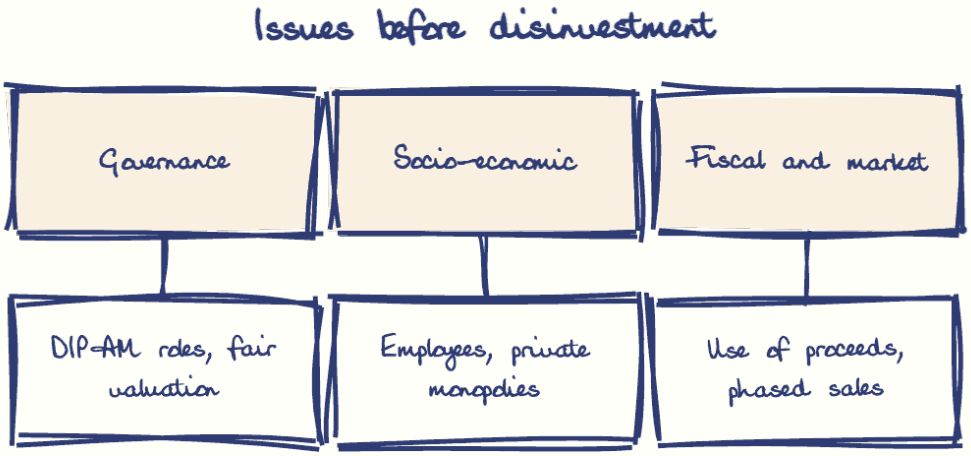
1. Employee interests: Safety nets and voluntary separation schemes for large older workforces.
2. Private monopolies: Sales must not replace public with private monopolies, a risk George Fernandes highlighted.
3. Use of proceeds: Channel funds into projects like Polavaram, not just deficit plugging.
4. Centre-state coordination: Align sales with regional priorities.

Fiscal and Market Issues

1. Fiscal strategy: Fit disinvestment into fiscal consolidation, mindful of Andhra Pradesh's revenue-deficit grant demands.
2. Market readiness: Better PSU governance attracts quality investors.
3. Phased monetisation: Sell assets such as Visakhapatnam port gradually to maximise value.
4. Insolvency law: Stronger IBC provisions ease resolution of stressed PSUs.

Way Forward

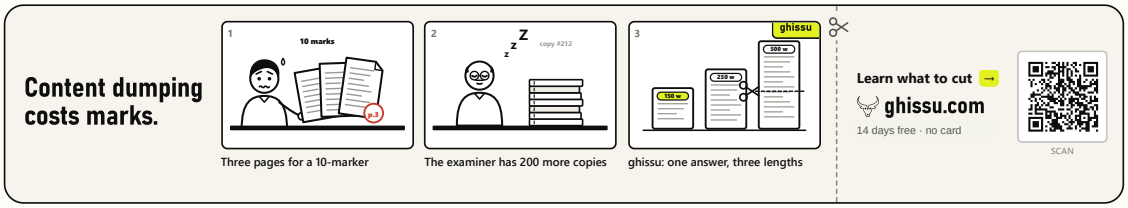
1. Institutional capacity: Strengthen DIPAM and state coordination with clear timelines and accountability.



2. Benchmarked valuation: Adopt international standards and involve independent experts for fair pricing.
3. Social safeguards: Plan employee transitions and social security for large PSU workforces.
4. Development use: Invest proceeds in infrastructure and social sectors for regional equity.

Conclusion

Settling these issues first ensures disinvestment raises efficiency without compromising welfare or regional development.



10(b) What are the challenges faced by the industrial sector of Andhra Pradesh? Throw light on the strategies created to face these challenges.

10

Introduction

Indian industry is in a critical phase of seeking sustainable growth amid environmental concerns and supply chain realignments. Andhra Pradesh, with its coastal location and mineral wealth, grew at 9.24% in 2024–25, but its industrial sector faces multifaceted challenges that must be addressed for inclusive growth under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Governance and Institutional Challenges

1. **Weak SPSE governance:** The state's 124 SPSEs face governance issues and arrears, hurting efficiency and the investment climate.
2. **Mineral revenue shortfall:** Despite holding 86.11% of India's barytes, the state had a 16% shortfall in mineral revenue in 2021–22.
3. **Weak environmental infrastructure:** Only 4 of 123 ULBs had operational sanitary landfills in 2022.
4. **Monitoring gaps:** Without robust pollution monitoring for industrial parks, environmental standards are hard to enforce.

Operational Challenges

1. Power deficit: Power shortages and high costs constrain manufacturing competitiveness and cluster development.
2. Limited exporters: Despite exports of over US$19 billion in FY22, many manufacturers lack IEC registration.
3. Skill and technology gaps: Inadequate skilled labour and low R&D slow innovation and adoption of Industry 4.0 technologies.
4. Resource constraints: Water scarcity forced a Visakhapatnam steel plant to run at reduced capacity.

Strategies to Face the Challenges

1. Sustainable industrial parks: Eco-industrial parks with effluent treatment, drawing on Telangana's Jadcherla park.
2. Ease of doing business: Single-window clearance, digitisation and interest subvention for GST-registered firms to reduce compliance burdens and attract investment.
3. Exporter capacity building: Trade fairs, workshops and certification agencies to add exporters and raise quality standards.

4. Skills and R&D: Industry–academia collaboration, vocational training and R&D incentives.
5. Institutional oversight: SPSE governance reforms and transparent, accountable mineral revenue collection.
6. Resource management: Integrated water and waste management in industrial zones to avoid disruptions.

Challenges and strategies

Challenge	Strategy
Weak SPSE governance	SPSE reform, mineral revenue
Few IEC exporters	Trade fairs, certification
Skill and R&D gaps	Industry–academia links
Water scarcity	Integrated water management
Weak pollution monitoring	Eco-industrial parks

Conclusion

Overcoming institutional, infrastructural and environmental challenges is essential to unlock the sector's potential. Sustainable policies and ease of doing business can deliver inclusive industrial growth.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

11(a) Describe some of the key initiatives taken and incentives provided by the government of Andhra Pradesh to promote agro and food processing industry.

10

Introduction

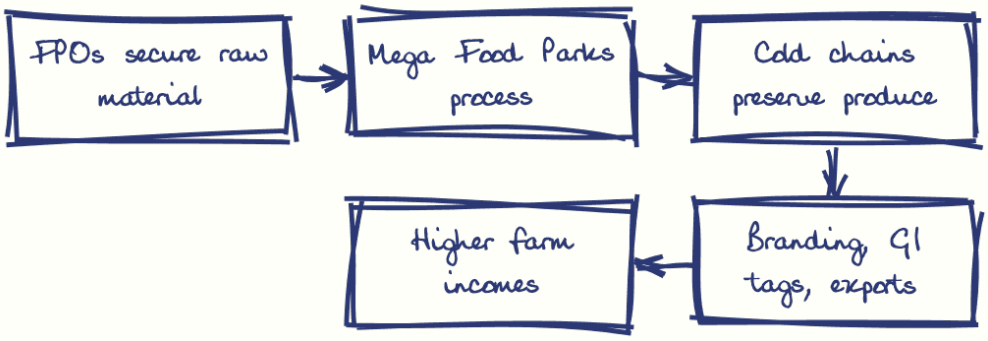
The agro and food processing industry is a key driver of growth, employment and rural development. With agriculture and allied GVA growing at 10.70% in 2024–25 and GSDP at 9.24%, Andhra Pradesh is using its rich farm base, long coastline and industrial corridors to boost agro-processing and value addition.

Key Initiatives

1. Mega Food Parks: World-class infrastructure integrates farmers, processors and markets, reducing post-harvest losses and improving the supply chain from farm to market.
2. Farmer Producer Organisations: FPOs aggregate small farmers, improve bargaining power and link them directly with processing units, ensuring steady raw material supply.
3. Abattairs and cold chain: Modernised abattairs, cold storage and refrigerated transport reduce wastage and raise quality for domestic and export markets.
4. National schemes: PMKSY and PLISFPI support

infrastructure, technology adoption and market promotion, with several projects sanctioned by 2024.

From farm to market



Incentives Provided

1. Financial support: Credit-linked subsidies and grants for processing units, cold chains and common facilities, with special focus on FPOs, cooperatives and self-help groups.
2. Fiscal concessions: Exemptions on stamp duty, electricity tariffs and land allotment charges reduce costs and attract private investment.
3. Single-window clearance: Streamlined procedures and single-window systems speed up approvals and reduce bureaucratic delays for agro enterprises.
4. Market and branding support: Financial aid for trade fairs, branding and export promotion, and GI tags for unique local products, widening

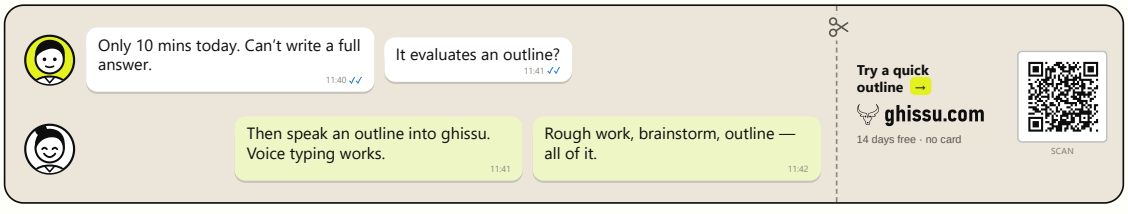
markets for processed goods.

Way Forward

1. Connectivity: Strengthen logistics linking production clusters with ports like Visakhapatnam to cut transit time and cost.
2. Technology: Help small and medium units adopt advanced processing technologies and digital tools.
3. Skills: Train rural youth in food processing and allied sectors.
4. Linkages: Promote contract farming and direct procurement for assured supply and fair prices.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's initiatives and incentives leverage its agricultural strengths to raise rural employment and farmers' incomes and cut post-harvest losses. A vibrant agro-processing ecosystem advances Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 and SDG 8.



11(b) Explain the Marginal Cost Pricing Rule for Public Utilities. What are the problems associated with this rule?

10

Introduction

The Marginal Cost Pricing Rule sets the price of a public utility service equal to the additional cost of producing one more unit. It is applied in electricity, water and transport, where public utilities often operate as natural monopolies. For Andhra Pradesh, with its Visakhapatnam port-led industrial corridor and ongoing power sector reforms, the rule matters for efficient resource allocation, though it faces serious practical problems.

The Rule Explained

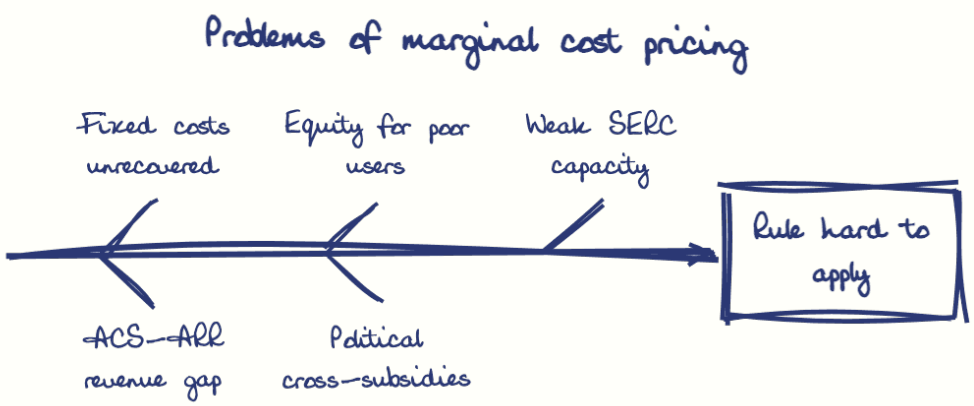
1. Allocative efficiency: When price equals marginal cost, consumers pay exactly the cost their extra use imposes, so resources are allocated efficiently.
2. Cost-reflective tariffs: The Electricity (Amendment) Bill, 2025 promotes cost-reflective tariffs and empowers SERCs to set prices closer to marginal costs.

Practice 11(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2020 · Paper IV

Scan to practice

Problems Associated with the Rule

1. **Fixed cost recovery:** Marginal cost covers mainly variable costs, while utilities carry large fixed costs such as infrastructure maintenance and loan repayments. This mismatch disrupts cash flows and hinders investment in capacity.
2. **Revenue gap:** The average cost of supply often exceeds average revenue, and this ~~ACS–ARR gap~~ stresses DISCOMs, making strict marginal cost pricing unsustainable.
3. **Equity concerns:** Marginal cost tariffs may raise bills for low-income consumers, a worry for Andhra Pradesh's rural and agrarian population that depends on subsidised power.
4. **Political economy:** Pressure to give free power to farmers distorts tariffs and sustains cross-subsidies that obscure true cost signals.
5. **Learning effects ignored:** The rule ignores costs that fall over time through learning by doing, discouraging early investment in renewables.
6. **Weak regulatory capacity:** SERCs face staff shortages and data gaps, overlapping central and state jurisdiction, and weak enforcement, with RPO penalties rarely imposed.



Way Forward

1. Strengthen SERCs: Ensure stable leadership, adequate staff and clear jurisdiction.
2. Gradual reform: Move to marginal cost pricing in phases, protecting vulnerable consumers through targeted subsidies.

Conclusion

Marginal cost pricing is sound in theory, but for public utilities it works only when cost recovery, equity and regulatory capacity are balanced together.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

12(a) In the light of the problems faced by public-private partnerships in India, give recommendations on the future plan of action.

10

Introduction

Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs) have been a key strategy for infrastructure under fiscal constraints. After early success in roads and ports, their momentum has slowed due to institutional and implementation problems. With investment targets rising sharply, the PPP framework needs rethinking.

Problems Faced by PPPs

1. Policy gaps: The absence of a unified, transparent policy has led to delays and disputes; governance issues in Andhra Pradesh's SPSEs, which form 6.69% of GSDP, show the need for streamlined oversight.
2. Weak capacity: Many public agencies lack the technical and managerial skills to design and monitor PPP contracts, weakening appraisal and risk management.
3. Poor risk allocation: Without clear risk-sharing between public and private partners, risks fall on those least able to manage them, and projects fail.
4. Unviable business models: Many projects fail because revenue streams are unclear or unstable,

so private partners cannot recover costs.

5. Delays in approvals: Delays in land acquisition and regulatory clearances have stalled projects in Andhra Pradesh and elsewhere.
6. Social concerns: Projects involving displacement or environmental impact face resistance when communities are not engaged.

Recommendations for the Future

1. Institutionalise best practices: Codify successful models and risk-sharing frameworks in state law.
2. Dedicated PPP cells: Trained professionals in Andhra Pradesh's departments for appraisal and risk management.
3. Balanced risks: As in roads, government should bear land and regulatory risk while private partners handle construction and maintenance.
4. Finance: Use IIFCL, state infrastructure funds and Viability Gap Funding, especially for irrigation and urban infrastructure.
5. Faster clearances: Digital platforms and single-window systems.
6. Digital monitoring: PRAGATI and the National e-Governance Plan for real-time oversight.

7. Capacity building: Regular training for public officials and private partners in contract management and dispute resolution.

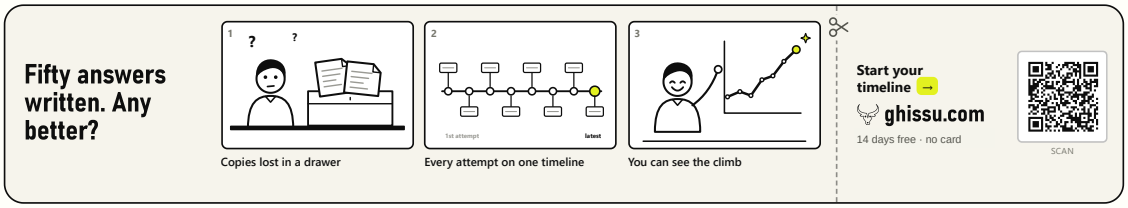
8. Viable models: Design projects with assured revenue streams and stronger social safeguards.

PPP problems and the plan of action

Problem	Recommendation
Policy gaps	Codify best practices
Weak capacity	Dedicated PPP cells
Poor risk allocation	Government bears land risk
Unviable models	Assured revenue streams
Approval delays	Single-window clearances

Conclusion

Reviving PPPs in India and Andhra Pradesh needs stronger institutions, clear financial and risk frameworks and technology for transparency. Done well, PPPs can speed infrastructure, improve services and deliver inclusive growth in line with Viksit Bharat 2047.



12(b) Describe the long term agenda of the Andhra Pradesh government with respect to development of infrastructure in the state.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's long-term infrastructure agenda is critical given its rapid growth, with a projected GSDP of Rs 19.75 lakh crore for 2026-27. The government aims to build physical and digital infrastructure for industry, agriculture and urbanisation, shaped by post-bifurcation needs such as a new capital and better connectivity.

Key infrastructure priorities of Andhra Pradesh



Irrigation lifeline, port corridor and lagging region

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Key Components of the Agenda

1. **Capital investment:** Special assistance of Rs 15,000 crore this year through multilateral agencies compensates for the loss of Hyderabad.
2. **Polavaram project:** Early completion of this lifeline will enhance irrigation and food security.
3. **Industrial corridors:** Nodes at Kopparthy on the Vishakhapatnam–Chennai corridor and Orvakal on the Hyderabad–Bengaluru corridor promote industry and jobs.
4. **Integrated governance:** Vision 2029 links infrastructure with SDGs for coordinated, real-time governance.

Priority Sectors

1. **Transport:** Cement concrete roads under MGNREGA synergy and rail and port links using the 974 km coastline.
2. **Energy:** Investment in power generation and distribution, with state power SPSEs contributing significantly to the economy.
3. **Digital:** Real-time tools like the CM Office's water dashboard and e-Seva improve services.
4. **Water:** Groundwater recharge and data-driven farm advisories address scarcity.

5. Ports and logistics: Aligned with Maritime India Vision 2030 to raise export competitiveness.

Alignment with Development Goals

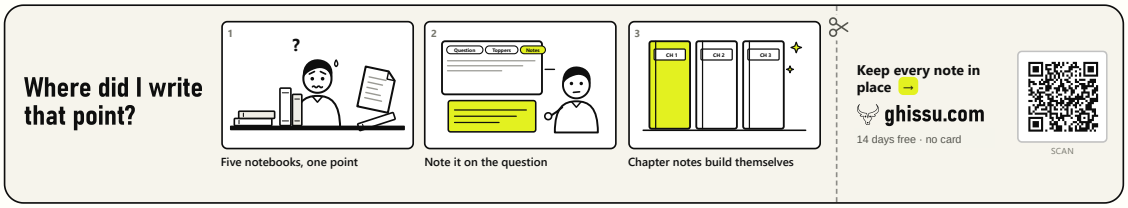
1. Inclusive growth: The agenda serves Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, targeting Rayalaseema and tribal areas.
2. Post-bifurcation recovery: New economic hubs offset the loss of Hyderabad.

Way Forward

1. Stronger PPPs: Improve risk-sharing to mobilise private investment and speed up execution.
2. Climate resilience: Build climate-resilient infrastructure, especially in water and energy.
3. Capex discipline: Prioritise capital spending to finish key projects on time.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's agenda is a comprehensive effort to build resilient, inclusive infrastructure that turns its post-bifurcation challenges into growth.



13(a) Discuss the initiatives taken by the Government of India to build smart cities, and highlight the challenges in doing so.

10

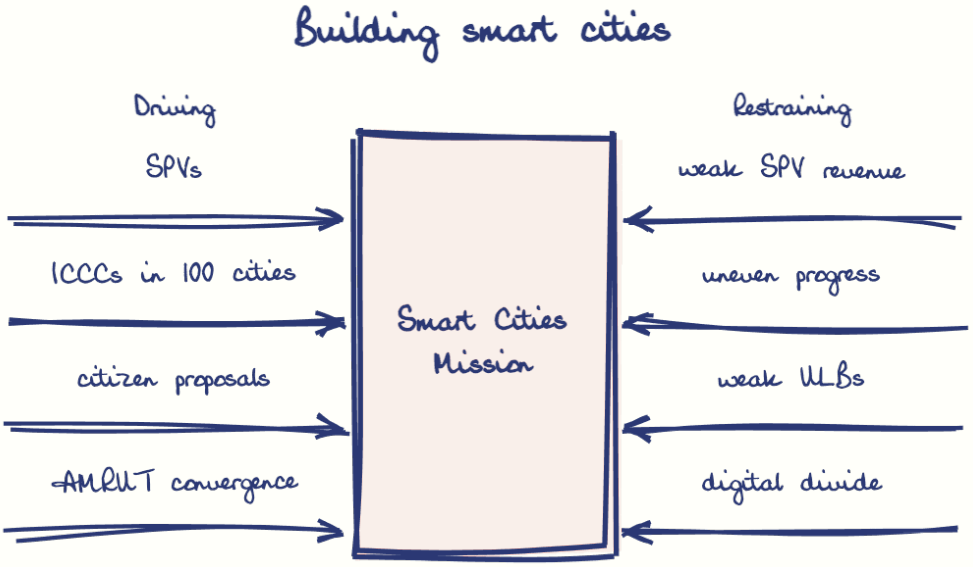
Introduction

India is urbanising rapidly: satellite data show nearly 45% of the population in urban areas, expected to reach 60% by 2050. This brings growth opportunities along with congestion, pollution and weak infrastructure. The Smart Cities Mission aims to transform 100 cities into hubs of sustainable development through technology and urban renewal.

Initiatives Taken by the Government

1. Special Purpose Vehicles: Each city has an SPV to plan, appraise, approve and implement projects, ensuring local accountability.
2. Convergence with schemes: The mission complements AMRUT and the Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme.
3. Citizen participation: Citizens, experts and stakeholders help prepare Smart City Proposals.
4. Technology adoption: All 100 cities have Integrated Command and Control Centres using AI and IoT for real-time monitoring.

5. Utilities and mobility: Smart meters cut leakages, while smart roads, cycle tracks and public transport integration ease congestion.



Challenges

1. Revenue generation: Many SPVs cannot raise funds beyond government grants, threatening long-term viability.
2. Uneven outcomes: Though 94% of projects are complete, some cities report slow progress and underuse of funds.
3. Weak municipal capacity: In Andhra Pradesh, the CAG found poor solid waste compliance in 82 of 123 ULBs, and only 46% of collected waste is processed.
4. Social inclusion: Benefits often favour the

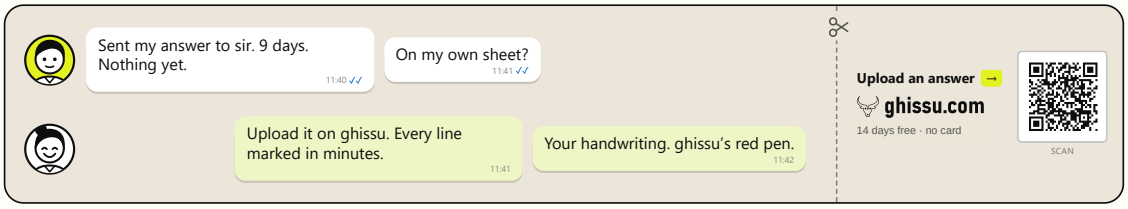
affluent, neglecting informal settlements, and the digital divide limits access.

Way Forward

1. Local revenue: Municipal bonds, land monetisation and PPPs suited to local resource potential.
2. ULB capacity: Targeted training and institutional reforms in planning, financial management and service delivery.
3. Inclusive plans: Explicitly address informal settlements, migrant workers and vulnerable groups.
4. Technology for sustainability: Use AI, IoT and data analytics for resource management and disaster resilience.

Conclusion

The mission harnesses technology and participatory governance for sustainable cities. Addressing institutional and social gaps can make it deliver inclusive growth in line with Viksit Bharat 2047.



13(b) Discuss the Industrial Policy statement 2015-20 of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The Industrial Policy Statement 2015–20 of Andhra Pradesh was formulated after the 2014 bifurcation, when the state urgently needed to rebuild its industrial landscape. It aimed to accelerate manufacturing, generate employment and enhance competitiveness by using the long coastline and port infrastructure.

Key Features of the Policy

1. Vision and objectives: Raise the manufacturing share of GDP, create jobs and promote export-oriented industrialisation to make the state a manufacturing hub in South India.
2. APIIC and industrial parks: APIIC was the nodal agency for parks with common facilities, with mandatory Environmental Impact Assessments before land allotment.
3. Incentive structure: Subsidies on power and interest and stamp duty exemptions attracted MSMEs and large units, focusing on electronics, pharmaceuticals and agro-processing.
4. Sustainability integration: Energy and water conservation, renewable energy and pollution control

were mandated within clusters, promoting green industrial growth.

Implementation Challenges

1. Infrastructure gaps: Despite port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam-Chennai, logistics inefficiency and power deficits constrained growth.
2. Skill mismatch: Despite the job target, structural unemployment from skill mismatches calls for stronger links between industry needs and vocational training.
3. Weak monitoring: Inconsistent enforcement and capacity constraints in regulators limited environmental gains.
4. Fiscal stress: A revenue deficit of 1.8% of GSDP in 2025-26 and SPSE governance issues delayed incentives, hurting investor confidence.

Pdicy design vs implementation

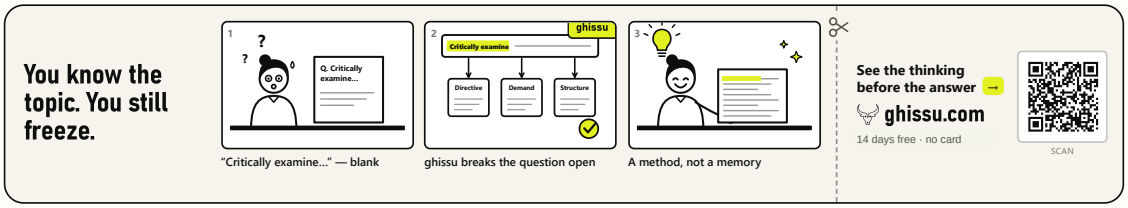
Pdicy design	Implementation
Export-oriented manufacturing hub	Logistics and power deficits
Job creation target	Skill mismatch
Green clusters, EIA	Weak regulatory monitoring
Power, interest subsidies	Fiscal stress delays incentives

Way Forward

1. Infrastructure: Upgrade power supply, transport connectivity and digital infrastructure in clusters to improve ease of doing business and attract higher FDI.
2. Skills: Align industrial policy with targeted skill development to reduce structural unemployment.
3. Environmental governance: Build capacity in regulators for stricter enforcement and reward cleaner technologies through fiscal incentives.
4. Fiscal prudence: Streamline fiscal management for timely incentive payments and improve SPSE governance to build investor trust.

Conclusion

The policy laid a foundational framework balancing economic expansion with sustainability. Its effective implementation, in line with SDG (8) and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, can make Andhra Pradesh a competitive manufacturing hub.



14(a) What are the challenges faced by energy sector in Andhra Pradesh? Briefly give the vision targets for energy sector set by the AP Government.

10

Introduction

The energy sector is critical to Andhra Pradesh's growth, projected at 9.24% for 2024–25 with a GSDP of 8.73 lakh crore. Industrialisation, urbanisation and agriculture all need reliable, affordable power, but the state faces challenges in infrastructure, utility finances and renewable integration. Its vision targets seek to address these in line with national clean energy goals.

Challenges Faced by the Energy Sector

1. **Financial stress on DISCOMs:** High revenue deficits and delayed tariff revisions constrain investment in upgrades and renewable integration.
2. **Grid integration issues:** Solar and wind potential is large but dispersed, and the lack of a smart transmission network limits evacuation, causing grid instability and curtailment of clean energy.
3. **Regulatory and policy gaps:** Despite progressive V2G and time-of-use tariffs for e-mobility, gaps in clarity, approvals and funding slow EV and renewable projects.

4. Fossil fuel dependence: Heavy reliance on conventional sources, with limited local fuel, exposes the state to price volatility and energy security risks.

Vision Targets of the AP Government

1. Renewables and clean mobility: Become a renewable leader through solar, wind and bioenergy, with model electric mobility cities, battery swapping stations and special EV charging tariffs.
2. 24x7 access: 24x7 power supply for all households and industries, with tariff rationalisation to improve DISCOM health and cut losses.
3. Smart grid modernisation: Upgraded transmission and distribution, simpler procedures and incentives for private investment.
4. Sustainable, inclusive energy: Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 treats clean energy transition, efficiency and equitable rural–urban access as a pillar.

Way Forward

1. DISCOM reform: Cut deficits and improve tariff structures.

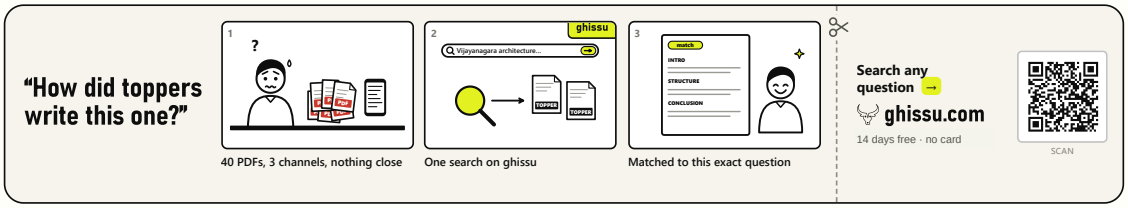
Energy challenges and vision targets

Challenge	Vision target
DISCOM financial stress	24x7 power, tariff rationalisation
Weak grid integration	Smart grid modernisation
Unclear EV rules	Model e-mobility cities
Fossil fuel dependence	Renewable energy leadership

2. Transmission and storage: Expand networks to harness renewables.
3. Clear EV rules: Streamline approvals and create funding channels.
4. PPPs: Transparent PPP models to mobilise private capital and technical expertise for sustainable energy.

Conclusion

Addressing financial, infrastructural and regulatory gaps will help Andhra Pradesh achieve clean, reliable and affordable energy, advancing SDG (7) and inclusive growth.



14(b) Discuss about some of the major initiatives highlighted in Vision 2020 for the development of agriculture sector in India.

10

Introduction

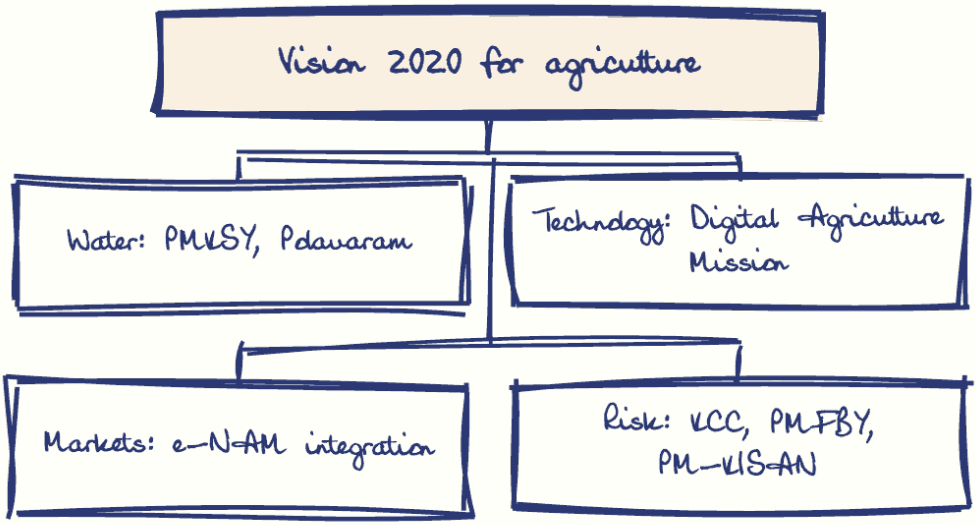
Agriculture supports about 42.3% of India's population and contributes 18.2% to GDP at current prices. Despite growth in production, resource degradation, climate change and low productivity persist. Vision 2020 for agriculture was framed to raise productivity and sustainability and to double farmers' income, in line with becoming a developed nation by 2047.

Major Initiatives

1. Infrastructure and water: PMKSY aims to improve irrigation efficiency and coverage. The Polavaram Project in Andhra Pradesh exemplifies large-scale irrigation, though slow rehabilitation of displaced families shows implementation gaps.
2. Research and technology: The vision promotes biotechnology, molecular biology and digital tools, with the Digital Agriculture Mission enabling precision farming.
3. Market reforms: It moves from produce marketing committees to grading, branding, packaging and market integration, with e-NAM offering unified

access; Andhra Pradesh has integrated multiple mandis into it.

4. Financial support and risk management: Kisan Credit Cards, PM-FBY crop insurance and PM-KISAN income support reduce exposure to market and climatic risks.



Contribution to Development

1. Productivity: Wider irrigation reduced dependence on erratic monsoons and helped record foodgrain production, though groundwater depletion remains a concern.

2. Technology-driven growth: Precision agriculture cuts input costs, raises yields and supports climate-resilient farming.

3. Market efficiency: Reforms improved price discovery and reduced intermediaries, raising farmers' share of consumer prices.
4. Risk mitigation: Credit and insurance let farmers invest in modern inputs while cushioning crop failures, and direct income support gives a safety net.

Way Forward

1. Faster project delivery: Speed up rehabilitation and land acquisition in projects like Polavaram for timely irrigation benefits.
2. Digital outreach: Expand farmer training under the Digital Agriculture Mission in rural areas.
3. Sustainability and linkages: Scale up the National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture for soil and water, and support FPOs for aggregation, branding and exports.

Conclusion

Vision 2020 laid a strong foundation for productive, sustainable agriculture. Fully realised, it will secure food and nutrition, advance India's 2047 goal and serve SDG 2 of ending hunger.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
ghissu.com →

15(a) Give an account of the objectives of Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) and the benefits received under this scheme.

10

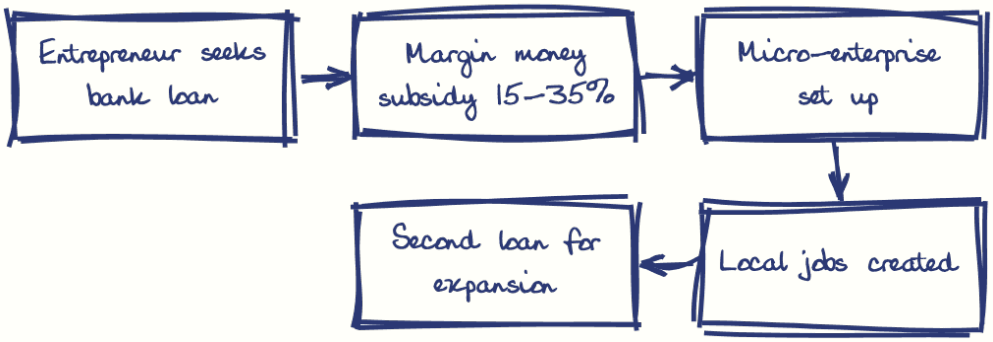
Introduction

India's demographic dividend makes sustainable employment a policy priority. The Prime Minister Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP), launched in 2008–09, addresses unemployment by fostering micro-enterprises in the non-farm sector, especially among traditional artisans and unemployed youth. It suits Andhra Pradesh, where rural jobs are vital for balanced growth.

Objectives of PMEGP

1. Micro-enterprise development: Create self-employment in manufacturing and services, reducing dependence on wage employment and fostering entrepreneurship.
2. Rural and urban employment: About 80% of units are in rural areas, reducing regional disparities in jobs.
3. Marginalised groups: SC, ST, OBC, women, minorities and differently-abled persons get higher margin money subsidies.
4. Sustained enterprises: 80% of units should continue beyond three years.

How PMEGP Works



Benefits Under the Scheme

1. **Margin money subsidy:** A credit-linked subsidy of 15% to 35% of project cost; general rural beneficiaries get 25%, special categories up to 35%.

2. **Second loan for expansion:** A 15% subsidy (20% for NE and hill areas) helps units upgrade; about 174 entrepreneurs availed it in 2024–25.

3. **Employment generation:** Jobs for about 64 lakh persons since inception, with annual targets above 5 lakh.

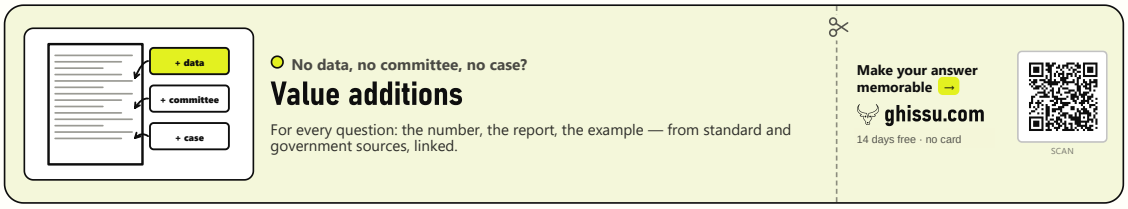
4. **Women and backward regions:** Nearly 50% of units are run by women entrepreneurs, and over 10% of the budget goes to backward states including the North East.

Way Forward

1. **Monitoring:** Digital tracking and timely releases to avoid idle funds flagged by the Public Accounts Committee.
2. **Skill linkages:** Link PMEGP with the National Career Service and PM Internship Scheme.
3. **Outreach:** Awareness and bank linkages in rural Andhra Pradesh for women and SC/ST entrepreneurs.
4. **Market and technology:** Link beneficiaries to MSME Champions for market access and technology upgrades, improving competitiveness.

Conclusion

PMEGP plays a pivotal role in inclusive employment by empowering micro-entrepreneurs in rural and backward regions. Effectively implemented, it advances SDG (8) on decent work and supports Viksit Bharat @2047 through broad-based job creation.



15(b) Explain briefly the four pillars for developing a strong IT in Andhra Pradesh?

10

Introduction

The growing importance of IT as a driver of economic growth makes a robust IT ecosystem imperative for Andhra Pradesh. With its vision of a knowledge economy and its early adoption of e-governance, the state shows four foundational pillars of a strong IT sector.

Pillar (1): Leadership and Governance

1. **Political will:** The Chief Minister's monthly monitoring of IT initiatives ensures sustained commitment and accountability.
2. **Project management:** In-house capabilities and a service delivery culture ensure efficient implementation and monitoring.

Pillar (2): Capacity Building and Training

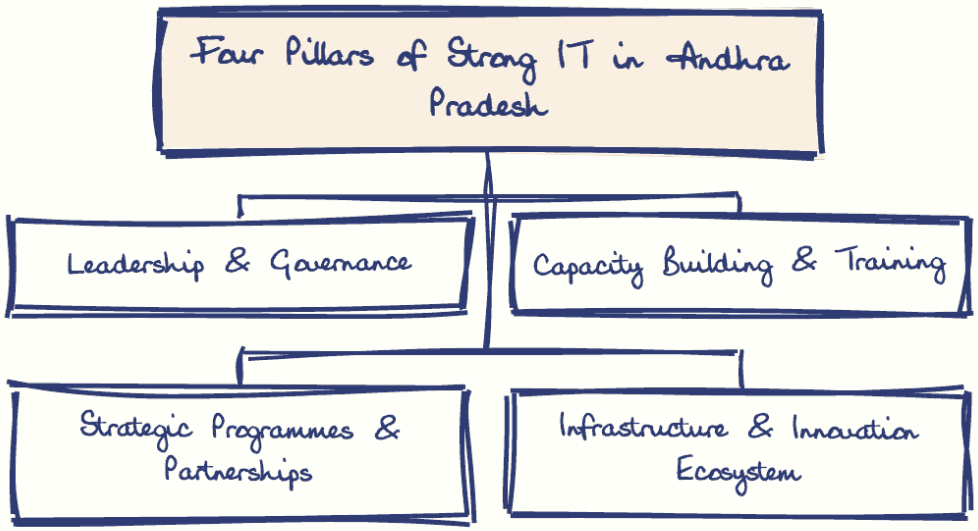
1. **Trained cadre:** The Chenna Reddy Institute trains senior civil servants in technology assessment, process reengineering and project management, creating IT champions in government.

Pillar (3): Strategic Programmes and Partnerships

1. **Clear strategy:** The e-governance strategy targets

measurable benefits, projects like TWINS and FAST were piloted and scaled with private participation.

2. PPP models: Private vendors invest and operate services under Build-Operate-Transfer, reducing the fiscal burden.



Pillar (4): Infrastructure and Innovation

1. Mature infrastructure: Networking and computing support back-office work and data-driven decisions.
2. Citizen services: e-Seva centres and CARD improve transparency for urban and rural citizens.
3. Innovation: Rising startups and incubators make the state a digital governance leader.

Way Forward

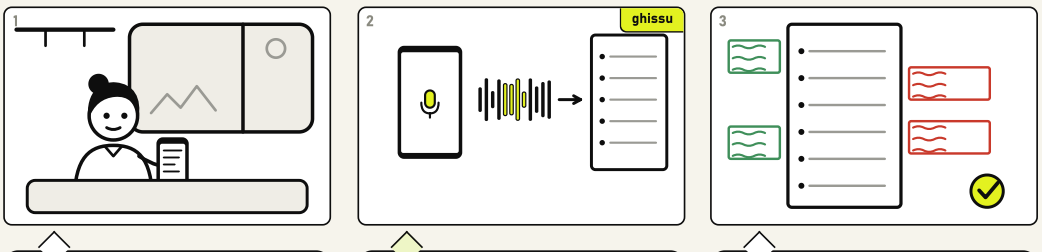
1. **Skills:** Extend training to grassroots workers and citizens.
2. **Rural IT:** Expand broadband and digital facilities in rural and tribal areas to bridge the digital divide.
3. **Data governance:** Adopt frameworks like DEPA to protect privacy and build trust in digital platforms.

Conclusion

Together, these four pillars enable efficient governance, inclusive service delivery and a knowledge-driven economy.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW QUICK OUTLINE — TYPE, SPEAK OR SCAN

Practice on the bus



— An outline a day beats a full answer a week.

Try a quick outline →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2017

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

P-III
1(a)

Discuss the nature of sectoral contribution of income to national income of India since independence. Also Examine whether the changes in sectoral contribution to national income of India followed Kuznets-Clark hypothesis.

10

Introduction

India's economic structure has transformed since independence, as seen in shifting sectoral shares of national income. These shifts test the Kuznets–Clark hypothesis, which holds that as economies develop, the lead shifts from agriculture to industry and then to services.

Sectoral Contribution at Independence

1. **Agriculture Dominant:** With allied activities, it gave nearly half of national income and was the mainstay of Andhra Pradesh's rural economy.
2. **Modest Industry:** Mining, manufacturing and hand trades gave about one-sixth, constrained by the licence raj and poor infrastructure.
3. **Services:** Commerce, transport, communication and administration gave roughly one-third, government alone was 7.6% of NDP in 1950–51.

Changes over Time

1. **Agriculture's Decline:** Its share fell to about 15.2% of GVA, yet 46.1% of workers remained

in farming in 2023–24, as in Andhra Pradesh's Rayalaseema.

2. Stagnant Industry: Industry's share rose only modestly and manufacturing stayed near 15–16%, called premature deindustrialisation.

3. Services Boom: Over half of GVA by 2024, boosted by 1990s liberalisation and UPI and DBT, Andhra Pradesh's services growth outpaces the national average.

4. Jobless Growth: Employment lagged output, and labour productivity fell as workers moved into low-productivity sectors, including agriculture.

Kuznets–Clark path vs India's path

Kuznets–Clark	India
Agriculture share declines	Agriculture share declined
Industry absorbs labour next	Industry stagnated
Services rise last	Services boomed early
Workers follow output	Jobless growth

Did India Follow Kuznets–Clark?

1. Partial Conformity: Agriculture's falling share and

the rise of services match the sequence the hypothesis predicts.

2. Deviation: The strong industrial phase never came; India moved to premature tertiarisation due to regulatory, infrastructure and skill constraints.
3. Sustainability: Weak industry and persistently high farm employment raise doubts about long-term, inclusive growth.

Conclusion

India followed the Kuznets–Clark path only partly. Agriculture declined and services rose, but industry never took the lead. A stronger manufacturing base is needed to absorb surplus labour and make growth broad-based.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
1(b)

What is human development ? Discuss the importance and measurement of Gross National Happiness Index.

10

Introduction

Human development has evolved into a multidimensional concept that goes beyond economic growth to the overall well-being and capabilities of individuals. The focus has shifted from material prosperity alone to health, education and quality of life, a central goal as India balances rapid growth with inclusive development.

What is Human Development?

1. **Meaning:** It is the expansion of people's choices and capabilities, including health, education and access to resources for a decent standard of living.
2. **Measurement:** The Human Development Index, developed by UNDP since 1990, combines longevity, educational attainment and income.
3. **Complementary Tools:** India also uses the Good Governance Index and Panchayat Development Index.

Gross National Happiness: Measurement

1. **Origin:** Bhutan pioneered GNH in the 1970s, integrating material and non-material well-being.

2. Pillars: Good governance, environmental conservation and cultural preservation are measured alongside economic indicators.

3. Method: A multidimensional index using qualitative and quantitative parameters, unlike the HDI's purely quantitative composite.

HDI vs GNH

HDI	GNH
UNDP, since 1990	Bhutan, 1970s
Longevity, education, income	Governance, environment, culture
Purely quantitative	Qualitative and quantitative

Importance of GNH

1. Non-Material Well-being: It brings ethical, spiritual and cultural values into development policy.

2. Governance as a Pillar: Good governance is measured directly, not indirectly as in the HDI.

3. Environmental Focus: Ecological protection is a core component.

4. Filling HDI Gaps: The HDI misses deprivation, inequality and culture, which GNH thinking helps

Practice 1(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

address.

5. Alternative Paradigm: Though unique to Bhutan, it shapes alternative development debates.

Relevance for India and Andhra Pradesh

1. Persisting Gaps: Andhra Pradesh's gains in literacy, healthcare access and governance reforms, tracked by the Good Governance Index, are real, but gaps persist in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
2. Policy Integration: Cultural preservation, ethical governance and sustainability can complement growth.

Way Forward

1. Holistic Policy: Combine GNH's non-material dimensions with economic growth.
2. Better Data: Disaggregated data in states like Andhra Pradesh to capture inequality and multidimensional poverty.

Conclusion

Human development and GNH together show that progress is about well-being, not income alone. Integrating non-material dimensions will make India's growth people-centred.

Only ten minutes today?
Speak an outline. It gets evaluated too.
ghissu.com →

P-III
2(a)

"The aim of economic reforms in India is to improve the competitiveness and efficiency of domestic industry and pave the way for achieving high rate of economic growth." Discuss.

10

Introduction

Economic reforms in India sought to make domestic industry competitive and efficient, opening the way to high growth. The statement holds broadly: reforms improved the business environment and growth, but deep industrialisation, jobs and inclusiveness remain unfinished.

How Reforms Aimed at Competitiveness

1. Gradualist approach: India chose a gradual reform strategy over shock therapy, building political consensus, letting institutions adapt and keeping stability.
2. Regulatory and legal reform: Strong contract enforcement is vital, as India's low ranking in it constrains investment and efficiency.
3. Public sector restructuring: Strategic disinvestment and revival of sick enterprises improved resource allocation and exposed industry to competition.
4. State capacity: Andhra Pradesh's fiscal management, with own tax revenue projected at Rs 94,967 crore for 2024–25, shows how states

shape outcomes.

Outcomes and Challenges

1. Shallow industrialisation: Productivity and global integration improved, yet manufacturing remains around 15–17% of GDP.
2. Employment gap: Nearly 78.5 lakh non-farm jobs are needed annually; growth has not yet produced inclusive employment in manufacturing and MSMEs.
3. Infrastructure bottlenecks: Logistics deficits persist, though the National Infrastructure Pipeline and Visakhapatnam port corridors are closing gaps.
4. Political economy: Uneven benefits weaken mass support, so reforms need a human face.

The reform chain



Assessment

Efficiency and competitiveness have improved and

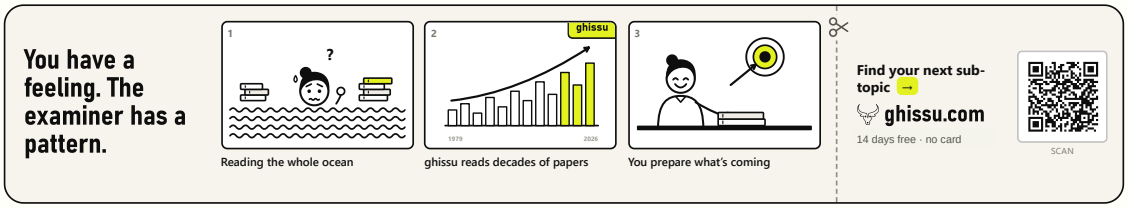
growth has risen, but growth without enough jobs, and competitiveness without strong institutions, show reform is only half complete.

Way Forward

1. Legal overhaul: Judicial reform and digitalisation to speed contract enforcement.
2. MSME competitiveness: Expand the Credit Guarantee Fund Trust and MSME Self-Reliant India Fund with technology and skills.
3. Infrastructure PPPs: Use port-led corridors as models.
4. Inclusive policies: Link industrial growth to job creation and poverty reduction.

Conclusion

Reforms have raised competitiveness and growth, but deeper institutional change and inclusive jobs are needed to achieve SDG (8) and a Viksit Bharat by 2047.



P-III
2(b)

Describe the salient features of National Manufacturing Policy and also the critical role of manufacturing sector in employment generation.

10

Introduction

Manufacturing is pivotal for India's transformation, as it must sustain high growth and absorb an expanding workforce. To use the demographic dividend, the National Manufacturing Policy (NMP) of 2011 sought to boost manufacturing growth and jobs. Make in India and the PLI scheme carry this aim forward, including in Andhra Pradesh's industrial corridors.

Salient Features of the NMP

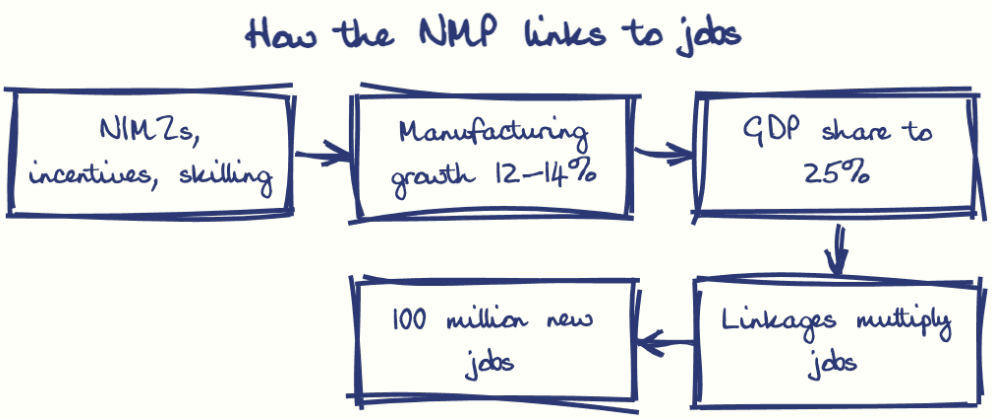
1. Growth and GDP share: Raise manufacturing growth to 12–14% over the medium term and its share of GDP to at least 25%.
2. Employment goal: Create 100 million additional manufacturing jobs, with skilling for rural migrants and the urban poor.
3. NIMZs: Large National Investment and Manufacturing Zones of at least 5000 hectares through PPPs, with the Centre funding trunk infrastructure and states giving land and utilities.
4. Sectoral focus: Employment-intensive textiles and

leather, capital goods, strategic sectors like aerospace and sdar, and competitive sectors like automobiles and pharmaceuticals, backed by incentives and procurement preference.

5. Sustainability and skills: Green practices and training through ITIs, polytechnics and instructor centres in NIMZs.

Role of Manufacturing in Employment

1. Mass job creation: Manufacturing absorbs semi-skilled and unskilled young workers.
2. MSMEs: Contributing over 35% of output, they form the backbone of manufacturing jobs but need credit and technology, as Andhra Pradesh's MSME clusters and industrial parks show.
3. Formalisation: Skill India and EPFO incentives for first-time employees encourage formal jobs.
4. Multiplier effects: Upstream and downstream linkages multiply jobs, as in the Visakhapatnam-Chennai corridor.
5. Technological challenge: Automation has stalled job growth; PLI and PM MITRA parks target labour-intensive segments.

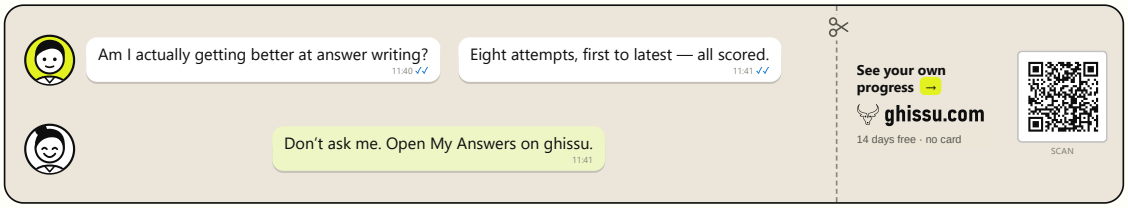


Way Forward

1. NIMZs: Speed up zones with state participation.
2. MSMEs: Expand credit, technology and market links.
3. Labour-intensive sectors: Incentivise textiles, food processing and electronics assembly.

Conclusion

The NMP offers a framework to make manufacturing an engine of growth and jobs. Investment, skills and labour-intensive focus can support a Viksit Bharat by 2047.



P-III
3(a)

According to the Economic Survey 2016 – 17, Universal Basic Income (UBI) aims at achieving Mahatma Gandhi's objective of "wiping every tear from every eye". In this backdrop, explain the concept of UBI and discuss how it is expected to achieve the stated objective.

10

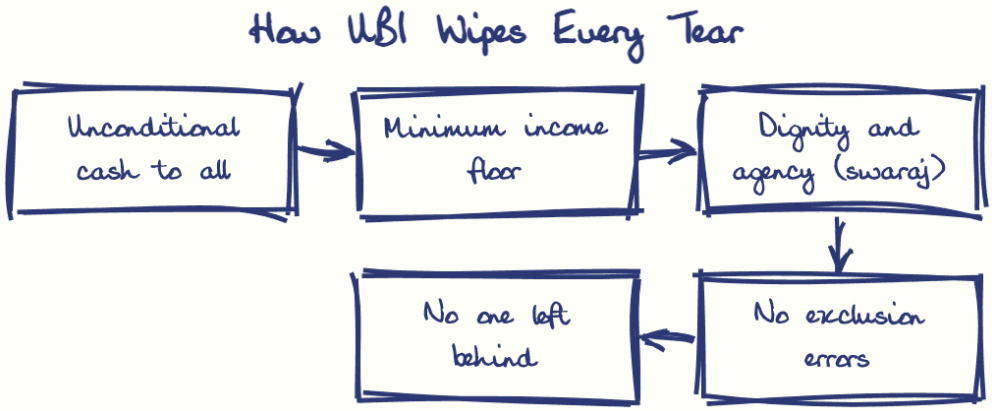
Introduction

India has reduced poverty since independence, yet Gandhi's vision to "wipe every tear from every eye" remains a challenge that goes beyond calories to dignity, freedom and psychological well-being. The Economic Survey 2016-17 brought Universal Basic Income (UBI) into the policy spotlight as a transformative approach to social justice.

Concept of UBI

1. Definition: A regular, unconditional cash transfer to all citizens regardless of income or employment, ensuring a minimum income floor and dignity.
2. Key features: Universality, unconditionality and agency: given to everyone without conditions, it lets recipients make their own choices.
3. Survey's proposal: A modest UBI of INR 7,620 a year for 75% of the population, made fiscally feasible by rationalising subsidies and cutting leakages.

4. Delivery readiness: DBT and the JAM trinity in states like Andhra Pradesh make transparent delivery possible.



How UBI Achieves Gandhi's Objective

1. Poverty and dignity: Guaranteed income gives material security and restores dignity through unconditional support.
2. Freedom and swaraj: Agency helps women and marginalised groups decide for themselves, reducing dependence on paternalistic welfare, in the spirit of swaraj.
3. Social justice: Universality removes exclusion errors of targeted schemes so no one is left behind.
4. Moral hazard answered: Gandhi feared free charity breeds idleness, but the SEWA Bharat pilot in Madhya Pradesh showed more own

cultivation and less debt.

5. Fiscal caution: The Survey says UBI must replace, not add to, inefficient subsidies.

Way Forward

1. Phased pilots: Start with vulnerable groups like women and small farmers to build evidence and capacity.
2. Integration: Gradually replace overlapping schemes without abruptly withdrawing food and employment guarantees.
3. Digital reach: Expand JAM and digital literacy in rural and tribal areas to reduce exclusion.

Conclusion

Introduced in phases and integrated with existing schemes, UBI offers a promising path to Gandhi's goal of wiping every tear.

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

ghissu

On ghissu every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into chapter notes by themselves.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
3(b)

What is relative poverty ? What are the reasons for its presence in India ? Explain the Gini-coefficient and Lorenz curve methods of measuring relative poverty.

10

Introduction

Relative poverty remains a critical issue in India despite strong growth. While absolute poverty has declined sharply, many people still face deprivation relative to society, limiting their opportunities and social inclusion, even in fast-growing states like Andhra Pradesh.

What is Relative Poverty?

1. Meaning: Having significantly less income or resources than the average standard of living, which limits full participation in social and economic life.
2. Beyond Fixed Lines: Unlike absolute poverty, it considers social context and inequality in education, health and freedoms.
3. Capability Deprivation: Following Amartya Sen, it is a lack of freedom to achieve well-being, not just low income.

Reasons for Relative Poverty in India

1. Unequal Growth: The top 10% control about 77% of national wealth while the bottom

50% share only 13%.

2. Regional Disparities: Andhra Pradesh grew 9.24% in 2024–25, yet pockets of poverty persist in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
3. Social Exclusion: STs and SCs face multidimensional poverty rates of 50.6% and 33.3%.
4. Weak Public Services: Andhra Pradesh has 22% vacancies in medical officer posts and 175 CHCs against 412 required.

Gini Coefficient Method

1. Definition: A measure of income inequality ranging from 0 (perfect equality) to 1 (maximum inequality).
2. Calculation: The area between the line of perfect equality and the Lorenz curve, relative to the total area under the equality line.
3. India's Trend: It fell from 28.8 in 2011 to 25.5 in 2022–23, yet the top 1% own 40% of wealth.

Lorenz Curve Method

1. Framework: Plots the cumulative percentage of income against the cumulative percentage of

population, from poorest to richest.

2. Interpretation: The further the curve bows from the line of equality, the greater the inequality.

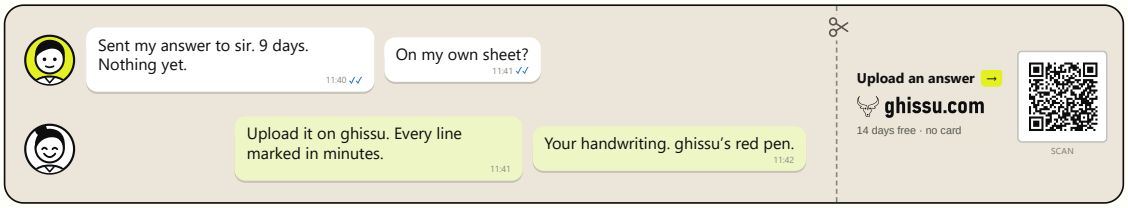
3. Complement: The Lorenz curve shows inequality visually, the Gini coefficient quantifies it.

Gini vs Lorenz

Gini Coefficient	Lorenz Curve
A number from 0 to 1	A curve of income shares
Quantifies inequality	Shows inequality visually
Area-based ratio	Bow from equality line

Conclusion

Relative poverty reflects inequality rather than bare survival. The Gini coefficient and Lorenz curve together help target schemes like Jan Dhan Yojana towards equitable growth.



P-III
4(a)

What are the objectives of the demonetization policy announced by the Central Government on 8th November, 2016 ? Discuss its impact on various sectors and various categories of people in the society. Analyse its scope for cashless economy in the near future.

10

Introduction

The demonetisation of 8th November 2016 invalidated 500 and 1000 notes, which formed 86% of cash in circulation. It aimed to tackle corruption, black money and counterfeit currency in India's cash-driven economy, and to accelerate the move to digital payments.

Objectives of the Policy

1. Curb black money: Force holders of unaccounted cash to declare it and pay tax or lose it, raising compliance.
2. Counter counterfeit currency: Disrupt fake currency that funded illegal activities.
3. Stop terror financing: Cut off funds held in high denomination notes.
4. Less-cash economy: Encourage digital transactions through BHIM and UPI.
5. Regime shift: Signal resolve to penalise illicit finance.

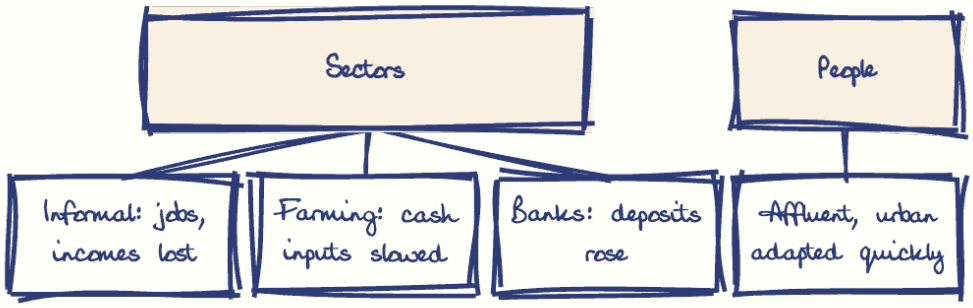
Practice 4(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

Impact on Sectors and People

1. Informal sector: Daily wage workers and small traders faced job losses and income decline.
2. Agriculture: Cash payments for seed, fertiliser and labour slowed, hurting rural markets.
3. Real estate: Demand and prices fell, which may make housing more affordable.
4. Financial sector: Deposits rose, widening the tax base and boosting mutual fund assets.
5. Social groups: The affluent and urban adapted quickly, while the poor and less digitally literate suffered. PMJDY helped bridge the gap.

Impact of demonetisation



Scope for a Cashless Economy

1. Payment infrastructure: BHIM, UPI and Aadhaar-enabled payments raised digital volumes significantly.

2. Financial inclusion: PMJDY accounts and digital governance in Andhra Pradesh laid the groundwork.

3. Limits: Digital illiteracy and trust issues keep many dependent on cash.

Conclusion

Demonetisation caused short-term distress, especially for the informal sector, farmers and the poor, but accelerated formalisation and digital payments. A less-cash economy is realistic with sustained digital literacy, infrastructure and trust, though a fully cashless economy remains a long-term goal.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON EXAM-HALL THINKING

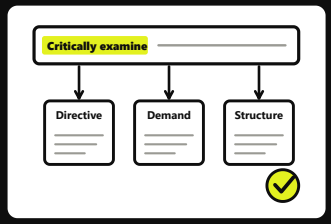
Decode the directive before you write

The directive word is an instruction. The marking scheme follows it — so should your answer.

1. **Discuss** — Both sides, then a verdict. The verdict carries marks.
2. **Critically examine** — The counter-view is compulsory — then commit to a judgement.
3. **Examine** — Causes, features and consequences, kept separate.
4. **Elucidate** — Make it clear with one example for every point.

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Exam-hall thinking decodes the directive and the demand for every PYQ — Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.



See the thinking before the answer →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
4(b)

Critically analyse the causes and consequences of India's public debt relating to the period from 1991 till date.

10

Introduction

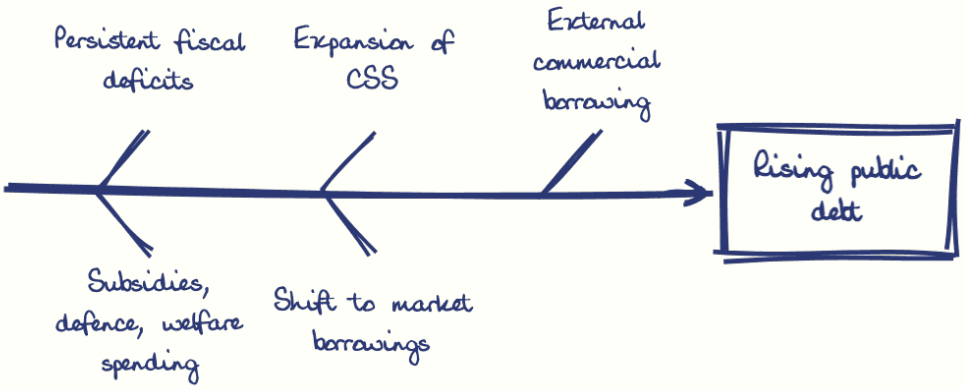
Since the economic liberalisation of 1991, India's public debt has changed in scale, composition and management, shaped by reforms, macroeconomic shocks and state finances. Its causes and consequences determine fiscal sustainability and growth, notably for post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh.

Causes of Public Debt Since 1991

1. Persistent fiscal deficits: Spending on subsidies, defence and welfare has outpaced revenue, with structural revenue deficits in states like Andhra Pradesh.
2. Expansion of CSS: Centrally Sponsored Schemes raised state spending obligations without matching transfers, forcing more borrowing.
3. Shift to market borrowings: The share of market loans in state liabilities rose from 21.1% to 53.3%, giving autonomy but raising servicing costs.
4. External debt dynamics: Lower global rates encouraged external commercial borrowing.

External debt grew (11.2%) a year in rupee terms between 1990–91 and 2010–11, partly due to rupee depreciation.

Why public debt rose after 1991



Consequences of Public Debt

1. Interest burden: Rising interest payments crowd out productive expenditure.
2. Andhra Pradesh's stress: Liabilities reached 5,79,621 crore (43.99% of GSDP) in 2022–23, with off-budget borrowings of 1,28,048 crore and capex only 0.55% of GSDP.
3. Growth linkage: Productive debt can support growth. Between 2003–04 and 2008–09, 8% average growth cut debt-to-GDP from 83% to 70%.
4. RBI's dual role: Combining debt management and

monetary policy hampers bond markets.

Way Forward

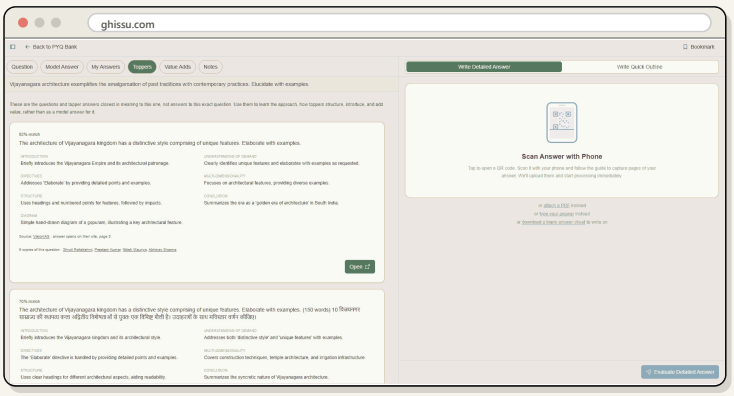
1. Fiscal rules: Enforce Fiscal Responsibility Laws, backed by the Debt Consolidation and Relief Facility.

Conclusion

Debt is not harmful in itself; what matters is its use. Since 1991, deficits, scheme expansion and market borrowing have raised India's debt, bringing heavy interest costs and state-level stress. Fiscal discipline, revenue mobilisation and productive borrowing can keep India's debt sustainable.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

Forty PDFs, and still no topper copy for this question?



See how toppers wrote it →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 Topper answers matched by meaning to this exact question.

2 Each broken down: introduction, directives, structure.

3 Searched from 1.5 lakh+ topper answers.

P-III
5(a)

"Selfish attitude of human beings is the sole cause of environmental degradation." Discuss.

10

Introduction

Environmental degradation is a pressing concern in India, where rapid growth and population pressure strain natural resources. Selfish human attitudes are a major driver, but treating them as the sole cause ignores poverty, institutions, technology and climate, which shape degradation equally. Policy needs this broader view.

How Selfishness Drives Degradation

1. Tragedy of the commons: Garrett Hardin showed that self-interest leads to overuse of shared forests and water, as in groundwater over-extraction in the Rayalaseema drought belt of Andhra Pradesh.
2. Consumerism: Demand for luxury and convenience drives encroachment of water bodies, worsening floods in Chennai and Uttarakhand.
3. Anthropocentric outlook: Valuing human needs over nature leads to practices like excessive fertiliser use in rural Andhra Pradesh, contaminating water.
4. Short-term gains: Unregulated industrial growth around the Visakhapatnam corridor pollutes air

and water.

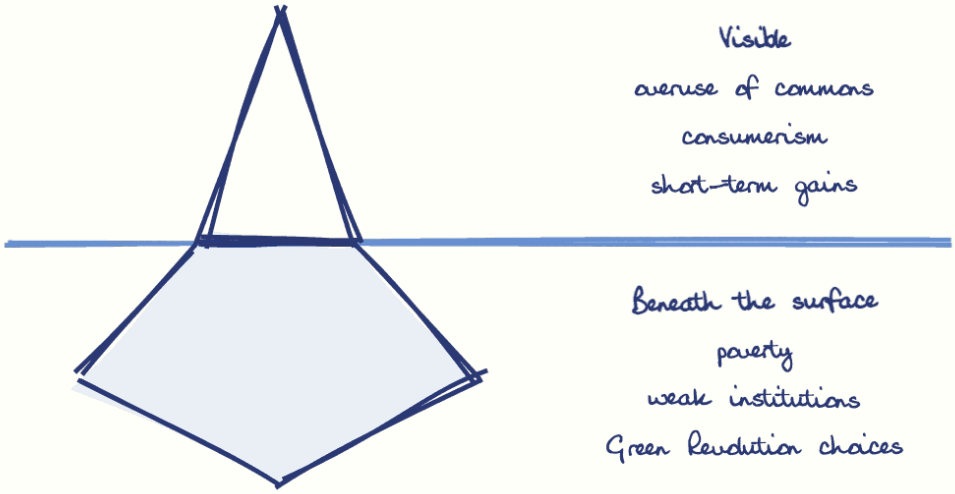
Why Selfishness Is Not the Sole Cause

1. Poverty-induced pressure: Tribal shifting cultivation in the Eastern Ghats of Andhra Pradesh clears forests out of survival needs, not greed.
2. Institutional failure: Weak enforcement and delays in compensatory afforestation in Andhra Pradesh worsen damage.
3. Technological choices: The Green Revolution raised chemical use and groundwater depletion in Andhra Pradesh's farm zones.
4. Urbanisation: Rapid expansion of Vijayawada strains infrastructure and habitats.
5. Economic inequality: Overconsumption by a few and survival use by the poor create dual pressure, as in the Krishna-Godavari delta aquaculture boom.
6. Climate change: Global phenomena intensify local vulnerability, such as recurrent droughts in Rayalaseema.

Way Forward

1. Environmental ethics: Teach Gandhian trusteeship and stewardship in school curricula across

Causes of environmental degradation



Andhra Pradesh to foster responsible attitudes towards nature.

2. Stronger institutions: Enforce environmental laws strictly and speed up compensatory afforestation in Andhra Pradesh, so that weak governance does not magnify individual excesses.

3. Awareness: Spread knowledge of sustainable practices among rural communities, where limited awareness hampers conservation.

Conclusion

Selfishness is a key but not the sole cause. Ethical change must go with poverty reduction, sound technology and strong institutions to achieve sustainable development.

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
5(b)

Discuss the nature and importance of Public-Private Partnership (PPP) in health care and basic education in India.

10

Introduction

Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs) have gained renewed importance in India's health care and basic education amid fiscal constraints and widening infrastructure gaps. They use private efficiency and innovation for public welfare goals. The Union Budget 2025's emphasis on social sector PPPs highlights their role in expanding access, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh.

Nature of PPPs

1. Varied policy base: There is no uniform national PPP policy in health and education; Andhra Pradesh invested Rs 1069 crore in education PPPs like Mid-day Meal partnerships and ICT upgrades.
2. Governance needs: Many health contracts lack performance indicators and beneficiary identification, hurting quality and trust.
3. Risk-sharing: PPPs depend on clear risk allocation and timely payments; delays and no evidence-based pricing deter private partners.
4. Narrow scope: Health PPPs focus mostly on

diagnostic and dialysis services.

Importance of PPPs

1. **Bridging gaps:** AP has (175) CHCs against (412) needed and (22%) specialist and (21%) staff nurse vacancies, which public effort alone has not met.
2. **Efficiency and quality:** Private management and innovation can improve service delivery.
3. **Replicable models:** Outsourced diagnostics in Maharashtra show how models can scale.
4. **Fiscal relief:** Partnerships extend services and infrastructure despite limited government budgets, as AP's education PPPs show.

PPPs in Health and Education

	Health	Education
Nature	Diagnostics, dialysis focus	Mid-day Meal, ICT partnerships
Importance	Fills CHC, specialist gaps	Extends services on tight budgets

Concerns

1. Fragile trust: SEWA Rural withdrew from primary health care as government relations deteriorated.
2. Equity: Private medical education pairs access with high costs.
3. Weak capacity: Agencies lack skills to design and manage contracts.

Way Forward

1. Capacity: Train officials in contract design and monitoring.
2. Regulation: Standard guidelines with performance metrics and pricing.
3. Inclusion: Subsidies or cross-subsidisation to keep services affordable for the marginalised.

Conclusion

PPPs are a vital strategy to bridge resource and capacity gaps in social sectors. Well institutionalised and managed, they can raise quality, widen access and foster innovation in health and education, supporting Viksit Bharat 2047.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
ghissu.com →

P-III
6(a)

Explain the reasons for constituting a land committee under the chairmanship of Sri Koneru Ranga Rao in the year 2004 and bring out its recommendations related to land reforms in Andhra Pradesh.

10

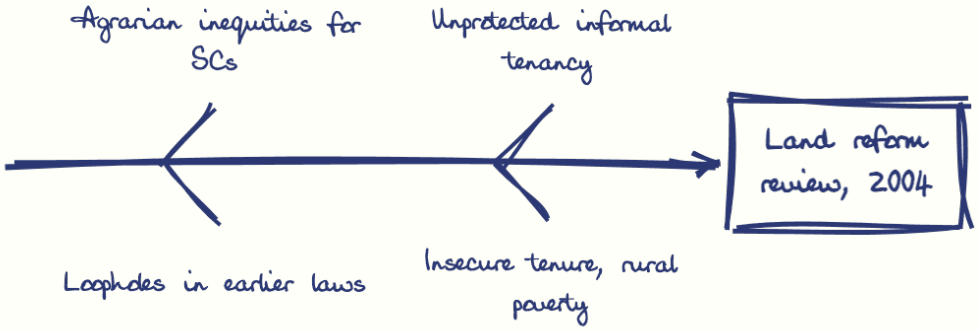
Introduction

Land reforms are a key tool against agrarian inequality, and Andhra Pradesh was among the pioneering states. Yet by 2004 inequitable distribution, tenancy insecurity and weak protection for marginalised cultivators persisted. The Koneru Ranga Rao Committee was constituted in 2004 to review land policy and revitalise reforms.

Reasons for Constituting the Committee

1. Agrarian inequities: Disparities in ownership left Scheduled Castes and other marginalised groups landless or insecure as tenants.
2. Implementation gaps: Loopholes and administrative weaknesses had limited earlier laws, needing a comprehensive review.
3. Unprotected tenancy: The rise of informal tenancy and sharecropping left cultivators without legal protection and blocked their access to land.
4. Productivity and poverty: Secure tenure improves productivity and reduces rural poverty, so reform could empower small and marginal farmers.

Why the Kaneru Ranga Rao Committee



Key Recommendations

1. **Strengthen tenancy reforms:** Legally recognise and protect tenant cultivators, and confer ownership rights on long-term tenants to curb exploitation and spur investment.
2. **Regularise assigned and surplus lands:** Distribute and regularise lands held by SCs and STs with secure titles, preventing illegal transfers.
3. **Simplify land records:** Modernise records and streamline transfer procedures to raise transparency and cut disputes.
4. **Enforce land ceilings:** Strictly apply land ceiling laws to identify surplus land for the landless.
5. **Institutional strengthening:** Build the capacity of revenue departments and coordinate with Gram Sabhas for implementation and grievance redressal.

Significance

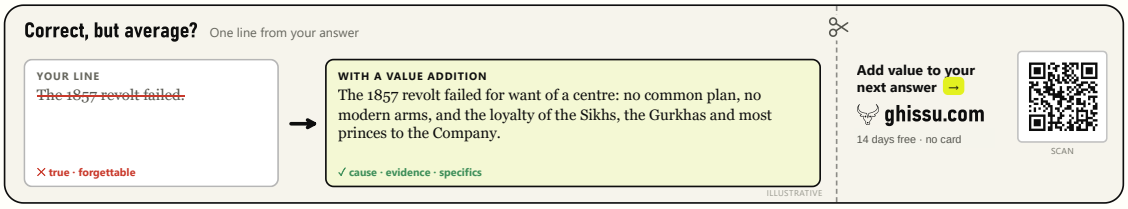
The recommendations shift the focus from passing laws to enforcing them, reaching the landless and insecure tenants whom earlier reforms had missed.

Way Forward

1. Legislation: Enact a comprehensive law protecting tenant rights and regulating land transfers.
2. Digitisation: Integrate land records state-wide to reduce corruption.
3. Gram Sabha role: Institutionalise Gram Sabha consent and participation in land acquisition and redistribution.
4. Capacity: Train and equip revenue officials to enforce reforms and resolve disputes faster, reducing litigation and delays.

Conclusion

The 2004 committee was a pivotal step to reinvigorate land reforms. Effective implementation can secure land rights for marginalised farmers, raise productivity and advance equitable growth.



P-III
6(b)

Discuss the evolution of tenancy reforms in Andhra Pradesh and also explain the main features of the Andhra Pradesh (Andhra Area) Tenancy Act, 1956 including the amendments to the Act.

10

Introduction

Tenancy reforms in Andhra Pradesh address the power imbalance between landlords and tenant cultivators. The state has one of India's highest tenancy rates, with 34.8% of operated area under tenancy in 2012–13 against a national 10.3%, so protecting tenants is central to agrarian policy.

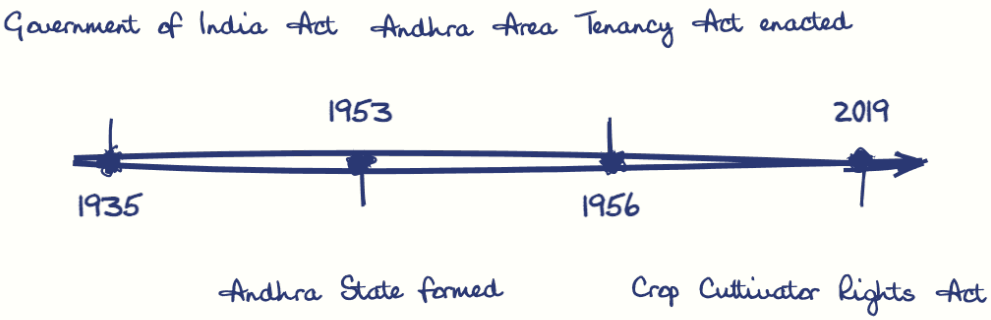
Evolution of Tenancy Reforms

1. **Colonial era:** Landlord–tenant relations were exploitative; the Government of India Act, 1935 decentralised land administration but did not empower tenants.
2. **Post-independence:** After Andhra State (1953) and Andhra Pradesh (1956) were formed, the Andhra Area Tenancy Act, 1956 regulated tenancy, curbed eviction and ensured fair rent.
3. **Persisting gaps:** Tenancy is high among Scheduled Castes, and most leases stay informal and unregistered, cutting tenants

off from credit and benefits.

4. Recent change: The Crop Cultivator Rights Act, 2019 replaced the old law to balance owner and tenant interests.

Evolution of Tenancy Reforms in Andhra Pradesh



Main Features of the 1956 Act

1. Lease security: A minimum lease of six years with automatic renewal.
2. Fair rent: Maximum rent of 30% of gross produce for irrigated and 25% for unirrigated land.
3. Remission of rent: Rent could be remitted on crop failure.
4. Limited resumption: Landlords could resume land only for personal cultivation within ceilings under the AP Land Reforms Act, 1973.

5. Right of first purchase: Registered tenants could buy leased land at up to five times the rent, in instalments.

6. Disputes and exclusions: Special officers settled disputes with appeal to district judges; plantations, orchards, grazing and government lands were excluded.

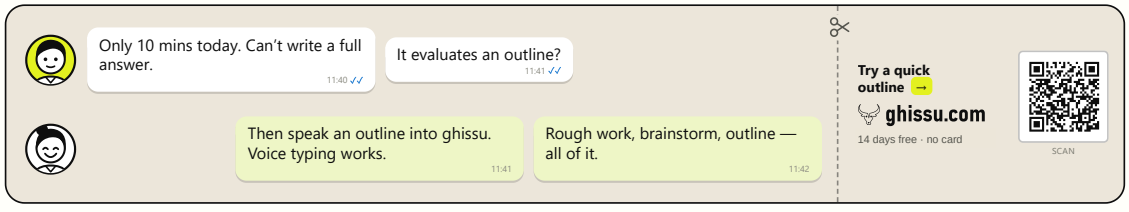
Amendments

1. Rent and lease terms: Amendments adjusted rent and lease terms over time.

2. Replacement in 2019: The 2019 Act repealed the 1956 law; critics say it dilutes tenant protection.

Conclusion

Tenancy law evolved from protection to liberalisation. Registering leases is vital so tenants gain credit and security.



P-III
7(a)

Discuss the structural composition of Andhra Pradesh's economy in terms of Gross Value Added (GVA) at current and constant basic prices (2011 – 12 base) from 2014 – 15 to 2016 – 17.

10

Introduction

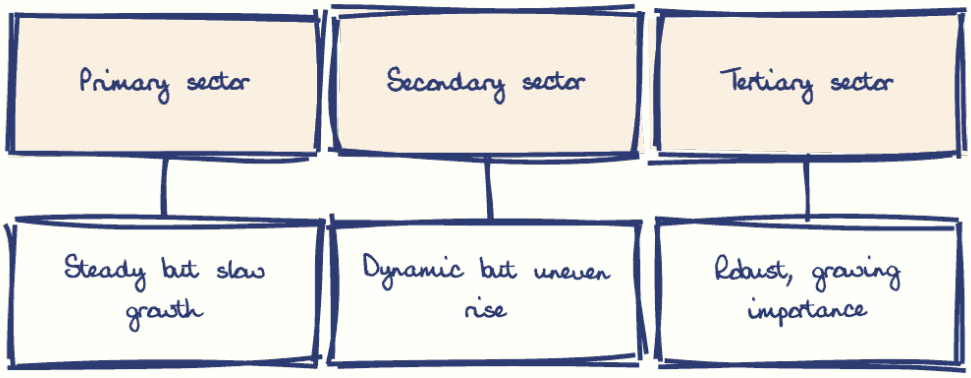
The Gross Value Added (GVA) of Andhra Pradesh at current and constant basic prices (2011–12 base) from 2014–15 to 2016–17 reveals the state's growth dynamics and sectoral contributions. The period follows the 2014 bifurcation, which took away Hyderabad as capital, so GVA trends show how each sector adjusted to new realities.

Structural Composition

1. Post-bifurcation realignment: Losing Hyderabad, a major industrial and service hub, forced the state to develop Visakhapatnam and Amaravati as new growth centres.
2. Primary sector: Agriculture, forestry and fishing showed steady but slow growth, reflecting the agrarian base.
3. Secondary sector: Manufacturing and infrastructure drove a more dynamic rise, though it was uneven.
4. Tertiary sector: Trade, finance and public services expanded robustly, showing the growing importance of services.

5. Diversification efforts: Port-led industrial corridors along the 974 km coastline and promotion of aquaculture and horticulture widened the base.

Sectoral trends in GVA, 2014–17



Challenges and Outcomes

1. Agriculture: Drought-prone Rayalaseema, Krishna and Godavari water disputes and limited irrigation slowed growth.
2. Industry: Infrastructure deficits and revenue shortfalls after bifurcation limited expansion.
3. Services and urbanisation: Growth centred on Visakhapatnam and Amaravati, leaving urban–rural disparities.
4. Fiscal stress: Rising revenue deficits constrained capital expenditure on infrastructure and social services.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Way Forward

1. Irrigation: Strengthen irrigation and resolve inter-state water disputes.
2. Industry and inclusion: Build industrial clusters around Visakhapatnam port and extend digital and financial services to rural areas.

Conclusion

From 2014-15 to 2016-17 Andhra Pradesh moved from primary reliance towards a service-oriented structure. Better irrigation, industrial clusters and fiscal discipline can make this transition balanced.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TREND ANALYSIS, PER SUB-TOPIC

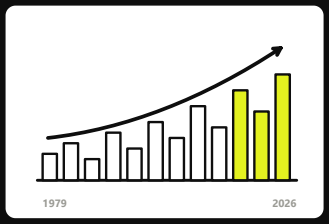
Read a chapter's past before its pages

Twenty minutes of this before a new chapter tells you where to spend the next twenty hours.

1. **List** — Every question asked from the chapter in the last ten years.
2. **Circle** — Sub-topics asked twice or more.
3. **Notice the shift** — Facts to analysis? National to State? Old to current?
4. **Read** — The circled sub-topics first; the rest second.

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Every syllabus topic already has its trend analysis: direction of travel, most tested sub-topic, probable next theme.



Prepare the pattern → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
7(b)

"SERP has been playing an important role in reducing rural poverty in Andhra Pradesh." Discuss.

10

Introduction

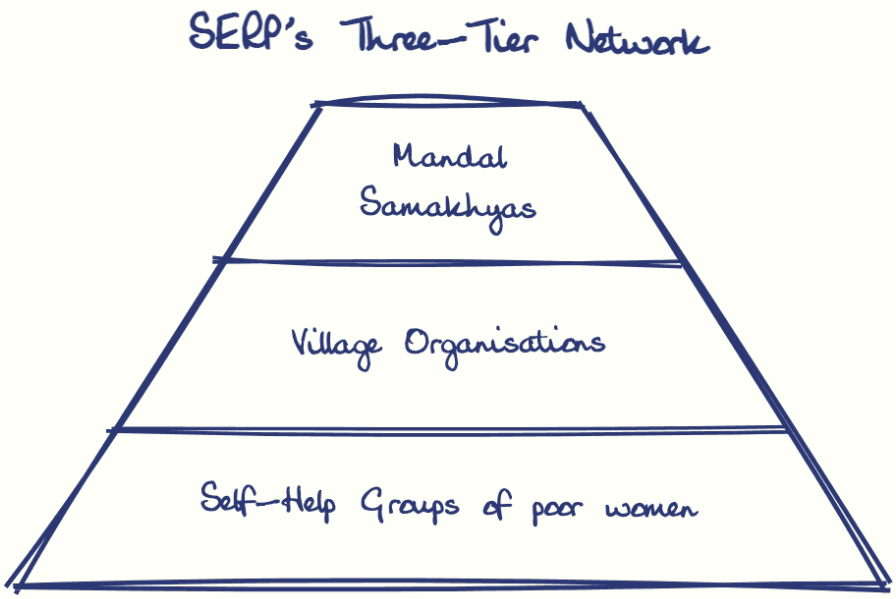
Nearly half of rural households in India still face multidimensional deprivation despite growth. In Andhra Pradesh, the Society for Elimination of Rural Poverty (SERP) has emerged as a pioneering institution that tackles rural poverty through community-driven approaches.

Community-Based Institutional Framework

1. Three-tier network: SERP works through SHGs, Village Organisations and Mandal Samakhyas, making rural women the primary agents of poverty alleviation and fostering local ownership.
2. Convergence: It links with state schemes like Annadatha Sukhibhava and national ones like MGNREGA, improving resource mobilisation and delivery.
3. Capacity building: Heavy investment in training enables members to access credit, take up livelihoods and join local governance, building social capital.

Role in Reducing Rural Poverty

1. Financial inclusion: SHGs give access to



microcredit and savings, reducing dependence on informal moneylenders.

2. Livelihood diversification: Through ~~APCNF~~, SERP promotes sustainable agriculture and non-farm livelihoods.

3. Gender empowerment: Its women-centred approach has improved gender parity in rural economic participation.

4. Transparency: Digital tools and MeeSeva grievance redressal improve scheme implementation.

Challenges

1. Credit gaps: Delays in credit flow and limited product diversity.

2. Markets and skills: Weak market linkages and skill mismatch limit incomes.

3. Social barriers: Entrenched hierarchies and regional disparities persist.

4. Data issues: Delays in data updating and errors in beneficiary identification.

Way Forward

1. Digital monitoring: Integrated platforms for real-time monitoring and beneficiary data management.

2. Market linkages: E-commerce and value chains for SHG products.

3. Skill upgradation: Local training stressing green jobs and sustainable farming under APCNF.

4. Inclusive participation: Targeted interventions for marginalised groups.

Conclusion

SERP has played a transformative role by institutionalising community participation and social mobilisation. Better digital tools and market integration will consolidate these gains towards SDG (1), SDG (8) and Swarna Andhra Vision (2047).



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
8(a)

Evaluate the programmes/schemes initiated by the Andhra Pradesh Government to achieve women empowerment.

10

Introduction

States play a pivotal role in women's empowerment. Andhra Pradesh, pursuing the Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, has initiated programmes to enhance women's safety, economic participation and social status. Evaluating them shows real gains alongside persistent gaps.

Key Programmes

1. **Mission Shakti:** Its Sambal (security) and Samarthya (economic empowerment) verticals run One Stop Centres and the Women Helpline 181 for women in vidence or distress.
2. **Economic schemes:** Mudra Yojana and Stand-Up India provide collateral-free loans, encouraging self-employment.
3. **Support services:** Sakhi Niwas hostels, Palna creches and Swadhar Greh give safe shetter and rehabilitation.
4. **Health and nutrition:** Janani Suraksha Yojana, PMSM-A and Mission POSHAN improve maternal and child health.

Evaluation: Achievements

1. Safety and support: OSCs and the helpline have given thousands of women medical, legal and psychological aid, building confidence to seek help.
2. Workforce participation: Female labour force participation has risen notably, especially in agriculture and services.
3. Financial inclusion: Wider access to Mudra and Stand-Up India loans has increased economic independence.
4. Health gains: Maternal and child health indicators have improved.

Evaluation: Limitations

1. Governance lapses: The CAG audit found diversion of welfare funds, inefficiency and pending claims.
2. Health constraints: Medical vacancies and inadequate health centres limit maternal care.
3. Social barriers: Patriarchal norms still restrict economic and political participation.
4. Data gaps: Lack of gender-disaggregated data weakens targeting.

Women Empowerment in AP: Evaluation

Achievements	Limitations
OSCs, Helpline 181 aid	Welfare fund diversion
Higher female workforce share	Patriarchal norms persist
Mudra, Stand-Up loans	Medical vacancies
Better maternal health	No gender-disaggregated data

Way Forward

1. Accountability: Transparent fund management to prevent diversion and ensure timely benefits.
2. Health capacity: Fill vacancies and upgrade health facilities.
3. Norms and data: Awareness campaigns against patriarchal attitudes and gender-disaggregated data for monitoring.

Conclusion

AP's programmes have made commendable strides in safety, economic inclusion and health. Better governance and data can convert them into lasting women empowerment.

Where did you write that point?
Notes that live with the question.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 8(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
8(b)

Critically evaluate the nature of occupational structure in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The occupational structure of Andhra Pradesh is a key indicator of its economic development and social transformation. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 and per capita income of Rs 2,68,653, above the national average, the distribution of its workforce across agriculture, industry and services reflects both progress and persistent challenges.

Nature of the Structure

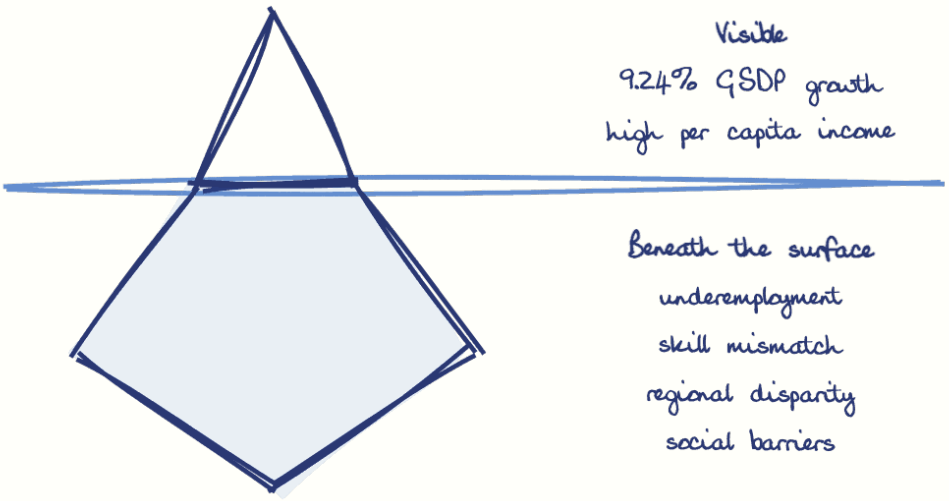
1. Agricultural dominance: Despite urbanisation, a large share of workers remain in agriculture and allied activities, which added Rs 2.32 lakh crore to GVA in 2024–25, growing at 10.70%.
2. Growing industry: Manufacturing and construction are expanding, helped by the 974 km coastline and port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai.
3. Expanding services: Knowledge-intensive jobs are rising, reflected in the state's human capital and ICT exports in the India Innovation Index 2019.
4. Transitional shift: Labour is gradually moving from the primary to the secondary and tertiary

sectors.

Influencing Factors

1. Agriculture: APCNF and Annadatha Sukhibhava help farmers, but Krishna–Godavari water disputes and drought in Rayalaseema limit diversification.
2. Industry: SPSEs contribute 6.69% of GSDP, but governance and arrears issues constrain them.
3. Education: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and ULLAS build human capital.

Occupational structure of Andhra Pradesh



Critical Evaluation

1. Growth vs employment quality: The large farm workforce faces underemployment and low income, risking rural distress.

2. Skill mismatch: Services demand skilled labour, but vacancies in health and education reveal inefficiencies.
3. Regional disparity: Coastal and urban areas benefit, while Rayalaseema lags.
4. Social barriers: Caste and regional disparities limit access to higher-status occupations.

Way Forward

1. Agriculture: Expand climate-resilient farming under APCNF and improve irrigation to mitigate drought.
2. Industry: Reform SPSE management and use port-led corridors for quality jobs.
3. Skills and regions: Align vocational training with service demand and target backward regions like Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's occupational structure is in dynamic transition from agriculture towards industry and services, reflecting growth but also gaps in quality and equity.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 8(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
9(a)

In the context of the financial situation of Andhra Pradesh after reorganization, discuss the nature and extent of Central assistance provided to Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

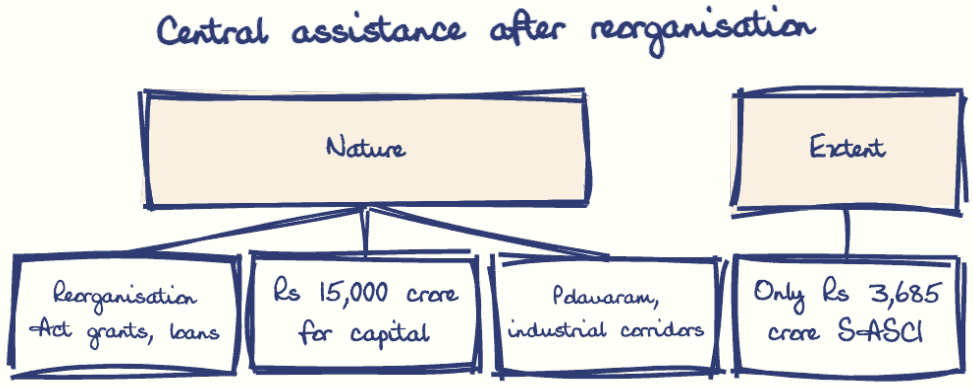
After its 2014 bifurcation, Andhra Pradesh lost Hyderabad and had to build new administrative and economic infrastructure. The Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014 mandated special Central assistance for the transition, infrastructure and fiscal stability.

Nature of Central Assistance

1. Legal mandate: The Reorganisation Act obliges the Union to provide grants and loans for capital formation and infrastructure.
2. Capital investment: The Centre arranged Rs 15,000 crore this year through multilateral agencies for a new capital.
3. Project funding: The Polavaram Irrigation Project, vital for agriculture and food security, is financed with World Bank and ADB loans.
4. Industrial corridors: Funds for nodes like Kopparthy on the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor and Orvakal on the Hyderabad–Bengaluru corridor.

Practice 9(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice



Extent and Outcomes

1. **Delayed releases:** Only Rs 3,685 crore was released under the Scheme for Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment in 2024–25.
2. **Fiscal stress:** The revenue deficit quadrupled and capital expenditure fell to 0.55% of GSDP, with high committed spending and off-budget borrowing.
3. **Dependence:** Own tax revenue grew moderately, so Central transfers form a large part of revenue receipts.
4. **Governance gaps:** Audits found diversion of welfare funds, diluting impact. Stronger institutional capacity is needed.

Growth Linkages

1. **Growth:** GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 outpaced the national average, partly enabled by

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Central funding. Infrastructure and welfare spending stimulated activity.

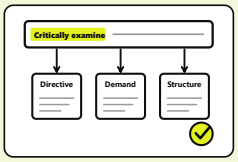
2. Capex constraint: Low capital spending limits productive assets.
3. SCS demand: The state still seeks Special Category Status.

Way Forward

1. Faster fund use: Strengthen release and utilisation.
2. Fiscal discipline: Rationalise committed spending.
3. Transparency: Robust audits to prevent diversion of funds.

Conclusion

Central assistance has been broad in nature but uneven in extent and timing. Faster releases, better governance and own revenue can reduce dependence on the Centre.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 9(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
9(b)

Discuss the sources and trends in revenue of the Andhra Pradesh Government before and after reorganization for the period 2011 – 12 to 2016 – 17.

10

Introduction

The reorganisation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014, which created Telangana, was a major fiscal turning point. It changed the revenue base and expenditure duties of the residual state. Its revenue sources and trends from 2011–12 to 2016–17 show how it adapted after losing Hyderabad and needing a new capital.

Sources of Revenue

1. Own tax revenue: Sales tax (pre-GST), excise, stamp duties and vehicle taxes, supplemented by the state's share in central taxes. These were the backbone of development and administrative spending.
2. Non-tax revenue and grants: User charges, fees and dividends from state enterprises, plus central grants-in-aid such as revenue-deficit grants, vital after 2014.
3. Capital receipts: Internal debt and central loans financed infrastructure, after 2014 borrowing funded new administrative structures and the Amaravati capital.

4. Reorganisation Act: Grants mandated by the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014 helped compensate for lost revenue. The state also had to expand its own tax base.

Trends Before and After Reorganisation

1. Pre-2014 stability: From 2011-12 to 2013-14 revenue receipts grew steadily on a diversified economy and better tax administration.
2. Post-2014 decline: Losing Hyderabad's large tax base caused a sharp fall in total revenue. Fiscal stress rose and capital spending was squeezed.
3. Dependence on Centre and debt: Transfers and borrowing filled gaps, while own tax revenue grew slowly. Persistent audit objections showed weak collection.
4. Leakages: Audits revealed underassessment and leakages in tax and land departments. These hampered collection and fiscal consdidation.

Impact on the Revenue Profile

1. Structural shift: Without Hyderabad's urban economy, revenue relied on agricutture, aquacutture and corridors like

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Revenue before and after reorganisation

2011–12 to 2013–14	After 2014
Steady revenue growth	Sharp fall in revenue
Hyderabad's large tax base	Agriculture, aquaculture, corridors
Diversified economy	Dependence on Centre, debt

Visakhapatnam–Chennai. Off-budget borrowings widened the fiscal deficit.

2. Reforms: Stronger tax administration, digitisation of revenue processes and rationalised user fees, though too slow to offset the loss.

Conclusion

Reorganisation turned a stable revenue profile into one dependent on transfers and borrowing. Expanding the own tax base and plugging leakages are key to fiscal health.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
10(a)

List out the monitorable targets of the 11th Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh State. Also explain the pattern of resource allocation in the 10th and 11th Five Year Plans of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's 11th Five Year Plan aimed to accelerate inclusive growth and human development amid regional disparities, fiscal constraints and infrastructure needs. It set monitorable targets to track progress, while resource allocation in the 10th and 11th Plans shows shifting priorities.

Monitorable Targets of the 11th Plan

1. **Inclusive growth:** Reduce poverty and uplift SCs and STs through the Tribal Sub Plan and Scheduled Castes Sub Plan.
2. **Human development:** Raise literacy, improve health infrastructure and cut infant and maternal mortality.
3. **Agriculture and irrigation:** Boost productivity and irrigation coverage for rural livelihoods and food security.
4. **Infrastructure and industry:** Expand power, transport and communication, with more private participation in communications.

Resource Allocation in the 10th Plan

1. **Agriculture priority:** About 20.2% of resources went to agriculture and allied activities.
2. **Balanced spread:** Power, industry and transport got sizeable shares, with social services at around 27%. This balanced economic and human development.
3. **Regional disparities:** Funds reached backward regions through the Rajiv Gandhi Shrameena Vikas Yojana. The Plan recognised widening disparities.
4. **Public enterprises:** PSUs helped finance the plan, despite subsidy and borrowing issues. Their contribution was significant.

Resource Allocation in the 11th Plan

1. **Social services up:** Their share rose to 30.3%, prioritising education, health and sanitation. This aimed at better human development outcomes.
2. **Agriculture down:** The share fell slightly to 18.5%, signalling diversification while still funding Polavaram. Industrial growth gained priority.
3. **Communications down:** Public outlay fell from

5.1% to 2.6% as the private sector grew. Public money moved to other priorities.

4. Fiscal limits: Revenue deficits and borrowing hampered use of funds. Capital expenditure shortfalls added to the strain.

Allocation shifts, 10th to 11th Plan

10th Plan	11th Plan
Agriculture 20.2%	Agriculture 18.5%
Social services about 27%	Social services 30.3%
Communications 5.1%	Communications 2.6%

Way Forward

1. Monitoring and targeting: Improve capital efficiency, expand real-time monitoring and focus funds on backward districts and vulnerable communities.

Conclusion

Allocation shifted from agriculture towards social services, a turn to human development. Better capital spending, monitoring and targeting of backward districts can deepen these gains.

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 10(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
10(b)

Explain the important features of the proposed strategy of Andhra Pradesh to achieve sustainable development goals by 2030.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's economy grew 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, and the task is to keep this growth sustainable and inclusive by 2030. The state's SDG strategy rests on a whole-of-government approach, integrating sectoral plans under Vision 2029 and using local governance to tackle grassroots challenges.

Key Features of the Strategy

1. **Integrated Vision 2029:** All line departments are aligned with the SDGs by mapping 17 goals into 44 themes and 121 targets, so economic, social and environmental goals advance together without duplication.
2. **Decentralised institutions:** Over 11,000 rural and nearly 4,000 urban Village and Ward Secretariats deliver 541 services across 28 departments at citizens' doorsteps.
3. **Real-time monitoring:** The ROMS system of the Planning Department tracks 212 indicators linked to SDG targets, enabling evidence-based correction.

Practice 10(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Gender and social inclusion: Multi-stakeholder conclaves on SDG (5) address women's workforce participation, health, wage gaps and safety, while schemes target vulnerable groups.
5. Participatory governance: Local representatives and civil society join awareness and capacity-building campaigns, building community ownership.

Andhra Pradesh's SDG strategy at work



Contribution to Achieving the SDGs

1. Inclusive growth: A per capita income of 2,68,653, above the national average, supports poverty reduction and jobs.
2. Social development: Doorstep services improve access to health, education and welfare, advancing SDG (3) and SDG (4).
3. Environmental resilience: Real-time data reveals gaps in waste processing and guides resources for

climate-resilient development.

Way Forward

1. Urban waste management: Expand sanitary landfills and wet waste plants in urban local bodies.
2. Health workforce: Fill medical and nursing vacancies and raise the health budget.
3. Local capacity: Scale up training for district and sub-district officials to align local plans with state goals.
4. Technology: Use the AP Seva Portal and the Sustainable Goals Development Portal for transparent, faster services.

Conclusion

By combining Vision 2029 planning, doorstep delivery and data-driven governance, Andhra Pradesh balances growth with social inclusion and environmental care, and is well placed to meet the 2030 goals inclusively.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
11(a)

Discuss the growth and structure of small and tiny sector establishments in Andhra Pradesh on the basis of data of the 6th Economic Census.

10

Introduction

Small and tiny sector establishments form the backbone of Andhra Pradesh's economy, contributing to employment and entrepreneurship, especially in rural and semi-urban areas. The 6th Economic Census gives a detailed snapshot of their growth and structure, which is vital for designing inclusive policy.

Growth Trends

1. Proprietary dominance: Most establishments operate as proprietary units, reflecting easy entry and low capital needs but also limited formal credit and scale economies.

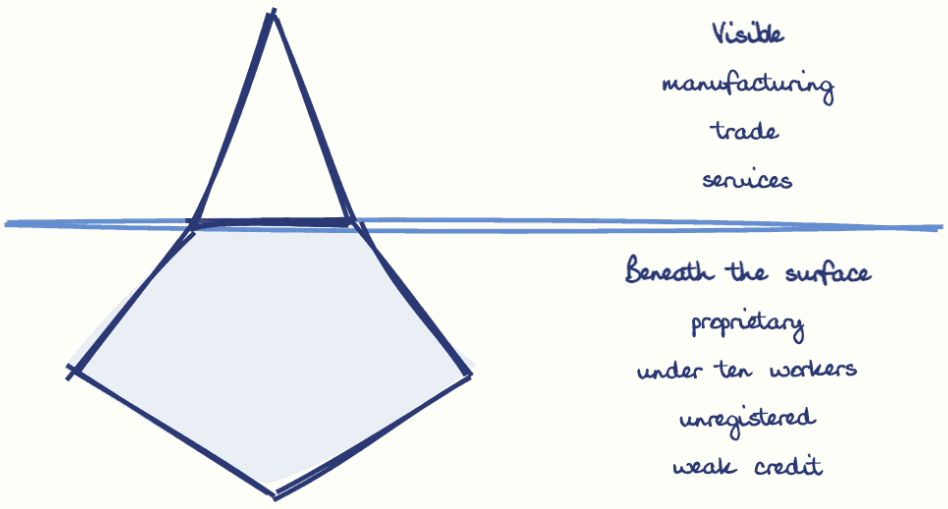
2. Employment absorption: They absorb the growing workforce, particularly in Krishna and Visakhapatnam, where urbanisation and industrial corridors raise demand for small manufacturing and services.

3. Constraints on growth: Credit constraints, technological backwardness and poor market access limit their ability to scale and formalise.

Structural Composition

1. **Sectoral distribution:** Most units are in manufacturing, trade and services, with a significant agro-based share reflecting the agrarian economy.
2. **Size and workforce:** They typically employ fewer than ten workers, often family-run or informal, which lowers productivity and social security access.
3. **Urban-rural divide:** Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada have higher density due to infrastructure, while many rural units lack registration and digital connectivity.
4. **Registration status:** A majority remain unregistered and informal, restricting access to schemes and credit.

Small and tiny units (6th Economic Census)



Implications

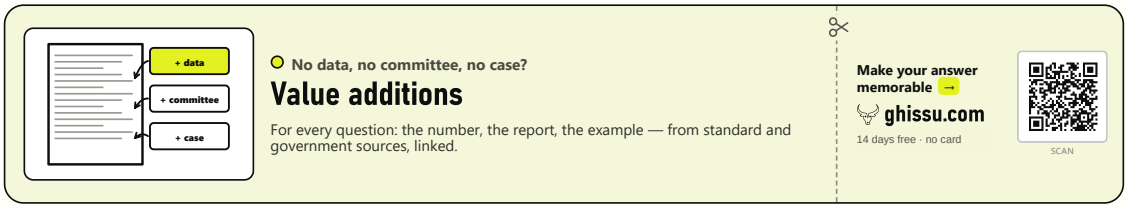
1. Inclusive employment: The sector offers jobs to women, youth and marginalised groups.
2. Formalisation as a lever: Simple registration can open government procurement and exports.
3. Regional balance: Infrastructure in lagging Rayalaseema and cluster development can reduce disparities.

Way Forward

1. Credit and technology: Easier credit through state-level MSME facilitation and digital literacy programmes.
2. Light compliance: Encourage registration without heavy compliance burdens.
3. Cluster programmes: Help small units share infrastructure and reach markets.

Conclusion

Small and tiny establishments are vital for inclusive growth in Andhra Pradesh. Formalisation, credit, technology and infrastructure support can lift their productivity.



P-III
11(b)

Discuss the nature of functioning of Aadhar enabled e-public distribution system (AePDS) in Andhra Pradesh in terms of purchase, transportation, storage, allotment and delivery of food grains.

10

Introduction

The Aadhaar-enabled PDS (AePDS) is a major reform that improves transparency and efficiency in delivering subsidised grain. In Andhra Pradesh, with agrarian challenges and socio-economic diversity, it uses biometric authentication to cut leakages, in line with the National Food Security Act, 2013.

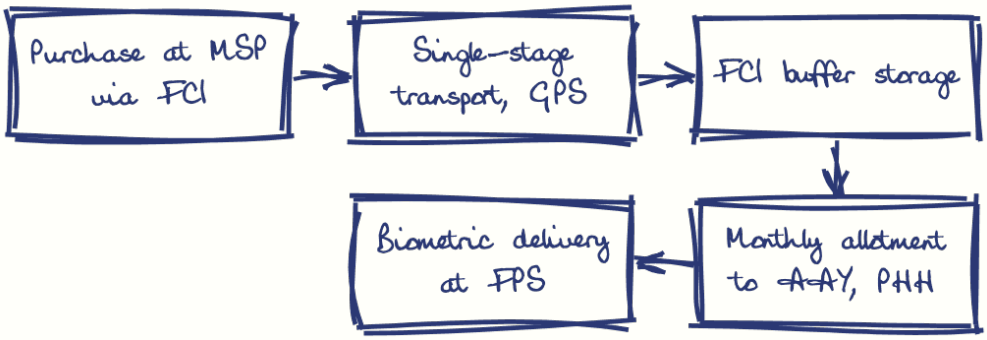
Institutional Set-up

1. Centre-State coordination: The Centre procures through FCI and allocates grain to the state, which distributes through Fair Price Shops.
2. Aadhaar integration: Biometric checks remove duplicate and ghost beneficiaries; 2,689 FPS covering 19 lakh cards moved to AePDS.
3. Digital support: e-Seva provides IT infrastructure and grievance redressal, strengthening institutional capacity.
4. Oversight: CAG reports show weak financial management, so stronger checks are needed.

Functioning of the Supply Chain

1. **Purchase:** Grain is procured at Minimum Support Price, with the state encouraged to maximise decentralised procurement, linked to MSP reforms benefiting over 1.84 crore farmers.
2. **Transportation:** Under the single-stage transport scheme, FCI delivers directly to FPS, bypassing intermediate warehouses, with GPS tracking of trucks.
3. **Storage:** FCI warehouses keep buffer stocks, but state storage gaps cause spoilage.
4. **Allotment:** Monthly allotment to Antyodaya Anna Yojana and Priority Households, with real-time updates.
5. **Delivery:** Biometric verification at FPS prevents diversion.

AePDS Supply Chain in AP



Outcomes and Challenges

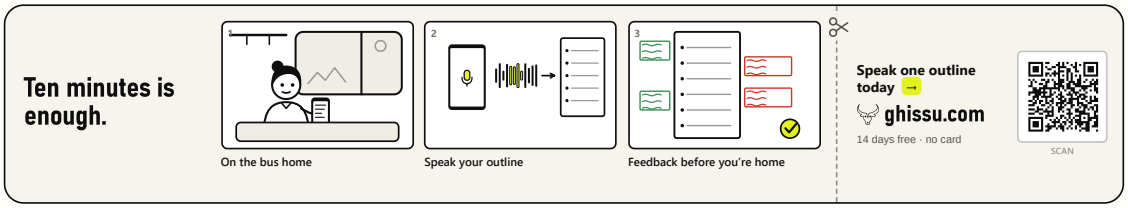
1. Reduced leakages: Fraudulent claims have fallen and targeting has improved.
2. Portability: Beneficiaries can draw rations from any FPS in the state, crucial for migrant and vulnerable people.
3. Last-mile issues: Biometric failures, FPS inefficiency and low awareness persist.
4. Administrative hurdles: Lapses in fund management and administrative delays can undermine timely delivery.

Way Forward

Modern, climate-resilient storage, awareness and technical support at FPS, stricter financial oversight and more decentralised procurement.

Conclusion

AePDS has made AP's food grain chain more transparent and targeted; fixing storage and last-mile gaps will complete the reform.



P-III
12(a)

Evaluate the trends in output and productivity of food and non-food crops in Andhra Pradesh (in the present 13 districts) since the year 2000 – 01. Also bring out the reasons for regional variations in productivity levels.

10

Introduction

Agricutture is a cornerstone of Andhra Pradesh's economy. Since 2000–01, the state's (13) districts have seen notable shifts in the output and productivity of food and non-food crops, shaped by changing cropping patterns, irrigation and technology. Yet regional variations in productivity persist and need attention.

Trends in Output and Productivity

1. Diversified growth: Output grew for staple food grains and strongly for horticutture, chilli and aquacutture. This diversification helped agricuttural GVA grow (10.70%) in 2024–25.
2. High land productivity: The state ranks among the top three nationally in aggregate land productivity, despite lower irrigation coverage than Punjab and Haryana, reflecting efficient resource use.
3. Technology: APCNF, improved seed varieties and precision agricutture have raised yields sustainably.
4. Regional specialisation: Krishna and East

Godavari excel in paddy and horticutture due to fertile soils and better irrigation, while drought-prone Rayalaseema districts adapt by favouring drought-resistant crops.

Regional variations in crop productivity



Dettas lead in paddy; Rayalaseema relies on dry crops

Reasons for Regional Variations

1. Irrigation and water stress: Rayalaseema's limited irrigation and groundwater depletion constrain productivity compared with coastal districts.
2. Soil health and fragmentation: Soil degradation and small holdings reduce economies of scale and mechanisation.
3. Finance and markets: Small farmers in backward

districts lack credit and market links, lowering input efficiency.

4. Climate vulnerability: Erratic monsoons and heat stress cause yield swings in certain districts.

Way Forward

1. Irrigation: Speed up Polavaram and micro-irrigation in drought-prone districts.
2. FPOs and soil health: Use FPOs for smallholders and scale up the Soil Health Card Scheme.

Conclusion

Output and productivity have risen through diversification and technology, but regional gaps remain. Targeted irrigation and sustainable practices can close them under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
12(b)

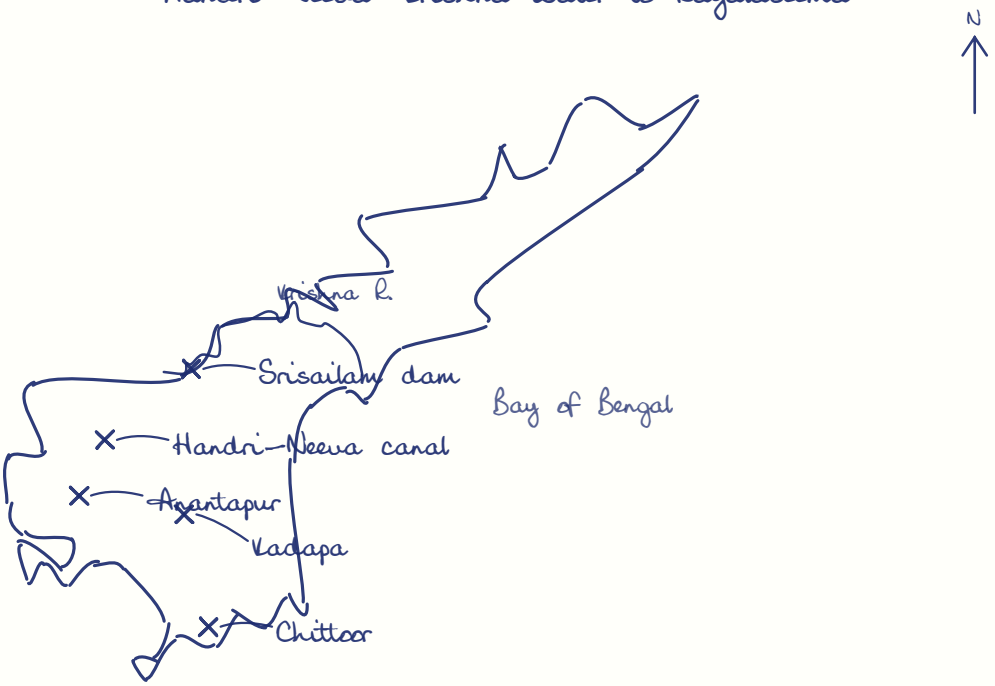
State and discuss the important features of the Handri-Neeva Sujala Sravanthi project and explain its role in meeting the water needs of the Rayalaseema Region.

10

Introduction

Water scarcity is a critical challenge for the drought-prone Rayalaseema region, hurting agriculture and livelihoods. The **Handri-Neeva Sujala Sravanthi** (HNSS) project is a major **inter-basin transfer** that diverts surplus Krishna water to the arid Rayalaseema districts. Amid climate variability and groundwater depletion, it is vital for irrigation and drinking water.

Handri-Neeva: Krishna water to Rayalaseema



Surplus Krishna water lifted to drought-prone districts

Important Features

1. **Inter-basin transfer:** It carries water from the Srisailam reservoir on the Krishna to districts like Anantapur, Kadapa and Chittoor, correcting regional water imbalance.
2. **Multi-purpose canal system:** Canals, reservoirs and lift irrigation schemes move water over long distances and varied terrain for irrigation, drinking and industry.
3. **Phased implementation:** Phase I targets irrigation for about 2.5 lakh acres and drinking water to several villages; later phases widen coverage.
4. **Local conservation:** It complements the Neeru-Chettu programme of tank desilting and minor irrigation repairs.

Role in Meeting Rayalaseema's Water Needs

1. **Irrigation capacity:** Krishna water expands irrigated area and reduces dependence on erratic rain and groundwater, stabilising yields.
2. **Drinking water security:** Safe supply eases scarcity that historically caused distress and migration.
3. **Crop diversification:** Reliable water lets farmers move beyond drought-resistant crops to horticulture and allied activities, raising incomes.

Practice 12(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Challenges: Delays in land acquisition, rehabilitation of Project Displaced Families and incomplete infrastructure, as in other large projects like Polavaram, can hamper timely and equitable delivery.

Way Forward

1. Rehabilitation: Speed up resettlement and land acquisition.
2. Community management: Empower Water Users Associations and Gram Panchayats.
3. Groundwater recharge: Combine canal supply with farm ponds and check dams under Neeru-Chettu.
4. Technology: Use GIS and remote sensing to monitor flows and reduce losses.

Conclusion

HNSS is a transformative initiative that addresses Rayalaseema's chronic water scarcity by harnessing surplus Krishna water for irrigation and drinking needs. Fully implemented, it can raise productivity, reduce drought vulnerability and serve SDG (6) and SDG (2).

Are you actually improving?
Every attempt scored. Watch the curve.
ghissu.com →

P-III
13(a)

Examine the present state of microfinance in Andhra Pradesh in the backdrop of its earlier crisis.

10

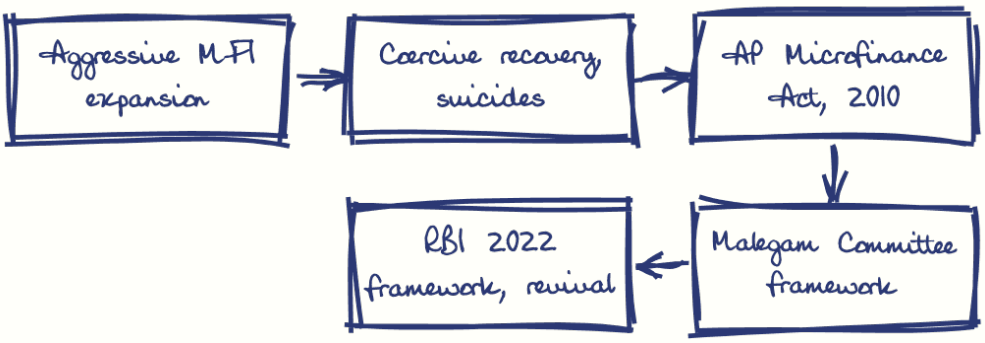
Introduction

Microfinance has been a key tool of financial inclusion in Andhra Pradesh, once a pioneer in lending to the underserved. The sector faced a severe 2010 crisis due to reckless lending and coercive recovery, and its present state is shaped by the reforms that followed.

The 2010 Crisis

1. **Causes:** Aggressive MFI expansion, with AP holding over one-third of all borrowers nationally, led to reckless lending, coercive recovery, borrower distress and suicides.
2. **State clampdown:** The AP Microfinance Act, 2010 imposed stringent curbs, collapsing lending and driving many MFIs out.
3. **National ripple:** RBI formed the Malegam Committee, which recommended a framework for NBFC-MFIs with interest ceilings and fair practice codes.
4. **Social cost:** Borrower trust was dented, and many poor households lost formal credit and returned to moneylenders.

From Crisis to Recovery



Present State of Microfinance

1. **Resilient recovery:** Reforms and renewed investor confidence revived the sector, with MFIs adopting responsible lending and digital tools.
2. **RBI 2022 framework:** It removed interest caps and introduced activity-based regulation, balancing borrower protection and lender sustainability.
3. **National schemes:** MUDRA Yojana loans reach micro-entrepreneurs, including many women and marginalised groups.
4. **Responsible practices:** Income verification and flexible repayment now guard against over-indebtedness.
5. **Digital rails:** Aadhaar and UPI ease transactions, while literacy drives raise borrower awareness.
6. **Persisting gaps:** Outreach in drought-prone

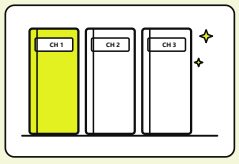
Rayalaseema is limited, and viability versus social goals remains a tension.

Way Forward

1. Financial literacy: Targeted campaigns in vulnerable districts on responsible borrowing.
2. Digital infrastructure: Stronger rural payment and credit assessment systems to cut costs.
3. Credit-plus services: Insurance, savings and skill development to build resilience and cut default risks.
4. Regional models: Strategies for drought-affected and tribal districts.

Conclusion

AP's microfinance has moved from crisis to responsible lending under stronger, RBI-aligned oversight that improves transparency and borrower protection. Literacy, technology and regional strategies can make this recovery durable.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
13(b)

"An efficient power sector is essential for growth and poverty reduction." In light of the above statement, discuss the impact of reorganization of the State on its power sector and the steps initiated by the A.P. State Government to address the issues of the power sector.

10

Introduction

An efficient power sector is a cornerstone of growth and poverty alleviation, as it underpins industry, agricultural productivity and living standards. The 2014 reorganisation, which created Telangana, changed Andhra Pradesh's resources, infrastructure ownership and administrative responsibilities in power, and addressing this was critical for growth.

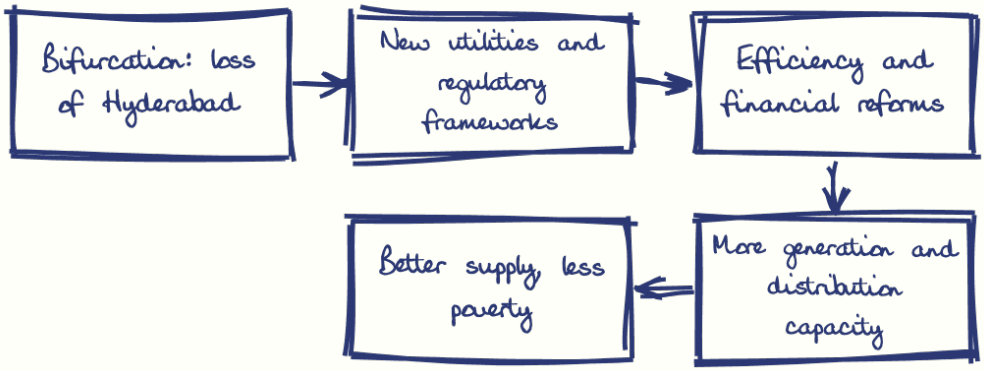
Impact of Reorganisation on the Power Sector

1. Division of resources: Losing Hyderabad, a major power and administrative hub, disrupted infrastructure and supply chains, forcing new assets within the state.
2. Administrative challenges: Separate regulators and utilities complicated coordination and caused transitional inefficiencies.
3. Financial strain: Heavy new investment and legacy liabilities brought revenue shortfalls and debt for power sector SPSEs, hurting discoms.
4. Demand–supply gap: Rising demand in rural and

industrial areas of Rayalaseema and Coastal Andhra went unmet, constraining growth and poverty reduction.

Steps Taken by the State Government

Andhra Pradesh Power Sector Reforms Post-Reorganization



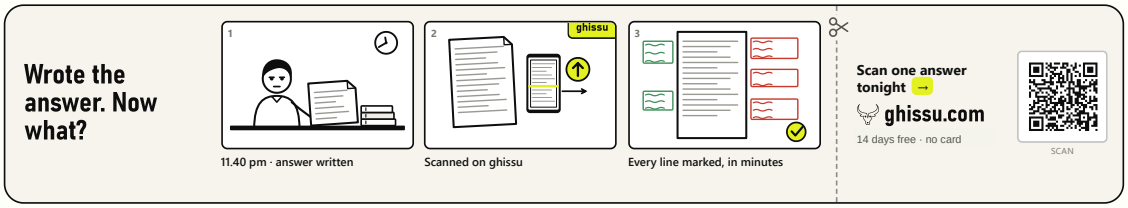
1. Regulatory strengthening: Independent commissions and unbundled utilities under the Electricity Act, 2003.
2. Financial restructuring: UDAY to cut distribution losses, improve billing and manage the debt of power SPSEs, in an economy where SPSEs form 6.69% of GSDP.
3. Infrastructure modernisation: Expanded generation, upgraded transmission and renewable projects supporting corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai.
4. Managerial reforms: Better customer service, performance incentives and steps against power theft and unmetered use.

Way Forward

1. Renewables: Scale up solar and wind using the long coastline and favourable climate to meet rising demand.
2. Discom health: Use advanced metering and digital billing to cut losses and subsidy dependence.
3. Mini-grids: Community-managed mini-grids in drought-prone Rayalaseema for rural electrification.
4. Coordination: Better state-centre coordination to attract private investment.

Conclusion

Reorganisation strained infrastructure, finances and service, but reforms have laid the base for an efficient power sector that sustains growth and poverty reduction under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.



P-III
14(a)

Discuss the objectives, complementary components and the importance of node-centric development of Phase-I of the East Coast Economic Corridor.

10

Introduction

The East Coast Economic Corridor (ECEC) is a flagship initiative to make India's eastern coastline a manufacturing and export hub. Phase-I, the Vizag-Chennai Industrial Corridor (VCIC), aligns with the Act East Policy and Make in India, linking domestic industry to value chains in Southeast and East Asia, and matters greatly for Andhra Pradesh with its long coastline and ports.

Objectives of Phase-I

1. Industrial growth and exports: Port-led industrialisation to raise manufacturing and exports in electronics, automotive and textiles.
2. Multimodal connectivity: Improving NH (16,) rail links and seven operational ports to cut logistics costs.
3. Regional integration: Linking Visakhapatnam and Chennai through clusters that create agglomeration economies and jobs.
4. Sustainable, inclusive growth: Environmental safeguards and opportunities for local SMEs.

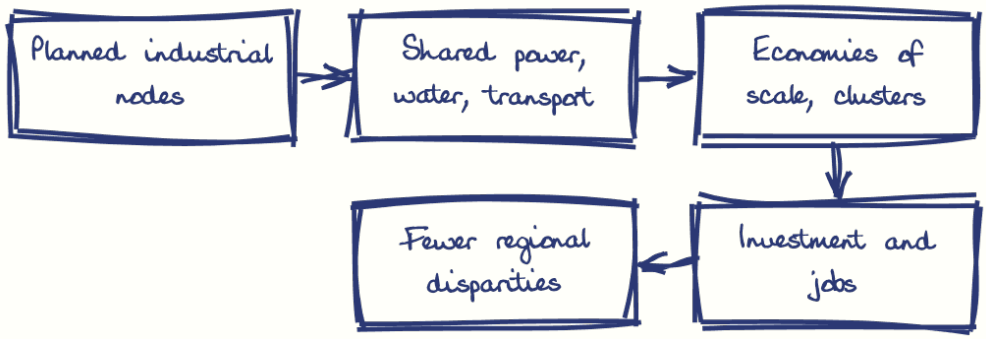
Practice 14(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2017 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

Complementary Components

1. **Transport upgradation:** Modernising NH (16) and the Kolkata–Chennai rail route.
2. **Clusters and SEZs:** Townships such as the proposed Japanese industrial township in Andhra Pradesh to attract FDI.
3. **Port modernisation:** Higher cargo capacity at Visakhapatnam and Chennai.
4. **Digital and regulatory frameworks:** ICT-enabled governance eases business.

Why node-centric development works



Importance of Node-Centric Development

1. **Localised growth poles:** Planned nodes attract investment and jobs, reducing regional disparities.
2. **Infrastructure synergies:** Concentrating power, water and transport creates economies of scale.
3. **Cluster benefits:** Shared suppliers, skilled labour and innovation spillovers raise productivity.

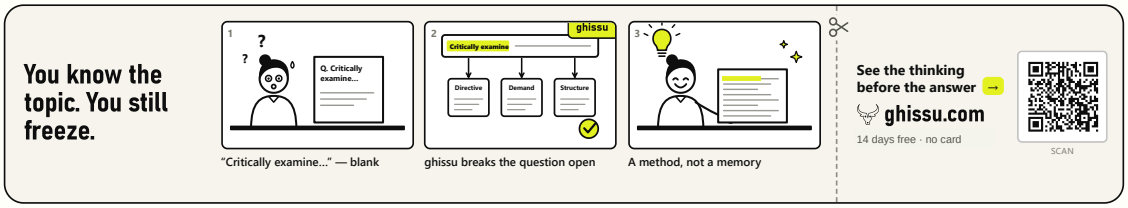
4. Inclusive urbanisation: Integrating urban infrastructure with industry improves living standards and spreads gains to local people, including vulnerable groups.

Way Forward

1. PPPs: Greater private participation in infrastructure and cluster management.
2. Skills: Targeted training in corridor nodes, especially Andhra Pradesh's industrial townships.

Conclusion

Phase-I of the ECEC, built on node-centric development and complementary infrastructure, can make the east coast a competitive and inclusive manufacturing hub.



P-III
14(b)

"The main aim of Andhra Pradesh State Mineral Policy is to serve as a guiding force to translate the State's mineral potential into reality with eco-friendly and sustainable mining." Discuss.

10

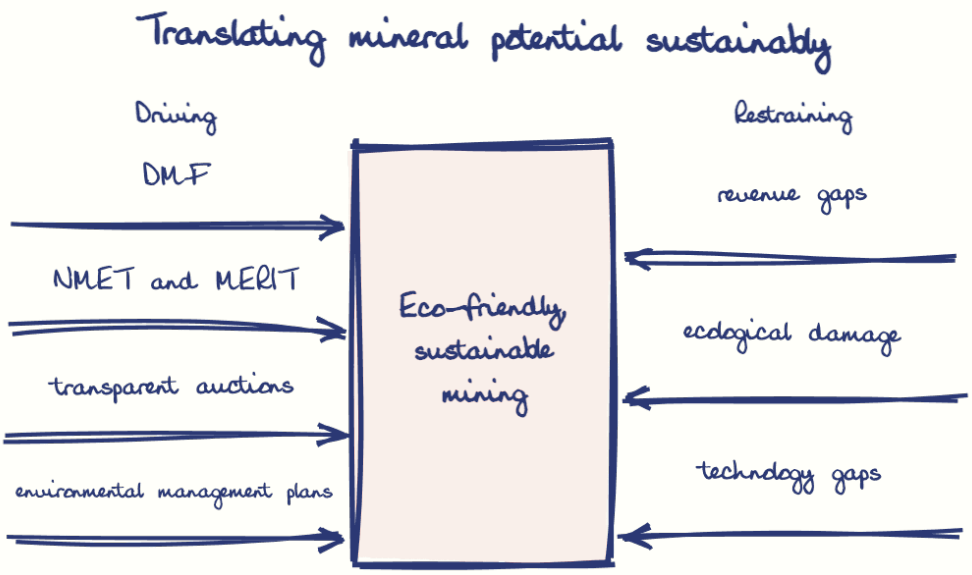
Introduction

The mineral sector drives growth and industry in resource-rich Andhra Pradesh. With vast barytes and limestone reserves, the State Mineral Policy aims to harness this potential responsibly, balancing economic gain with environmental sustainability as the state targets GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024-25.

Institutional Framework

1. Regulatory mechanisms: The District Mineral Foundation, the National Mineral Exploration Trust and MERIT ensure mineral wealth benefits local communities and spurs exploration. Innovation in exploration is encouraged.
2. Oversight bodies: The State Coordination cum Empowered Committee and Public Accounts Committee address gaps flagged by the CAG, such as revenue shortfalls.
3. Environmental compliance: Mines need approved mining and environmental management plans, in line with Supreme Court directives on illegal mining.
4. Transparent auctions: Auctions for leases and

licences curb corruption and illegal mining which caused shortfalls of up to 52% in 2017–22.



Implementation Challenges

1. **Revenue gaps:** Receipts were Rs 2,983 crore in 2025–26 against an estimate of Rs 3,550 crore. Enforcement and monitoring remain weak.
2. **Ecological damage:** The policy stresses concurrent reclamation, afforestation and converting disused mines to forests, which are hard to enforce. Mining has caused land degradation.
3. **Fragile zones:** Avoiding mining in ecologically fragile zones needs capacity and community engagement. Restoration must follow extraction.
4. **Technology gaps:** Uneven adoption limits efficiency and environmental performance. Stronger incentives

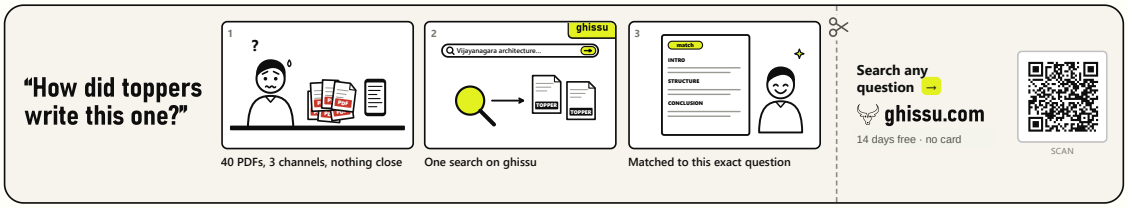
and partnerships are needed.

Way Forward

1. Revenue monitoring: Digital tracking and audit mechanisms to reduce leakages and improve royalty compliance.
2. Environmental capacity: Train local authorities and mining firms to implement environmental plans and restoration.
3. Community participation: Widen the DMF's role so that mining benefits are shared fairly and social impacts are reduced.
4. Innovation: PPPs and research collaborations to speed up sustainable mining technology.

Conclusion

The Mineral Policy is a crucial guide to unlocking mineral potential with eco-friendly and sustainable mining, balancing revenue with restoration. Its aim will be met only through strong governance, enforcement and community involvement, in line with SDG (8.)



P-III
15(a)

State the important features of the Infrastructure Mission of Andhra Pradesh and discuss its role in Vision 2029.

10

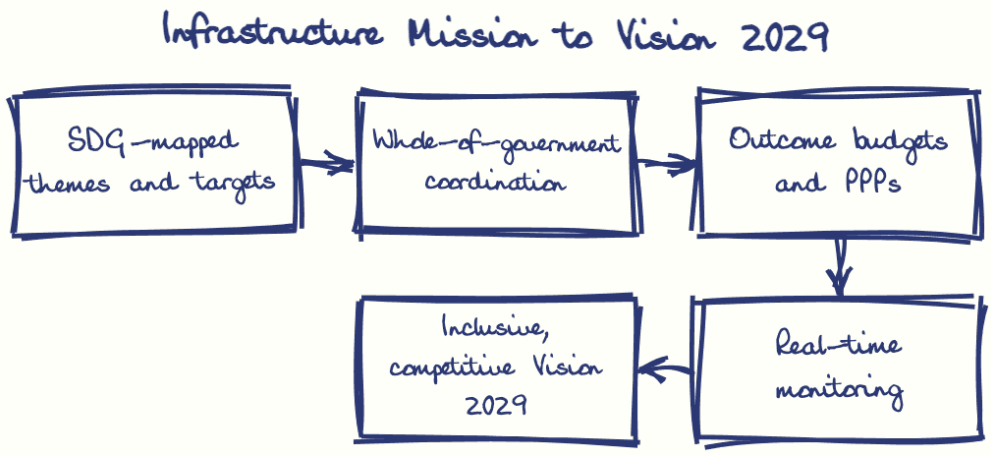
Introduction

Infrastructure is a critical driver of Andhra Pradesh's Vision 2029, which aims to build a globally competitive and inclusive economy. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, sustaining momentum needs strategic investment. The Infrastructure Mission integrates physical, digital and social infrastructure within an SDG-aligned framework.

Features of the Infrastructure Mission

1. **Whole-of-government coordination:** All line departments are aligned with SDG targets, enabling integrated planning and monitoring without duplication.
2. **SDG integration:** Initiatives are mapped to 44 themes and 121 SDG targets, linking infrastructure to human development and inclusive growth.
3. **Institutional partnerships:** The state works with NITI Aayog and presented its SDG strategy at the UN High-Level Political Forum in 2017.
4. **Outcome budgets:** Resources follow priorities, supporting fiscal targets such as a revenue deficit of 1.1% of GSDP in 2026–27.

5. Private participation: Better risk-sharing and contract management attract investment.



Role in Vision 2029

1. Inclusive growth: Connectivity, services and jobs reach lagging regions like Rayalaseema and coastal Andhra.
2. Sustainability: Climate-resilient planning and groundwater recharge earned the highest national score in source augmentation.
3. Real-time governance: Digital infrastructure improves transparency and citizen engagement.
4. Competitiveness: The Visakhapatnam-Chennai and Hyderabad-Bengaluru corridors integrate the state into global value chains.

Implementation Challenges

1. Delays: Polavaram, a flagship project, has

rehabilitated only (11%) of Project Displaced Families after (17) years, reflecting slow land acquisition and resettlement.

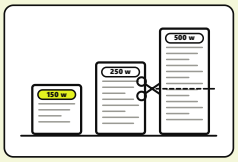
2. Social gaps: (22%) of specialist health posts remain vacant, hurting service quality and human development.

Way Forward

1. Monitoring: Use real-time monitoring to clear land acquisition and rehabilitation delays.
2. Health: Fill vacancies and upgrade facilities.
3. Private capital: Build clear PPP frameworks with risk mitigation.
4. Sustainability: Embed climate resilience metrics in all planning.

Conclusion

The Infrastructure Mission is a cornerstone of Vision (2029), and timely execution can turn its plans into inclusive, sustainable growth.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
15(b)

Explain the details of the "Arogya Raksha" scheme started by the Government of Andhra Pradesh. Also compare the scheme with other health insurance schemes of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Health insurance is vital for healthcare access and financial protection of vulnerable people. Andhra Pradesh, facing health infrastructure gaps flagged by the CAG, introduced Arogya Raksha to extend cover beyond the poor to economically weaker sections and the missing middle.

Details of the Scheme

1. **Beyond BPL:** It extends insurance to Above Poverty Line (APL) families, filling a major gap.
2. **Sum insured:** Rs 2 lakh a year per individual, covering 1,044 procedures, far above the Rs 30,000 per family of earlier BPL schemes.
3. **Co-payment for APL:** The state bears 70% of the cost and the insured 30%, keeping it affordable with shared responsibility.
4. **Cashless hospitalisation:** Treatment at empanelled government and private hospitals for secondary and tertiary care.

Comparison with Other AP Schemes

Arogya Raksha vs Other Andhra Pradesh Schemes

Arogya Raksha	Other AP Schemes
APL and missing middle	Mainly BPL and vulnerable
Rs 2 lakh per individual	Rs 30,000 per family
Co-payment for APL	Mostly free for BPL
Government and private hospitals	Mostly government hospitals

1. Broader target: Unlike YSR Aarogyasri, which focused mainly on BPL families, it explicitly covers APL households and the missing middle.
2. Higher cover: A higher per-individual sum insured, against limited per-family cover elsewhere, protects against costlier treatment.
3. Cost sharing: The co-payment model balances fiscal sustainability and affordability.
4. Complements PM-JAY: Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY covers the poorest, Arogya Raksha covers those left out.

Way Forward

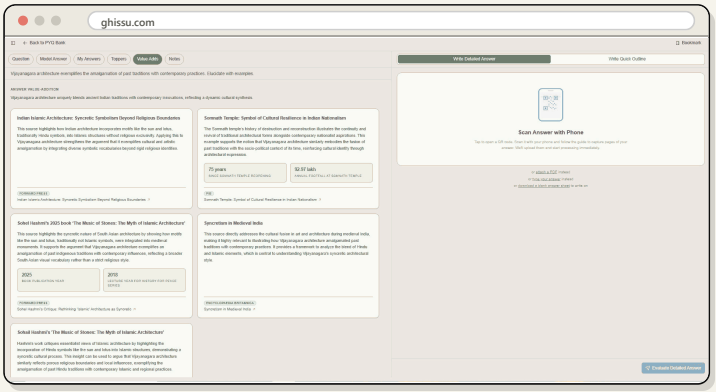
1. **Awareness:** Outreach in rural and semi-urban areas to raise enrolment of the missing middle.
2. **Hospital network:** Empanel more private hospitals in underserved regions to cut out-of-pocket costs.
3. **Digital health:** Use the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission for beneficiary identification and claims.

Conclusion

Arogya Raksha broadens AP's health insurance to the missing middle and, through co-payment, balances wider inclusion with fiscal prudence.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP VALUE ADDITIONS

Correct answer. Average marks. Why?



Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 Value additions for one question, ready to use.

2 Numbers you can quote — each with its source.

3 Picked only from standard and government sources.

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2016

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

P-III
1(a)

Discuss the difficulties faced in measuring the developmental level of economy and justify whether the current method of measurement in India overcomes the difficulties.

10

Introduction

Measuring an economy's level of development is crucial for policy and for tracking inclusive growth. Rapid change, such as Andhra Pradesh's 9.24% GSDP growth in 2024–25 against the national 6.4%, demands accurate tools, yet development is multidimensional, combining quantitative and qualitative factors, which makes measurement inherently complex.

Difficulties in Measuring Development

1. Defining Development: It spans income, health, education, social security and environment, so consensus is hard for bodies like MoSPI and the Standing Committee on Economic Statistics.
2. Data Collection and Dissemination: The IMF's SDDS report flagged India's delays in timely data release.
3. Informal Economy: Andhra Pradesh's large agrarian and informal sectors remain outside formal statistics.
4. Qualitative Dimensions: Social prestige, sustainability and community well-being are hard

to quantify.

5. Employment Quality: Jobless growth and youth underemployment are poorly captured by inconsistent data, as in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
6. Regional Disparities: National averages mask sub-national inequality, as Andhra Pradesh's higher per capita income shows.

Does the Current Method Overcome These?

1. Improvements: The HDI adds health and education to income, the GDP base revision to 2022-23 and NITI Aayog's Output-Outcome Framework reflect structural change.
2. Persisting Gaps: GDP still ignores social welfare and environmental costs.
3. Missing Sustainability Indices: Measures urged since the 1992 Rio Earth Summit are absent.
4. Weak Sub-National Data: State-level granularity remains limited.

Way Forward

1. Multidimensional Indices: Go beyond GDP and HDI to add sustainability, social equity and quality of life, tailored to state contexts like Andhra Pradesh's aquaculture and horticulture.

Does the current method overcome difficulties?

Difficulty	Current method
Development is multidimensional	HDI adds health, education
Structural change missed	GDP base revised to 2022–23
Environmental costs	Still ignored by GDP
Sub-national disparities	State data still weak

2. Data Infrastructure: Digital collection, real-time monitoring and tools like the GoIStats app.
3. Informal Sector: Better surveys and administrative data for unorganised activity.
4. Transparency: Regular audits and public release of development data.

Conclusion

Measuring development means overcoming definitional ambiguity, data limits and qualitative complexity. India's HDI and revised GDP series have made strides but only partly overcome these difficulties, especially at the sub-national level. Multidimensional measurement is needed for development that is equitable and resilient.

Write your own answer to 1(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
1(b)

Discuss briefly the major changes involved in the recent revision in the base year and method of national income accounting.

10

Introduction

Revising the base year and methoddogy of national income accounting is essential to reflect the economy's changing structure. The latest revision to base year 2022–23, scheduled for February 2026, adds new data sources and international standards, improving GDP estimates for policy, investment and global comparison.

Major Changes in Institutions and Data

1. ACNAS: The Advisory Committee on National Account Statistics, set up in June 2024, and its sub-committees guide methods and data, ensuring expert consensus.
2. New Data Sources: ASUSE and PLFS provide frequent, detailed data on informal and household sectors.
3. Global Alignment: Methods follow the UN's SNA 2008, with preparation for SNA 2025.
4. Basic Prices: GVA shifts from factor cost to basic prices, capturing production taxes and subsidies.

Major Changes in Method and Coverage

1. **Chain-Base Method:** Replacing the fixed base, it updates weights annually, so changes like the gig economy show up without the earlier 5–7 year delay.
2. **Corporate and Financial Coverage:** The MCA21 database, activity-wise revenue shares and inclusion of stock brokers and asset managers improve output measurement, significant in states like Andhra Pradesh with growing service industries.
3. **Regional Accounts:** State-specific data, including from Andhra Pradesh, helps understand sub-national dynamics, vital for post-bifurcation planning and projects like Polavaram and port-led industrial corridors.

What the revision changed

Earlier	Revised
GVA at factor cost	GVA at basic prices
Fixed base year	Chain-base, annual weights
Thin informal data	ASUSE and PLFS data
Limited corporate coverage	MCA21 database

Challenges

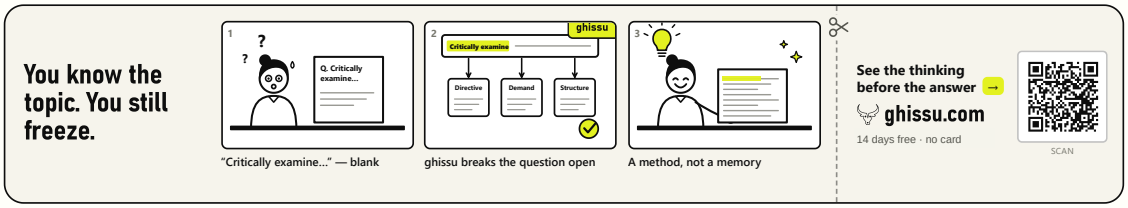
1. Timeliness: The IMF's SDDS reports noted delays and gaps in India's data release.
2. State Capacity: State statistical systems need strengthening for granular data.

Way Forward

1. Full Chain-Base Adoption: Annual weight updates for faster capture of emerging sectors.
2. State Data Infrastructure: Build capacity, especially in Andhra Pradesh, for timely regional accounts.
3. Digital Sources: Wider use of platforms like MCA21.
4. Dissemination: Align releases with SDDS guidelines to build trust.

Conclusion

The revision is a significant step towards accurate, timely and comparable statistics. By capturing structural change and widening coverage of informal, corporate and financial activity, it strengthens evidence-based policymaking and investor confidence.



P-III
2(a)

Eleventh five year plan identified the weaknesses on the employment front during the period of reforms. Describe them.

10

Introduction

The Eleventh Five Year Plan (2007–2012) was formulated when India was deep into economic reforms aimed at faster and more inclusive growth. Despite robust GDP growth, the Plan highlighted serious weaknesses in employment generation that threatened to undermine the benefits of reform.

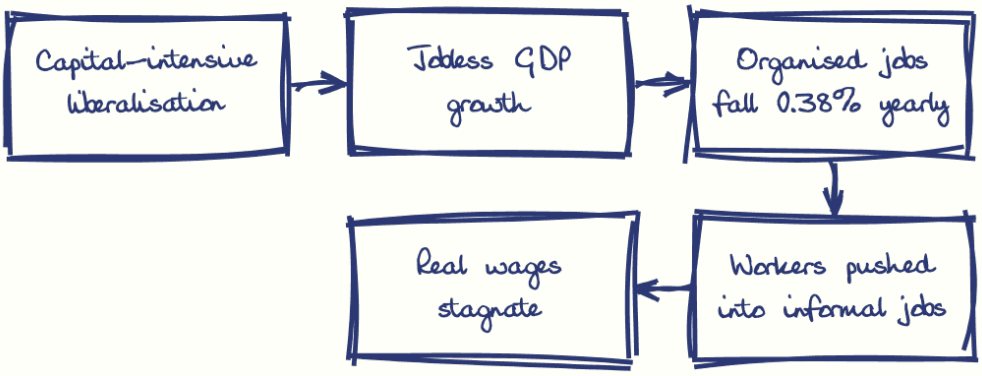
Weaknesses Identified by the Plan

1. Jobless growth: GDP growth did not translate into adequate employment, and unemployment rose sharply among agricultural labour households.
2. Decline in organised employment: Organised sector jobs fell at 0.38% a year during 1994–2004, frustrating educated youth. Capital intensity and outsourcing drove this.
3. Dominance of informal jobs: Non-agricultural employment grew 4.7% a year in 1999–2005, but mainly as low-productivity self-employment without security or benefits.
4. Wage stagnation and inequality: Real non-farm wages stagnated, workers' wages fell while managerial salaries rose, and the wage share

halved in organised industry after the 1980s.

5. Structural mismatch: Skill gaps and regional disparities, as in agrarian Andhra Pradesh, slowed absorption of surplus farm labour.

How reforms weakened employment



Why Reforms Produced These Weaknesses

1. Capital-intensive growth: Liberalisation raised capital intensity and cut labour absorption in the organised sector.
2. Neglect of SMEs: Labour-intensive SMEs lacked clear policy support, and a focus on contract farming and capital-intensive agriculture sidelined small peasants.
3. Rigid labour laws: Tension between worker protection and flexibility slowed formal job creation.
4. Informal sector as safety net: As the formal

sector could not absorb the growing labour force, workers moved into precarious informal jobs with little social security.

5. Regional imbalance: Andhra Pradesh's coastal corridors grew while drought-prone Rayalaseema lagged, leaving its surplus farm labour unabsorbed.

Conclusion

The Plan showed that growth alone does not create good jobs: unemployment rose, organised employment shrank, informal work dominated and wages stagnated. Support for labour-intensive SMEs, skilling and labour reform with social security are essential for inclusive growth.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

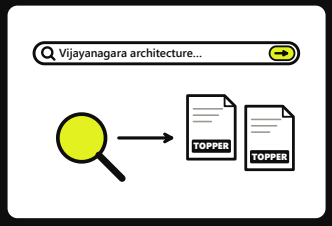
Read a topper copy like an examiner

Don't read a topper's answer for its facts. Read it for its moves — they transfer to any question.

1. **First two lines** — How does the intro frame the demand?
2. **Headings** — How is the body split — by dimension, by actor, by time?
3. **Proof** — Which fact, report or case holds up each paragraph?
4. **Last two lines** — What way forward, and how specific is it?

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

1.5 lakh+ topper answers are matched to each question — with their intro, structure and conclusion laid bare.



Search any question →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
2(b)

Discuss briefly the guiding principles in setting up the NITI Aayog.

10

Introduction

The setting up of NITI Aayog in 2015, replacing the Planning Commission, marked a paradigm shift in India's planning. It was driven by the need for a flexible, cooperative and outcome-oriented body suited to a rapidly evolving economy and a diverse federal structure, as India targets a $30 trillion economy by 2047.

Guiding Principles

1. **Cooperative Federalism:** A lean platform where the Governing Council, chaired by the Prime Minister, includes all Chief Ministers, giving states an active role in policy.
2. **Bottom-up Planning:** Credible village-level plans are formulated and progressively aggregated, bringing local priorities into national strategy.
3. **Expertise and Flexibility:** A knowledge hub of experts from academia, research bodies and practice gives strategic advice, unlike the rigid top-down predecessor.
4. **Good Governance:** Inspired by Chanakya's dictum, it stresses transparency, accountability and a shift from outlays to measurable outcomes.

5. Antyodaya and Inclusion: Upliftment of marginalised and vulnerable sections.

Planning Commission vs NITI Aayog

Planning Commission	NITI Aayog
Top-down planning	Bottom-up village plans
Rigid structure	Flexible knowledge hub
Focus on outlays	Focus on outcomes

Principles in Practice

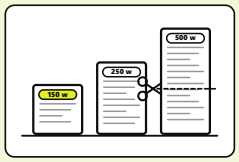
1. State Engagement: (26) State Institutions for Transformation and regional councils address inter-state issues, including those of Andhra Pradesh.
2. Inclusive Development: The Aspirational Districts Programme in (112) districts and the Aspirational Blocks Programme reach backward regions of Andhra Pradesh.
3. Data-Driven Monitoring: Real-time tracking of (49) key indicators enables mid-course corrections.
4. Limitations: It lacks implementation powers and financial autonomy, relying on scheme convergence.

Way Forward

1. Implementation Authority: Statutory backing for a stronger role in monitoring and implementation would ensure policy adherence and timely execution across states.
2. Dedicated Fund: A fund for strategic interventions would reduce dependence on scheme convergence and support innovation in lagging regions like Rayalaseema.
3. Data and Research: Expanding the Research and Networking Division and adopting open data policies would improve evidence-based policy.
4. People's Participation: Digital platforms can deepen citizen engagement so that development reaches all sections.

Conclusion

NITI Aayog's principles of cooperative federalism, inclusion, innovation and good governance have made planning adaptive and participatory, supporting Viksit Bharat 2047. Its success will depend on turning these principles into results through the states, which remain the main implementers of development.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
3(a)

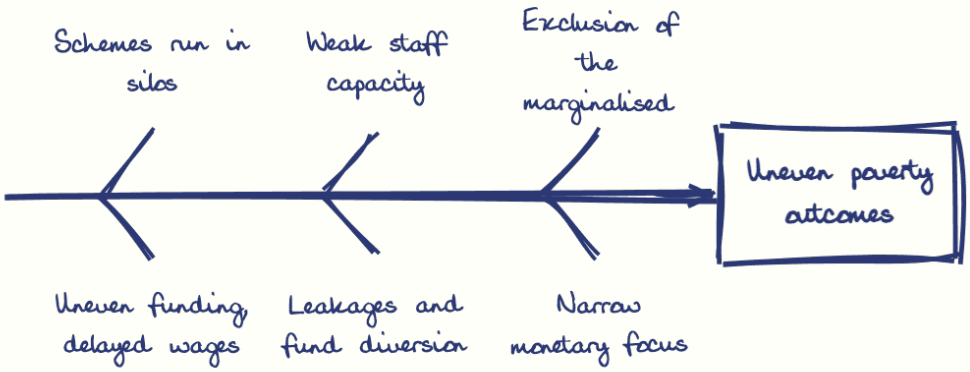
Explain the possible limitations in the strategy for poverty alleviation adopted by the Government of India.

10

Introduction

India has made significant strides in poverty alleviation, with multidimensional poverty falling from 29.17% in 2013–14 to 11.28% in 2022–23. The rights-based approach legally guarantees access to resources and services, but uneven outcomes reveal limits in strategy and implementation.

Limits of the Anti-Poverty Strategy



Institutional Design and Capacity Limits

1. Fragmented governance: MGNREGA, the National Food Security Act and PDS operate in silos, causing duplication and lack of convergence.
2. Inadequate resources: Inconsistent MGNREGA funding, budget cuts and delayed wages undermine guaranteed benefits, including in Andhra Pradesh.

3. Weak capacity: Limited skilled personnel, such as health worker shortages under the National Health Mission, hamper delivery.

4. Corruption and leakages: Audits in Andhra Pradesh reveal diversion of welfare funds, excess payments and delayed claims.

Implementation Limits and Outcomes

1. Narrow monetary focus: Schemes offer financial support but neglect social, political and health dimensions, leaving 364 million Indians multidimensionally poor.

2. Exclusion of the marginalised: Intersectional barriers of caste, gender and ethnicity block access, as Dalits and Adivasis are excluded from PDS due to documentation issues.

3. Weak monitoring: Poor data and no real-time feedback delay course corrections in NRLM.

4. Regional disparities: Drought-hit, underdeveloped Rayalaseema lags while other regions advance faster, reflecting uneven resource distribution and governance capacity.

Way Forward

1. Convergence: Build integrated governance frameworks so that schemes address multiple deprivations together.

2. Predictable funding: Secure timely funds with digital audits and beneficiary tracking to cut leakages and delays.
3. Targeted inclusion: Use technology and community engagement to bring marginalised groups into entitlements and social protection.
4. Capacity and data: Train frontline workers and build real-time monitoring platforms for evidence-based policy.

Conclusion

India's rights-based strategy has laid a strong legal foundation, but limits in institutional design, resources and implementation hold it back. Fixing these gaps is essential to achieve SDG (1) and Viksit Bharat (2047), so that growth becomes shared prosperity for all.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 3(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
3(b)

Discuss the possible consequences of rural unemployment on the society and suggest two effective remedial measures.

10

Introduction

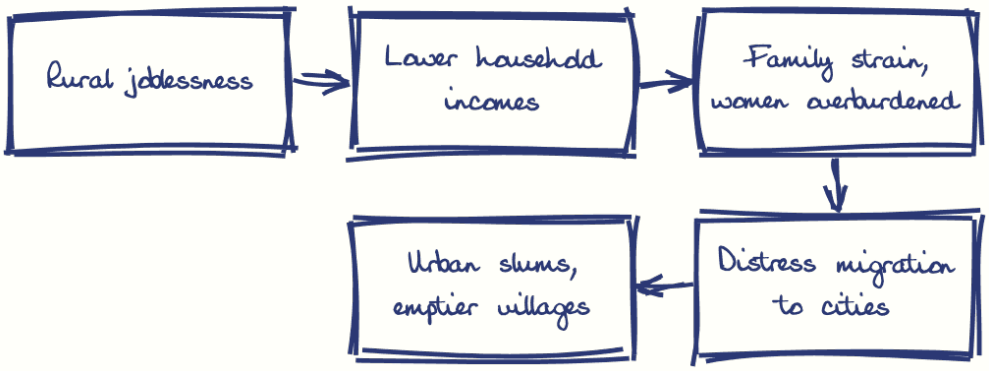
Rural unemployment remains a critical challenge, as the rural population forms a large share of India's workforce. Stagnant job creation drives distress migration and social instability, worsened by widening rural–urban income gaps and COVID-19, and seen in agrarian distress and male outmigration in Andhra Pradesh.

Consequences for Society

1. **Persistent poverty:** Lower incomes slow poverty reduction. Rural extreme poverty fell from 18.4% in 2011–12 to 2.8% in 2022–23, but more slowly than urban poverty.
2. **Family disorganisation:** Unemployment creates tension, as when jobless men resist women taking jobs. Sociologists like Joanna Cdcord documented how this weakens family and community cohesion.
3. **Migration and urban pressure:** Workers move to cities, causing unplanned growth and slums and straining urban services, while villages lose their productive workforce.

4. Gendered work burden: Disguised unemployment leaves women working longer for lower wages, and the feminisation of responsibility adds to their load without empowerment.

Ripple Effects of Rural Unemployment



Two Effective Remedial Measures

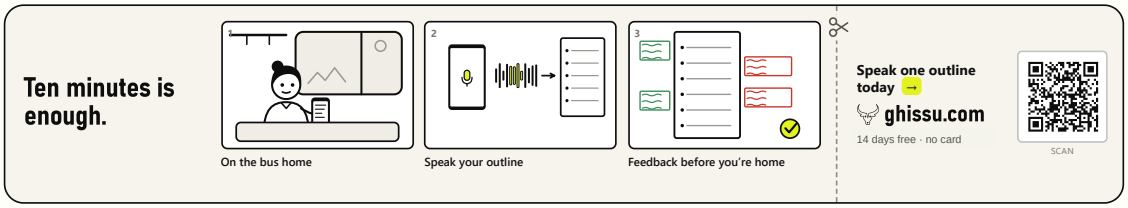
1. Strengthen and expand MGNREGA: Guaranteed wage employment absorbed rural labour during COVID-19. In Andhra Pradesh it eased distress and gave income security, especially to women, who form a large share of its workforce.
2. Skill development through RSETIs: Rural Self-Employment Training Institutes, set up with banks in districts of Andhra Pradesh, give rural youth vocational skills for self-employment and entrepreneurship, closing the mismatch between education and job skills.

Supporting Steps

1. Rural industrialisation: Agro-based and cottage industries under Article 43 can create lasting jobs.
2. Infrastructure: Expanding PM Gram Sadak Yojana in Andhra Pradesh improves connectivity, market access and village economic opportunities.
3. Market-linked training: Aligning skill programmes with local and export market needs helps absorb rural youth into productive work.
4. Social security nets: Direct income support and food security schemes protect vulnerable households during employment fluctuations.

Conclusion

Rural unemployment hurts economic stability, social harmony and demographic patterns. MGNREGA and RSETIs, backed by rural industry and infrastructure, can foster inclusive and sustainable rural growth in line with SDG 8.



P-III
4(a)

Discuss briefly the recommendations of the expert committee constituted "To revise and strengthen the monetary policy framework".

10

Introduction

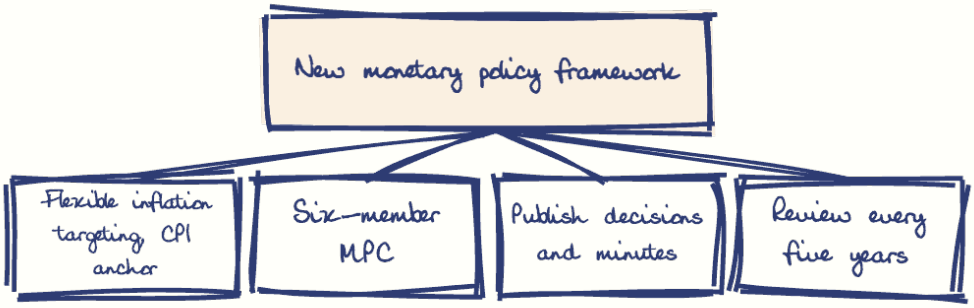
India's monetary policy framework has evolved to meet changing economic realities. The expert committee constituted to revise and strengthen it aimed to make monetary policy more effective in controlling inflation while supporting growth, amid financial liberalisation, global shocks and later COVID-19.

Key Recommendations of the Committee

1. **Flexible inflation targeting:** Adopt inflation targeting as the nominal anchor, with a CPI inflation target of (4%) and a tolerance band of +/- (2%). This was formalised in the Monetary Policy Framework Agreement of (2015).
2. **Monetary Policy Committee:** A six-member MPC of three RBI officials and three government-appointed members, replacing the sole discretion of the RBI Governor to improve transparency and accountability.
3. **Transparent communication:** The MPC must publish its decisions, voting patterns and minutes within (14) days, helping markets understand the policy rationale.

4. Institutional strengthening: Review the framework every five years and maintain adequate risk buffers in RBI's balance sheet for financial stability.

Key recommendations of the committee



Rationale Behind the Revision

1. Price stability with growth: Price stability is the foremost objective. A clear anchor reduces inflation volatility that harms investment and consumption, vital for price-sensitive sectors in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Credibility and predictability: The MPC and open communication anchor inflation expectations, reducing uncertainty for households and investors.
3. Financial liberalisation: The earlier multiple indicator approach lost effectiveness with financial innovation, so policy was aligned with market-determined rates.

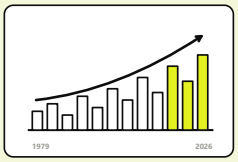
4. Shocks and volatility: The flexible framework allows an accommodative stance when needed, as during COVID-19.

Way Forward

1. Better transmission: Ensure policy rate changes reach lending rates, especially where markets are less developed.
2. Data capacity: Robust data systems and research will help the MPC reflect real-time conditions and regional disparities.
3. Financial inclusion: Wider access to formal finance in states like Andhra Pradesh improves the reach of monetary policy.

Conclusion

By institutionalising inflation targeting and the MPC, the committee modernised India's monetary policy, making it transparent, credible and responsive, in line with Viksit Bharat @2047.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
4(b)

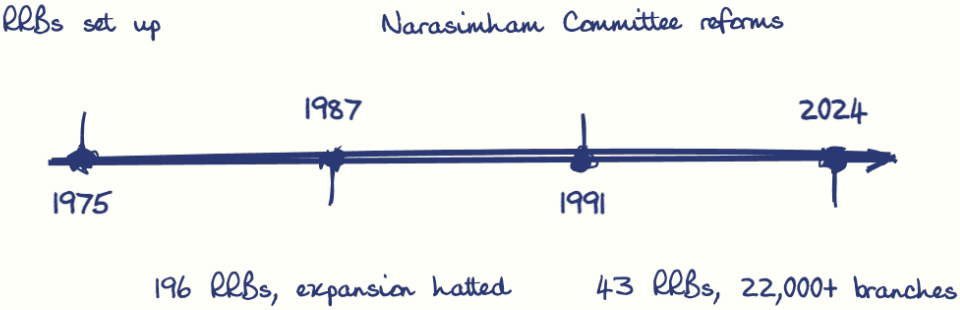
Explain the need for emergence of Regional rural banks, and discuss the problems faced by them and the corresponding revisions made.

10

Introduction

Formal banking long bypassed small and marginal farmers, artisans and rural entrepreneurs, leaving them dependent on informal moneylenders. Regional Rural Banks (RRBs) emerged in 1975 to bridge this gap with accessible, affordable credit suited to rural needs, a role still vital in agrarian states like Andhra Pradesh.

Evolution of RRBs



Need for the Emergence of RRBs

1. Targeted rural outreach: RRBs were mandated to serve weaker sections such as small farmers and artisans, blending government support with commercial banking expertise.

2. Local focus: Their operation was limited to notified districts for focused service delivery.
3. Tripartite ownership: Share capital comes from the Centre (50%), State (15%) and sponsoring bank (35%), pooling resources and expertise.

Problems Faced

1. Financial losses: By 1987 there were 196 RRBs, but expansion hatted as excessive social banking without recovery mechanisms caused losses.
2. Poor viability: Low recovery rates and rising wage bills eroded sustainability, while overlap with sponsor banks' rural branches raised costs.
3. Coverage gaps: Only 18.4% of rural people had deposit accounts with commercial banks including RRBs.
4. Regional disparity: The southern region, including Andhra Pradesh, has many branches and earns nearly half of total profits, so performance is uneven.
5. Current concerns: Deposit growth lags commercial banks, with difficulty in raising low-cost deposits and managing NPAs.

Revisions Made

1. Narasimham Committee (1991): It urged combining RRBs' local character with sponsor bank strength, rural subsidiaries of commercial banks, branch rationalisation and allowing all types of banking business.
2. Consolidation: As of 2024, 43 RRBs operate through over 22,000 branches, 91.8% in rural and semi-urban areas.
3. Proposed reforms: RBI's updated prudential norms and risk management guidelines aim at better governance.
4. Way forward: Digital banking, Business Correspondents and staff training can cut costs and improve recovery.

Conclusion

RRBs have extended institutional credit to rural India. Reforms and technology can resolve their viability problems and make them pillars of rural financial inclusion.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
5(a)

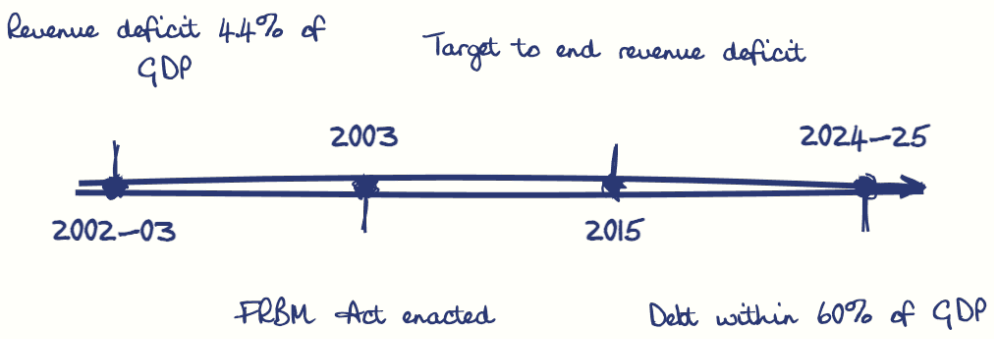
Describe the highlights of Fiscal Reforms and Budget Management Act 2003.

10

Introduction

The FRBM Act, 2003 was enacted against a high revenue deficit of 4.4% of GDP in 2002–03, which showed unsustainable borrowing to finance current spending. It was a watershed in India's fiscal reforms, institutionalising fiscal discipline to restore macroeconomic stability.

FRBM Act at a Glance



Objectives and Principles

1. Macroeconomic Stability: Controlling deficits and keeping debt sustainable for stable growth and inflation control.
2. Inter-generational Equity: Limiting borrowing so future generations do not bear undue burdens.
3. Transparency: Detailed fiscal policy statements to

Parliament enhance accountability.

4. Supporting Monetary Policy: Limiting borrowing from the RBI strengthens inflation control.

Fiscal Targets

1. Deficit Reduction: Eliminate the revenue deficit by March 31, 2015, reducing it by 0.5% of GDP a year and the fiscal deficit by 0.3% a year.
2. Debt Ceiling: General government debt within 60% of GDP by 2024–25, with central debt capped at 40%.
3. Escape Clause: Targets may be exceeded only on exceptional grounds such as war, national security, natural calamities or severe agricultural distress.

Mechanisms for Discipline

1. Three Statements: The Fiscal Policy Strategy Statement, Medium-Term Fiscal Policy Statement and Macro-Economic Framework Statement are laid before Parliament yearly.
2. No RBI Financing: Direct borrowing from the RBI is barred except through Ways and Means Advances, ensuring market-based borrowing.
3. Annual Targets and Reviews: Quarterly reviews

of receipts and expenditure allow corrective action.

4. State Acts: States including Andhra Pradesh enacted their own fiscal responsibility laws.

Way Forward

1. Fiscal Transparency: Real-time fiscal data disclosure and independent audits, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh, to improve budget credibility.
2. Medium-Term Frameworks: Align annual budgets with medium-term fiscal targets and development plans for outcome-oriented spending.
3. Legislative Oversight: Equip state legislatures with resources and expertise to scrutinise budgets.
4. Technology: Digital tools for tax administration and expenditure tracking to widen the tax base.

Conclusion

The FRBM Act has been pivotal in institutionalising fiscal discipline and sustainable public finances. Effectively implemented, it ensures macroeconomic stability, prudent debt management and inter-generational equity, creating a conducive environment for inclusive growth.

Where did you write that point?
Notes that live with the question.
ghissu.com

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
5(b)

Discuss the concept of revenue deficit and effective revenue deficit and justify the reasons for introducing effective revenue deficit. Give the details of the expected revenue deficit & the effective revenue deficit by the fiscal 2016-17, as per the Union Budget 2013-14.

10

Introduction

Revenue deficit is a key fiscal indicator, reflecting the gap between the government's revenue expenditure and revenue receipts. The effective revenue deficit (ERD) was introduced in the Union Budget 2011-12 to refine this measure by excluding grants that, though booked as revenue spending, create assets and support growth.

Concepts

1. Revenue Deficit: When revenue expenditure exceeds revenue receipts, current income cannot meet current expenses, so the government borrows for consumption rather than investment.
2. Effective Revenue Deficit: The conventional revenue deficit minus grants to states and union territories that finance creation of capital assets.

Reasons for Introducing ERD

1. Avoiding Distortion: The traditional measure

Practice 5(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

RD vs ERD

Revenue Deficit	Effective Revenue Deficit
Revenue spending minus receipts	RD minus capital asset grants
All revenue spending as consumption	Separates asset-creating grants
Headline gap	Projected well below RD

treated all revenue spending as non-productive, ignoring the productive nature of capital grants.

2. Accurate Fiscal Picture: ERD separates unproductive consumption from growth-enhancing expenditure.
3. FRBM Alignment: In line with the FRBM Act, it improves expenditure quality so borrowing finances capital formation.
4. Debt Sustainability: Promoting capital formation raises long-term growth and lowers the debt burden relative to GDP.

Expected Deficits by 2016-17 (Union Budget 2013-14)

1. ERD Projected Lower: The Budget 2013-14 consolidation path projected the effective revenue deficit well below the revenue deficit for 2016-17,

as capital grants were excluded.

2. State Realities: Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit is estimated at 33,186 crore in 2025-26 (1.8% of GSDP), while capital spending fell to 0.55% of GSDP.

Way Forward

1. Revenue Mobilisation: Broaden the tax base to cut borrowing for revenue spending.
2. Capital Grants: Expand well-targeted grants for asset creation.

Conclusion

ERD distinguishes consumption from growth-supporting spending and ensures borrowing finances productive investment, supporting Viksit Bharat @2047.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 5(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
6(a)

Analyse the possible reasons for placing ceilings on agricultural holdings. Give two possible disadvantages to the economy due to such ceilings.

10

Introduction

Land ownership in India is highly skewed: a few large landholders control vast tracts while many remain landless or hold uneconomic plots. Ceilings on agricultural holdings were introduced as a land reform to redistribute surplus land to the landless and marginal farmers, enhancing rural equity. However, they also create economic challenges.

Reasons for Ceilings

1. Social justice: Land is the main source of rural income. Redistributing surplus land to landless workers, especially SCs and STs, fulfils the constitutional mandate of equitable distribution.
2. Employment through small holdings: Many small peasant proprietors promote labour-intensive farming. Japan shows that small farms can achieve higher yields per hectare.
3. Curbing absentee landlordism: Limits on ownership stop large owners from exploiting tenants and sharecroppers and encourage direct, efficient farming by owners, which can improve output and rural welfare.

Practice 6(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Andhra Pradesh framework: The state applies ceilings to family units, with exemptions and compensation, though enforcement faces heavy litigation.

Land Ceiling Impact

Objectives of Land Ceilings	Challenges and Limitations
Social justice and equity	Mala fide transfers and legal evasion
Employment through small farms	Delayed implementation and litigation backlog
Prevention of land concentration	Exemptions for efficient farms create loopholes
Redistribution to landless	Little surplus land actually distributed

Two Disadvantages to the Economy

1. Distorted land markets: Mala fide transfers and benami transactions evade the law, reduce transparency and discourage long-term investment in land improvement and mechanisation.
2. Fragmentation of holdings: Subdivision to avoid surplus creates uneconomic holdings, losing economies of scale. In Rayalaseema, fragmented plots struggle to adopt water-saving technology and crop diversification.

Beyond these, exemptions and delayed enforcement

leave little surplus land to redistribute, while litigation drains administrative resources.

Way Forward

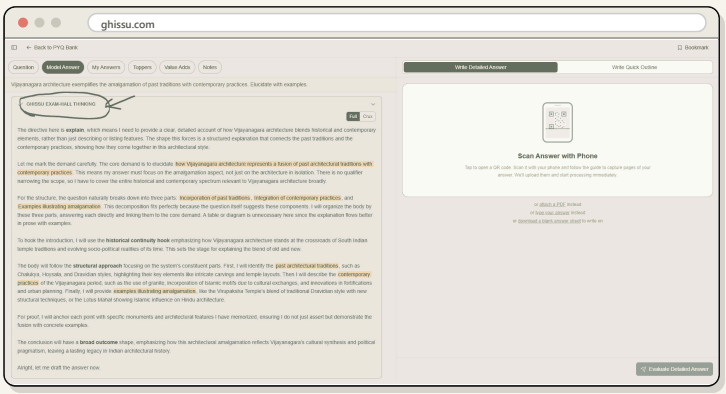
1. Digitised records: Prevent mala fide transfers and improve enforcement.
2. Leasing and consdidation: Formal leasing and cooperative farming let smallholders pool resources.

Conclusion

Ceilings advance social justice, but their economic costs need remedy so that equity and efficiency go together.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP EXAM-HALL THINKING

Know the topic, but freeze at the question?



Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 The question broken open before a single line of the answer.

2 Directive, demand and structure highlighted in the text.

3 Full walks a beginner through it; Crux is a ten-second check.

P-III
6(b)

Explain the need to enact the Andhra Pradesh Land Licensed Cultivators Act, 2011 and discuss the problems faced in meeting the objective of enacting the Act.

10

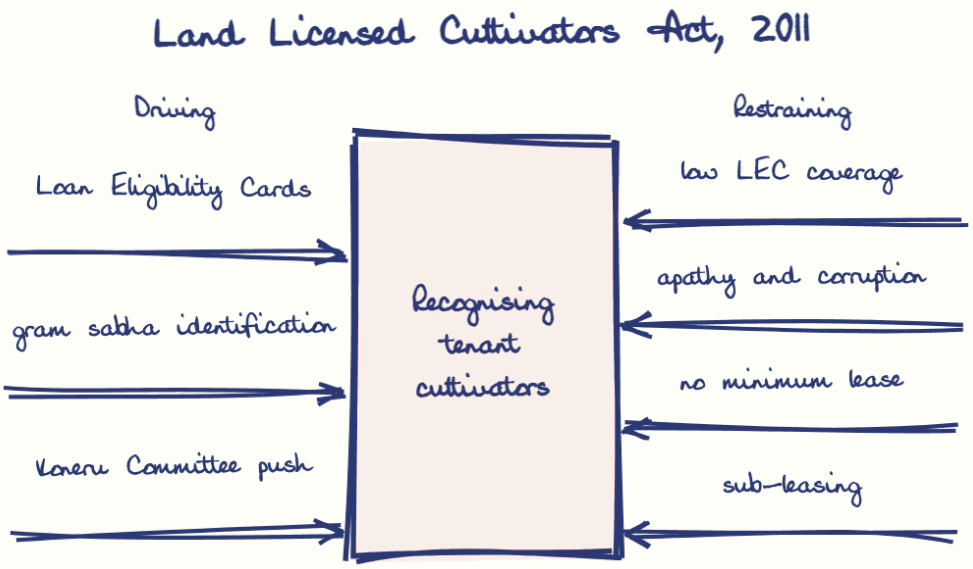
Introduction

Agriculture is a critical livelihood in Andhra Pradesh, and a large share of cultivators are tenants rather than owners. Restrictive tenancy laws long excluded them from institutional credit, subsidies and crop insurance. The Land Licensed Cultivators Act, 2011 was enacted to recognise tenant cultivators legally and open these benefits to them, aiding productivity and social justice.

Need for the Act

1. Exclusion from benefits: Informal, unregistered tenancy barred tenants from institutional credit, crop insurance, input subsidies and compensation for crop damage.
2. Loan Eligibility Cards: The Act issued Loan Eligibility Cards (LECs) to licensed tenants, improving the viability of their farming.
3. Balancing interests: It protected owners' rights while extending benefits to tenants, reflecting the Jayati Ghosh Committee (2005) and the Vaneru Ranga Rao Committee.
4. Formalising tenancy: Involving gram sabhas in

tenant identification aimed to reduce informal leasing and make distribution transparent.



Problems in Meeting the Objectives

1. Low coverage: Of 1.74 million tenant farmers, only about 30% received LECs initially, falling to 24% later, so most tenants stayed excluded.
2. Apathy and administration: Lack of political will, bureaucratic inertia, inefficient gram sabha identification and corruption allegations delayed benefits.
3. Tenant versus owner rights: Protecting owners led to deletion of tenant purchase rights and minimum lease protection, discouraging long-term investment.
4. Sub-leasing: The Act did not stop

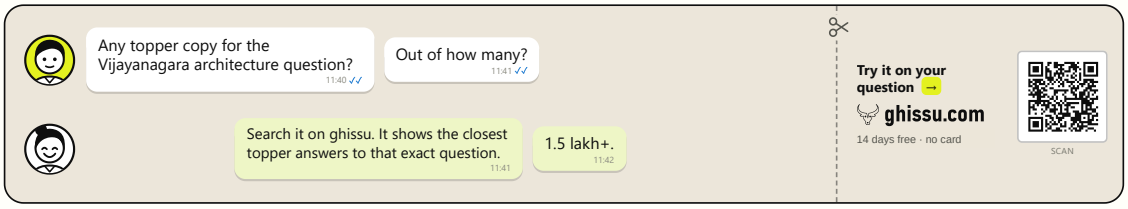
intermediaries and sub-leases, complicating identification and hurting small tenants.

Way Forward

1. Better identification: Use gram sabhas and Sub-Divisional Land Advisory Committees for timely LECs.
2. Incentivise registration: Reward owners who formally register leases.
3. Restore protections: Bring back minimum lease duration and purchase options so tenants have security and reason to invest.
4. Awareness: Run outreach for tenants and owners on the Act's provisions to reduce misinformation and build cooperative tenancy relations.

Conclusion

The 2011 Act was a crucial step in recognising tenant cultivators, but weak implementation and legal limits blunted it. Stronger provisions and lease registration can secure equitable tenancy.



P-III
7(a)

Describe the strategies being adopted by Andhra Pradesh to achieve the mission on agriculture extension program.

10

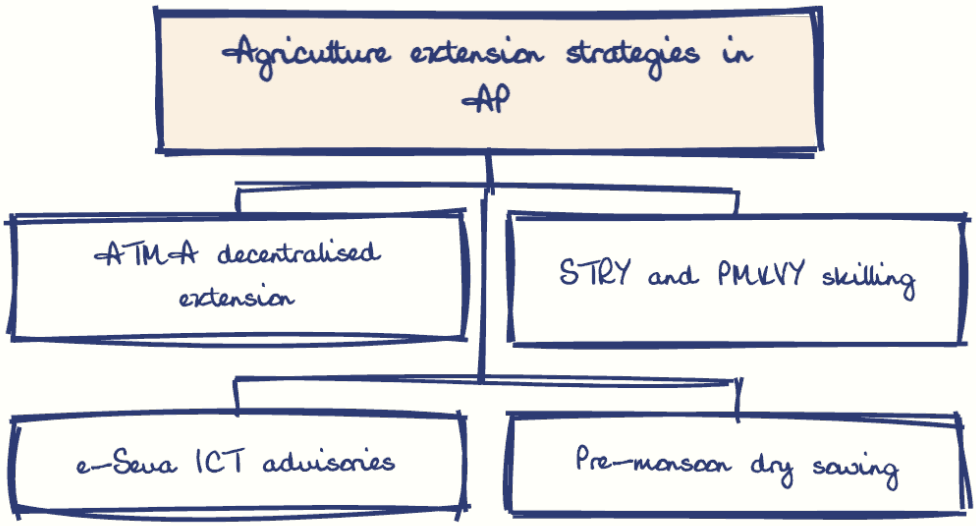
Introduction

Agricultural extension bridges the gap between research and farmers by spreading modern technologies and practices. In Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture and allied sectors sustain a large share of livelihoods, the state follows integrated, technology-driven and farmer-centric extension in line with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Key Strategies Adopted

1. ATMA model: The ATMA framework decentralises extension through district-level planning and farmer participation, with training, demonstrations and exposure visits reaching over 1.27 crore farmers by 2025.
2. Skill training: STRY and PMKVY train rural youth in multiple agricultural and allied activities, giving year-round employment and wider outreach.
3. ICT and digital platforms: e-Seva and other ICT tools deliver real-time information on inputs and advisory services, making extension more accessible and efficient.
4. Climate-resilient practices: Pre-monsoon dry sowing

(PMDS) helps farmers cope with erratic rain, covering nearly 90,000 farmers in over 3,000 gram panchayats.



Contribution to Mission Objectives

1. Technology adoption: Participatory ATMA advice raises adoption of improved seeds, mechanisation and sustainable practices.
2. Skill-based empowerment: Trained youth support extension and allied sectors, diversifying incomes and reducing distress migration.
3. Timely information: ICT cuts the time lag in technology transfer and gives market, weather and input information that is critical for decisions and risk mitigation.

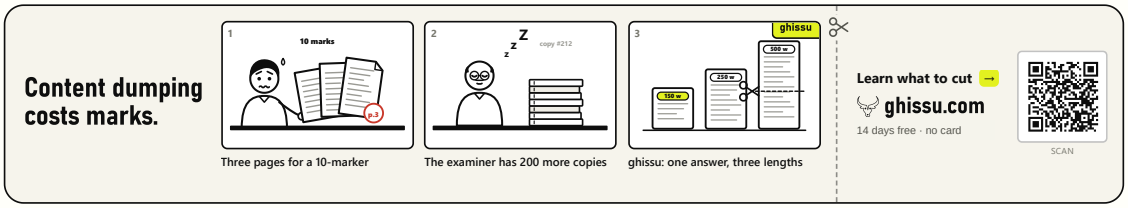
4. Sustainability: PMDS and water-efficient practices under Neeru-Chettu address water scarcity and climate variability.

Way Forward

1. Digital reach: Strengthen ICT networks and extend mobile-based advisories to remote and rainfed areas for inclusive access.
2. Market linkage: Link extension with FPOs and e-NAM to improve income realisation.
3. Multi-disciplinary teams: Include animal husbandry, fisheries and horticulture experts to meet diverse farmer needs.
4. Monitoring and feedback: Use data analytics and farmer feedback to keep improving content and delivery.

Conclusion

Decentralised, skill-based, ICT-driven and climate-resilient extension is empowering farmers in Andhra Pradesh, advancing SDG (2) on zero hunger and food and livelihood security.



P-III
7(b)

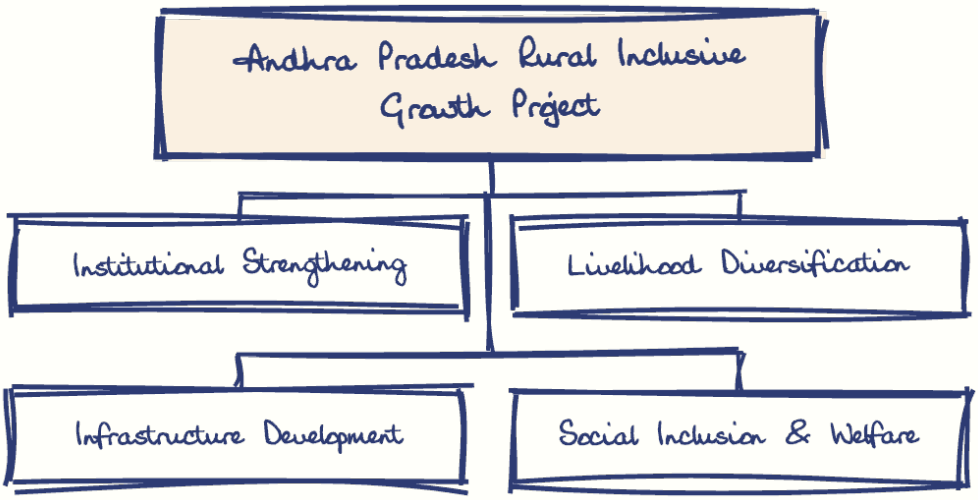
Detail the key four pillars, the project components, beneficiaries and key result indicators of Andhra Pradesh rural inclusive growth project.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 outpaces the national average, but rural interventions are needed for gains to reach vulnerable people. The rural inclusive growth project tackles structural challenges through four pillars integrating economic, social, institutional and infrastructural dimensions.

The Four Pillars



Project Components

1. Institutional strengthening: A decentralised model

through 13,428 Gram Panchayats, Mandal and Zilla Praja Parishads, with capacity building under Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan.

2. Community-driven development: It builds on AP-DPIP, which mobilised community investment funds for income activities.
3. Livelihood diversification: Support for dairy, horticulture and non-farm trades, with skills matched to local markets.
4. Infrastructure: All-weather roads, electrification, potable water and health facilities.
5. Convergence: Integration with MGNREGS and PM-AY avoids duplication.

Beneficiaries

1. Farmers: Small and marginal farmers get aid under YSR Rythu Bharosa and PM Kisan.
2. Women and vulnerable groups: SCs, STs and landless labourers gain via DBT and Janani Suraksha Yojana.
3. Youth and artisans: Skill and entrepreneurship programmes cut unemployment.

Key Result Indicators

1. Dashboard: A 49-indicator dashboard tracks health,

education, agricutture and infrastructure, fostering district competition.

2. Outcomes: Household electricity, literacy, poverty reduction, health and financial inclusion.

Way Forward

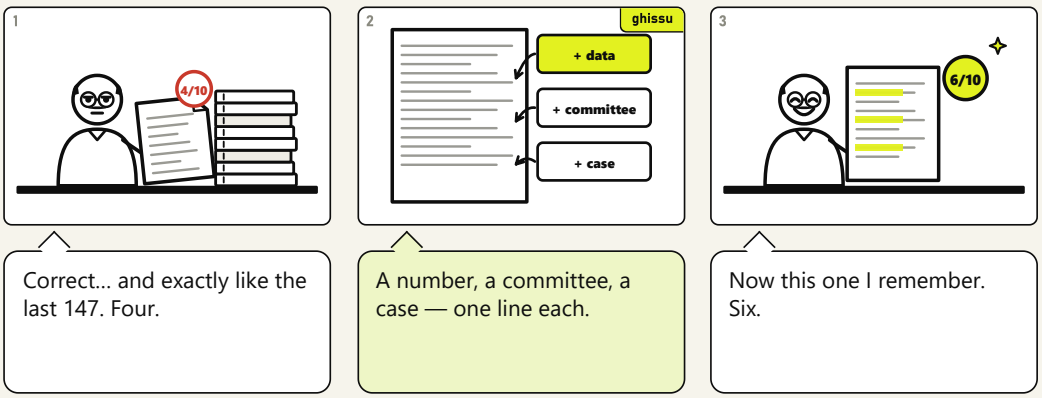
Simplify IT platforms to stop exclusion, fill rural health vacancies and scale community-managed natural farming.

Conclusion

The project links local governance with livelihoods and welfare. Closing these delivery gaps can make rural growth truly inclusive.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW VALUE ADDITIONS

Copy number 148



— One line richer per paragraph: that is the gap between 4 and 6.

Make your answer memorable →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
8(a)

Discuss the trends in the literacy rates in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Literacy is a fundamental indicator of human development. In Andhra Pradesh, literacy trends reflect sustained efforts to widen educational access, alongside regional and gender gaps that matter for inclusive growth.

Trends in Literacy

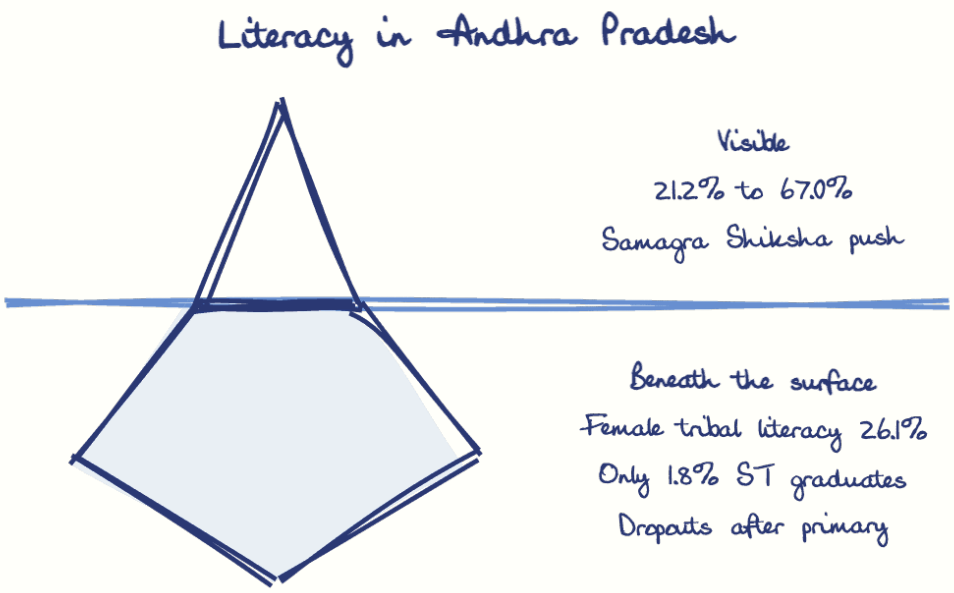
1. Steady long-term growth: Literacy rose from 21.2% in 1961 to 67.0% in 2011, but still lagged the national average of 74.04%.
2. School education push: Samagra Shiksha ~~Abhiyan~~ integrates pre-primary to senior secondary education to improve enrolment and retention.
3. Female literacy: Gender gaps are narrowing through Mission Shakti and gender-inclusive policies.
4. Tribal literacy: ST literacy stays low, with female tribal literacy at only 26.1%.

Challenges Behind the Trends

1. Regional disparities: Rural and tribal areas lag urban areas due to teacher and infrastructure

Practice 8(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice



gaps.

2. Dropouts: High dropout after primary and secondary levels limits depth, only 1.8% of ST literates are graduates.
3. Socio-economic factors: Poverty reduction has helped, but social norms and opportunity costs restrict female and adult literacy.

Implications

1. Economic growth: Rising literacy supports a skilled workforce behind 9.24% GSDP growth in 2024–25.
2. Gender empowerment: A narrower gap raises women's work participation, vital for Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

3. Digital needs: As the state advances technologically, digital literacy is essential to prepare youth for future jobs.
4. Health nexus: Literacy gains go with better health, reinforced by the Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust.

Way Forward

1. Tribal education: Expand infrastructure, recruit teachers and use culturally sensitive curricula with community engagement in backward districts.
2. Female literacy: Scale up schdarships, safe transport and female teacher recruitment to close the gender gap.
3. Digital skills: Embed digital training in schod curricula and adutt education programmes.
4. Monitoring: Build robust data systems to track literacy outcomes and guide resource allocation.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has made commendable progress in literacy, but closing regional and gender gaps and improving quality are needed for universal, functional literacy.

Write your own answer to 8(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
8(b)

"Employment opportunities through Jawahar Knowledge Centres"- Explain how the Andhra Pradesh Government expects to meet its objective through this program.

10

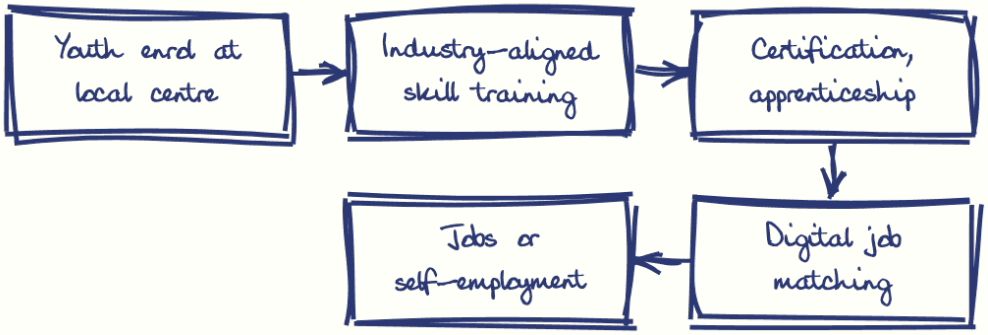
Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's economic growth outpaces the national average, and its youthful population seeks meaningful work. The Jawahar Knowledge Centres (JKCs) programme aims to bridge the skill gap and raise youth employability, tackling structural unemployment and sustaining the state's 9.24% GSDP growth.

Objectives and Mechanisms

1. Skill development: Industry-relevant training for unemployed and underemployed youth, urban and rural, in IT, manufacturing and services.
2. Collaborative framework: Partnerships of colleges, government and industry keep curricula aligned with market and technology needs.
3. Access and outreach: Centres in colleges and community hubs reach women, rural youth and marginalised groups.
4. Certification and placement: Employer-recognised certificates and links with companies and the National Career Service Portal.

From Training to Jobs at JKLCs



How JKLCs Create Employment

1. Bridging mismatch: Training based on local industry needs reduces the skill-job mismatch.
2. Apprenticeships: On-the-job training with local industries gives practical exposure and sustained jobs.
3. Digital job matching: AI-driven platforms connect candidates with employers, cutting recruitment friction.
4. Women and marginalised groups: Focus on women's skills and entrepreneurship raises workforce participation.

Expected Impact

1. Employability: Lower unemployment and underemployment among youth.
2. Growth support: A skilled workforce for industrial corridors and services, sustaining the 9.24% GSDP growth for 2024-25.
3. Inclusive development: Outreach to rural and

disadvantaged people narrows regional and social disparities.

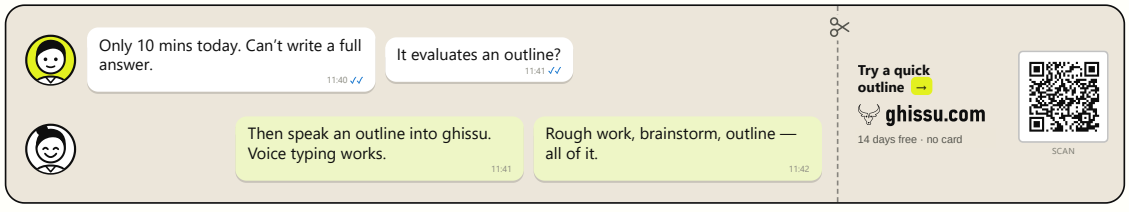
4. Entrepreneurship: Self-employment and innovation generate more jobs and diversify the economy.

Way Forward

1. New sectors: Partnerships with aquaculture and port-led industries.
2. Digital platforms: Better job matching and real-time tracking of outcomes.
3. Quality: Standardised training and certification to keep employer confidence.

Conclusion

JVCs embody AP's effort to turn its demographic dividend into a skilled workforce, driving inclusive growth and SDG (8.)



P-III
9(a)

Explain the distinct aspect of Annual Budget for 2016-17 of Andhra Pradesh. Discuss the reasons for revenue deficit and fiscal deficit in residuary AP.

10

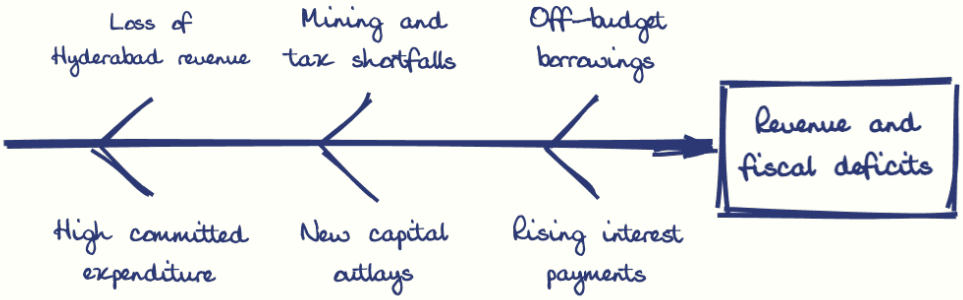
Introduction

The Annual Budget 2016–17 of Andhra Pradesh was presented in the aftermath of the 2014 bifurcation, which created residuary Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. It grappled with the loss of Hyderabad, the former capital and economic hub, while building a new capital and setting a growth path amid deficits.

Distinct Aspects of the 2016–17 Budget

1. **Post-Bifurcation Realignment:** It focused on compensating for the loss of Hyderabad's revenue and administrative infrastructure.
2. **Capital Formation:** Substantial funds for the new capital region, Amaravati, building infrastructure from scratch, a challenge unique among states.
3. **Central Dependence:** With a weak own tax base, it relied heavily on central grants and the special category status demand.
4. **Welfare Commitment:** Welfare schemes, including direct benefit transfers, were maintained despite constraints.

Deficits of Residuary AP



Reasons for Revenue Deficit

1. Loss of Hyderabad: A major contributor to own tax revenue was lost, cutting receipts sharply.
2. Committed Expenditure: Salaries, pensions and interest consumed a large share of revenue receipts.
3. Revenue Shortfalls: Mining revenue gaps, delays in policy and audit observations in commercial taxes reduced collections.
4. Low Capital Spending: Weak asset creation limited future revenue capacity.

Reasons for Fiscal Deficit

1. Higher Borrowing: Including off-budget borrowings, raising debt and the deficit.
2. Capital Needs: Heavy investment in the new capital required upfront outlays.
3. Slow Tax Growth: Own tax revenue could not

keep pace with rising expenditure.

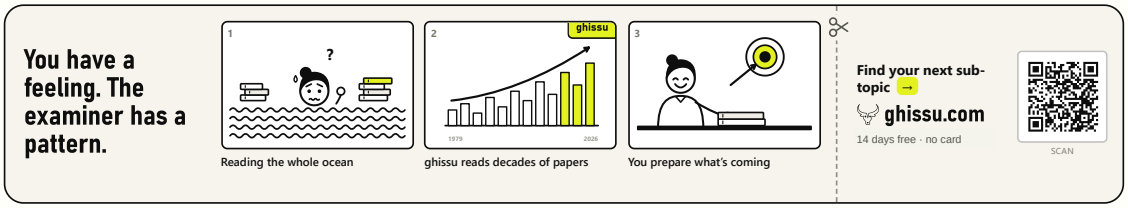
4. Interest Payments: A growing debt stock raised interest costs, crowding out other spending.

Way Forward

1. Revenue Mobilisation: Address audit observations and improve compliance in commercial taxes and mining.
2. Expenditure Composition: Prioritise capital spending and target welfare through direct benefit transfers.
3. Debt Discipline: Adhere to the ~~AP FRBM Act~~ and cut off-budget borrowings.

Conclusion

The 2016-17 Budget reflected a new state building itself under severe constraints. Stronger revenues and disciplined borrowing are key to its fiscal health. Its deficits were structural, rooted in bifurcation itself.



Write your own answer to 9(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

P-III
9(b)

The proportion of revenue receipts and total budgetary receipts as percentage of GSDP increased during the period 2002-2007 and declined during 2008-14. Explain the factors contributed for such trend.

10

Introduction

The share of revenue receipts and total budgetary receipts in GSDP is a key indicator of fiscal health. It rose in 2002–07, reflecting robust growth and better revenue mobilisation, but fell in 2008–14 under global shocks and domestic fiscal challenges.

Factors Behind the Rise (2002–2007)

1. **Strong growth:** Average GDP growth of around 8% raised incomes and corporate profits, directly boosting tax collections.
2. **Wider tax base:** Service tax rose from 5% to 12% and its coverage widened from 52 to 98 services, sharply lifting receipts.
3. **Fiscal reforms:** Better tax administration and compliance improved buoyancy, and the Twelfth Finance Commission raised non-plan grants to states.
4. **Non-tax revenue:** Disinvestment and recovery of loans added to total receipts.

Factors Behind the Decline (2008–2014)

1. **Global financial crisis:** The 2008 slowdown reduced activity and tax collections at the Centre and in states.
2. **Rising committed expenditure:** Pensions and interest payments crowded out fiscal space and weakened mobilisation.
3. **Slower tax buoyancy:** Corporate tax growth was muted due to uncertainty and policy inertia.
4. **Lower capital receipts:** A slowdown in disinvestment and loan recovery cut non-debt capital receipts.

Why receipts rose, then fell

2002–07 rise	2008–14 decline
Growth around 8%	2008 global slowdown
Service tax base widened	Slower tax buoyancy
Better tax administration	Rising committed expenditure
Disinvestment, loan recovery	Lower capital receipts

Underlying Fiscal Dynamics

1. **Growth–borrowing wedge:** In 2002–07 growth

outpaced borrowing costs, improving fiscal indicators; in 2008–14 the wedge narrowed.

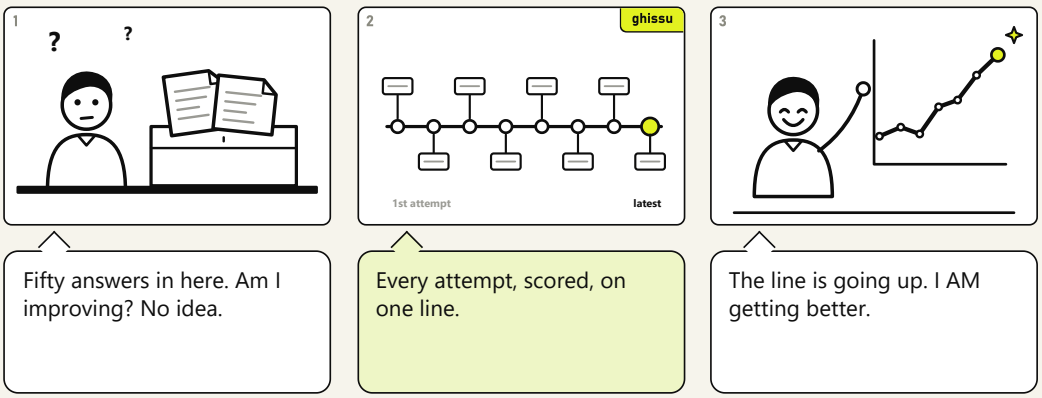
2. Revenue deficits: Persistent deficits limit capital spending and future revenue potential. This turns a temporary slowdown into lasting fiscal stress.

Conclusion

Receipts rise with growth and reform momentum and fall when shocks and committed spending dominate. Sustained growth, a broader tax base and spending discipline are key to stable finances.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW · MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

The drawer of old answers



— You can't fix what you can't see.

See your own progress →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
10(a)

Discuss the performance of agriculture sector during the 11th plan period and reasons for such performance.

10

Introduction

The 11th Five Year Plan (2007–2012) was a critical period for Indian agriculture. It aimed to reverse the stagnation of earlier decades and achieve 4 percent annual growth in a sector that supports nearly half of India's workforce and is vital for food security. Renewed policy focus and investment brought a notable improvement.

Performance During the 11th Plan

1. **Growth beyond target:** Agriculture grew at an average 4.3 percent, above the 4 percent target and far better than the 2.5 percent of the 9th and 10th Plans. This helped the economy exceed 8 percent growth for the first time in the planning era.
2. **Foodgrain production:** Output rose by nearly 30 percent, helping India move from food deficit to a major exporter of farm commodities.
3. **Diversification:** The National Horticulture Mission and RKVY widened the base beyond food crops, raising incomes and nutrition.

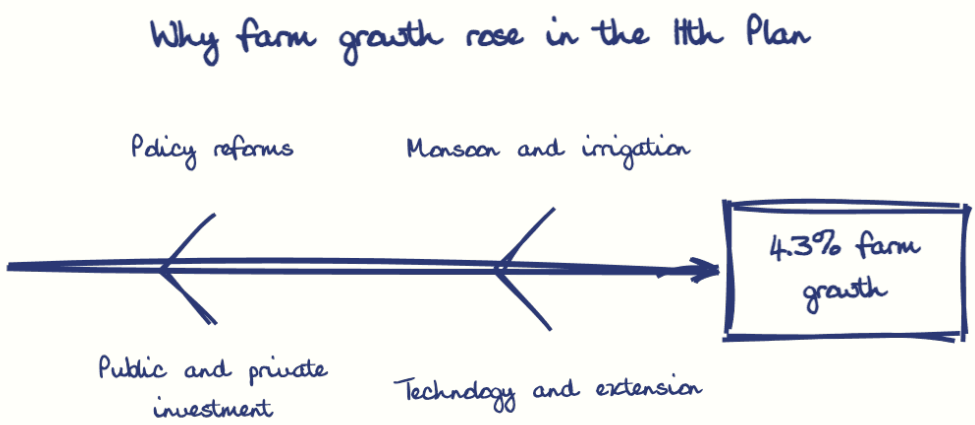
4. Public investment: Its decline in the previous decade was reversed, with more for irrigation, credit and infrastructure.

Reasons for the Performance

1. Policy reforms: The National Policy on Farmers (2007) and the National Commission on Farmers set a framework of watershed management, credit, crop insurance and marketing reforms.
2. Public and private investment: Rising public investment and private entry into contract farming and agro-processing improved access to inputs, technology and markets.
3. Monsoon and irrigation: Better monsoons and wider irrigation, including watershed development, reduced rainfall dependence, as in Andhra Pradesh where Polavaram aimed to raise water availability.
4. Technology and extension: High-yielding varieties and Krishi Vigyan Kendras raised yields and diversified cropping.

Way Forward

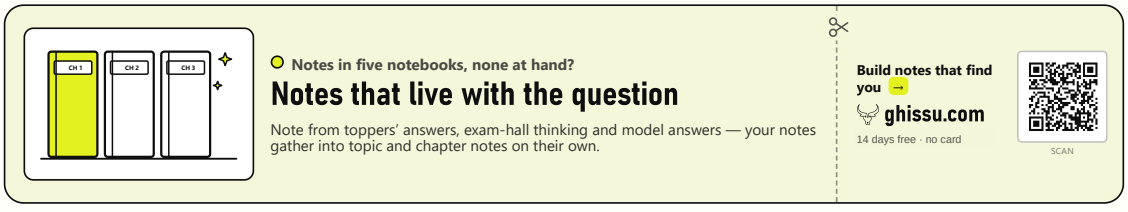
1. Irrigation: Accelerate major projects to ensure reliable water and reduce monsoon dependency.



2. Market linkages: Integrate mandis with e-NAM and promote Farmer Producer Organisations for fair prices.
3. Climate resilience and credit: Spread climate-resilient varieties and ensure timely institutional credit for small and marginal farmers.

Conclusion

The 11th Plan was a turning point for Indian agriculture, driven by reforms, investment and technology. Sustaining it needs closing gaps in infrastructure, markets and climate resilience, which will support doubling farmers' income and Atmanirbhar Krishi.



P-III
10(b)

List all the flagship programmes of Central Government implemented by the State during the 11th plan period and state the objective of the programs in one sentence.

10

Introduction

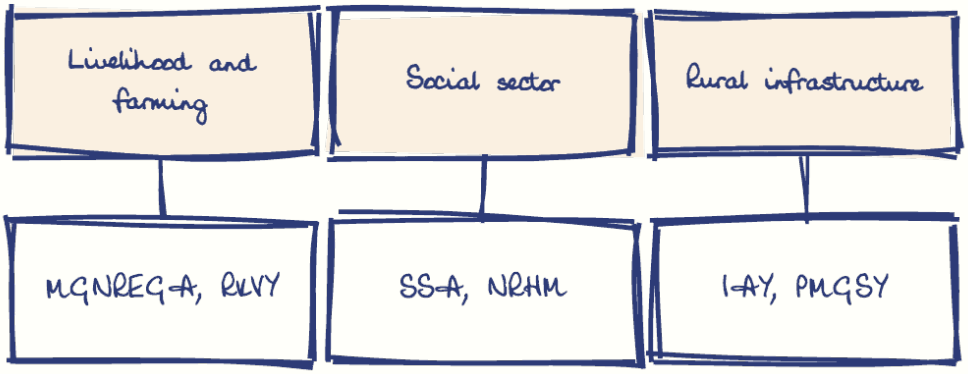
The Eleventh Five Year Plan (2007–2012) emphasised inclusive growth and a better quality of life through social sectors, rural development and infrastructure. States including Andhra Pradesh implemented several central flagship programmes, designed to be demand-driven and people-centric.

Flagship Programmes and Their Objectives

1. **MGNREGA:** Guarantees 100 days of wage employment to rural households to secure livelihoods and create durable assets.
2. **Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA):** Universalises elementary education by improving access, retention and quality for children aged 6–14.
3. **National Rural Health Mission (NRHM):** Improves rural healthcare by strengthening infrastructure and access to quality services.
4. **Indira Awaas Yojana (IAY):** Provides financial assistance to the rural poor to build durable houses.
5. **PMGSY:** Provides all-weather road access to unconnected rural habitations.

6. Rajiv Gandhi Drinking Water Mission: Ensures safe and adequate drinking water for rural people.
7. Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC): Promotes sanitation and hygiene to end open defecation.
8. Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY): Boosts agricultural growth through state-specific plans and higher investment.

Eleventh Plan Flagships



Implementation in Andhra Pradesh

1. Employment: MGNREGA generated significant person-days of work, improving rural livelihoods.
2. Education: SSA raised enrolment and reduced dropouts.
3. Health: NRHM strengthened rural health infrastructure and maternal and child health.
4. Housing and Roads: IAY and PMGSY improved

housing and rural connectivity.

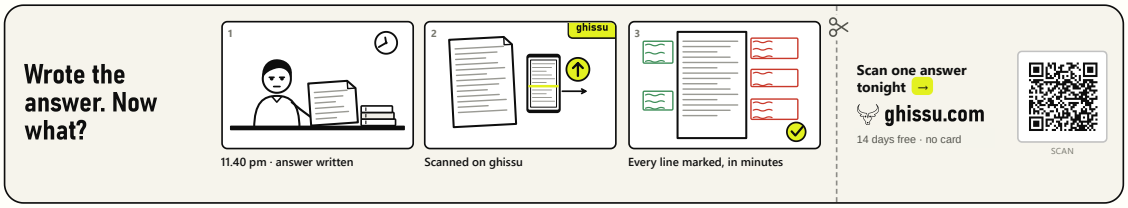
5. Water, Sanitation and Farming: Better water and sanitation cut waterborne diseases, while RKVY raised investment in irrigation.

Way Forward

1. Stronger Monitoring: Real-time monitoring and evaluation for timely and transparent implementation of flagship schemes.
2. Centre–State Coordination: Better coordination on resource allocation and customisation of schemes to state needs.
3. Capacity Building: Train local officials and Panchayati Raj Institutions to improve grassroots delivery.
4. Technology: Digital platforms and Direct Benefit Transfer to cut leakages and improve targeting.

Conclusion

These programmes laid the foundation for inclusive development, in the spirit of Sabka Saath Sabka Vikas.



P-III
11(a)

Discuss salient features of Andhra Pradesh Industrial Investment Promotion Policy - 2015-20.

10

Introduction

The Industrial Investment Promotion Policy 2015–20 was formulated after the 2014 bifurcation, when the loss of Hyderabad demanded a renewed focus on industrial growth. Using the state's location, coastal access and resource base, it aimed to attract investment, promote clusters and ease doing business.

Salient Features

1. Comprehensive incentives: Capital subsidies, interest subsidies and stamp duty reimbursement were offered to large, medium and small industries to create a competitive climate.

2. Industrial infrastructure: APIIC developed industrial parks and zones with common facilities, with mandatory Environmental Impact Assessments before land allotment.

3. Single-window clearance: Approvals were institutionalised in one window, reducing delays and raising transparency.

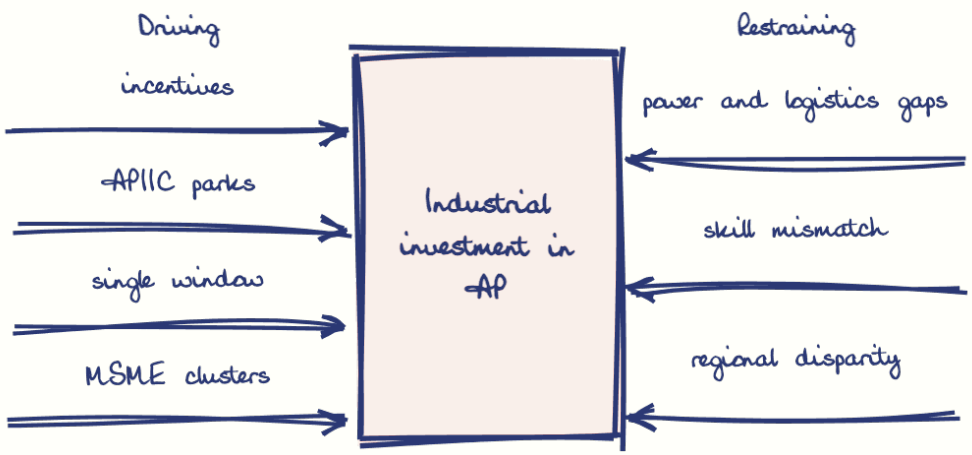
4. MSMEs and clusters: Dedicated MSME parks and cluster development eased access to technology, finance and markets in Rayalaseema and coastal Andhra.

5. Environmental zoning: Zoning and green category approvals promoted eco-friendly industries.

Implementation Outcomes

1. Infrastructure gaps: Power supply and logistics bottlenecks limited the competitiveness of industries in Andhra Pradesh despite generous incentives.
2. Moderate employment: Skill mismatches and capital-intensive industries limited job creation, though skill upgradation programmes were introduced.
3. Environment versus expansion: Green norms promoted clean industry but made balancing expansion with environmental rules harder.
4. Regional disparities: Coastal Visakhapatnam and Krishna districts attracted more investment than drought-prone Rayalaseema, showing the need for targeted regional strategies.

IIPP 2015–20



Way Forward

1. PPPs: Use PPP models to mobilise private capital and expertise for cluster infrastructure.
2. Innovation: Support R&D and startups within industrial parks to raise technological capability and competitiveness.
3. Inclusive incentives: Extend support to MSMEs, women entrepreneurs and backward regions so that growth becomes broad-based.
4. Ease of doing business: Streamline regulation further and expand digital governance to cut transaction costs.

Conclusion

The policy laid a strong foundation by combining fiscal incentives, infrastructure and environmental sustainability. With a focus on innovation, regional balance and skills, it can drive inclusive industrialisation in line with SDG 8.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

ghissu

ghissu exam-hall thinking decodes every directive — Discuss, Examine, Elucidate — before you write a line.

Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 11(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

3 / 3

Scan to practice

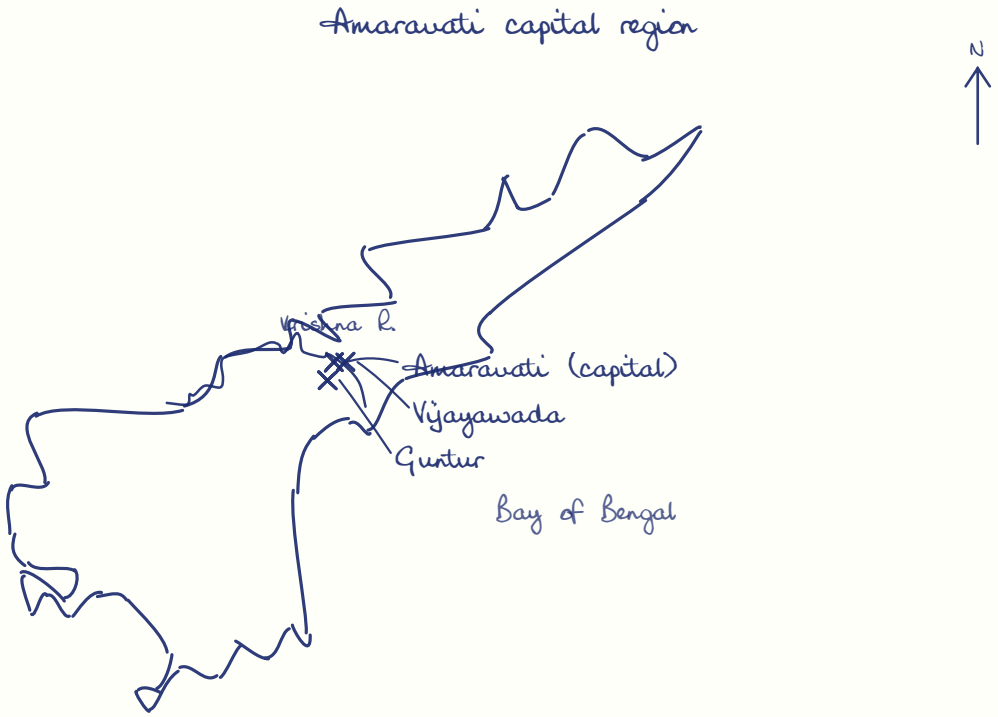
P-III
11(b)

Explain the need for the Andhra Pradesh Capital Region Development Authority Bill 2014 and describe its salient features.

10

Introduction

The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014 under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act cost the state Hyderabad, its capital, to Telangana. A new capital region was needed as the state's political and economic hub. The APCRDA Bill 2014 provided a legal and institutional mechanism to plan, develop and regulate this new capital, Amaravati.



New capital on the Krishna after losing Hyderabad

Need for the Bill

1. Loss of capital: Without Hyderabad, the state had no administrative and economic centre.
2. Orderly urban growth: A single legal authority was needed to plan infrastructure and prevent fragmented sprawl
3. Land assembly: Building a capital required contiguous land, which needed a legal basis for pooling.

Salient Features

1. Statutory authority: APCRDA is responsible for planning, coordination, execution and supervision of development in the capital region, ensuring unified urban governance.
2. Governance structure: A governing council of government officials and experts combines administrative oversight with technical expertise.
3. Legal powers: It regulates land use, building rules, infrastructure and environmental safeguards, and manages land pooling schemes.

Implementation Challenges

1. Land pooling: Allegations of insider trading and corruption led to judicial scrutiny and public distrust.

2. Local bodies: Overlapping jurisdiction with panchayats and municipalities caused delays.
3. Fiscal limits: Capital expenditure of only 0.55% of GSDP in 2026–27 slowed infrastructure.
4. Political controversy: Debates over multiple capitals complicated a cohesive plan.

Way Forward

1. Transparency: Build audit and monitoring systems for fair land pooling.
2. Fiscal support: Raise capex for Amaravati's infrastructure and use multilateral funding to attract investment.
3. Local integration: Harmonise APCRDA plans with local governments for inclusive service delivery.

Conclusion

The APCRDA Bill was a critical step to institutionalise a new capital, and effective implementation can make Amaravati a modern, inclusive capital.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
12(a)

Discuss the recent initiatives taken to help farmers to increase productivity levels in agriculture.

10

Introduction

Agriculture is the backbone of India's rural economy, employing nearly 46.1% of the workforce, yet productivity per hectare lags global standards. Recent initiatives aim to raise productivity, secure food, lift farm incomes and promote sustainable practices amid climate change and fragmented landholdings, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh.

Recent Initiatives

1. Research and technology: Krishonnati Yojana and the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Extension (SAME) spread high-yielding varieties, bio-fertilisers and precision farming. KVKs in Andhra Pradesh trained over 58 lakh farmers between 2021 and 2024.

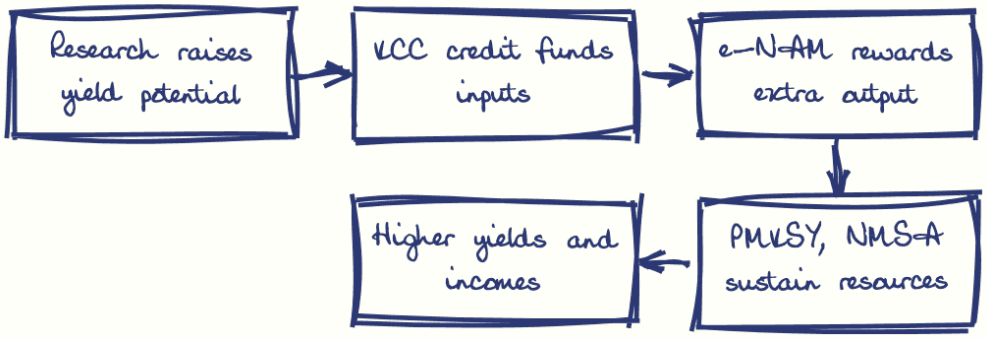
2. Credit access: The Kisan Credit Card offers affordable loans for inputs and machinery, the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund supports post-harvest assets, and PACS digitisation improves credit flow to smallholders.

3. Market reforms: e-NAM integrates 1,473 mandis across 23 states, including Andhra Pradesh,

while RKVY supports cold storage and logistics.

4. Water and soil: PMKSY promotes micro-irrigation for water-scarce areas like Rayalaseema, and NMSA encourages organic fertilisers and soil health.

How initiatives lift productivity



Impact on Productivity

1. Higher yields: Quality seeds, bio-stimulants and integrated pest management raised yields by 20–25% in RKVY and SAME regions. In Andhra Pradesh, MIDH lifted horticulture productivity by 35%, reflecting targeted research and extension.

2. Financial resilience: Timely, affordable credit through KCC and digitised PACS lets farmers invest in modern machinery and quality inputs, reducing reliance on informal lenders.

3. Price realisation: e-NAM increases buyer competition, giving remunerative prices that reward

productive practices, including for chillies and aquaculture.

4. Sustainable resources: Efficient irrigation under PMKSY and organic practices under NMSA conserve water and soil, securing long-term viability in drought-prone Rayalaseema.

Way Forward

1. Digital extension: Use the Digital Agriculture Mission for real-time advisory to small farmers.
2. FPOs and resilience: Build on 2,500 registered FPOs with over 5.87 lakh farmers, and develop drought-resistant varieties.

Conclusion

Research, credit, market and resource initiatives together are lifting farm productivity. Extending them to small and marginal farmers will make the gains lasting.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
12(b)

"Fair Price Shop Automation and portability within a District" – discuss the possible advantages of these changes in public distribution system.

10

Introduction

The Public Distribution System (PDS) is the cornerstone of food security for vulnerable people. Automation of Fair Price Shops (FPS) and ration card portability within districts aim to improve efficiency and inclusion, given rising internal migration and the need for accountable welfare, areas where Andhra Pradesh has pioneered digital governance.

Advantages of the Changes

1. Transparency through automation: e-PoS devices in over 5,33,000 FPS nationwide record transactions in real time with biometric authentication, curbing diversion of subsidised grain.
2. Migrant inclusion: Intra-district portability lets beneficiaries draw entitlements from any FPS in their district, recognising labour mobility in AP's urbanising districts.
3. Better targeting: Linking ration databases with welfare registries cuts inclusion and exclusion errors, as the Justice Wadhwa Committee

recommended.

4. Supply chain efficiency: AP's GPS tracking of grain trucks shows how technology eases bottlenecks.

FPS Automation vs Portability

FPS Automation	Portability
Transparency through biometric verification	Access flexibility for migrants
Real-time transaction tracking	Intra-district entitlement use
Reduces diversion and leakages	Addresses exclusion due to migration
Requires infrastructure investment	Depends on interoperable databases

Challenges

1. Digital divide: Uneven connectivity and literacy in rural AP delay e-PoS operations.
2. Awareness and trust: Migrants in coastal districts need outreach and grievance redressal.
3. Data privacy: Integrated biometric data needs legal and cyber safeguards.

Way Forward

1. Infrastructure: Better internet and power in rural

AP for uninterrupted e-PoS.

2. Capacity building: Train FPS dealers and beneficiaries on digital tools and grievance redressal.

3. Portability and privacy: Interoperable databases for seasonal migrants and strict data protection with audits.

Conclusion

Automation and portability make PDS transparent, inclusive and responsive to a mobile population, advancing SDG (2) and SDG (10).

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON VALUE ADDITIONS

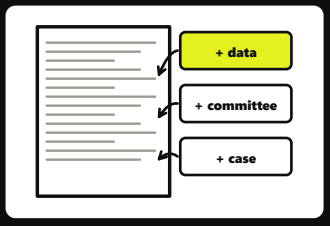
The authority ladder

An assertion with nothing behind it is an opinion, and opinions aren't marked. Anchor claims — highest rung first.

1. **Constitution** — Articles, Schedules, Amendments.
2. **Courts & commissions** — Supreme Court judgments; Sarkaria, Punchhi, ARC, Law Commission.
3. **Government data** — Economic Survey, NFHS, PLFS, NCRB, Census, PIB.
4. **International** — IPCC, UNDP, World Bank, FAO — then expert opinion, last.

ON GHISSU, THIS IS DONE FOR YOU — ON EVERY QUESTION.

Every question comes with its value additions — the data, the report, the case — from standard and government sources, linked.



Add value to your next answer →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
13(a)

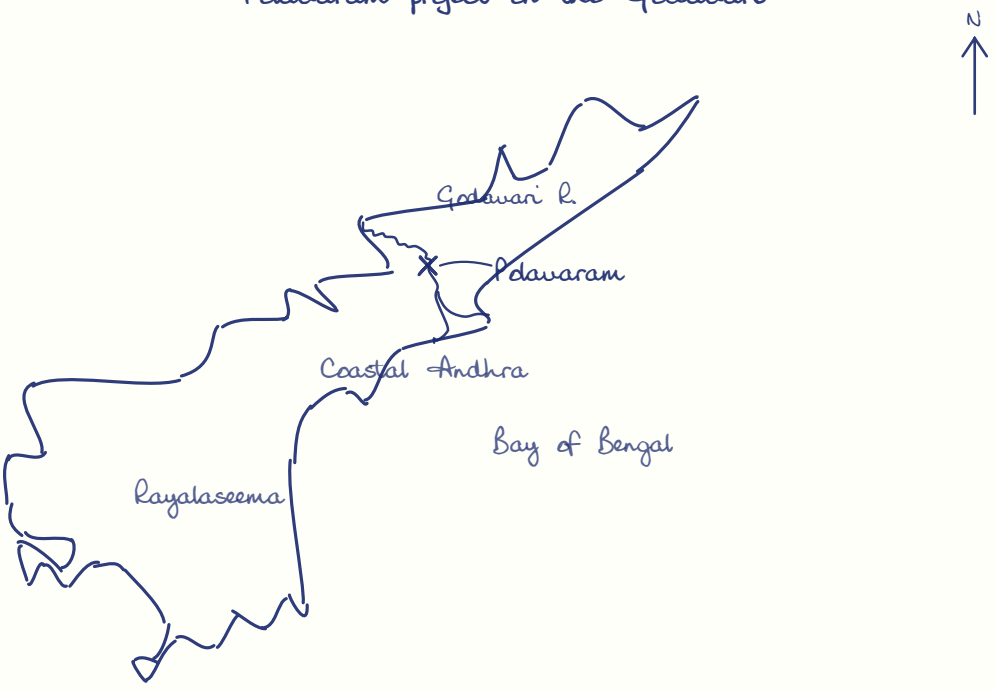
Describe the salient features of Polavaram irrigation project and explain its benefits.

10

Introduction

The Polavaram irrigation project is a multipurpose initiative that harnesses the Godavari to meet irrigation, drinking water and power needs in Andhra Pradesh. For an agrarian state with drought-prone areas like Rayalaseema, it is strategic for water security. Its status as a national project under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act shows its importance.

Polavaram project on the Godavari



Left and Right Main Canals irrigate 2.91 lakh ha

Salient Features

1. **Multipurpose dam and reservoir:** A large dam across the Godavari creates a reservoir for irrigation, drinking water and hydropower, and regulates river flow.
2. **Canal network:** The Left and Right Main Canals are designed to irrigate about 2.91 lakh hectares.
3. **Hydroelectric component:** An integrated power station will generate clean energy and reduce reliance on fossil fuels.
4. **Land acquisition and rehabilitation:** The project needs about 1,79,770 acres, of which only 67.43% is acquired. Only 11% of Project Displaced Families have moved to planned colonies.

Benefits

1. **Irrigation and productivity:** Irrigating about 2.91 lakh hectares can turn dry, drought-prone areas of Seemandhra fertile, enabling multiple cropping and higher yields.
2. **Drinking water:** It will supply about 28.5 lakh people in 540 villages, easing scarcity and improving health.
3. **Flood control:** Regulating the Godavari's flow

reduces downstream floods, protecting lives, property and farmland.

4. Renewable energy: Hydropower supports the state's energy needs sustainably and cuts carbon emissions, in line with its renewable energy commitment.

Way Forward

1. Rehabilitation: Fully implement the RFCTLARR Act for fair, timely resettlement.
2. Monitoring and funding: Use the Technical Advisory Committee and Revised Cost Committee, with steady budgets.
3. Power component: Prioritise completing the hydroelectric station to realise the full multipurpose potential.
4. Community and environment: Involve local communities and follow environmental norms.

Conclusion

Polavaram is a transformative opportunity to secure water for irrigation, drinking and power in Andhra Pradesh. Its completion will boost agriculture, reduce floods and advance SDG 6 on clean water.

Write your own answer to 13(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
13(b)

Explain the salient features and benefits of the PPP model of health services provided under Dr NTR Vaidya Seva programme.

10

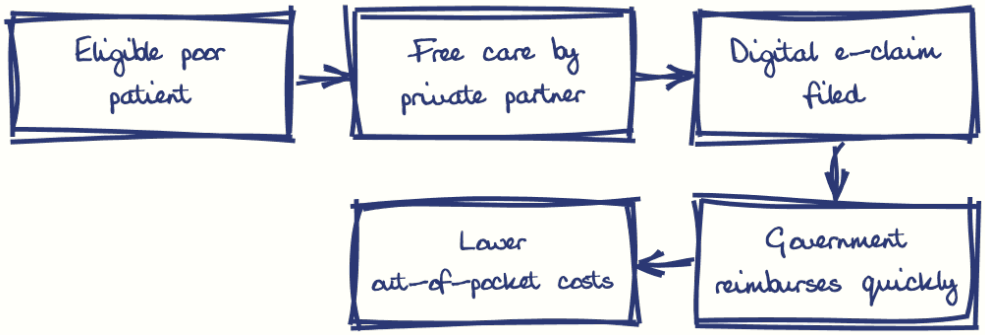
Introduction

The Dr NTR Vaidya Seva programme in Andhra Pradesh is a major effort to improve healthcare through a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model. The 2024 CAG report showed vacancies in specialist and nursing posts, so innovative PPPs are essential. The model supports Universal Health Coverage by using private efficiency while keeping care affordable.

Salient Features of the PPP Model

1. Comprehensive coverage: Outpatient, inpatient, diagnostic and emergency care are offered under a single umbrella for holistic treatment.
2. Government-private collaboration: The government provides infrastructure and regulatory oversight, while private partners manage delivery with managerial expertise.
3. Free treatment: Eligible patients, especially the economically weaker sections, receive free medical treatment, cutting out-of-pocket costs.
4. Technology and automation: E-claims and digital record-keeping streamline operations, improve transparency and speed reimbursements.

How the PPP Model Works



Benefits of the Model

1. Access and affordability: Private providers extend quality care to underserved people, offsetting specialist vacancies and infrastructure shortfalls.
2. Quality and efficiency: Private management practices, quality control and accountability improve patient outcomes.
3. Financial protection: Free or subsidised care prevents catastrophic health expenditure.
4. Scalability and sustainability: Long-term contracts and viability gap funding allow scaling without overburdening public finances.

Way Forward

1. Regulation: A dedicated regulator to monitor contracts, enforce quality and resolve disputes.
2. Capacity: Train district and taluka officials to oversee PPPs.

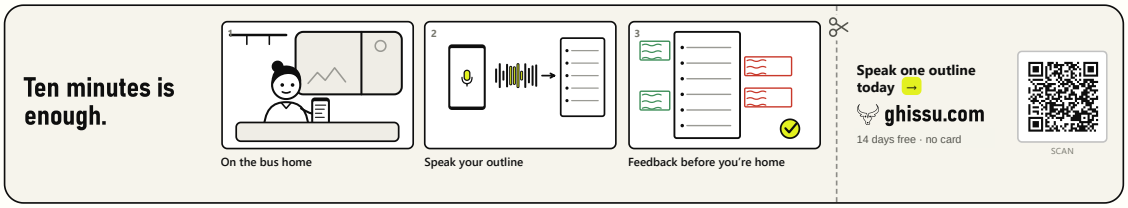
3. Digital health: Link patient data and claims with the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission to cut payment delays.
4. Community awareness: Outreach on benefits and eligibility to raise utilisation and trust.

Assessment

1. Strength: The model uses private capacity to fill gaps that public hospitals cannot fill quickly.
2. Risk: Weak contract monitoring could hurt quality or raise costs, so regulation and trained officials are essential.

Conclusion

Combining public oversight with private efficiency, the programme improves access, quality and financial protection, moving Andhra Pradesh towards health for all.



P-III
14(a)

Discuss the highlights of farmers' debt redemption scheme implemented in Andhra Pradesh and its benefits.

10

Introduction

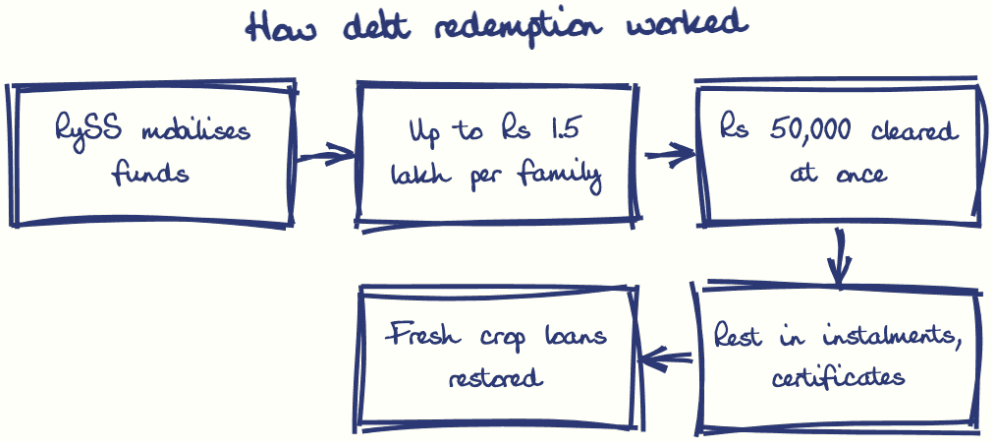
Indebtedness drains farm incomes and blocks fresh credit. After the 2014 bifurcation, Andhra Pradesh faced heavy overdue crop loans, drought in Rayalaseema and the loss of Hyderabad's revenues. It therefore launched the farmers' debt redemption scheme (Rythu Runa Upasamana), a large crop loan waiver to clean loan accounts and restore eligibility for bank credit.

Highlights of the Scheme

1. **Dedicated institution:** The Rythu Sadhikara Samstha (RySS) was set up in 2014 to mobilise funds and settle farmers' dues with banks, outside the regular budget process.
2. **Ceiling per family:** Crop loans, including gold loans taken for agriculture, were eligible up to Rs 1.5 lakh per farm family, spreading relief over many small and marginal farmers.
3. **Staggered payment:** Loans up to Rs 50,000 were cleared at once; for larger loans about 20% was paid first and the balance in four

annual instalments at 10% interest, backed by Runa Upasamana Arhata Patram certificates.

4. Technology-based verification: Bank loan data was matched with Aadhaar, ration card and land records, with grievance cells and MeeSeva centres to correct errors.



Benefits

1. Immediate relief: Lakhs of farm families were freed wholly or partly from overdue loans and the risk of distress sales.
2. Restored credit: Farmers regained eligibility for fresh crop loans and Kisan Credit Card renewals, reducing dependence on moneylenders.
3. Drought support: Relief came when drought in Rayalaseema and Prakasam had cut incomes, protecting consumption and the next season's investment.

Limitations

1. **Interest gap:** Bank interest on the unpaid portion often exceeded the amount released, keeping many in default for years.
2. **Exclusion errors:** Record mismatches left out eligible farmers, and tenant farmers who borrow informally gained little.
3. **Fiscal burden:** It strained a revenue-deficit state and crowded out irrigation spending.

Way Forward

1. **Shift to prevention:** Income support such as Annadatha Sukhibhava, crop insurance and assured irrigation prevent debt rather than waive it.
2. **Cover tenants:** Crop cultivator rights cards can extend credit to tenant farmers.

Conclusion

The scheme gave significant relief after bifurcation, but waivers are a one-time remedy; lasting relief needs better incomes and inclusive credit.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
14(b)

"An Indian peasant is born in debt, lives in debt and dies in debt". In this context, explain the problems faced by the rural population in getting the loans from institutional and non-institutional sources in AP and how they get into debt trap and poverty.

10

Introduction

Rural indebtedness remains a critical challenge in Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture employs many but yields low incomes. Despite 9.24% GSDP growth in 2024–25, many peasants cannot get affordable credit, so the saying that the peasant is "born in debt, lives in debt and dies in debt" still holds for many small and marginal farmers.

Problems with Institutional Loans

1. **Stringent documentation:** Collateral and paperwork requirements of banks and cooperatives exclude many, despite Kisan Credit Cards.
2. **Limited reach:** Banks and cooperative societies are sparse in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
3. **Delays and costs:** Late disbursal and high transaction costs reduce the use of loans for timely operations.
4. **Weak crop insurance:** Without risk cover, banks are reluctant to lend.

Problems with Non-Institutional Loans

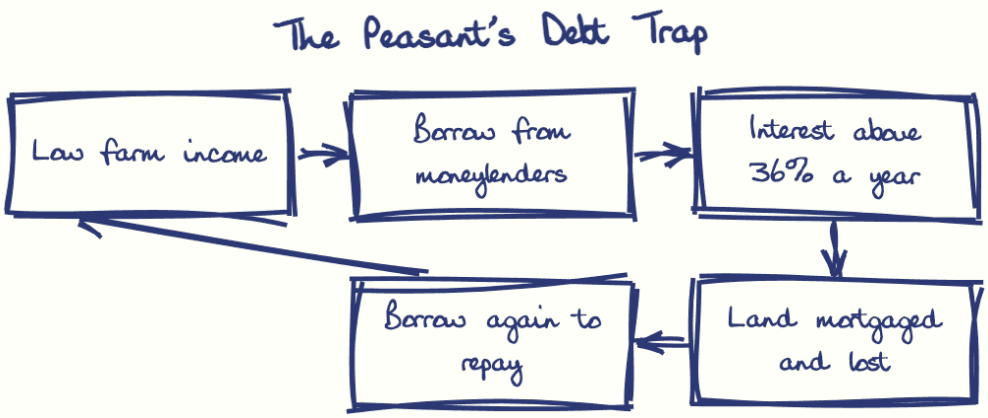
1. Predatory interest: Moneylenders charge exorbitant rates, sometimes above 36% a year.
2. Land mortgaging: Farmers are coerced to mortgage land, leading to land loss and bonded labour, especially among tribal communities.
3. Low literacy: Unaware borrowers are cheated through false accounts and unfair terms.
4. Social pressures: Marriages and festivals drive unproductive borrowing.

How the Debt Trap Deepens Poverty

1. Debt spiral: Peasants borrow repeatedly to repay old debts.
2. Land alienation: Mortgaged land is lost, pushing farmers into wage labour or migration.
3. Low productivity: Debt blocks investment in inputs, keeping incomes low.
4. Social distress: Farmer suicides and distress migration disrupt the social fabric of villages and deepen poverty.

Way Forward

1. Financial infrastructure: Extend banks and cooperatives in underserved regions, using



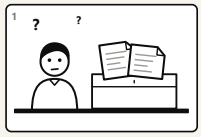
e-Seva for easier loan access.

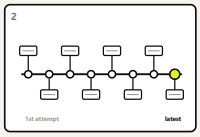
2. Literacy and insurance: Financial literacy on credit options and rights, and crop insurance with timely claims.
3. Regulation: Stricter regulation and monitoring of moneylenders.

Conclusion

The peasant's debt trap comes from exclusion by formal lenders and exploitation by informal ones. Breaking it needs both easier institutional credit and protection from usury.

Fifty answers written. Any better?


Copies lost in a drawer


Every attempt on one timeline


You can see the climb

Start your timeline →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
15(a)

Explain the e-pragati initiative of Andhra Pradesh and its benefits.

10

Introduction

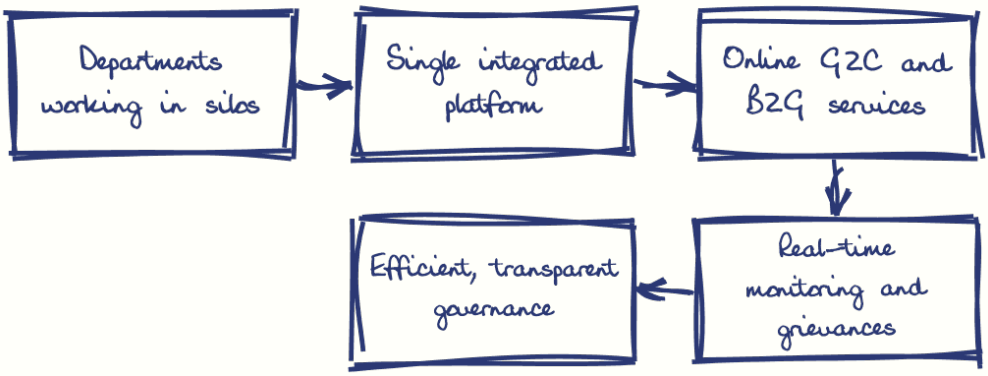
In the digital era, efficient governance is crucial for accelerating development and improving public service delivery. Andhra Pradesh, with its focus on technology-driven reform, launched e-Pragati to transform government-citizen interactions through integrated digital platforms. It reflects the state's vision of inclusive and transparent governance using ICT.

Features of e-Pragati

1. Integrated digital platform: It brings government departments and services onto a single platform, enabling seamless data sharing and service delivery.
2. Citizen-centric delivery: G2C and B2G services move online, cutting visits and paperwork, building on e-Seva centres for bill payments and certificates.
3. Real-time monitoring: Real-time tracking of projects and grievance redressal improves accountability and reduces delays.
4. PPP model: High-impact applications were piloted with state funding and then scaled with private participation, keeping rollout cost-effective and

sustainable across the state.

How e-Pragati works



Benefits of e-Pragati

1. Administrative efficiency: Digitised workflows and integrated departmental data significantly cut processing times for services and approvals, speeding decisions and project execution.
2. Transparency and accountability: Real-time grievance redressal and project monitoring help curb corruption and ensure citizens get timely responses from agencies.
3. Inclusive access: Rural and marginalised people reach services through e-Seva and mobile platforms, narrowing the digital divide.
4. Economic and social impact: Streamlined welfare delivery and investor confidence support the projected GSDP growth of 9.24% for 2024-25.

Way Forward

1. Digital infrastructure: Strengthen broadband and digital literacy in rural and remote areas so all citizens can use the platform.
2. Interoperability: Develop standard protocols for data sharing between departments and third-party providers.
3. Capacity building: Train officials and frontline workers continuously to manage its digital tools.
4. Emerging technologies: Use ~~AI~~ and data analytics to predict citizen needs and optimise resource allocation.

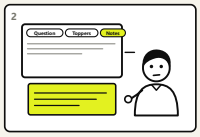
Conclusion

By joining up departments that once worked in silos, e-Pragati shows how digital governance can make administration efficient, transparent and inclusive, so that reforms reach every citizen, contributing to SDG (16) on peace, justice and strong institutions.

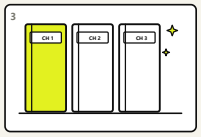
Where did I write that point?



Five notebooks, one point



Note it on the question



Chapter notes build themselves

Keep every note in place →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 15(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2016 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
15(b)

"Smart village - Smart ward towards Smart Andhra Pradesh" - Explain.

10

Introduction

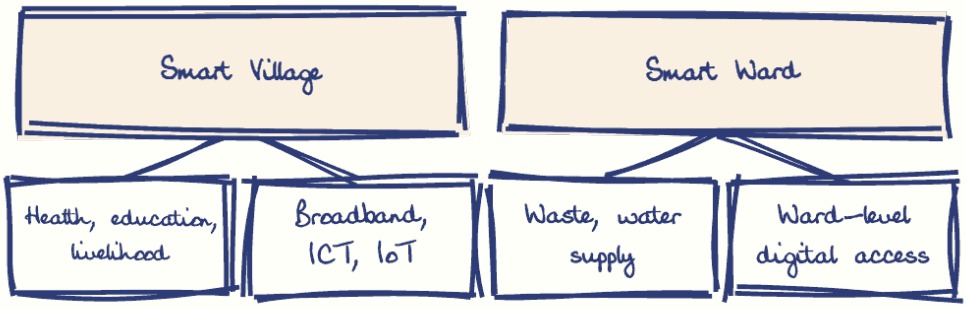
A Smart Andhra Pradesh uses technology and good governance to transform both rural and urban areas. With over 70% of its people living in villages, the state must bridge the rural-urban divide. Smart Village and Smart Ward initiatives aim at self-reliant, digitally empowered communities that drive development from the grassroots up.

Concept and Components

1. Holistic Smart Village: Integrated development in health, education, livelihood and infrastructure, meeting food, shelter, sanitation and energy needs sustainably, embedded in the Gram Panchayat Development Plan.
2. Technology-enabled services: ICT and IoT improve delivery and transparency. Mori village in East Godavari has broadband, Wi-Fi in all households and wide digital payments.
3. Community participation: Gram Panchayats, SHGs and cooperatives ensure development reflects local priorities.
4. Smart Ward: Urban governance is decentralised to

wards, improving infrastructure, waste management, water supply and digital access.

Building Blocks of Smart AP



Contribution to Smart Andhra Pradesh

1. Inclusive growth: Self-employment, digital literacy and scheme access reduce poverty, supporting 9.24% GSDP growth for 2024-25.
2. Bridging the digital divide: Broadband gives equal access to education, health and finance, reducing regional disparities.
3. Better governance: eGramSwaraj improves accountability in fund use, addressing audit-flagged gaps.
4. Sustainability: Eco-friendly technology and conservation of natural resources align with APCNF natural farming.

Role of Technology and Governance

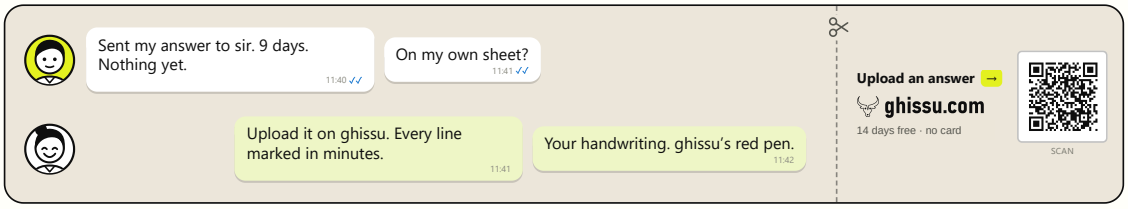
1. Digital enabler: Reliable internet enables cashless payments, telemedicine and e-governance.
2. Data-driven planning: eGramSwaraj and AIKosh support evidence-based planning and monitoring of programmes.
3. Capacity building: Training local functionaries closes digital literacy gaps.

Way Forward

1. Connectivity: Expand broadband through public-private partnerships and technologies like LiFi for universal internet access.
2. Local institutions: Regular training and resources for Gram Panchayats and urban wards.
3. Synergy: Align with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 and the Deepam-2 Scheme.

Conclusion

Smart villages and smart wards are the building blocks of a Smart Andhra Pradesh, turning connectivity and participation into inclusive development.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2012

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

P-III
1(a)

Declining share of agriculture in national income facilitated a rise in the rate of economic growth in India. - Justify your answer

Introduction

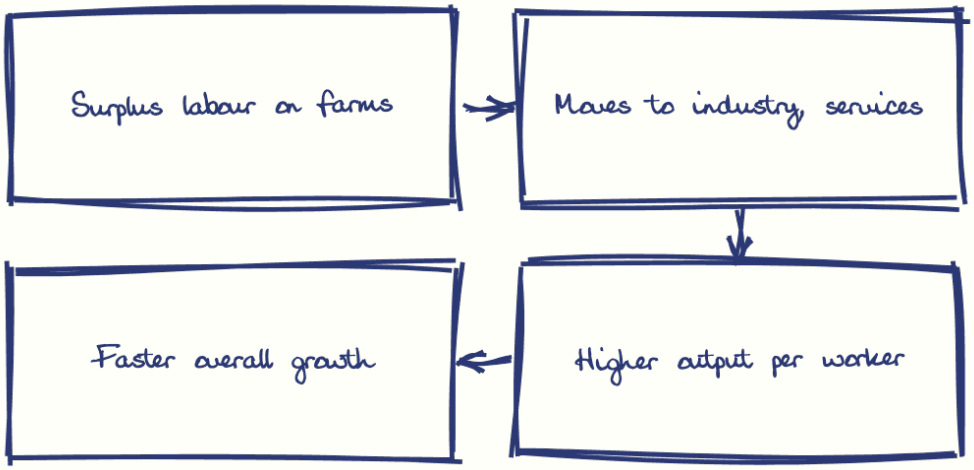
The declining share of agriculture in India's national income is a hallmark of structural transformation. Although agriculture still employs a large workforce, faster growth in industry and services has reduced its share in GVA. This shift raised overall growth by moving resources to more productive sectors.

Justification: How the Shift Raised Growth

1. Structural dynamics: Agriculture's share fell from about 18.2% in 2014–15 to 16.5% in 2019–20, as industry and services absorbed capital and labour, raising overall productivity.
2. Labour productivity: Agriculture employs over 45% of workers but contributes far less to GVA, revealing disguised unemployment; moving labour to manufacturing and services drives growth.
3. Income differential: Farm income grew about 5.2% a year over the decade against 6.2% for non-farm income, so a larger non-farm share lifts the average.
4. State evidence: In Andhra Pradesh, non-agricultural sectors grew faster than farming,

supporting 9.24% GSDP growth in 2024–25, with higher tax revenue funding infrastructure.

How a Smaller Farm Share Lifts Growth



Supporting Reforms in Agriculture

1. Risk and irrigation: PM Fasal Bima Yojana and PM Krishi Sinchayee Yojana improve risk management and irrigation, stabilising farm incomes.
2. Credit: NABARD, Regional Rural Banks and Kisan Credit Cards help farmers invest in modern inputs.
3. Markets: e-NAM and better MSP mechanisms improve price realisation.
4. Diversification: Fisheries and horticulture in AP's coastal and Rayalaseema regions supplement farm incomes.

Caveats

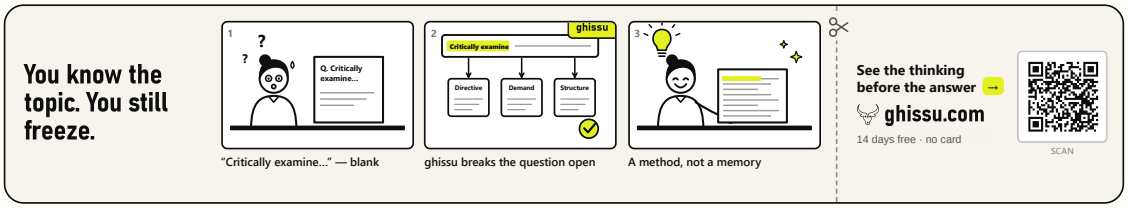
1. Low productivity: Low mechanisation and fragmented holdings limit farm gains.
2. Regional disparity: Drought-prone areas of AP face persistent agrarian distress.
3. Climate risks: Climate variability and groundwater depletion limit the sector's contribution.

Way Forward

1. Productivity: Climate-resilient technology and mechanisation to cut disguised unemployment.
2. Value addition: Wider e-NAM, contract farming with FPOs and agro-processing clusters for rural non-farm jobs.
3. Risk cover: Affordable credit and wider PM-FBY crop insurance.

Conclusion

The falling farm share has accelerated growth through structural change; raising farm productivity will keep that growth inclusive.



P-III
2(a)

Briefly discuss the main objectives and strategies outlined in the XII Five Year Plan of India.

Introduction

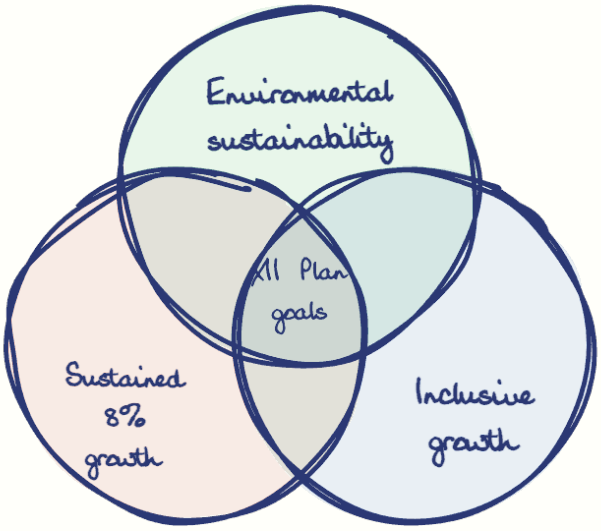
The XII Five Year Plan (2012–2017) was formulated as India recovered from the global slowdown while facing fiscal deficits and inflation. It aimed to sustain about 8% growth while ensuring that its benefits were inclusive, balancing development with social justice, poverty reduction and environmental sustainability.

Main Objectives

1. **Sustained Growth:** An average 8% GDP growth with job creation for a growing labour force.
2. **Inclusive Growth:** Reducing disparities of income, region and social group, with focus on Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women, so growth reaches all sections.
3. **Human Development:** Higher investment in health, education and social protection to reduce poverty.
4. **Environmental Sustainability:** Sustainable resource use, pollution control, climate resilience, more forest cover and cleaner rivers.
5. **Balanced Regional Development:** Special attention to lagging states and regions, including coastal

Andhra Pradesh and the North Eastern districts.

Vision of the XII Plan



Key Strategies

1. Indicative Planning: A shift from directive to indicative planning, with Centre–State coordination and local institutions strengthening implementation.
2. Fiscal Consolidation: Lower deficits under the FRBM Act while raising capital expenditure for infrastructure.
3. Agriculture and Rural Development: Better irrigation, credit access and technology adoption, especially in drought-prone regions like Rayalaseema.
4. Infrastructure: Expansion of energy, transport and digital networks to support growth and connectivity.

5. Technology and Innovation: Higher R&D spending and private participation in manufacturing and services.

6. Governance Reforms: Judicial reform, digital public infrastructure and outcome-based monitoring to achieve objectives efficiently.

Challenges

1. Employment: Labour market rigidities and skill mismatches limited the employment elasticity of growth.
2. Disparities: Social disparities persisted despite gains in literacy and health, needing targeted rural employment and welfare interventions.

Conclusion

The XII Plan laid a roadmap balancing rapid growth with social inclusion and sustainability. Industry-aligned skill development, efficient public capital spending through PPPs, well-monitored safety nets and climate-resilient agriculture and urban planning were needed to realise its vision of an equitable and prosperous India with decent work for all.

How did toppers write this one?
1.5 lakh+ topper answers, matched to each question.
ghissu.com →

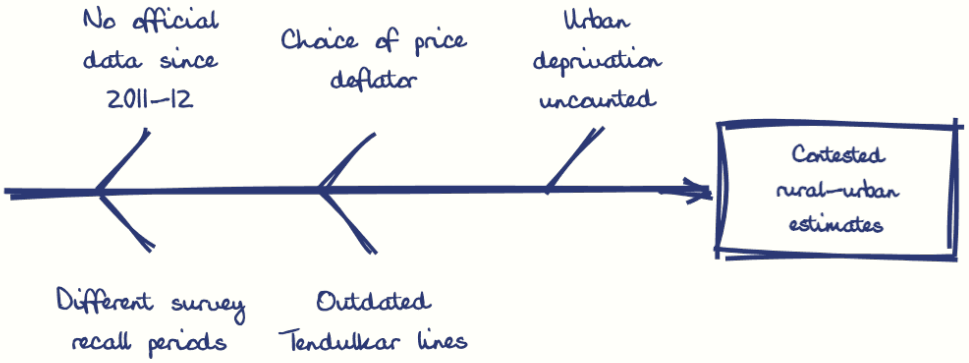
P-III
3(a)

Comment on the recent controversies relating to the estimates of rural-urban poverty in India.

Introduction

Recent poverty estimates in India have sparked intense debate on the rural–urban divide. With no official poverty data since 2011–12 and new survey-based figures emerging, questions of methodology and comparability have come to the fore. They matter because poverty measurement drives policy targeting and resource allocation.

Why Poverty Estimates Are Disputed



Sources of Controversy

1. Methodological discrepancies: The CES and PLFS use varying recall periods and consumption aggregates, giving inconsistent rural–urban estimates.
2. Price deflator choice: WPI, CPI for agricultural and industrial labour and rural–urban CPI give

very different poverty levels, with rural poverty understated under inappropriate deflators.

3. Outdated poverty line: The Tendulkar Committee lines, anchored in 1973–74 consumption patterns, do not reflect current baskets, especially in urban areas.

4. Urban poverty underestimated: Official urban rates below 5% are challenged by studies suggesting 40–60% once multidimensional deprivation, informal housing and poor access to services are counted.

Implications for Policy

1. Mistargeting of welfare: Schemes like MGNREGS and PDS, crucial for rural livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh, may be misdirected while the urban poor stay underserved.

2. Complacency: Low figures create a false sense of achievement despite persistent deprivation in urban slums and drought-prone Rayalaseema.

3. Loss of trust: Divergent data fuels political debate and scepticism about official statistics.

4. Weak monitoring: Without comparable data, assessing schemes like PM-AY in urban Visakhapatnam becomes difficult.

Way Forward

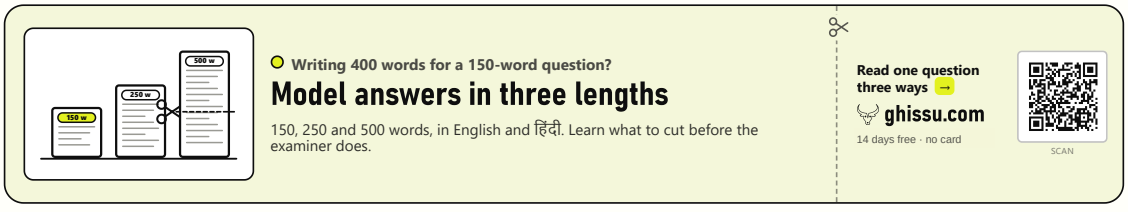
1. **Bridging surveys:** Harmonise recall periods and consumption measurement across rural and urban surveys.
2. **Revise poverty lines:** Constitute a new expert committee reflecting current consumption and cost structures.
3. **Open microdata:** Publish survey microdata for independent verification and research, fostering trust.
4. **Multidimensional metrics:** Expand the National Multidimensional Poverty Index to capture housing, health and education deprivation.

Accuracy Concerns

1. **State-level variation:** In Andhra Pradesh, rural poverty stagnates in some districts despite GSDP growth, so aggregates mask local realities.

Conclusion

Credible rural-urban poverty estimates need harmonised surveys, updated lines and multidimensional metrics, so that welfare reaches the truly poor.



P-III
3(b)

Assess the impact of MGNREGS in reducing the intensity of unemployment in rural areas of our country

Introduction

The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme is India's flagship intervention for rural wage employment and livelihood security. Its role grew during COVID-19, when reverse migration and lost urban jobs deepened rural distress.

Effect on Rural Unemployment

1. Employment generation: It generated 290.60 crore person-days in FY 2024-25, absorbing seasonal and distress unemployment.
2. Less distress migration: Guaranteed local work has stabilised rural labour markets, including in Rayalaseema.
3. Women's participation: It rose to 58.15% in FY 2024-25, raising household income security and cutting joblessness among rural women.
4. Limited reach: Only 100 days are guaranteed and often fewer are given, so the cushion is partial.

Practice 3(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

Mechanisms of Impact

How MGNREGS Eases Rural Unemployment



1. Direct wage work: Unskilled manual jobs give a fallback in lean agricultural seasons.
2. Asset creation: Water conservation and soil works raise productivity and diversify incomes.
3. Social inclusion: Mandating one-third women and targeting SC/ST strengthens safety nets and workers' bargaining power.
4. Decentralised planning: Gram Sabhas and Panchayati Raj Institutions select works to suit local needs.

Limitations

1. Only 100 days: Many workers remain underemployed for the rest of the year.
2. Wage issues: Rates below minimum wages and delays weaken the scheme.
3. Weak capacity: Delayed fund disbursal and

poor social audits hurt delivery, so impact varies across states.

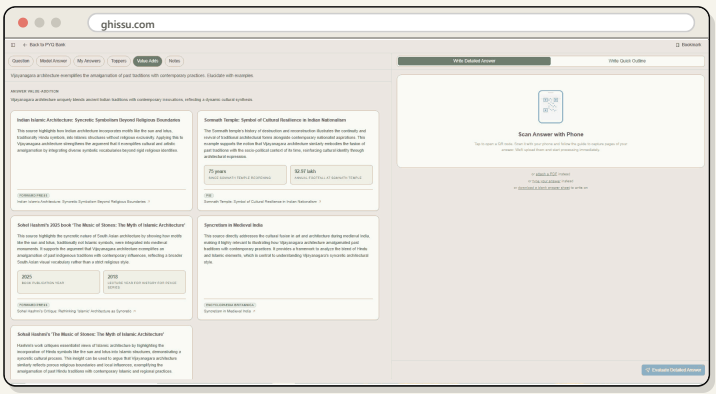
4. Asset quality: Many works are of poor quality and misaligned with long-term priorities.
5. Structural unemployment: Skill mismatches and lack of non-farm jobs remain unaddressed.

Conclusion

MGNREGS has reduced the intensity of rural unemployment but not ended it. More work days in drought-hit regions like Rayalaseema, timely wages and better assets can turn this seasonal cushion into lasting livelihood security.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP VALUE ADDITIONS

Correct answer. Average marks. Why?



Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

1 Value additions for one question, ready to use.

2 Numbers you can quote — each with its source.

3 Picked only from standard and government sources.

P-III
4(a)

Analyse the strategy adopted by Reserve Bank of India to control the rising prices in the last two years.

Introduction

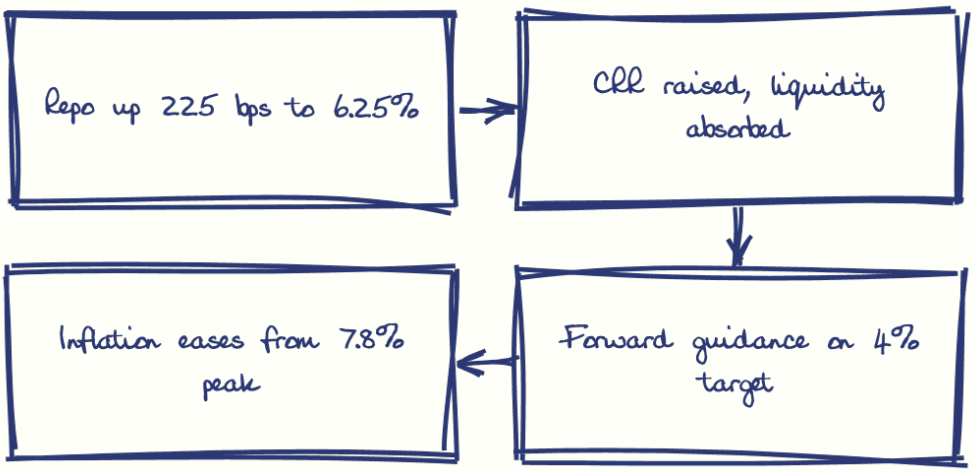
India recently faced significant inflation driven by global supply shocks, rising crude oil prices and domestic supply constraints, with inflation persistently above the 6% upper tolerance limit. The RBI responded with a calibrated monetary strategy to stabilise prices while supporting growth amid geopolitical tension.

Components of RBI's Strategy

1. **Monetary tightening:** The MPC raised the repo rate by 225 basis points, from 4.0% to 6.25%, between May and December 2022. Higher borrowing costs dampened demand and investment, cutting demand-pull inflation and slowing credit growth.
2. **CRR increase:** Raising the Cash Reserve Ratio forced banks to hold more deposits as reserves, limiting lending and excess money supply.
3. **Communication and forward guidance:** Clear signals of commitment to the 4% target with a ±2% band anchored expectations and reduced the risk of a wage-price spiral.

4. Selective credit controls: Less used recently, they historically restricted credit to inflation-sensitive sectors and curbed speculative demand in essential commodities.

RBI's anti-inflation strategy



Effectiveness and Challenges

1. Inflation moderation: Headline inflation fell from a peak of 7.8% in April 2022 to around 5.7% by December 2022, within the target range, showing the success of tightening.
2. Supply-side limits: Shocks from crude prices and farm output lie beyond demand management and need government action.
3. Growth trade-off: Tightening risks slowing growth and credit to productive sectors, a concern where state capital expenditure has plummeted, as in Andhra Pradesh.

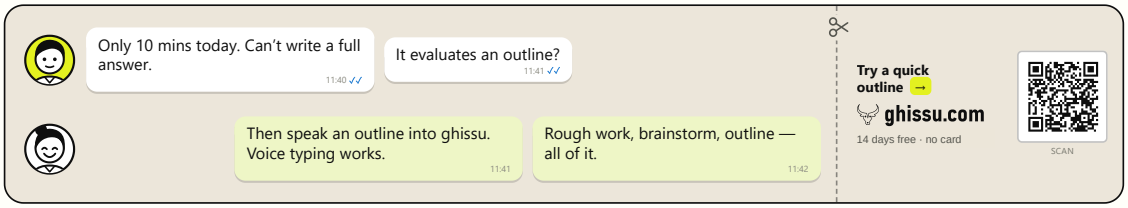
4. External pressures: Rupee depreciation and falling forex reserves required intervention without losing policy autonomy.

Way Forward

1. Supply-side action: Raise farm productivity in Andhra Pradesh and expand irrigation, as under the Polavaram project, to ease food inflation.
2. Calibrated policy: Adjust rates cautiously, balancing inflation control with credit flow to MSMEs in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Fiscal discipline: Cut the revenue deficit and raise capital expenditure in Andhra Pradesh to complement RBI's efforts.
4. Clear communication: Keep guiding market expectations to anchor inflation.

Conclusion

The RBI's monetary tightening, liquidity control and guidance curbed inflation, but lasting price stability needs supply-side and fiscal support.



P-III
4(b)

State the measures initiated by Reserve Bank of India to regulate credit disbursed by Non-Banking Financial Institutions.

Introduction

Regulating credit disbursed by Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) has gained importance due to their growing role and the risks exposed by the IL&FS crisis. As NBFCs serve sectors underserved by banks, including in Andhra Pradesh, RBI has initiated measures to strengthen oversight, risk management and borrower protection.

Strengthening the Regulatory Framework

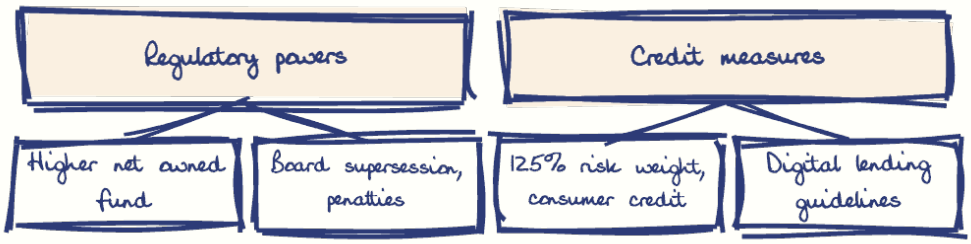
1. **Enhanced supervisory powers:** The amended RBI Act, 1934 empowers RBI to raise the minimum net owned fund for NBFCs to up to Rs 100 crore from Rs 2 crore.
2. **Board control:** RBI can remove directors and supersede boards of NBFCs, except government companies. This allows governance reform in weak entities.
3. **Group audits and disclosure:** NBFCs must annex group company accounts and allow RBI inspection. This improves transparency and risk assessment across corporate groups.
4. **Penalty and resolution:** RBI can impose higher

penalties and direct amalgamation or reconstruction of stressed NBFCs, protecting depositors and creditors.

Credit-Specific Measures

1. Liquidity risk management: NBFCs with assets above Rs 100 crore must use granular maturity buckets, improving resilience but straining smaller NBFCs in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Risk weights: Risk weight on consumer credit was raised to 125%, excluding housing and microfinance, moderating credit growth.
3. Digital lending: Following the Working Group on Digital Lending, digital lending guidelines curb mis-selling and unethical recovery, vital as fintech NBFCs grow in urban and semi-urban Andhra Pradesh.
4. Credit information: NBFCs report data to credit information companies, reducing information asymmetry for MSME lending.

RBI measures on NBFC credit



Way Forward

1. State coordination: Work with Andhra Pradesh regulators to monitor local credit flows and risks.
2. Capacity building: Help smaller NBFCs with compliance and risk management without stifling credit.
3. Consumer protection: Expand depositor education and grievance redressal in rural and semi-urban Andhra Pradesh to safeguard vulnerable borrowers.
4. Tech supervision: Use AI and data analytics for real-time monitoring of NBFC credit portfolios and proactive risk mitigation.

Conclusion

RBI's measures have strengthened oversight of NBFC credit, balancing inclusion with stability so that NBFCs keep serving MSMEs and retail borrowers safely, in line with Viksit Bharat @2047.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
5(a)

Examine the relative shares of direct and indirect tax revenues of Indian Government in the post-reforms period.

Introduction

The post-reform period from the early 1990s brought a significant shift in India's tax structure, reflecting liberalisation and growth. The relative shares of direct and indirect taxes affect fiscal capacity, equity and efficiency, and show India's progress towards a balanced, progressive tax system.

Direct Taxes: A Rising Share

1. **Growing share:** Direct taxes have risen steadily to over 58% of total tax revenue in the 2024–25 revised estimates, driven by personal income and corporate tax as formalisation and compliance improved.
2. **Equity and wider base:** Being based on ability to pay, direct taxes make the system fairer. Individual income tax filers rose from 3.91 crore in FY 2013–14 to 9.19 crore in FY 2024–25.
3. **Administrative reforms:** Faceless e-assessment and a proposed new Income Tax law aim to cut litigation, under the

"Transparent Taxation – Honouring the Honest" initiative.

4. Weak recovery: 97% of uncollected direct tax demand is considered difficult to recover, and a CAG audit found a 1,806 crore impact in Andhra Pradesh in 2021–22.

Indirect Taxes: Relative Decline

1. From dominance to decline: Indirect taxes held over 80% of revenue before reforms, but their relative share has fallen.
2. GST buoyancy: GST created a seamless national market. Monthly GST collections rose from 0.90 lakh crore in FY18 to 1.49 lakh crore in FY23.
3. Regressive burden: Indirect taxes weigh more on lower and middle-income groups, and state administration lags: Andhra Pradesh's Commercial Taxes Department had 1,954 crore in outstanding audit observations as of 2025.
4. Complexity: Multiple GST rates and exemptions create complexity and scope for evasion, which ongoing rate rationalisation seeks to address.

Direct vs indirect tax shares

Direct taxes	Indirect taxes
Over 58% of tax revenue	Over 80% before reforms
Rising share	Relative decline
Based on ability to pay	Regressive burden
Faceless e-assessment	GST buoyancy

Comparative Assessment

1. Shift to direct taxes: Growth, formalisation and better administration have moved India closer to advanced economies, where direct taxes dominate.
2. Complementary roles: Direct taxes promote equity and are non-inflationary, while indirect taxes give stable revenue and are easier to administer.

Conclusion

The post-reform tilt towards direct taxes has made India's tax system fairer and more buoyant. Rationalising GST rates and improving recovery of tax dues will consolidate a balanced tax mix for inclusive growth.

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
5(b)

Justify the view that public debt is essential for the development of Indian economy endowed with natural resources.

Introduction

India's GVA growth was near 6.4% in FY24, and capital expenditure exceeds Rs 11 lakh crore in FY25. Its vast natural resources, minerals and coastal assets, need substantial investment to be harnessed. Public debt bridges the gap between available resources and the financing needed, especially in fiscally constrained states like Andhra Pradesh.

Why Public Debt Is Essential

1. Infrastructure financing: Borrowing mobilises large funds for roads, ports, irrigation and energy that unlock resource potential, as in the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor.
2. Unlocking natural resources: Extraction, processing and value addition need upfront investment that private capital avoids due to long gestation and risk. Andhra Pradesh, with 86.11% of India's barytes reserves, shows this need.
3. Counter-cyclical policy: In downturns like COVID-19, debt sustains demand. The Economic Survey 2020–21 noted a negative interest rate–growth differential, which justifies

growth-led borrowing.

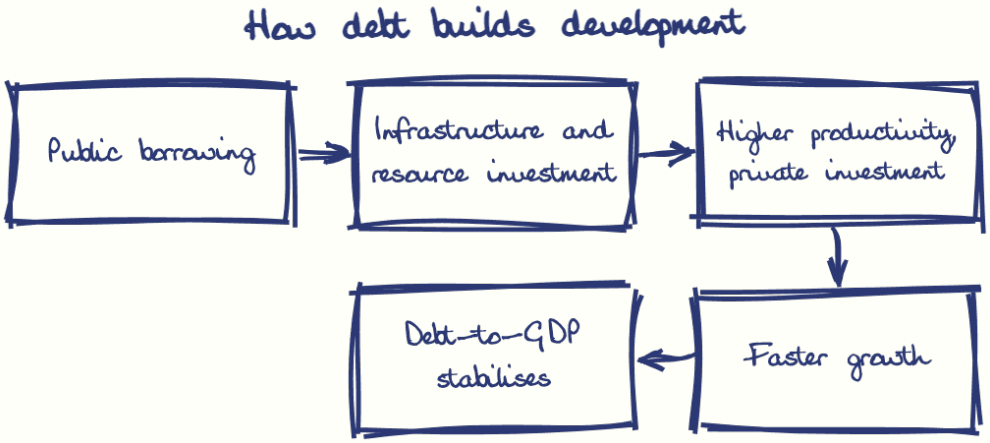
4. Bridging revenue gaps: States like Andhra Pradesh face revenue deficits; debt sustains social and infrastructure spending despite shortfalls in tax and mineral revenue.

Debt and Development in a Resource-Rich Economy

1. Investment multiplier: Debt-financed infrastructure raises productivity and attracts private investment, creating a multiplier effect, as Andhra Pradesh's National Infrastructure Pipeline projects aim to do for activity and jobs.
2. Growth-linked sustainability: When growth exceeds interest rates, debt-to-GDP stabilises; Andhra Pradesh's 9.24% growth supports manageable debt.
3. Mostly internal debt: India's debt is predominantly internal, which reduces exposure to external shocks.
4. Inclusive outcomes: Debt-funded welfare and infrastructure in Andhra Pradesh have helped lift per capita income above the national average and reduce regional disparities.

Risks to Manage

1. Overdependence: Debt without efficient investment causes fiscal stress, inflation and crowding out of

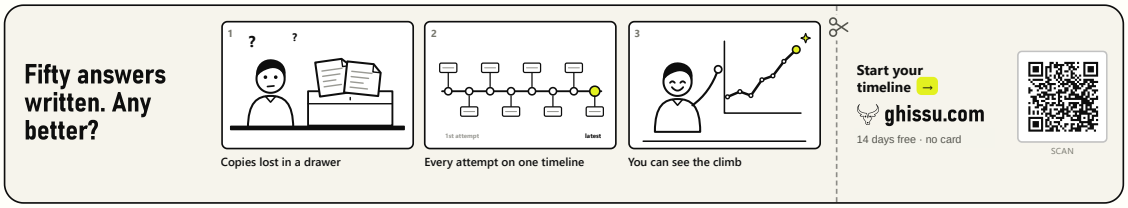


private investment, as Andhra Pradesh's fall in capital spending in 2022–23 shows.

2. Servicing burden: High debt raises interest payments that divert funds from development, and Andhra Pradesh's liabilities have reached 36% of GSDP.

Conclusion

Public debt is essential to turn India's natural wealth into infrastructure and growth, provided it funds productive assets, growth outpaces interest costs and fiscal discipline is maintained. For Andhra Pradesh, this means borrowing for ports, corridors and minerals while restoring capital spending.



P-III
6(a)

Describe the changing structure of land holdings in Andhra Pradesh in the past two decades

Introduction

The structure of land holdings in Andhra Pradesh has changed significantly over the past two decades, reflecting socio-economic and policy shifts. With agriculture still employing a large rural population, these changes matter for livelihoods and food security. Reforms such as title deeds for over 20 lakh farmers and amended tenancy laws have reshaped holdings further.

Changing Pattern of Holdings

1. Rise of marginal and small holdings: The share of marginal and small farmers in ownership and operational holdings has risen through inheritance and population pressure, especially in the Godavari-Krishna delta.

2. Growth of tenancy: Leased-in land, especially among pure tenants, has grown faster than the all-India average, with Scheduled Castes moving from agricultural labour to tenant cultivation.

3. Shift in tenancy terms: Fixed rent tenancy rose from 29.9% to 55% between 2002 and

2012 as sharecropping declined, placing more risk on tenants.

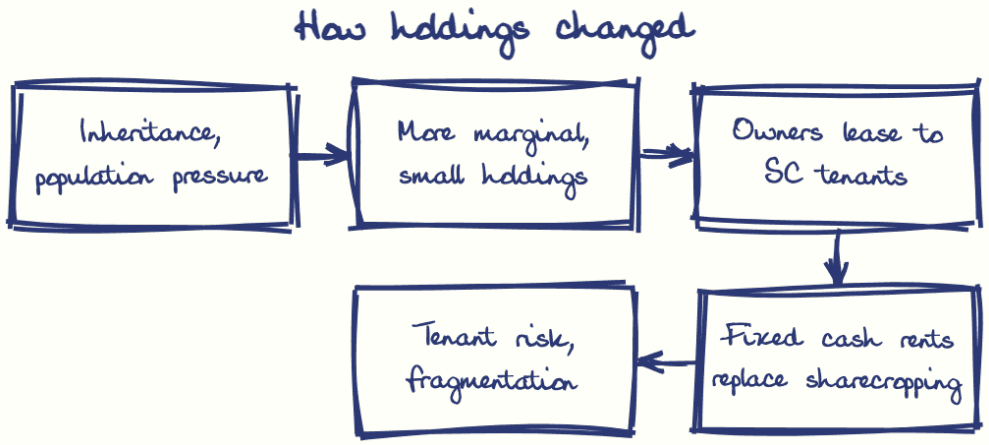
4. Titles for assigned land: Ownership titles for 20.24 lakh farmers over 35.45 lakh acres converted assigned lands, many held by Dalits, into freehold.

Factors Behind the Change

1. Legal reforms: Tenancy laws of 1956, 2011 and 2019 and the 2023 ~~Assigned Lands~~ amendment regulated leases and enabled transfers, though transfers from Dalits are controversial.
2. Caste and mobility: Land-owning forward castes moving to non-farm sectors lease land to marginalised groups.
3. Crop patterns: Intensive vegetables and horticulture in regions like Rayalaseema make smaller holdings viable, shaping leasing decisions.
4. Bifurcation: ~~After~~ 2014, ~~Amaravati land pooling~~ affected land values, with allegations of speculation.

Implications

1. Tenure security: Titles improve access to credit



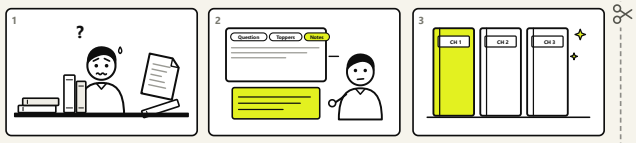
and schemes.

2. Tenant vulnerability: Fixed rents and high SC tenancy raise distress risks.
3. Fragmentation: Small plots hinder mechanisation unless backed by FPOs or cooperative farming.
4. Equity concerns: Controversies over assigned land transfers raise fears for Dalit land rights.

Conclusion

Holdings in Andhra Pradesh are now smaller, more leased and more cash-rented. Policy must protect tenants and help small farms gain scale through collective models.

Where did I write that point?



Five notebooks, one point
Note it on the question
Chapter notes build themselves

Keep every note in place →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
6(b)

Discuss the problems associated with the issue of land distribution in Andhra Pradesh State.

Introduction

Land distribution directly shapes agricultural productivity, social equity and rural livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh. Early reforms redistributed land to marginalised groups, but legal amendments, weak administration and corruption allegations now threaten these gains, especially for Dalits and Scheduled Tribes.

Land distribution flashpoints in Andhra Pradesh



Poding, displacement, acquisition pressure, fragmentation

Core Problems in Land Distribution

1. **Caste-based disparities:** Although reforms

distributed about 50 lakh acres to the underprivileged, upper-caste landlords still control large tracts while Dalits and Adivasis remain landless or hold marginal land.

2. Dilution of assigned lands: The 2023 amendment to the AP Assigned Lands (Prohibition of Transfers) Act relaxed transfer curbs, leading to allegations that officials and connected persons acquired land from Dalit assignees.

3. Weak land administration: Poor accountability enables collusion, and the CAG audit (2021-22) found significant revenue losses in land departments.

4. Displacement: The Polavaram project displaced over one lakh families, and rehabilitation lags.

State-Specific Issues

1. Bifurcation and Amaravati: After the 2014 bifurcation and loss of Hyderabad, land pooling for Amaravati drew allegations of insider trading and speculation.

2. Freehold conversion: The SC and Tribal Sub-Plans fund land purchase, yet converting assigned lands into freehold titles without safeguards raised concerns, including no consultation with the National Commission for Scheduled Castes.

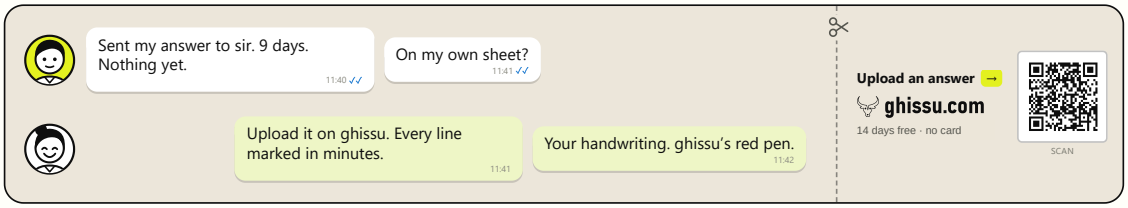
3. Regional contrasts: Visakhapatnam faces acquisition pressure from industrial corridors, while drought-prone Rayalaseema has fragmented holdings.

Way Forward

1. Protect assigned lands: Reinstate strict transfer prohibitions and involve the NCSC in policy changes.
2. Transparency: Digital land records and grievance redressal can curb corruption.
3. Rehabilitation: Fund and monitor timely rehabilitation of Polavaram families to safeguard their land rights and livelihoods.

Conclusion

Unequal and insecure land distribution undermines social justice in Andhra Pradesh. Strong safeguards and transparent administration are vital for inclusive growth under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

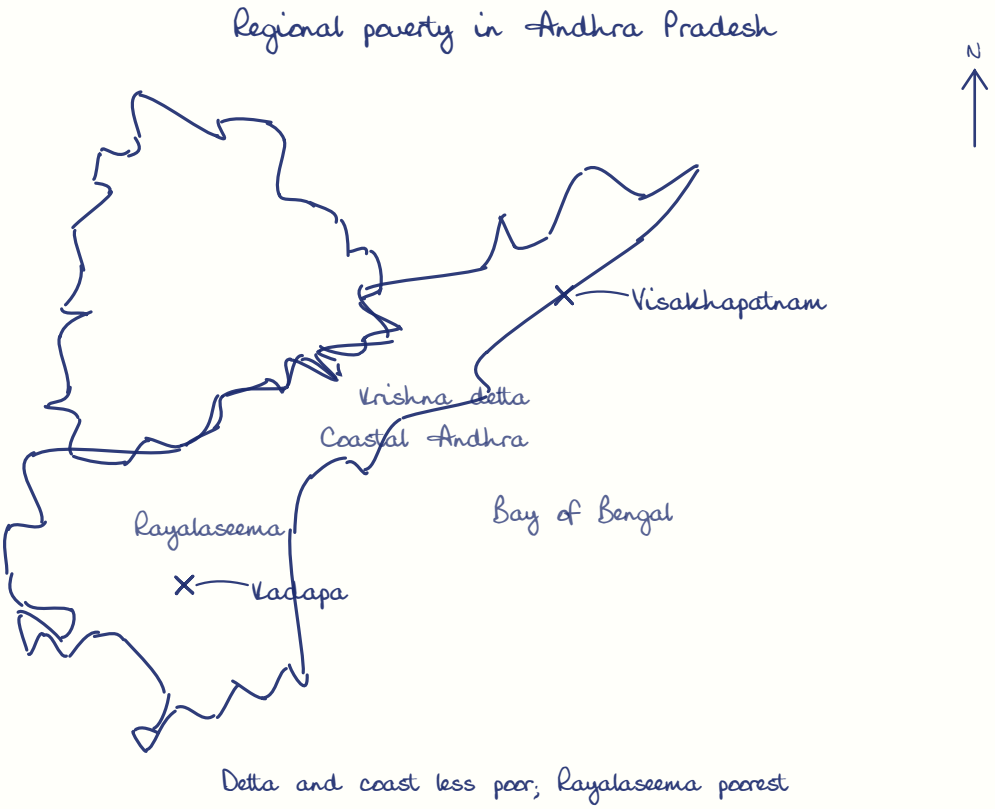


P-III
7(a)

Explain the existing inter-regional differences in the levels of poverty in Andhra Pradesh economy.

Introduction

Inter-regional poverty differences remain critical as Andhra Pradesh pursues inclusive growth. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024-25, above the national average, understanding why poverty persists unevenly across Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Telangana is vital for targeted policy.



Regional Differences in Poverty

1. Rayalaseema poorest: Drought and low farm

Practice 7(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

productivity have historically kept its poverty higher than in prosperous Coastal Andhra.

2. Density and opportunity: Krishna, with the highest density of 518 per sq. km, has better opportunities and lower poverty. less dense YSR district has higher poverty.

3. Uneven decline: Poverty has fallen overall, but Coastal Andhra gained more, while Rayalaseema and parts of Telangana lag.

Regional Poverty in Andhra Pradesh

Coastal Andhra	Rayalaseema
Agricultural productivity	Drought-prone, low productivity
Population density high	Population density low
Industrial and port-led growth	Limited industrialisation
Lower poverty rate	Higher poverty rate

Causes of the Differences

1. Agriculture and climate: Fertile deltaic soils and irrigation raise coastal incomes, while rain-fed Rayalaseema suffers droughts.

2. Industry: Visakhapatnam's port-led corridors

attract investment, Rayalaseema lacks industry.

3. Fiscal capacity: Developed areas raise more own-tax revenue and deliver better services, while backward areas face weak governance despite schemes like Deepam-2 and Annadatha Sukhibhava.

4. Human development: Gaps in literacy, health and schemes like Samagra Shiksha perpetuate poverty.

Implications

1. Migration: Poverty drives migration to coastal and urban areas, straining cities and depopulating villages.

2. Unrest: Grievances fed demands for special status and the Telangana movement.

Conclusion

Regional poverty gaps in Andhra Pradesh reflect differences in agriculture, industry, governance and human development. Irrigation, roads and industrial parks in Rayalaseema, with stronger local governance, can narrow them.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

ghissu

ghissu exam-hall thinking decodes every directive — Discuss, Examine, Elucidate — before you write a line.

Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
7(b)

How far does the present use of agricultural inputs and technical knowledge facilitate the achievement of evergreen revolution in Andhra Pradesh?

Introduction

Agricutture is a cornerstone of Andhra Pradesh's economy, with the agricutture and allied sector growing (10.7%) in 2024–25. Under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, an evergreen revolution means sustainable, climate-resilient and inclusive growth. Present input use and technical knowledge support it only partly, balancing productivity against sustainability.

Present Use of Agricuttural Inputs

1. Intensive input use: HYV seeds, chemical fertilisers and pesticides boost productivity and multiple cropping in irrigated regions like West Godavari, though heavy chemical use strains sustainability.
2. Irrigation constraints: At Polavaram, only (11%) of displaced families have been rehabilitated and land acquisition lags, limiting the assured water that inputs need to perform.
3. Natural farming: APCNF reduces chemical dependence, lowers costs and improves soil health, but covers only about (10.5%) of farmers.
4. Cost and access: Small farmers in

Practice 7(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

drought-prone Rayalaseema lack quality inputs and credit; Annadatha Sukhibhava needs better targeting.

Role of Technical Knowledge

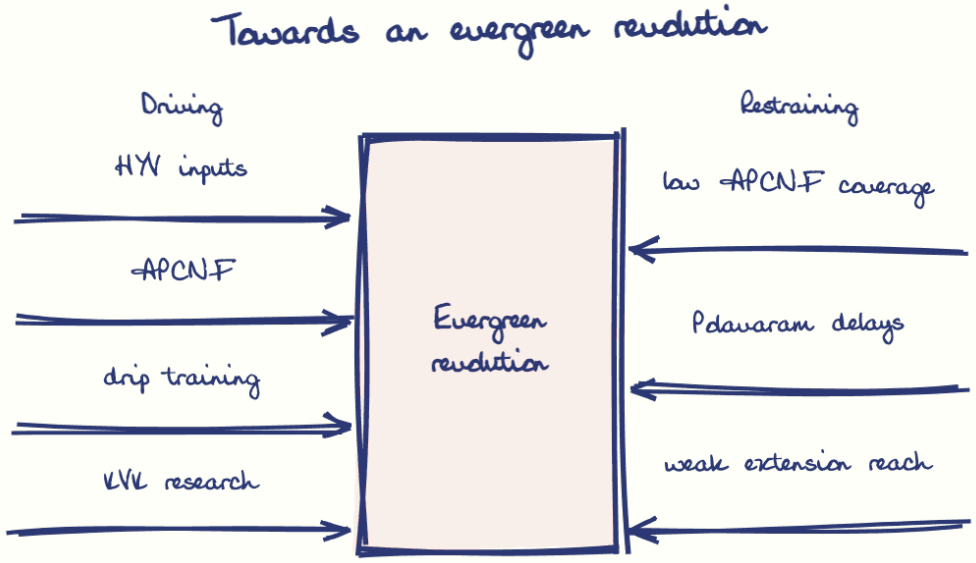
1. Extension and training: Training in integrated nutrient and pest management, mechanisation and drip irrigation has raised yields and cut costs in Kadapa.
2. Digital platforms: M-KISAN and e-NAM give market and advisory information, yet only 28% of rural women have internet access.
3. Research linkages: Agricultural universities and Krishi Vigyan Kendras develop climate-resilient varieties, but adoption is uneven.
4. Transfer gaps: Many farmers still rely on traditional practices due to limited extension reach and resource constraints, so knowledge does not fully turn into resilience.

Assessment

Inputs and extension have delivered high output in irrigated belts, but small APCNF coverage and weak reach to Rayalaseema smallholders and women leave the sustainable and inclusive parts of the goal unmet.

Practice 7(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice



Way Forward

1. Scale APCNF: Expand training, input support and market linkages for natural produce.
2. Complete Polavaram: Clear rehabilitation and land acquisition bottlenecks.
3. Digital inclusion: Improve rural internet and digital literacy, especially for women.
4. Collectivisation: Support FPOs for shared access to machinery and inputs.

Conclusion

Current inputs and knowledge give a strong but incomplete foundation. Integrated with inclusive policy and infrastructure, they can make agriculture climate-resilient and viable, securing livelihoods and food security.

Write your own answer to 7(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
8(a)

Suggest suitable steps to utilise demographic dividend for the rapid economic development of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's GSDP grew 9.24% in 2024–25, well above the national 6.4%. Its expanding working-age population offers a demographic dividend that can sustain this momentum, provided skill gaps, weak job creation and infrastructure deficits are addressed.

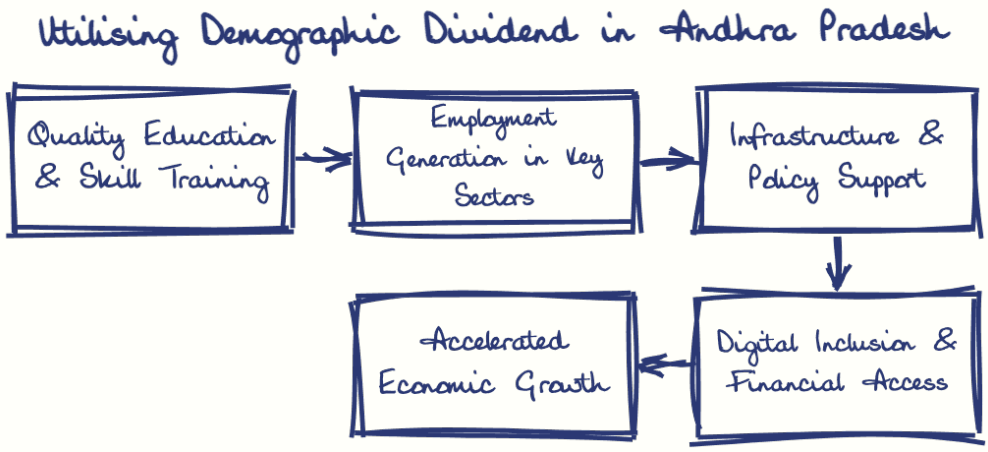
Steps to Utilise the Demographic Dividend

1. Education and skill development: Strengthen Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and integrate vocational training from school level, so youth gain industry-aligned skills and better employability.
2. Job-rich industrial growth: Promote aquaculture, horticulture and port-led corridors like the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor, with targeted incentives for MSMEs and startups to absorb the workforce.
3. Health and infrastructure: Raise the low health budget (3.11% in 2026), improve care under Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust, and complete Polavaram irrigation and coastal ports to attract investment.

Practice 8(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Digital and financial inclusion: Build on e-Seva to expand digital literacy and access to jobs and services, bringing informal workers into the formal economy.



How These Steps Speed Up Development

1. Higher productivity: Better education and health raise labour productivity and attract higher-value industries, lifting per capita income beyond 2,68,653.
2. Jobs reduce poverty: Formal jobs in corridors and MSMEs further cut poverty, already down to 6.06%, making growth broad-based.
3. Infrastructure multiplier: Transport and irrigation lower costs and improve market access, supporting the 10.7% growth in agriculture and allied sectors.
4. Formalisation: Integrating workers into formal

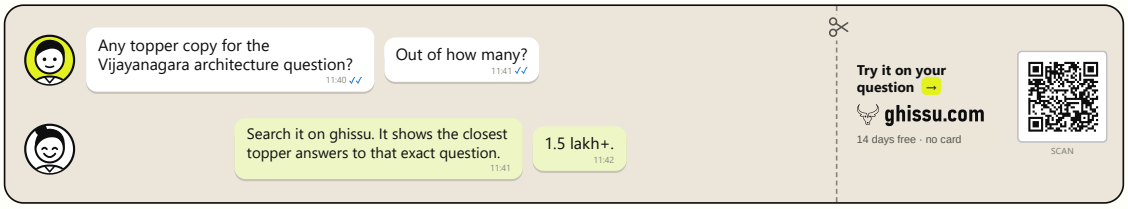
systems through digital platforms raises tax revenue and improves governance and public service delivery.

Way Forward

1. Scale up vocational training: Expand industry-linked skilling to match emerging sector demand.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's demographic dividend is a powerful lever for rapid development. Strategic investment in education, jobs, infrastructure and digital inclusion will turn it into inclusive prosperity under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, making a young workforce the state's strongest asset.



P-III
8(b)

Critically Examine the socio-economic issues retarding the pace of women empowerment in Andhra Pradesh.

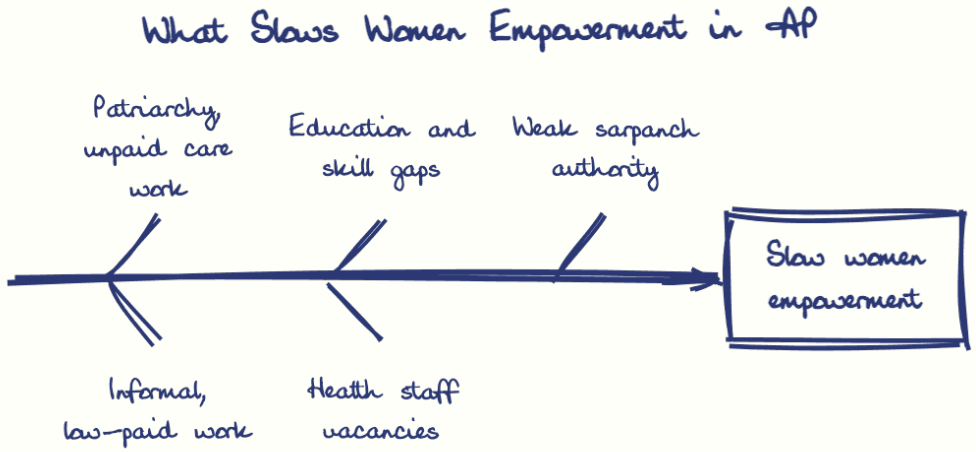
Introduction

Women empowerment is central to inclusive development, and Andhra Pradesh shows mixed progress. Despite GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, barriers in social norms, economic participation, education and institutions continue to slow women's empowerment.

Socio-Economic Issues

1. Household patriarchy: Women are confined to domestic duties with heavy unpaid care work, limiting decisions, mobility and paid work.
2. Economic participation barriers: Only about 21% of women above 15 are economically active nationally. AP women work in informal sectors like agriculture and fisheries, and face exploitation in the shrimp sector.
3. Education and skill gaps: Samagra Shiksha improved access, but teacher shortages persist and only 28% of rural women have internet access.
4. Institutional constraints: Despite Mission Shakti and JSY, CAG (2024) found 22% vacancy

in medical officer posts, and access to formal credit is low.



Impact on the Pace of Empowerment

1. Economic dependency: Unpaid and informal work slows poverty reduction and creates intergenerational deprivation.
2. Unequal skills: Digital divides keep women out of formal jobs.
3. Health vulnerability: Weak services raise risks of maternal mortality and domestic violence.
4. Limited representation: 43% of gram panchayats have women sarpanches, but patriarchal control weakens their leadership.

Way Forward

1. Norm change: Community campaigns to redistribute

unpaid care work.

2. Economic inclusion: Expand formal jobs, social security and targeted credit for women in fisheries and agriculture.

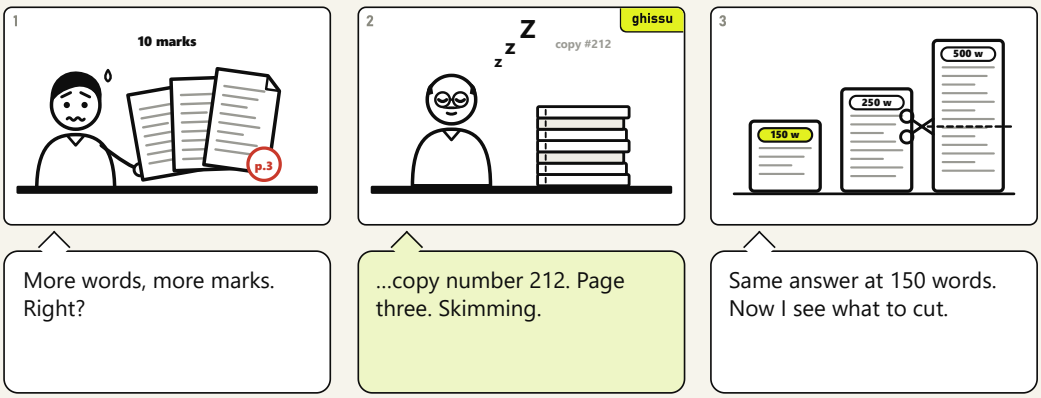
3. Education and digital access: Invest in teacher training and digital infrastructure for rural girls and women.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's rapid growth will translate into women's empowerment only if social norms, economic exclusion, education gaps and institutional weaknesses are tackled together.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW · MODEL ANSWERS IN 150 · 250 · 500

Three pages for ten marks



— Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Learn what to cut →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
9(a)

Describe the analysis of tax devolution from Central Government to Andhra Pradesh Government in the last decade.

Introduction

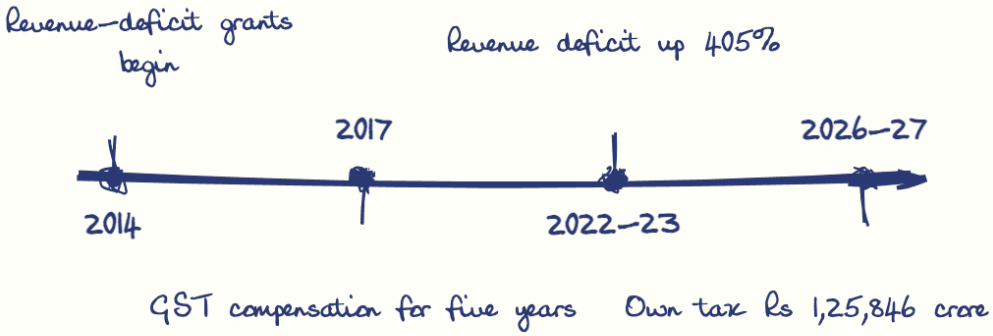
Tax devolution from the Centre has been a critical part of Andhra Pradesh's fiscal framework in the last decade, marked by the 2014 bifurcation and the Reorganisation Act. Finance Commission awards, the loss of Hyderabad and the demand for Special Category Status have shaped these transfers.

Patterns and Trends

1. Post-bifurcation transfers: The Centre first gave revenue-deficit grants under the Reorganisation Act, 2014 to offset Hyderabad's lost revenue and stabilise finances.
2. Rising share: The state's share in central transfers rose gradually with its economic size, while own tax revenue also grew.
3. GST: From 2017 the Centre compensated states for revenue losses for five years, which helped the state.
4. Delayed State Finance Commission: The Fourth SFC came eight years late and has not reported, slowing funds to local bodies.

Urban local bodies and panchayats suffer.

Devolution and Andhra Pradesh's finances



Impact on Fiscal Capacity

1. **Deficits persist:** The revenue deficit rose 405% in 2022–23 to Rs 43,487 crore, as devolution could not match expenditure commitments. Welfare schemes add to the strain.
2. **Own revenues:** Own tax revenue is estimated at Rs 1,25,846 crore in 2026–27, 6.4% of GSDP, but a CAG audit found Rs 1,806 crore of leakage.
3. **Fund use:** Audits found diversion in welfare boards. Better governance must accompany devolution.

Role of Finance Commissions

1. **Formula-based transfers:** The Fourteenth and

~~Fifteenth Finance Commissions~~ used population, area and fiscal capacity, the Fifteenth stressed performance-based grants.

2. Revenue deficit grants: Both Commissions awarded post-devolution revenue deficit grants, as devolution alone could not meet the state's needs after bifurcation.

3. Local devolution: Delayed SFC reports and incomplete functional devolution limit the fiscal autonomy of local bodies.

Conclusion

Devolution moved Andhra Pradesh from grant dependence towards a more balanced structure, but deficits and leakages show that better governance must accompany it.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 9(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
10(a)

Discuss the sectoral performance of Eleventh Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The Eleventh Five Year Plan (2007–2012) was a pivotal phase for Andhra Pradesh. It aimed at inclusive growth by accelerating sectoral development and improving quality of life, balancing rapid expansion with social equity and using the state's geographic and demographic advantages.

Sectoral Performance

1. Agriculture and allied activities: The sector made progress, but in drought-prone Rayalaseema irrigation infrastructure lagged, limiting uniform growth. Farmer welfare and productivity remained the focus.

2. Industry and manufacturing: The Plan targeted double-digit growth in manufacturing, using the coastal location and ports around Visakhapatnam. Governance and arrears issues in state enterprises and slow policy implementation constrained results. Corridors attracted some investment.

3. Services and infrastructure: IT and tourism grew rapidly, expanding jobs in health and education. This matched the Plan's vision. Digital services also improved delivery. Janani Suraksha Yojana

built human capital, while Polavaram and e-Seva aided development.

Impact on Overall Development

1. Employment and human development: Services generated jobs and improved social indicators, but job quality suffered with a large informal sector. Job creation was uneven across regions.
2. Fiscal and institutional outcomes: Own tax revenue rose steadily, yet deficits and committed spending limited new infrastructure; delays in mining revenue exposed governance gaps. State enterprises needed reform.
3. Regional inclusiveness: Coastal and urban areas gained more than drought-prone rural regions; social schemes only partly offset this. Weak irrigation and rural infrastructure limited inclusive impact.
4. Broad-based growth: Integrating agriculture, industry and services widened economic opportunities, a step towards inclusive growth.

Way Forward

1. Irrigation: Speed up Polavaram for equitable farm growth in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
2. State enterprises: Reform to clear arrears and raise

XI Plan: gains and gaps

Gains	Gaps
Farm progress	Rayalaseema irrigation lags
IT, tourism grew fast	Job quality suffered
Own tax revenue rose	Deficits limit infrastructure
Coastal, urban areas gained	Drought-prone rural lag

efficiency, unlocking their economic potential.

3. Skills: Education and vocational training aligned with industry to improve job quality.
4. Capital spending: Prioritise high-impact infrastructure and diversify revenue to sustain growth.

Conclusion

The Eleventh Plan advanced agriculture, industry and services and laid a foundation for inclusive growth in Andhra Pradesh, building on its coastal and demographic advantages. However, uneven regional growth, informal jobs and fiscal limits demand better irrigation, skills and spending quality.

Only ten minutes today?
Speak an outline. It gets evaluated too.
ghissu.com →

P-III
10(b)

Explain the important features of XII Five Year Plan of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's XII Five Year Plan aimed to accelerate inclusive growth, enhance infrastructure and improve social welfare, using the state's coastal and agrarian strengths to bridge regional disparities. Its implementation coincided with the 2014 bifurcation and its economic and administrative strain, making sustainable development and fiscal consolidation central.

Institutional Framework and Priorities

1. Decentralised planning: Stronger Panchayati Raj Institutions to plan and implement programmes at the grassroots. Local needs and priorities thus shaped programmes.
2. Whole-of-government approach: Line departments aligned under one framework to achieve Vision 2029 and the SDGs, aiding coordinated allocation. Monitoring also improved.
3. Fiscal discipline: Better quality of expenditure through higher capital outlay, optimised committed spending and diverse revenue to cut dependence on transfers.
4. Infrastructure focus: Fast-tracking irrigation, energy and transport, using the coastal location and port

connectivity. This aimed to raise farm productivity and industrial growth.

Implementation and Outcomes

1. Agriculture: Raising farmers' income and food security, but technology adoption and irrigation efficiency lagged. Gains were therefore uneven.
2. Social sector: Health and education spending, including Janani Suraksha Yojana, improved maternal health, but gaps persisted in Rayalaseema. Literacy also improved.
3. Fiscal constraints: A high revenue deficit and low capital expenditure limited funding for growth drivers. Long-term investment suffered.
4. Governance: Audits found diversion of funds and pending claims, eroding trust.
5. Regional disparities: The Plan sought to bridge gaps using coastal and agrarian strengths, but backward regions like Rayalaseema still lagged.

Way Forward

1. Capital spending: Raise it to at least the general states' average, focused on high-impact infrastructure.
2. Accountability: Real-time dashboards and district

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

XII Plan: aims and outcomes

Aim	Outcome
Higher capital outlay	Revenue deficit limited funding
Farm income, irrigation	Technology, irrigation gaps
Better maternal health	JSY improved outcomes
Bridge regional gaps	Backward regions lag

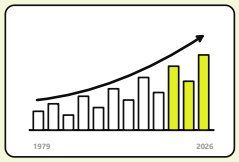
social audits.

3. Water and farming: Community-managed natural farming and projects like Polavaram for climate resilience.

4. Revenue: Broaden the tax base and rationalise subsidies to create fiscal space for development.

Conclusion

The XII Plan built a base for inclusive, sustainable growth by combining institutional reform, welfare and infrastructure. Effective implementation can reduce regional disparities, in line with SDG (8.)



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 10(b) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

3 / 3

Scan to practice

P-III
11(a)

State the policy measures recently implemented by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to promote the growth of Industries.

Introduction

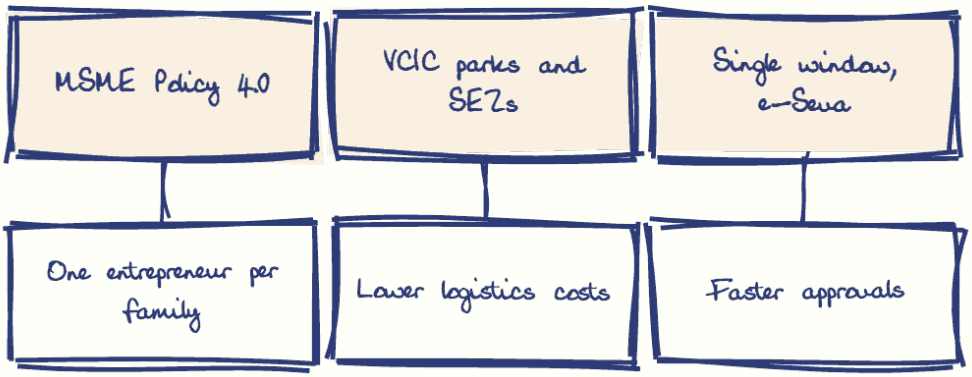
The Government of Andhra Pradesh is pursuing industrial growth by leveraging its strategic coastal location, rich natural resources and skilled workforce. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, recent policies aim to raise investment, infrastructure and ease of doing business in line with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Recent Policy Measures

1. **MSME Policy 4.0:** The MSME & Entrepreneur Development Policy 2024–29 supports small enterprises through financial incentives, skill development and technology adoption, aiming to create one entrepreneur per family by 2030.
2. **Industrial infrastructure:** Industrial parks and special economic zones are being developed along the 974 km coastline, including the Visakhapatnam–Chennai Industrial Corridor, to attract export-oriented industries.
3. **Ease of doing business:** A single-window clearance system and digital platforms like e-Seva streamline approvals.

4. Green industry promotion: Subsidies for clean production methods and green building certifications align industry with pollution control and energy efficiency mandates.

AP measures and their effect



How These Measures Promote Growth

1. Entrepreneurship: Capital subsidies and capacity building lower entry barriers for startups and small industries, fostering innovation and jobs.
2. Better logistics: Corridors and export zones reduce costs and attract domestic and foreign investment.
3. Lower regulatory burden: Digital services speed up project approvals, boosting investor confidence.
4. Sustainability: Green incentives help firms comply with environmental norms and avoid shutdowns.

Expected Outcomes

1. Exports and output: Exports of over US$19 billion in FY22 are expected to expand further.
2. Inclusive growth: MSME focus will create jobs in urban and rural areas, aiding poverty reduction and balanced regional development.
3. Investment climate: Higher FDI can bring technology transfer, skills and higher productivity.
4. Environmental sustainability: Green practices will curb pollution and resource depletion.

Way Forward

1. Power reliability: Address power deficits to cut operating costs and raise industrial productivity.
2. Export capacity: More certification agencies and regular trade fairs for MSMEs.
3. Digital and cluster push: Raise internet penetration and develop clusters in underdeveloped regions.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's recent measures combine incentives, infrastructure, regulatory ease and sustainability, laying the base for competitive and inclusive industrial growth.

Are you actually improving?
Every attempt scored. Watch the curve.
ghissu.com →

P-III
11(b)

Suggest appropriate measures to overcome the institutional problems of small scale industries in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Small scale industries (SSIs) in Andhra Pradesh are vital for inclusive growth, employment and regional development. Despite GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 and rising per capita income, institutional problems keep SSIs below their potential, and solving them is key to industrial diversification under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Institutional Problems

1. Limited credit: Stringent collateral requirements and a lack of specialised branches restrict working capital and expansion.
2. Infrastructure and power: Frequent outages and weak cluster infrastructure raise costs, especially for micro-enterprises without backup power.
3. Weak marketing support: Withdrawal of permanent price preference policies has hurt the marketing and competitiveness of SSI products in local and national markets.
4. Governance delays: Complex procedures, weak enforcement of the Delayed Payment to SSI Act and low awareness of schemes hamper growth.

SSI problems and remedies

Problem	Remedy
Collateral-bound credit	Viability-based lending, SSI branches
Power outages	Uninterrupted, affordable power
Price preference withdrawn	10% price preference
Delayed payments, red tape	Enforce Act, simplify licensing

Measures to Overcome Them

1. Financial inclusion: Banks should open specialised SSI branches in clusters and use integrated credit systems based on enterprise viability over collateral, as the Abid Hussain Committee recommended.
2. Reliable power and infrastructure: Ensure uninterrupted, affordable power and build industrial parks with shared renewable energy.
3. Marketing revival: Reinstate a 10% price preference for SSI products and strengthen e-commerce and government procurement links.
4. Regulatory streamlining: Simplify licensing and inspections, enforce the Delayed Payment Act rigorously and run awareness campaigns.

Way Forward

1. Digital integration: A state-wide platform integrating credit, marketing and regulatory services can improve transparency and ease of access.
2. Capacity building: Targeted training can raise the managerial and technical skills of SSI entrepreneurs.
3. PPP clusters: Modern clusters with shared facilities can cut costs and raise productivity.
4. Monitoring cell: A dedicated state-level cell can assess the impact of SSI policies and adapt strategies using feedback and data analytics.

Conclusion

The institutional problems of SSIs are interlinked, so remedies must work together. Tackling credit, infrastructure, marketing and regulatory gaps will build a vibrant SSI sector, advancing inclusive growth, employment and regional development under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 and SDG 8.

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

ghissu

On ghissu every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into chapter notes by themselves.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 11(b) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
12(a)

Examine the view that Public Distribution System in India shall be made the responsibility of State Governments.

Introduction

The Public Distribution System (PDS) is the cornerstone of India's food security, providing subsidised grain under the National Food Security Act, 2013. With rising procurement and subsidy burdens, whether PDS should be fully entrusted to states has become a key question for Indian federalism.

Current Structure

1. Shared roles: Under TPDS, the Centre procures at MSP and allocates grain, while states identify beneficiaries and manage ration shops.
2. Procurement problems: FCI audits reveal storage shortfalls and grain wastage.
3. Targeting errors: About 61% exclusion and 25% inclusion errors, plus leakage in transport and at shops.

Arguments for State Responsibility

1. Local flexibility: States know local needs; Tamil Nadu runs a universal PDS, and Andhra Pradesh uses ration card digitisation and

grievance redressal.

2. Accountability: Direct state control can cut delays and involve communities, as the Centre cannot monitor thousands of shops.

3. Efficiency: States can innovate, linking PDS to welfare as in Andhra Pradesh's DBT template.

4. Migrants: States can adapt to migration, given the uneven rollout of One Nation–One Ration Card.

Arguments Against

1. Fiscal capacity: States like Andhra Pradesh, targeting a 3.8% fiscal deficit, may not sustain subsidies without central support.

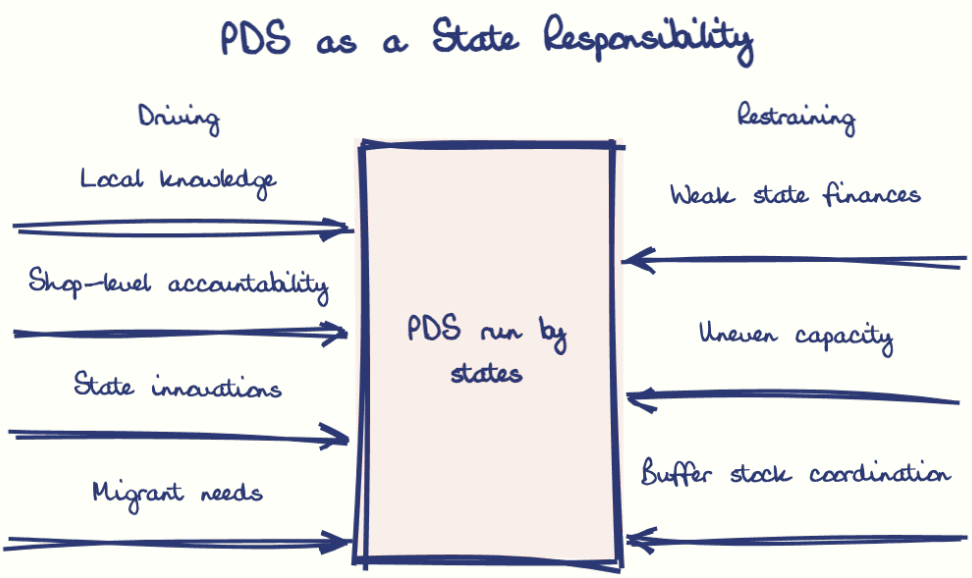
2. Uneven outcomes: Differences in capacity and political will may widen regional gaps in food security.

3. Coordination: Procurement, buffer stocks and emergencies need central management.

Way Forward

1. State capacity: Invest in state infrastructure, technology and staff.

2. Fiscal devolution: Earmarked transfers for food



security.

3. Monitoring: State Level Standing Committees and Vigilance Committees with regular audits to curb leakages.

4. Coordination: Share best practices among states and strengthen One Nation–One Ration Card.

Conclusion

The view has merit for distribution, where states know local needs best. A cooperative model is wiser: states run distribution, backed by fiscal devolution, while the Centre keeps procurement and buffer stocks.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
12(b)

Analyse the recent changes in the composition and structure of agricultural output in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Agriculture is vital to Andhra Pradesh's economy and rural livelihoods. Recent years have brought clear shifts in both the composition and the structure of agricultural output, driven by changing market demand, climatic challenges and policy interventions. These shifts matter for growth strategies under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Changes in Composition

1. Horticulture and pulses: Chillies, mangoes and bananas, along with black gram and pigeon pea, have grown, shifting output from cereal dominance to high-value crops. Pulses are gaining in Krishna and Guntur despite pest attacks.

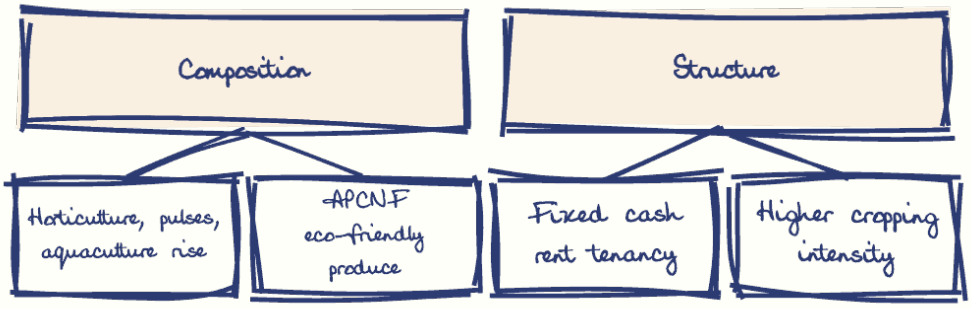
2. Aquaculture and allied activities: The extensive coastline has made aquaculture a significant contributor to output, diversifying rural incomes and exports.

3. Natural farming: APCNF promotes organic agriculture to improve soil health and cut input costs, tilting output towards eco-friendly produce.

Changes in Structure

1. Tenancy patterns: Fixed cash rent tenancy has risen substantially, transferring price and output risks to tenants. Semi-medium and medium farmers dominate leased-in land.
2. Consolidation through leasing: Despite many small and marginal farmers, leasing consolidates land, influencing crop choice and mechanisation.
3. Irrigation and inputs: Better irrigation has raised cropping intensity, though delayed water release in Krishna district hurts timely sowing.
4. Marketing: Weak storage caused distress sales, which schemes like Annadatha Sukhibhava seek to address.

Changing agricultural output



Causes and Effects

1. Causes: Rising demand for high-value crops, MSP and procurement support and the Crop Cultivators

Practice 12(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV
Scan to practice

Right Act encouraged the shift, while water scarcity in Rayalaseema pushed drought-resistant crops.

2. Effects: Diversification improved incomes, with per capita income of Rs 2,68,653 in 2024-25, but tenancy risks and volatility challenge smallholders.
3. Sustainability: Organic farming and better irrigation strengthen resilience and food security, though infrastructure gaps and delayed water management remain bottlenecks.

Way Forward

1. Irrigation management: Ensure timely water release and community-based irrigation in Krishna and Rayalaseema.
2. Markets and sustainability: Build local storage, use e-NAM to cut distress sales, and scale up APCNF.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's output is becoming more diverse, market-driven and sustainable, while its structure shows rising tenancy risk. Policy must back this transition.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 12(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
13(a)

Write a brief note on the regional disparities in irrigation facilities in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Irrigation is critical for agricultural productivity and food security in Andhra Pradesh, a state with diverse agro-climatic zones and varying water availability. Despite heavy investment, regional disparities persist, affecting yields and farm incomes unevenly. They are sharpest between the water-rich coastal districts and the drought-prone Rayalaseema region.

Regional disparities in irrigation



Canal-fed deltas vs groundwater-dependent Rayalaseema

Nature of the Disparities

1. **Coastal vs Rayalaseema divide:** Districts like East and West Godavari enjoy canal irrigation from the Godavari and Krishna, while Rayalaseema suffers erratic rainfall and limited surface water, lowering coverage and productivity.
2. **Groundwater dependence:** About 95% of minor irrigation schemes rely on groundwater, which is unevenly available, especially in Anantapuramu and YSR Kadapa.
3. **Uneven micro-irrigation:** In 2017–18 Anantapuramu had over 100,000 hectares under micro-irrigation, while Srikakulam and Vizianagaram had far less.
4. **Uneven scheme impact:** PMKSY raised irrigation potential in some districts, but uneven funds and execution limited its statewide effect.

Causes of the Disparities

1. **Fragmented management:** The Water Resources Department and local bodies share control, creating coordination problems.
2. **Project delays:** Polavaram has only 67.43% of land acquired and 11% of displaced families rehabilitated, limiting its reach.
3. **Poor maintenance:** Veligonda's canal discharge

capacity is 32% below design.

4. Farmer barriers: Small farmers in drought-prone areas lack credit, technology and training.

Local Successes and Risks

1. Innovation: Sub-surface dams in YSR Kadapa have improved groundwater recharge and stabilised irrigation.
2. Depletion risk: Over-extraction through tube wells threatens long-term sustainability in some regions.

Way Forward

1. Integrated management: Coordinate agencies for equitable distribution.
2. Projects and micro-irrigation: Complete Polavaram and extend micro-irrigation subsidies and training to lagging districts.
3. Groundwater: Regulate extraction and promote recharge structures.

Conclusion

Irrigation disparities in Andhra Pradesh reflect geography, fragmented institutions and uneven execution of projects and schemes. Closing them is key to balanced agricultural growth and fair incomes across regions.

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 13(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2012 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
13(b)

Evaluate the trends in the expenditure of Andhra Pradesh Government on health and education in the last decade.

Introduction

Expenditure on health and education is a key indicator of Andhra Pradesh's commitment to human development and inclusive growth. Over the last decade, these trends reveal both progress and persistent challenges, shaped by tight fiscal space.

Health Expenditure Trends

1. **Low Allocation:** Only 3.11% of the budget went to health as of March 2022, far below the recommended 8%.
2. **Infrastructure and Staff Gaps:** 743 of 3,316 specialist and medical officer posts in secondary care are vacant, and there are only 175 Community Health Centres against 412 needed.
3. **Fiscal Constraints:** The revenue deficit quadrupled in 2022–23 to 43,487 crore, limiting health investment.
4. **Positive Outcomes:** Life expectancy of 70.6 years exceeds the national average, helped by the YSR Aarogyasri Scheme and the National Health Mission.

Education Expenditure Trends

1. Relative Priority: Education takes about 12–13% of total spending, higher than some neighbouring states.
2. Key Schemes: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan aims to improve schod infrastructure and quality.
3. Quality Gaps: Declining per-student spending and vacant higher education facutty posts limit outcomes.
4. Capital Squeeze: Capital expenditure fell to 0.55% of GSDP in 2022–23, restricting schod modernisation.

Health vs Education in AP

Health	Education
3.11% of budget	About 12–13% of spending
Specialist posts vacant	Facutty posts vacant
Below recommended 8%	Falling per-student spending

Implications

1. Health Strain: Low share and vacancies hurt rural care and raise out-of-pocket costs.

2. Moderated Education Gains: Infrastructure gaps hold back learning outcomes.
3. Shrinking Fiscal Space: Rising deficits and high liabilities limit social sector spending.
4. Welfare Cushion: NTR Bharosa pensions and the NTR Vaidya Seva Trust soften some effects.

Way Forward

1. Health Budget: Move towards 8% and fill vacancies.
2. Education Capital: Invest in school and college infrastructure through Samagra Shiksha.
3. Fiscal Management: Protect social budgets while improving fiscal discipline.
4. Technology and PPPs: Use telemedicine and public–private partnerships in remote areas.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has prioritised education better than health, but deficits limit both. Protecting social budgets while improving fiscal discipline is the way ahead.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
14(a)

Comment on the inadequacy of institutional credit in rural areas of Andhra Pradesh State.

Introduction

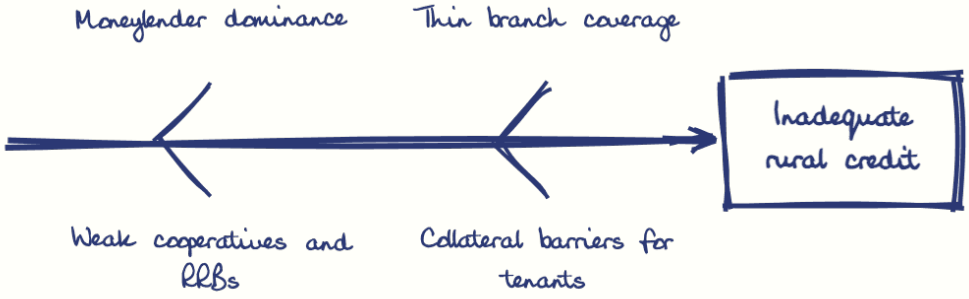
Institutional credit is vital for agricultural productivity and rural livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture and allied sectors are central to the economy. Despite many initiatives, rural areas still face inadequate institutional credit, hurting farmer welfare and the goal of doubling farmers' income under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Causes of Inadequacy

1. Dominance of informal credit: Many rural borrowers still rely on moneylenders for quick loans at exorbitant interest, because formal institutions impose procedural delays and rigid collateral rules.
2. Weak cooperatives and RRBs: The declining share, poor financial health and high overdues of cooperative banks and Regional Rural Banks reduce their reach to small farmers.
3. Thin branch and staff coverage: Insufficient rural banking infrastructure and trained personnel limit outreach.
4. Collateral barriers: Small and tenant farmers, including those classed as "landless" under tenancy

laws, lack collateral and credit histories.

Why institutional credit falls short



Consequences

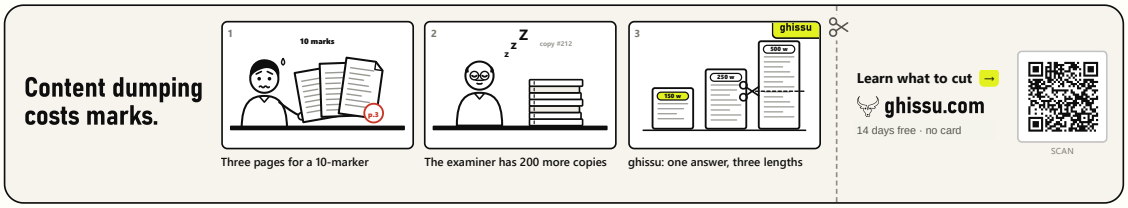
1. Indebtedness and distress: High-interest informal loans create debt traps, contributing to agrarian distress and farmer suicides in Rayalaseema.
2. Suboptimal investment: Without timely and adequate credit, farmers cannot invest enough in quality inputs, irrigation and technology, which lowers productivity and income potential.
3. Exclusion of the vulnerable: Marginal farmers, tenants and landless labourers stay outside formal credit, deepening inequality.
4. Distorted credit markets: Uncoordinated agencies over-finance some areas and under-finance others, raising default risk.

Measures to Improve Access

1. **Strengthen cooperatives and RRBs:** Restructure them and integrate them with commercial banks.
2. **Repayment-based lending:** Assess repayment capacity rather than collateral to include tenants.
3. **Wider outreach:** Add rural branches, deploy Business Correspondents and use digital platforms like e-Seva to improve delivery and financial literacy.
4. **Coordinated planning:** Use integrated district-level credit plans with clear agency roles to remove overlaps and gaps.

Conclusion

Inadequate institutional credit is a significant barrier to sustainable agricultural growth and rural prosperity in Andhra Pradesh. Systemic reforms that improve its reach, affordability and suitability for small and marginal farmers will reduce dependence on exploitative informal lenders, empower rural communities to invest productively and advance inclusive rural development.



P-III
14(b)

Elucidate the problems of cooperatives in providing adequate agricultural credit to farmers in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

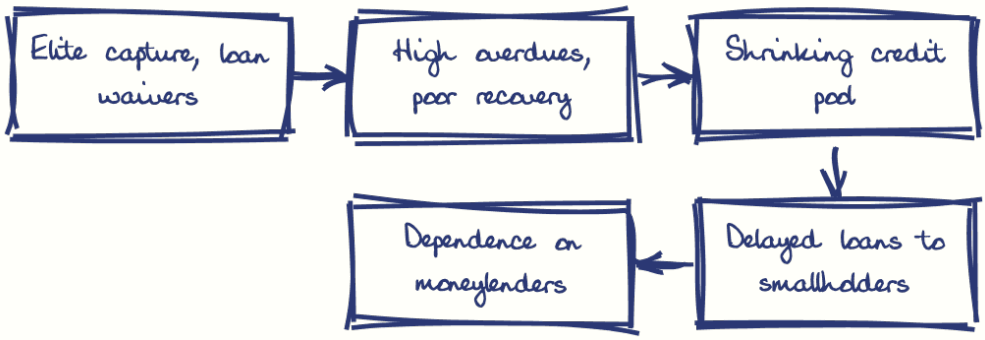
Agricultural credit is vital for farm productivity and rural livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture forms a large part of the economy. Despite their historical role in rural credit, cooperative credit societies face persistent problems that limit adequate and timely credit, especially to small and marginal farmers.

Problems of Cooperatives in Providing Credit

1. Dominance of large landowners: Leadership and control rest with wealthy landowners, so credit is often diverted to non-agricultural uses or consumption instead of reaching small farmers.
2. High overdues and poor recovery: Repayment delays and defaults, worsened by political interference and loan waivers, reduce viability and the capacity to recycle funds.
3. Inadequate reach: Insistence on land as collateral excludes tenant farmers, sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers.
4. Weak institutional capacity: Lack of professional management, poor member participation and

dependence on government subsidies hinder efficient delivery.

How cooperative problems starve credit



Impact on Credit Adequacy

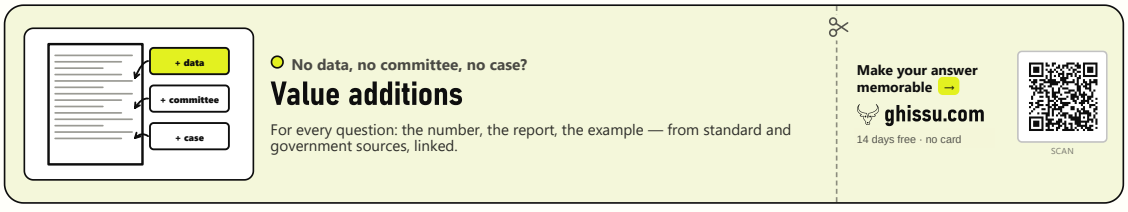
1. Insufficient and untimely credit: Elite capture and poor recovery shrink the credit pool, so smallholders receive delayed loans, affecting timely input purchase, crop yields and income.
2. Dependence on moneylenders: Excluded farmers borrow from informal lenders at exorbitant interest, perpetuating indebtedness.
3. Regional and social disparities: Uneven distribution leaves some regions and groups underserved, aggravating agrarian distress.
4. Eroded infrastructure: Persistent financial stress has weakened the cooperative credit network itself.

Way Forward

1. Professionalise and digitise: ERP-based computerisation of PACS and staff capacity building improve transparency and efficiency.
2. Targeted inclusion: Expand collateral-free loans under the Kisan Credit Card platform to tenant farmers and landless labourers.
3. Stronger recovery: Robust recovery frameworks with minimal political interference, plus financial literacy among farmers, can raise repayment and restore cooperative sustainability.
4. Integration with state platforms: Linking cooperatives with M4AGRI and e-Seva can give farmers one-stop credit, extension and market access.

Conclusion

Cooperatives in Andhra Pradesh face multifaceted problems. Institutional reform, digitisation and inclusive credit policy can strengthen rural finance and help double farmers' income.



P-III
15(a)

Describe the changes in the composition and growth of service sector of Andhra Pradesh in the post-reforms period.

Introduction

The post-reforms period, beginning in the early 1990s, marked a major shift with services emerging as a key growth driver. In Andhra Pradesh this gained momentum after the 2014 bifurcation, which demanded economic diversification. The sector's changing composition and strong growth now underpin the state's GSDP growth.

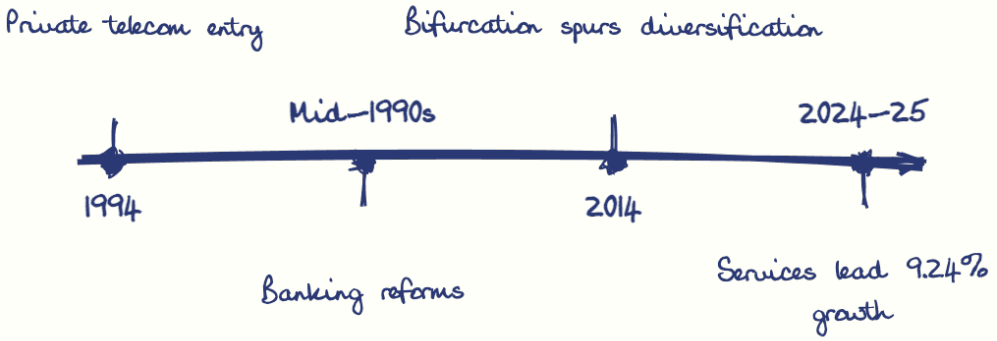
Changes in Composition

1. **Public to Private Dominance:** A largely state-dominated sector became private-led after private telecom entry in 1994 and banking reforms in the mid-1990s, boosting telecom, finance and business services.
2. **Rise of Modern Services:** Skill-intensive IT, IT-enabled services and business process outsourcing became major contributors, with Visakhapatnam's port-led corridor and IT hubs like Vijayawada.
3. **Education and Health:** Public and private investment in human development grew, supported by schemes like the Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva

Trust.

4. Traditional Services: Transport, storage and hospitality retain a significant share, aided by the coastal location and Swadesh Darshan tourism projects.

Services in Andhra Pradesh after reforms



Changes in Growth Pattern

1. Sustained High Growth: Services consistently outpaced other sectors, in line with the state's 9.24% growth in 2024-25, led by financial services, business services and telecom.
2. Skill-Biased Employment: Jobs grew mainly in IT and finance, the capital-intensive nature of these services limited large-scale unskilled employment, a structural challenge.
3. Infrastructure and Policy: e-Seva and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 improved ease of business

and delivery.

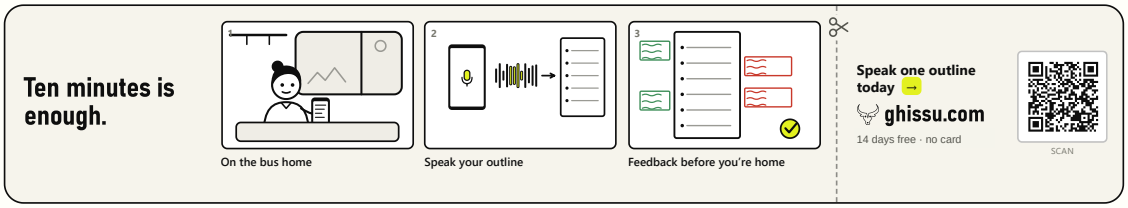
4. Resilience: Services stayed more stable than agriculture and manufacturing, cushioning the economy during global slowdowns and domestic challenges.

Way Forward

1. Skills: Vocational and digital training to bridge skill gaps and absorb more workers.
2. Service Exports: Nodal agencies to market IT and business clusters globally.
3. Digital Infrastructure: Build on e-Seva for wider engagement.
4. Inclusion: Support for traditional services and MSMEs in rural and semi-urban areas.

Conclusion

Services have moved from state-led and traditional to private-led and modern, becoming the backbone of Andhra Pradesh's economy. Wider skills, service exports and support for traditional services and MSMEs can make this growth inclusive and broad-based.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2011

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

P-III
1(b)

Explain the important sectoral changes in post-independence Indian economy with respect to income and work-force.

Introduction

Since independence India's economy has undergone major sectoral change, reshaping income and workforce composition. The shift from an agrarian economy to one dominated by industry and services has driven growth, but the employment shift has lagged well behind the output shift, with implications for inclusive development.

Sectoral Changes in Income

1. **Decline of Agriculture:** Its share in GVA fell sharply to about 15.2% in 2023–24, reflecting structural transformation.
2. **Modest Industrial Growth:** Industry's share rose modestly, as manufacturing and construction expanded after 1990 liberalisation, while in Andhra Pradesh the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor fostered manufacturing and higher GSDP growth.
3. **Services Dominance:** Services became the largest contributor, about 57% of GVA by 2023–24, led by IT, finance and trade.
4. **Rural Non-Farm Economy:** Non-farm activity

now generates about two-thirds of rural income, and rural manufacturing over half of manufacturing value added.

Changes in the Workforce

1. **Slow Shift from Agriculture:** About 46.1% of workers still depend on agriculture, causing underemployment and low productivity.
2. **Limited Industrial Absorption:** Industry absorbed only a small part of the labour leaving farming, unlike the classical pattern of development.
3. **Informalisation:** Many new service and rural non-farm jobs are casual and low quality rather than stable formal jobs, nationally and in Andhra Pradesh.
4. **Women Workers:** Female participation has risen, especially in rural areas, but remains concentrated in farm and informal work.

Output moved, workers lagged

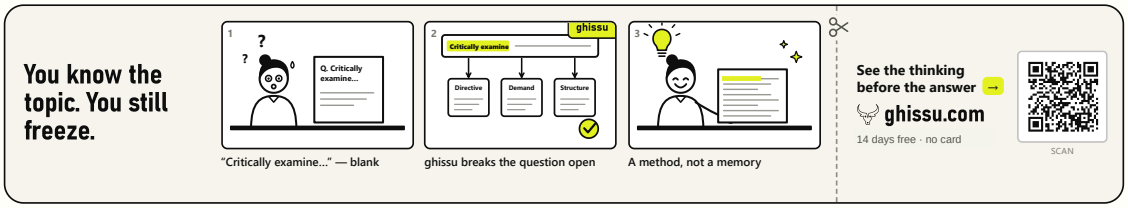
Share in income	Share in workforce
Agriculture fell to 15.2%	46.1% still in farming
Industry rose modestly	Limited labour absorption
Services about 57% of GVA	Casual, informal service jobs

Impact on Income Distribution

1. **Sectoral Gaps:** Industry and services offer far higher per-worker incomes than agriculture, where incomes remain low and stagnant.
2. **Wealth Concentration:** The top 10% control about 77% of national wealth.
3. **Rural-Urban Gap:** Even states with higher per capita income, like Andhra Pradesh (2,68,653 in 2024-25), show rural incomes lagging behind urban centres.
4. **Limited Poverty Impact:** Slow absorption of labour into better-paid sectors has constrained broad-based income gains for marginalised groups.

Conclusion

India's structural transformation is clear in income but incomplete in employment. Skilling, labour-intensive manufacturing, formal job creation and rural diversification are needed so that the workforce follows output into higher-productivity sectors and growth becomes inclusive.



P-III
2(a)

Critically Examine the performance of X Five Year Plan.

Introduction

The X Five Year Plan (2002–2007) set ambitious targets to accelerate growth, reduce poverty and enhance social development. It aimed for 8% average GDP growth with focus on infrastructure, agriculture and human development. Its record shows a clear gap between planning and outcomes.

Achievements

1. Growth and Investment: The economy grew at around 7%, slightly below target, and the incremental capital–output ratio improved marginally.
2. Social Services: Health and education saw incremental improvements.
3. Growth Momentum in States: States like Andhra Pradesh showed strong growth momentum.

X Plan: achievements and shortfalls

Achievements	Shortfalls
Growth around 7%	Poverty 27.5%, target missed
Strong momentum in Andhra Pradesh	Real allocations fell 24%
Health, education improved	Power, transport bottlenecks

Practice 2(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

Institutional and Fiscal Shortfalls

1. **Fiscal Slippage:** Against a planned outlay of 15.25 lakh crore, real allocations fell by about 24%, constraining projects and social schemes.
2. **Weak Revenue Mobilisation:** No positive balance from current revenues meant more borrowing and less capital expenditure.
3. **Coordination Gaps:** The Planning Commission's Centre–State coordination was limited, delaying projects.
4. **Monitoring Gaps:** Without real-time monitoring, delays and cost overruns went uncorrected.

Sectoral Shortfalls

1. **Poverty Target Missed:** The aim of cutting poverty from 26.1% to 19.2% failed; NSS data showed 27.5%, showing growth did not reach the poorest.
2. **Agriculture:** Inadequate irrigation, fragmented landholdings and droughts kept growth below expectations; Andhra Pradesh's agrarian economy faced the same, hurting rural incomes.
3. **Infrastructure:** Bottlenecks in power, transport and rural connectivity persisted, as did regional disparities in places like Rayalaseema.

4. Capital Efficiency: A high ICOR showed inefficient use of capital.

Way Forward

1. Fiscal Discipline: Broaden the tax base in states like Andhra Pradesh to fund capital expenditure.
2. Monitoring: Real-time, data-driven tracking like the Aspirational Districts Programme.
3. Inclusion: Targeted inclusive growth schemes using strengths like aquaculture and horticulture in Andhra Pradesh.
4. Infrastructure: PPPs and innovative financing for corridors like the Visakhapatnam–Chennai industrial corridor.

Conclusion

The X Plan made notable strides in growth and investment but fell short on poverty and social goals due to fiscal constraints and weak implementation. Future planning must combine fiscal prudence with inclusion and robust monitoring.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
2(b)

What is the scope for public-private partnership in post-economic reform period in India? Elaborate.

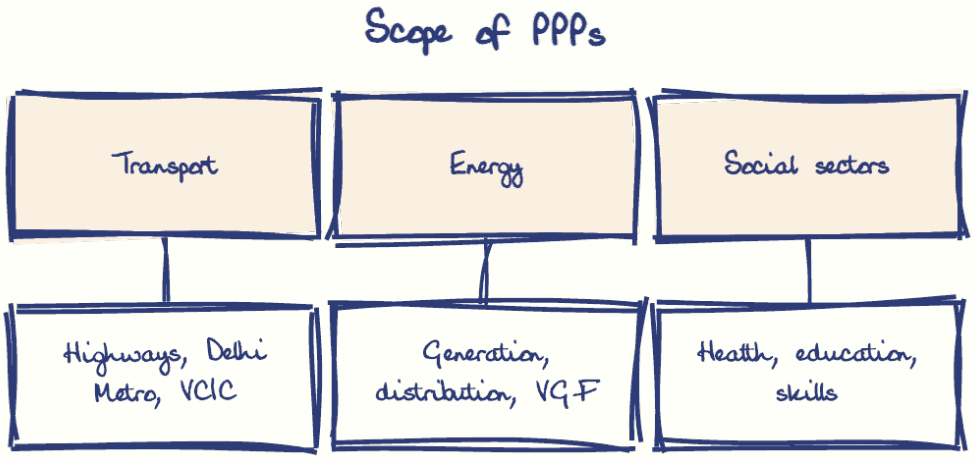
Introduction

The post-reform period has shifted how India builds infrastructure and delivers services. With fiscal constraints, borrowing limits and rising demand, public-private partnerships (PPPs) have become vital for mobilising private capital and expertise to sustain growth towards Viksit Bharat @2047.

Scope of PPPs in Key Sectors

1. Transport: Highways, airports and urban transit use PPPs, as the Delhi Metro and national highway projects show; Andhra Pradesh's port-led Visakhapatnam-Chennai corridor also supports regional growth.
2. Energy and power: Private investment in generation and distribution, backed by Viability Gap Funding and the Infrastructure Development Fund, helps meet deficits; private renewable projects add capacity in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Social services: PPPs extend to health, education and skills through private medical research centres and vocational institutes; Andhra Pradesh uses PPP frameworks for digital delivery of social

benefits.



How Reforms Shaped PPPs

1. Liberalisation: The 1991 reforms removed controls, and SEBI and easier capital markets aided PPP finance.
2. Institutional innovation: IIFCL and standard contracts improved appraisal, private share of infrastructure investment reached 36.6% in the Eleventh Plan.
3. Fiscal limits: FRBM limits made PPPs necessary, but regulatory hurdles and risk misallocation stalled projects.
4. Digital reforms: PRAGATI and PM GatiShakti eased approvals and monitoring.

Challenges and Opportunities

1. **Risk allocation:** Poor risk-sharing in many contracts causes financial stress and stalled projects; independent renegotiation committees can restore investor confidence.
2. **Fiscal space:** With borrowing capped, PPPs crowd in private funds, but efficient project selection and viability gap funding are needed to protect long-term affordability.
3. **Social sectors:** Health, education and skills in underserved regions offer fresh scope to improve quality and access.

Way Forward

Robust regulatory and monitoring bodies at state and central levels can ensure transparent risk allocation and timely execution.

Conclusion

PPPs have wide scope in post-reform India, from transport and power to health and education. Better risk-sharing, sound project selection and strong institutions will unlock this scope for Viksit Bharat @2047.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
ghissu.com →

P-III
3(a)

What are the important concepts of employment / unemployment used by National Sample Survey Organization (NSSO)?

Introduction

Understanding employment and unemployment is vital for labour policy. The National Sample Survey Organization (NSSO) provides this data, earlier through quinquennial Employment and Unemployment Surveys (EUS) and now the annual Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), informing policy at national and state levels, including Andhra Pradesh.

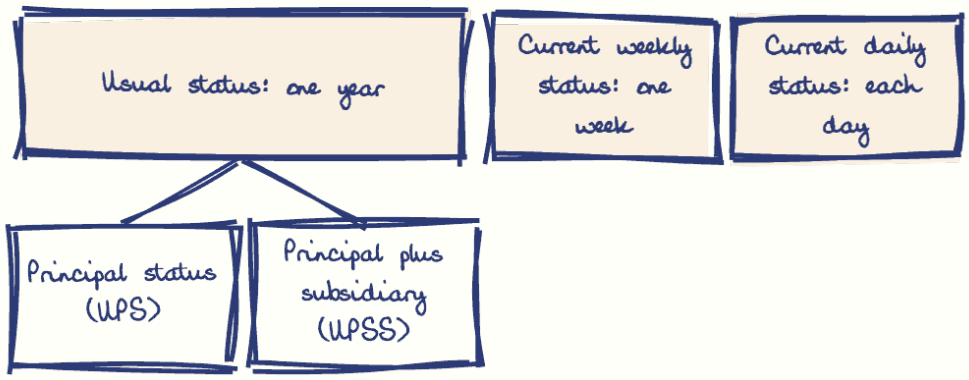
Key Concepts Used by NSSO

1. Usual status: Activity status over a reference period of one year, showing long-term engagement.
2. Current weekly status: Activity over the preceding week, capturing short-term labour engagement.
3. Current daily status: Activity on each day of the reference week, which best reveals underemployment.
4. Usual principal status (UPS): The main activity pursued by a person over a long period.
5. UPSS: Usual principal and subsidiary status

also counts secondary activities, giving a more comprehensive measure of employment.

6. Labour force classification: The population is classified as employed, unemployed or out of the labour force, yielding LFPR, WPR and the unemployment rate.
7. Sampling and stratification: EUS used stratification by consumption expenditure and livelihoods; PLFS uses education levels.
8. Temporal coverage: PLFS gives annual rural and quarterly urban data, capturing seasonal and short-term changes.

NSSO activity status concepts



Issues in Application

1. Comparability: The move from EUS to PLFS changed methods, making trend analysis difficult.

2. Gender gaps: NSSO estimates women's work better than the Census, but female participation remains low.

3. Sectoral shifts: Data show movement from agriculture to non-agriculture, but uneven due to skill mismatch and mechanisation.

Way Forward

1. Harmonise methods: Align EUS and PLFS frameworks for consistent, comparable data and better policy evaluation at the state level.

2. Measure women's work better: Improve survey instruments to capture informal work done by women.

3. Use digital platforms: National Career Service and e-Shram can complement NSSO data with real-time information.

Conclusion

NSSO concepts capture diverse employment statuses and time dimensions. Used well, they enable targeted policies for inclusive growth and SDG (8.)

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
3(b)

Discuss the important anti-poverty programmes implemented by the Government of India

Introduction

India's sustained growth has significantly reduced poverty, yet multidimensional poverty remains a critical challenge. Government anti-poverty programmes have driven this progress by providing employment, social security and financial inclusion, in line with SDG (1) of ending poverty in all its forms by 2030.

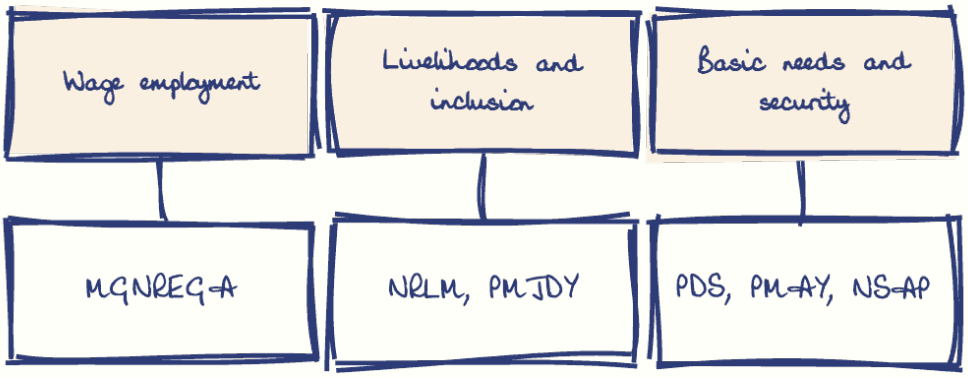
Key Anti-Poverty Programmes

1. **MGNREGA:** Guarantees 100 days of wage employment a year to rural households and builds irrigation and road assets. Demand rose 30% during COVID-19.
2. **NRLM:** Promotes SHGs and skill development, empowering women through collective enterprise and financial inclusion.
3. **PMJDY:** Over 55 crore bank accounts enable direct benefit transfers and access to credit, a safety net during the pandemic.
4. **PDS:** Subsidised food grains ensure food security despite leakages.
5. **PM-AY:** Affordable housing for the urban and

rural poor reduces homelessness.

6. Social security: NSAP pensions for the elderly, widows and disabled, and Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana for life cover.

Anti-Poverty Programmes



Effectiveness and Impact

1. Poverty reduction: Multidimensional poverty fell from 29.17% in 2013–14 to 11.28% in 2022–23, though Andhra Pradesh shows stagnation.
2. Income security: MGNREGA reduced distress migration, though funding cuts limit it.
3. Administrative gaps: Audits in Andhra Pradesh reveal welfare fund diversion and pending claims, and rehabilitation of families displaced by the Polavaram Project remains incomplete.

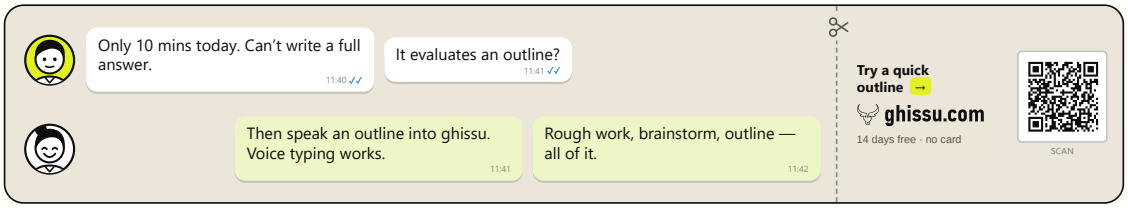
4. Exclusion errors: Poor coordination, bureaucratic hurdles and weak targeting keep many poor outside the safety net.

Way Forward

1. Monitoring: Use technology and independent audits to curb diversion and delays.
2. Convergence: Integrate schemes across health, education, employment and social security.
3. Funding and coverage: Guarantee full MGNREGA entitlements and extend social security to informal sector workers.
4. Livelihoods: Scale up NRLM and urban livelihood missions with market-linked skills and entrepreneurship to reduce dependency on welfare.

Conclusion

India's anti-poverty programmes have built a wide safety net. With better convergence, funding and accountability, they can move India decisively towards ending poverty in all its forms.



P-III
4(a)

Explain the structure of Indian Banking System

Introduction

The Indian banking system is a critical pillar of the financial architecture, supporting growth, financial inclusion and stability. It mobilises savings, allocates credit and regulates financial activity through diverse institutions under a hierarchical framework led by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

Main Components

1. RBI: Established in 1935, it is the central bank and apex monetary authority. It formulates monetary policy, issues currency and ensures stability.
2. Scheduled Commercial Banks: These include public sector banks, private banks and foreign banks. SBI, born from the Imperial Bank of India nationalised in 1955, leads in deposits and advances, while private and foreign banks serve diverse customers.
3. Cooperative Banks: Urban and rural banks registered under the Cooperative Societies Act serve agriculture and small industry, especially in Andhra Pradesh where farming is a key

Practice 4(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

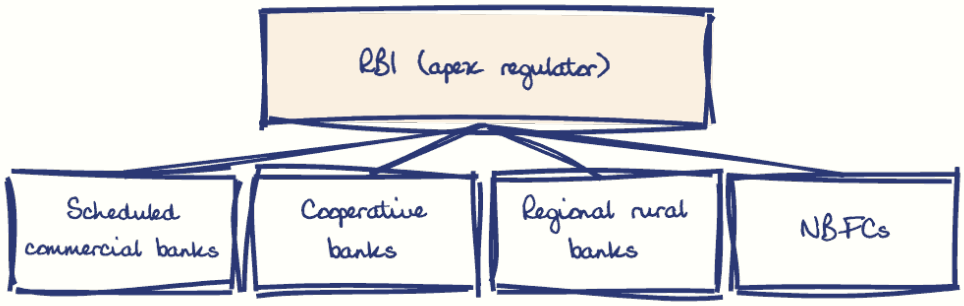
Scan to practice

livelihood.

4. Regional Rural Banks: Set up under the RRB ~~Act,~~ (1976,) jointly owned by the Centre, states and sponsoring banks.

5. NBFCs: Intermediaries that lend without a banking licence; many indigenous bankers in Visakhapatnam became NBFCs.

Structure of Indian banking



Roles and Functions

1. RBI: Regulates liquidity through CRR and SLR, supervises banks and manages payment systems. It also oversees NBFCs and urban cooperative banks.

2. SCBs: Mobilise deposits and lend to industry, agriculture and services; PSBs carry a priority sector obligation.

3. Cooperative Banks and RRBs: Their local presence gives affordable credit to farmers and

artisans, vital in drought-prone Rayalaseema and rural Andhra Pradesh districts.

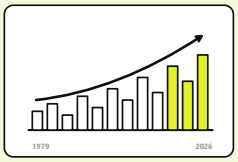
4. NBFCs: Lend flexibly where banks hesitate due to lack of collateral or scale, often innovating in urban and semi-urban credit.

Regulatory Relationships

1. RBI as apex regulator: It sets prudential norms, licensing and supervision for SCBs, NBFCs and urban cooperative banks.
2. Banking Regulation Act, 1949: SCBs operate under it, with RBI monitoring their health; PSBs are government-owned but follow RBI rules.
3. Dual control: Cooperative banks are regulated by both RBI and state governments. Their oversight is therefore shared between two levels.

Conclusion

With RBI at the apex and commercial, cooperative, rural and non-bank lenders below it, the structure balances efficiency with outreach and inclusion.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
4(b)

Critically Examine the role of RBI in credit control.

Introduction

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) plays a pivotal role in regulating credit flow to maintain macroeconomic stability and support growth. After the credit slowdown following the IL&FS crisis and rising non-performing assets (NPAs), its credit control mechanisms have gained renewed importance for managing inflation, ensuring financial stability and fostering inclusive growth, especially in Andhra Pradesh, where credit access shapes agriculture and MSMEs.

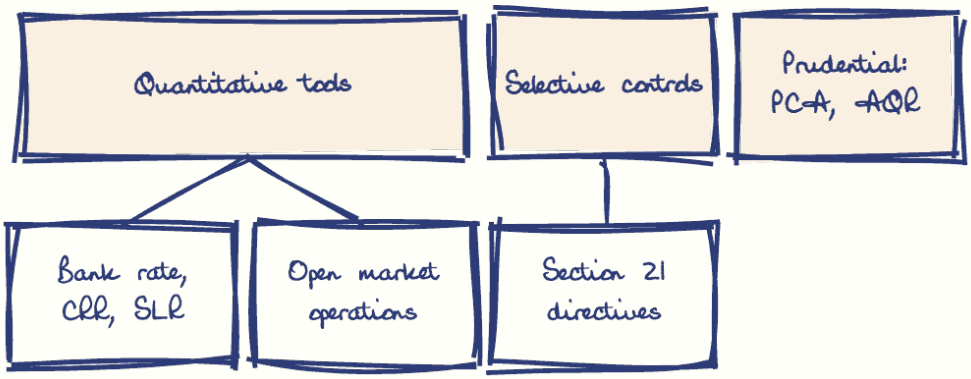
Mechanisms of Credit Control

1. **Quantitative tools:** The bank rate, CRR, SLR and open market operations regulate the overall volume of credit. Raising the CRR reduces banks' lending capacity and checks inflation.
2. **Selective credit controls:** Under Section (21) of the Banking Regulation Act, RBI issues directives on lending purposes, margins, interest rates and ceilings. The Credit Authorisation Scheme of (1965) required RBI approval for large loans.
3. **Prudential supervision:** Prompt Corrective Action (PCA) and Asset Quality Review monitor

asset quality and capital adequacy, restricting credit from weak banks.

4. Developmental role: Priority Sector Lending, the Account Aggregator framework and Digital Lending Guidelines expand formal credit access.

RBI's credit control toolkit



Effectiveness and Limitations

1. Inflation management: CRR and repo rate changes have controlled demand-pull inflation, while selective controls checked speculative credit.

2. Structural limits: The bank rate has limited influence on market rates and the bill market is underdeveloped.

3. Stability versus growth: PCA improved asset quality but caused credit contraction from PSU banks, contributing to the post-2018 slowdown.

4. NBFC gap: The IL&FS crisis exposed gaps in

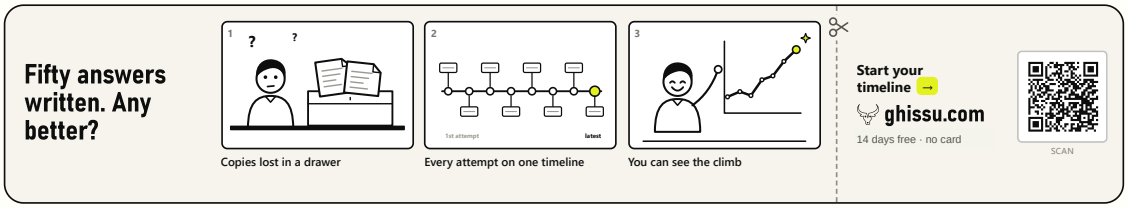
RBI's regulatory reach over NBFCs, affecting credit in Andhra Pradesh.

Impact on the Economy

1. Stability: Curbing excessive credit growth supports the inflation targeting framework adopted since 2016.
2. Inclusion: Only about 25% of adults have institutional credit access, so formal credit penetration remains limited, a challenge Andhra Pradesh shares.

Conclusion

RBI's credit control has strengthened stability and bank resilience, but it must be calibrated so that prudence does not starve MSMEs and infrastructure of credit.



P-III
5(a)

Explain the role of Finance Commission in a federal country like India.

Introduction

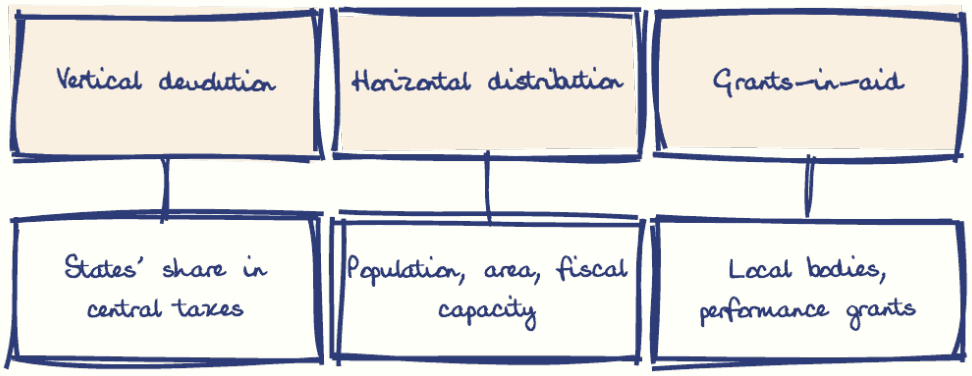
In India's evolving fiscal federalism, the Finance Commission keeps the delicate balance of financial relations between the Union and the States. With the 16th Finance Commission constituted amid post-GST challenges, its recommendations are crucial for equitable distribution, especially for states like Andhra Pradesh facing post-bifurcation fiscal stress and demanding special category status.

Functions of the Finance Commission

1. Tax Revenue Distribution: Under Article 280(3)(a), it recommends states' share in central taxes, the 14th Commission raised it from 32% to 42%.
2. Grants-in-Aid: It frames principles for grants from the Consolidated Fund of India, including support to local bodies under the 73rd and 74th Amendments.
3. Correcting Imbalances: As a quasi-judicial body, it corrects vertical and horizontal fiscal imbalances, vital for revenue-deficit states like Andhra Pradesh.
4. Advisory Role: It advises on matters referred by

the President, such as funding for defence and internal security.

Finance Commission (Article 280)



Role in Indian Federalism

1. **Balancing Wheel:** It mediates Centre–State finances to prevent central dominance and protect state autonomy.
2. **Addressing Disparities:** Criteria like population, area and fiscal capacity reduce regional inequality; the use of 2011 census data sparked debate for southern states.
3. **Cooperative Federalism:** It fosters dialogue and shared ownership between the Centre and states.

Facilitating Devolution

1. **Vertical and Horizontal Devolution:** Fair shares help states fund projects like the Polavaram

irrigation scheme.

2. Local Governance: Grants to Panchayats and Municipalities support decentralisation.

3. Performance Incentives: Performance-linked grants reward better fiscal management and service delivery.

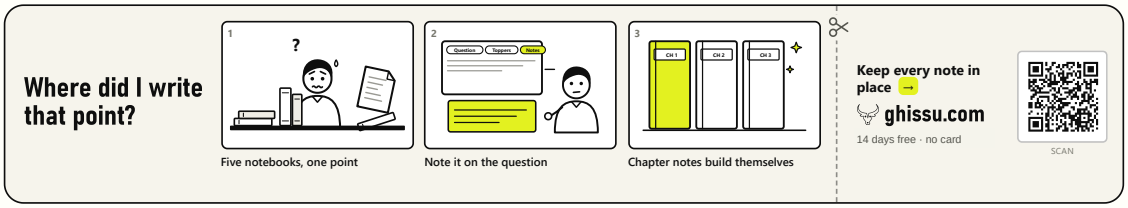
Way Forward

1. State Participation: Involve states, including Andhra Pradesh, in framing the Commission's Terms of Reference so that diverse fiscal realities are reflected.

2. State Finance Commissions: Ensure their timely constitution and functioning to deepen fiscal decentralisation.

Conclusion

The Finance Commission is the backbone of cooperative federalism. It balances state autonomy with equity, so that every state, including Andhra Pradesh, has the resources to develop.



P-III
5(b)

What are the important tax reforms in India since 1991?

Introduction

Since the economic liberalisation of 1991, India has undertaken major tax reforms to modernise its fiscal architecture. They aimed to simplify the structure, widen the base and improve compliance. GST and digitalisation of administration have been pivotal, for the nation and for Andhra Pradesh.

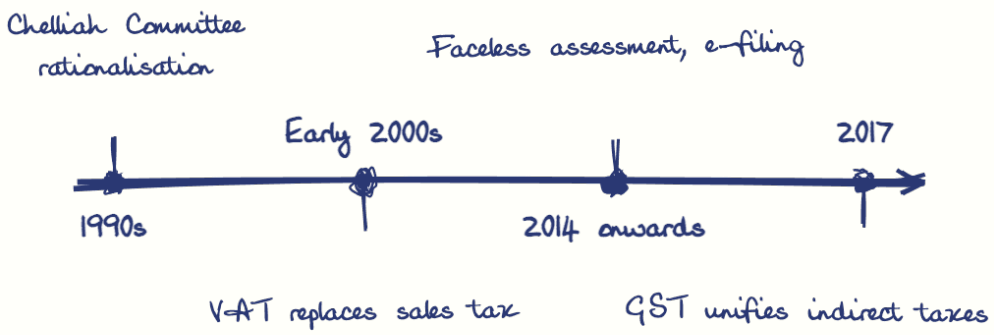
Important Tax Reforms Since 1991

1. **Income tax rationalisation:** Under the structural adjustment led by the Raja J. Chelliah Committee, the maximum marginal rate was reduced and slabs were cut to three, simplifying the structure and encouraging compliance.
2. **VAT:** In the early 2000s, VAT replaced the cascading sales tax regime, improving efficiency and transparency. Andhra Pradesh implemented VAT in 2005.
3. **GST in 2017:** Excise duty, service tax, VAT and CST were unified into one tax, lowering logistics costs. The GST Council, including Andhra Pradesh, harmonises rates across states.
4. **Digital administration:** Since 2014, faceless assessment, e-filing and the Transparent Taxation

– Honouring the Honest platform have modernised tax administration.

5. Concessional rates: Lower rates for individuals and companies, with a higher exemption limit and standard deduction, gave predictability and middle-class relief.

Tax reforms since 1991



Impact of the Reforms

1. Revenue mobilisation: Tax collections nearly doubled from 6.38 lakh crore in 2013–14 to almost 12 lakh crore in 2018–19, reflecting better compliance and a wider base.

2. Lower business costs: GST removed checkpoints and cascading, benefiting corridors like the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor in Andhra Pradesh.

3. Administrative gaps: Despite digital reforms,

pending audit objections and underassessment persist in Andhra Pradesh's commercial tax departments, limiting full revenue potential.

Way Forward

1. Stronger audits: Resolve CAG-flagged outstanding revenue quickly.
2. Easier GST compliance: Simplify filing and fix technical glitches for MSMEs.
3. Digital integration: Link tax processes with business registration through the National Single Window System and SPICe+.
4. Taxpayer trust: Awareness campaigns in Andhra Pradesh can encourage voluntary compliance.

Conclusion

India's tax reforms since 1991 have built an efficient, transparent and growth-oriented system supporting Viksit Bharat @2047, though state-level administration still needs strengthening, as CAG findings of outstanding revenue and underassessment in Andhra Pradesh show. A simple, inclusive regime will foster sustainable and equitable growth.

Wrote the answer. Now what?
Upload it — every line marked, in minutes.
ghissu.com →

P-III
6(b)

Do you consider that land reforms in Andhra Pradesh have provided sufficient protection to tenants?

Introduction

Tenancy is widespread in Andhra Pradesh, and since 1956 the state has enacted three laws to regulate landlord–tenant relations and protect cultivators from exploitation and eviction. These laws once gave substantial security, but recent liberalisation, informal leasing and weak enforcement mean tenants are not sufficiently protected today.

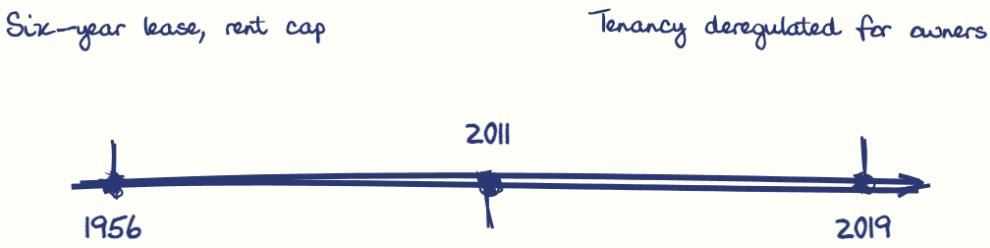
Evolution of Tenancy Protection

1. **1956 Act:** It mandated a six-year minimum lease, capped rent at 25–30% of produce and gave tenants a right of first refusal to buy leased land.
2. **2011 Act:** The Land Licensed Cultivators Act introduced Loan Eligibility Cards, recognising tenants as actual cultivators deserving credit, subsidies and crop insurance.
3. **2019 Act:** The Crop Cultivator Rights Act, 2019 repealed earlier laws and deregulated tenancy in favour of owners.

Protections Achieved

1. **Security of tenure:** Older laws curbed arbitrary eviction, controlled rent and allowed lease renewal, encouraging investment.
2. **Access to benefits:** LECs filled a critical gap where informal tenants had been excluded from institutional credit and subsidies, improving their economic security.

Tenancy protection in Andhra Pradesh



Loan Eligibility Cards

Why Protection Remains Insufficient

1. **Deregulation:** The 2019 Act removed curbs on lease terms and rent, exposing marginal tenants with little bargaining power.
2. **Informal tenancy:** Most agreements are unregistered, so tenants cannot claim rights or schemes.

3. Caste dimension: Scheduled Castes form a large share of tenants, linking tenancy to social marginalisation.

4. Implementation gaps: Weak institutions, low awareness and poor grievance redressal hinder realisation of rights.

Way Forward

1. Mandatory registration: Compulsory lease registration to formalise tenant status.

2. Clear definition: Define the tenant as the actual cultivator household and prohibit sub-leasing.

3. District grievance bodies: Staffed bodies to settle tenancy disputes swiftly.

4. SC tenants: Special schemes for credit, inputs and land rights.

Conclusion

Land reforms have not given tenants sufficient protection. Registration, clear rights and enforcement are essential to secure the actual tiller.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

ghissu

ghissu exam-hall thinking decodes every directive — Discuss, Examine, Elucidate — before you write a line.

Decode your next question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
7(a)

Highlight the important trends in incidence of poverty in Andhra Pradesh.

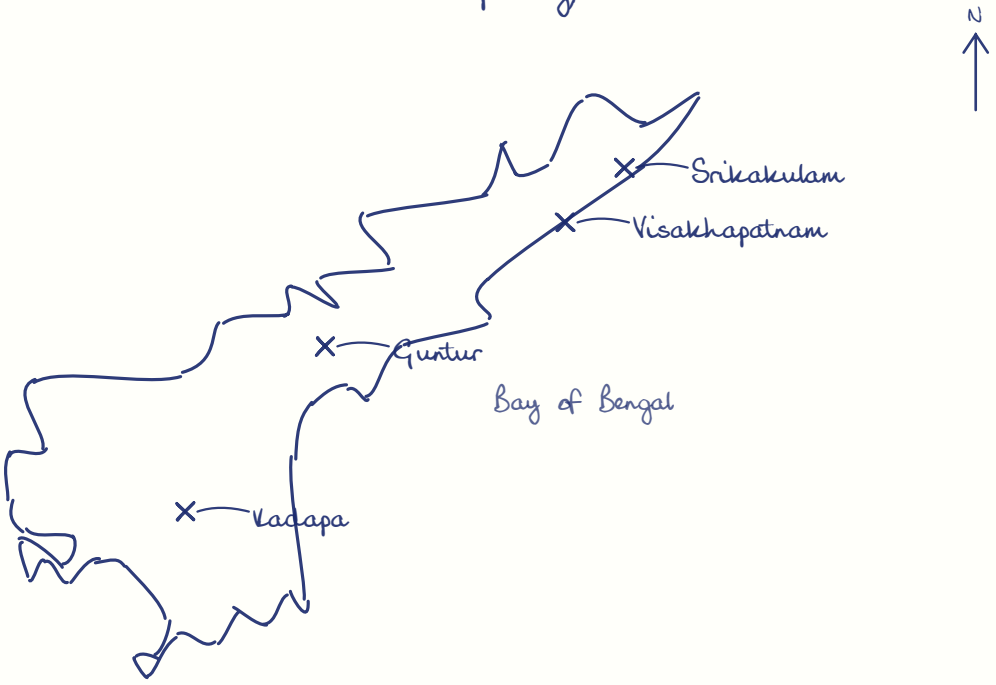
Introduction

The incidence of poverty in Andhra Pradesh has changed significantly over recent decades, reflecting socio-economic change and policy interventions. With the economy growing faster than the national average and welfare schemes in place, poverty has fallen, though regional disparities demand focused responses.

Key Trends in Poverty Incidence

1. **Sharp Decline:** The poverty rate has fallen steadily over three decades.
2. **Multidimensional Poverty:** The MPI headcount ratio is 15.37%, reflecting better health, education and living standards, though rural areas still lag urban centres.
3. **District Disparities:** Krishna and Guntur show poverty around 4%, while YSR Kadapa and Srikakulam exceed 9%, revealing spatial inequality.
4. **Urban Poverty:** Urbanisation and growth reduced poverty, but informal employment and housing shortages keep urban poverty a concern.

District contrasts in poverty Andhra Pradesh



Guntur near 4%; Kadapa, Srikakulam above 9%

Factors Behind the Trends

1. **Economic Growth:** Agriculture grew 10.7% in 2024–25, raising rural incomes, while industrial corridors around Visakhapatnam created urban jobs.
2. **Welfare Schemes:** MGNREGS, PM-AY, Annadatha Sukhibhava and the NTR Bharosa pension provide safety nets for housing, nutrition and health.
3. **Service Gaps:** 22% vacancies in secondary health posts and health spending of only 3.11% of the budget against an 8% target perpetuate poverty cycles.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

4. Governance: Reports of welfare fund diversion limit anti-poverty efforts.

Implications

1. Inclusive Growth: Per capita income of 2,68,653 in 2024-25 creates room for better education, health and mobility.
2. Social Inequality: Uneven gains among SCs, STs and districts may hinder balanced development.

Way Forward

1. Health and Education: Fill vacancies and expand infrastructure.
2. Regional Focus: Targeted plans for districts like YSR Kadapa.
3. Welfare Delivery: Improve transparency in NTR Bharosa and PM-AY funds.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has cut poverty substantially, but closing district and social gaps is key to its eradication. Growth must now reach the districts and groups it has missed.

How did toppers write this one?
1.5 lakh+ topper answers, matched to each question.
ghissu.com →

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 7(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
7(b)

Do you consider that Andhra Pradesh economy is still dominated by agricultural sector? Justify your answer.

Introduction

Agriculture remains vital to Andhra Pradesh's economy, sustaining the livelihoods of a large share of its population. Despite rapid industrialisation and service growth, it still contributes substantially to GSDP and employment. On balance the economy is still agriculture-dominated, especially in employment, even as its output share declines.

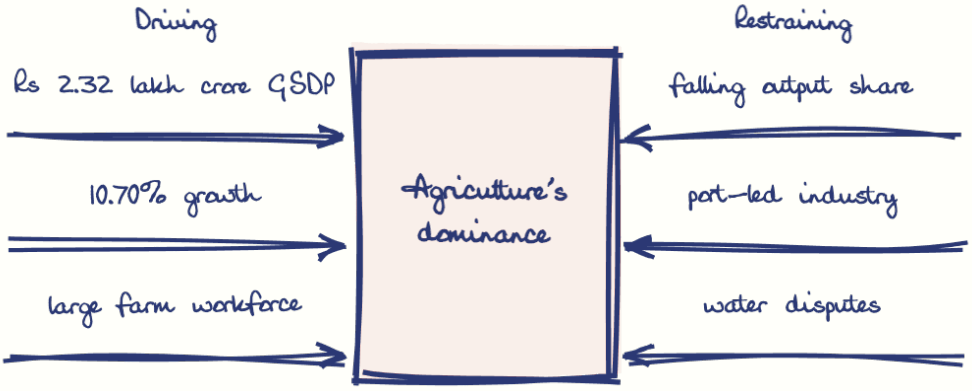
Evidence of Dominance

1. **Large GSDP contribution:** Agriculture and allied sectors contributed Rs 2.32 lakh crore to the state's GSDP of Rs 8.73 lakh crore in 2024-25, a key pillar despite diversification.
2. **Strong growth:** The sector grew at 10.70% in 2024-25, above the national farm growth rate.
3. **Employment reliance:** A large segment of the workforce depends on agriculture, mirroring the national trend where nearly half the population is in farming.
4. **Regional and commercial strengths:** From the fertile Krishna delta to drought-prone Rayalaseema, farming dominates, with horticulture,

aquaculture and chillies showing export potential.

5. Welfare link: Per capita income of Rs 2,68,653 in 2024–25 and a poverty rate down to 6.06% reflect agricultural prosperity.

Is AP still agriculture-dominated?



Signs of Structural Change

1. Declining share: Agriculture's share is falling relative to industry and services, showing structural transformation.

2. Diversification: Industrial corridors and port-led growth at Visakhapatnam are expanding rapidly, though agriculture remains critical for inclusive growth and rural stability.

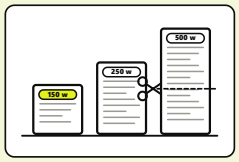
3. Risks: Krishna and Godavari water disputes and climate variability threaten sustained dominance.

Way Forward

1. Climate-resilient farming: Scale up APCNF to cut climate risks, and use the Annadatha Sukhibhava Scheme to support farmer welfare and productivity.
2. Agri-processing and markets: Strengthen post-harvest infrastructure and link farmers through e-NAM to raise incomes and reduce wastage.
3. Diversify the rural economy: Promote aquaculture, horticulture and non-farm rural jobs to reduce overdependence on traditional crops.

Conclusion

Agriculture still dominates Andhra Pradesh's economy in employment and makes a large GSDP contribution, even as industry and services grow. Strengthening it through sustainable practices, infrastructure and market reforms is central to inclusive growth, food security and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
8(b)

What are the measures taken by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to empower women? Elaborate.

Introduction

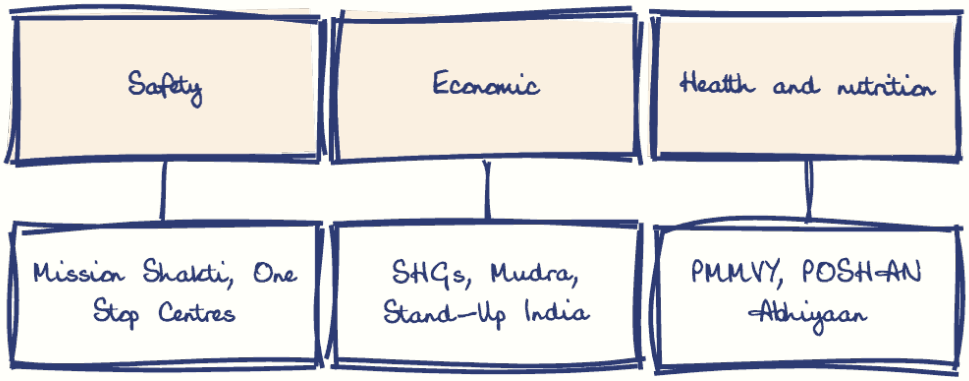
Women's empowerment is critical for inclusive socio-economic development in Andhra Pradesh, a state striving for fast growth and social equity. The government has taken targeted measures to raise women's participation in education, health, economic activity and governance, aligned with national priorities and the SDGs.

Measures Taken by the Government

1. Mission Shakti umbrella: Mission Shakti integrates One Stop Centres, Women Helplines, Shakti Sadans and Sakhi Niwas hostels, providing safety, legal aid and rehabilitation.
2. Self-Help Groups: Under DAY-NRLM, which has mobilised over 10 crore rural families nationally, women's SHGs are linked to credit and livelihoods.
3. Entrepreneurship: Mudra Yojana and Stand-Up India give collateral-free loans and training; 68% of Mudra loans are sanctioned to women.
4. Health and nutrition: PMMVY, Mission POSHAN and POSHAN Abhiyaan target maternal health

and nutrition.

AP Measures for Women



Impact on Women's Status

1. Financial autonomy: SHGs and microfinance give women control over household finances, with per capita income at Rs 2,68,653 for 2024–25.
2. Health and education: Life expectancy of 70.6 years and better girls' enrolment.
3. Political participation: Women hold about 47% of Panchayat seats, building grassroots leadership.
4. Safety support: One Stop Centres and Helplines aid victims of violence.

Challenges

1. Fund diversion: The CAG found welfare funds diverted and admin costs above limits.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

2. Health gaps: 22% specialist vacancies, only 175 CHCs against 412 required.

3. Informality: Rural women in informal work lack quality jobs, skill training, social security and childcare.

4. Awareness: Low legal awareness and under-reporting of violence blunt safety measures.

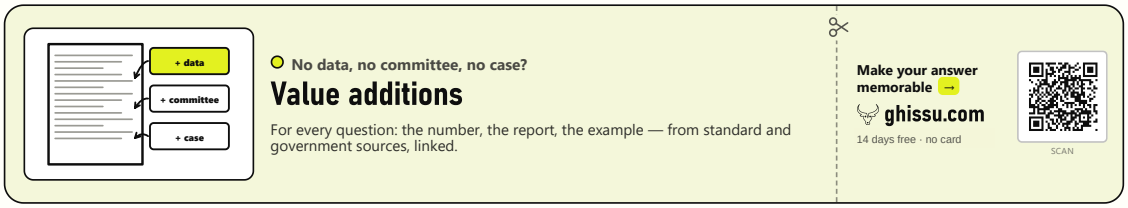
Way Forward

1. Fund management: Fund transparency and monitoring to stop diversion.

2. Health and skills: Fill health vacancies, upgrade CHCs and tailor skill training with childcare support for formal jobs.

Conclusion

AP's measures have widened women's safety, income, health and political voice. Closing governance and health gaps will turn them into lasting empowerment.



P-III
9(a)

Critically Examine the role of World Bank Loans in the Development of Andhra Pradesh Economy.

Introduction

World Bank loans have grown in importance for Andhra Pradesh given its ambitious growth targets and infrastructure needs after the 2014 bifurcation. External finance supports large projects, but its contributions must be weighed against its costs to judge whether growth is sustainable and inclusive.

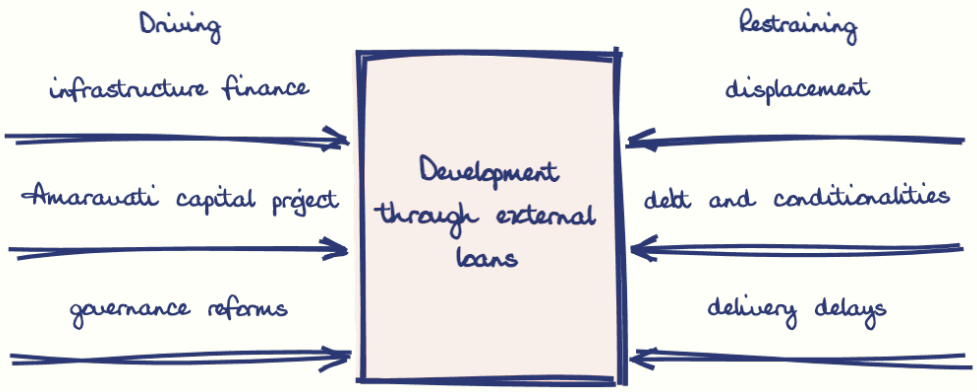
Contributions of World Bank Loans

1. **Infrastructure financing:** Loans fund projects that improve water security and connectivity, supporting agriculture and industry. This directly aids economic expansion.
2. **Capital city development:** The Amaravati Sustainable Capital City Development Project, with AIIB, aims at a modern capital that attracts investment.
3. **Reforms and capacity:** Support for governance reforms improves fiscal management and service delivery. These are foundations for long-term development.

Positive and Negative Impacts

1. Growth and jobs: Funds boosted agriculture and industry; per capita income was Rs 2,68,653 in 2024–25, above the national average.
2. Inclusion: Components improve irrigation for small farmers and skills.
3. Social and environmental costs: Amaravati faced criticism over land acquisition and displacement. This raised social justice concerns.
4. Debt and conditionalities: Loans add to debt and may limit policy autonomy.

World Bank loans in Andhra Pradesh



Effectiveness and Challenges

1. Delivery: Weak administrative capacity and coordination cause delays. Delays and cost overruns follow such gaps.
2. Accountability: The Inspection Panel case shows

gaps in transparency and grievance redressal.

3. Alignment: Fitting projects to Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 needs constant dialogue.

Way Forward

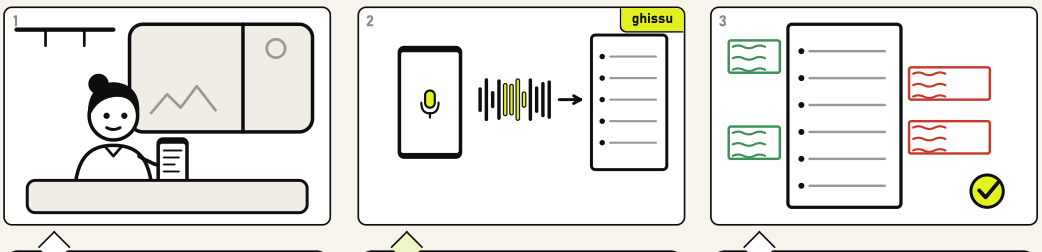
1. Safeguards: Better community engagement and grievance redressal.
2. Capacity: Faster execution and monitoring.

Conclusion

World Bank loans have aided infrastructure, reform and growth, but social costs, debt and delivery gaps call for strong safeguards.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW QUICK OUTLINE — TYPE, SPEAK OR SCAN

Practice on the bus



No desk, no time. No practice today, again.

Just speak the outline into ghissu.

Feedback before my stop.

— An outline a day beats a full answer a week.

Try a quick outline →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
10(a)

Do you consider that Public Sector is getting adequate financial support from the Government of Andhra Pradesh in XI Five Year Plan?

Introduction

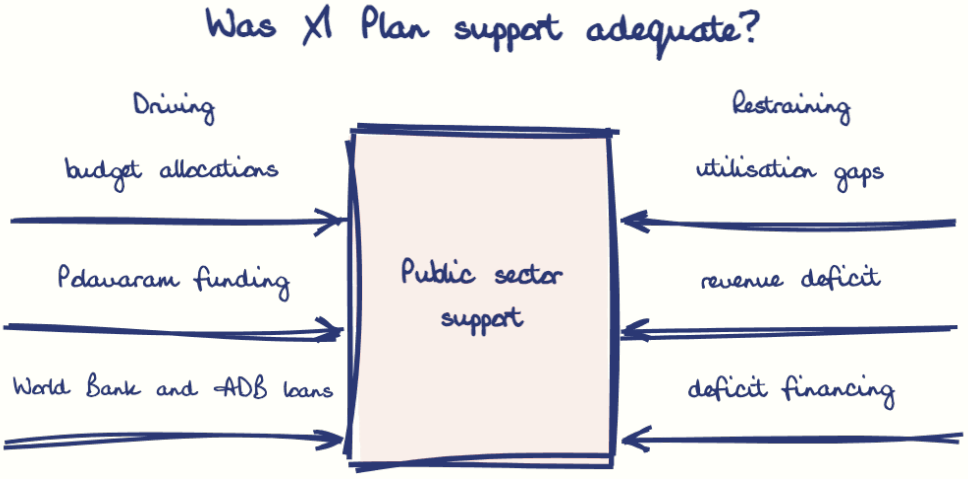
Financial support to the Public Sector during the XI Five Year Plan (2007–2012) is key to judging Andhra Pradesh's industrial and infrastructure growth. It reveals the state's fiscal priorities and the role of public enterprises in regional development. On balance, support was considerable but not fully adequate.

Financial Support in the XI Plan

1. Budgetary allocations: Substantial resources went to Public Sector Enterprises, especially in energy and irrigation, vital for the agrarian economy.
2. Capital investment: Projects like the Polavaram irrigation project received dedicated funding for large public assets.
3. External financing: Loans from the World Bank and Asian Development Bank supplemented state resources, showing the scale of needs.
4. Utilisation gaps: Underutilisation and diversion of funds in some schemes reduced the support that actually reached projects.

Was the Support Adequate?

1. Needs versus allocations: The investment needs of the Public Sector often outpaced available funds, leaving gaps in operations and expansion.
2. Revenue deficit: Committed revenue spending consumed resources, cutting fiscal space for capital outlay. Public Sector investment suffered most.
3. SPSE health: Governance and arrears problems were worsened by inadequate and delayed support.
4. Borrowing: Reliance on deficit financing raised fiscal sustainability concerns.



Implications

1. Mixed performance: Some projects progressed, but

governance and finance limits held back public units.

2. Regional gains: Polavaram had positive spillovers for agriculture and rural livelihoods.
3. Fiscal strain: Rising debt reduced the ability to sustain support later.

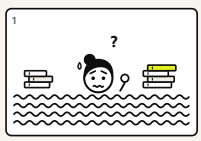
Way Forward

1. Capex efficiency: Ensure timely and full use of allocated funds.
2. SPSE governance: Improve financial discipline.
3. Revenue and PPPs: Broaden the revenue base and use public–private partnerships.

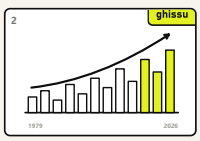
Conclusion

The government gave considerable support to the Public Sector in the XI Plan, but fiscal constraints and governance gaps kept it short of needs. Structural reforms can make support more effective.

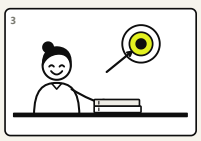
You have a feeling. The examiner has a pattern.



Reading the whole ocean



ghissu reads decades of papers



You prepare what's coming

Find your next sub-topic →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 10(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
10(b)

Critically Examine the allocation pattern of resources in X and XI Five Year Plans of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Resource allocation in the X and XI Five Year Plans was crucial for Andhra Pradesh in the 2000s, a period of efforts to address regional disparities and tribal welfare. With backward tribal areas, agrarian distress and infrastructure deficits, these Plans show how well resources were targeted for inclusive growth.

X Plan Allocation

1. Agriculture and rural development: A significant share went to agriculture and allied activities, reflecting the agrarian base and the needs of drought-prone Rayalaseema.
2. Tribal Sub Plan gaps: Tribal Sub Plan allocations were inadequate, underused or diverted, as CAG reports highlighted.
3. Irrigation emphasis: Early phases of the Polavaram project were funded, but capital spending often fell below targets.
4. Fiscal imbalance: Rising revenue deficits from subsidies in power and agriculture limited productive investment. Capital spending stayed

law.

XI Plan Allocation

1. **Expanded outlay:** The Plan proposed a 125% increase over the X Plan, with more support for social services and infrastructure.
2. **Inclusive growth:** More funds for backward and tribal areas through the Remote and Interior Areas Development Programme, and health via Rajiv Arogyasri.
3. **Persistent diversion:** Underutilisation continued, with failure to meet population-based allocations.
4. **Fiscal limits:** High deficits, low capital spending and heavy borrowing weakened impact. Own revenue was insufficient.

X vs XI Plan allocations

X Plan	XI Plan
Large agriculture share	125% higher outlay
Early Pdavaram funding	More for backward, tribal areas
TSP funds underused	Diversion persisted

Critical Assessment

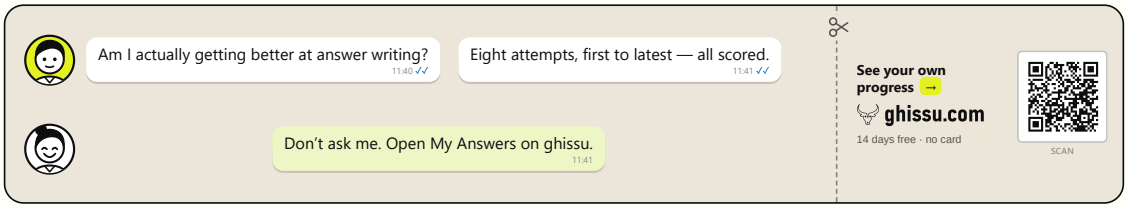
1. Allocation versus utilisation: Funds for Scheduled Tribes were not fully used, undermining inclusive goals. This reflects governance and implementation failures.
2. Regional disparities: Benefits went mainly to developed regions, while tribal and drought-prone areas lagged. Irrigation spending did not yield balanced development.
3. Fiscal constraints: Committed spending on subsidies and pensions cut productive investment.

Way Forward

1. Sub-plan monitoring: Ensure SC and Tribal Sub-Plan funds are spent according to population ratios.

Conclusion

Both Plans raised allocations, but weak utilisation, diversion and fiscal limits blunted their inclusive goals. Accountable spending is the key lesson.



P-III
11(a)

Evaluate the performance of Industrial Sector in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The industrial sector is a key driver of growth, employment and structural transformation in Andhra Pradesh. With GSDP estimated at 8.73 lakh crore and growing at 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, evaluating industry shows how far it sustains this momentum.

Performance of the Industrial Sector

1. **Robust growth:** Strong performance in manufacturing, electricity and construction reflects diversification within industry.
2. **Exports and investment:** The state exported over US$19 billion in FY22, led by seafood and iron, supported by Export Promotion Zones and agri-export zones. FDI inflows have also increased.
3. **Infrastructure and clusters:** APIIC's industrial parks and common facility centres have enhanced manufacturing capabilities.

Factors Shaping Performance

1. **Policy support:** Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, industrial zoning and APIIC's PPP-based parks

Practice 11(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

have eased approvals and growth.

2. Resource constraints: Power deficits and water scarcity have reduced capacity utilisation, as in steel at Visakhapatnam.
3. Weak SPSEs: SPSEs contribute about 6.69% of GSDP but suffer from arrears in accounts and high debt–equity ratios.
4. Innovation gap: Moderate scores on the India Innovation Index show the need for more R&D and skills.

AP industry: strengths and constraints

Strengths	Constraints
9.24% GSDP growth	Power deficits, water scarcity
US$19 billion exports (FY22)	SPSE arrears, high debt
APIIC parks, clusters	Low R&D, innovation

Way Forward

1. Infrastructure investment: Upgrade power supply, water management and digital infrastructure in clusters.
2. SPSE governance: Reduce arrears and improve

accountability in state enterprises.

3. Skills and innovation: Expand technical education and R&D funding aligned to industry.

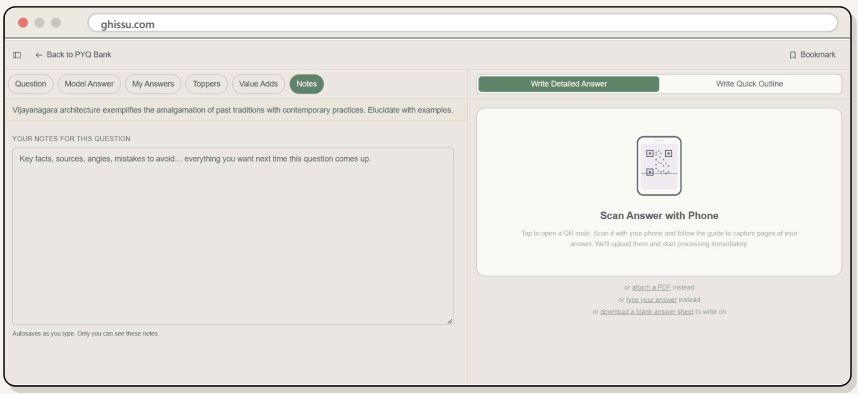
4. Export-oriented MSMEs: Support MSMEs with export certifications using export promotion zones.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's industry shows strong growth and a diversified base, but resource, governance and innovation gaps limit it. Addressing them can move the state towards higher value-added manufacturing.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP NOTES THAT LIVE WITH THE QUESTION

Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?



1 A notes tab beside every question.

2 Note from model answers, toppers and exam-hall thinking.

3 Autosaves — and rolls up into chapter notes.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
11(b)

Discuss the measures taken by the Government of Andhra Pradesh to promote small scale Industries have they yielded expected results?

Introduction

Promoting small scale industries (SSIs) is crucial for inclusive growth, employment and regional development. Andhra Pradesh, growing at 9.24% in 2024–25 with a per capita income of 2,68,653, above the national average, has backed SSIs through decentralised industrialisation in line with national MSME priorities.

Measures Taken by the State

1. DIC network: District Industries Centres serve as single-window agencies for small and village industries, easing access to credit, technology and marketing.
2. Financial incentives: Interest subvention schemes and priority sector lending improve SSI access to finance.
3. Cluster development: The Industrial Infrastructure Upgradation Scheme and Integrated Infrastructural Development provide common facilities, technology upgradation and market linkages, cutting costs.
4. Technology and skills: Technology Centres and incubation hubs support skills and innovation, and

made essential medical supplies during COVID-19.

Have They Yielded Expected Results?

1. Growth and jobs: SSIs contribute significantly to employment and production, but capacity utilisation is uneven due to infrastructure and technology constraints.
2. Finance gaps: Many units still struggle for timely credit and technical help, and the backlog of accounts and governance issues in state enterprises show systemic inefficiencies.
3. Infrastructure limits: Cluster projects face delays and incomplete implementation, and poor infrastructure raises costs.
4. Regulatory burden: Enforcement gaps and complex rules still hinder growth and formalisation.

Measures and results

Measure	Result
DIC single window	Uneven capacity utilisation
Interest subvention	Credit still delayed
Cluster schemes	Delayed, incomplete projects
Technology Centres	COVID medical supplies made

Way Forward

1. Complete clusters: Finish Common Facility Centres with timely grant disbursal.
2. Credit flow: Expand specialised SSI branches and train bankers in techno-economic appraisal.
3. Simpler regulation: A digitised single-window system and fewer inspections.
4. Technology: Invest more in technology centres and vocational training aligned with industry needs to boost productivity and innovation.
5. Formalisation: Lower compliance costs so more small units register and use state support.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's measures have laid a strong foundation but have yielded only partial results due to implementation and infrastructure gaps. Focused action can raise SSI competitiveness and inclusive employment in line with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 11(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
12(a)

Critically Examine the procurement price policy of the Government of India and Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The procurement price policy is a cornerstone of India's agricultural strategy, aimed at assuring remunerative prices to farmers and stabilising food security. The goal of doubling farmers' income has renewed its importance. In Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture and allied sectors sustain a large share of livelihoods, its impact on rural welfare is critical.

Features of the National Policy

1. MSP as a price floor: The Government of India sets Minimum Support Prices to guarantee a minimum return, especially for staples like rice and wheat.
2. Food security and buffer stocks: Procurement at MSP feeds the Public Distribution System with buffer stocks for vulnerable groups.
3. Dual pricing: It subsidises essential goods for weaker sections while keeping production viable.
4. Price stabilisation: Procurement prevents distress sales during bumper harvests and steadies prices.

Implementation in Andhra Pradesh

1. State procurement: Mechanisms aligned with national MSP procure mainly paddy and other staples, supporting farm incomes.
2. Annadatha Sukhibhava Scheme: It complements procurement by promoting crop diversification and sustainable practices.
3. Fiscal constraints: The state's revenue deficit limits modernisation of procurement, affecting timely payments.

Procurement policy: India vs Andhra Pradesh

Government of India	Andhra Pradesh
MSP as price floor	MSP-aligned paddy procurement
Buffer stocks for PDS	Annadatha Sukhibhava diversification
Subsidy burden	Revenue deficit limits

Critical Assessment

1. Narrow coverage: The skew towards a few crops and regions leaves small and marginal farmers in drought-prone Rayalaseema with limited access to procurement centres.
2. Implementation gaps: Delays, quality issues and

inadequate storage cause post-harvest losses and distress.

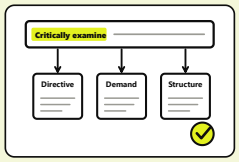
3. Fiscal sustainability: The dual burden of subsidies and procurement costs strains both governments' finances, calling for reforms that balance farmer welfare with fiscal prudence.

Way Forward

1. Wider coverage: Extend MSP and procurement to pulses, oilseeds and horticulture, and align it with AP Community Managed Natural Farming.
2. FPOs and infrastructure: Empower Farmer Producer Organisations to aggregate produce, and invest in cold storage, quality testing and digital payments for timely payment.

Conclusion

The procurement price policy remains vital for farm incomes and food security, but its coverage, efficiency and fiscal sustainability are limited. In Andhra Pradesh, regional disparities and fiscal constraints make its recalibration urgent.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 12(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
12(b)

Highlights the important features of Public Distribution System in Andhra Pradesh.

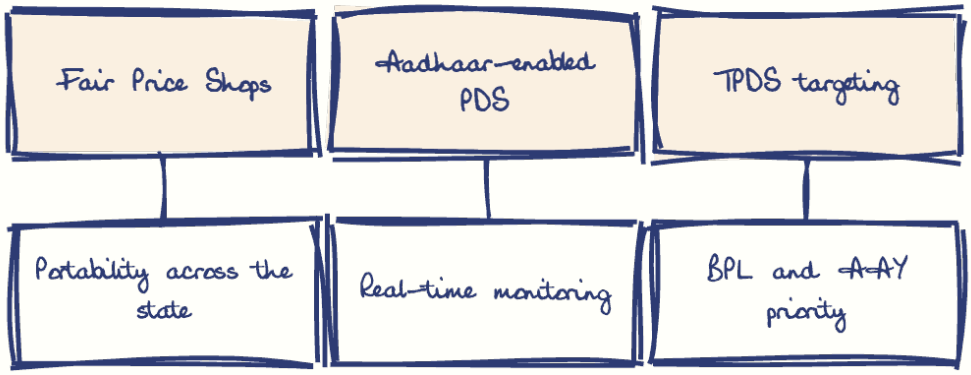
Introduction

The Public Distribution System (PDS) is a critical instrument of food security and poverty alleviation in agrarian states like Andhra Pradesh. An efficient PDS supports vulnerable households and nutrition, and technology such as Aadhaar-enabled PDS has improved its transparency and reach.

Institutional and Technological Features

1. **Fair Price Shop network:** A widespread FPS network distributes rice, wheat, sugar and kerosene, ensuring access even in remote areas.
2. **AePDS:** Thousands of shops and cards have moved to Aadhaar-enabled PDS, where biometric authentication improves identification and reduces leakages.
3. **Targeted system:** Under the TPDS framework, BPL and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households are prioritised.
4. **Coordination:** The state works with central schemes and local bodies on procurement, storage and distribution, using e-Seva for grievance redressal.

Features of AP's PDS



Outcomes

1. Portability: Beneficiaries can draw rations from any FPS in the state.
2. Accountability: Real-time monitoring of FPS transactions reduces corruption and diversion of grains.
3. Food security: PDS has reduced food insecurity and malnutrition among vulnerable groups.
4. Grievance redressal: Digital platforms like e-Seva give beneficiaries a channel for complaints.

Challenges

1. Targeting errors: Inclusion errors benefit the non-poor while exclusion errors leave out eligible poor.
2. Fiscal limits: The fiscal deficit and spending

priorities, as seen in the AP Budget 2026–27, affect the scale and efficiency of PDS.

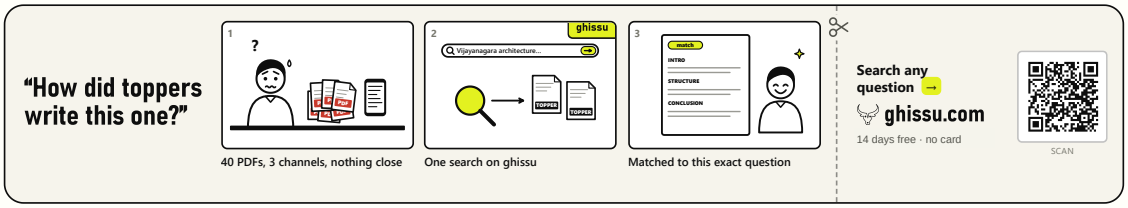
3. Logistics: Storage and transport gaps occasionally delay distribution.

Way Forward

1. Beneficiary database: Regular verification through Aadhaar and socio-economic surveys so the poorest receive their entitlements.
2. Supply chain: Modern storage, including cold storage for perishables, and efficient logistics to cut wastage.
3. Nutrition link: Integrate PDS with Saksham Anganwadi and POSHAN 2.0 for diverse food baskets.
4. Technology: Wider digital platforms for real-time monitoring and beneficiary feedback.

Conclusion

AP's PDS uses targeting and technology to secure food for the vulnerable, advancing zero hunger and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.



P-III
13(a)

What are the causes for inter-regional and inter-district disparities in Andhra Pradesh?

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's rapid growth, with GSDP rising 9.24% in 2024–25, masks significant disparities across regions and districts. These affect access to resources, infrastructure and opportunities, so understanding their causes is crucial for balanced growth under Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Causes of Inter-Regional Disparities

1. Geographical constraints: Telangana, Coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema differ in resources and climate, drought-prone Rayalaseema lags the fertile Krishna-Godavari delta.
2. Infrastructure concentration: Ports and industry cluster around Visakhapatnam and port-led corridors, drawing private investment, while Telangana and Rayalaseema lag.
3. Historical and political factors: The failure of the 1956 Telangana agreement and perceived job and economic discrimination fuelled the demand for statehood.
4. Social development gaps: Coastal Andhra has better literacy and health; CAG (2024) found vacancies

and poor facilities in backward regions.

Regional and district disparities in Andhra Pradesh



Deltas and coast lead, Rayalaseema, Telangana lag

Causes of Inter-District Disparities

1. Unequal resources: Dense, active districts like Krishna get more funds and investment, while YSR and Prakasam face underinvestment.

2. Agricultural productivity: Irrigated coastal districts gain from aquaculture and horticulture, while rain-fed districts in Rayalaseema suffer droughts.

3. Connectivity deficits: Uneven roads, digital services and energy leave some districts isolated.

4. Governance gaps: CAG audits show lapses and

fund diversion that hit backward districts hardest.

Way Forward

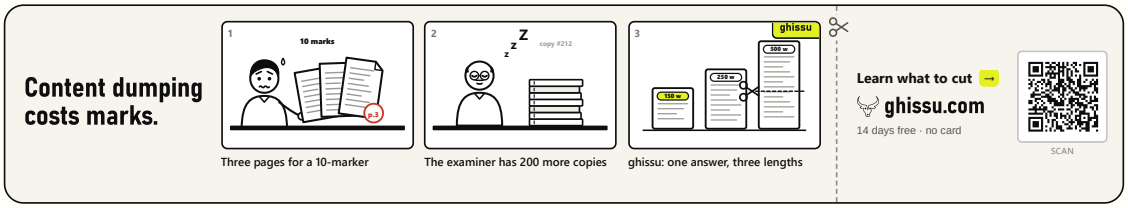
1. Infrastructure: Prioritise transport, irrigation and digital links in backward regions and districts.
2. Diversification: Agro-processing, MSMEs and sustainable industries suited to regional strengths, especially in drought-prone districts.
3. Social spending: Raise health and education budgets in lagging districts and fill vacancies flagged by the CAG.

Assessment

1. Nature versus policy: Geography explains part of the gap, but concentration of ports, industry and funds on the coast has widened it.

Conclusion

Disparities arise from geography, economy, society and politics together. A multi-dimensional approach can ensure equitable opportunities, in line with SDG (8.)



P-III
13(b)

Discuss the measures taken by the Government to improve education and health status in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Improving education and health is critical for Andhra Pradesh's inclusive growth. With projected GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 and per capita income above the national average, the state aims to build human capital through SDG-aligned schemes, despite infrastructure and resource gaps.

Institutional Measures

1. **SDG framework:** Vision 2029 integrates education and health targets across line departments for coordinated policy.
2. **Digital governance:** The Gram/Ward Sachivalayam system, AP Seva and Navasakam give single-window access to welfare at the grassroots.
3. **Budget support:** Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan for education, NHM and YSR Aarogyasri for health, though health gets only 3.11% of the budget against an 8% target.
4. **Specialised bodies:** Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust and AP Vaidya Vidhana Parishad oversee

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

healthcare quality and coverage.

AP Measures for Education and Health



Welfare and Community Measures

1. Education access: Samagra Shiksha and ULLAS raised enrolment, girls' toilets and drinking water reduced dropouts.
2. Nutrition and maternal health: ICDS and Janani Suraksha Yojana reduced anaemia and under-five mortality.
3. Gender inclusion: Mission Shakti and targeted schdarships address gender gaps in health and education.
4. Data monitoring: (115) SDG indicators at district and secretariat levels enable course correction.

Challenges

1. Staff shortages: CAG (2024) found (743)

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Practice 13(b) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

specialist and medical officer posts and 1,852 ANM posts vacant, even as life expectancy reached 70.6 years.

2. Infrastructure: Only 175 CHCs against 412 required, medical colleges lack faculty.
3. Fiscal stress: The revenue deficit surged in 2022–23 and capital spending on health and education stays low, delaying fund use.

Way Forward

1. Health funding: Raise health expenditure progressively to the 8% budget target.
2. Medical staff: Use incentives and career paths to fill specialist and nurse posts in rural areas.
3. Nutrition outreach: Scale up integrated nutrition and maternal health programmes with community participation.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh has built a strong institutional base. Raising health spending to 8%, filling vacancies and faster fund use can turn it into lasting human development.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
14(a)

Discuss the composition of institutional and non-institutional credit in rural Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Rural credit is a critical enabler of farm productivity and livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh, a state ranging from drought-prone Rayalaseema to the fertile Krishna-Godavari delta. Despite rising GSDP, many small and marginal farmers struggle to get affordable credit. The split between institutional and non-institutional sources shapes financial inclusion and rural resilience.

Institutional Credit

1. Multi-agency framework: Cooperative societies, commercial banks and Regional Rural Banks lend in rural areas. The cooperative share has declined, and commercial banks now account for most institutional lending, following nationalisation and branch expansion.
2. Kisan Credit Card: KCC enables short-term crop loans at subsidised interest, and higher collateral-free limits help smallholders get timely credit.
3. NABARD and state support: NABARD refinances rural institutions, while interest

subvention and rehabilitation packages for distressed farmers add to credit flow.

4. Limited reach: Small and marginal farmers, tenants and landless labourers stay underserved due to delays, collateral rules, few remote branches and weak cooperatives.

Non-Institutional Credit

1. Moneylenders and informal networks: Agricultural and professional moneylenders, landlords, relatives and traders give a large share of loans, especially to poor households.
2. High interest: Rates sometimes exceed 24% per annum, deepening debt for small farmers and labourers.
3. Promptness: Easy, quick access makes informal credit attractive despite its cost.
4. Social costs: Dependence exposes SCs and STs to exploitation and is linked to farmer suicides in Rayalaseema.

Comparative Composition

1. Relative share: Institutional credit holds the majority, as nationally where it supplies over 57% of rural credit, but informal credit remains

Rural credit sources

Institutional	Non-institutional
Banks, cooperatives, RRBs	Moneylenders, landlords, traders
Subsidised KCC loans	Over 24% interest
Productive investment	Consumption, social obligations
Misses tenants, landless	Quick, easy access

substantial among marginal farmers.

2. Different uses: Formal loans fund productive investment and diversification, while informal loans often finance consumption and social obligations, creating debt cycles.
3. Inclusion gaps: The coexistence of both shows that formal credit has not reached tenants and landless labourers.

Conclusion

Rural Andhra Pradesh relies mainly on institutional credit, yet costly informal credit persists among the vulnerable. Targeted outreach to tenants and the landless is needed to break debt traps.

Only ten minutes today?
Speak an outline. It gets evaluated too.
ghissu.com →

P-III
14(b)

Explain the significance of micro-finance institutions in meeting rural credit needs in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Micro-finance institutions (MFIs) have become pivotal in closing the rural credit gap, as formal banks often cannot reach the poorest. In Andhra Pradesh, with a large rural population, agrarian distress and a need to empower women, MFIs are a key channel of financial inclusion, sustaining a state economy projected to grow 9.24% in 2024–25.

Significance in Rural Credit

1. Bridging credit gaps: MFIs lend to households lacking collateral and credit history, vital where small and marginal farmers struggle to get institutional credit.
2. SHG–bank linkage: AP accounts for about 40% of bank-linked SHGs nationally, mobilising millions of women into collective savings and credit groups.
3. Inclusion catalyst: MFIs complement DAY-NRLM, which has mobilised over 10 crore rural households into SHGs, cutting dependence on exorbitant moneylenders.

Impact on Rural Borrowers

1. Women's empowerment: Over 90% of bank-linked SHGs in AP are women-exclusive, and credit for micro-enterprises raises their independence and status.
2. Poverty alleviation: Credit diversifies incomes and supports agriculture, aiding drought-prone Rayalaseema.
3. Less informal borrowing: Timely credit has improved the financial health of many rural families.

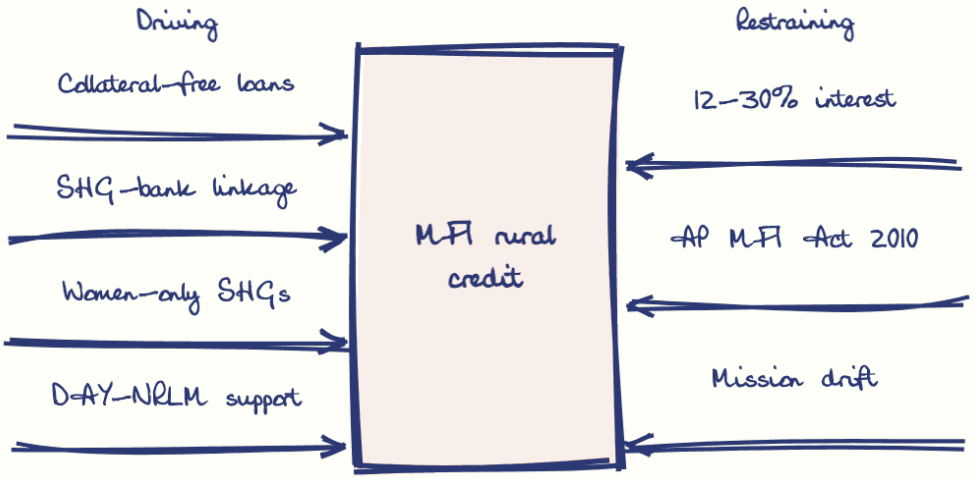
Challenges

1. Over-indebtedness: MFIs charge 12-30%, higher than commercial banks, risking borrower distress.
2. Regulatory shock: The AP Microfinance Institutions Act, 2010 made many MFIs exit the state, disrupting credit flow.
3. Mission drift: Some MFIs chase profit, and concentration in southern states raises equity concerns.
4. Low literacy: Weak borrower awareness hampers effective use of credit.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

MFIs in Rural AP



Way Forward

1. Balanced regulation: AP should work with RBI on a balanced regulatory framework ensuring fair lending without stifling growth.
2. Financial literacy: State-led financial literacy drives, especially for women, to prevent over-indebtedness.

Conclusion

MFIs are significant for AP's rural credit and women's empowerment. Sound regulation and borrower awareness can make them a sustainable pillar of rural financial inclusion.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 14(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
15(a)

Bring out the importance of transport and communication in the development of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

Advances in transport and communication have shaped the development of Andhra Pradesh, acting as enablers of growth and social integration. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, and a geography that includes a 974 km coastline and the Krishna and Godavari basins, these sectors are strategically vital.

Transport nodes and river basins of Andhra Pradesh



Role of Transport

1. Connectivity and trade: Visakhapatnam port and the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor improve movement of goods and people, boosting trade and contributing to per capita income of 2,68,653 in 2024–25.
2. Agricultural change: Better roads let Rayalaseema farmers shift to cash crops and aquaculture, raising incomes.
3. Urban mobility: Urban transport in Vijayawada and Amaravati supports industrial clusters, while the Electric Mobility Policy 2018–23 promotes cleaner mobility.
4. Challenges: Congestion, modal imbalance and poor maintenance reduce efficiency, so highway expansion and multimodal integration are crucial.

Role of Communication

1. Digital governance: e-Seva improves service delivery and supports schemes like Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan.
2. Market access: Telecom links give farmers and small businesses information, markets and finance, bridging regional gaps.
3. Education and health: Remote education and

telemedicine address health gaps flagged by the CAG.

Synergy of Both

1. Trade and investment: Together they enable port-led development and real-time logistics for export industries.
2. Resilience: They aid disaster response, such as floods in the Krishna basin.

Way Forward

1. Integrated planning: Unify intermodal and digital infrastructure planning.
2. Rural connectivity: Extend roads and telecom in backward regions like Rayalaseema.
3. Sustainable transport: Speed up the Electric Mobility Policy with incentives and charging infrastructure.

Conclusion

Transport and communication are the twin engines of Andhra Pradesh's development, and integrated investment can make growth balanced across regions.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
15(b)

Write about the growth of IT industry in Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The IT industry has emerged as a significant driver of growth and employment in Andhra Pradesh, especially after bifurcation. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, IT enhances the state's competitiveness in the knowledge economy, helped by a government focus on digital infrastructure and innovation.

Growth and Current Status

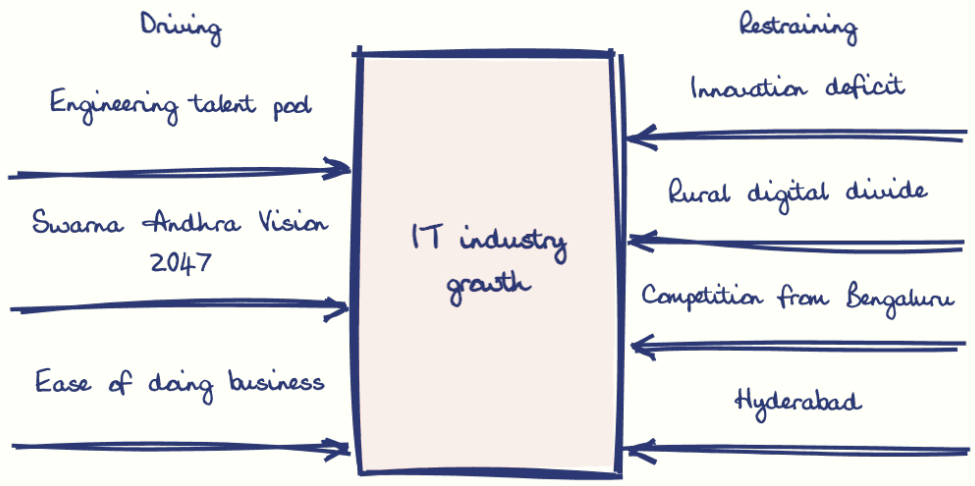
1. Growing workforce: Knowledge workers and IT professionals are increasing steadily, supported by a large output of engineering graduates.
2. Innovation and startups: Scores of 14.51 in innovation and 19.95 in knowledge output on the India Innovation Index show a growing but nascent ecosystem, incubators remain below the national average.
3. Digital infrastructure: Internet penetration of about 65%, ICT labs in 20.6% of schools and e-Seva support digital literacy and services.
4. Exports and business climate: ICT exports are growing but modest, while an ease of doing

business implementation score of 98.78% eases IT investment.

Factors Behind the Growth

1. Human capital: Higher education and Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan build a skilled talent pool.
2. Government policy: Broadband and ICT services, and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, aim to make the state a knowledge hub.
3. Connectivity: The coastline and Visakhapatnam port support IT hardware exports.
4. Investment climate: Measures to attract FDI and venture capital encourage startups.

IT growth in Andhra Pradesh



Challenges and Opportunities

1. Innovation deficit: Few patents and private

R&D units keep IT service-based rather than product-based.

2. Digital divide: Rural and semi-urban areas lag in infrastructure.
3. Competition: Established hubs like Bengaluru and Hyderabad compete for firms.
4. Emerging technologies: AI and fintech offer new opportunities.

Way Forward

1. More R&D: Raise R&D investment and incentives for private R&D units to boost patents and product development.
2. Digital literacy: Expand ICT labs in rural schools and digital skills training to widen the talent base.
3. Startups: Build more incubators with venture capital support.

Conclusion

With innovation and inclusive digital access, IT can become a lasting pillar of Andhra Pradesh's growth.

Where did you write that point?
Notes that live with the question.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 15(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2011 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

2008

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

P-III
1(a)

Explain various approaches to measure national income.

10

Introduction

Measuring national income is crucial to understanding an economy's health and growth path. With India's GDP growing 7.3% in 2023–24 and national accounts being reformed, accurate measurement matters more than ever for policy and welfare assessment. The production, income and expenditure approaches offer complementary perspectives.

① Production (Output) Approach

1. Method: Sums the value added at each stage of production across agriculture, manufacturing and services, excluding intermediate goods to avoid double counting.
2. Example: Andhra Pradesh's farm output is estimated by multiplying area sown by yield per hectare, covering subsistence and commercial production.
3. Use and Limits: It shows sectoral contributions and growth drivers, but struggles with the non-monetised sector, such as subsistence farming in Andhra Pradesh's Rayalaseema drought belt.

Practice 1(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

2. Income Approach

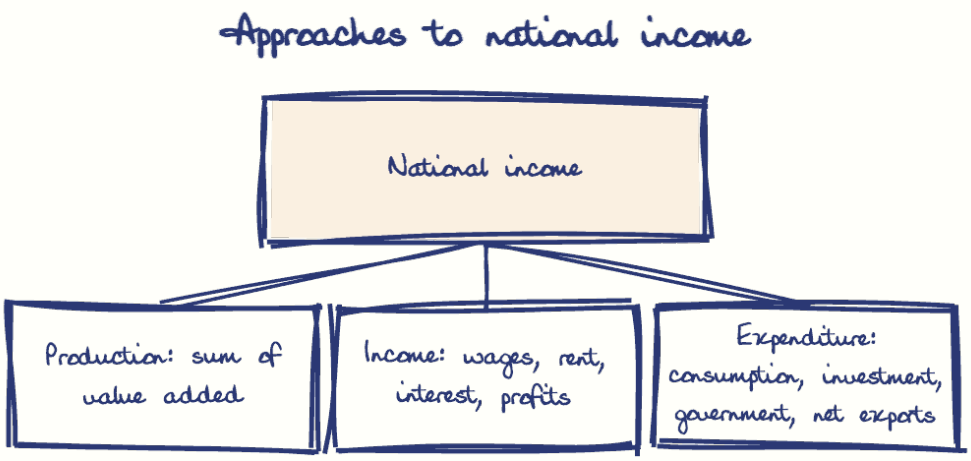
1. **Method:** Aggregates all factor incomes: wages, rent, interest and profits.
2. **Use:** It shows how income is shared among labour, capital and landowners, giving insight into inequality, such as earnings of Andhra Pradesh's farm labourers and aquaculture entrepreneurs.
3. **Limits:** Underreporting, illiteracy and missing accounts in informal enterprises reduce accuracy.

3. Expenditure Approach

1. **Method:** Totals spending on final goods and services: consumption, investment, government spending and net exports.
2. **Use:** It captures demand-side trends; spending on projects like the Polavaram irrigation scheme in Andhra Pradesh is a key component.
3. **Limits:** Unrecorded transactions, informal consumption and complex trade data, as in Andhra Pradesh with its long coastline and ports, distort it.

Way Forward

1. **Informal Sector Data:** Run surveys like ASUSE more rigorously in Andhra Pradesh for small



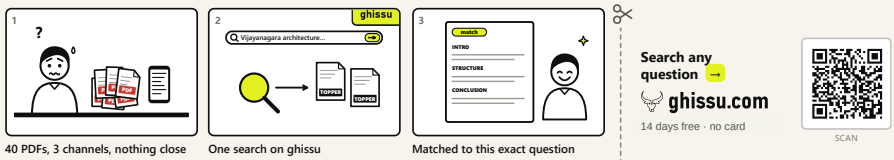
and family-run enterprises.

2. Technology: Use digital platforms and e-governance for real-time data.
3. State Statistics: Develop IPI and CPI for Andhra Pradesh to reduce time lags.
4. Integration: Combine all three approaches with cross-verification to minimise errors.

Conclusion

Each approach captures a different side of the economy: what is produced, who earns it and how it is spent. Together, cross-verified against each other, they give a fuller and more reliable picture of national income for policy.

"How did toppers write this one?"



Search any question →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
1(b)

Explain the problems in measuring national income.

10

Introduction

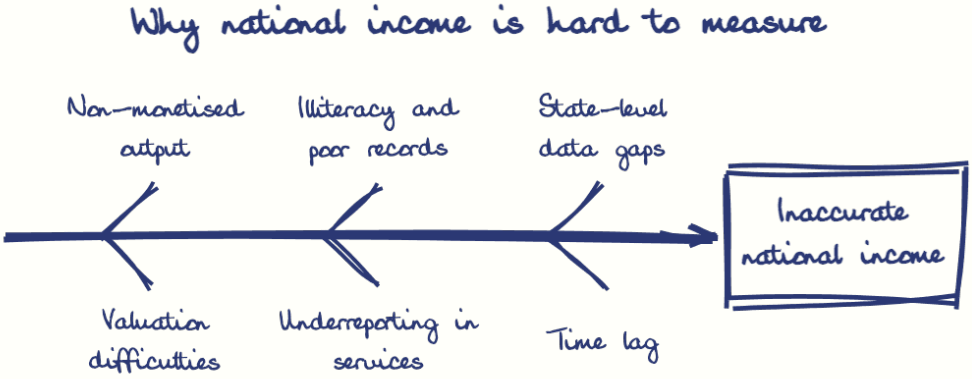
Accurate measurement of national income is crucial for assessing economic performance and planning development. In India it is difficult because of a large informal sector, data limitations and methodological complexity, problems that became sharper after the COVID-19 pandemic.

Conceptual and Structural Problems

1. **Non-Monetised Output:** Much farm produce is consumed by producers or bartered, so output is underestimated, as in subsistence farming in Rayalaseema.
2. **Incomplete Occupational Specialisation:** Informal activities lack clear categories, complicating classification, as in small household enterprises in Andhra Pradesh.
3. **No Income Distribution Data:** National accounts lack income distribution data, NSSO and IHDS surveys give partial insight with sample and reporting issues.
4. **Valuation Difficulties:** Valuing inventories and depreciation and avoiding double counting are technically hard, as in Visakhapatnam's port and industrial corridors.

Practical Problems in Data Collection

1. Illiteracy and Poor Records: Many producers keep no accounts, forcing guesswork in agriculture-dependent districts of Andhra Pradesh.
2. Underreporting in Services: Doctors, teachers and lawyers often under-report income.
3. State-Level Gaps: Many states, including Andhra Pradesh, lack comprehensive industrial production data, delaying state GDP estimates.
4. Time Lag: Figures take years to finalise, hampering policy response, as during COVID-19.



Implications

1. Policy Misalignment: Underestimated informal output means too little support for Andhra Pradesh's aquaculture and horticulture enterprises.
2. Distorted Growth: Errors obscure true growth, hampering evaluation of the Visakhapatnam-Chennai

industrial corridor.

3. Poverty Misestimation: Weak distribution data hampers targeting in drought-prone Rayalaseema.
4. Planning: Delayed data weakens planning for projects like the Polavaram irrigation scheme.

Way Forward

1. Data Integration: Add ASUSE and PLFS annually, as ~~ACNAS~~ recommends.
2. State Capacity: Strengthen Andhra Pradesh's statistical systems for timely industrial and farm data.
3. Digital Records: Encourage digital accounting in informal enterprises.
4. Faster Release: Expedite estimates with clear communication of revisions.

Conclusion

Overcoming these problems through better data integration, technology and timely, transparent revision is essential, because reliable national income figures are the foundation of evidence-based policy.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
2(a)

Explain the important objectives of the 10th Five Year Plan.

10

Introduction

The 10th Five Year Plan (2002–2007) was launched when India was on a higher growth trajectory after the economic reforms. It aimed to consolidate and accelerate growth while explicitly addressing equity and social justice, so that development reached all sections. Its objectives covered income, jobs, poverty and quality of life.

Important Objectives

1. **Doubling Income:** An 8% annual GDP growth target to double per capita income within a decade and raise productive capacity.
2. **Employment Generation:** Recognising the demographic dividend, creating 50 million jobs, especially in labour-intensive sectors, to absorb the growing workforce.
3. **Poverty Reduction:** Lowering the poverty ratio from 26%, so that growth brought real gains for the poor and marginalised.
4. **Decentralised Planning:** Greater role for states and Panchayati Raj Institutions in planning and implementation, promoting cooperative federalism, better resource allocation and

accountability.

5. Fiscal Consolidation: Reducing revenue deficits through better tax collection and subsidy rationalisation to fund public investment.

6. Quality of Life: Improving literacy, reducing gender gaps in education and wages, and widening access to potable drinking water.

10th Plan: targets and outcomes

Target	Outcome
8% GDP growth	7.6% achieved
50 million jobs	Job growth trailed workforce
Cut poverty from 26%	Poverty reduction slowed
Literacy, water, gender gaps	Improved; health lagged

Performance against Objectives

1. Growth: GDP grew 7.6%, short of the 8% target but well above the previous Plan's 5.5%, with industry and services leading the expansion.

2. Poverty and Jobs: Uneven regional growth and skill mismatches slowed poverty reduction, and

Candidates must not write on this margin

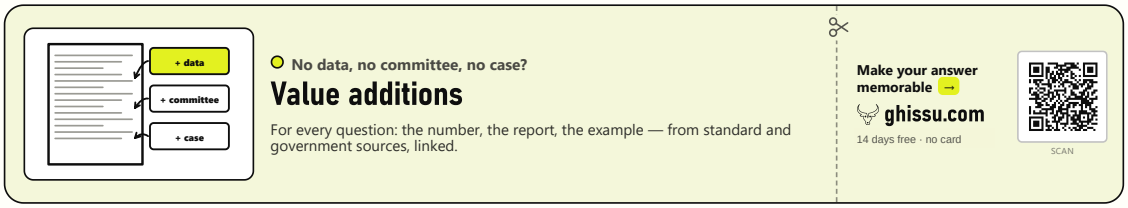
Candidates must not write on this margin

job growth trailed labour force additions.

3. Agriculture: Farm growth improved only modestly, exposing structural problems in rural areas and the limits of growth led by industry and services.
4. Fiscal Front: Better tax collection and subsidy rationalisation were pursued to reduce revenue deficits.
5. Social Indicators: Literacy, gender gaps and drinking water improved, but health and rural infrastructure lagged in backward regions like Rayalaseema.

Conclusion

The 10th Plan sought balanced growth with social justice, focusing on doubling income, generating jobs and reducing poverty. It laid the foundation for an inclusive and sustainable development model, though skills, rural infrastructure and decentralisation needed deeper work. Later plans built on its insight that growth must be judged by how widely it is shared.



P-III
2(b)

Explain the role of private sector after economic reforms.

10

Introduction

The 1991 reforms marked a paradigm shift by opening India to private enterprise and market forces. The private sector, earlier constrained by controls, emerged as a key driver of investment, innovation and employment, complementing the public sector. Andhra Pradesh too has drawn private participation into infrastructure and IT.

Role of the Private Sector After Reforms

1. Growth driver: Private firms like Tata and Reliance expanded and diversified output; port-led corridors in Visakhapatnam show private investment driving regional activity.
2. Employment: MSMEs and startups create jobs; over 2.23 lakh startups have generated 23.3 lakh direct jobs.
3. Innovation: Start-up India and Atal Tinkering Labs promote R&D, firms like TCS became global IT leaders, and Andhra Pradesh's incubation centres nurture local innovation.
4. Infrastructure: PPPs have accelerated projects, as in Amaravati and renewable energy in

Rayalaseema.

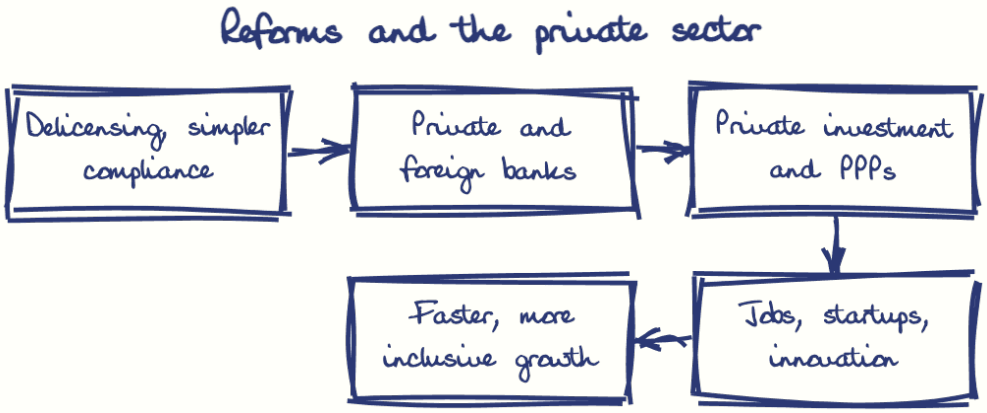
5. Complementing PSUs: Private players take on commercial roles in power and oil, easing the burden on public enterprises, as in Andhra Pradesh's power sector reforms.

How Reforms Enabled Private Growth

1. Delicensing: Firms entered sectors once reserved for PSUs and made global acquisitions like Jaguar.
2. Regulatory simplification: The Jan Vishwas Act 2023 and removal of over 40,000 compliances helped lift India's Ease of Doing Business rank from 142 in 2014 to 63 in 2019.
3. Financial reforms: Entry of private and foreign banks increased competition and credit availability. ECLGS helped MSMEs recover after the pandemic.
4. Governance: SEBI rules on independent directors and CSR professionalised firms and improved transparency and social accountability.

Impact on Overall Progress

1. Inclusive growth: Per capita GDP rose from 34% to 41% of the world average between 2014



and 2022.

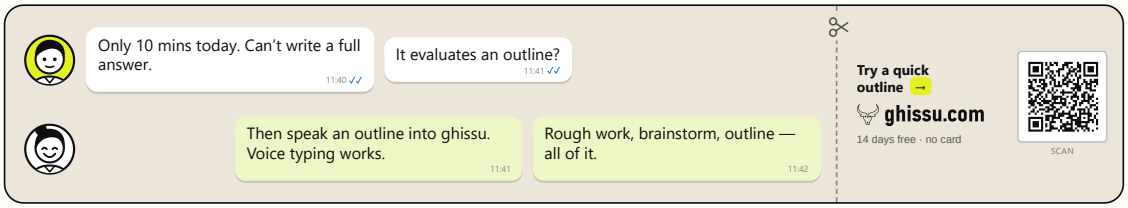
2. Formalisation: UPI and DBT have formalised enterprises and widened inclusion.

3. Green growth: Private solar projects on Andhra Pradesh's coastal belt support climate goals.

4. Rural livelihoods: Private investment in aquaculture and horticulture has improved rural incomes in Andhra Pradesh.

Conclusion

After reforms, the private sector became the main engine of growth, jobs and innovation, working with the public sector in a competitive mixed economy.



P-III
3(a)

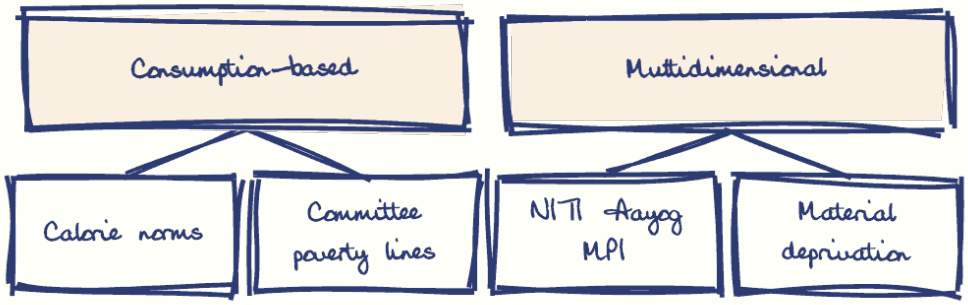
Explain the methods of measuring poverty in India.

10

Introduction

Measuring poverty is critical for policy and welfare targeting as India pursues inclusive growth. Poverty has declined significantly yet disparities persist across states, including Andhra Pradesh. The methods have evolved from calorie lines to multidimensional measures.

Methods of Measuring Poverty



Consumption-Based Methods

1. **Calorie Norms:** Early poverty lines were based on minimum energy intake.
2. **Expert Committees:** The Lakdawala Committee (1993), Tendulkar Committee (2009) and Rangarajan Committee (2014) refined poverty lines using regional price variations and nutritional outcomes.
3. **NSSO Surveys:** Large-scale consumption expenditure surveys on food and non-food spending form the

empirical basis.

4. Broader Baskets: Later lines include health, education and housing, not just food.
5. State-Specific Lines: These account for regional price differences.

Multidimensional Methods

1. MPI: NITI Aayog's Multidimensional Poverty Index covers health, education and living standards, going beyond income.
2. Material Deprivation: Tracking nutrition, housing quality and connectivity, as the NITI Aayog Task Force recommended.
3. Composite Indices: Combining consumption with multidimensional indicators helps identify chronic poverty.

Challenges in Measurement

1. Comparability: Different recall periods, survey design and price deflators break trends, needing bridging surveys.
2. Urban Underestimation: In states like Andhra Pradesh, urban poverty sometimes exceeds rural.
3. Non-Monetary Gaps: Consumption lines can miss essential non-food expenditure, causing exclusion errors.

Candidates must not write on this margin

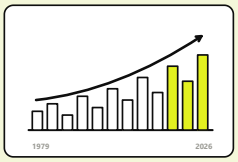
Candidates must not write on this margin

Way Forward

1. New Expert Committee: Revise poverty lines for current consumption and regional gaps.
2. Better Surveys: Standardise recall periods in NSSO surveys.
3. Official MPI: Institutionalise the MPI alongside consumption-based measures.
4. Stronger Schemes: Address fund diversion in states like Andhra Pradesh to maximise the impact of poverty alleviation.

Conclusion

Poverty measurement has moved from calorie lines to multidimensional frameworks. Combining both gives a truer picture of deprivation. Accurate measurement is the first step to accurate targeting.



Which sub-topic will they ask next?

Trend analysis

Every syllabus topic: the direction of travel, the most tested sub-topic, the probable next theme.

Prepare the pattern →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 3(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

3 / 3

Scan to practice

P-III
3(b)

Explain the methods of measuring unemployment in India.

10

Introduction

Measuring unemployment in India is complex because of widespread underemployment and a large informal sector. Unlike developed economies, poverty compels many to accept even marginal work, so open unemployment alone is an insufficient indicator. Accurate measurement is vital for employment policy.

Methods of Measuring Unemployment

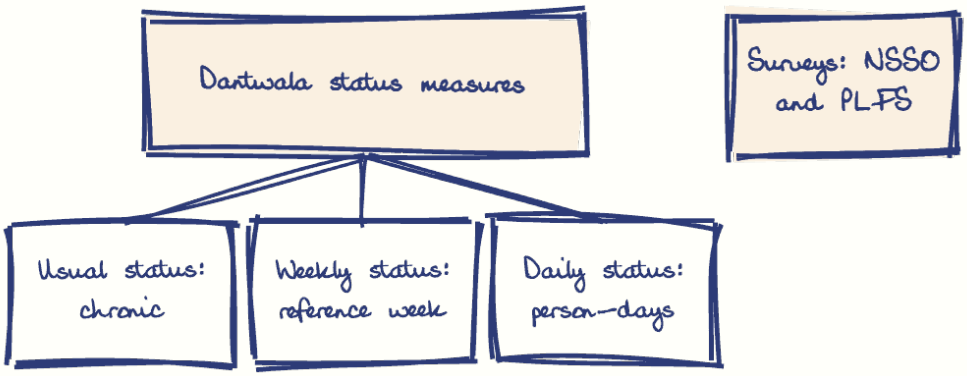
1. Dantwala approaches: The Planning Commission's (1968) Dantwala Committee introduced four approaches: usual status, current weekly status, current daily status and labour time disposition, capturing both long-term and seasonal labour use.
2. Usual status: Measures chronic unemployment over a long reference period and gives the lowest rate, about (2.2%).
3. Current weekly status: Records whether a person found work during the reference week, capturing short-term joblessness.
4. Current daily status: Measures unemployment in person-days, capturing seasonal and partial unemployment; its rate exceeds (7%).

5. NSSO and PLFS surveys: NSSO conducts quinquennial employment–unemployment surveys, while the Periodic Labour Force Survey provides annual and quarterly data across rural and urban India.

6. Labour Bureau: Annual household surveys and quarterly reports on key sectors track the effect of economic changes on jobs, including in the Visakhapatnam port-led industrial corridors.

7. Administrative data: Integrating administrative records, as attempted in Maharashtra, can improve timeliness.

Measuring unemployment in India



Challenges in Measurement

1. Underemployment and informality: Subsistence work blurs the line between employment and unemployment.

2. Variability of estimates: Differing population projections, reference periods and definitions produce

different rates.

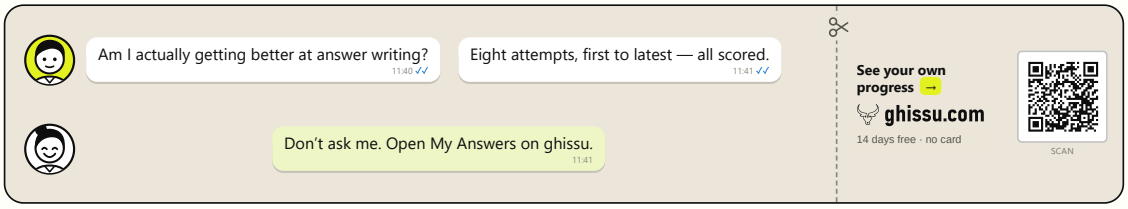
3. Disparities: Youth and women face longer unemployment spells, as in urban Andhra Pradesh.
4. Economic shocks: COVID-19 spikes showed the need for frequent, granular data.

Way Forward

1. More frequent surveys: Wider coverage, especially in vulnerable regions like Rayalaseema.
2. Link administrative data: Social security and welfare records can improve accuracy and reduce reliance on self-reported data.
3. Underemployment metrics: Indicators of quality of employment beyond the unemployment rate will reflect labour market realities.

Conclusion

A multifaceted approach that accounts for underemployment and diversity will make unemployment statistics more accurate and support SDG (8.)



P-III
4(a)

Explain the objectives of monetary policy.

10

Introduction

Monetary policy has gained renewed importance in India amid inflation volatility, growth slowdown and financial sector risks. With the policy repo rate at 5.50 per cent, the RBI must balance price stability with sustainable growth while supporting inclusive development in an uncertain global environment.

Institutional Mandate

1. **Monetary Policy Committee:** The MPC formulates policy with a dual mandate of price stability and growth, moving beyond earlier frameworks focused solely on inflation.
2. **Inflation targeting:** Since 2015, India follows flexible inflation targeting with a 4% CPI target and a band of +/− 2%, anchoring expectations. The RBI Act amendment of 2016 gave it legal backing.

Objectives of Monetary Policy

1. **Price stability:** The primary objective is controlling food and core inflation, which affects purchasing power and welfare. The RBI uses repo

rate changes and open market operations.

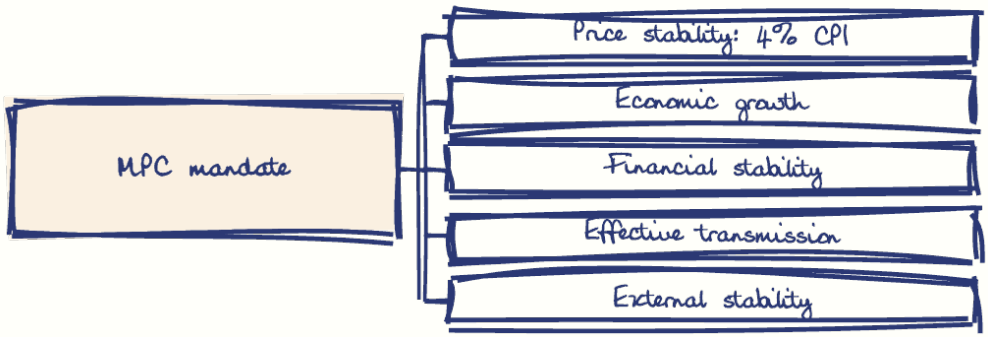
2. Economic growth: By managing liquidity and interest rates, policy creates conditions for investment and consumption, fostering durable and inclusive growth that can absorb the demographic dividend.

3. Financial stability: After the 2008 global financial crisis, the health of the banking and financial system became an explicit objective, given its close link with monetary policy.

4. Effective transmission: Policy aims at well-functioning markets so that rate changes reach credit, including for agriculture and MSMEs.

5. External stability: Policy influences exchange rates and competitiveness, crucial for Andhra Pradesh's coastline and port-led corridors.

Objectives of monetary policy



Way Forward

1. Stronger transmission: Strengthen financial infrastructure and banking health in Andhra Pradesh so that policy rates reach priority sectors.
2. Inclusive focus: Tailor tools to support sectors critical to Andhra Pradesh, like aquaculture and horticulture,, so growth reaches rural populations.
3. Financial stability frameworks: Coordinate monetary and financial policy to pre-empt risks from credit cycles and asset prices.
4. Digital finance: Digital payments and financial inclusion in Andhra Pradesh improve transmission and broaden the tax base.

Conclusion

Price stability, growth and financial stability together create a stable environment for investment, jobs and equitable development, supporting Viksit Bharat (2047) and SDG (8.)

STUDY TIP · WHERE TO WRITE A NOTE

Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

ghissu

On ghissu every question has a notes tab — and your notes gather into chapter notes by themselves.

Open the notes tab →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
4(b)

Explain the impact of economic reforms in the Banking sector.

10

Introduction

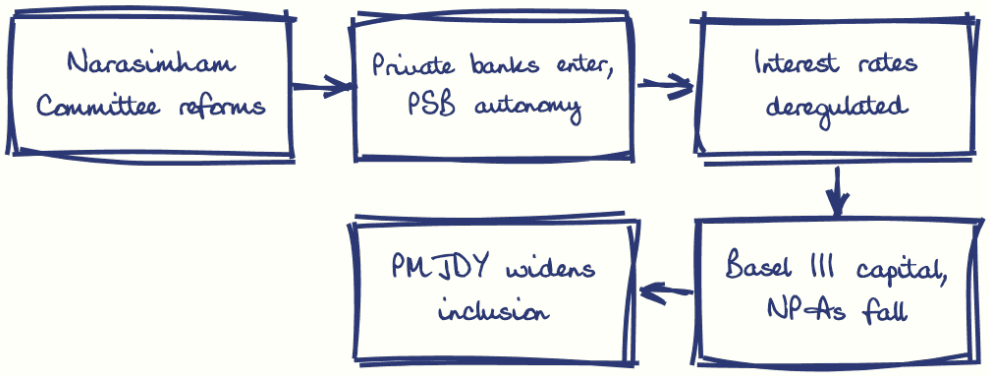
Banking sector reforms since the liberalisation of 1991 have shaped India's economic path. Driven by the need for efficiency, competitiveness and stability, RBI and the government focused on deregulation, autonomy and technology, making banks a key enabler of inclusive growth, including in Andhra Pradesh.

Key Reforms

1. Liberalised ownership: The Narasimham Committee recommendations allowed private and foreign banks such as ICICI and HDFC, fostering competition.
2. Autonomy to PSBs: Public sector banks gained operational freedom within RBI's framework to compete in a market-driven environment.
3. Interest rate deregulation: Deposit and lending rates were freed, improving resource allocation and customer choice, the shift from BPLR to the base rate system improved transparency. Rates became market-driven rather than set by RBI.
4. Cooperative bank reform: RBI resumed 'on tap' licensing for Urban Co-operative Banks and tightened prudential norms. This is crucial for rural and semi-urban credit in Andhra

Pradesh's farm sector.

How reforms reshaped banking



Impact on Operations and Stability

1. Capital and asset quality: Basel III norms and RBI oversight raised CRAR, while gross NPAs fell from 11.2% to 2.3%, strengthening financial stability.

2. Technology: The Committee on Computerisation in Banks drove automation and digital banking, improving efficiency and customer experience, leveraged in Andhra Pradesh's digital financial inclusion.

3. Governance: The Indradhanush framework improved accountability and risk control, reducing political interference. PSB performance metrics improved.

4. Financial inclusion: PMJDY expanded banking access to millions, including in Andhra Pradesh,

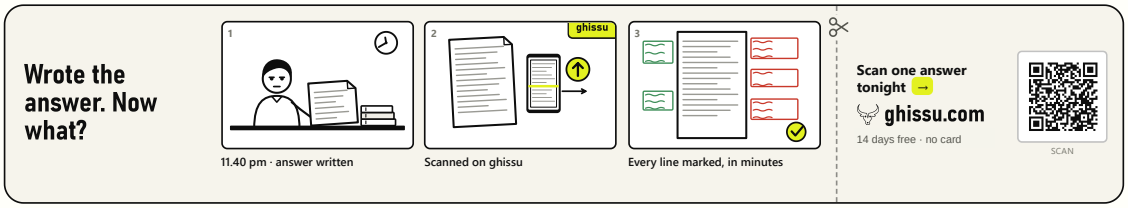
promoting savings and credit for marginalised groups. Banking reached far beyond its limited pre-reform base.

Wider Economic Impact

1. Investment and growth: Reforms mobilised savings, and better credit to industry and MSMEs supports projects like the Visakhapatnam-Chennai industrial corridor in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Jobs: Credit to agriculture and MSMEs creates employment in Rayalaseema and coastal Andhra.
3. Fiscal health: Healthier banks reduce the recapitalisation burden and raise investor confidence, aiding capital markets and ease of doing business.

Conclusion

By improving capital, governance and reach, reforms transformed a PSB-dominated, regulated system into a competitive, technology-driven and inclusive one, strengthening stability and making banking a catalyst for growth.



P-III
5(a)

Explain the pattern of revenue collection after economic reforms in India.

10

Introduction

The (1991) reforms of liberalisation, privatisation and global integration transformed India's revenue collection. By broadening the tax base and improving tax administration, they shaped the fiscal capacity of the Centre and of states like Andhra Pradesh, which face special post-bifurcation challenges.

Pattern of Revenue Collection After Reforms

1. **Shift to direct taxes:** The share of direct taxes rose from about (36%) in the 1980s to nearly (59%) of gross tax revenue by 2024–25, reflecting better compliance. Personal income tax has overtaken corporate tax.

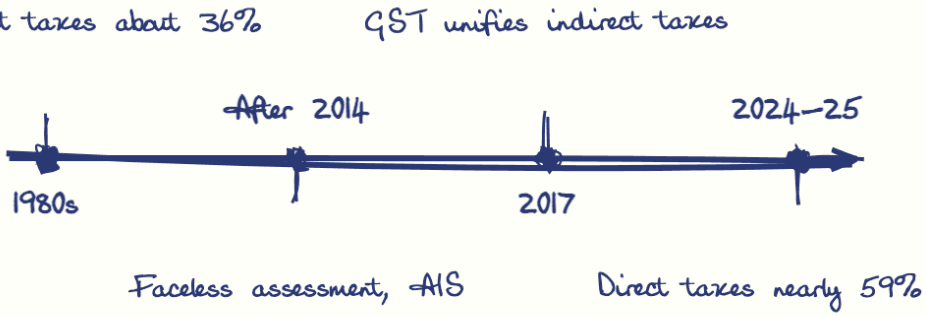
2. **GST:** Introduced in (2017), GST unified many indirect taxes into one destination-based tax. Monthly collections rose from 0.90 lakh crore in FY18 to 1.49 lakh crore in FY23, easing interstate trade.

3. **Digital administration:** After (2014), the Faceless Assessment Scheme and the Annual Information Statement improved transparency.

4. **State-level shortfalls:** Post-bifurcation Andhra

Pradesh faces revenue gaps. A CAG audit found a 1,806 crore impact from its tax and land departments in 2021–22.

Revenue collection after reforms



Factors Shaping the Pattern

1. Growth and formalisation: A larger formal sector and higher GDP growth widened the base, though informality and evasion persist and need continuous reform.
2. Tax rationalisation: Lower corporate rates and removal of Dividend Distribution Tax aided investment and compliance.
3. Technology: Data analytics reduced leakages, though underassessment and short levy persist in Andhra Pradesh's commercial taxes and registration departments.
4. Fiscal federalism: GST and Finance

Commission awards shape state revenue; Andhra Pradesh depends heavily on central transfers, and its mining revenue has lagged budget estimates.

Implications for Fiscal Health

1. More fiscal space: Buoyant taxes fund higher capital expenditure for infrastructure.
2. Persistent deficits: Many states, including Andhra Pradesh, still run revenue deficits due to expenditure pressures and revenue shortfalls, and borrow more.
3. Quality of spending: With a modest tax-to-GDP ratio, efficient collection must be matched by productive spending.
4. Administration: Outstanding audit objections and revenue leakages in Andhra Pradesh show the need for stronger tax administration and accountability.

Conclusion

Post-reform revenue has become more direct, digital and buoyant. Stronger state capacity and administration will make fiscal health sustainable.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
ghissu.com →

Write your own answer to 5(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

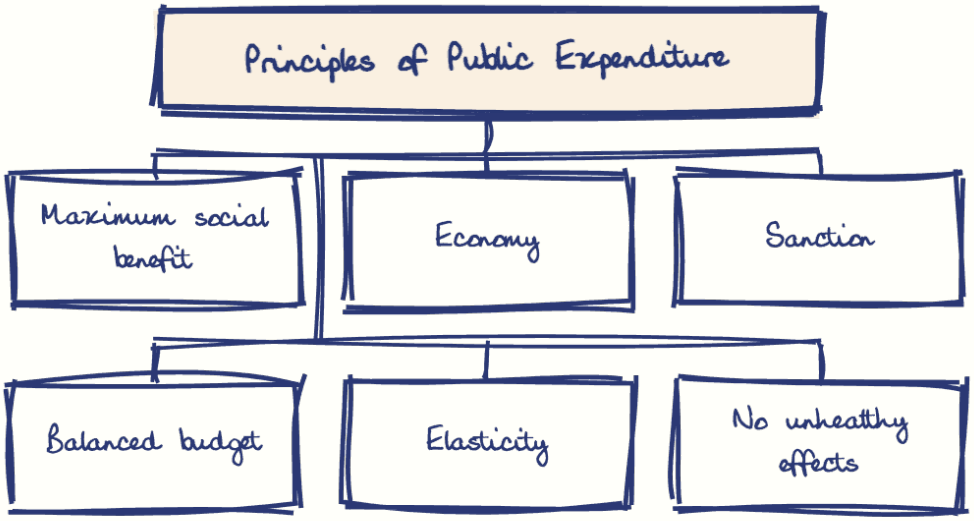
P-III
5(b)

Explain the principles of public expenditure.

10

Introduction

Public expenditure plays a crucial role in economic development and social welfare, especially in Andhra Pradesh where balanced regional growth and infrastructure are post-bifurcation priorities. Its principles guide governments to allocate resources efficiently, securing maximum social benefit while keeping fiscal discipline.



Core Principles of Public Expenditure

1. **Maximum Social Benefit:** Spending should secure the greatest social advantage, prioritising broad welfare gains such as Polavaram irrigation and healthcare infrastructure.

2. Principle of Economy: Governments must avoid wasteful and duplicate spending. The Andhra Pradesh CFMS audit revealed 968 crore in excess payments.

3. Principle of Sanction: All spending needs prior authorisation by a competent authority, a safeguard made critical by misappropriation reported in welfare schemes.

4. Balanced Budget: Avoiding persistent deficits is essential for fiscal sustainability, a challenge given the state's rising revenue deficit.

5. Elasticity: Expenditure must respond to changing needs, such as scaling up capital outlays for Visakhapatnam port-led industrial corridors, without financial breakdown.

6. No Unhealthy Economic Effects: Spending should not distort production or income distribution; subsidies must be targeted to avoid dependency.

Challenges in Andhra Pradesh

1. Revenue Skew: Capital expenditure was only 3.45% of total spending in 2022-23, far below the states' average, limiting asset creation.

Ensuring Social and Economic Impact

1. Social Overheads: Schools and hospitals are

critical for human development in lagging regions like Rayalaseema.

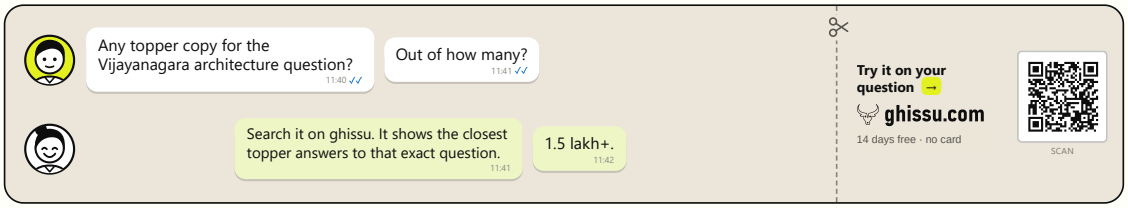
2. Balanced Regional Growth: Targeted grants for backward areas reduce disparities, a key concern after the loss of Hyderabad.

3. Agriculture and Industry: Spending on irrigation, power and agro-processing supports the agrarian economy, while industrial parks foster diversification and employment.

4. Sustainable Fiscal Practice: Managing debt and avoiding excessive freebies supports the goal of a 3.8% of GSDP fiscal deficit in 2026-27.

Conclusion

Stricter pre-sanction checks, better targeting through direct benefit transfers and a larger capital outlay will help Andhra Pradesh turn these principles into inclusive and sustainable growth.



P-III
6(a)

Why are Land Reforms implemented? What are the main laws pertaining to Land Reforms in Andhra Pradesh?

10

Introduction

Land reforms are a key policy tool to correct historical inequities in land ownership and promote inclusive agricultural growth. In Andhra Pradesh, where agriculture sustains much of rural life, they have reduced poverty and empowered Dalits and Adivasis through assignment lands and D Form pattas.

Why Land Reforms Are Implemented

1. Ending intermediaries: To abolish zamindars and give cultivators a direct relationship with the government.
2. Equity and social justice: To redistribute land to the landless and marginalised and cap concentration of holdings.
3. Poverty reduction: Land access gives the rural poor economic security and a stable livelihood.
4. Productivity: Secure tenure encourages investment and higher agricultural output.

Practice 6(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

Main Laws on Land Reforms in Andhra Pradesh

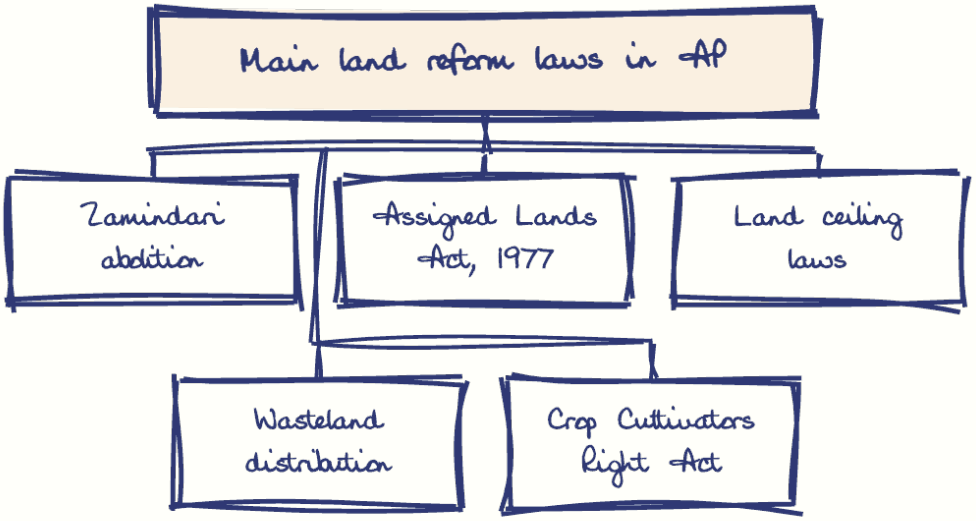
1. **Abolition of intermediaries:** Andhra Pradesh was among the first states to abolish zamindari after independence, transferring rights to tenants and cultivators.
2. **Assigned Lands Act, 1977:** The AP Assigned Lands (Prohibition of Transfers) Act protects land allotted to Dalits and other marginalised groups from transfer. Its 2023 amendment relaxed curbs, sparking controversy and corruption allegations.
3. **Land ceiling laws:** Maximum holdings are capped and surplus land redistributed to landless farmers.
4. **Wasteland distribution:** Poramboke and surplus government land is distributed as house sites or farmland to the rural poor.
5. **Tenancy laws:** Tenancy reforms and the Crop Cultivators Right Act protect cultivators, though weak land records limit enforcement.

Implementation Challenges

1. **Hurdles:** Litigation, bureaucratic delay and vested interests of landlords, moneylenders and traders blunt reforms.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin



2. Policy reversals: Allowing sale of assigned lands raises fears of erosion of Dalit land rights.

Way Forward

1. Safeguards and records: Protect assigned lands and modernise land records and dispute resolution.
2. Community role: Involve Dalits and Adivasis in monitoring distribution.

Conclusion

Land reforms in Andhra Pradesh have advanced social justice and agricultural development. Stronger safeguards and institutions can keep them central to poverty alleviation and inclusive growth.

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 6(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
6(b)

Explain the scope of Land Reforms in Andhra Pradesh and assess success in computerisation of Land Records.

10

Introduction

Land reforms and the computerisation of land records are central to farm productivity, secure land rights and better governance in Andhra Pradesh. Transparent, updated records are essential for credit access, dispute resolution and sustainable development, and the state's efforts reflect a push to modernise rural administration.

Scope of Land Reforms

1. Tribal land rights: Laws protect tribal land from alienation and have restored substantial land to tribal communities, advancing social equity.
2. Women's land rights: The state amended Hindu Succession Act provisions to strengthen women's inheritance, addressing gender disparity.
3. Ceiling and tenancy: Enforcement of land ceiling laws and tenancy regulation aims to redistribute land to small and marginal farmers.
4. Implementation limits: Loopholes, protracted litigation, administrative inertia and vested interests have limited results.

Assessment of Computerisation

1. **Progress:** Under the DILRMP, records have been computerised with online mutation and issuance of Record of Rights, improving transparency and access.
2. **Accuracy issues:** Incomplete, outdated cadastral maps and mismatches between textual and spatial records prevent conclusive titling and weaken reliability.
3. **Governance challenges:** Weak accountability and coordination slow progress, and audits show revenue losses and underutilised funds.
4. **Positive impact:** Faster service delivery and grievance redressal in Krishna and Kurnool show the potential.

Computerisation of land records

Gains	Gaps
Online mutation, Record of Rights	Outdated cadastral maps
Faster services in Krishna, Kurnool	Textual and spatial mismatches
More transparency	Revenue losses, unused funds

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

Overall Assessment

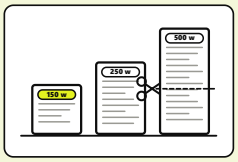
Computerisation has improved access and speed of services, but without accurate maps and integrated records it cannot yet deliver conclusive titles.

Way Forward

1. Survey and resurvey: Use modern technology to update and reconcile spatial and textual records.
2. Legal reform: Streamline registration and mutation laws for conclusive titling.
3. Single window: Integrate records across departments.
4. Accountability: Use monitoring and technology to curb corruption.

Conclusion

Land reforms have built a base for equitable rights, especially for tribals and women. Computerisation has made commendable but partial progress; accurate data and governance reform can realise Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 6(b) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
7(a)

How is Andhra Pradesh economy popularly classified? What are the relative shares of the three regions in the GSDP of Andhra Pradesh in the recent years?

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's economy is popularly classified in two ways: by three sectors (agriculture, industry, services) and by three regions (Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Uttarandhra). The regions contribute very unequal shares to the GSDP, which shapes the state's development planning.

Popular Classification

1. Three-sector model: The economy is divided into agriculture, industry and services. Services increasingly dominate GSDP through IT, trade and finance, while agriculture remains vital for employment and rural livelihoods.
2. State enterprises: (124) Special Purpose State Enterprises contribute about (6.69%) of GSDP, though governance and arrears issues persist.
3. Fiscal profile: A revenue deficit of Rs (43,487 crore) in 2024–25 coexists with steadily growing own tax revenue.
4. Three regions: Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Uttarandhra (North Andhra) each have distinct institutional setups that shape economic planning

Practice 7(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

and resource allocation.

Three regions of Andhra Pradesh



Coastal Andhra largest GSDP share, Rayalaseema smaller

Relative Regional Shares in GSDP

1. Coastal Andhra, largest share: Districts like Krishna and East Godavari lead, driven by fertile land, aquaculture and hubs such as Visakhapatnam port and the Visakhapatnam–Chennai industrial corridor.
2. Rayalaseema, smaller share: Drought-prone areas with lower irrigation coverage contribute less, reflecting agrarian distress and limited industrialisation.
3. Uttarandhra, moderate share: Srikakulam and Vizianagaram grow through minerals, ports and

emerging clusters, but lag Coastal Andhra in per capita income.

4. Spatial disparity: Coastal Andhra's density and infrastructure contrast with Rayalaseema's vulnerability.

Reasons for the Gap

1. Infrastructure gaps: Rayalaseema and parts of Uttarandhra lack irrigation, power and connectivity despite the long coastline.
2. Agriculture: Assured irrigation and diverse cropping in Coastal Andhra contrast with drought-constrained output in Rayalaseema.
3. Concentration: Industrial corridors and IT hubs cluster around Visakhapatnam, making job and income growth uneven.
4. Fiscal limits: High committed spending and revenue deficits restrict capital outlays on regional projects.

Conclusion

The economy is classified by sector and region, with Coastal Andhra dominating GSDP. Balanced regional development needs irrigation, transport and power, agro-industrial clusters and fiscal discipline in the lagging regions.

Write your own answer to 7(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
7(b)

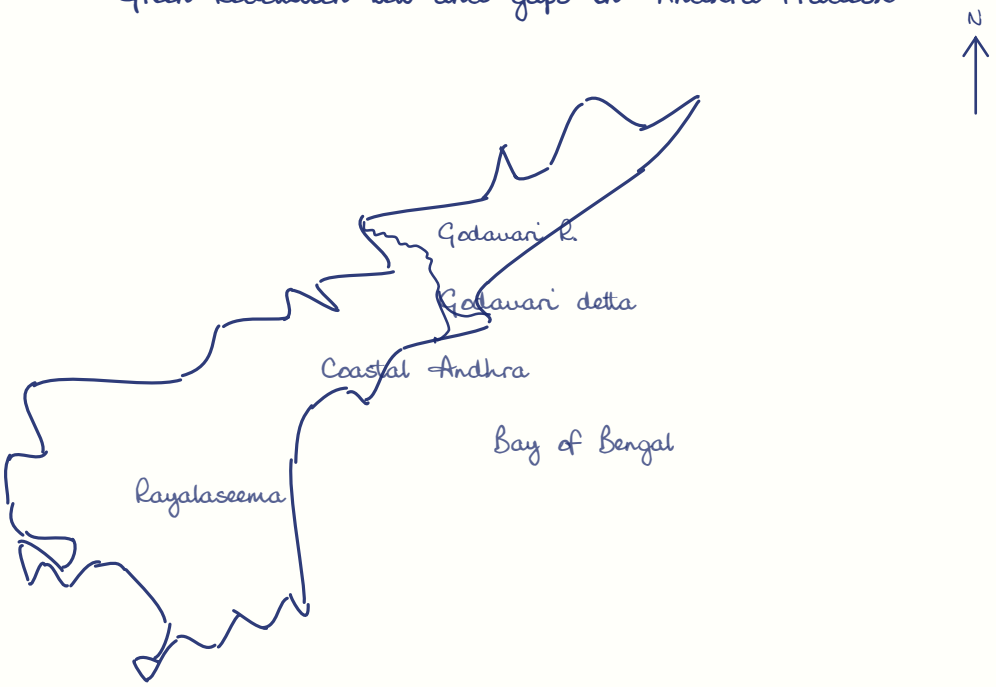
What is Green Revolution? What is its impact on the agricultural economy of Andhra Pradesh?

10

Introduction

The Green Revolution was a transformative phase in Indian agriculture during the 1960s and 1970s. It introduced high-yielding variety (HYV) seeds, chemical fertilizers and improved irrigation to boost foodgrain production. It was crucial for India's food security, enabling self-sufficiency in cereals amid a fast-growing population. In Andhra Pradesh it notably transformed rice production.

Green Revolution belt and gaps in Andhra Pradesh



Irrigated deltas gained most; dry Rayalaseema lagged

Spread in Andhra Pradesh

1. **Targeted irrigated zones:** It was implemented mainly in well-irrigated coastal districts like West Godavari, where assured water supply supported HYV rice, following the national focus on irrigated areas.
2. **Agricultural university and extension:** The Acharya N.G. Ranga Agricultural University led research and spread the new technology through farmer training and seed distribution.
3. **Credit and inputs:** Cooperative banks expanded access to fertilizers, pesticides and machinery, though smallholders often found them costly.
4. **Government programmes:** The Intensive Agriculture Development Programme (IADP) was piloted in districts of the state, laying the ground for the revolution's spread.

Impact on the Agricultural Economy

1. **Rice production and food security:** Rice yields rose significantly, raising food availability and rural incomes; agriculture still drives the state, with agricultural GVA growing 10.7% in 2024-25.
2. **Regional and social disparities:** Medium and large farmers in irrigated zones gained more, while small and marginal farmers in drought-prone

Rayalaseema struggled for inputs and credit, deepening agrarian inequality.

3. Environmental concerns: Intensive use of fertilizers and pesticides led to soil degradation and groundwater depletion, which the state now tackles through AP Community Managed Natural Farming (APCNF).
4. Market and infrastructure limits: Weak post-harvest storage and market access kept farmers from securing better prices.

Way Forward

1. Sustainable and resilient farming: Scale up APCNF and spread drought-resistant varieties suited to Rayalaseema.
2. Credit and infrastructure: Widen credit for small farmers and invest in cold storage and warehousing.

Conclusion

The Green Revolution raised productivity and food security in Andhra Pradesh's irrigated rice belt but revealed inequality and environmental strain. Integrating sustainable, inclusive practices, as envisaged in Swarna Andhra Vision 2047, will turn its gains into long-term prosperity.

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 7(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
8(a)

Examine the structure of occupations pursued by Andhra Pradesh people and the proportion of SC-ST population in the total population of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

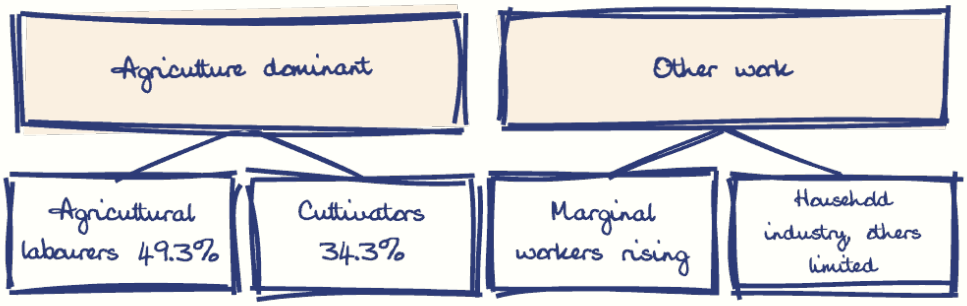
The occupational structure and social composition of Andhra Pradesh are key to its socio-economic dynamics. Agriculture and allied sectors still employ a large share of people, so development depends on reducing occupational disparities and including Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST). The 2001 Census and later surveys show this pattern.

Occupational Structure

1. **Agriculture dominant:** Cultivators and agricultural labourers form the bulk of workers. Among STs, 49.3 percent are agricultural labourers and 34.3 percent cultivators, showing heavy primary-sector dependence.
2. **Rise of marginal work:** Main workers have declined and marginal workers have risen to 20.7 percent, signalling underemployment and seasonal work.
3. **Limited diversification:** Household industries and other sectors employ only about 16.5 percent combined, limiting resilience and mobility.

4. Gender participation: ST work participation is fairly balanced, 55.7 percent for males and 52 percent for females, though women are concentrated in low-paid informal work.

Occupational structure of STs



Proportion of SC-ST Population

1. Scheduled Tribes: STs form about 6.6 percent of the population as per the 2001 Census, over 5 million people. Khammam, Visakhapatnam, Warangal, Adilabad and Nalgonda hold nearly half of them.

2. Scheduled Castes: The state has a substantial SC population, a critical part of its social fabric. Nationally, SCs are progressing in professional jobs but rarely reach higher managerial posts.

3. ST characteristics: STs have a sex ratio of 972 females per 1000 males and lower literacy, and speak Dravidian, Indo-European and

Austric languages.

Implications

1. Economic vulnerability: Dependence on farm and marginal work exposes SC–ST groups to seasonal unemployment and low wages.
2. Few skilled jobs: Educational gaps, social discrimination and weak vocational training keep them underrepresented in skilled and formal jobs.
3. Regional and gender barriers: Tribal agency areas lack markets and services, and SC–ST women face double discrimination, which Mission Shakti seeks to address.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's workforce is farm-dependent, and SC–ST groups are concentrated in its weakest segments. Education, skills and Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 must target these inequalities.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

Examiners read hundreds of answers a day. The one with a number, a committee and a case is the one they remember.

ghissu

ghissu gives you the data point, the report and the example for every question — each linked to its source.

Get the value adds for any question →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
8(b)

Write notes on : (i) Measures taken by the Andhra Pradesh government to empower women. (ii) Infant Mortality and Death rates in Andhra Pradesh in the recent decade.

10

Introduction

Women's empowerment and infant mortality are critical indicators of social development and human capital. In Andhra Pradesh both have gained renewed focus amid rapid economic growth and demographic change, in line with the goals of inclusive and sustainable development.

(i) Measures Taken to Empower Women

1. **Mission Shakti:** The flagship Mission Shakti empowers women through self-help groups, skill development and financial inclusion, fostering economic independence.

2. **Health institutions:** The Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust and AP Vaidya Vidhana Parishad widen access to maternal and child health services.

3. **Education and nutrition:** The ICDS scheme and Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan improve female literacy and nutrition, the base of empowerment.

4. **Social protection:** Stronger legal frameworks and the NTR Bharosa pension provide financial

Practice 8(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

security against socio-economic vulnerability.

(ii) Infant Mortality and Death Rates in the Recent Decade

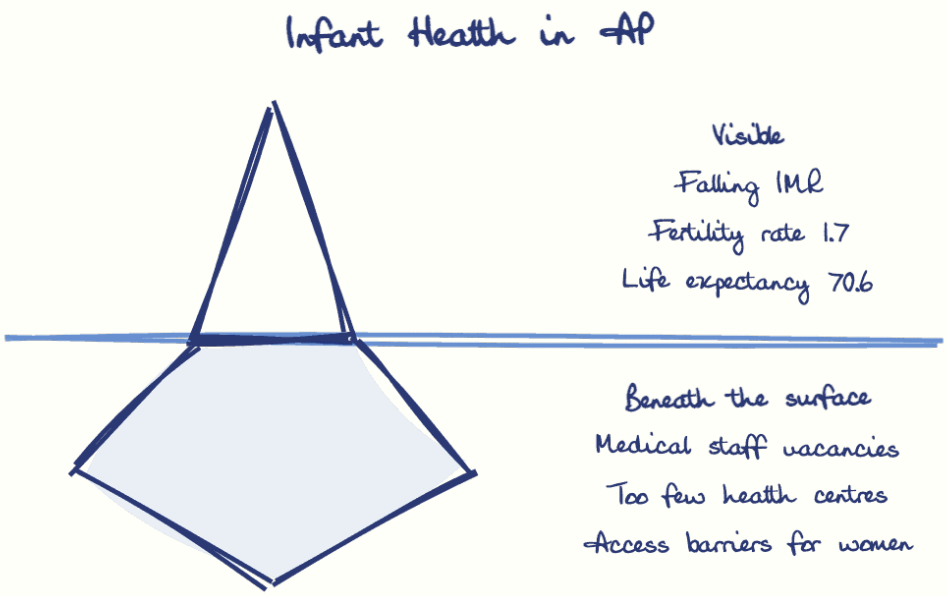
1. **Falling IMR:** Infant mortality has declined over the past decade, supported by more institutional deliveries under Janani Suraksha Yojana, though rural disparities remain.
2. **Wider health gains:** The total fertility rate is (1.7), below the national (2.1), and life expectancy at birth is (70.6) years, slightly above the national average.
3. **Resource gaps:** The CAG (2024) report found major medical staff vacancies and inadequate community health centres, limiting the delivery of maternal and infant care.
4. **Access barriers:** Two-thirds of women report difficulty accessing care due to financial and logistical constraints, which slows further gains in rural and underserved areas.

Way Forward

1. **Health workforce:** Address high vacancy rates by incentivising rural postings and expanding training to improve maternal and infant care.
2. **Nutritional support:** Scale up nutrition for

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin



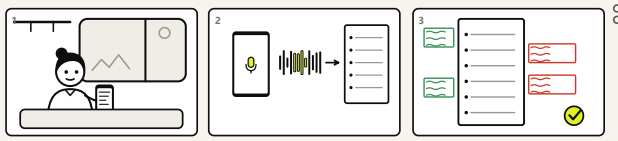
addescent girls and pregnant women to reduce anaemia and improve birth outcomes.

3. Monitoring: Robust tracking of welfare funds and scheme delivery to reduce administrative lapses so benefits reach women.

Conclusion

AP's mix of health, education and welfare schemes has advanced women's empowerment and reduced infant mortality. Closing staffing and access gaps will sustain these gains towards SDG (3) and SDG (5).

Ten minutes is enough.



Speak one outline today →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
9(a)

What are the direct and indirect taxes levied by the government of Andhra Pradesh?

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh projects GSDP growth of 12% for 2026–27, and taxation forms the backbone of its own revenue. It finances welfare such as the NTR Bharosa pension and Annadata Sukhibhava. The state's direct and indirect taxes reveal its fiscal strategy.

Direct Taxes

1. Property tax: A major source for local bodies and Panchayats under the AP Panchayat Act, 1994, paid directly by owners. It funds urban and rural infrastructure.
2. Profession tax: Levied on trades, professions and callings, capturing non-agricultural income. It is revised periodically with economic conditions.
3. Land revenue and stamp duty: Paid by landowners and buyers, drawing revenue from real estate. They also help regulate land use.
4. Collection gaps: A CAG audit found a Rs 1,806 crore revenue impact from underassessment in tax and land departments.

Indirect Taxes

1. **SGST:** Collected on intra-state supply of goods and services, the major source, replacing VAT, entry tax and entertainment tax. It is paid by consumers through the supply chain.

2. **Entry tax:** The AP Tax on Entry of Goods into Local Areas Act, 2001 was repealed after GST, though some entry levies remain under local laws.

3. **Entertainment and luxury taxes:** Levied on cinema, events and luxury services, now largely subsumed or reduced under GST. Their revenue share has shrunk.

4. **Vehicle and toll taxes:** Vehicle entry fees and tolls on roads and bridges, paid by road users, fund transport infrastructure such as the Visakhapatnam–Chennai industrial corridor.

Taxes levied in Andhra Pradesh



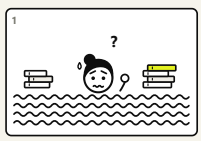
Way Forward

1. Compliance: Stronger audits and digital platforms like e-Seva.
2. Wider base: Better property records in Amaravati and Visakhapatnam.
3. GST efficiency: Coordinate with the Centre and use technology against evasion.
4. Capital spending: Balance revenue growth with prudent fiscal management to revive capital expenditure, which has declined sharply.

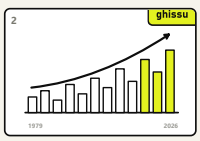
Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's tax structure is pivotal for fiscal sustainability. Plugging leakages like those the CAG found, digital compliance through e-Seva and a wider property tax base in growing cities will raise revenue without new taxes. This will fund inclusive welfare and infrastructure, in line with Viksit Bharat @2047.

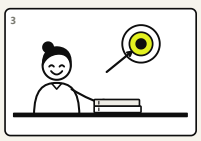
You have a feeling. The examiner has a pattern.



Reading the whole ocean



ghissu reads decades of papers



You prepare what's coming

Find your next sub-topic →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
9(b)

Write notes on : (i) Debt composition of Andhra Pradesh government (ii) Tax revenue and other resource inflows into Andhra Pradesh government from the Central government.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's fiscal health is critical for growth and social development, especially after the 2014 bifurcation created unique financial strains. Its debt composition and the inflows of tax and other resources from the Centre show its fiscal sustainability and capacity to fund development.

(i) Debt Composition

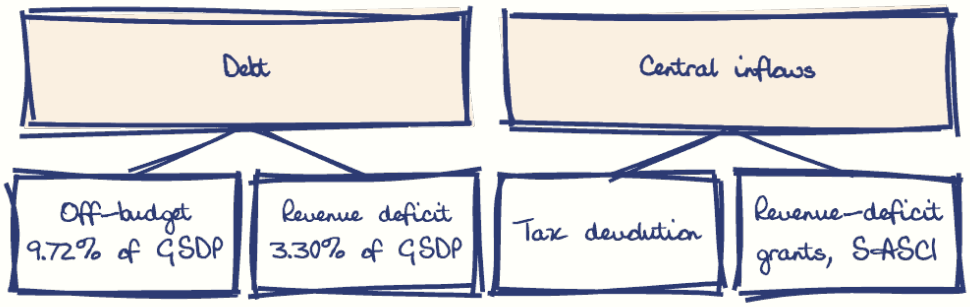
1. **High outstanding liabilities:** On 31 March 2023 total liabilities, including off-budget borrowing, stood at Rs 5,79,621 crore, or 43.99% of GSDP.
2. **Off-budget borrowings:** These were Rs 1,28,048 crore, or 9.72% of GSDP, a non-transparent risk to debt sustainability. They escape fiscal discipline.
3. **Low capital expenditure:** Capex was only 3.45% of total expenditure in 2023-24, against a states' average of 13.48%, limiting asset creation.
4. **Revenue deficit:** A deficit of 3.30% of GSDP

means borrowing funds consumption rather than investment.

(ii) Tax Revenue Inflows from the Centre

1. Tax devolution: The Finance Commission's devolution of central taxes is a crucial part of revenue receipts. It helps bridge post-bifurcation gaps.
2. Own tax growth: Own tax revenue grew about 6% a year between 2018-19 and 2022-23, its share in total tax revenue rose from 64% to 67%.
3. Administration gaps: A CAG audit found Rs 1,806 crore revenue impact from underassessment, Rs 2,772 crore of audit observations remain.

Andhra Pradesh's debt and central inflows



Other Resource Inflows

1. Grants and special assistance: Revenue-deficit

grants and special schemes offset Hyderabad's loss and fund Polavaram.

2. Capex incentive: The Scheme for Special Assistance to States rewards capital spending, though actual capex lags.
3. Sectoral funds: Central funds support education, health and urban development.
4. Utilisation gaps: Low capex outturn and audit findings weaken their impact.

Way Forward

1. Debt transparency: Monitor off-budget borrowing.
2. Tax administration: Resolve audit observations.
3. Capital spending: Improve project execution and use central incentives to build infrastructure for long-term growth.

Conclusion

Heavy debt and weak capital spending make central inflows vital. Transparency, tax efficiency and better use of grants are key to sustainability.



Improving — or just writing more?

My answers

Every attempt, every score, every enhanced version of your answer — on one timeline.

Watch your curve →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
10(a)

Explain the pattern of resource mobilisation for the public sector in the 5-Year Plans of Andhra Pradesh in the recent decade.

10

Introduction

The pattern of resource mobilisation for Andhra Pradesh's public sector in its Plans reflects its development path amid the 2014 bifurcation and the loss of Hyderabad. Its fiscal health, sectoral priorities and revenue streams show how internal and external finance shape public investment.

Sources and Trends

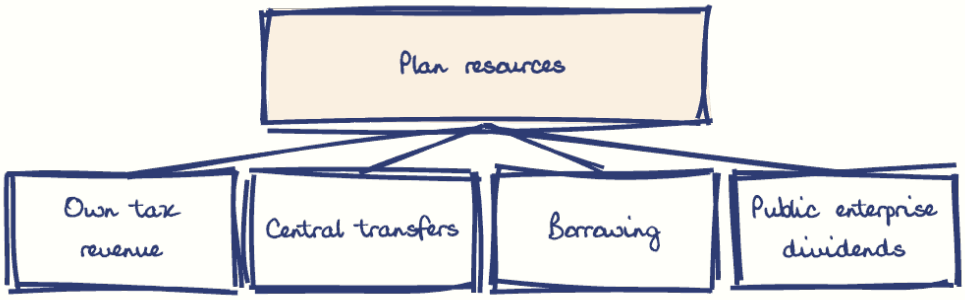
1. **Diverse revenue streams:** Own tax revenue grew at about 6% a year between 2018–19 and 2022–23, while central transfers reached Rs 89,157 crore, a balance of internal and external sources. Non-tax revenue adds a smaller share.
2. **Borrowing and deficits:** The fiscal deficit is targeted at 4.4% of GSDP for 2025–26, but committed spending of about 51% of revenue expenditure limits new investment.
3. **Public enterprises:** Dividends and taxes from state enterprises supplement budgets, echoing CPSE gains in the Tenth Plan. These flows are not yet optimised.

Practice 10(a) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Projects and welfare: The Polavaram project and the NTR Bharosa pension steer funds to agriculture and social infrastructure.

Resources for the public sector



Allocation within the Public Sector

1. Capital spending: Capex in social and economic services fell over 60% cumulatively since 2018–19, though 2025–26 estimates aim to raise it. Resources raised were absorbed by revenue needs.
2. Priority sectors: Agriculture grew 10.7% in 2024–25 with Annadatta Sukhibhava, while the CAG flagged health gaps.
3. Revenue versus capital: Salaries, pensions and subsidies push the state to borrow and seek central aid. Too little reaches investment.
4. Decentralised delivery: Samagra Shiksha and e-Seva improve efficiency. They align

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

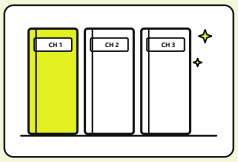
spending with plan objectives.

Notable Shifts

1. Post-bifurcation realignment: The state raised own tax collections and sought central transfers, including Special Category Status. This offset the loss of Hyderabad's revenue base.
2. Rising own revenue: Efforts to widen the tax base and improve compliance increased its share. CAG audits on tax and land revenue still show gaps.
3. Welfare orientation: Funds increasingly flow to welfare such as the NTR Bharosa pension and to agriculture through Annadatta Sukhibhava.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh mobilises resources from own taxes, transfers, borrowing and enterprises. Committed spending squeezes capital investment, so better tax effort and spending quality are vital.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
10(b)

What are the total outlays of Andhra Pradesh's X and XI 5-Year Plans? What proportion of the outlay is allocated to agriculture including irrigation?

10

Introduction

Plan allocations reflect a state's development priorities. In Andhra Pradesh, agriculture is critical for rural employment and food security, so the total outlays of the X and XI Plans and the share for agriculture and irrigation show its commitment to agrarian growth amid water scarcity.

Total Outlays of the X and XI Plans

1. X Plan: The national outlay was about Rs 15.25 lakh crore, with Andhra Pradesh's share aligned with its economic size and needs. The rise from the X to the XI Plan mirrored the state's expanding fiscal capacity.
2. XI Plan: Outlays nearly doubled to Rs 36.44 lakh crore nationally. The state's share rose with better resource mobilisation and projects like Polavaram.
3. Fiscal constraints: A high revenue deficit, highlighted by the CAG report on state finances, limited use of plan funds in

capital-heavy sectors like irrigation. Recent budgets with projected GSDP growth of 12-14% build on this base.

Share for Agriculture and Irrigation

1. **Around one-fifth:** Allocations hovered between 20-24%, with about 20% in the X Plan and 18.5% in the XI Plan.
2. **Allied activities:** Outlays covered rural development and special area programmes; the XI Plan gave Rs 6.74 lakh crore to agriculture and allied sectors.
3. **Falling irrigation share:** Irrigation fell to around 6% of outlay in the X Plan, a concern for drought-prone Rayalaseema.
4. **State focus:** Polavaram and the Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme back irrigation, though fiscal pressure limits its share.

X and XI Plans at a glance

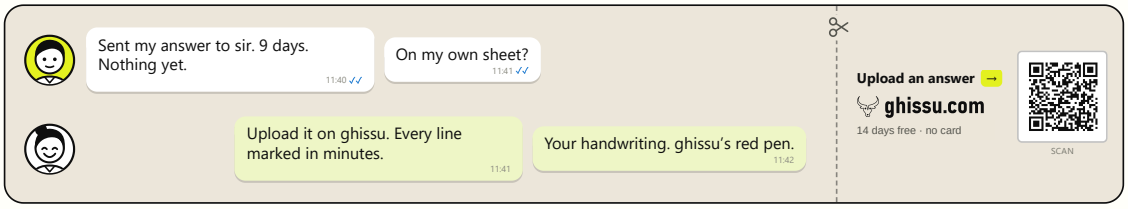
X Plan	XI Plan
Rs 15.25 lakh crore nationally	Rs 36.44 lakh crore
Agriculture about 20%	Agriculture 18.5%
State share matched its size	State share rose, Polavaram

Way Forward

1. More for irrigation: Raise the irrigation share using central schemes and PPPs to tackle water scarcity.
2. Allied integration: Link agriculture with rural development and allied activities through targeted budget support.
3. Fiscal discipline: Cut revenue deficits to free capital funds for irrigation.
4. Technology: Modern irrigation and organic farming, as the Tenth Plan encouraged.

Conclusion

Outlays rose sharply from the X to the X1 Plan, with about 20% for agriculture and irrigation. Falling irrigation investment and fiscal stress must be corrected for sustainable agrarian growth.



P-III
11(a)

Examine the growth and structure of industries in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's industrial sector has transformed significantly since bifurcation in 2014, driven by focused policy and infrastructure development. Industrial growth is pivotal for the state's economic advancement and jobs, so its trends and structure reveal both competitiveness and challenges.

Growth Trends

1. **Robust GSDP growth:** Industry contributed to the state's GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, supported by Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.
2. **Export expansion:** Exports exceeded US$19 billion in FY22, led by seafood, iron and engineering goods, aided by district export promotion zones and capacity-building workshops.
3. **FDI and business climate:** FDI has risen, but gaps in power supply and internet coverage limit export and investment potential.
4. **Sectoral variations:** Engineering and agro-based manufacturing grow steadily, while technology and service industries emerge with knowledge-intensive jobs, supported by ISRO's Sriharikota facility.

Structure of Industries

1. Agro-based dominance: Agro-processing remains the backbone, the long coastline supports fisheries and aquacutture, and East Godavari and Krishna excel in rice milling and coconut products.
2. Diversified manufacturing: Labour-intensive textiles and apparel coexist with capital-intensive minerals and heavy engineering, though infrastructure, R&D and pollution contrd lag.
3. Knowledge industries: ICT exports and startups are growing with public spending on technical education, but private R&D remains low.
4. Public enterprises: 124 SPSEs contribute 6.69% of GSDP, but arrears and governance issues weaken them.

Structural Challenges

Agro-based units face seasonal risk and little value addition, manufacturing faces infrastructure, pollution and logistics gaps, technology firms face low private R&D, skill gaps and limited incubation.

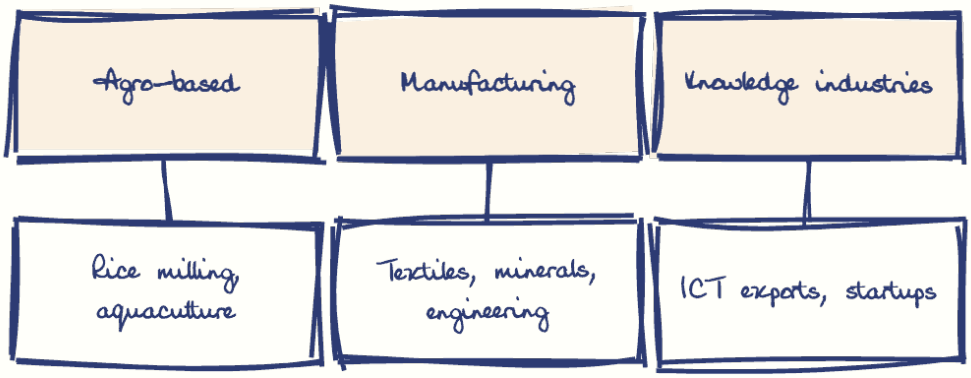
Way Forward

1. Infrastructure: Reliable power, digital connectivity and logistics.

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

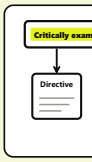
Structure of industry in AP



2. R&D and innovation: More funding and stronger incubation centres.
3. Agro-industrial linkages: Value addition to reduce seasonal risk and raise export quality.
4. SPSE reform: Governance reform and financial restructuring to improve efficiency.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's industry shows strong exports and diversification across agro-based, manufacturing and technology sectors. Fixing infrastructure, boosting innovation and reforming SPSEs are key to sustainable, inclusive growth.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

Write your own answer to 11(a) and get it evaluated →

Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed

ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
11(b)

Explain the significance of SSI in the development of Andhra Pradesh and mention the incentives extended by the government to this sector.

10

Introduction

Small Scale Industries (SSI) play a crucial role in Andhra Pradesh by fostering inclusive growth, employment and regional industrialisation. With GSDP growing at 9.24% in 2024–25, SSIs diversify the industrial base and sustain rural and semi-urban economies, and targeted incentives aim to keep them competitive.

Significance of SSI

1. Employment generation: SSIs create jobs in rural and semi-urban areas, making growth inclusive and reducing pressure on farm incomes.
2. Regional industrialisation: They spread industry beyond big centres and support balanced socio-economic progress.
3. Industrial diversification: They widen the state's industrial base and reduce dependence on a few large units.
4. Technology and innovation: Incubation centres and funds for high-tech SSIs help technocrat entrepreneurs in biotechnology and IT.

Government Incentives and Support

1. **Credit support:** Interest subsidy schemes and low-cost credit through SIDBI's SME Fund, along with concessional loans and credit guarantees, ease collateral and working capital shortages.
2. **Tax and duty relief:** Excise exemptions and waivers on electricity and stamp duty lower operational costs.
3. **Infrastructure support:** Incubation centres provide infrastructure and technical consultancy to SSIs.
4. **Regulatory simplification:** Unified acts and fewer inspector visits free SSIs from Inspector Raj.
5. **Revival of sick units:** The ~~S-AM-ADH-AN~~ scheme gives one-time settlement and an exit route.
6. **Market linkages:** The state aims to revive price preference and link SSIs with large industries.

Incentives for SSIs



Implementation Gaps

1. Credit access: Delays and collateral demands persist despite the SME Fund.
2. Delayed payments: Weak enforcement of the Delayed Payments Act causes cash-flow stress.
3. Market constraints: Poor infrastructure and withdrawal of price preference hurt competitiveness, especially in urban markets.
4. Sick units: SAMADHAN's uptake in the state still needs strengthening.

Conclusion

SSIs are a cornerstone of Andhra Pradesh's industrial and employment landscape, driving inclusive and sustainable growth. Incentives that address financial, regulatory and infrastructural gaps are pivotal, and strengthening them will help realise Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 and advance SDG 8 on decent work.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

14 days free · no card

SCAN

P-III
12(a)

Briefly explain the need for administering agricultural commodity prices and mention the administering machinery.

10

Introduction

Administering agricultural commodity prices is crucial to protect farmers from volatile markets and to ensure food security. Agriculture employs a large share of the workforce, and stable, remunerative prices encourage farmers to invest and adopt modern technology. In Andhra Pradesh, where chillies, horticulture and aquaculture dominate, price administration eases distress from unpredictable markets and climate.

Need for Price Administration

1. **Shield against volatility:** Price support protects farmers from distress sales caused by market swings and climatic shocks.
2. **Food security:** Assured prices sustain production of essential commodities for the population.
3. **Guiding cropping choices:** A minimum remunerative price influences cropping patterns and encourages investment in production.

Administering Machinery

1. **Legal foundations:** The Essential Commodities Act,

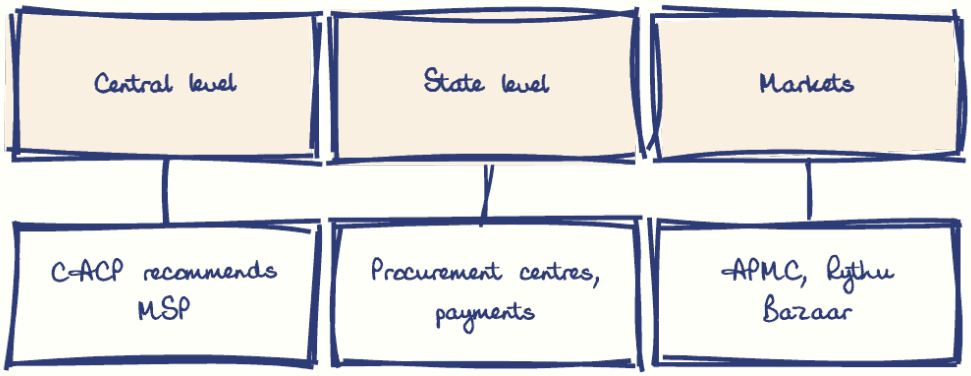
1955 and state APMC Acts provide the statutory basis to regulate procurement, storage and movement of commodities.

2. CACP and MSP: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends Minimum Support Prices for 23 commodities, based on production costs, demand–supply and market trends.

3. State-level administration: State governments, including Andhra Pradesh, run procurement centres, storage facilities and payments to farmers.

4. Regulated markets and reforms: APMC markets curb exploitative middlemen and improve price discovery, while Rythu Bazaar lets farmers sell directly to consumers.

Price administering machinery



Challenges

1. Low awareness: Few farmers know the MSP before

sowing, limiting its effect on crop choices.

2. Infrastructure deficits: Poor storage in areas like the Rayalaseema drought belt forces sales at low prices after harvest.
3. Middlemen influence: Private traders and commission agents still capture a large share of the consumer price.
4. Delayed payments: Irregular procurement centres and late payments discourage farmers from government procurement.

Way Forward

1. Awareness and storage: Spread MSP information through digital platforms and build scientific storage and cold chains.
2. Markets and technology: Scale up Rythu Bazaar and Farmer Producer Organisations, and integrate e-NAM with local procurement.

Conclusion

A robust price machinery safeguards farm incomes and food security. Linking it with PM-AASHA and digital procurement will build resilient agriculture in Andhra Pradesh.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
ghissu.com →

P-III
12(b)

Explain the basic features of Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS) and its performance in the state.

10

Introduction

The Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS) is central to India's food security, providing subsidised grains to vulnerable people. The National Food Security Act (2013) made it a legal entitlement for nearly two-thirds of the population. Its performance matters for states like Andhra Pradesh where disparities persist.

Basic Features of TPDS

1. Shared Centre–State roles: In a cooperative federal design, the Centre procures grain at MSP and allocates it, while states identify beneficiaries and distribute through Fair Price Shops, tailoring delivery to local priorities.
2. Targeting mechanism: BPL and Antyodaya Anna Yojana households are prioritised, but studies show about (61%) exclusion and (25%) inclusion errors.
3. Legal backing: NFSA makes the right to food justiciable, and AP has digitised ration cards and adopted biometric authentication.

4. State adaptations: Tamil Nadu runs a Universal PDS to avoid exclusion errors, while AP uses computerisation and smart cards for transparency.

Performance in Andhra Pradesh

1. Leakages: Diversion of grain to the open market, estimated at up to 20%, reduces supply to intended beneficiaries and raises the fiscal burden.
2. Storage and quality: The CAG has flagged inadequate storage and grain spoilage, and AP audits note inefficient fund use and supply chain management.
3. Targeting errors: Socio-political pressures cause misclassification, and without periodic review bogus and duplicate cards remain a concern.
4. Technology reforms: GPS tracking of transport, SMS monitoring and online grievance portals have improved transparency, though holistic monitoring is still needed to stop leakages fully.

Way Forward

1. Identification: Periodic Aadhaar-based biometric verification to remove bogus and duplicate cards.

TPDS in AP: Problems and Fixes

Problem	Reform
Up to 20% grain diverted	GPS tracking of trucks
Bogus, duplicate cards	Computerised smart cards
Complaints unheard	SMS monitoring, online portals

2. Storage: Modern covered storage to cut spoilage, as CAG audits urge.
3. Supply chain: End-to-end computerisation and GPS tracking in all districts.
4. Alternatives: Pilot cash transfers or food coupons in select districts.

Conclusion

TPDS remains a cornerstone of food security. Despite leakages and targeting errors, technology-led reforms are improving AP's performance, advancing SDG ② of zero hunger.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

Add value to your next answer →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 12(b) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
13(a)

Examine the causes for regional disparities in Andhra Pradesh and measures initiated by the government to reduce the same.

10

Introduction

Regional disparities remain a critical challenge in Andhra Pradesh despite GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25 and a per capita income of Rs 2,68,653, above the national average. Telangana, Coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema differ sharply in development, infrastructure and resources, and these gaps threaten inclusive growth and social cohesion.

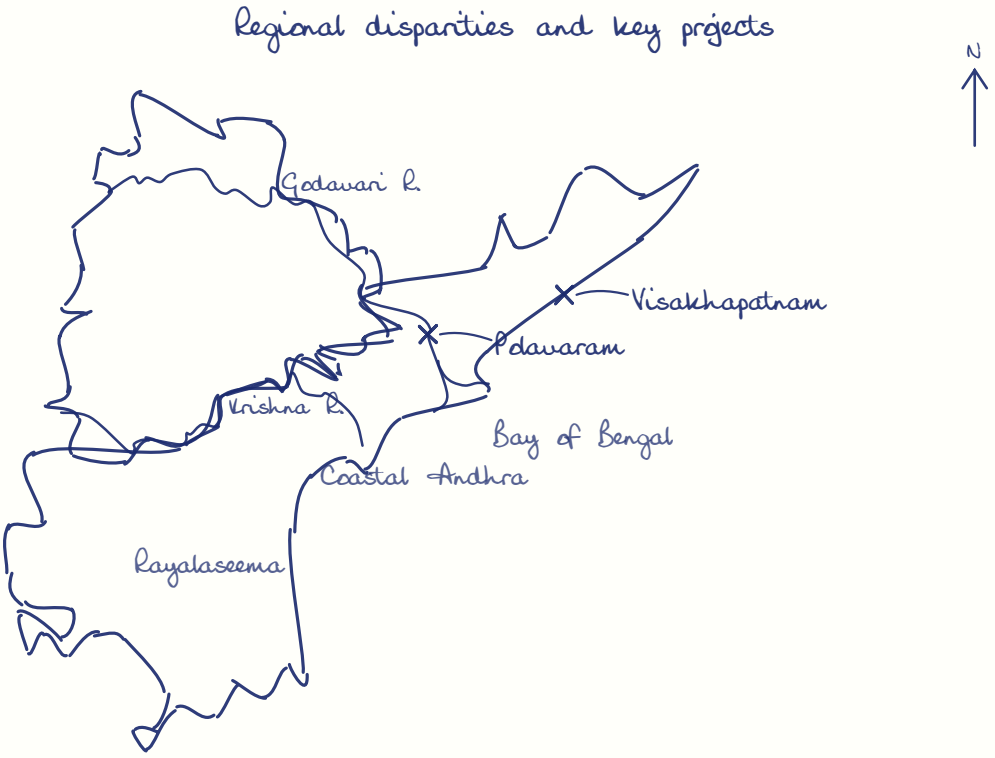
Causes of Regional Disparities

1. Geographical factors: Rayalaseema suffers chronic drought and water scarcity, while coastal Andhra benefits from the Krishna and Godavari basins.
2. Uneven infrastructure: Investment favoured Visakhapatnam and the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor, while Rayalaseema lags in transport, irrigation and health, as CAG (2024) noted.
3. Agricultural imbalance: The coast excels in aquaculture, horticulture and chillies; irrigation and subsidies historically favoured well-irrigated areas.
4. Fiscal and governance gaps: CAG (2025) found welfare fund diversion, and urban bodies in

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

backward districts lag in basic services.



River basins favour the coast, Rayalaseema drought-prone

Government Measures

1. Swarna Andhra Vision 2047: A long-term plan for balanced growth that targets backward regions in education, health and jobs.
2. Farm and welfare schemes: Annadatha Sukhibhava gives income support, the Crop Cultivators Right Act protects farmers, and APCNF natural farming addresses farm gaps.
3. Education: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and the ULLAS scheme improve educational outcomes in underdeveloped districts, building human capital.

How to use this book with ghissu.com
see page 4

Index · page 6

Practice 13(a) on Ghissu →
Andhra Pradesh and national value addition · quick outline practice · friends' and public answers
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

4. Irrigation and health: The Polavaram National Project seeks to ease water scarcity in Rayalaseema, while health and infrastructure allocations have risen, though still below targets.

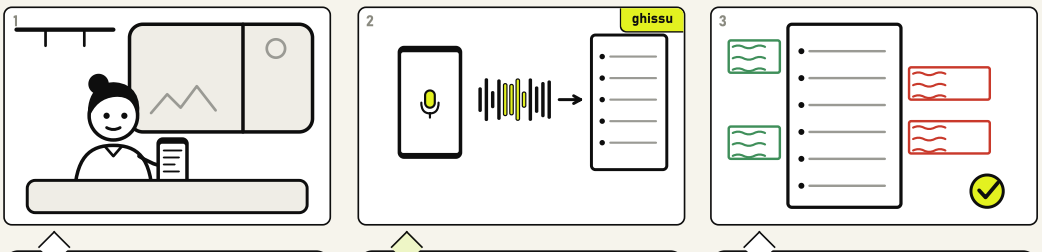
5. Local governance: Stronger local bodies in backward regions ensure better use of resources, and e-Seva improves transparency and access to services.

Conclusion

The measures are well designed, but APCNF faces implementation challenges and health allocations remain below targets. Stricter audits against fund diversion and integrated water management focused on Rayalaseema will help them narrow regional gaps and make growth inclusive.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW QUICK OUTLINE — TYPE, SPEAK OR SCAN

Practice on the bus



— An outline a day beats a full answer a week.

Try a quick outline →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
13(b)

Explain the causes for backwardness of certain regions and suggest measures for development.

10

Introduction

Regional backwardness remains a major obstacle to inclusive development, as disparities in income, infrastructure and human development persist across and within states. Historical, geographical and institutional factors hold certain areas back, which matters for harnessing the demographic dividend and achieving Viksit Bharat @2047.

Causes of Backwardness

1. Colonial legacy: The colonial focus on Bombay, Calcutta and Madras neglected interior regions, while the British land revenue system impoverished farmers and entrenched landlords.

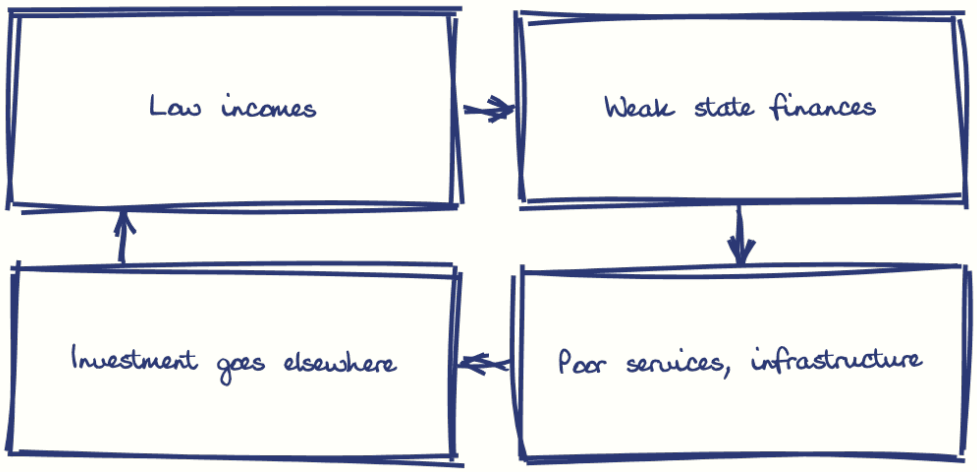
2. Geographical isolation: Himalayan districts and Rayalaseema face difficult terrain and poor connectivity, limiting access to markets, schools and hospitals; weak transport, irrigation and energy deter investment.

3. Socio-economic constraints: High population density on cultivable land, low literacy and limited urbanisation mark backward areas; the gap between coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema shows uneven

governance.

4. Weak fiscal capacity and market failure: Poor states cannot fund services, creating a vicious cycle, and liberalisation concentrated investment in developed regions.

Vicious Cycle of Backwardness



Measures for Development

1. Fiscal transfers: The Backward Regions Grant Fund and Finance Commission grants; AP's demand for Special Category Status reflects this need.
2. Infrastructure: Transport, irrigation like the Polavaram project and energy link backward regions to growth centres.
3. Local governance: Panchayati Raj, NREGA and the data-driven Aspirational Districts Programme improve health and education.

4. Private investment and skills: Incentives, subsidised land, interest-free loans and entrepreneurial training.

Way Forward

1. Block-level planning: Composite criteria to identify backward areas and tailor interventions.
2. Fiscal autonomy: Stronger state and local tax bases and better use of central transfers to fund infrastructure and services.
3. Digital infrastructure: Connectivity and formalisation of the economy to widen access to markets, education and government services.
4. Human development: Prioritise health, education and skills so that the demographic dividend becomes inclusive growth.

Conclusion

Backwardness stems from historical neglect, geography and weak institutions, so it needs a multifaceted response. Combining fiscal transfers, infrastructure, local governance and private investment can achieve Sabka Saath Sabka Vikas and SDG (8.)

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

ghissu
ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

P-III
14(a)

Examine the role of SHGs in Andhra Pradesh in meeting the credit requirements of rural people.

10

Introduction

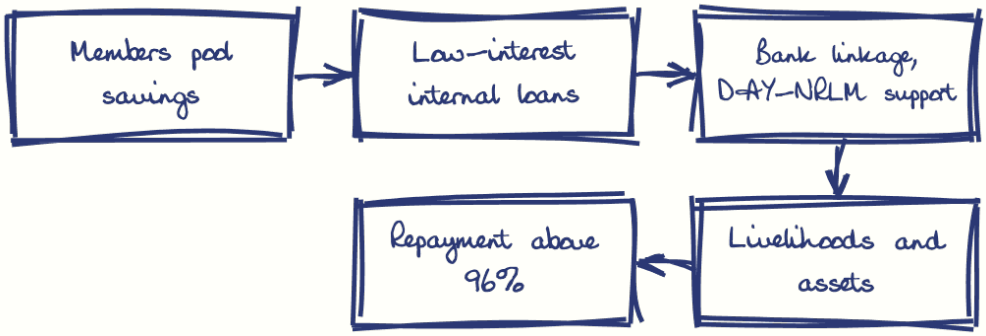
In Andhra Pradesh, rural livelihoods are largely agrarian and informal credit is often exploitative. Self-Help Groups (SHGs) have emerged as vital community institutions for financial inclusion and poverty alleviation, supported by state initiatives like Indira Kranthi Patham, which mobilises women into SHGs to access credit.

How SHGs Provide Rural Credit

1. Pooled savings: Members' savings create an internal fund lent at low interest, reducing dependence on moneylenders and building financial discipline.
2. Bank linkage: SHGs link rural borrowers to banks; AP has a significant share of bank-linked SHGs, and DAY-NRLM offers interest subvention to women's SHGs.
3. Capacity building: NABARD and SERP train members, and the e-Shakti project digitises SHG accounts for transparent bank appraisal.
4. State support: Podupu Lakshmi and Indira Kranthi Patham combine credit with livelihood,

health and education support.

How SHGs Deliver Rural Credit



Impact on Rural Credit and Livelihoods

1. Assets and income: Talluru village in East Godavari shows how SHG microfinance improved incomes, infrastructure and education.
2. Less informal borrowing: Repayment rates above 96% show credit discipline and trustworthiness.
3. Women's empowerment: Members gained self-esteem, social networks and political participation.
4. Access to schemes: SHGs channel welfare in health, education and social security.

Challenges

1. Infrastructure: Poor roads and unreliable power in remote areas limit expansion.
2. Capacity gaps: Uneven training leaves weak bookkeeping and financial literacy.

3. Social barriers: Patriarchy and caste discrimination can cause elite capture.

4. Market and technology access: Weak market links and digital tools push loans into low-return activities.

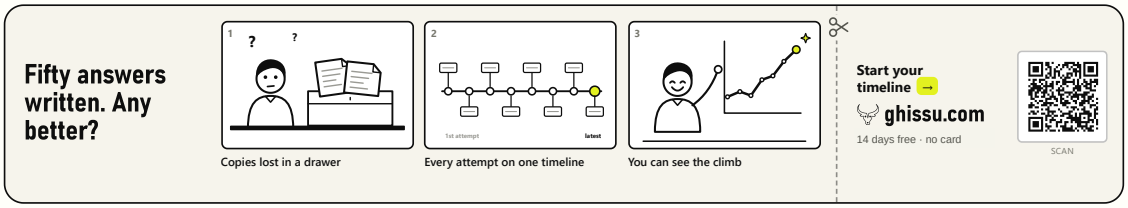
Way Forward

1. Larger, cheaper credit: Raise loan sizes in line with SHG grading and extend interest subvention.

2. Federations and market links: Strengthen village organisations and mandal samakhyas for bulk credit and marketing.

Conclusion

SHGs have become the backbone of rural credit in Andhra Pradesh. Stronger training, infrastructure and market access will help them meet rural credit needs more fully.



P-III
14(b)

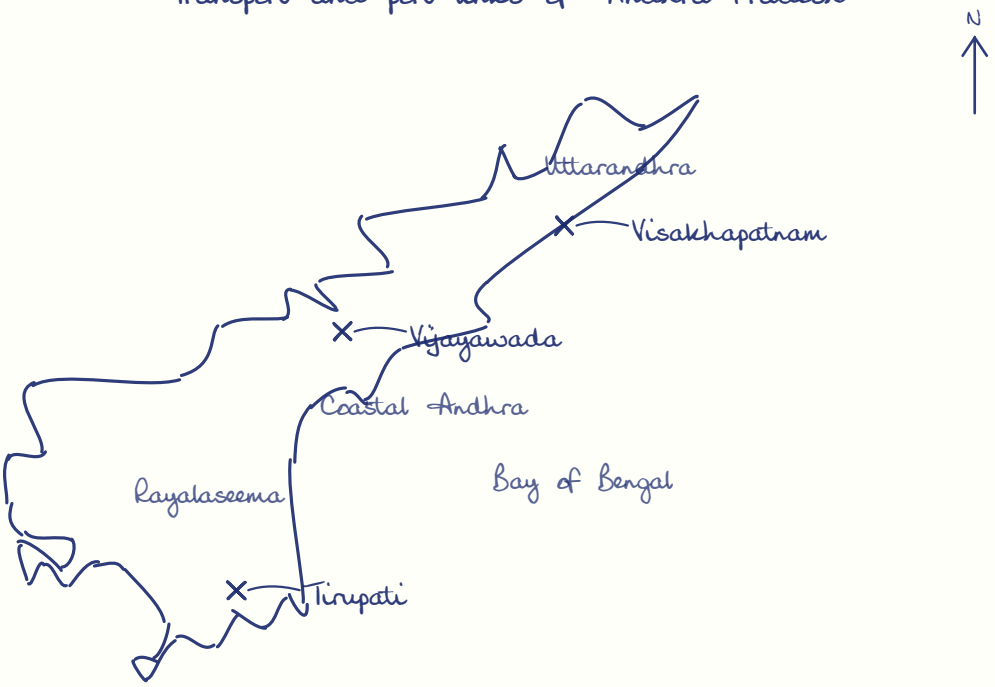
Examine the importance and development of transport and communication in the state of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Transport and communication are critical drivers of growth in Andhra Pradesh, a state ranging from a 974 km coastline to drought-prone Rayalaseema. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024-25, above the national average, efficient networks are essential to sustain momentum and ensure inclusive development amid regional and urban-rural divides.

Transport and port links of Andhra Pradesh



Importance for Andhra Pradesh

1. **Economic catalyst:** Networks move goods, services and people, raising trade, agricultural and industrial productivity.
2. **Regional integration:** They bridge gaps between coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Uttarandhra, widening access to markets, schools and hospitals.
3. **Key sectors:** Ports like Visakhapatnam give horticulture and aquaculture timely export access, while communication supports IT and innovation.

Development of Transport

1. **Roads:** National highways and rural roads connect districts and the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor, though maintenance and urban congestion remain problems.
2. **Ports:** Visakhapatnam port handles rising cargo, but coastal shipping is underused.
3. **Electric mobility:** The Electric Mobility Policy (2018–23) aims to convert government fleets by 2024 and commercial fleets by 2030, with infrastructure in Vijayawada and Tirupati.
4. **Rail and waterways:** Rail faces capacity limits and inland waterways remain underdeveloped.

Development of Communication

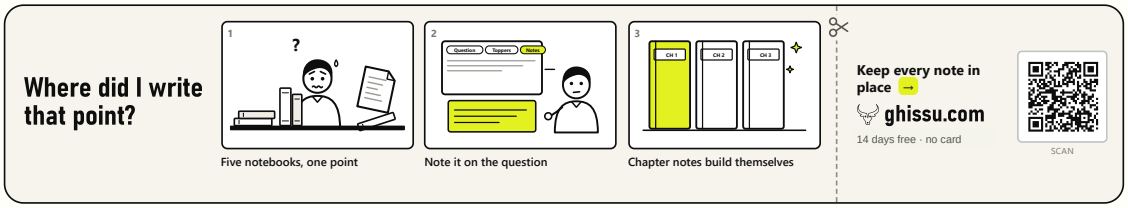
1. Digital connectivity: Wider internet and mobile access supports better India Innovation Index scores and ICT exports.
2. e-Governance: e-Seva provides G2C and B2C services, improving transparency.
3. Rural gaps: Weak rural connectivity limits digital education and healthcare for a large rural population.

Way Forward

1. Integrated planning: Build a multimodal transport strategy linking roads, rail, ports and waterways.
2. Stronger EV ecosystem: Raise public awareness, streamline approvals and upgrade power infrastructure to manage EV load.

Conclusion

Well-planned transport and communication networks can turn Andhra Pradesh's high growth into balanced, inclusive development.



P-III
15(a)

State the importance of service sector in the development of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The service sector has emerged as a pivotal driver of growth and development in Andhra Pradesh, especially after bifurcation. With GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25, above the national average, its role in employment, infrastructure and socio-economic upliftment is central to sustaining this momentum.

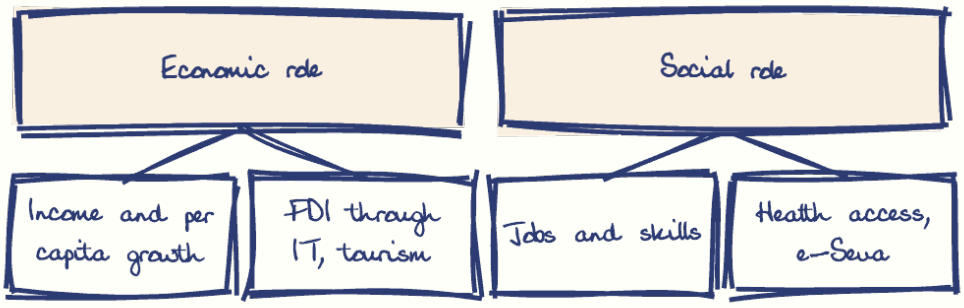
Economic Importance

1. **Income Growth:** Services contribute substantially to a GSDP of 8.73 lakh crore (2024–25) and underpin the state's higher per capita income of 2,68,653, above the national average.
2. **FDI and Global Integration:** IT and tourism attract FDI and integrate the state into the global economy.
3. **Public Administration:** A strong administrative subsector supports policy implementation and mobilisation of central transfers and taxes.
4. **Transport and Ports:** Corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai improve logistics and support shipping, warehousing and trade services.

Socio-Economic Importance

1. Employment and Human Development: Services absorb a large share of the workforce, and education services raise literacy and skills.
2. Health and Social Services: Janani Suraksha Yojana and Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust improve healthcare access, though CAG reports note specialist gaps.
3. Digital Governance: e-Seva improves transparency and efficiency in citizen services.
4. Knowledge Economy: IT, startups and R&D institutions foster innovation, building a knowledge economy.
5. Tourism: Cultural heritage and the coastline support labour-intensive employment under Vision 2029.

Why services matter for Andhra Pradesh



Challenges

1. Infrastructure: Power deficits and limited internet penetration constrain competitiveness and investment.
2. SPSEs: Service public sector enterprises, 6.69% of GSDP, face governance and arrears problems.

Way Forward

1. Digital Infrastructure: Expand internet coverage and digital literacy to support IT and e-governance.
2. Power and Transport: Address power deficits and improve transport to cut costs and attract investment.
3. SPSE Reform: Governance reforms for efficient public enterprises.

Conclusion

The service sector drives income, jobs, innovation and better public services in Andhra Pradesh, and links the state to national and global markets. Closing infrastructure gaps and reforming public enterprises will let it power inclusive growth and long-term development.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

Get your intro fixed on your sheet →
ghissu.com
14 days free · no card
SCAN

Write your own answer to 15(a) and get it evaluated →
Detailed, examiner-style feedback marked on your handwritten sheet · first 14 days of Pro free, no card needed
ghissu.com · APPSC Group-I Mains 2008 · printed in old-syllabus Paper III, now Paper IV

Scan to practice

P-III
15(b)

Write short notes on : (i) Kisan Credit Card Scheme (ii) Providing Urban Facilities in Rural Areas (PURA)

10

Introduction

Agriculture employs a large share of Indians but faces gaps in credit and rural infrastructure. The Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme and PURA tackle these, aiming to raise farm productivity and stem rural-urban migration through sustainable rural economies.

(i) Kisan Credit Card Scheme

1. **Comprehensive credit:** Launched in 1998, it gives timely short-term credit for crops and allied activities like animal husbandry and fisheries; loans are collateral-free up to Rs 2 lakh, with a total limit of Rs 5 lakh under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme.
2. **Wide reach:** 457 banks including RRBs and cooperatives; as of January 2024, over 7.75 crore accounts with about Rs 9.81 lakh crore outstanding.
3. **Risk cover:** Holders get personal accident insurance, reducing vulnerability beyond farm risks.
4. **Challenges:** Weak banking reach in remote

and tribal areas, misuse of funds and delays; in AP, drought-prone Rayalaseema still lags.

(ii) Providing Urban Facilities in Rural Areas (PURA)

1. Connectivity: Conceived by Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, it provides physical, electronic and knowledge connectivity: roads, electrification, communication and professional institutions.
2. Economic opportunity: Urban amenities like water, sanitation, health and education in villages reduce migration and create local jobs, building self-sufficient rural clusters.
3. Institutional support: A Central Sector scheme under the Ministry of Rural Development, with Asian Development Bank technical help and convergence of projects.
4. Limitations: Recent CAG audits in AP reveal gaps in solid waste management and sanitation compliance, which affect the quality of facilities and call for better governance.

Way Forward

1. KCC uptake: Awareness and digital literacy in rural and tribal AP to raise KCC uptake and proper use of credit.

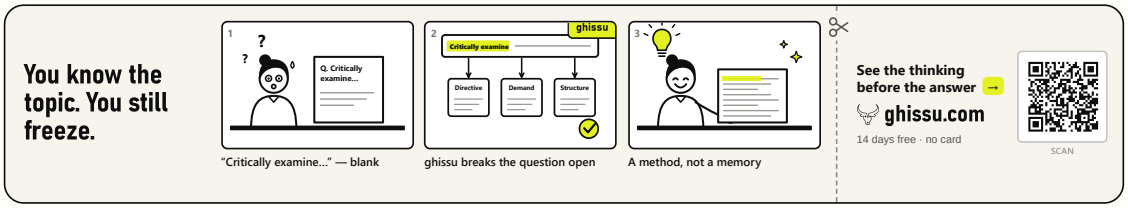
KCC vs PMKA

Kisan Credit Card	PMKA
Launched in 1998	Conceived by Dr. Kalam
Short-term farm credit	Rural connectivity, amenities
7.75 crore accounts	ADB technical support
Weak reach in Rayalaseema	Sanitation, waste lapses

2. FPOs: Help farmer producer organisations use KCC credit for collective investment in technology and markets.
3. PMKA governance: Align PMKA with state projects like Polavaram, with robust audits against fund diversion.

Conclusion

KCC and PMKA together improve financial access and urban-like amenities in villages. Implemented well, they empower farmers, reduce distress migration and foster inclusive growth.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER IV

Read an answer here. Write yours on ghissu.com.

This book collects 232 previous year questions of Paper IV, Economy and Development of India and Andhra Pradesh, from eight sittings between 2008 and 2025. Each answer is written to the length an aspirant can produce in the exam hall: three pages, an introduction that meets the demand, structured body points, a diagram or map where it earns its place, and a conclusion.

IN THIS BOOK

- Questions numbered exactly as in the official papers
- Arranged paper-wise and year-wise under the latest syllabus
- Old-syllabus questions placed in the paper they belong to today
- A clickable index and a link to practice every question

ON GHISSU.COM

- Subject, topic and sub-topic-wise PYQs with UPSC questions (1979 to 2026)
- Answer evaluation with detailed feedback in minutes
- Exam-hall thinking, toppers' answers and value additions
- Ask Ghissu and the Ghissu bull, in your own language

FOLLOW GHISSU @tryghissu

WhatsApp / Telegram: 85228 64298

TELEGRAM

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sri Charan Vegireddi studied Mathematics and Computing Engineering at DTU, New Delhi, and has written two UPSC Civil Services Mains, two APPSC Group-I Mains and one APPSC Group-II Mains. As Mentor-cum-Head Reviewer at Vajiram & Ravi, New Delhi, he headed the evaluation of its Mains Test Series, reviewed more than 10,000 answer copies, trained over 600 evaluators and mentored more than 100 aspirants.

Continue on ghissu.com

1. Open ghissu.com and sign in.
2. Join the waitlist. Requests are usually approved within one or two days.
3. Open any question from this book and start writing.

SCAN TO BEGIN

Ghissu

A free resource. Share it with an aspirant.

Questions are reproduced from the official APPSC question papers for educational use.
© 2026 Ghissu · hello@ghissu.com